Russian, Step by Step, Root by Root

A gentle, etymology-driven introduction to Russian

Adhithya Rajasekaran

Starter edition — thirteen cumulative chapters of short lessons.

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Preface

This book teaches Russian one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It assumes no Russian and no Cyrillic. Every section takes one small expression, introduces only the letters, sounds, or grammar that expression needs, connects it to history you may already know, and ends by asking for it back.

Russian is a Slavic language, a cousin of English far enough back that the family resemblance survives in surprising places — *three* is *tri*, *sister* is *sestrá* — and it is worth knowing which resemblances are real and which are traps. This book flags both.

Stress matters enormously in Russian, and ordinary Cyrillic does not print it. So the romanization here marks the stressed vowel with an acute accent, and then gradually yields to the script as you come to read it.

This is a starter edition: thirteen chapters, complete in themselves, with more being written. Chapters 1 and 2 were written straight into LaTeX; chapters 3 to 13 are generated from the same lesson files the audio course reads, so the printed page and the spoken lesson cannot drift apart.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Russian out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real

words from the first page rather than drilling a chart.

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Chapter 1

Greetings and courtesy

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (6) **pen** (10) **Hands-free start:** the first 7 of 17 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone in Russian, respond courteously, and close the exchange naturally.
>
> *Complete RU-C01-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint, and demonstrate the chapter promise: greet someone in Russian, respond courteously, and close the exchange naturally, then write its ten letters and two of its words from sound alone.*

1.1 Privét — "hi," the everyday hello

> Your first Russian word and Cyrillic letters. Several shapes are **false friends** that look Latin but sound different; meet them head-on.

The letters in this word

(If you already read Cyrillic, skim this.) Russian is written **left to right**, like English. Six letters spell *privét*; meet three of them now:

- п = "p" — think Greek **pi** (Π), not Latin p.
- р = **"r"** — a rolled r. **FALSE FRIEND:** it looks like Latin *p* but says *r* (it's Greek **rho**).
- в = **"v"** — **FALSE FRIEND:** looks like Latin *B* but says *v*.

The other three, and the whole written word, arrive over this chapter. Say **privét** with the stress on the second syllable; Russian never writes its stress marks, so you learn the stress *with* the word.

Two false friends in one short word — р=r and в=v — are the two you'll trip on most. Fix them now and half of Cyrillic stops fooling you.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Privét is built from *pri-* ("at, to, up against") + the old root *-vet* ("to speak, to counsel"). The picture is *a word brought to you* — a greeting handed over.
That root *-vet* is quietly everywhere in Russian, and it hides a word you already know in English:

- *sovét* = "a speaking-together" → **council, advice**. Borrowed into English as **Soviet** — the *Soviet* Union was literally the *Council* Union.
- *otvét* = "a speaking-back" → **an answer**.
- *obét* = "a vow."

So *privét* is a cousin of **Soviet** — the same "speak" root, one a friendly hello, the other the most famous Russian word in English.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Russian *privét*, Spanish *hola*, French *salut*, German *hallo*, and English *hi* fill the casual slot. Russian draws the line sharply: use *privét* with friends and the next lesson's formal greeting with everyone else.

Why it's said this way

Privét is **informal** — warm, but only for people you'd address casually. To a stranger, an elder, a shopkeeper, or your boss, it can sound too familiar; there you reach for *zdrávstvuyte*. Russian draws the formal/informal line more strictly than English does, and greetings are where you first feel it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- p · r · i · v · ye · t → "privét," stress the *vyet*
- which letter looks like Latin B but says "v" (в), and which looks like Latin p but says "r" (р)
- "privét" to a friend

Before you move on

Which letter looks like Latin B, and which looks like Latin p? What does each really say? (в says v, р says r — the two false friends.) Is it formal or informal? (Informal — friends only.) And what famous English word shares its *-vet* "speak" root? (*Soviet*, from *sovét*, "a council.")

1.2 Zdrávstvuyte — "be healthy," the formal hello

You can say *privét* to a friend. Now the word for everyone else — longer, older, and worth the effort.

What to know first

- the *privét* lesson — this is its formal opposite, and it reuses в=v and р=r from there.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) It's a long word, and you already know two of its letters, р and в. Meet three more now:

- з = "z" — looks like the digit **3**.
- с = **"s"** — **FALSE FRIEND:** looks like Latin *C* but says *s* (Greek **sigma**).
- у = **"oo"** (as in *boot*) — **FALSE FRIEND:** looks like Latin *y* but says *oo*.

Its other letters arrive with this chapter's next words; the whole written word waits until every one of them is yours.

A pronunciation mercy: the first *v* is **silent** here — natives say *"zdrás-tvuy-tye,"* dropping the *v* in *-vstv-*. Nobody articulates all those consonants.

zdrávstvuyte (“ZDRAST-vooy-tye”)

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Zdrávstvuyte is a wish for **health**. Its core is *zdoróvye* (“health”) / *zdoróv* (“healthy”) — so the greeting literally means **“be healthy!”** You are, politely, wishing wellness on the person in front of you.

- *-te* on the end is the **plural/polite ending** — the same *-te* that makes a command respectful. Drop it and you get the informal singular *zdrávstvuy*.

An honest note on cousins: Russian *zdoróvye* (“health”) is **not** related to English *health* — they come from different roots (English *health/whole/hale* is Germanic). The *idea* is the shared one: many languages greet by wishing **health** (Latin *salve* = “be well,” the ancestor of Spanish *hola*’s cousin *salud*) or **peace** (Arabic *salām*, Hebrew *shalom*). Russian picked health.

Grammar Lens — Russian’s formal *you* is plural

The *-te* ending here is your first taste of a rule that runs through Russian: **politeness = plural.** To address one person formally, Russian uses the *plural* “you” (*vy*) and plural verb endings — exactly like French *vous* or the *usted* idea in Spanish. So *zdrávstvuy-**te*** is “be healthy” said to a *vy* — one respected person, addressed as if plural.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ZDRAST-vooy-tye” — let the first в go silent
- which two false friends appear here (с = s, у = oo)
- “zdrávstvuyte” to a stranger; “privét” to a friend

Before you move on

Say *zdrávstvuyte*. What does it literally wish? (Health — “be healthy.”) Formal or informal, and how do you know? (Formal — the polite plural *-te*.) What do с and у each sound like? (s and oo

— two false friends.)

1.3 да (da) — “yes”

Two greetings so far, one casual and one formal. The next two words are the shortest in the chapter and the most used in the language.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) Just two, both new and both heard in *zdrávstvuyte*: д (d, from Greek delta Δ) + а (a, as in *father*) — the one vowel that looks *and* sounds like Latin a.

да = **da** — short, clear, stressed. The easiest word in the language to read.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

да is an old Slavic да that has always meant “yes.” But it moonlights: Russians sprinkle да through speech as a soft **“and / so / well...”** or a tag —

- *nu da* = “well, yeah.”
- *«*да*?»* on the end of a sentence = “...right?” (like French *n’est-ce pas?*).

So the first word you can *say* is also one of the most common little glue-words in the language.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Every language improvised its own “yes,” and you can hear where each one came from:

- Russian да — an old Slavic affirmative.
- Spanish **sí** — Latin *sic*, “thus, so.”
- French **oui** — Latin *hoc ille*, “that’s it.”

- German **ja** — old Germanic *ja*.
- Latin **ita** or **sic** — "thus, so."

Notice how many languages say "yes" with a word that means **"so / thus"** (*sí*, *sic*, *ita*). Russian's да is its own thing — but its side-job as a "so/and" word rhymes with that pattern.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "da"
- *nu da* — "well, yeah"
- which letter is д (d) and which is а (a)

Before you move on

Read it: да Two letters — name their sounds (d, a). Besides "yes," what else does да do in a sentence? (Works as a soft "and / well… / right?")

1.4 нет (nyet) — "no," literally "there-is-not"

Say *da*. One syllable, no trap in it. Its opposite has a trap.

What to know first

- *da* — its opposite, learned together as a pair.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) Three letters: н · е · т.

- н = **"n"** — **FALSE FRIEND:** it looks exactly like Latin *H* but says *n*.
- е = "ye" (as in *yes*) — looks like Latin e, but carries a *y*-glide; it is the *ye* of *privét*.

- т = "t" — like Latin T.

  нет = **nyet** ("nyeht") — one syllable, stressed, with a soft *y* onset.

That н=n is the last of the big four false friends (н=n; the other three say *v*, *r* and *s*). Learn those four and Cyrillic stops disguising itself as Latin.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нет is a **compression of a whole clause**. Vasmer traces it to older *ne je tu*, **"not is here."**

- не (*nye*) — the negator, **"not."**
- *je* — an old "is", the verb of English *is*.
- *tu* — "here", as in *tut*.

So Russian's "no" is "**not-is-here**", worn down to one syllable. (Its longer form *nyétu*, "there isn't any," still shows the seam.)
And that little не is one of the deepest words in the whole Indo-European family — the ancient negation ***ne**. You already own a dozen of its English children:

> не ↔ English **no, not, none, never, nay, neither** ↔ Latin **nōn** ↔ Sanskrit **na** ↔ French **non**.

When you say нет, you are pronouncing a cousin of *no* that has meant "not" for six thousand years.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Unlike "yes" — where every language improvised — the world's "no" is astonishingly **one word**, stretched across the whole family. Russian нет carries не; English says **no** and **not**; Latin said *nōn*, French says *non*, Sanskrit said *na*. All of them are the same ancient **ne*, and нет is Russia's share of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nyet"
- which letter looks like Latin H but says "n" (н)
- "*da*… нет" — yes, then no

Before you move on

Read it: нет What clause is it worn down from? (Older *ne je tu*, "not is here.") What does н sound like — and what does it *look* like? (Says n, looks like Latin H.) Name two English cousins of не. (no, not, never, none, nay…)

1.5 спасибо (spasíbo) — "God save you," now just "thanks"

You can greet someone. Now thank them — and this word has a whole sentence folded inside it.

What to know first

- *privét* — to contrast б (b) with the B-shaped letter you met there, which says *v*.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) Six letters: с · п · а · с · и · б · о.

- с = "s" (the false friend), п = "p", а = "a" — all met already.
- и = "ee," like a backwards Latin N; о = "o".
- б = **"b"** — meet the partner that ends the confusion: б is *b*, while the very similar-looking letter in *privét* is *v*. One has an open belly (б = b); the other stacks two bowls and says *v*.

A sound note: the first о is *unstressed*, so it **reduces** toward "a" — natives say *"spa-SEE-ba."* Unstressed Russian о almost always softens to an *a*-ish sound. Stress lands on -си-.

спасибо = **spasíbo** ("spa-SEE-ba")

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спасибо is a **frozen prayer**. It is a worn-down contraction of *spasí Bog* — **"God save [you]"**:

- спаси — "save!", the command form of *spasti* ("to save, rescue").
- *Bog* — **"God."**

Over centuries *spasí Bog* fused and shed its final consonant into today's спасибо. You are, etymologically, blessing whoever helped you. Courtesy words are often fossilised blessings — Spanish **adiós** is *a Dios*, English **goodbye** is *God be with ye*. спасибо belongs to that family: a little "God save you," said so often the prayer wore invisible.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- Russian спасибо — **"God save you."**
- Spanish **gracias** — Latin *gratia*, "grace."
- French **merci** — Latin *merces*, "reward, mercy."
- German **danke** — "think of, be mindful."
- English **thank you** — "think": I'll hold you in thought.

Every culture built "thanks" from a different metaphor — grace, reward, mindful thought — and Russian built it from a **blessing**.

Why it's said this way

Because it began as *spasí Bog*, older or very devout speakers sometimes still feel the "God" in it; a few religious communities prefer *blagodaryú* ("I give a blessing," a calque of Greek *eucharistō*). But in everyday modern Russian, спасибо is simply **the** word for thanks, its prayer long dissolved.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "spa-SEE-ba" — reduce that first о to an *a*

- which letter is b (б), and what the two-bowled letter of *privét* says (v)
- "спасибо" — and recall the hidden *spasí Bog*

Before you move on

Read it: спасибо What two words is it worn down from, and what do they mean? (*spasí Bog* — "God save [you].") Which other courtesy words are fossilised blessings? (*adiós* = to God; *goodbye* = God be with ye.) Does б say b or v? (b.)

1.6 пожалуйста (pozhálusta) — "please," and also "you're welcome"

Say *spasíbo*. The word that answers it, and asks for things, is the longest you have met — and shorter than it looks when spoken.

What to know first

- *spasíbo* — this is its natural partner: *spasíbo* → пожалуйста is Russia's "thank you" → "you're welcome."

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) Everything here is familiar except one new letter: пожалуйста.

- ж = **"zh"** — the sound in *mea**s**ure*. It looks like a little beetle with wings; no Latin letter carries this sound.
- The rest you know: п(p) о(o) а(a) л(l) у(oo) й(y) с(s) т(t).

A big pronunciation mercy: nobody says all four middle syllables. The written пожалуйста is spoken **"pa-ZHAL-sta,"** swallowing the -уй- entirely, and the first о reduces to *a*.

пожалуйста = **pozhálusta**, said *"pa-ZHAL-sta"*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пожалуйста is пожалуй + a softening tag -ста. пожалуй is either the command form of the old verb *zhálovat'*, "to grant, to bestow a favour", or a worn-down *pozhálu(yu)*, "I grant" (Vasmer gives both) — on the root жал-, often linked to *zhal'*, "a pity".
So under the politeness sits **"grant [me this], do me the kindness."** English **please** is the same idea worn down — short for *if it please you*. It also does a job English splits off: the **reply to thanks**. Where English needs a separate "you're welcome," Russian answers *spasíbo* with пожалуйста.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

- Russian пожалуйста — "grant [me] a favour."
- French **s'il vous plaît** — "if it pleases you."
- Spanish **por favor** — "for a favour."
- English **please** — "[if it] please [you]."
- German **bitte** — "I request," and also "you're welcome."

German *bitte* pulls the same double shift — one word for both "please" and "you're welcome."

Why it's said this way

Because it is really a request for a kindness, пожалуйста also softens commands: add it to an instruction and a bark becomes a request. And as the answer to *spasíbo*, it closes the ritual of thanks the way *"you're welcome"* does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pa-ZHAL-sta" — drop the middle -уй-
- the new sound ж (the *zh* in *measure*)
- the exchange — "spasíbo!" … "пожалуйста!"

Before you move on

Read it: пожалуйста What favour-root hides inside it? (*zhálovat'*, "to grant a favour" — linked to *zhal'*, "pity.") What two English phrases does this one word cover? ("please" **and** "you're welcome.") What sound does ж make? (*zh*, as in *measure*.)

1.7 Chapter 1 — putting it together

Six words, all of them now in your ear and your mouth. The writing lessons that follow put their letters in your hand; first, prove you can say every one.

Sounds you'll need

Four letters in these words look Latin and lie. You will write them next; for now, say each sound aloud:

- the letter shaped like a Latin B says **v** — as in *privét*.
- the letter shaped like a Latin P says **r** — as in *privét*.
- the letter shaped like a Latin C says **s** — as in *spasíbo*.
- the letter shaped like a Latin H says **n** — as in *nyet*.

And the two vowel traps: the letter shaped like a Latin y says "oo", and the one shaped like a Latin e says "ye."

Your turn — say them cold

Say each, then what it means:

- *privét* (hi)
- *zdrávstvuyte* (hello, formal)
- *spasíbo* (thank you)
- *da* (yes)
- *nyet* (no)
- *pozhálusta* (please / you're welcome)

The exchange

Run the whole ritual, formal then informal:

- Meet a stranger: *Zdrávstvuyte!*
- They thank you: *Spasíbo!* → you answer *Pozhálusta!*
- A friend waves: *Privét!*
- Answer a question: *Da!* … or *Nyet!*

What you've built — the thread through the chapter

Every word carried a hidden story:

- *privét* shares its *-vet* "speak" root with **Soviet** (*sovét*, a council).
- *zdrávstvuyte* wishes you **health**; *spasíbo* blesses you (*God save you*).
- *nyet* is the ancient ***ne** you already own in *no, not, never.*
- *pozhálusta* asks for a **favour** — and doubles as "you're welcome."

Before you move on

Without looking: which greeting is formal and which is informal? (*zdrávstvuyte / privét.*) Which word answers *spasíbo*? (*pozhálusta.*) Name the four false-friend letters and their real sounds. (The B-shape says v, the P-shape r, the C-shape s, the H-shape n.)

1.8 в and р — writing the two great false friends

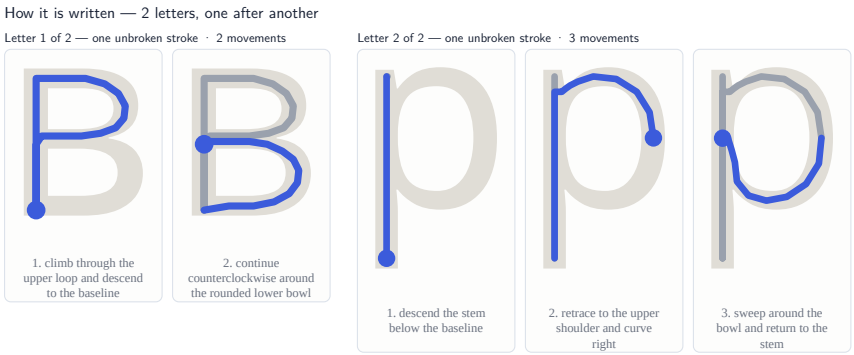
You *read* these two in привет. Now you'll **write** them. в and р are the letters that fool every beginner — they wear Latin faces (*B* and *P*) but say *v* and *r*. Forming them by hand is the fastest way to stop your eye from lying to you.

Why it's said this way

Both came from **Greek**, not Latin, so the shape and the sound drifted apart:

- в is Greek **beta** — beta made the "v" sound in later Greek, and Cyrillic kept it. It looks like Latin *B*; it says **v**.
- р is Greek **rho** — always an "r." It looks like Latin *P*; it says a rolled **r**.

Writing — break it apart, then write it



Letter 1: stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase в demonstration, 01:33–01:38, YouTube, 5 February 2013
Letter 2: stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase р demonstration, 06:46–06:52, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: в, р

в ("v") — *a vertical, then two stacked bowls*:

1. **the vertical** — a straight downstroke, top to bottom.
2. **the upper bowl** — from the top of the vertical, bulge out right and back in.
3. **the lower bowl** — from the middle, a second belly out to the base.

Two bellies stacked on a spine — that's what tells в apart from Latin *B* (one belly) and from Russian б (which you'll meet next).

р ("r") — *a vertical that drops below the line, then a top loop*:

1. **the vertical** — a downstroke that sinks **below** the baseline (like the tail of Latin *p*).
2. **the loop** — a single closed bump at the **top**, on the right.

So р is drawn like a Latin lowercase *p*, tail and all — but it is an **r**.

Their capitals, В and Р, are the same shapes drawn to full height, with Р sitting on the line. They look even more like Latin *B* and *P*, and they still say *v* and *r*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* trace в — "vertical, upper bowl, lower bowl" — and say its sound, "v"
- *Say it:* trace р — "vertical below the line, top loop" — and say its sound, "r"
- *Write it:* привет slowly, pausing on the в and the р

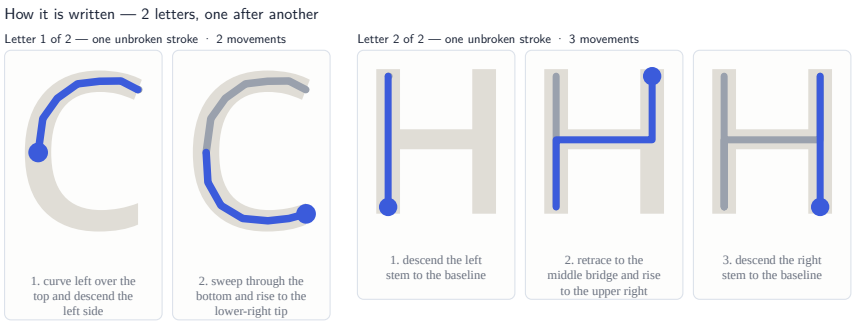
Before you move on

Draw в from its three strokes — what sound? ("v"; a vertical + two stacked bowls.) Draw р — what sound, and which Greek letter? ("r"; Greek **rho**.) Which Latin letters do they *look* like, and why is that a trap? (*B* and *P* — they're Greek by descent, so the shapes stayed but the sounds didn't.) Next: the other two false friends, с and н.

1.9 с and н — the last two false friends

Two more letters that wear a Latin mask. с looks like Latin *C* but says **s**; н looks like Latin *H* but says **n**. You've already read them — с opens спасибо, н opens нет — now write them and the four-letter false-friend set (в р с н) is complete.

Writing — break it apart, then write it



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: С, Н

С (“s”) — *a single open curve*:

1. **the curve** — one stroke: start top-right, sweep left and down like a *C*, open on the right.

That’s the whole letter — a lone crescent. It **is** the shape of Latin *C*, but it comes from **Greek sigma** (the “s” sound). Think of it as the “s” hiding inside the English word *centre* said the soft way — *c* that sounds like *s*.

Н (“n”) — *two verticals joined by a middle bar* (a Latin *H* shape):

1. **the left vertical** — a downstroke.
2. **the cross bar** — a short horizontal joining the two uprights **in the middle** (not slanted like a Latin *N*).
3. **the right vertical** — a second downstroke, parallel to the first.

So Н is drawn exactly like a capital *H* — two posts and a rung — but it is an **n**. (Russian’s letter for the *H*-sound doesn’t exist; the “h” of foreign words is usually spelled with Г or Х.)

The capital of с is С, the same crescent drawn to full height, and it still says *s*.

Script — the four false friends, together

letter	looks like	actually says, and from
в	Latin B	**v**, from Greek beta
р	Latin P	**r**, from Greek rho
с	Latin C	**s**, from Greek sigma
н	Latin H	**n**

Learn these four and the rest of Cyrillic stops ambushing you — most other letters either look foreign (so you can't be fooled) or behave.

Your turn

- *Say it:* trace с — "one open curve" — sound "s"
- *Say it:* trace н — "left post, middle rung, right post" — sound "n"
- *Write it:* спасибо (find the с) and нет (find the н)

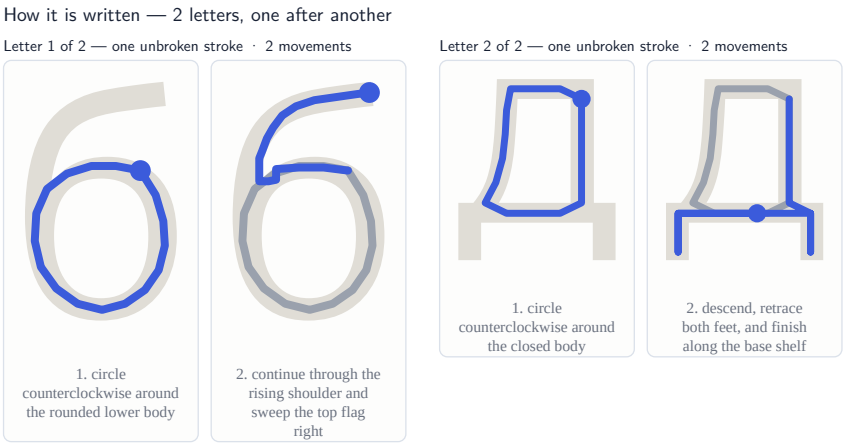
Before you move on

Draw с — one stroke, what sound and which Latin look-alike? ("s"; looks like *C.*) Draw н — three strokes, what sound and look-alike? ("n"; looks like *H.*) Name all four false friends and their sounds. (в=v, р=r, с=s, н=n.) Next: two letters with **no** Latin disguise — б and д.

1.10 б and д — letters that hide nothing

A relief after the false friends: б ("b") and д ("d") look like **nothing in Latin**, so they can't trick you — you just have to learn to draw them. You've read both already: б sits in спасибо, д opens да.

Script — б (“b”) — and how it differs from в



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: б, д

б and в are cousins (both from Greek **beta**, which split into a “b” letter and a “v” letter). They share a **vertical spine**, so keep them apart by their tops:

- в (v) = spine + **two stacked bowls** (both bellies face right).
- б (b) = spine + **one lower belly** + a **flag/hat** curving off the **top**.

Break б apart — *a vertical, a lower belly, a top flag*:

1. **the vertical** — a downstroke.
2. **the belly** — one bowl bulging right from the **lower** half.
3. **the top flag** — a short stroke off the top, curving **right** (the “hat” that в doesn’t have).

That top flag is the whole difference: б has a hat and one belly; в has no hat and two bellies.

Script — д (“d”) — the delta on little feet

д comes from Greek **delta** (Δ), the triangle — and you can still feel the triangle in it. Break it apart — *a body, then two little feet*:

1. **the body** — a rounded/looped shape sitting on the baseline (think a small *delta* or a curled *g*-like body).
2. **the feet** — two little legs dropping **below** the baseline, one at each corner of the base.

Those two descending feet are д’s signature — no Latin letter has them. Say “delta” as you draw it and the shape sticks.

Their capitals: Б keeps the belly but swaps the curling flag for a straight bar across the top; Д is the delta on its feet, drawn to full height.

Your turn

- *Say it:* trace б — “spine, lower belly, top flag” — sound “b” — then в for contrast (“two bellies, no hat”)
- *Say it:* trace д — “body, two feet below the line” — sound “d”, from delta
- *Write it:* спасибо (find the б) and да (the д)

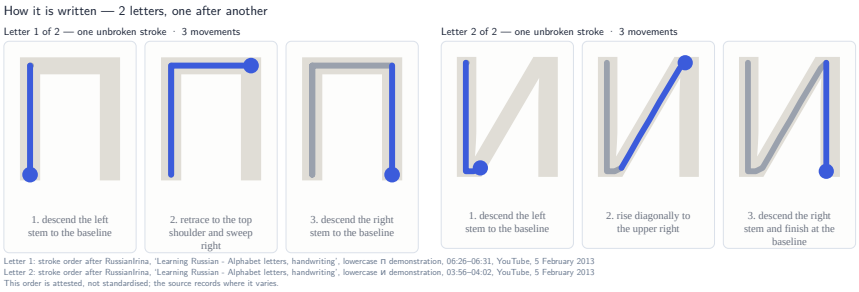
Before you move on

What one stroke separates б from в? (The **top flag/hat** — б has it, and one belly; в has two bellies, no hat.) Draw д — what sound, from which Greek letter, and what’s its signature? (“d”; from **delta**; the two little feet below the line.) You can now hand-write every letter in привет, спасибо, да, and нет.

1.11 п and и — filling in привет

You can already hand-write the в and the р of привет. Now take two more of its letters: п (“p”) and и (“ee”). One is an honest Greek shape; the other is a **quiet false friend** — it looks like a Latin *N*.

Script — п (“p”) — the Greek gate



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: п, и

п is Greek **pi** (Π), the letter mathematicians write for 3.14…. It’s an honest letter: it looks like a little gateway and says **“p.”**

Break it apart — *two verticals joined by a top bar*:

1. **the left vertical** — a downstroke.
2. **the top bar** — a short horizontal across the top.
3. **the right vertical** — a second downstroke, parallel to the first.

A doorway shape: two posts and a lintel. (Don’t confuse it with н — that one’s bar sits in the **middle**, this one’s sits on **top**.)

Script — и (“ee”) — the backwards N

и says **“ee”** (as in *meet*) — a vowel. But watch out: it looks almost exactly like a **Latin N with the diagonal reversed**. That’s the quiet trap — your eye reads “N,” but it’s a vowel.

Break it apart — *two verticals joined by a rising diagonal*:

1. **the left vertical** — a downstroke.
2. **the diagonal** — from the **bottom** of the left vertical **up** to the top of the right (rising left-to-right — the mirror of Latin *N*, whose diagonal **falls**).
3. **the right vertical** — a downstroke.

So the tell between и and Latin *N* is which way the diagonal leans: и rises, *N* falls. (Later you’ll meet й — an и with a little breve on top, “ee-y.”)

Their capitals, П and И, are the same shapes drawn to full height. So is Н, the capital of н, with its bar still in the middle.

Your turn

- *Say it:* trace п — "left post, top bar, right post" — sound "p"
- *Say it:* trace и — "left post, rising diagonal, right post" — sound "ee"
- *Write it:* the start of привет — п · р · и · … — three letters down

Before you move on

Draw п — what sound and which Greek letter? ("p"; Greek **pi** Π.) Draw и — what sound, and how do you tell it from Latin *N*? ("ee"; its diagonal **rises** left-to-right, where *N*'s falls.) Which letter has its bar on top, п or н? (п — top bar; н — middle bar.) Next: е and т, and you'll have all of привет.

1.12 е and т — the last two letters of привет

The finish line. е and т are two of Cyrillic's most **honest** letters — they look like their Latin twins *and* sound close to them. Learn these and you can hand-write the whole of привет from memory.

Script — е ("ye") — the honest vowel

е looks like a Latin **e** and sounds close to one — with a small twist: at the start of a syllable it carries a **y**-glide, "**ye**" (as in *yes*). So привет ends *…v-**ye**-t*. (Letters that add a *y*-onset like this are called *iotated* — е, ё, ю, я are the family; you'll meet the others in Chapter 2.)

Break it apart — *a curve, then a middle bar* (exactly like writing a Latin *e*):

1. **the curve** — start top-right, sweep left, curl down and round.
2. **the middle bar** — the short horizontal that closes the *e*.

No trap here: what you see is what you get.

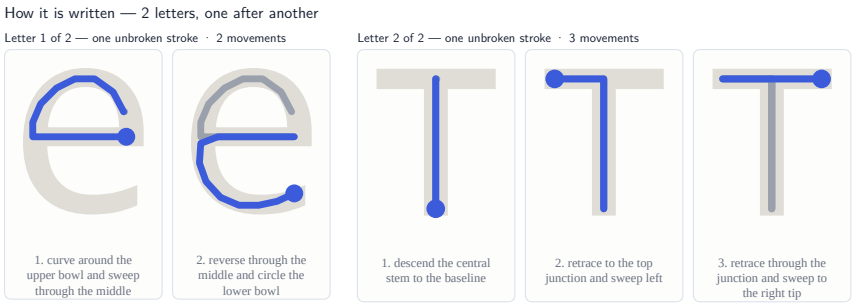
Script — т ("t") — Greek tau, honest too

т is Greek **tau**, and it looks and sounds like Latin **T**: a crossbar on a stem. (In *handwriting* Russians often make lowercase т look like an *m* with a bar over it, but the printed citation form is the clean T-shape you see here.)

Break it apart — *a central downstroke, then a top bar*:

1. **the downstroke** — a vertical stem.
2. **the top bar** — a horizontal across the top, centred on the stem.

Writing — now write the whole word



How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: е, т

You now own every letter of привет:

п (p) · р (r) · и (ee) · в (v) · е (ye) · т (t) = *privét*

Two of them are false friends (р=r, в=v), one is a quiet one (и=ee), and three are honest (**п, е, т**). Write it slowly, naming each letter's sound.

Your turn

- *Say it:* trace е — "curve, middle bar" — sound "ye"
- *Say it:* trace т — "downstroke, top bar" — sound "t", Greek tau
- *Write it:* the full word — привет — start to finish, from memory

Before you move on

Draw е — what sound, and what does *iotated* mean? ("Ye"; it carries a *y*-onset.) Draw т — what sound and which Greek letter? ("t"; Greek **tau**.) Spell out the letters of привет with their sounds. (п-р-и-в-е-т = p-r-i-v-ye-t.) You can now hand-write your first Russian word end to end.

1.13 привет — watch one word move

Look at привет. Point from left to right and say the six sounds slowly: *p, r, ee, v, ye, t.* Every shape is already known.

Writing — observe and trace

Keep привет visible. Trace it once with a finger or a capped pen. Pause on р and say *r*; pause on в and say *v*. Stop after one careful trace.

Before you move on

Read привет once. Today was observation, not a memory test.

1.14 привет — one supported copy

Keep привет visible. Point to its two traps: р says *r* and в says *v*. You may look back after every letter.

Writing — guided copy

Copy привет once. Use three small chunks: при · ве · т. After each chunk, look back and compare only those letters. Then read the finished word.

Before you move on

Stop after one supported copy. Hiding the model belongs to the next lesson.

1.15 привет — look, hide, write, compare

Look at привет for five seconds. Touch the three chunks при · ве · т. Do not copy while the model is visible.

Writing — delayed copy

- cover привет
- wait five seconds
- write it once from memory
- uncover the model and compare one chunk at a time

Circle and repair one differing letter if needed. Repair is part of retrieval.

Before you move on

Read the repaired word once. Stop after one memory attempt.

1.16 One heard greeting — write what you know

Cover the answer lower on this page. You will hear one familiar informal greeting. No new Russian and no new Cyrillic shape is hiding here.

Writing — short dictation

Hear: privét — informal "hi"

Write the Russian word from sound alone. Do not use a visible model or romanization. Now uncover and compare: привет. Check р and в first, then the other four letters. Repair one place if needed.

Before you move on

This completes a tiny writing runway, not an exam simulation. Later work must grow from one word to messages, connected composition, and timed production.

1.17 Chapter 1 checkpoint — say it, know the letters, write it

> Nothing new arrives here. This checks what the chapter built: the spoken exchange, ten letters, and two words from sound alone. First: which greeting goes to a friend, and which to a stranger? (Привет; *zdrávstvuyte.*)

The exchange — formal, then informal

With a stranger:

- *Zdrávstvuyte!* — and it comes back to you.
- Спасибо! (*Spasíbo!*) — *Pozhálusta!*

With a friend:

- Привет! (*Privét!*)
- Да! (*Da!*) or Нет. (*Nyet.*)

Only the greeting changes between the scenes. That one choice is the whole of the register so far.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the stranger's scene, both voices — *Zdrávstvuyte!* … Спасибо*!* … *Pozhálusta!*
- the friend's scene — Привет*!* — then yes, then no: Да*!* … Нет.

Script — ten letters, three kinds

- **False friends**: в р с н look like Latin *B, P, C, H* and say **v, r, s, n**.
- **A quiet false friend**: и looks like a reversed *N* and says **ee**.
- **New shapes**: б (a flag on top) says **b**; д (two feet below the line) says **d**.
- **Honest letters**: п е т say **p, ye, t**.

Read it: the ten letters aloud by their sounds — в р с н и б д п е т

Writing — from sound alone

Cover: the letter list above and the key below, so no model and no romanization stays in view

Hear: v, r, s, n, ee — b, d — p, ye, t
Write it: one Cyrillic letter for each sound, ten in all
Hear: privét — "hi" — and *nyet* — "no"
Write it: both words
Check: against the key — в р с н и, б д, п е т, привет, нет
The usual slip is the Latin hand taking over: *r* for р, *n* for н, *i* for и.
Write it: one repaired letter, then stop

Before you move on

Which word answers спасибо? (*Pozhálusta.*) Name the four false friends by their real sounds. (v, r, s, n.) Which letter wears a flag on top, and which stands on two feet? (б; д.) That is the chapter: a greeting for each kind of person, the courtesy after it, and ten letters on demand.

Chapter 2

Introducing yourself

Modes: **voice** (9) **eyes** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give my name in Russian, ask for someone else's, and pick ты or вы to match how well I know them.
>
> *Run the whole introduction with a stranger — greet, ask* Как вас зовут*?, answer* Меня зовут*…, close with* Очень приятно *— then switch it for one friend by changing only the greeting and* вас → тебя.

2.1 я — "I"

> The shortest word in the chapter: one letter, one sound, and a pedigree of about six thousand years.

You'll want to know first — я

> я — *ya* — **I**

That is the whole word. A single letter, pronounced *ya*.

It is a **new letter** — the writing track has taught в, р, с, н, б, д, п, и, е and т, and hasn't reached я. *Read it:* я here

You'll draw it when the track gets there. And be careful with its shape. **я looks like a mirrored Latin R and has nothing to do with R.** (It descends from ѧ, the "little yus" — not from R at all.)

It is also the **last** letter of the alphabet, 33rd of 33, and Russian has a rebuke built on that: «*Ya — poslédnyaya búkva v alfavíte*», "я is the last letter of the alphabet." You say it to someone who talks about themselves too much. The letter's position is the joke — don't put yourself first.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pronouns are the **least borrowable** part of a language. Nouns come and go by the thousand — *sputnik*, *pizza*, *computer* — but nobody borrows a word for *I*. So **я** has simply been inherited, without interruption, for as long as there has been an Indo-European family: Russian **я**, Latin *ego*, German *ich*, English **I**, Greek *egṓ*.
All from PIE **eǵh₂(om)*. Russian's route ran through Proto-Slavic **azŭ*, which East Slavic reshaped — a *j-* was added at the front (**azŭ* → **yazŭ*) and the ending fell away — leaving the **one letter** you now say. It is the most extreme change in the family, and the reason **я** sounds nothing like *ego* while being the same word.
Latin *ego* is the one English borrowed back, whole and untranslated, for the part of the mind that says *I*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**я**" — *ya*
- the family — "**я** … *ego* … *ich* … **I**"
- the erosion — "**azŭ* … **я**"

Before you move on

Say "I". (**я** — one letter, said *ya*.) What must you not mistake it for? (A **Latin R** — the shape is a coincidence.) Why has it changed so little in meaning? (**Pronouns are the least borrowable words** a language has.) Name three relatives. (*Ego*, *ich*, *I* — and Greek *egṓ*.) What did Russian's come from? (Proto-Slavic **azŭ*, with a *j-* added at the front and the ending lost.) Next: the two words for "you."

2.2 ты, вы — the two words for "you"

Chapter 1 gave you two ways to say hello, split by formality. That split runs through the whole language — and here is the place it matters most: Russian has **two words for "you."**

The two words

> **ТЫ** — *ty* — you, one person you're familiar with. **ВЫ** — *vy* — you, formal, **or** more than one person.

Both turn on **Ы**, which is the hardest vowel in Russian for an English speaker: not the *ee* of **ТЫ**'s look-alike, but a tighter, further-back sound made with the tongue pulled towards the throat. Say English *ill*, then try to say it with your tongue drawn back. The writing track hasn't reached **Ы** either.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Pronouns are the **least borrowable** part of a language. Nouns come and go; *I* and *you* stay. So the first two line up almost too neatly:

- **Я** (last lesson) — Latin *ego*, English **I**, German *ich*.
- **ТЫ** — Latin *tū*, English **thou**, German *du*.
- **ВЫ** — Latin *vōs*, with no English or German survivor to set beside it.

The first two lines are the same word four times over. **The third is only half a set**: **ВЫ** and *vōs* both continue PIE **wos*, but English *you* and German *ihr* come from the **other** stem in that paradigm, **yūs*. Cousins, not twins — worth marking rather than smoothing over. **ТЫ** and *tū* and *thou* are the same word, barely touched in four thousand years. *Thou* fell out of standard English through the 1600s (it survives in Quaker usage, northern dialect and liturgy), leaving *you* for everyone — which is why the **ТЫ**/**ВЫ** choice feels foreign to English speakers. English **had** it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**Я**" — *ya*
- "**ТЫ**" and "**ВЫ**" — hear the difference
- the family — "**ТЫ** … *tū* … **thou**"

Before you move on

Say "I". (Я.) What are the two words for "you", and what splits them? (*Ty* informal, ВЫ formal — or plural.) Why is ТЫ familiar to an English speaker's ear? (It's the **same word as *thou***, which left standard English through the 1600s.) Next: why plural ВЫ became polite.

2.3 Why plural ВЫ became polite

Give the pair: ТЫ for one familiar person; ВЫ for more than one person — or for one person addressed respectfully.

Grammar Lens: one social job, several grammatical routes

Russian ВЫ is a plural used for **one person** as a mark of respect. French does the same job with second-person plural **vous**. Chapter 1's *zdrávstvuyte* already carried the matching polite-plural ending -ТЕ. Other languages reached respect differently:

- Russian ВЫ — the second-person plural.
- French **vous** — the second-person plural, the very same route.
- German **Sie** — the *third*-person plural, not the ordinary *ihr*.
- Spanish **usted** — a worn-down title, *vuestra merced*, "your grace."

Russian's polite ВЫ is generally treated as an eighteenth-century import from French and German social usage, not a pattern Russian invented alone.

Why it's said this way

Use ВЫ with a stranger, an older person, or in a formal relationship. Use ТЫ with a friend, child, or family member. When unsure with an adult, begin with ВЫ; too much respect is safer than unwanted familiarity.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- one close friend — ты
- a new professor — вы
- Russian and French use which route — second-person plural
- Spanish *usted* came from what — "your grace"

Before you move on

Why can вы address one person? (A plural became respectful.) Which language shares that exact route? (French *vous*.) Which two take different routes? (German *Sie* uses third-person plural; Spanish *usted* came from a title.) Which Russian form is safest when you are unsure? (Вы.)

2.4 меня зовут... — "my name is..."

Many languages say "my name is" with a word for *my* and a word for *name*. Russian says something quite different.

The exchange

Menyá zovút Anna. — "My name is Anna."

меня — *menya* — **me**, the object form. зовут — *zovut* — **they call**. So: **"[they] call me Anna."**

There is **no word for "my"** and **no word for "name"** in the sentence. Russian reports what people call you, not what you possess.

Grammar Lens: the invisible "they"

Zovút is the **they** form of *zvat'*, "to call," inherited from Proto-Slavic **zŭvati*, a cousin of Sanskrit *hávate*, "calls" (Vasmer). But there is no они ("they") anywhere — and there isn't meant to be. Russian uses a bare plural verb to mean "people in general," the way English says *"they say it'll rain"* without anyone in mind.
English does the same:

They call me Anna. — Who are *they*? Nobody. Everybody.

Grammar Lens: меня is not я

This is the important part, and this book's first taste of **case**.
You learned я for "I" last lesson. But here it is меня — because *I* is now the **object** of the calling, not the one doing it. Russian changes the **shape of the word** to mark that job:
я is *I*, the one acting; меня is *me*, the one acted on.
English does this with about six **pairs** — *I/me*, *he/him*, *she/her*, *we/us*, *they/them*, *who/whom*. Russian does it with **every noun and pronoun in the language**. That system is called **case**, and it is the main thing standing between you and Russian.
You do not need to learn it yet. You need to notice that меня is a **different shape of** я, and that the shape carries the meaning.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Menyá zovút…" and your own name
- the literal — "**they call me** …"
- the pair — "я … меня"
- the English echo — "*they say it'll rain*"

Before you move on

Say "my name is Anna." (*Menyá zovút Anna.*) What does it literally mean? ("**They call me** Anna.") Which two words is it missing? (Any word for **my**, and any word for **name**.) Who are "they"? (**Nobody** — a bare plural verb meaning "people in general," like English *they say*.) Why меня and not я? (Because it's the **object** — Russian changes a word's **shape** for its job. That's **case**.) Next: asking someone else's name.

2.5 как вас зовут? — "what's your name?"

You can say your own name. Now ask for someone else's — and notice that Russian asks a different question from English.

The exchange

> *Kak vas zovút?* — formal, or to more than one person. *Kak tebyá zovút?* — informal, to one person you know.

Taken apart:
как — *kak* — **how**. вас or тебя — *vas* / *tebya* — **you**, in the object form. зовут — *zovut* — they call.
So: **"How do they call you?"**

Grammar Lens: the object forms again

Last lesson's *menyá* has partners, and they follow the same logic — the person being called is the **object**, so the word changes shape:

- я becomes *menyá* — me.
- *ty* becomes тебя — you, informal.
- *vy* becomes вас — you, formal or plural.

You now have a matched pair: *Kak vas zovút? — Menyá zovút…*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Kak vas zovút?" — formal
- "Kak tebyá zovút?" — informal
- the whole exchange — "Kak vas zovút?" · "Menyá zovút…"

Before you move on

Ask a stranger's name. (*Kak vas zovút?*) And a friend's? (*Kak tebyá зовут?*) What does как mean, and why does it matter? (**How** — Russian asks *how they call you*, about an **action**, where English asks *what*, about a **possession**.) Give the three object forms. (*Menyá,* тебя, вас.) Next: compare how several languages frame the same question.

2.6 Why Russian asks *how*, not *what*

In *Kak vas zovút?*, which word means "how"? (*Kak.*)

Grammar Lens: one question, two ways to organize it

English asks **what** your name is, treating the name as a thing you have. Russian asks **how** people call you, treating naming as something people do.
English is the odd one out in this small comparison:

- Russian asks *Kak vas zovút?* — **how**.
- French asks *Comment vous appelez-vous ?* — **how**.
- Spanish asks *¿Cómo se llama?* — **how**.
- English asks ***What*** is your name? — **what**.

Three languages organize the question around an **action**; English organizes it around a **possession**. The answer is the same social fact, but the route to it differs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three action words — как, *comment*, *cómo*
- Russian literally asks — "how do they call you?"
- English asks about — a thing you have

Before you move on

Which three languages ask "how"? (Russian, French, Spanish.) Which asks "what"? (English.) What is the underlying contrast? (Naming as an action versus a name as a possession.)

2.7 очень приятно — "pleased to meet you"

The reply that closes an introduction — and the best etymology in the chapter.

The two words

Óchen priyátno. — "Pleased to meet you."

Literally: **"very pleasant."**

очень — *ochen* — very. приятно — *priyatno* — pleasant, agreeable.

There is no "to meet you" and no "I am." Russian states the **quality of the moment** and leaves the rest understood — the same economy as *menyá zovút*, which left out "my" and "name."

Both ч (*ch*) and я are letters the writing track hasn't reached. *Read it:* both letters

You'll draw them later.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Приятно comes from Slavic ***prijati***, "to favour, to be well-disposed toward" — which gives Russian *priyátel'*, a friend.
That root goes back to PIE **preyH-*, "to love, to please." And it went into Germanic too:

- Russian приятно, pleasant, and *priyátel'*, a friend.
- English **friend** — literally "one who is loving," an old participle of a verb meaning *to love*.
- German *Freund*.

So приятно and *friend* are the same root, arriving from opposite ends of Europe.
Free almost certainly belongs to the family too. The usual account: the word first meant "belonging to the beloved household" — the members of a family as opposed to the slaves in it — and only later meant "not in bondage." *Free* and *friend* start in the same place.
Saying очень приятно is, at the root, calling the meeting **friendly**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "Óchen priyátno"
- the whole exchange — "Kak vas zovút?" · "Menyá zovút…" · "Óchen priyátno"

- the family — “приятно … *priyátel’* … **friend**”

Before you move on

Say “pleased to meet you.” (*Óchen priyátno.*) What does it literally mean? (“**Very pleasant**” — no “I am,” no “to meet you.”) What is приятно related to? (Slavic *prijati* “to favour” → *priyátel’* “friend” — and, from the same PIE root **preyH-*, English **friend** and German *Freund*.) And *free*? (Most likely the **same family** — originally “belonging to the beloved household,” i.e. not a slave.) Next: putting the chapter together.

2.8 Chapter 2 practice — run the exchange

Give the three words the chapter opened with: *I*, familiar *you*, formal *you*. (*Ya*, *ty*, *vy*.) Everything below is built from those.

The exchange

Two strangers meet. Say both voices aloud, one after the other:

— Zdrávstvuyte! — Kak vas zovút? — Menyá zovút Anna. A vas? — Menyá zovút Iván. Óchen priyátno.

Everything in it is formal, because *vy* is the safe opening with an adult you do not know.

Grammar Lens: what moves when the exchange goes informal

With one friend, exactly two pieces change:

- the greeting — *Zdrávstvuyte* becomes Привет;
- the object pronoun — вас becomes тебя.

So *Kak vas zovút?* becomes *Kak tebyá zovút?* The verb *zovút* does not move, and *menyá* in the answer does not move either — you are still the one being called, whoever is asking.

Grammar Lens: why the shapes change at all

Ya becomes *menyá* because the calling lands **on** you rather than coming **from** you; *ty* and *vy* become тебя and вас for the same reason. And *zovút* is a plural verb with nobody behind it — "**they** call me," where *they* is no one in particular. That is why the Russian question asks **how** people call you, not **what** your name is: naming is something people do, not something you own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the full formal exchange, both voices
- the same exchange to one friend
- your own answer — "Menyá zovút…" and your name

Before you move on

Run the formal exchange from memory, then switch it for one friend. Which two pieces changed? (The greeting, and вас → тебя.) Which word never moved? (*Zovút.*) Which form do you choose for an adult you have just met, and why? (*Vy* — a plural used as respect, and the safer default.) Who is doing the calling in *menyá zovút*? (Nobody in particular — a bare plural verb.) And why is the question *kak* rather than *shto*? (Russian asks **how** people call you.)

2.9 Chapter 2 practice — the two person shapes

Russian changes a pronoun's shape when the action lands on that person. English still shows the same idea in *I* → *me*.

Grammar lens — cover and retrieve

Cover the right column, then give the acted-on form:

doing the action	action lands here	meaning
ya	*menyá*	I / me
ty	*tebyá*	you / you, informal
vy	*vas*	you / you, formal or plural

Russian has six cases, but none of that system is due yet. Learn these three pairs because the naming exchange needs them.

How to answer — each shape in the frame

- *Menyá zovút…* — people call **me**…
- *Kak tebyá zovút?* — how do people call **you**, one friend?
- *Kak vas zovút?* — how do people call **you**, formally?

The verb stays *zovút*; the person changes shape.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ya* → *menyá*
- *ty* → *tebyá*
- *vy* → *vas*
- one verb, three object forms

Before you move on

Give the three pairs. Which shape answers "who receives the calling"? (The object form.) Do you need the six-case table yet? (No — only these earned pairs.)

2.10 Chapter 2 practice — what Russian leaves out

Russian often says less than the English translation. Name only the words that are genuinely absent; do not erase a verb that is really there.

Grammar lens — three phrases, three English expansions

- *Menyá zovút Anna* reads literally "they call me Anna"; English adds *my* and *name*.
- *Óchen priyátno* reads literally "very pleasant"; English adds *it is* and *to meet you*.
- *Kak vas zovút?* reads literally "how do they call you?"; English adds *what* and *your*.

Only the middle sentence has **no verb at all**. In present-tense descriptions, Russian normally drops the linking verb: *Óchen priyátno* needs no spoken "is."
The other two sentences do contain *zovút*, "they call." They lack "is" because they are not "X is Y" sentences in Russian; English simply translates them that way.
Russian also has a present-tense *yest'*. Chapter 1 already hid it inside нет = не + *yest'*, "not-is." The next chapter will reuse it. So the careful rule is not "Russian has no *is*"; it is "Russian usually omits the linking verb in a present-tense description."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the one verb-free phrase — *Óchen priyátno*
- the verb inside the naming pair — *zovút*
- the verb hidden inside нет — *yest'*

Before you move on

Which sentence demonstrates the zero copula? (*Óchen priyátno.*)
Why do the naming sentences not count? (They contain *zovút.*)
Does Russian lack a present form of "be" entirely? (No: *yest'* exists; the linking use is normally omitted here.)

2.11 с н б д — four letters, two kinds of trouble

> The long polite greeting, from memory, and who you would say it to. Then say who you would not.

Script: two that lie, two that are only new

letter	the trouble
с	looks like a Latin *c*, says **s**
н	looks like a Latin *n*, says **n** — but the shape is not the one you expect
б	a genuinely new shape, says **b**
д	a genuinely new shape, says **d**

Two kinds of difficulty, needing different handling. с and н are false friends: your eye reads those shapes already, and reads them wrong, so the work is **unlearning**. б and д arrive with nothing attached, so the work is only **learning**. The second kind is easier, and mixing the two up is why the first kind keeps catching people out.

Grammar Lens: the verb that is not there

Russian leaves out the present tense of *to be*. Where English needs *am*, *is* or *are*, Russian sets the two halves of the sentence side by side and stops.

The person words are the other half of that. Subject and object forms differ, and with no verb to carry the person, **the pronoun is doing more work than its English counterpart** — which is why the shapes are worth drilling rather than recognising.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the polite greeting, then the courtesy exchange that follows it
- *Look:* at с and н, and say which Latin letter each one is pretending to be
- *Say it:* б and д, and note that neither is pretending anything
- *Say it:* a sentence with no verb in it, and say what English would have added

Before you move on

Which two of the four are false friends, and why is that harder? (`C` and `H` — you have to **unlearn** a reading, not only learn one.) What does Russian leave out of a present-tense sentence? (**The verb *to be***.) And what does that put on the pronoun? (**More work** — it carries the person alone.)

Chapter 3

Six Verbs, and the One You Never Say

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I do in Russian with six everyday verbs — быть, жить, знать, говорить, видеть, идти — put each of them in the я form, negate one with не, and say a sentence like «Я — Анна» the way Russian does, by leaving the verb out entirely.
>
> *Say* иду *— «I am going», one trip, right now — against* хожу*, the habit, and the go / went split Russian shares with English; then say the chapter's other five verbs back without their pages: «*Я студент*» with* быть *left silent,* живу*,* не знаю*,* говорю *with its gamma, and* вижу *with its* д→ж *swap, naming each one's English kin or false friend.*

3.1 быть — "to be"

Chapter 2 ended on a Russian sentence with no verb in it at all. This lesson is the verb that wasn't there.

You'll want to know first — быть

быть — *byt'* — **to be**

Four letters, and you have met all four already: б from спасибо, ы from ты, т from привет, and the soft sign ь from *óchen*. Nothing new to decode — which is rare, and worth enjoying.

The ь is not a sound; it softens the т in front of it. That ending **-ть** is how almost every Russian verb names itself, the way English puts *to* in front.

Grammar Lens: the tense Russian will not say

English: *I am a student.* Russian:

ya studént — literally **"I student."**

There is no word between them. Not a short one, not a quiet one — **none**. Russian does not use быть in the present tense; you link two things by setting them side by side.
The verb was not lost. Push the sentence into the past and it walks back in: *ya byl studéntom* — "I was a student." The present is the one place it goes silent.
Chapter 1 already showed you the survivor: нет is не + есть, "not-is." *Yest'* means **there is**, never *am*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

быть comes from Proto-Slavic **byti*, from PIE **b*^{h}*uH*-, "to grow, to become." Say *byt'* and then say **be** — that is the same root, barely worn.
Its cousins: English **be** and **been**, German *bin*, Latin *fuī* "I was" (which gave English **future**), Sanskrit *bhávati*.
Now the part worth keeping. English *be* is stitched from **three** different ancient roots — *be* from **b*^{h}*uH*-, *is* and *am* from **h*$_1$*es*-, *was* and *were* from **wes*-. Russian holds two of those apart and lets you watch: быть is the **b*^{h}*uH*- one, есть is the **h*$_1$*es*- one — the same root as English **is**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "быть" — *byt'*, with a soft final t
- "Ya studént" — and feel the gap where English puts *am*
- the two roots Russian keeps apart — "быть … есть"
- the English pair — "**be** … **is**"

Before you move on

Say "to be." (Быть.) Now say "I am a student." (*Ya studént* — two words, and no verb.) Is the verb gone from the language? (No — *byl* returns in the past; only the present drops it.) Which English word is быть? (**Be** — same root, $*b^huH$-.) And which English word is есть? (**Is**.) Next: *zhit'*, "to live."

3.2 жить — "to live"

Last lesson gave you a verb Russian refuses to say. This one you say constantly — and it is the first time you will put an ending on one.

You'll want to know first — жить

жить — *zhit'* — **to live**

Same **-ть** ending as *byt'*, and no new letters. The first one, **ж**, you met buried in *pozhálusta*: it is the *zh* of English *mea**s**ure* or *plea**s**ure* — a *sh* with the voice switched on. English never gives that sound a letter of its own; Russian gives it one.

So: *zhit'*, one syllable, soft *t* at the end.

Grammar Lens: the ending that means "I"

ya zhivú — **I live.**

Two things happened. A **-u** arrived on the end, and that *-u* is the whole signal for **I** — it is what *am*, *do* and *-s* are in English, packed into one letter. And a **в** surfaced in the middle that the infinitive never showed you: жи-ть becomes жив-*u*.
That is normal. A Russian verb's dictionary form and its working stem are allowed to differ, so you learn the pair, not the one.
Switch to *you*, and the ending switches: *ty zhivyósh* — "you live." The person lives in the ending; Russian can therefore drop the pronoun entirely and still be perfectly clear.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жить goes back to PIE *$g^{w}eih_{3}$-, "to live," and the family is enormous: Latin *vīvere* gave English **vivid, survive, revive, vital**; Greek *bíos* gave **biology**, and Greek *zōḗ* gave **zoo** and **zodiac**.
But the cousin worth carrying is the plain English one: **quick**. It meant **alive**, not fast — the speed came later, from how the living move. It is still frozen in the phrase *the **quick** and the dead*, in *cut to the **quick*** (cut to the living flesh), and in **quicksilver**, the metal that behaves as if alive.
So жить is **quick** in its older sense: to be among the living.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "жить" — *zhit'*, with the *measure* sound in front
- "Ya zhivú" — and land on the **-u**
- the pair — "zhivú … zhivyósh"
- the old English meaning — "**quick** … alive"

Before you move on

Say "to live." (*Zhit'.*) Say "I live." (*Ya zhivú* — and the **-u** is doing the work.) What did English *quick* once mean? (**Alive** — as in *the quick and the dead.*) Name two Latin cousins. (*Vivid*, *survive* — from *vīvere.*) Next: *znat'*, "to know."

3.3 знать — "to know"

The most useful sentence a beginner owns is not *hello.* It is *I don't know* — and after this lesson you will have it.

You'll want to know first — знать

знать — *znat'* — **to know**

No new letters, and the same **-ть** that ended *byt'* and *zhit'*. Say the **з** and **н** together with no vowel between them — *zn-*, exactly as English does in the middle of *ma**gn**et* but never at the start of a word.

In the present it takes the ending you already own:

ya znáyu — **I know.**

That **-ю** is not a new ending. It is the same **-u** you put on *zhivú*, spelled so it carries a *y*-glide in front — the same glide **е** carries in **привет**. Russian writes the glide into the vowel instead of adding a letter for it.

Grammar Lens: не, the whole of "don't"

ya ne znáyu — **I don't know.**

You met **не** in Chapter 1, hidden inside **нет** — **не** + **есть**, "not-is." Here it stands on its own, and it is the entire machinery of English *don't*, *doesn't* and *didn't*: one small word, parked directly in front of the verb, never changing shape.
English needs a helper verb to negate — *I know* becomes *I **do** not know*, with a *do* that appears from nowhere. Russian adds nothing and borrows nothing. Put **не** in front, and you are done.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

знать is PIE **ǵnehᵢ₃-*, "to know," and so is English **know** — the silent *k* in *know* is the fossil of a sound Russian still pronounces in **зн-**.
Down the Latin branch: *nōscere* gave **notice, notion, note, ignore** (*not*-knowing), **recognize**, **incognito**, and — through *nōbilis*, "knowable, well-known" — **noble**. Down the Greek branch: *gignṓskein* gave **diagnosis**, **prognosis**, **agnostic**. English **ken** and **cunning** come straight down the Germanic branch beside *know*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**знать**" — *znat'*, both consonants together
- "Ya znáyu" — the **-ю** is your *-u* wearing a glide
- "Ya ne znáyu" — and notice you added nothing else
- the family — "**know** … *notice* … *ignore* … *diagnosis*"

Before you move on

Say "to know." (*Znat'.*) Say "I don't know." (*Ya ne znáyu.*) What does Russian add to negate a verb, besides не? (**Nothing** — no helper verb at all.) Which English word is знать? (**Know** — and its silent *k* is the sound Russian kept.) Next: "to speak."

3.4 говорить — "to speak"

Your first new letter in three lessons, and an English word that looks like a relative and is not one.

You'll want to know first — говорить

говорить — *govorít'* — **to speak, to talk**

One letter here is **new**: г. It is Greek **gamma** (Γ) with the corner rounded off, and it says a hard **g**, as in *go* — never the *j* of *gem*.

Everything else you have met. And the two оs behave the way спасибо taught you: an о away from the stress slides towards *a*. The stress falls on the last syllable, so this is **ga-va-RIT'**. Russian spells the *o*; your mouth says *a*.

Grammar Lens: verbs come in two families

ya gavaryú — **I speak.**

The **I** ending is the same **-ю** you put on *znáyu*. Every Russian verb in the present ends the same way for *I*. Then switch to *you*, and the two families separate:

- *ty znáyesh* — you know
- *ty gavarísh* — you speak

An **-е-** against an **-и-**. That one vowel is the whole difference, and it is why you learn the *you* form alongside the dictionary form: it names the family, and the remaining endings follow from it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the new letter — "г is gamma, and says *g* as in *go*"
- "говорить" — *ga-va-RIT'*, both *o*s leaning towards *a*
- "Ya gavaryú" — same **-ю** as *znáyu*
- the two families — "znáyesh … gavarísh"

Before you move on

What sound is г? (A hard **g**, from Greek gamma.) Say "I speak." (*Ya gavaryú.*) Which vowel separates the two verb families in the *you* form? (**-е-** in *znáyesh* against **-и-** in *gavarísh.*) Next: why говорить is not English *govern.*

3.5 (говорить, continued) — The word, taken apart — and a false friend

Before going on: say говорить again, and what it means.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

говорить is built on the old Slavic noun **govorŭ*, "a murmur, a din, the noise of many voices." Russian still keeps говор for the buzz of a crowd or a regional way of talking. Most etymologists read the root as **imitative** — the word sounds like what it names — which is honest but means there is no tidy English cousin to hand you. Where a root is uncertain, this book says so.

What there *is* to hand you is a trap. **Govern** is **not** related. That is Latin *gubernāre*, "to steer a ship," from Greek *kybernân* — the same word that gave English **cybernetics** and every **cyber-** since. A governor steers; a говор is a noise. Two roots that never met.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "говорить" — and "not *govern*"

Before you move on

Is говорить related to English *govern*? (**No** — *govern* is Greek *kybernân*, "to steer.") Next: "to see."

3.6 видеть — "to see"

One root, two meanings, and half of them ended up in English as words about **knowing** rather than about eyes.

You'll want to know first — видеть

видеть — *vídet'* — **to see**

No new letters. Two you should keep honest, though: в says *v*, not *b*, and и says *ee* — the pair that fooled you in привет.

Stress lands on the **first** syllable here — *VEE-dyet'* — the opposite of говорить. Russian never prints its stress, so it travels with the word.

The *you* form tells you the family, exactly as promised last lesson:

ty vídish — **you see**

An **-ish**, so видеть belongs with говорить, not with *znat'*.

Grammar Lens: the letter that swaps for "I"

Now the surprise:

ya vízhu — **I see.**

The д has become *zh* — the *measure* sound from *zhit'*. The ending is the ordinary **-u**; it is the consonant in front of it that shifted.
This happens in the **I** form and nowhere else in the present. *Ty vídish*, and everyone else, keep their д. So the pattern to carry is small and exact: *vízhu*, then *vídish* — and after that the verb behaves.
English does the same trick and has stopped noticing: *speak* against *speech*, *break* against *breach*, *bake* against *batch*. A consonant softening beside a front vowel, in both languages, for the same ancient reason.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

видеть is PIE **weid-*, and that root carried **two** senses at once: *to see*, and — because what you have seen is what you know — *to know*. The seeing branch, through Latin *vidēre*: **video, vision, visit, evident, provide, review, advise**. Through Greek *eîdos*: **idea** and **idol**.
The knowing branch came into English directly: **wit**, **wise**, **wisdom**, **witness** — someone who knows because they saw. Sanskrit took the same turn: the **Veda** is "what has been seen," meaning knowledge. Russian kept both halves as two verbs: видеть for the eyes, and the older ведать for knowing — the *ved-* of *Veda*, still alive in Russian.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "видеть" — *VEE-dyet'*, stress at the front
- the odd pair — "vízhu … vídish"
- which family it joins — "vídish, like gavarísh"
- the two branches — "*video* … **wit**"

Before you move on

Say "to see." (Видеть.) Say "I see." (*Ya vízhu* — the д swapped to *zh*.) Does that swap happen anywhere else in the present? (**No** — the *I* form only.) What second meaning did **weid-* carry? (**To know** — hence *wit*, *wise*, *Veda*.) Next: "to go."

3.7 идти — "to go"

English has one verb for going. Russian has two.

You'll want to know first — идти

идти — *idtí* — **to go** (on foot, and under way right now)

No new letters. The дт blurs into one sound — *it-TEE*, stress at the end.

ya idú — **I'm going.**

ty idyósh — **you're going.**

-u for *I*, **-yesh** for *you*: идти sits with *znat'*, not *govorít'*.

Grammar Lens: going now against going often

Russian keeps a **second** verb for the same activity:

Ya idú — I am on my way, **now**, in one direction.

ya khazhú — I go, **as a habit**, back and forth.

Not two tenses: two verbs. English draws the line with tense — *I'm going*, *I go* — and every Russian verb of motion comes in such a pair.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

идти is PIE **h₁ei-*, "to go" — the root of Latin *īre*, which gave English **exit**, **transit** and **itinerary**.
Its past, *shol*, shares **no root** with it: a verb this common wears out and patches the hole with another verb. That is **suppletion**.
English did the same: *go* took **went** from *wend*. So идти → *shol* is *go* → *went* — the words we use most wear out fastest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "идти" — *it-TEE*
- "Ya idú" — on my way this minute
- the contrast — "idú … khazhú"
- the two broken verbs — "идти … shol", "go … went"

Your turn — the chapter, said back

- "I am a student"? (*Ya studént* — *byt'*, cousin of **be**, stays silent.)
- "I live"? (*Ya zhivú.*) What did *quick* once mean? (**Alive**, like *zhit'*.)

- "I don't know"? (*Ya ne znáyu* — only не; *znat'* is **know**.)
- "I speak"? (*Ya gavaryú* — г is gamma, a hard *g*.) Kin to *govern*? (**No.**)
- "I see"? (*Ya vízhu* — д turns *zh*, *I* form only.) English kin? (**Wit.**)

Before you move on

Say "I'm on my way." (*Ya idú.*) And "I go there regularly"? (*Ya khazhú* — another verb, not a tense.) What is the past of идти? (*Shol* — another root, like *went*.) Name two English cousins of **h₁ei-*. (*Exit*, *transit* — or *itinerary*.) That is six Russian verbs, and one of them you will spend your life not saying.

Chapter 4

Verbs of the Mind and the Page

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I think, understand, read and write in Russian, name the finished partner each of those verbs travels with, and read the letter ш that has been hiding in words I already say.
>
> *Say all four verbs of the chapter in the I form —* я думаю*,* я понимаю*,* я читаю*,* я пишу *— then name each one's finished partner, put the stress on the end of* писать *where it belongs, and read the* ш *you have been decoding since* живёшь*.*

4.1 думать — "to think"

> Six verbs behind you. This one opens the largest fact about Russian verbs.

You'll want to know first — думать

> думать — *dúmat'* — **to think**

No new letters, and the **-ть** of *znat'*. Stress on the first syllable, and it never moves: **DOO-mat'**.

> *ya dúmayu* — **I think.**

That **-ю** is the one you put on *znáyu*. And *ty dúmayesh* — an **-yesh**, so думать files with *znat'*, not говорить.

Three verbs of the head now: *ya znáyu* is a fact I hold, *ya vízhu* is what reaches my eyes, я думаю is what goes on behind them.

Grammar Lens: every Russian verb travels with a partner

Russian verbs come in **pairs**. One member is the **doing** — under way, repeated, unfinished. The other is the **deed done**, seen whole. Думать is the first kind; its partner подумать is not "to think" but "to have a thought, and be done with it."
You have met the instinct once. Идти was going *now, one way*, with a separate partner for going *as a habit* — one small family of motion verbs. This is a **different** distinction, applied to nearly **every verb in the language**.
So one job per verb: learn its partner's **name**. What a pair does to a sentence is a later lesson.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дума is the Russian noun for **a thought** — and for a body that thinks: the State Дума is the lower house of the Russian parliament, this same word.
Its own origin carries a hedge. The standard account makes дума an early borrowing from **Gothic** *dōms*, "a judgement" — behind English **doom** (a judgement before it was a fate) and **deem**. If so, думать and *doom* are relatives **by contact**, not by descent; a minority prefer an inherited root.
Latin's *cogito, ergo sum* is built on the same idea, and its other pieces are yours: the **-o** of *cogito* is Latin **ego**, the pronoun Russian keeps as я; and *fuī*, "I was," is *byt"*s root, English **be**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "думать" — *DOO-mat'*, stress on the front
- the three heads — "ya znáyu … ya vízhu … ya dúmayu"
- the pair — "думать … подумать", the doing and the done

Before you move on

Say "I think." (*Ya dúmayu.*) Which family does думать join, *znáyesh* or *gavarísh*? (*Znáyesh.*) What is подумать beside думать, and how many verbs have such a partner? (The **finished** member;

nearly **all**.) Which English word does the standard account attach дума to? (**Doom**, by borrowing.)

4.2 понимать — "to understand"

The most useful sentence a traveller owns is short, and after this lesson it is yours: *I don't understand.*

You'll want to know first — понимать

понимать — *ponimát'* — **to understand**

No new letters. Stress on the last syllable, and both оs lean towards *a* away from it: **pa-ni-MAT'**.

ya panimáyu — **I understand.**

The same **-ю** as *dúmayu*. And now the sentence worth more than the rest:

ya ne panimáyu — **I don't understand.**

Не does the whole job, exactly as in *ya ne znáyu*: one word in front of the verb, no helper borrowed from anywhere. Say those syllables to a Russian speaker and the conversation slows down for you.

Grammar Lens: the partner, and a warning about its shape

Dúmat' took *podúmat'*: a prefix on the front, nothing else disturbed. Do not expect that every time.
Понимать's partner is понять — same root, but the middle of the word has been squeezed out, **-ним-** against **-ня-**. Russian builds a pair by prefix, by a reshaped stem, or by both, and the shape is learned with the verb.
The job is unchanged: понимать, понять, said together, one entry.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

понимать is **по-** plus a root meaning simply **to take**: Indo-European *h_1em-, which came down the Latin branch as *emere*, "to take, and so to buy." English took the family whole — **exempt** (taken out),

redeem (bought back), **example** (taken as a specimen), **premium**, **prompt**, **assume**, **consume**.
So понимать literally says **take hold of**. English says the same and has stopped noticing: **comprehend** is Latin *com-prehendere*, "to seize together"; **grasp** is what a hand does; German **begreifen** is *greifen*, "to grip."
Set that beside the two pictures Russian already gave you. *Znat'* was **ǵneh₃-*, English **know** — knowledge you simply *have*. Видеть was **weid-*, which meant *see* and *know* at once and gave English **wit** and **wise** — knowledge you *saw*. Now understanding as something you *caught*. And unlike *dúmat'*, which arrived by Gothic borrowing, this one is inherited straight down.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "понимать" — *pa-ni-MAT'*, both *o*s leaning to *a*
- "Ya panimáyu" then "Ya ne panimáyu" — one word added, nothing else
- the pair — "понимать … понять", the squeezed middle
- the picture — "take hold" … *comprehend, grasp*

Before you move on

Say "I don't understand." (*Ya ne panimáyu.*) Name понимать's partner and say how its shape differs from *podúmat'*. (Понять — the stem is reshaped, not just prefixed.) What does the root of понимать mean? (**To take** — as *comprehend* and *grasp* also do.) And which of your knowing-verbs is a borrowing rather than an inheritance? (*Dúmat'*, from Gothic.)

4.3 читать — "to read"

English says *I read* and *I am reading* and means two things. Russian cannot — and the reason is a verb it refuses to say.

You'll want to know first — читать

читать — *chitát'* — **to read**

No new letters: ч you have been reading since очень, and it says the *ch* of *cheese*. Stress on the last syllable, **chi-TAT'**.

ya chitáyu — **I read.**

The same **-ю**, and *ty chitáyesh* puts it with *znat'* and *dúmat'*. Two verbs, one ordinary sentence:

ya chitáyu i panimáyu — **I read and I understand.**

Grammar Lens: one present tense, two English sentences

Ya chitáyu is *I read* **and** *I am reading*. Russian has one present tense and it covers both.
There is a reason, and you hold it. English builds *I am reading* out of **be** plus *-ing*; Russian's *byt'* has no present tense to build with — the missing verb of Chapter 3, the one *Ya studént* does without. With no auxiliary, Russian never grew the machinery.
The work English does with *am reading* against *read* is carried instead by the **pair**. *Chitát'* is the ongoing member; прочитать is the finished one — to read a thing **through**, to the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

читать rests on an old Slavic root meaning **to count, to reckon, to heed**, and Russian keeps the family in plain sight: *chisló* is a *number*, честь is *honour*, почитать is *to hold in esteem*. Counting, respecting and reading are one act — careful attention, item by item. Outside Slavic the root surfaces in Sanskrit *cétati*, "he perceives."
And then the trail stops. There is **no secure English descendant**, and the two words that look promising are not it: **cheat** is a clipped *escheat*, from Latin *cadere*, "to fall," and **chit**, the little note, came into English from India. This book would rather hand you nothing than a cousin that is only a resemblance — the care it took with говорить, which is not *govern*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "читать" — *chi-TAT'*, the *ch* of *cheese*
- "Ya chitáyu i panimáyu" — and hear it as both *read* and *am reading*
- the pair — "читать … прочитать", the doing and the read-through

Before you move on

Say "I read and I understand." (*Ya chitáyu i panimáyu.*) Give the two English sentences я читаю covers, and say why. (*I read* and *I am reading*; *byt'* has no present tense to build the second.) Name the finished partner. (Прочитать.) Which two Russian nouns share this root, and is читать related to English *cheat*? (*Chisló* and честь; and **no** — as говорить was not related to *govern*.)

4.4 писать — "to write"

A new letter, an English family you know on sight, and a stress mistake worth naming before you make it.

You'll want to know first — писать

писать — *pisát'* — **to write**

Stress on the **last** syllable, **pi-SAT'** — not a detail you may skip.

ya pishú — **I write**, and **I am writing**.

Two things moved: the с becomes *sh* in the present, and the stress that sat on the ending for *I* jumps back to the stem elsewhere — *pishú*, but *ty píshesh*. The pair runs as it did for *chitát'*: писать ongoing, написать finished.

Careful. Писать stressed at the end — *pisát'* — is **to write**. Писать stressed at the front — *písat'* — is a child's word for **to urinate**, whose *I* form is *písayu* beside *pishú*. The two differ only in where your voice lifts, and beginners land on the wrong one. Stress the **end** and say *pishú*.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) All of писать is familiar; the new sound arrives in *pishú*.

- **"sh"**, the sound of *shoe*, has a letter of its own: three uprights on a bar, like a comb with the teeth up. You will write it in the letter chapters.

You have been hearing it without being told: *zhivyósh*, *znáyesh*, *gavarísh* and the past *shol* all carry it. And note the kind of letter it is: я lies to a Latin reader, looking like a mirrored *R* while being a vowel; the comb resembles nothing Latin at all.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

писать is Indo-European **peyǩ-*, "**to cut, to scratch, to mark**" — before ink there was a point and a surface. The root became, in Latin, *pingere*, "to paint", and English took the results: **paint**, **picture**, **pigment**. Russian's *pis'mó* (a letter) and *pisátel'* (a writer) sit on the verb.
That closes the chapter's thread: *dúmat'* came in from Gothic, *ponimát'* is a root meaning *take*, *chitát'* a root meaning *count* with no English descendant, and писать a root meaning *scratch* that handed English a wall of paint.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "писать" then "ya pishú" — stress on the end, and the *sh* arriving
- the four — "ya dúmayu, ya panimáyu, ya chitáyu, ya pishú"

Before you move on

Say "I write." (*Ya pishú.*) Where does the stress go, and what if it goes on the front? (On the **end**; *písat'* is a child's word for urinating.) What sound does the comb-shaped letter make? (**Sh** — *zhivyósh*, *znáyesh*, *gavarísh*, *shol.*) Say the chapter's four verbs in the *I* form, then their finished partners. (*Ya dúmayu, ya panimáyu, ya chitáyu, ya pishú*; *podúmat'*, понять, *prochitát'*, написать.) And

what did писать's root mean? (**To scratch** — hence *paint*.)

Chapter 5

Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I take, ask, help and love in Russian, put any verb I own after люблю as a bare infinitive, and tell a suppletive aspect pair like брать · взять from an ordinary one like спрашивать · спросить.
>
> *Say* я люблю *with its inserted* л*, then run every verb you own through it —* я люблю читать*,* писать*,* помогать*,* жить *— and close by naming the chapter's four partners and picking out* взять *as the one built from a different root.*

5.1 брать — "to take"

> A short verb, an English cousin you carry every day, and a partner that shares not one letter with it.

You'll want to know first — брать

брать — *brat'* — **to take**

Five letters, all of them yours, and the familiar **-ть**.

ya berú — **I take.**

The stem grows a vowel: бр- in the infinitive, бер- once an ending arrives. Then *ty beryósh*, so this verb sits in the *znat'* family, and that **-u** is the plain form of the **-ю** you have been saying.

Three sentences, all ordinary Russian:

Ya chitáyu. Ya pishú. Ya berú.

Grammar Lens: a pair with nothing in common

The partners so far were recognisable: *chitát'* · *prochitát'* added a prefix, *ponimát'* · понять reshaped a middle. Now the hard case. брать's finished partner is *vzyat'* — *ya vaz'mú*. Not a prefixed брать, not a squeezed one: a **different word entirely**, drafted in as half of the pair.

Grammarians call this **suppletion**, and you have met it once: идти takes *shol* for its past, from another root, exactly as English *go* takes **went**. Here the same trick builds an aspect pair instead of a past tense.

There is a quiet reward in it. *Vzyat'* is *vz-* on the very root that built *ponimát'*, the ancient root meaning *take*. So брать's finished partner is family with the verb for *understand*, and брать is the outsider.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

брать is Indo-European $*b^{h}er$-, "**to carry, to bear**", one of the richest roots English owns: **bear**, **birth**, **burden**, **bier**; Latin *ferre* behind **transfer**, **refer**, **fertile**; Greek *phérein* behind **metaphor**, a carrying-across. Russian keeps the load too — *brémya* is a burden, and *berémennaya*, *pregnant*, is literally *carrying*.

Now the trap, because this track flags both kinds. The word for **brother**, брат, sits one soft sign from брать, and is **not related**: брат is $*b^{h}réh_{2}ter$, English *brother*. And *byt'* is $*b^{h}uH$-, English *be*. Three roots that all begin **bh** — a family accent, not a shared word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "брать" then "ya berú" — hear the stem grow its vowel
- "Ya chitáyu. Ya pishú. Ya berú." — *ya chitáyu, ya pishú, ya berú*
- the odd pair — "брать … vzyat'", two words sharing nothing
- the other suppletion — "идти … shol", "go … went"
- "брать" then English "bear, birth, burden, transfer, metaphor"

Before you move on

Say "I take." (*Ya berú.*) Name брать's finished partner and say what is strange about it, then give the English pair that behaves the same way. (*Vzyat'*, a different root; *go* and **went**, as идти takes *shol.*) Which verb of yours is *vzyat'* related to? (*Ponimát'* — both on the old root for *take.*) And the word one soft sign away, meaning **brother**: related? (**No** — another root, like *byt'.*)

5.2 спрашивать — "to ask"

You have asked a question in Russian since Chapter 2 without owning the verb for asking. Here it is.

You'll want to know first — спрашивать

спрашивать — *spráshivat'* — **to ask (a question)**

Long on the page, easy in the mouth: the stress lands on спра- and stays, **SPRA-shi-vat'**. The ш in the middle is the letter *pishú* introduced.

ya spráshivayu — **I ask.**

The same **-ю**, and *ty spráshivayesh* puts it in the *znat'* family. Set it beside your other verb for opening your mouth: говорить is to speak, спрашивать is to speak with a question mark on the end. And one distinction English hides: Russian asks a **question** with спрашивать, but **for a thing** with просить.

Grammar Lens: an ordinary pair, after a very strange one

Брать took *vzyat'*, a partner from a different root. That was the worst case, not the norm. Спрашивать's partner is спросить — *ya sproshú, ty sprósish* — one root worn into two shapes, the ongoing member long, the finished short.

Why it's said this way

The moment you ask, Russian makes you choose. *Kak vas zovút?* takes вас for a stranger and тебя for a friend — a choice that sits inside *ty* and *vy*, the split English lost when **thou**, *ty*'s cousin, left ordinary use.

Other languages make the same move by other grammar: French **vous** and Russian *vy* are the plural doing polite duty, German **Sie** borrows the third person, Spanish **usted** grew out of a title.
And recall what that question literally asks: **how** they call you, not what your name is — an action where English reaches for a possession, as French and Spanish also do.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Strip the prefix and спрашивать rests on the root of просить, "to request": Indo-European **prek̑-*, "**to ask**." In Latin it became *precārī*, "to pray", and English took the lot: **pray**, **prayer**, **precarious**, **deprecate**. German **fragen** is the Germanic outcome, so спрашивать and *fragen* are one inherited word.
English **ask** is not in this family; the cousin kept here is *pray*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "спрашивать" then "я спрашиваю" — and hear the ш of *pishú*
- the two mouths — "я говорю … я спрашиваю"
- "Kak vas zovút" then "Kak tebyá zovút" — and choose which fits

Before you move on

Say "I ask." (*Ya spráshivayu.*) Name the partner and say how this pair differs from брать · *vzyat'*. (Спросить — one root in two shapes.) In *Kak vas zovút?*, what decides between вас and тебя? (Whether the person is *vy* or *ty* — and *ty* is English *thou*.) And give an English cousin of **prek̑-*. (*Pray*, *prayer*, *precarious*.)

5.3 помогать — "to help"

This verb is built out of the word for *being able*, and that word is English **may**. Helping, in Russian, is lending someone your can.

You'll want to know first — помогать

помогать — *pomogát'* — **to help**

The г is the letter говорить introduced: Greek gamma, a hard **g** as in *go*. Both оs lean towards *a* away from the stress, as говорить's do — **pa-ma-GAT'**.

ya pamagáyu — **I help.**

Same **-ю**, and *ty pamagáyesh* files it with *znat'*.

One honest limit: the person you help takes a case this book has not reached, so keep the sentence bare. *Ya pamagáyu* alone is ordinary Russian.

Grammar Lens: a partner that does not end in -ть

Every infinitive so far ended in **-ть**. The partner of помогать does not: it is *pomóch'*, ending in **-ch'**, and *ya pamagú, ty pamózhesh*.
A small handful of Russian verbs end that way, and they are built on old roots about power. The shape is a signpost, not an exception to memorise blind.
Three pairs cover the chapter so far: брать · **vzyat'**, **spráshivat'** · спросить, помогать · *pomóch'*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

помогать is по- plus **-могать**, and under it sits *moch'*, "to be able" — *ya magú*, "I can."
That root is Indo-European **mag*^{h}-, "**to be able, to have power**", and English holds several pieces of it:

- **may** and **might** — the ordinary modal, and the noun for strength in *with might and main*.
- **dismay** — to strip someone of their power to act.
- German **mögen** and **Macht**; and Greek *mēkhanḗ*, "a contrivance", which is English **machine** and **mechanic**.

Note what did **not** happen here. *Magú* and *may* still mean the same thing after five thousand years. That is not the usual outcome: *zhit"*s root handed English **quick**, which once meant **alive** and now means *fast*. Some roots keep their sense, some drift out of recognition, and

*spráshivat'*s went from *ask* all the way to *pray*. Each one has to be checked rather than guessed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "помогать" — *pa-ma-GAT'*, both *o*s leaning to *a*
- "Ya pamagáyu"
- the three pairs — "брать · vzyat', spráshivat' · спросить, помогать · pomóch'"
- "magú" then English "may, might" — one meaning, two languages

Before you move on

Say "I help." (*Ya pamagáyu*.) Which verb is hiding inside it, and what does it mean? (*Moch'* — to be able; *ya magú*.) Name the partner and say what is odd about its ending. (*Pomóch'*, in **-ch'** rather than -ть.) Give two English cousins of *mag^h-. (*May*, *might*, *dismay*, *machine*.) And which English word from your verbs no longer means what its root meant? (**Quick**, from *zhit'*'s root — it meant *alive*.)

5.4 любить — "to love, and to like"

The last verb of the chapter is English **love**, and it lets you say every verb you own in a real sentence.

You'll want to know first — любить

любить — *lyubít'* — **to love**, and **to like**

One verb for both: with a person, *love*; with an activity, closer to *like*.

ya lyublyú — **I love.**

And *ty lyúbish* — an **-ish**, so любить joins говорить and видеть, not *znat'*. The stress moves too: *lyublyú* on the ending, *lyúbish* on the stem.

Grammar Lens: the letter that appears out of nowhere

Lyubít' has no л after the б. *Lyublyú* does.
You have met this shape. Видеть swapped д for *zh* in *vízhu* and nowhere else. Here it happens by insertion: stems ending in б, п, в or the letters for *m* and *f* push an л in — but **only in the *I* form**.
So люблю, then *lyúbish*, любят, with no л at all. Learn the *I* form and the rest behaves.

Grammar Lens: now say everything at once

Lyubít' takes a bare infinitive, as English *like* does — the dictionary form goes straight in:

> *Ya lyublyú chitát'.* — I like reading. *Ya lyublyú pisát'.* — I like writing. *Ya lyublyú dúmat'.* — I like thinking. *Ya lyublyú pomogát'.* — I like helping. *Ya lyublyú zhit'.* — I love living.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

любить is Indo-European **leub*^{h}-, and English **love** is the same word — no borrowing, no detour. The family is wider than it looks: **lief**; **believe** (*be-* plus the root — to hold a thing dear enough to trust); **leave** in *by your leave*; and Latin *libet*, "it pleases", behind **libido**.
Its partner полюбить deserves an honest line: not *to finish loving* but **to come to love**, the moment the feeling starts. A pair does not always mean *doing* against *done* — which is why they get a later chapter of their own.
And the root thread: бр- carries (*bear*), -прос- asks (*pray*), **mog-** is able (*might*), люб- holds dear (*love*) — with пис- from last chapter still scratching its mark (*picture*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "любить" then "я люблю", then "ty lyúbish" without the л
- "Ya lyublyú chitát'. Ya lyublyú pisát'. Ya lyublyú pomogát'. Ya lyublyú zhit'."

- the four pairs — "брать · vzyat', spráshivat' · спросить, pomogát' · pomóch', любить · полюбить"

Before you move on

Say "I love", then "I like reading." (*Ya lyublyú*; *Ya lyublyú chitát'.*) Where is the л in *ty lyúbish*, and which earlier verb behaved this way? (Gone — the insert hits only the *I* form, as д → **zh** in *vízhu.*) Name the chapter's four partners, and which is a different root from its verb. (*Vzyat'*, спросить, *pomóch'*, полюбить; *vzyat'.*) And give the English cousins of любить, брать, *spráshivat'*, *pomogát'* and писать. (**Love**, *bear*, *pray*, *might*, *picture.*)

Chapter 6

Water, Coffee, Tea, and Bread

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 👁 **eyes** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name water, coffee, tea and bread with their genders in Russian, ask for any of them politely, and say which are native and which are loans.
>
> *The chapter closes on* хлеб*, the word that looks native but is a prehistoric Germanic loan: the reader produces all four words with their genders, extends* пожалуйста *into a real request pattern on* кофе *and* чай*, and sorts the set into native (*вода*), loan disguised by age (*хлеб*), and two visibly foreign words that arrived by opposite routes (*кофе *by sea,* чай *overland). It reaches back to Chapter 5's* любить*, closing the chapter's own final atoms which nothing had yet revisited.*

6.1 вода — "water," and how every Russian noun announces itself

Five chapters of verbs, and not one noun. Here is the first — and it comes with a rule that will save you for the rest of the book.

You'll want to know first — вода

вода — *vodá* — **water**

Stress on the last syllable, *vo-DÁ*; the unstressed first о drifts toward *a*, the same reduction you have been hearing since спасибо.

Grammar Lens: no "the," no "a" — and the ending tells you the gender

Two facts belong together, because each explains the other.
First: Russian has no articles at all. No word for *the*, no word for *a*. Вода by itself can mean "water," "the water," or "a water" — context carries the difference. Every Romance or Germanic language taught in this program has spent a whole lesson on articles. Russian never will, because it has none to teach.
Second: every Russian noun is one of three genders — masculine, feminine, or neuter — and, unlike Hindi's arbitrary assignment, Russian's *ending* usually tells you which:

ending	gender	this chapter's example
a consonant	masculine	*(next lesson)*
-а / -я	feminine	вод-а
-о / -е	neuter	*(ahead)*

Вода ends in -а, so it is **feminine** — regular, no exception, the easiest kind of noun this language has. Hold that confidence for exactly one lesson; the next word breaks the rule on purpose.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вода is Indo-European **wódr*, one of the best-preserved roots in the whole family. English **water** is the same word, barely disguised; so is the combining form **hydro-** in *hydrogen* and *hydrate*, which English borrowed separately from the Greek branch of the same root.
Russian kept building on it at home, too: **vódka** is вод-а plus the affectionate diminutive **-ka** — literally **"little water."**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "вода" — *vo-DÁ*, stress on the end
- the three endings — "consonant, masculine; -а or -я, feminine; -о or -е, neuter"
- "water, hydro-, vódka" — one root, three words you already own

Before you move on

Say "water." (Вода.) What two words does Russian have for "the" and "a"? (**Neither exists.**) What ending makes вода feminine, and what are the other two endings for? (-а; a consonant for masculine, -о or -е for neuter.) Name two English words from the same root as вода. (**Water**, **hydro-** — and Russian's own **vódka**, "little water.")

6.2 кофе — "coffee," the noun that breaks the rule you just learned

Last lesson's rule said -о and -е endings are neuter. This word ends in -е and is not neuter at all — meet Russian's most argued-about noun.

You'll want to know first — кофе

кофе — *kófe* — **coffee**. **Masculine.**

Say that twice: **masculine**, ending in -е. By last lesson's rule it should be neuter, like every other -е noun ahead in this book. It never declines at all — кофе is **indeclinable**, the identical shape in every sentence, so there is no ending left to fix.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) One new letter: ф.

- ф = **"f"** — Greek **phi** (Φ), a circle with a line through it. You have already met two other Greek-shaped letters, г (gamma) and the letter for *l* (lambda); ф joins them.

Everything else in кофе — к, о, е — you have read since Chapter 1.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кофе is a loanword, and a recent one beside вода's prehistoric root. It travelled **Arabic *qahwa*** → **Ottoman Turkish *kahve*** → **Dutch *koffie*,** and reached Russian during Peter the Great's westernizing reforms in the early 1700s — the same push that filled Russian with

borrowed Dutch and German trade and technical vocabulary. Its first Russian form was кофий, ending like an ordinary masculine noun (compare *chai*, next lesson). Across the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries the final syllable wore down to today's кофе — but the **gender stuck**, long after the ending that explained it was gone. Dictionaries still mark it masculine; everyday speech increasingly treats it as neuter, exactly the way last lesson's rule would predict, and the argument between the two is still alive in Russian classrooms today. You already own the verb for how you feel about it:

ya lyublyú kófe — **I love coffee.**

(Kófe is inanimate and masculine, so it takes exactly the same shape here as it does standing alone — nothing to adjust.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "кофе" — masculine, indeclinable, never changes shape
- the new letter — "ф is phi, and says f"
- the route — "qahwa, kahve, koffie, кофе"
- "Ya lyublyú kófe."

Before you move on

Say "coffee," with its gender. (*Kófe* — **masculine**.) Why is that surprising, given last lesson's rule? (**It ends in -е**, which the rule predicts as neuter.) Name the three languages the word crossed before Russian, and the century it arrived. (**Arabic, Turkish, Dutch**; **the early 1700s**.) Say "I love coffee." (*Ya lyublyú kófe.*)

6.3 чай — "tea," which went overland while *kófe* went by sea

Same drink family, a completely different journey — and, finally, the sentence that actually orders one.

You'll want to know first — чай

чай — *chai* — **tea**. **Masculine.**

A consonant ending, so last lesson's rule holds without a fight this time: consonant-final nouns are masculine, and чай is the plain case. Every letter — ч, а, й — you have read since Chapter 2.

*(Careful on paper: romanized, this word looks like the English drink brand name **chai** and nothing else — pure coincidence of spelling, not a shared history. Its real cousins are below.)*

Grammar Lens: asking politely, at last

You have owned *pazhálusta* since Chapter 1 and had nothing new to attach it to. Now you do: name the thing, add the word.

> *Chai, pazhálusta.* — **Tea, please.** *Kófe, pazhálusta.* — **Coffee, please.**

Both words sit here exactly as they do alone — чай is already the shape a request needs, and *kófe* never changes shape at all. That is not an accident of this chapter: it is the simplest version of a pattern you will meet in its fuller, case-shifting form once this book reaches nouns that *do* change for a request. For now, name the thing, add *pazhálusta*, and you are understood.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чай is Mandarin Chinese **chá**, and it reached Russia by the opposite road from *kófe*. Persian traders on the Silk Road bought it from northern China as *cha-ye khatai*, "tea of Cathay," and their Turkic-speaking customers misheard the trailing syllable as part of the word itself — giving **Turkish *çay*, Persian *chāy*,** and, at the end of the same overland chain, **Russian** чай.
Compare last lesson's *kófe*: **Arabic → Turkish → Dutch, by ship**, arriving in Peter the Great's Russia from the west. *Chai* came **overland, from the east**, along a caravan route that also carried it into Hindi (*chai*) and Arabic (*shai*). One plant; two words for it in English (**tea** took the same Chinese root by sea, through Dutch traders on the coast) — and Russian happens to have picked the **eastern** branch, while English picked the **southern coastal** one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "чай" — one syllable, masculine
- "Chai, pazhálusta. Kófe, pazhálusta."
- the fork — "chá overland to chai; chá by sea to tea"

Before you move on

Say "tea," with its gender. (*Chai* — **masculine**.) Ask for it politely. (*Chai, pazhálusta.*) Which route did чай travel, and which did *kófe* travel? (*Chai*: overland, Chinese → Persian → Turkic → Russian. *Kófe*: by sea, Arabic → Turkish → Dutch → Russian.) Which English word took the same Chinese root as чай, but by the other route? (**Tea** — by sea, through Dutch.)

6.4 хлеб — "bread," the chapter's fourth word and its only immigrant besides *kófe*

One more request word, one more letter, and then the whole table — four things to ask for, and what each one's history actually is.

You'll want to know first — хлеб

хлеб — *khleb* — **bread**. **Masculine.**

Consonant-final, so the ending rule holds again. And the pattern from last lesson still works:

Khleb, pazhálusta. — **Bread, please.**

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) One new letter: х.

- х = a raspy **"kh,"** made where you'd clear your throat — not the hard *k* of *kófe*. It **looks like Latin *x*** and says nothing like it: a fourth false friend, alongside в, р, с, н from Chapter 1.

л, е, б you already have. Keep х apart from last lesson's letter for *f*: one is a throat rasp, the other a clean *f*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Here is the twist this chapter has been building to. хлеб looks and sounds completely native — nothing about it announces itself as foreign the way *kófe* or *chai* do. But it is a **borrowing**, and an ancient one: Proto-Slavic took it from **Proto-Germanic *hlaibaz**, the same root that gave English **loaf** and German **Laib**. It happened so far back in prehistory — long before *kófe*'s eighteenth century or *chai*'s Silk Road centuries — that the word has had well over a thousand years to stop feeling borrowed at all.

So the chapter's four words sort into a pattern worth naming outright:

word	route	age
вода	inherited straight from PIE	prehistoric, native
kófe	Arabic → Turkish → Dutch, **by sea**	18th century
chai	Chinese → Persian → Turkic, **overland**	centuries old
хлеб	Germanic *hlaibaz	prehistoric, but **borrowed**

Вода and хлеб both feel completely native — but only one of them actually is. Age can disguise a loanword as thoroughly as it can preserve an inheritance.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "хлеб" — the raspy х, masculine
- "Khleb, pazhálusta."
- all four requests — "Vodá, kófe, chai, khleb, pazhálusta" — one request word covering the whole table
- "Ya lyublyú khleb." — the same pattern that closed *kófe*'s lesson

Before you move on

Say "bread," with its gender, and ask for it politely. (*Khleb* — **masculine**; *Khleb, pazhálusta.*) What does х sound like, and which Latin letter does it impersonate? (A raspy **kh**; looks like **x**.) Which of this chapter's four words is native, which is borrowed but looks native, and which two are visibly foreign? (Вода native; хлеб borrowed from Germanic but disguised by age; *kófe* and *chai*, both visibly loans, by opposite routes.) Say "I love bread," recalling the verb Chapter 5 ended on. (*Ya lyublyú khleb* — люблю, with its inserted л.)

Chapter 7

Friend and Siblings

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a friend, brother and sister in Russian, build a feminine person-noun with по-...-а, and say which pronoun, ты or вы, goes with each.
>
> *The chapter closes on* сестра*,* брат*'s securely cognate pair: the reader produces* друг*,* подруга*,* брат *and* сестра *with their genders, builds the* по-...-а *feminine pattern on* подруга*, and names all four as exactly who Chapter 2's* ты *was for. It reaches back to Chapter 5's* брать*/*брат *minimal pair and rescues three Chapter 2 atoms — the* ты*/*вы *comparison, the vy-politeness pragmatics, and the ty/thou etymology — that nothing had revisited since.*

7.1 друг — "friend," the word that explains why *ty* exists

A new chapter, and the first word in it names exactly who Chapter 2's informal *ty* was built for.

You'll want to know first — друг

друг — *drug* — **friend** (a man, or a friend generally)

Consonant-final, so masculine — the ending rule holding steady for the third time. Every letter is one you already read — none of them the throat-rasp х that *khleb* just taught you; that one waits for a later word.

(Romanized, this word is spelled exactly like the English ***drug*** *— pure accident of transliteration, no shared root at all. Say it* drook-*ish, not like the English word it happens to resemble on the page.)*

This is the noun Chapter 2's whole *ty/vy* choice was about. *Ty* is for a друг — someone close enough that formality would feel wrong. *Vy* is for the stranger, the elder, the shopkeeper: everyone друг does not cover.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

друг is Indo-European **d*^{h}*rewg*^{h}-, "to accompany, to be loyal" — a companion-on-the-road sense, not far from друг's meaning today. Its clearest descendants sit outside everyday modern English: Gothic **gadrauhts**, "warrior" (literally one who accompanies), and Old English **dryhten**, "lord" — originally the leader a troop of *drauhts* followed, a word that survives only in old poetry now, not in ordinary speech.
Unlike *khleb*'s tidy modern cousin *loaf*, this is a root that mostly vanished from English rather than one that thrived in it — worth saying plainly rather than stretching for a connection that isn't really there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "друг" — masculine, consonant ending
- the pair — "ty for a друг, vy for everyone else"
- the false friend on paper — "drug, spelled like the English word, unrelated to it"
- last chapter's letter — "х, the throat-rasp from khleb"

Before you move on

Say "friend." (Друг.) Which pronoun goes with a друг, and which is for everyone else? (*Ty* for a friend; *vy* otherwise.) What did друг's root originally mean? (**To accompany, to be loyal** — Gothic *gadrauhts*, "warrior"; English *dryhten*, now archaic.) Is друг related to the English word it looks like on the page? (**No** — pure spelling coincidence.) And what English word is *khleb*'s modern

cousin? (**Loaf.**)

7.2 подруга — "friend" (female), built on the word you just learned

Russian doesn't reach for a new word to make друг feminine — it builds one, in front of your eyes, out of pieces you already have.

You'll want to know first — подруга

подруга — *podrúga* — **friend** (a woman)

Ends in -а, so feminine — the rule holding for the second time in this chapter, this time on a longer word.

Grammar Lens: watch the word get built

Take друг apart and put it back together:

по- (a prefix here worn down to little independent meaning) + друг (friend) + -а (the feminine ending) → подруга

This is Russian's ordinary machinery for turning a masculine person-word feminine: keep the root, change the ending, sometimes add a light prefix along the way. It is the same instinct English uses in *host* → *host-ess* or *actor* → *actr-ess* — a suffix doing the work — except Russian reaches for this pattern constantly, on ordinary words, not just a formal handful.
Say the pair together and the family resemblance is obvious:

друг · подруга — *drug* · *podrúga*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "подруга" — feminine, stress on the second syllable

- the build — "по- plus друг plus -а"
- the pair — "друг, подруга"

Before you move on

Say "friend" for a woman. (Подруга.) What three pieces build it, and what does each contribute? (По- + друг + -а, the feminine ending.) What English pattern does the same job, on different words? (**-ess**, as in *host/hostess*.) And what does друг itself trace back to? (**PIE *d^hrewg^h-*, "to accompany, be loyal."**)

7.3 брат — "brother," the noun Chapter 5 already warned you about

Chapter 5 told you брат meant "brother" and was **not** related to the verb *brat'*, "to take" — a warning, in passing, about a word not yet properly taught. Here it is, properly taught.

You'll want to know first — брат

брат — *brat* — **brother**. **Masculine.**

Consonant-final, so the ending rule holds a fourth time. And here is the minimal pair Chapter 5 flagged: брат (brother) against *brat'* (to take, romanized *brat'*) — one soft sign, and nothing else, separates them. Say *brat* with a hard final *t* for "brother"; *brat'* with a soft one for "to take."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

брат is Indo-European *$b^hréh_2tēr$ — and this time the resemblance to English is not a trap but the real thing: **brother** is the same word, inherited, not borrowed. So is Latin **frāter** (→ **fraternal**, **fraternity**), and Sanskrit **bhrātar**. Few words in any language family are reconstructed with as much confidence as this one.
Recall Chapter 5's other two *b^h- words, because the three sit right next to each other and mean three different things: *brat'* (*b^her-, "to carry" → **bear**, **birth**), *byt'* (*b^huH-, "to be" → English **be**), and now брат (*$b^hréh_2tēr$, "brother"). Three roots, one shared opening sound, no shared meaning — a family accent, not a family.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "брат" — hard final t, brother
- the minimal pair — "брат, brat'" — one soft sign apart
- "brother, frāter, bhrātar" — the same word, three languages
- the chapter so far — *drug, podrúga, brat*

Before you move on

Say "brother." (брат.) What one sound separates it from *brat'*, "to take"? (**A soft sign** — none in брат, one in *brat'*.) Is брат's resemblance to English **brother** real or a trap? (**Real** — inherited, like Latin *frāter* and Sanskrit *bhrātar*.) Name Chapter 5's two other $*b^h$- words, and what each one means. (*Byt'*, "to be"; *brat'*, "to take" — three different roots, one shared sound.)

7.4 сестра — "sister," and the chapter closes on four people

Брат (*brat*)'s partner, one more secure cognate, and the four people this chapter has introduced you to, gathered in one place.

You'll want to know first — сестра

сестра — *sestrá* — **sister**. **Feminine.**

Ends in -а, stress on the end: *ses-TRÁ*. Say брат and сестра together and you have both siblings, both genders' endings, in one breath.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сестра is Indo-European $*swésōr$ — and, like брат, this is a straight inheritance, not a loan and not a false lead. English **sister** is the same word (by way of Old Norse, reinforcing an Old English form that had drifted further); Latin's version, **soror**, took a bumpier sound-change road to the same root. Brother and sister arrive as a matched pair in Russian exactly as they do in the deep history of the whole family.

Grammar Lens: who gets *ty*

Chapter 2 gave you *ty* for someone close and *vy* for everyone else — the same choice English used to make with **thou** and **you**, before *thou* died out and *you* took over both jobs. This chapter has now named exactly who sits on the *ty* side of that line: a *drug*, a *podrúga*, a брат, a сестра — the people close enough that formality would be strange. Everyone else still gets *vy*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "сестра" — feminine, stress on the end
- the pair — "брат, сестра" — brother, sister
- the four people — *drug, podrúga, brat, sestrá*
- "sister, soror" — same root, one smooth, one bumpy

Before you move on

Say "sister," with its gender. (Сестра — **feminine**.) Is its resemblance to English **sister** real? (**Yes** — both from PIE **swésōr*.) Name all four people this chapter taught, and which pronoun goes with every one of them. (*Drug, podrúga, brat, sestrá* — all *ty*.) What pair of English words used to make the same close/distant choice Russian's *ty*/*vy* still makes? (**Thou** and **you**.)

Chapter 8

Family

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a family in Russian, and say what its own root shares with the English word home.
>
> *A one-lesson chapter that gathers Chapter 7's four people under* семья*, and reaches all the way back to Chapter 3's* жить *to rescue that lesson's stranded etymon — the two words share an idea, if not a root, and the chapter says so honestly.*

8.1 семья — "family," the word that gathers the chapter before it

> One word to hold everyone Chapter 7 introduced — and a root that turns out to be hiding an English word you use every day.

You'll want to know first — семья

> семья — *sem'yá* — **family**

The soft sign softens the м; stress lands on the final -я, so it rhymes with *drug* · *podrúga* · брат · сестра — this is the word that gathers all four of them.

(Note the ending: -ья *is a soft-consonant variant of* -я*, and still counts as the regular feminine ending from Chapter 6's rule.)*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

семья is Indo-European **ḱey-*, "to lie down, to settle" — the same root that, through the Baltic branch, gave Lithuanian **šeimà**, "family," and Ancient Greek **kōmē**, "village." That is already a wide family. But it goes one branch further: through **Proto-Germanic *haimaz**, "home, village," the very same root became English **home** — and, in its diminutive form, **hamlet** — and it survives fossilized in every English place name ending in **-ham**: *Birmingham*, *Nottingham*, *Durham*. Settle somewhere, and Slavic calls the people you settled with your семья; the deep Germanic cousin of that same root calls the place itself your *home*.
Chapter 3 taught you *zhit'*, "to live" — a different root (PIE *$g^{w}eyh_{3}$-, the one behind English *quick* in its old sense of "alive"), but the same idea from a different angle: семья is who you settle with; *zhit'* is what you do once you're there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "семья" — soft м, stress on -я
- the four it gathers — "drug, podrúga, brat, sestrá — moyá sem'yá" in idea, if not yet in Russian grammar
- the cousin — "*ḱey-* settle → семья, and → home, hamlet, -ham"
- "семья, zhit'" — who you settle with, and what you do there

Before you move on

Say "family." (Семья.) What English word is its distant Germanic cousin, and what three English place-name endings preserve the same root? (**Home** — and every **-ham** place name: *Birmingham*, *Nottingham*, *Durham*.) Which earlier verb shares the same idea, if not the same root, and what did that verb's own root originally mean? (*Zhit'*, "to live" — PIE for "quick, alive.") Name the four people семья gathers. (*Drug, podrúga, brat, sestrá.*)

Chapter 9

Eyes, Ears, Mouth, and Nose

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the ear, nose, mouth and eye in Russian with their genders, and say which trace to a secure ancient root and which do not.
>
> *The chapter closes on* глаз*, the word that quietly evicted Russian's true inherited eye-word: the reader produces all four face words with their genders, names* ухо *and* нос *as secure PIE cognates, names* рот *as an honest dead end, and traces* глаз *back to slang for 'ball' while placing the real cousin of English eye,* око*, inside* очки*. It is the first realization of SPINE-CHECK-WELLBEING in this track, and it reaches back to Chapter 3's* видеть *and* говорить*, rescuing three atoms nothing had revisited.*

9.1 ухо — "ear," and Russian's third gender finally arrives

A new chapter, a new part of the body, and the last of Chapter 6's three genders — held back until now, on purpose.

You'll want to know first — ухо

ухо — *úkho* — **ear**. **Neuter.**

Stress on the first syllable: *Ú-kho*. Ends in **-о**, so — finally — Chapter 6's third row: **-о and -е mark the neuter**, and here is the first word in this book to actually wear it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ухо is Indo-European **h₂ous-*, and the cousin web is about as tight as this book gets: English **ear** is the same word; so is Latin **auris** (→ **auricle**, **aural**), and Greek **ous** (→ **otitis**, an ear infection). Four languages, one unbroken thread from a single ancient root — no borrowing, no replacement, nothing lost along the way.
That makes ухо the plainest kind of cousin in this book: not a loanword like *кóфе*, not a word that replaced an older one, just the same PIE root worn down four different ways in four different mouths.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ухо" — stress on the front, neuter
- the third row — "-о and -е, neuter"
- "ear, auris, ous" — one root, three languages

Before you move on

Say "ear." (*Úkho.*) What gender is it, and which ending finally shows it? (**Neuter** — **-о**.) Name two other languages that share the same root word for "ear." (**English *ear*, Latin *auris*** — also Greek *ous*.) Is this word borrowed or inherited? (**Inherited**, straight from PIE, no detour.)

9.2 нос — "nose," a second straight cousin in a row

One syllable, one gender back to consonant-final masculine, and another word that never left the family.

You'll want to know first — нос

нос — *nos* — **nose**. **Masculine.**

Consonant-final, back to the first row of Chapter 6's table. Every letter is one you have read since Chapter 1.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

HOC is Indo-European **nas-*, and it barely needs translating: English **nose** is the same word, and so is Latin **nasus** (→ **nasal**, **nasturtium**, the "nose-twisting" flower). Say *nos* next to *nose* and *nasus* and the family resemblance needs no explaining at all.
Two body-part words in a row, *úkho* and HOC, and both are the same kind of cousin: no loan, no replacement, just the same ancient root, worn down along three different paths to the same meaning.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "HOC" — one syllable, masculine
- "nose, nasus" — barely disguised
- the pair so far — "úkho, HOC"

Before you move on

Say "nose," with its gender. (Hoc — **masculine**.) Name its two closest cousins. (**English *nose*, Latin *nasus*.**) What English flower name comes from the Latin cousin? (***Nasturtium***.) Which earlier word in this chapter is the same kind of straight inheritance? (*Úkho*, "ear.")

9.3 POT — "mouth," where the cousin trail actually runs out

Two straight cousins in a row was good luck, not the rule. This one has no secure English relative at all — and it belongs to a verb you already own.

You'll want to know first — POT

POT — *rot* — **mouth**. **Masculine.**

Consonant-final, masculine again. *(On paper this romanizes exactly like the English word **rot** — another spelling coincidence, like Russian* drug *and English* drug*, with no shared history at all.)*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Úkho and нос both handed you a clean English cousin. рот does not. Its Proto-Slavic ancestor ***rŭtŭ** originally meant "beak, snout" and is **probably** related to *ryt'*, "to dig, to burrow" — the picture of an animal's snout rooting through the ground, later widened to any mouth, including yours. There is **no secure link to English *mouth*** at all: English's word comes from an entirely separate Germanic root, ***munþaz**, with no shared ancestor here. Where Chapter 4's *chitát* had no English descendant, this word has no English *ancestor* in common — a different kind of dead end, and worth naming exactly that plainly rather than forcing a connection that isn't there.
What рот does have is a job you have been practising since Chapter 3: it is what makes *govorít'* possible. You met г as Greek gamma on *govorít"*s very first line; here is the mouth that has been saying it ever since.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "рот" — one syllable, masculine
- the honest dead end — "no English cousin, only ryt', 'to dig'"
- "рот, govorít'" — the mouth, and what it has been doing since Chapter 3

Before you move on

Say "mouth," with its gender. (Рот — **masculine**.) Is it related to English *mouth*? (**No** — separate Germanic root, no shared ancestor.) What is its own best guess of an origin? (*Ryt'*, "to dig" — a snout rooting the ground.) Which Chapter 3 verb does the mouth make possible, and what letter did that verb first teach you? (*Govorít'*; the letter г, Greek gamma.)

9.4 глаз — “eye,” the word for the eye that isn’t the word for the eye

The last of four face words, and the strangest story in the chapter: Russian’s everyday word for “eye” is not the word Indo-European gave it for “eye” at all.

You’ll want to know first — глаз

глаз — *glaz* — **eye**. **Masculine.**

Consonant-final, masculine, closing the chapter’s four with the same pattern that opened it in Chapter 6.

*(Tempting, on the page, to link this to English **glass** — the spellings even rhyme. Resist it: they trace to two different PIE roots and are not cousins. Its real story is stranger than that coincidence.)*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Every other body word in this chapter kept its ancient Indo-European name. *Glaz* did not. *Glaz* began in Old Russian as ***glazŭ**, “a ball, a glass bead, a smooth round stone” — PIE **g(ʰ)el-*, “round.” Starting around the sixteenth century it spread as slang for “eyeball,” then simply “eye,” and it **completely displaced** the true inherited word. That older word was *oko* (plural *ochi*) — PIE **h₃ókʷs*, the actual, secure cousin of English **eye** itself, the same root behind Latin **oculus** (→ **ocular**, **monocle**) and Greek **ophthalmós**. *Oko* still exists, but only in poetry and set phrases now. Its one everyday survivor is hiding in plain sight: *ochki*, “eyeglasses,” is built directly on *ochi* — literally **“little eyes.”** So the word that means *eye* in Russian today is a Slavic upstart; the word that is actually your cousin only shows up when you put spectacles on.

This is Chapter 3’s *vídet’* completed at last: the organ that does the seeing turns out to have replaced its own name, while the verb for *seeing* stayed put the whole time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “глаз” — masculine, and not related to English *glass*

- the evicted word — “oko, ochi — the real cousin of *eye*”
- where it hides — “ochki, ’little eyes’”
- the whole face — “úkho, нос, рот, глаз”

Before you move on

Say “eye,” with its gender. (*Glaz* — **masculine**.) What did глаз originally mean, and what word did it push out? (**“Round object, ball”**; it displaced *oko*.) Where does the true inherited eye-word survive today? (*Ochki*, “glasses” — literally “little eyes.”) Name all four face words this chapter taught, in order. (*Úkho*, **нос, рот, глаз**.) Which Chapter 3 verb does the eye make possible, and what sound-swap did that verb teach in its *I* form? (*Vídet’*; **д → zh**, as in *vízhu*.)

Chapter 10

Heart

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the heart in Russian, pronounce its silent letter correctly, and name its cousins across three other languages.
>
> *A one-lesson chapter closing the tranche on* сердце*, the surest cognate in the book: the reader produces the word with its silent* д*, reads the new letter* ц*, names heart, cor and kardía as its cousins, and closes by naming* любить *as the verb the heart does — the last of Chapter 5's atoms to be rescued.*

10.1 сердце — "heart," the surest cousin in this book

One more letter, one silent consonant, and then the tightest Indo-European cognate set this book will show you.

You'll want to know first — сердце

сердце — *sérdtse* — **heart**. **Neuter.**

Ends in -це, a spelling variant of -о/-е forced by the letter before it — still Chapter 6's neuter row. Stress on the front: *SYÉRT-se*. And listen closely: the д is not pronounced at all. Four consonants in a row would be unsayable, so Russian drops the middle one in speech — write сердце, say *sérts-e*.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Cyrillic.) One new letter: ц.

- ц = **"ts,"** the sound at the end of English *cat**s***. No Latin look-alike to trip over — it simply hasn't been in your way until now.

с, е, р, д, е you already have.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сердце is Indo-European **ḱerd-*, and few roots in this book have travelled so far with so little disguise. English **heart** is the same word. Latin **cor**, genitive **cordis**, gave English **cordial** ("heartfelt"), **courage** (from the heart), and — by a long and surprising road through "to learn by heart" — **record**. Greek **kardía** gave **cardiac** and **cardiology**. Say *sérdtse*, *heart*, *cor*, *kardía* in a row and the family resemblance needs no proof.
It is fitting that the book's most secure cousin is also the organ Chapter 5 gave a verb to: *lyubít'*, with its inserted *l*, is what the сердце does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "сердце" — silent д, *SYÉRT-se*
- the new letter — "ц says ts, as in cats"
- "heart, cor, kardía" — one root, three more languages
- all five body words — "úkho, нос, рот, glaz, сердце"
- "Ya lyublyú" — the verb the heart does

Before you move on

Say "heart," with its gender, and pronounce it correctly. (Сердце — **neuter** — *sérts-e*, the д silent.) What sound does ц make? (**Ts**, as in *cats*.) Name three English words that share its root, beyond *heart* itself. (**Cordial, courage, record** — from Latin *cor/cordis*; or **cardiac**, from Greek *kardía*.) Which Chapter 5 verb is what the

heart does? (*Lyubít'*, "to love.")

Chapter 11

Parting Words

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can close a Russian conversation with the parting word that fits how long until I see the person again, and say good night.
>
> *The chapter closes on* спокойной ночи*, the last word of the day and the surest cognate in the chapter: the reader produces all six parting words in order, names* ночь *and* покой*'s English cousins, and hears the* до *+ genitive pattern that links five of the six. It is the first realization of SPINE-TAKE-LEAVE in this track, closing all six of the node's concepts, and it reaches back to Chapter 6 to rescue* ф*,* х*,* чай*,* хлеб *and the request pattern, nothing had revisited since.*

11.1 до свидания — "goodbye," built on a verb you already own

Plenty of meeting, greeting and naming so far, and not one word yet for closing the door behind you. That changes now — with a phrase built from a verb you already own.

You'll want to know first — до свидания

до свидания — *da svidániya* — **goodbye** (the ordinary, all-purpose parting word)

Two words, said fast as one: *da-svi-DA-ni-ya*. Every letter is one you already read.

Grammar Lens: до asks for the genitive

до means "until," and it always reshapes the word after it — the **genitive** case, Russian's way of marking "of" or "belonging to this event." Свидания is свидание wearing the shape до requires. You do not need the rule behind that shape yet — only that до always asks for one, and every parting word this chapter teaches will show it again.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свидание means "a meeting, a seeing of one another" — a noun built on *videt'sya*, "to see each other," which is your own verb *vídet'*, "to see," wearing the reflexive ending and the prefix с-, "together." Taken apart, the whole phrase reads: **"until [we] see each other again."** That is not a Russian oddity. **French *au revoir*** and **German *auf Wiedersehen*** are built the same way, on their own "see" verbs — every one of them says goodbye by promising to see you again, rather than by naming an ending. Russian's *vídet'* is the same root you met wearing English clothes as **wit**, **wise** and **video**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "до свидания" — *da-svi-DA-ni-ya*, all-purpose goodbye
- the verb inside it — "vídet', videt'sya, свидание — see, see each other, a seeing"
- the pattern — "до + genitive, every time"
- the three languages — "до свидания, au revoir, auf Wiedersehen — all 'until the re-seeing'"

Before you move on

Say "goodbye," the all-purpose way. (До свидания.) Which familiar verb is hiding inside it, and what does the whole phrase literally mean? (*Vídet'*, "to see" — literally "until [we] see each other again.") What case does до always ask for? (**The genitive.**) Name one other language that says goodbye the same way. (**French *au revoir*** or **German *auf Wiedersehen*.**) One last look back:

what word closed the previous lesson, and what English words share its root? (*Sérdtse*, "heart" — cousin of *heart*, Latin *cor/cordis*, Greek *kardía*.)

11.2 пока — "bye," the casual half of yesterday's word

Every formal word in this book has an informal twin somewhere. Here is до свидания's — and it turns out to share a root with a word you already own, from the other end of the book entirely.

You'll want to know first — пока

пока — *paká* — **bye** (casual — friends, family, anyone you'd use *ty* with)

Two syllables, stress on the second: *pa-KÁ*. Reach for до свидания with a stranger or someone older; reach for пока with exactly the people *drug* was about.

(Note: no genitive here at all — this word does not follow yesterday's до*-pattern. It is not built the same way, which is your first clue that it has a different history.)*

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пока is built from по- plus an old Slavic pronoun, *kyi*, "which, what kind" — the ancestor of the modern word какой, "which one." That pronoun descends from the same ancient Indo-European question-root, PIE ***k^{w}os**, "who," that gives Russian как ("how," the question word from *kak vas zovút?*) and, on the Germanic branch, the **entire English wh- family**: *who, what, when, where, why, which.* Пока is, at its root, a fossil of "however long" or "for the while that" — the same idea as English *while*, which shortens *for a while* into *bye for now.* But the word you are learning to say "bye" with is much younger than its root. Dictionaries record пока as a parting word only from the early 20th century — colloquial slang at first, likely modeled on English **"so long"** — centuries after *kyi* had already worn down into как and какой. The root is ancient; the goodbye is recent.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "пока" — *pa-KÁ*, casual bye
- the pair — "до свидания for a stranger, пока for a drug"
- the root — "как, пока — one ancient question-stem"
- the timeline — "the root is ancient; the goodbye is 20th century"

Before you move on

Say "bye," casually. (Пока.) Which earlier word shares its root, and what English word-family is its cousin? (*Kak*; English *who, what, when, where, why, which*.) Does пока follow yesterday's до + genitive pattern? (**No** — it is built differently.) How old is пока's use as a farewell? (**Only since the early 20th century.**) One more look back: which word closes on the sound *ts*, as in *cats*? (*Sérdtse*.)

11.3 до скорого — "see you soon," and a root that goes nowhere in English

Back to yesterday's до + genitive pattern — and to a word whose trail, unlike свидания's, simply stops before it reaches English.

You'll want to know first — до скорого

до скорого — *da skórava* — **see you soon**

Same shape as до свидания: до plus a genitive. The word underneath is *skóryy*, "quick" or "soon" — so this is literally **"until the soon [thing/meeting]."** Say it *da-SKÓ-ra-va*; that final -ого is spelled with a г but said like a в, a small spelling-versus-sound gap that shows up on this exact ending across the whole language, not just here.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

skóryy is native Slavic, from a Proto-Indo-European root reconstructed as ***sker-**, "to jump, to hurry" — the same root, on the Baltic branch, as Lithuanian *skėrỹs*, "locust" (a jumping insect, and a vivid enough image for "quick" that it needs no further gloss). Slavic languages keep a whole family on this root: Russian скоро ("soon"), Ukrainian скорий, Polish **skory**, Bulgarian скоро.
Unlike yesterday's до свидания, this root **does not reach English at all** — no confident cousin, on any branch. That is a different kind of honesty than пока's: пока had an ancient root but a young use as a farewell; *skóryy* has an ancient root and an ancient use, and simply never left a descendant in the language you already speak. *Chitát'* and рот taught you this shape of sentence already — some roots travel to England, and some do not, and a good etymology says so either way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "до скорого" — *da-SKÓ-ra-va*, see you soon
- the shape — "до + genitive, like до свидания"
- the honest gap — "*sker-*, 'to hurry' — no English cousin at all"
- the г-as-в spelling — "-ого, said -ova"

Before you move on

Say "see you soon." (До скорого.) What word for "quick, soon" is it built from, in the genitive? (*Skóryy.*) Does it have a secure English cousin? (**No** — PIE **sker-*, "to hurry," with no confident descendant in English.) What grammatical pattern does it share with до свидания? (**До + genitive.**) One more look back: which earlier word ends on the sound *ts*, as in *cats*? (*Sérdtse.*)

11.4 до завтра — "see you tomorrow," with the dawn hiding inside it

A precise version of "see you soon" — more definite than *da skórava*, warmer than *paká* — and, taken apart, a word for "to-

morrow" that turns out to be built directly on the word for "morning."

You'll want to know first — до завтра

до завтра — *da záftra* — **see you tomorrow**

Unlike the last two lessons, завтра does not change shape after до — it is an adverb, not a noun, so it has no genitive to show. Say it *da-ZÁF-tra*, with the в devoicing to an *f* sound in front of the voiceless т that follows it — the same kind of small sound-shift you already handle in *zdrávstvuyte*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

завтра splits cleanly into за-, "beyond, after," and *utro*, "morning" — so "tomorrow" is literally **"after-the-morning."** And *utro* is not a dead end the way last lesson's *skóryy* was: it continues Proto-Indo-European ***h₂ews-**, "to shine, to dawn" — the very root behind English **east** (the direction dawn comes from), Latin **aurora** ("dawn," and the name of the Roman dawn-goddess), and Greek **ēōs** ("dawn," also a goddess's name). Say *utro*, *east*, *aurora*, *ēōs* in a row and you are tracing one ancient sunrise across four languages.
So *da skórava* and до завтра make a matched pair: one word this book could not connect to English at all, and the very next one buried inside a word you use to talk about breakfast — the kind of contrast that only shows up when you keep asking the question honestly, lesson after lesson.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "до завтра" — *da-ZÁF-tra*, see you tomorrow
- the split — "за- 'after' + utro 'morning'"
- the cousins — "utro, east, aurora, ēōs — one root, four languages"
- the contrast — "skórava had no cousin; завтра has three"

Before you move on

Say "see you tomorrow." (До завтра.) Split it into its two parts and give their meanings. (**Za-**, "after" + *utro*, "morning.") Name three English/Latin/Greek cousins of *utro*. (**East, aurora, ēōs.**) Does завтра take a genitive after до, the way *skórava* did? (**No** — it is an adverb, unchanged.) One quick look back: what is the word for "eye," and what did it originally mean as slang? (*Glaz* — "round stone.")

11.5 до встречи — "see you later," a meeting built from two prefixes

Vaguer than *da záftra*, warmer than *da skórava* — the fifth parting word, and the last one built on the до + genitive pattern.

You'll want to know first — до встречи

до встречи — *da fstréchi* — **see you later** (no specific time promised, unlike *záftra*)

До plus the genitive of встреча, "a meeting" — the fourth phrase in a row to follow that shape. Say it *da-FSTRÉ-chi*: four consonants in a row at the front (в-с-т-р-), which is genuinely a mouthful even for a native speaker, so slow down on the approach and let each one land.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

встреча takes apart by its pieces rather than by a single ancient root: в-, "into," plus с-, "with, together," on an old Slavic base (Vasmer compares Lithuanian *surėsti*, "to catch") meaning roughly "to come upon." Put together, it is close to what English *meet* does when it means "to come together" — but that closeness is a match of **idea**, not of **ancestry**: there is no secure shared root behind the two words, the same honest gap this chapter already met in *skórava*.

That makes two of this chapter's five words so far with **no** confirmed English cousin (*skórava*, встречи), against three that connect cleanly (свидания, *paká*'s root, *záftra*). A chapter of goodbyes turns out to be as good a place as any to see that ratio plainly: a good deal of what a language says every day traces back to something you already know,

and a good deal simply does not, and neither half is the "real" Russian.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "до встречи" — *da-FSTRÉ-chi*, see you later
- the pieces — "в- 'into' + с- 'with' + an old 'come upon' root"
- idea vs. ancestry — "close to *meet* in meaning, not in history"
- the running count — "two of the five with no English cousin so far"

Before you move on

Say "see you later." (До встречи.) Which two prefixes is встреча built from? (в-, "into," and с-, "with.") Is it a true cousin of English *meet*, or only a resemblance in meaning? (**Only in meaning** — no secure shared root.) How many of this chapter's words so far have no confirmed English cousin so far? (**Two**: *skórava* and встречи.)

11.6 спокойной ночи — "good night," the chapter's most secure cousin

The last of six ways to close a conversation — and, fittingly for the final word before sleep, the phrase with the deepest and most secure roots in the whole chapter.

You'll want to know first — спокойной ночи

спокойной ночи — *spakóynay nóchi* — **good night**

Unlike this chapter's five до-phrases, there is no до here at all: this is the genitive standing alone, after an unspoken wish — **"[I wish you] a calm night."** Say it *spa-KOY-nay NO-chi*. It closes the day the way *zdrávstvuyte* opens one, back at the very start of this book: a whole sentence's worth of meaning compressed into two words.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

noch', "night," is Proto-Indo-European ***nók^{w}ts** — one of the most secure cognate sets that survives anywhere in the family, changed almost nothing on its way here: English **night**, Latin **nox / noctis** (→ *nocturnal*, *equinox*), Greek **nýx** (→ *nyctophobia*). Say *noch', night, nox, nyx* together and there is no gap left to explain.
Спокойной carries an equally solid, if less obvious, root. It is built on покой, "calm, rest, peace," from PIE ***k^{w}eih$_1$-**, "to rest, be quiet" — the same root, through Latin **quiēs**, as English **quiet**, **quiescent**, and **tranquil**; and, through a separate Germanic path (Gothic *hveila*, "a space of time"), the same root as English **while**. Rest, quiet, and "a while" all sit on one ancient idea of stillness — and Russian says good night by wishing you both the darkness and the calm in the same two words.
That makes the chapter's tally, word by word: свидания (cousin: *see*), пока's root (cousin: *who/what/why*), скорого (no cousin), *záftra* (cousin: *east*), встречи (no cousin), and ночи / спокойной (**several cousins each**). The book's last word before sleep turns out to be its best evidence yet that English and Russian are the same language, worn down two very different ways for four thousand years.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "спокойной ночи" — *spa-KOY-nay NO-chi*, good night
- "noch', night, nox, nyx" — one root, barely worn down
- "покой, quiet, tranquil, while" — one more
- all six parting words, in order — "da svidániya, paká, da skórava, da záftra, da fstréchi, spakóynay nóchi"

Before you move on

Say "good night." (Спокойной ночи.) Name three English cousins of *noch'*. (**Night, nox, nyx.**) Name two English cousins of покой. (**Quiet** and **tranquil** — or **while**.) Now reach all the way back to the water-coffee-tea-bread words: which of them carries the *f* sound,

and what does х sound like? (*Kófe*; a raspy **kh**, from *khleb.*) Ask for tea or bread politely, the pattern *chai, pazhálusta* already taught. (*Chai, pazhálusta. Khleb, pazhálusta.*)

Chapter 12

Mother and Father

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my mother and father in Russian, in both the affectionate and the formal register, and say which one is a real cousin of the English word and which is not.
>
> *The chapter closes on* отец*, the surprise of the pair: the reader produces* мама*,* папа*,* мать *and* отец*, states the natural-gender exception* папа *tests, and names* мать *as a secure PIE cousin of mother while* отец *is not a cousin of father at all. It reaches back to Chapter 8's* семья *to complete the family it gathers, and rescues four atoms nothing had revisited since Chapters 2, 7 and 8.*

12.1 мама — "mom," a resemblance that isn't really a cousin

> Say good night, say see-you-later, and now a new chapter — back to *sem'yá* to fill it in, one person at a time, starting with a word that looks like a cousin of English and, on close inspection, is not really one at all.

You'll want to know first — мама

> мама — *máma* — **mom, mum** (the everyday, affectionate word)

Stress on the first syllable, *MÁ-ma*. Ends in **-а**, so the noun-gender ending rule holds: feminine, matching the person it names.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Every etymology so far in this book has asked the same question: does this word share an **ancestor** with an English one? *Máma* is the first word where the honest answer requires a different question entirely. *Máma* is not descended from Proto-Indo-European, and it is not borrowed from anywhere. Babies across the world, whatever language surrounds them, babble the same easy sounds first — an open **a**, made with a wide-open mouth, paired with the simplest consonants a mouth can make by pressing the lips together: **m**, **b**, **p**. Parents everywhere hear that babble and adopt it, so *nearly every language on earth* ends up with something that sounds like *mama* for "mother" — Mandarin **māma**, French **maman**, Swahili **mama**, English **mama** — without any of them having borrowed the word or inherited it from a common source. It is not a family resemblance; it is a resemblance built from the shape of a human mouth, reinvented from scratch in every generation.

That is a genuinely different kind of "no" from рот's or *da skórava*'s — those had no cousin **because** no one has found one. *Máma* has no cousin **because the question does not apply**: it was never inherited in the first place.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "мама" — feminine, first-syllable stress
- the babble sounds — "open a, plus m, b, or p"
- the world tour — "māma, maman, mama, mama"
- the distinction — "not a family resemblance; the same invention, everywhere"

Before you move on

Say "mom." (*Máma.*) What gender, and why? (**Feminine** — ends in **-а**.) Why does мама resemble the word for "mother" in so many unrelated languages? (**Universal infant babbling** — the easiest sounds a baby's mouth makes, not shared ancestry.) Is this the same kind of "no cousin" as рот or *da skórava*? (**No** — those simply have

not been traced to one; мама was never inherited at all.)

12.2 папа — "dad," the word that breaks the ending rule on purpose

Máma's twin, built the same babbling way — but this one does something *kófe* only hinted at: it breaks the noun-gender ending rule outright, and tells you exactly when that is allowed to happen.

You'll want to know first — папа

папа — *pápa* — **dad, papa** (the everyday, affectionate word)

Stress on the first syllable, *PÁ-pa* — the same rhythm as *máma*, the *m* simply swapped for п. Same babbling story, same easy vowel, one consonant apart.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

папа is a nursery word, like Greek *páppa* and Latin *pāpa*, "father". Vasmer thinks Russian probably took it from French *papa*, as German did; the old noble папа, stressed on its last syllable, is surely French.

Grammar Lens: when biology beats the ending

Here is the rule you already know: -а/-я endings are feminine. Папа ends in -а — and папа is **masculine**.
This is not another *kófe*, a fossil accident that happens to break the pattern. It is a real, live rule of its own, and a small closed set of words follows it: any noun naming a **male person** is masculine, whatever letter it ends in, because Russian lets biology outrank spelling for people. You will meet the rule's other members later — дядя ("uncle") and *dédushka* ("grandpa") both end in -я/-а and are both masculine for exactly this reason. Папа is your first sighting of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “папа” — masculine, despite the -а
- the rule — “a male person is always masculine, whatever the ending”
- the pair — “máma, feminine; папа, masculine — same ending, opposite gender”

Before you move on

Say “dad.” (Папа.) What gender is it, and does that match its -а ending? (**Masculine** — it does **not** match; a male person overrides the ending.) Name the shared origin of *máma* and папа. (**Universal infant babbling** — the easiest mouth sounds, reinvented everywhere.) Name one other Russian word that will follow the same male-person rule later. (Дядя or *dédushka*.) And one last look further back: how do you say “good night”? (*Spakóynay nóchi*.)

12.3 мать — “mother,” the word мама only pretends to resemble

The formal word behind yesterday’s affectionate one — and, unlike мама, a word with a real, unbroken, six-thousand-year paper trail straight to the English word you already own.

You’ll want to know first — мать

мать — *mat’* — **mother** (formal register: forms, introductions, “my mother is a doctor”)

One syllable, softened by the ь at the end — the same soft sign you already read in *óchen* and семья. Feminine, matching мама, but reach for мать where English would reach for *mother* rather than *mom*: on a form, in an introduction, talking *about* her rather than *to* her.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Where мама only **resembles** English *mama* by babbling coincidence, мать is the genuine article: Proto-Indo-European ***méh₂tēr**, one of the oldest reconstructed words in the entire family, and one whose meaning has not shifted at all in perhaps six thousand years. English

mother, Latin **māter** (→ *maternal*, *matrix*), Greek **mḗtēr** (→ *metropolis*, literally "mother city"), and Sanskrit **mātar** all continue the same word. Say мать*, mother, māter, mḗtēr, mātar* together and you are pronouncing one sentence's worth of unbroken history. Linguists suspect **méh₂tēr* itself grew out of the same infant babble as мама — the *m*-sound a baby makes first — but so long ago, and so thoroughly grammaticalized into "mother" across every daughter language, that it counts as real inheritance now, not live coincidence. *Máma* is that babble happening again, fresh, in front of you; мать is the fossil the same babble left five thousand years ago.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "мать" — one syllable, soft ть
- "мать, mother, māter, mḗtēr, mātar" — one word, five languages
- the register split — "мама to her; мать about her"
- the two kinds of "m" — "мама, live babble; мать, ancient fossil"

Before you move on

Say "mother," formally. (*Mat'*.) Name three language cousins beyond English *mother*. (**Latin *māter*, Greek *mḗtēr*, Sanskrit *mātar*.**) Is мать's connection to *mother* the same kind of thing as мама's? (**No** — мать is true inheritance; мама is fresh babble that merely resembles it.) When would you say мама instead of мать? (**To her, informally** — not on a form or in a formal introduction.)

12.4 отец — "father," an old word that is a stranger to its English namesake

Mat' just gave you the cleanest cousin in this book. Its partner is the opposite kind of surprise: an equally ancient word — and one with **no** relation at all to the English word it translates.

You'll want to know first — отец

отец — *atéts* — **father** (formal register, matching *mat'*)

Stress on the last syllable, *a-TÉTS*. Consonant-final, so — regular rule, no exception needed this time — masculine.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Here is the twist *mat'* did not prepare you for. *Atéts* is genuinely old — it continues Proto-Indo-European ***átta**, itself a nursery address-word for "father," parallel to *máma*'s babble but grammaticalized into the formal word millennia ago. Its cousins are real: **Gothic *atta***, **Latin *atta*** (an affectionate, informal "papa," distinct from the formal *pater*), **Hittite *attaš***, **Ancient Greek *átta.*** But *none of those is English* ***father***. English *father* continues a **completely different** PIE root, ***ph₂tḗr**, the formal word matched to **méh₂tēr* "mother" — the very cousin set *mat'* just gave you. Slavic simply **lost** that word somewhere in its history and replaced it with the *atta*-family word instead. So the two halves of this book's family pair are not symmetric at all: *mat'* kept the ancient formal word and still matches *mother*; отец kept an ancient word too, just a *different* one, and the formal match with *father* never survived into Slavic at all. Introduce your own family the way you already learned to introduce yourself: *Menyá zovút…* for you; *Yevó zovút…* ("**his** name is…" — that same unnamed "they," and the same object-shaped pronoun его that вас/тебя already showed you a piece of) for your father, brother, or anyone else.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "отец" — *a-TÉTS*, masculine
- the real cousins — "atta, atta, attaš — Gothic, Latin, Hittite"
- the honest gap — "NOT father — that word is *ph₂tḗr*, lost from Slavic entirely"
- the naming pattern — "Menyá zovút… / Yevó zovút…"

Before you move on

Say "father," formally. (*Atéts.*) Is it related to English *father*? (**No** — *father* is **ph₂tḗr*, a different root Slavic lost; отец continues **átta* instead.) Name three real cousins of отец. (**Gothic *atta*, Latin *atta*, Hittite *attaš*.**) Now reach back to Chapters 2, 7 and 8: how would you say "his name is…", and what word gathers everyone this chapter just named? (*Yevó zovút…*; *sem'yá*, the word for *drug, podrúga,* брат, сестра — and now *máma,* папа, *mat',* отец too.)

Chapter 13

Milk, Cheese, Juice, and Soup

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name milk, cheese, juice and soup in Russian with their genders, ask for any of them politely, and say which are inherited and which are borrowed.
>
> *The chapter closes on* суп*, a French loan that mirrors* кофе*'s story from the opposite direction: the reader produces* молоко*,* сыр*,* сок *and* суп *with their genders, extends Chapter 6's request pattern to all four, and sorts the set into a hand-motion cousin, a taste cousin, an honest dead end, and a shared loanword. It reaches all the way back to Chapter 2 to rescue the naming-question comparison and* я*'s script warning, the last two atoms in the track that nothing had revisited.*

13.1 молоко — "milk," a cousin down to the hand motion

Mat' and *atéts* just closed the family — remember папа's odd masculine ending on the way past — and now a new chapter, back to the water-coffee-tea-bread drink shelf to add three more words, starting with one whose English cousin shares not just a sound, but the very gesture the word describes.

You'll want to know first — молоко

молоко — *malakó* — **milk**. **Neuter.**

Stress on the last syllable, and the two unstressed **о**s both reduce toward *a* — the *akanye* rule from your very first lessons, doing real work here: *ma-la-KÓ*, not *mo-lo-KO*. The **-о** ending gives the third gender, same row as *úkho* and *sérdtse*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молоко continues Proto-Indo-European ***h₂melǵ-**, "to rub, to stroke, to milk" — a root that names the *motion of the hand*, not the liquid itself, exactly the way English **milk** does too: English **milk**, German **Milch**, Latin **mulgeō** ("I milk," → the rare English *emulsion* relative), and Greek **amélgō** all continue the same word. Say **молоко**, *milk, Milch, mulgeō* together and every one of them still carries the memory of a hand closing around an udder.

One honest complication: some etymologists treat the Slavic word as a **borrowing** from early Germanic rather than an independent inheritance from the same PIE root — the same kind of hedge this book already gave *dúmat'* and its link to **doom**. Either way, **молоко** and *milk* share the same ultimate ancestor; the only open question is how directly.

Ask for it the way you already know:

Malakó, pazhálusta. — **Milk, please.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**молоко**" — *ma-la-KÓ*, neuter, both **о**'s reduced
- "**молоко**, milk, Milch, mulgeō" — the hand's motion, four languages
- "Malakó, pazhálusta." — the request pattern, holding steady

Before you move on

Say "milk," with its gender. (*Malakó* — **neuter**.) What did its PIE root originally describe — the liquid, or something else? (**The hand motion of milking.**) Name two Germanic cousins. (**Milk, Milch.**) Ask for milk politely. (*Malakó, pazhálusta.*)

13.2 сыр — "cheese," which is really just an old word for "sour"

Bread's natural partner, finally on the table — and a word whose Russian double life gives away exactly how it got its name.

You'll want to know first — сыр

сыр — *syr* — **cheese**. **Masculine.**

One syllable, consonant-final — the regular rule again, no exception. Say it with the vowel ты already made you practise: drawn back in the throat, not the *ee* of и.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сыр is, historically, the same word as сырой, "raw, damp, uncooked" — cheese named not for what it becomes, but for the state its milk was in on the way there. Both continue a Proto-Indo-European root for "sour, damp," and the family shows up right on English's own doorstep: **English *sour*** (Old English *sūr*, from the same Germanic branch), **Old Norse *súrr***, **Old High German *sûr***. Say сырой, *sour, súrr, sûr* and you are hearing one old idea of "gone tart" spread across the whole Germanic half of the family, with Russian's сыр sitting one short step away from all of it.
That gives you the chapter's drink-and-bread shelf a genuine internal logic: *malakó* was named for the *hand* that made it; сыр is named for the *taste* milk takes on before it becomes food at all.

Syr, pazhálusta. — **Cheese, please.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "сыр" — masculine, the pulled-back ы
- the double life — "сыр and сырой, one root"
- "сырой, sour, súrr, sûr" — Slavic and Germanic, side by side
- *syr, pazhálusta; khleb, pazhálusta* — cheese and bread, the request pattern's pair

Before you move on

Say "cheese," with its gender. (Сыр — **masculine**.) What Russian adjective does сыр secretly share its root with, and what does it mean? (Сырой, "raw, damp.") Name its English cousin. (**Sour.**) Ask for it politely. (*Syr, pazhálusta.*)

13.3 сок — "juice," ancient and untranslatable into English cousins

The third drink on this chapter's shelf — and, like скорого and *fstréchi* before it, a root old enough to reconstruct and still without a single confirmed English relative.

You'll want to know first — сок

сок — *sok* — **juice**. **Masculine.**

One syllable, consonant-final, the regular rule holding for the third lesson running. Every letter you have owned for a long time now.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сок reconstructs cleanly to Proto-Indo-European ***sok^{w}ós**, by way of Proto-Balto-Slavic ***sakás** — this is not a shaky guess the way рот's root was, but a solid reconstruction with real evidence behind it. What it does **not** have is a surviving cousin anywhere in English or the rest of Germanic: the trail is well documented all the way back, and then simply stops before it reaches the language you already speak.
That is worth holding next to *malakó* and *syr*, the two words either side of it on this shelf: three drinks, three different outcomes. *Malakó* connects to English down to the hand motion. *Syr* connects through a Germanic side door, by way of *sour*. Сок connects to nothing at all — and all three are equally real, equally ancient Russian.

Sok, pazhálusta. — **Juice, please.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “сок” — masculine, one syllable
- the honest gap — “*sok^{w}ós, well attested, no English cousin”
- the three-way contrast — “malakó, syr, сок — hand motion, sourness, and nothing at all”
- “Sok, pazhálusta.” — juice, please

Before you move on

Say “juice,” with its gender. (Сок — **masculine**.) Does it have a confirmed English cousin? (**No** — a solid PIE root, but no surviving Germanic descendant.) Which of this chapter’s three drink words connects to English through a hand motion, and which through a taste? (*Malakó* through milking; *syr* through *sour*.) Ask for juice politely. (*Sok, pazhálusta.*)

13.4 суп — “soup,” the same French word English also borrowed

The last word on this chapter’s table — and, like *kófe* before it, a loanword rather than an inheritance, which makes it the perfect word to close on.

You’ll want to know first — суп

суп — *sup* — **soup**. **Masculine.**

One syllable, consonant-final, the regular rule holding one last time. Every letter is one you have owned for a long time now.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

суп is a straight loan from **French *soupe***, part of the flood of French vocabulary that entered Russian aristocratic life in the 1700s — the same century, and nearly the same social world, that gave *kófe* its own sea route into the language. Chase *soupe* back further and it comes from Late Latin **suppa**, “bread soaked in broth.”
Here is what makes суп different from everything else on this shelf: **English *soup* took the identical French word**, by a separate

crossing, centuries apart from Russian's own borrowing. So суп and *soup* **are** related — but by two languages independently reaching for the same French word, not by shared Russian-English ancestry. It mirrors *kófe* and *coffee*, which took one Arabic word by two different European doors; here, two languages took the *same* French door, just at different times.
Ask for the whole shelf the way you already know:

> *Malakó, syr, sok i sup, pazhálusta.* — **Milk, cheese, juice and soup, please.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "суп" — masculine, one syllable
- the loan — "French soupe, 1700s, same century as kófe"
- the mirror — "суп/soup: one French word, two borrowings; *kófe*/coffee: one Arabic word, two doors"
- the whole shelf — *malakó, syr, sok, sup, pazhálusta*

Before you move on

Say "soup," with its gender. (Суп — **masculine**.) When did it enter Russian, and from where? (**The 1700s**, from **French *soupe***.) Is суп related to English *soup* by inheritance or by borrowing? (**Borrowing** — two separate crossings of the same French word.) Now reach all the way back to the naming-question comparison: which languages ask "how do they call you" instead of "what is your name," and what must you never mistake this book's very first letter, я, for? (**Russian and French**, against English's *what*; **never a mirrored Latin R**.)

Chapter 14

Eleven Letters, Sorted Into Three Kinds

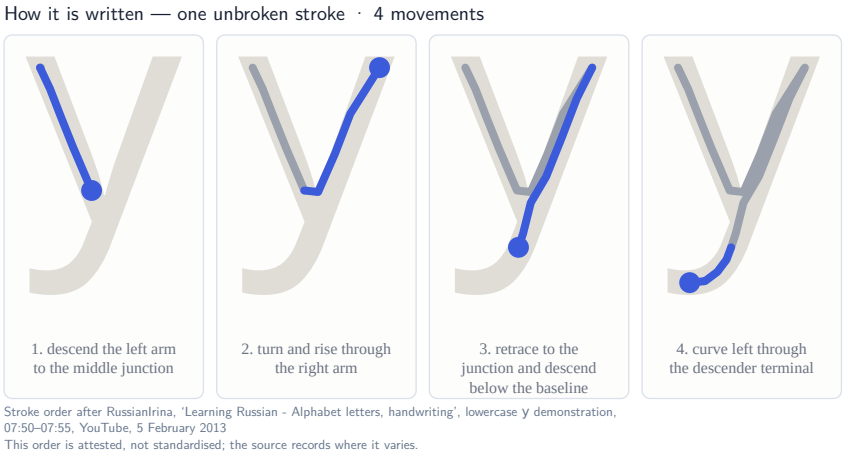
Modes: ✓ **pen** (11) **Hands-free start:** none of the 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write eleven more Cyrillic letters from memory, sort any Cyrillic letter into true friend, false friend or new shape, and explain what the soft sign does even though it makes no sound of its own.
>
> *A letter that is a whole syllable and looks like a backwards R that it has nothing to do with — closing a chapter whose organising idea is that every Cyrillic letter sorts into one of three kinds.*

14.1 у — the letter that looks like Latin y and says 'oo'

You have met the false friends and the first new shapes. This chapter takes the eleven letters that block the most words you cannot yet read.

Script



How у *is written, stroke by stroke*

у У

The capital, У, is the same shape drawn to full height, sitting on the line.

It looks like a Latin **y**. It is not one. It says **oo**, the vowel of English *boot*.

This is the single most expensive letter to get wrong, because it is common: it blocks more words in this book than any other letter you have left. Every time an English eye reads it as *y*, a word comes apart.

The shape is close to Latin *y* — a small bowl on top, a tail below the line — but the tail is usually straighter and the bowl smaller.

Say it round and short, with the lips pushed forward. Not the *y* of *yes*. Not the *u* of *cup*. The *oo* of *boot*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* у
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

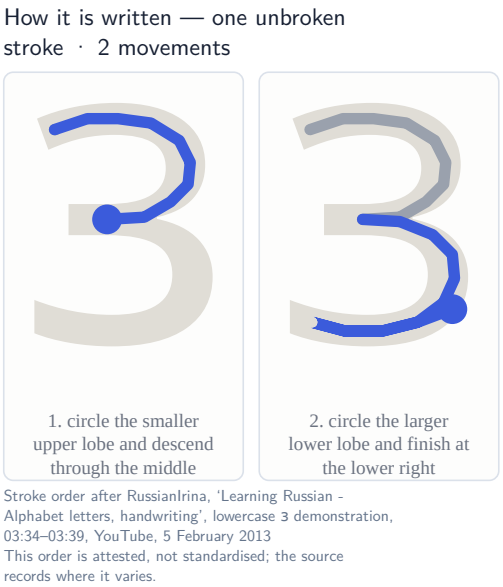
Before you move on

What does ы sound like? (**oo**, as in *boot*.) What does an English eye want it to be? (A **y** — and that is the trap.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.2 з — a letter shaped like the digit 3

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



How з *is written, stroke by stroke*

з З

The capital, З, is the same shape drawn to full height.

z, the *z* of English *zoo*. And the shape is exactly what it looks like: **the digit 3**.

That is not a coincidence to memorise around — it is simply a convenient hook, and a rare piece of luck in this alphabet. Nothing in Latin looks like this, so nothing can mislead you.

Write it as you would write a 3, and read it as *z*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* `З`
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

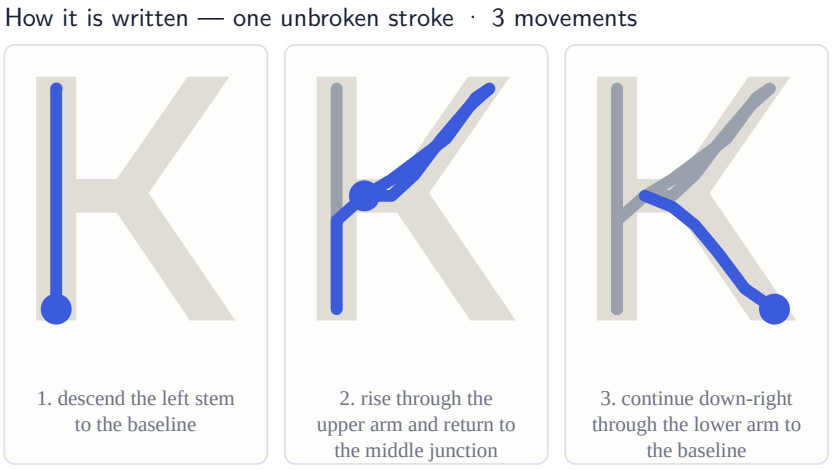
Before you move on

What does `З` sound like? (**z**.) And what does it look like? (The **digit 3**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.3 `К` — a true friend

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase к demonstration, 04:45–04:51, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How к *is written, stroke by stroke*

к K

The capital, K, is the Latin *K*.

k, the *k* of English *skip*. It looks like a Latin **k** and it **is** one.

Cyrillic letters come in three kinds for an English reader, and it is worth having the three named:

- **true friends** — look Latin, sound Latin. This one, and the letters romanised *a*, *o*, *m*, *t*.
- **false friends** — look Latin, sound different. у you just met, and the ones you met earlier as *v*, *r*, *s* and *n*.
- **new shapes** — look like nothing Latin at all. з from a moment ago, and the two you learned as *b* and *d*.

There is no fourth kind. Sorting every new letter into one of those three is most of what learning this alphabet is.

Your turn

- *Write it:* к
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

Before you move on

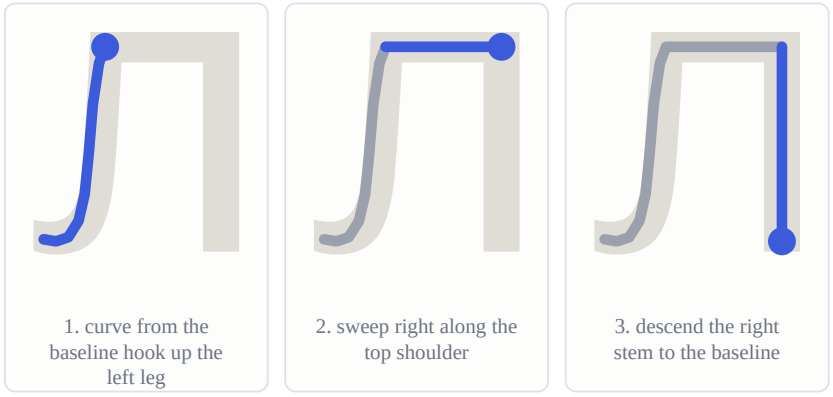
What are the three kinds of Cyrillic letter for an English reader? (**True friends**, **false friends**, **new shapes**.) Which is к? (A **true friend**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.4 л — a new shape

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. curve from the baseline hook up the left leg
2. sweep right along the top shoulder
3. descend the right stem to the baseline

Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase л demonstration, 05:06–05:10, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How л *is written, stroke by stroke*

л Л

The capital, Л, is the same two legs drawn to full height.

l, the *l* of English *love*. A **new shape**: nothing in Latin looks like it.

Two legs meeting at a peak, with the left leg kicking out; the hand draws both without lifting the pen. Written quickly it leans, and in some fonts it is nearly a triangle with an open base.

Careful with one thing. In handwriting л and м are close relatives, and you are about to meet м. The difference is the top: л comes to a **point**, м has a **dip** in the middle.

Your turn

- *Write it:* л
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

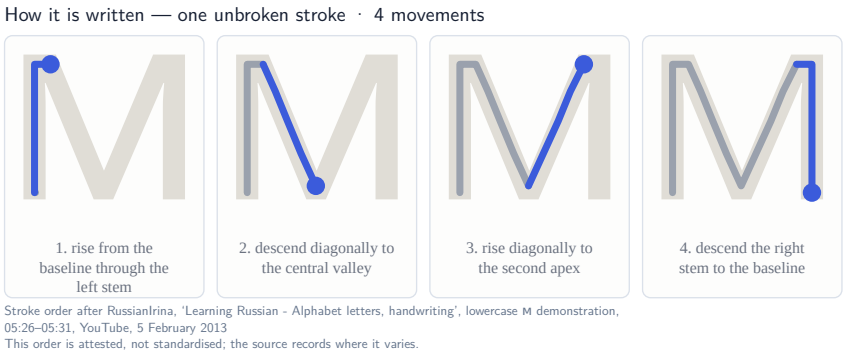
Before you move on

Is л a true friend, a false friend, or a new shape? (A **new shape**.)
How do you tell it from the letter coming next? (л peaks; the other **dips**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.5 м — a true friend, and its capital

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase м demonstration, 05:26–05:31, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How м is written, stroke by stroke

m, the *m* of English *met* — a **true friend** in both cases.

You have met a capital beside most letters so far, and here is the rule behind them: **most Cyrillic capitals are simply the lowercase letter drawn large.** Latin makes you learn two shapes for *a*, *b*, *d*, *e*, *g*; Cyrillic mostly does not.

This letter is one of them, and so are the ones romanised *k*, *o*, *s* and *t*: same shape, two sizes. The capital of т is Т.

Not all of them — the letters for *b*, *e* and *a* do have distinct capitals (the capital of е is Е, the Latin *E*) — but the default is that a capital costs you nothing new, which is a genuine saving over the Latin alphabet and the opposite of what a beginner expects.

Your turn

- *Write it:* м
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

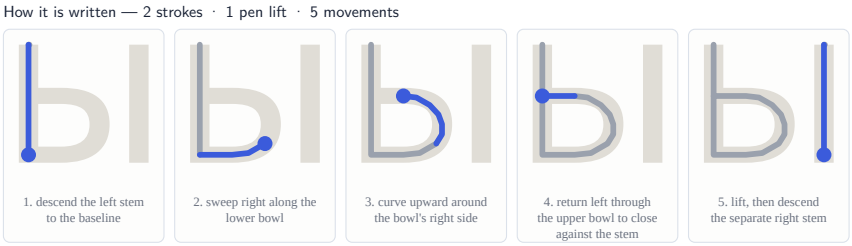
Before you move on

What sound is м? (**m**.) And what is true of most Cyrillic capitals? (They are the **lowercase drawn large** — no new shape to learn.) Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.6 ы — the vowel English has no name for

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



How ы *is written, stroke by stroke*

ы Ы

The capital, Ы, exists, but no Russian word begins with this vowel, so you meet it only in words printed in capitals.

Now a letter with no English equivalent at all — not a shape problem, a **sound** problem.

ы is a vowel made with the tongue pulled **back and high**, roughly where you hold it for *oo*, but with the lips **unrounded** and spread as for *ee*. English has no such vowel and no letter for it. Books usually transliterate it *y*, which helps nobody.

The reliable way in: say *ee*. Hold it. Now, without moving your lips, pull your tongue back towards your throat. What comes out is close.

The shape is two pieces — a hard sign body and a vertical — and it is **never capitalised at the start of a word**, because no Russian word begins with it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ы
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

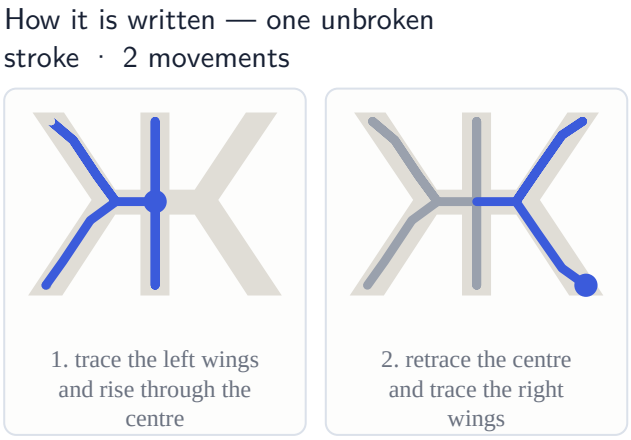
Before you move on

Is ы a shape problem or a sound problem? (A **sound** problem.) How do you find it? (Say *ee*, then **pull the tongue back** without moving the lips.) And can a word begin with it? (**No**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.7 ж — the beetle

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase ж demonstration, 03:16–03:21, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ж is written, stroke by stroke

ж Ж

The capital, Ж, is the same beetle drawn to full height.

zh, the sound in the middle of English *measure* or *vision*. A **new shape**, and the most recognisable one in Cyrillic: three lines radiating from a central spine, symmetrical, often called **the beetle**. The hand draws all of it without lifting the pen.

The sound is worth isolating. English has it — *measure*, *treasure*, *azure*, *genre* — but spells it with no letter of its own, and no ordinary English word opens with it. Russian gives it a letter and opens words with it freely.

Symmetrical, so there is no wrong way round. Draw the spine, then the four legs.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ж
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

Before you move on

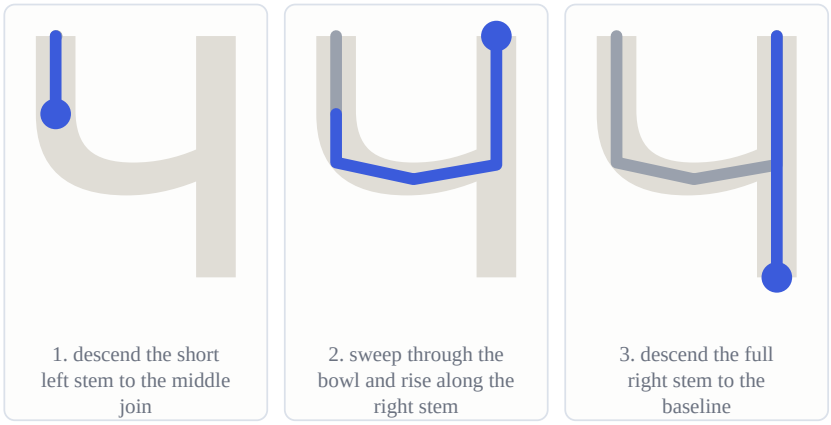
What sound is ж? (The middle of *measure*.) Does English have that sound? (**Yes** — but no letter for it.) And what is the shape called? (**The beetle**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.8 ч — one letter for a sound English spells with two

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase ч demonstration, 09:24–09:28, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ч *is written, stroke by stroke*

ч Ч

The capital, Ч, is the same shape drawn to full height.

ch, the *ch* of English *cheese*. A **new shape** — roughly a Latin *h* rotated, or a wine glass.

Notice what the alphabet is doing. English needs **two** letters, *c* and *h*, to write this sound, and that pair is ambiguous — compare *church*, *chorus*, *machine*. Cyrillic spends **one letter** on it and the letter means one thing.

This is a genuine advantage of the script and it is worth naming: Russian spelling is far more regular than English spelling. A letter usually says one thing.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ч
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

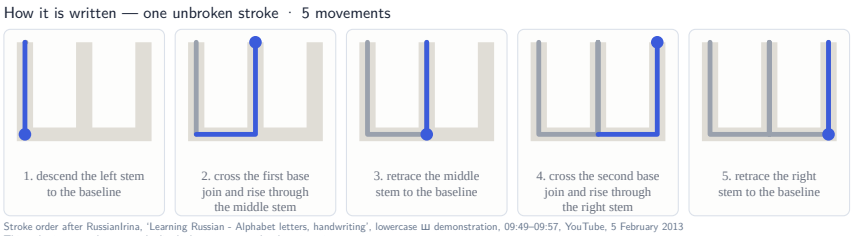
Before you move on

How many letters does English use for this sound? (**Two** — and ambiguously.) How many does Russian? (**One**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.9 ш — the comb

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



How ш *is written, stroke by stroke*

ш Ш

The capital, Ш, is the same comb drawn to full height.

sh, the *sh* of English *shoe*. A **new shape**: three vertical teeth on a base, like a **comb**.

Same point as the last letter, and it is a pattern rather than a coincidence: English writes this with two letters, Russian with one.

Keep it apart from the beetle by counting: ж radiates from a centre, ш stands on a flat base with three uprights.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ш
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

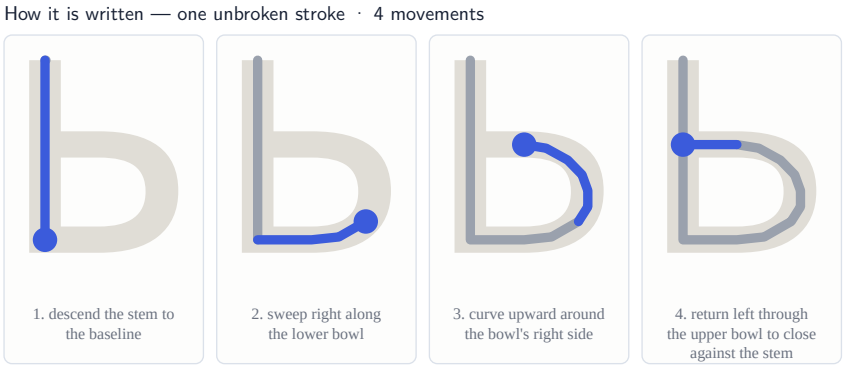
Before you move on

What sound is ш? (**sh**.) How do you tell it from the beetle? (ш has three uprights on a **flat base**; the beetle **radiates** from a centre.) Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.10 ь — a letter that makes no sound of its own

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script



How ь *is written, stroke by stroke*

Now the idea this alphabet has and Latin does not.

ь

This is the **soft sign**, and **it is not a sound**. You cannot pronounce it. It has no name you say aloud in a word. What it does is change the letter **before** it: it **softens** that consonant, which means the tongue moves towards the roof of the mouth, as if a faint *y* were sliding in after it.

English does this by accident. Compare the *n* in *canyon* with the *n* in *can* — the first is softer, because a *y* follows. Russian treats that difference as **meaningful** and gives it a letter.

A letter that is a modifier rather than a sound is the one genuinely alien thing in this script for an English reader. Everything else is a shape to learn or a sound to hear; this is a different kind of object entirely.

It is also common — it blocks a great many words in this book — and it never begins a word, so you will only ever meet it after a consonant.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ь
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

Before you move on

Can you pronounce ь? (**No** — it makes no sound of its own.) What does it do? (**Softens** the consonant before it.) And where in a word can it never appear? (At the **start**.)
Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

14.11 Я — one letter that is a whole syllable

Write the letter from the previous lesson, and say which of the three kinds it is.

Script

Я я

Last, and it carries two lessons at once.

It looks like a backwards Latin R. It is not an R and has nothing to do with one. That resemblance is the reason this letter appears on every parody of Russian ever printed in English, and it means nothing.

And it is not one sound but two. я says **ya** — a whole syllable, a *y* glide plus an *a*, in a single letter. Cyrillic has several of these, and they are why a Russian word can look shorter than its pronunciation.

On its own, я is also the Russian word for **I**. A single letter, a whole word — like English *a* and *I*, and for the same reason: the commonest words wear down to the shortest forms.

That is your eleventh piece. Sort each one into the three kinds as you go, and the rest of the alphabet is more of the same.

Your turn

- *Write it:* Я
- *Sort:* true friend, false friend, or new shape?

Before you move on

What does я sound like? (**ya** — two sounds, one letter.) Is it related to Latin R? (**No** — the resemblance is meaningless.) And what word is it on its own? (**I**.)

Source: Unicode Cyrillic chart.

Chapter 15

The Two Letters You Already Knew, and Six You Did Not

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (1) ✓ **pen** (8) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 9 lessons.

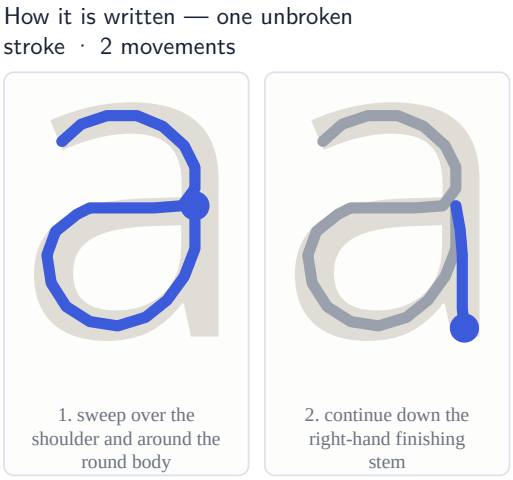
> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write eight more Cyrillic letters from memory, sort each of them into true friend, false friend or new shape, and read an unstressed о as an a – which is the commonest thing an English reader gets wrong when reading Russian aloud.
>
> *Eight letters sorted into two true friends, one false friend and five new shapes – with the false friend named as the dangerous kind, because it is the only one that can be read confidently and wrongly.*

15.1 а — a true friend, and the sound Russian keeps landing on

Write я. A whole syllable in one letter, and nothing to do with the Latin R it resembles.

Three kinds of letter, you were told: **true friends**, **false friends**, and **new shapes**. This chapter opens with the two truest friends in the alphabet — and then shows you why they still catch people out.

Script



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase а demonstration, 00:50–00:55, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How а *is written, stroke by stroke*

а А

The capital, А, is the Latin *A*.

A **true friend**, and about as true as they come. Same shape as Latin *a*, and when it is stressed it says the *a* of English *father* — clean, open, and with none of the drift English *a* has in *cat*, *cake* or *call*.

Nothing to learn about the shape. What is worth learning is how **often** you will see it, and there is a reason for that beyond the alphabet, which the next letter explains.

Write it as you write a Latin *a*. That is the whole instruction.

Your turn

- *Write it:* а — exactly the Latin letter
- *Say it:* **а** as in *father*, held open, not the *a* of *cat*

Before you move on

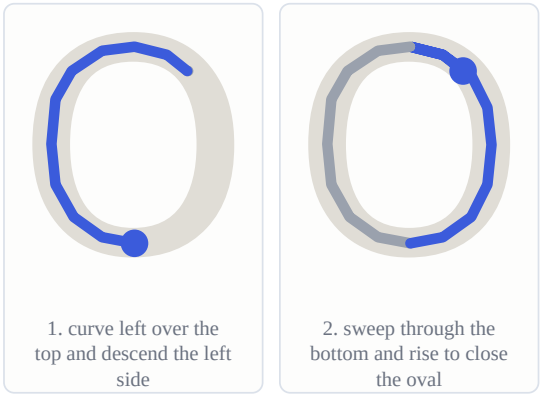
Which English *a* is it — the one in *cat*, or the one in *father*? (**Father**.)

15.2 о — the letter that is not always itself

Write а. Say it as in *father*.

Script

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 movements



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase о demonstration, 05:59–06:03, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How о *is written, stroke by stroke*

о О

The capital, О, is the same ring drawn to full height.

Another **true friend** on the page: same shape as Latin *o*, and when it is **stressed** it says the *o* of English *more*, shortened and rounded.

Write it as you write a Latin *o*.

Why it's said this way

Now the part that matters, and it is worth more to you than the shape. **When o is NOT stressed, it is not pronounced o. It is pronounced a.**
Russian words carry exactly one stressed syllable, and every other vowel in the word relaxes towards the middle. For o, that relaxation lands on **a**. So a word written with two o's, stressed on the second, comes out of a Russian mouth as *a-o* — not *o-o*.
This has a name — **akanye** — and you do not need the name. You need the habit:

written o, stressed → say **o**

written o, unstressed → say **a**

One refinement, so the rule does not mislead you later: right **before** the stress the sound is a full *a*. Further from the stress it relaxes further still, towards the *uh* of English *sofa*. Either way it is **not an o**, which is the part that matters.
It is the single commonest thing an English reader gets wrong when reading Russian aloud, because the letter is sitting right there on the page looking like an *o* and behaving like an *a*.
This is also why a is the most-heard vowel in the language while not being the most-written one: it gets reinforcements from every unstressed o.
And this is why stress is marked in this book's romanizations rather than on the Cyrillic. Russian text does not print stress marks — a native reader knows where the stress falls and needs no help. You do not know yet, so the romanization carries it, and the Cyrillic stays exactly as you would meet it in the world.

Your turn

- *Write it:* o — the Latin letter
- *Say it:* a stressed **o**, then an unstressed one — and let the second become **a**

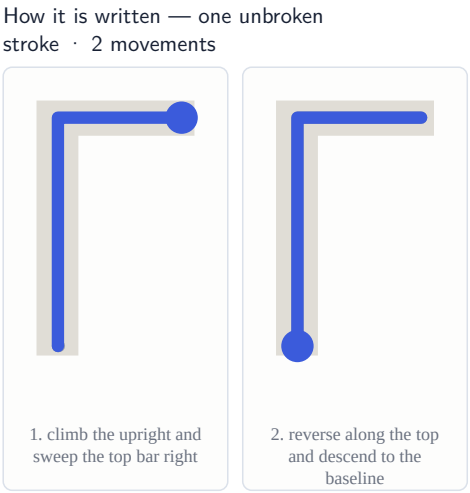
Before you move on

Does the spelling change when the sound does? (**No** — the page keeps о.)

15.3 г — a corner, and a hard g

Write о. Then say what it becomes when it is not stressed.

Script



How г *is written, stroke by stroke*

г Г

The capital, Г, is the same corner drawn to full height.

A **new shape** — no Latin relative to mislead you. Two lines meeting at a square corner: a horizontal across the top, and a vertical dropping from its left end. The hand draws both without lifting the pen. Like a Latin **F** with the middle bar removed, or a rotated **L**.

It says **g**, hard, as in English *go* — **never** the soft *g* of *gem*. Russian spelling does not have that ambiguity, which is one fewer thing to carry than English asks of you.

It does have one twist, and you have already met it. In the ending -ого (and -его) this letter is written г and **said** в — which is why до скорого comes out *da-SKO-ra-va*. That ending is everywhere in Russian, so the exception is worth knowing on the day you learn the letter rather than being ambushed by it later. Everywhere else: hard g.

If it helps: this is the Greek **gamma**, squared off. Russian took its alphabet from Greek, and this is one of the letters where the descent is plain.

Your turn

- *Write it:* г — top horizontal, then the vertical down from its left end
- *Say it:* **g** as in *go*, never as in *gem*

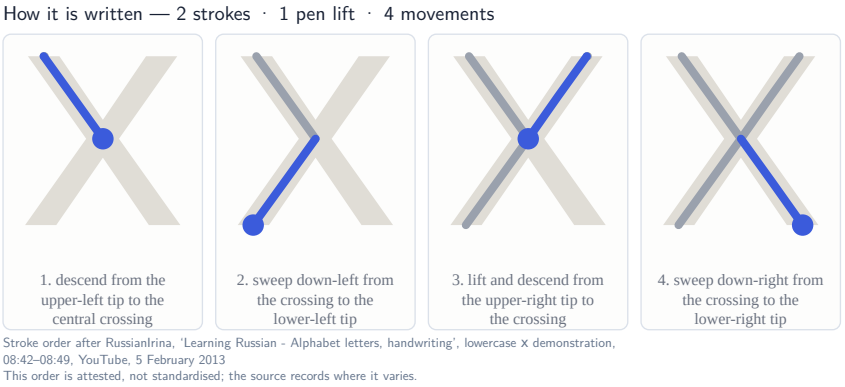
Before you move on

Which Latin letter does it resemble with a bar removed? (**F**.)

15.4 х — an x that is not an x

Write г. A corner, and a hard g.

Script



Stroke order after RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase х demonstration, 08:42–08:49, YouTube, 5 February 2013
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How x *is written, stroke by stroke*



The capital, X, is the same cross drawn to full height.

A **false friend**, and a well-disguised one. Two crossing diagonals — an exact Latin **x** on the page — and it does not say *x*.

It says the sound at the end of Scottish *loch* and German *Bach*: a **breathy rasp** made at the back of the mouth, in the same place as *k* but without ever closing it. Start to say *k*, then leave the gap open and push air through.

Romanized in this book as **kh**, which is a warning label rather than a spelling: there is no *k* and no *h* in it, only the one rasping sound.

English has no letter for it, which is why English borrows it as *ch* in *loch* and *Bach* and then most speakers say a *k* anyway. You have the letter now, so you can do better than the borrowing.

Your turn

- *Write it:* x — two crossing diagonals, like a Latin x
- *Say it:* **kh** — start a *k*, then leave it open and breathe through
- *Say it: loch*, the Scottish way, then just its ending

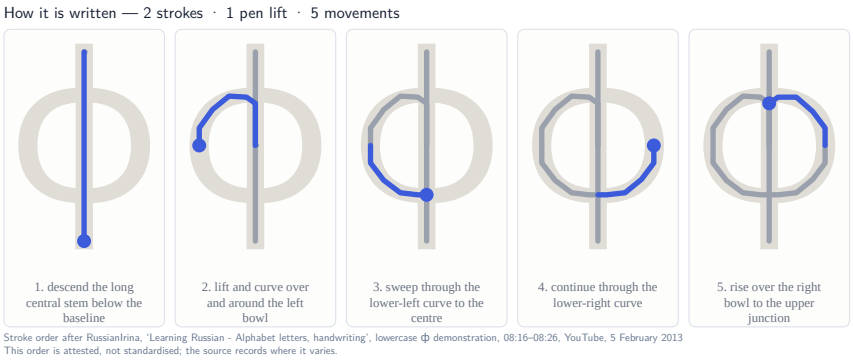
Before you move on

Is there a *k* sound in it? (**No** — the mouth never closes.)

15.5 ɸ — a circle on a stick

Write x. Then make its sound without letting your mouth close.

Script



How ф *is written, stroke by stroke*

ф Ф

The capital, Ф, is the same shape drawn to full height.

A **new shape**: a vertical stroke with a closed loop threaded onto it, the loop sitting on both sides of the line. Draw the vertical first, then the loop across it.

It says **f**, exactly as in English *foot*. No trap at all.

This is Greek **phi**, and that ancestry shows in where you find it. Native Slavic words almost never contain ф — nearly every Russian word with this letter came in from Greek or later from Western Europe. When you meet it, the word is very often one you can half-guess, because it was borrowed from a language you know.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ф — the vertical, then the loop threaded across it
- *Say it:* **f** as in *foot*

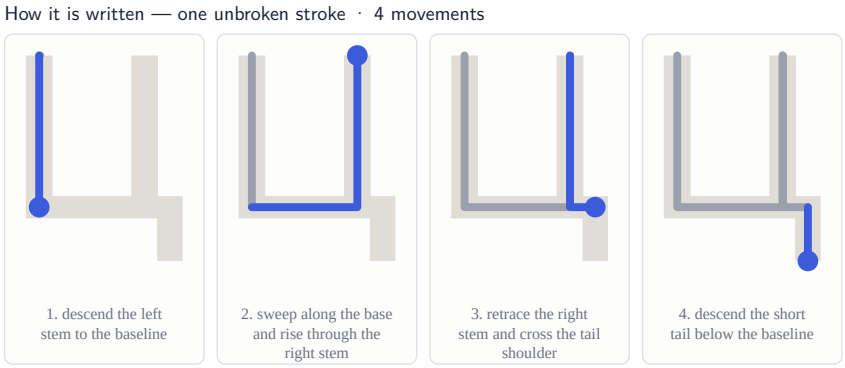
Before you move on

Which Greek letter is it? (**Phi**.)

15.6 ц — one letter for two sounds

Write ш — three uprights standing on a base.

Script



How ц *is written, stroke by stroke*

ц Ц

The capital, Ц, is the same shape, tail and all, drawn to full height.

A **new shape**, and one you should compare to ш immediately, because they are close:

ш — three uprights on a base, **nothing below the line**

ц — two uprights on a base, and a **small tail dropping below** at the right

Two uprights instead of three, and a descender. That tail is doing real work: it is the only thing separating this letter from one you already know.

It says **ts**, the ending of English *cats* — but as a **single** sound at the **start** of a word too, which English never asks of you. Say *cats*, then say just its last two letters, then put a vowel after them.

One letter, one sound, even though English needs two letters to write it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ф, then ш, then ц — and check which one has the tail
- *Say it: cats*, then **ts** alone, then **tsa**

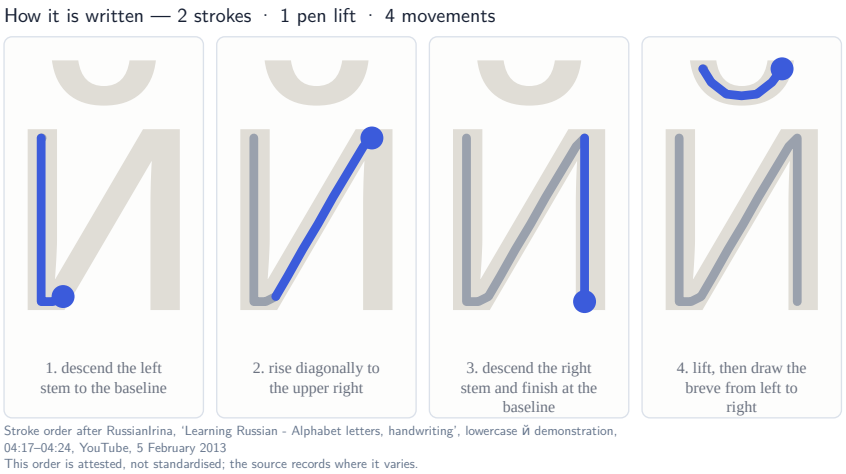
Before you move on

Does English write this sound with one letter or two? (**Two** — *ts.*)

15.7 й — и in a hat

Write ц. Two uprights, base, tail.

Script



How й *is written, stroke by stroke*

й Й

The capital, Й, is the same letter drawn to full height, cap and all.

No new shape at all. This is и, which you have written since your very first letters, with a small curved cap sitting on top of it. The cap is called a *breve*, and you draw the letter exactly as before and then add it last.

The cap changes the job. и is a vowel, the *ee* of *see*. й is a **consonant**: the *y* of English *boy* or *yes*. Its formal name is "short и", which describes it well — the same sound, clipped so short it stops being a syllable of its own and leans on the vowel beside it.

That is why it turns up glued to other vowels at the ends of words, and why it never carries the stress: it cannot, because it is not a syllable.

Your turn

- *Write it:* и, then add the cap to make й
- *Say it:* **ee**, then clip it to the **y** of *boy*

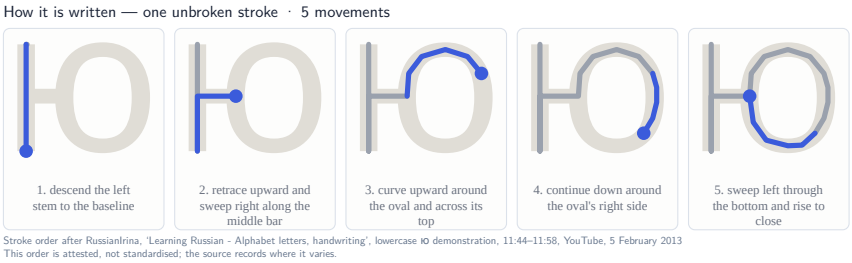
Before you move on

Can this letter carry the stress of a word? (**No** — it is not a syllable.)

15.8 ю — a syllable in one letter, again

Write я, then у. One is a whole syllable; the other is the *oo* that looks like a Latin y.

Script



How ю *is written, stroke by stroke*

ю Ю

The capital, Ю, is the same shape drawn to full height.

A **new shape**, but a familiar idea. Two parts, joined: a **vertical stroke** on the left, and a **closed loop** to its right, tied to the vertical by a short horizontal at mid-height.

It says **yu** — the *you* of English, or the *u* of *use*. One letter, two sounds, exactly the deal you already accepted with я (*ya*).

That is the pattern worth taking away: Russian has a small set of letters that each write a **y-glide plus a vowel** in a single shape. You have met two of them now. They are the reason a Russian word can look shorter than its

pronunciation, and the reason counting letters is a poor guide to counting syllables.

Do not confuse its sound with у, the *oo* letter that looks like a Latin y. ю is that sound with a *y* welded to its front.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ю — the vertical, the loop, and the bar that ties them
- *Say it:* у (oo), then ю (yoo) — the glide is the only difference
- *Say it:* я, then ю — the same trick, two vowels
- *Write it:* й, then ю — a capped letter, then a syllable-letter

Before you move on

Is ю the same sound as у? (**No** — it is у with a *y* in front.)

15.9 Practice — eight more letters, sorted

Write it: а and о Then say what happens to the second one when it is not the stressed vowel.

Script — the three kinds, one more time

You already have a way to sort any Cyrillic letter. Here are this chapter's eight, sorted:

True friends — the shape and the sound both match Latin:

а *a* · о *o*

False friend — the Latin shape, a different sound:

х *kh*, the rasp in *loch*

New shapes — no Latin relative to help or mislead:

г *g* · ф *f* · ц *ts* · ю *yu*

And one that fits none of the three, because it is not a new letter at all:

й — и wearing a cap

Two, one, four and one. The single false friend is the one to drill, because a false friend is the only kind that can be read confidently and wrongly: a new shape stops you dead, but х lets you read straight past it.

What you've built

Twenty-one letters before this chapter, and twenty-nine now. Russian has thirty-three.
Three of the eight cost you almost nothing. а and о were already yours from the Latin alphabet — the work in them was not the shape but **what unstressed о does to your ear** — and й is a letter you already write, wearing a cap.
That leaves **four genuinely new shapes** (г, ф, ц, ю) and **one false friend** (х) to drill. Five letters of real work out of eight.

Your turn

- *Write it:* а о г х ф ц й ю — all eight, in order, without looking above
- *Say it:* **kh**, the one that is not an x
- *Write it:* ш, then ц — and check which one has the tail
- *Say it:* и, then й — vowel, then consonant

Before you move on

How many of the thirty-three are now yours? (**Twenty-nine**.)

Chapter 16

And, Or, and Neither

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can join two words or two whole sentences with i, offer a choice with ili, refuse both halves at once with ni ... ni, and agree with somebody using tozhe.
>
> *The first two-clause sentence this book can make. Until this chapter the longest structure the track taught was a single clause, and i – the commonest word in Russian – had been printed twice as a conjunction without any lesson owning it. ni … ni is the first joining pattern in the book that stands in FRONT of both halves rather than between them, and it needs the negative said three times in one short sentence.*

16.1 и — the word you have already read

Two verbs from the chapter of first verbs, before the smallest word in the book arrives.

- *Recall:* знать, its English cousin *know*, and how не goes in front
- *Recall:* говорить, which is **not** a relative of *govern*, and the two verb families it belongs to
- *Recall:* the eight letters you sorted into true friends, false friends and new shapes

You'll want to know first — и

- и — *i* — **and**

One letter. One vowel. Nothing else. It is the commonest word in Russian, and you have been reading it since the verbs of the mind:

- Я читаю и понимаю. — *ya chitáyu i panimáyu* — I read **and** I understand.

That sentence was on the page long before anyone told you that the little и between the two verbs was a word at all. It is. It joins two things of the same kind: two nouns, two verbs, two whole thoughts.

The letter is one you can already write, and the word is the letter. Nothing new goes on the page here — only the fact that this shape has a meaning.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

и goes back to a Slavic particle built on the ancient **pointing stem** **i-*, the demonstrative that meant roughly *this one, that one*. A joining word that began as a pointing word is not strange: *and* is a way of saying *there is another one over here*.
That same old stem is the one hiding in его — which is why the smallest word in the language and one of its pronouns are relatives.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я читаю и понимаю — and hear и as a word this time
- *Say it:* any two verbs you own, with и between them
- *Build:* two foods, joined — молоко и сок

Before you move on

Say "and." (и.) Which letter is it, and had you written that letter before today? (и — yes, from the writing lessons.) What kind of old word is it built on? (**A pointing word.**) And one look back: say "I know," and then say you do not. (я знаю / я не знаю.)

16.2 и between two sentences — the book's first long sentence

Yesterday's word, and two verbs it is about to join.

- *Recall:* идти, the one-way verb whose past comes from another root entirely
- *Recall:* думать, the verb hiding inside the name of the Russian parliament, and the partner verb that finishes what it starts

Grammar lens — one word, any size of piece

You have joined two verbs with и. Now join two whole sentences with it. The word does not change:

- я иду и я думаю — *ya idú i ya dúmayu* — I am walking **and** I am thinking.

Each half stands on its own. Take the и away and you have two sentences that are still Russian. Put it back and you have one sentence with two halves, which is a thing this book has not been able to make until now.
Russian does not need a comma here, and does not want one: when и joins two halves that share a subject, nothing goes in front of it.

- я иду и думаю — *ya idú i dúmayu* — I walk and think.

Say the second я or leave it out; both are Russian. Leaving it out is what a Russian usually does, because the ending on the verb has already said who.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я иду и думаю
- *Build:* any two things you do, joined with и, dropping the second я
- *Build:* the same pair with the second я put back

Before you move on

Does и change when the pieces it joins get bigger? (**No** — one letter, always, and it is still the same old pointing word underneath.) Does a comma go in front of it when both halves share a subject? (**No**.) And one look back: which verb of motion means going one way, this once? (The verb is идти.)

16.3 или — "or," which is "and" with a doubt on the end

The two verbs that first stood on either side of и.

- *Recall:* понимать, which literally means to **take hold of** — the same picture English keeps in *comprehend*
- *Recall:* читать, and the fact that Russian has **no separate way** to say *I am reading*
- *Recall:* the whole first exchange — да, нет, and which greeting you give a stranger

You'll want to know first — или

- или — *íli* — **or**

Stress the first syllable: *Í-li.* It sits between the two things exactly where и sat, and it does the opposite job — not both, but one of the two.

- чай или кофе? — *chai íli kófe* — tea **or** coffee?
- я читаю или пишу — *ya chitáyu íli pishú* — I read **or** I write.

Offering somebody a choice is one of the first useful things you can do with a joining word, and this is the whole of it: two nouns, или, a rising voice.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

или is и with a small word welded on the end: ли, an old particle that carries doubt — the thing Russian puts in a sentence when the answer is not yet known.

So *and* plus *maybe* gives *or*. Once you see и at the front of или, the pair is impossible to confuse: the short one joins, the long one doubts. Vasmer takes it the same way: и plus ли.

Your turn

- *Say it:* чай или кофе*?* with the voice going up
- *Build:* the same two drinks joined with и instead — and hear the meaning turn over
- *Build:* two of your own verbs with или between them

Before you move on

Say "or." (It is или.) Which two pieces is it built from? (и plus ли.) Which of the two, и or или, offers a choice? (The long one, или.) And one look back: what does понимать literally do to a thing? (**Takes hold of it.**)

16.4 ни … ни … — refusing both halves at once

Two verbs, and the letter one of them brought with it.

- *Recall:* писать, whose root means to **scratch** — the same root behind *paint* and *picture* — and the letter ш it taught you
- *Recall:* брать, English *bear*, and the partner verb from a completely different root
- *Recall:* или, and the two pieces и and ли it is welded from

Grammar lens — the word that goes in front, twice

и and или both stand **between** the two things. This one stands **in front** of each of them, and there are two of it:

- ни чай, ни кофе — *ni chai, ni kófe* — **neither** tea **nor** coffee.

That shape is new. Every joining word so far has been a hinge in the middle; ни **…** ни **…** is a pair of flags planted before each half.

ни is the negator не with its vowel changed. Russian keeps them apart by job: не denies one thing, ни is the form that turns up when the denial has to be said twice.
And Russian says the denial a third time, on the verb. Where English is content with *I take neither*, Russian negates the verb as well:

- я не беру ни чай, ни сок — *ya ne berú ni chai, ni sok* — I take neither tea nor juice.

Three negatives in one short sentence, and every one of them is required. That is not sloppiness — it is the rule.

Your turn

- *Say it:* ни чай, ни кофе
- *Say it:* the whole refusal — я не беру ни чай, ни сок
- *Build:* two foods you own, refused together

Before you move on

Where does ни stand — between the halves or in front of them? (**In front of each half**.) How many times is the negative said in я не беру ни чай, ни сок? (**Three**.) And one look back: which verb means to write, and which letter arrived with it? (The verb is писать; the letter is ш.)

16.5 тоже — "me too," and "me neither"

Two verbs whose roots went a long way from home.

- *Recall:* спрашивать, on the root that gave Latin its word for **pray**
- *Recall:* помогать, built on a verb meaning **to be able** — English *may*, *might* and *main*

You'll want to know first — тоже

- тоже — *tózhe* — **also, too**

Stress the first syllable. It is not a joining word — it does not sit between two things — but it does the same social work as one: it puts a second person or a second fact alongside the first.

- я тоже — *ya tózhe* — **me too**.

Two syllables, and one of the most useful answers in the language. Somebody says what they do; you say я тоже and you have agreed, in full, without owning a single extra verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тоже is two words fused: то (that) and же (a little word meaning *the very same*). *That same* — which is what *also* has always meant. And because Russian negates by putting не in front of the verb, *me neither* comes out by putting не after тоже:

- я тоже не знаю — *ya tózhe ne znáyu* — I do **not** know **either**.

English swaps the whole word — *too* becomes *either*. Russian leaves тоже where it is and lets не do the work, which is one fewer word to learn. Both pieces are old Slavic words; Vasmer compares же with Greek *-ge*, a small word of emphasis.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я тоже
- *Say it:* я тоже не знаю
- *Build:* agree with any sentence you can already make, using тоже

Before you move on

Say "me too." (That is я тоже.) Which two words is тоже built from? (то and же.) How do you turn it into "me neither"? (**Put не in front of the verb** — the word тоже itself does not change.) And one look back: which verb means to help, and what is buried inside it? (The verb is помогать, and the piece inside it means **to be able**.)

Chapter 17

But, Twice Over

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can contradict with no, set two facts side by side with a, count one, name the other one, divide a fact between two people with odin ... drugoy, and close a sentence with the three marks Russian writes only at the end.
>
> *English hides two different jobs under one word, but. Russian splits them: no denies the first half, a sets two facts beside each other, and an English speaker reaches for the wrong one until the whereas test is stated out loud. drugoy then pays back a root the book has been holding since the friends chapter – drug, the companion, is literally the other one. The chapter closes on the page itself: Russian, unlike Spanish, opens nothing and marks only the end.*

17.1 но — “but,” said flatly

One word from the drinks chapter, one from the verbs, and the two newest words in the book.

- *Recall:* любить, English *love* itself, and the letter л that appears from nowhere in я люблю
- *Recall:* кофе, which sailed Arabic to Turkish to Dutch to Russia, and the letter ф it needed
- *Recall:* и, and its old pointing stem, and тоже with не after it

You'll want to know first — но

- но — *no* — **but**

Two letters, and it sits between the halves exactly where и sat. Where и adds, но takes back:

- я люблю чай, но не кофе — *ya lyublyú chai, no ne kófe* — I like tea, **but not** coffee.

Notice the comma. Russian puts one in front of но every time, and this is the first joining word in the book that has asked for one — и did not.

но contradicts. Whatever the first half led you to expect, the second half denies it, and nothing softer is meant.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

но goes back to Old Russian *nŭ*, a bare Slavic particle. Vasmer finds it probably related to an ancient word for "now": Lithuanian, Sanskrit and Gothic *nu*. So English **now** is a likely cousin. Vasmer also reports a less likely account, so the link is probable, not proven.
That is worth saying out loud rather than papering over: a language's oldest, smallest, most-used words are often the ones whose history is least secure, because they are too short to leave much evidence behind.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я люблю чай, но не кофе
- *Build:* the same sentence with и instead of но, and hear it stop contradicting
- *Build:* two things you do, the second one denied, with но не

Before you move on

Say "but." (That is но.) Does a comma go in front of it? (**Yes** — always.) Did и want one? (**No**.) Does но have an English cousin? (**Probably** — *now*, on Vasmer's preferred account.) And one look back: how do you say "me neither"? (я тоже не plus the verb.)

17.2 а — the other "but," and the one English does not have

Two words from the food chapter, and the two joiners you already own.

- *Recall:* чай, which came overland from Mandarin through Persian while English *tea* came by sea
- *Recall:* хлеб, borrowed from Germanic before Russian was Russian, and the letter х in it
- *Recall:* и joining two whole clauses, and но taking the second one back

You'll want to know first — а

- а — *a* — **and, but** — the *whereas* one

One letter again. Russian's two commonest joining words, и and а, are both single letters, and you learned to write both of them long before anyone said they were words.

- я люблю чай, а ты любишь кофе — *ya lyublyú chai, a ty lyúbish kófe* — I like tea, **and you** like coffee.

Nothing is denied there. Two facts are set side by side so that the difference between them can be seen. English has no separate word for this and reaches for *but*, or *and*, or *whereas*, depending on the sentence.

Like но, а takes a comma in front of it.

Grammar lens — which of the two to reach for

Ask one question: **is the second half denying the first, or standing beside it?**

- но — denying. *I like tea,* ***but not*** *coffee.*
- а — standing beside. *I like tea,* ***and you*** *like coffee.*

English hides both jobs under one word, so an English speaker will reach for но far too often. The test that works: if you could say *whereas*, use а.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я люблю чай, а ты любишь кофе
- *Say it:* я люблю чай, но не кофе — and hear the two sentences part company
- *Build:* one of each, about you and somebody else

Before you move on

Which word denies, and which sets two facts side by side? (но denies; а sets side by side.) Which English word can you swap in to test for а? (*Whereas.*) Which two joining words are single letters? (и and а.) And one look back: which drink came overland and which came by sea? (Tea came overland as чай; English *tea* came by sea.)

17.3 один — "one," and five English words that are the same word

The pair of friends, and two joining words.

- *Recall:* друг, on a root meaning **to accompany**, whose English descendants have all died out
- *Recall:* подруга, the same word with a prefix and the feminine -а
- *Recall:* или, built from и plus ли, and а the *whereas* word

You'll want to know first — один

- один — *adín* — **one**

Stress the second syllable, and the unstressed о at the front says *a*, which is the reduction rule the letters chapter left you with: *a-DÍN*, never *o-DIN*.

- один друг — *adín drug* — **one friend**.

It is the first number this book has given you, and it is here for a reason: it is half of a joining pattern that arrives in the next lesson.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

Strip the strengthening piece off the front of один and what is left goes back to PIE ***óynos**, "one." That single root gave English **five** separate everyday words:

- **one** — the number itself
- **an** and **a** — which are *one*, worn down to nothing
- **alone** — *all-one*
- **only** — *one-ly*

Latin took the same root and made **unus**, behind *unit*, *union* and *universe*. Russian kept it in один and, unlike English, never wore any of it down into an article — which is why Russian has no word for *a* at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- один — *a-DÍN*, with the first vowel reduced
- один друг
- the English family — *one, an, a, alone, only* — all one root

Before you move on

Say "one." (That is один.) Which syllable is stressed, and what does the first vowel say? (**The second**; the first о says *a*.) Name three English words from the same root. (*One*, *an*, *alone* — or *a*, or *only*.) And one look back: what does друг's root mean? (**To accompany**.)

17.4 другой — "the other one," and it is your word for friend

The pair of siblings, and yesterday's number.

- *Recall:* брат, one of the most secure cognate sets in the whole family — *brother*, *frater*, *bhrātar*
- *Recall:* сестра, which completes the pair as securely as брат did
- *Recall:* один, and ни … ни … standing in front of both halves

You'll want to know first — другой

- другой — *drugóy* — **other, another**

Look at the front of it. It is друг, your word for *friend*, with an ending stitched on — and the meaning that came out is *the other one*.

That is not a coincidence and it is not a pun. In the oldest Slavic, a друг was a companion: the one who is not you, the second of a pair. Ask who *the other one* is, and the answer is the person beside you.

- другой брат — *drugóy brat* — the **other** brother.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

другой was first the same word as друг, "friend", says Vasmer: Proto-Slavic **drugŭ*, "companion", a cousin of Lithuanian *draũgas*, "companion".

Grammar lens — один ... другой ...

Put the two words at the front of two halves and you have the last of the joining patterns: the one that hands out a fact to each of two people.

- один брат любит чай, другой любит кофе — *adín brat lyúbit chai, drugóy lyúbit kófe* — **one** brother likes tea, **the other** likes coffee.

Like ни **...** ни **...**, this pattern stands in **front** of its halves rather than between them. Unlike ни **...** ни **...**, it denies nothing: it divides.

Your turn

- *Say it:* другой — and hear друг at the front of it

- *Say it:* один брат любит чай, другой любит кофе
- *Build:* the same split with two sisters, and two drinks of your own

Before you move on

Which word for a person is hiding inside другой? (It is друг.) Why does *companion* end up meaning *the other one*? (**Because the companion is the one who is not you**.) Which two joining patterns stand in front of their halves rather than between them? (ни … ни … and один … другой ….)

17.5 . ? ! — the three marks that close a Russian sentence

Two nouns from earlier, before the page itself is the lesson.

- *Recall:* семья, a cousin of English *home* through the root meaning **to settle**
- *Recall:* ухо, inherited straight from the root behind English *ear*
- *Recall:* тоже, and how не turns it into *me neither*
- *Recall:* four of the last eight letters — ф, ц, й, ю — and which of the eight was the false friend

Writing — the three closing marks

Russian uses the same three marks English does, in the same three shapes:

- **.** — точка — the full stop, and the Russian word for it means *a dot*
- **?** — the question mark
- **!** — the exclamation mark

A statement ends with the dot. Nothing else is needed and nothing goes at the front:

брат и сестра.

Draw the dot on the writing line, not floating above it. That is the whole of the stroke, and it is the mark you will make more often than any other.

Grammar lens — Russian closes, and never opens

Spanish opens a question with an upside-down mark and closes it with the ordinary one. Russian does **not**. One mark, at the end, and nothing at the beginning:

- чай или кофе? — one mark, at the end
- ухо! — the same rule for the exclamation

So a Russian question looks exactly like a Russian statement until you reach the last character. What tells a listener it is a question is the **voice**, not the page — which is why the reading and the saying have to be practised together.

Your turn

- *Write it:* брат и сестра and close it with a dot on the line
- *Write it:* чай или кофе and close it with one question mark, nothing at the front
- *Say it:* the same two words as a statement, then as a question, and hear the only difference

Before you move on

How many marks does a Russian question take, and where? (**One**, at the end.) What does точка mean as an ordinary word? (**A dot**.) What tells a listener a Russian sentence is a question? (**The voice**.) And one look back: which pattern hands one fact to each of two people? (один … другой …)

Chapter 18

One Word, and a Whole Sentence After It

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what, say I think that something is so, say what it is I do not know, and write the dash that stands where the missing verb to be would have been.
>
> *chto is the cheapest sentence-level word in the queue: one syllable that turns dumat and znat – both taught chapters ago and both stuck without an object – into verbs that carry a whole clause. It is also the word Russian spells with a ch and says with a sh in one job and not the other, and the word English splits into that and what while Russian does not. The chapter ends on the dash, which is the only mark in the language whose job is to stand in for a word the sentence never says.*

18.1 ЧТО — "what," spelled with a Ч and said with a sh

Two parts of the face, and the mark that closes a question.

- *Recall:* НОС, inherited straight from the root behind English *nose*
- *Recall:* РОТ, probably from a verb meaning **to dig** — a snout rooting the ground
- *Recall:* the one question mark at the **end**, and НО, *but*, likely kin to *now*

You'll want to know first — что

- что — *shto* — **what**

Read it: the spelling, then the sound again, because they disagree

The word is written with ч, and it is said with a ш: *shto*, never *chto*.

That is not carelessness. It is one of a small handful of Russian words where the old spelling was kept after the pronunciation moved, and it is the commonest of them, so it is worth learning as a fact about this word rather than as a rule.

что? on its own is already a whole question, and it is the plainest way to ask somebody to say a word again. A single word, a rising voice, and one mark at the end.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

что goes back to PIE ***k^{w}id**, "what" — the same word as Latin **quid** and English **what** itself.

You have met this family before. The farewell пока was built on the ancient question-stem ***k^{w}o-**, the one behind как and the entire English *wh-* set. что is that family's plainest member, and the book collects the rest of it over the chapters that follow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- что — *shto*, with a ш sound and a ч on the page
- it as a one-word question, voice rising
- the three you own — как, пока, что — one ancient stem

Before you move on

Say "what." (It is что, said *shto*.) Which letter is on the page and which sound comes out? (ч on the page, ш in the mouth.) Which two words you already own belong to the same ancient family? (They are как and пока.) And one look back: which part of the face is a straight inheritance from the root behind *nose*? (That is нос.)

18.2 что as a hinge — one word carrying a whole sentence

Two more of the body, and the newest word in the book.

- *Recall:* глаз, which began as slang for a **ball** and pushed the true eye-word out of the language
- *Recall:* сердце, English *heart* barely disguised, and the letter ц inside it
- *Recall:* что said *shto*, and а, the *whereas* word
- *Recall:* the first letters you wrote — р с н б д е т — and the one that looks like an English R and is not one

Grammar lens — the same word, doing the other job

Put что between two clauses instead of at the front of a question, and it stops asking and starts carrying:

- я знаю, что ты понимаешь — *ya znáyu, shto ty panimáyesh* — I know **that** you understand.

Three things to notice, and the third is the one to hold on to.

- The **comma is compulsory**. Russian puts one in front of что every single time, with no exceptions of the kind English allows.
- The English *that* can be dropped — *I know you understand* is perfectly good English. The Russian что cannot. Leave it out and the sentence breaks.
- As a joining word it is said the way it is **spelled**: *chto*, not *shto*. Same letters, two jobs, two pronunciations.

English plays the same trick, twice: *what* and *that* both began as question words and one of them settled into this job.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я знаю, что ты понимаешь
- *Say it:* что twice — as the question *shto*, then as the hinge *chto*

- *Build:* я знаю, что plus any sentence you can already make

Before you move on

May the Russian что be dropped the way English drops *that*? (**No** — never.) What must always stand in front of it? (**A comma**.) Which of the two jobs is said *shto*? (**The question**.) And one look back: which eye-word did глаз push out of everyday Russian? (The word око, which survives inside очки, "little eyes.")

18.3 я думаю, что ... — saying that an opinion is yours

The two farewells, formal and casual, and the number from the last chapter.

- *Recall:* до свидания, literally **until the re-seeing**, with до taking the genitive after it
- *Recall:* пока, whose root is ancient and whose use as a goodbye is a hundred years old
- *Recall:* один, and the five English words its root became
- *Recall:* как вас зовут*?*, and the choice between ты and вы inside it

Grammar lens — the opinion frame

думать has been in this book since the verbs of the mind, and until this chapter it had nothing to think **about** — no object bigger than a single word could be attached to it. что fixes that in one move:

- я думаю, что **...** — *ya dúmayu, shto …* — **I think that ...**

Whatever you can already say in Russian, you can now say you **think** it. That is a genuine step up rather than one more phrase: it turns every sentence you own into an opinion you have marked as your own, which is the difference between reporting a fact and taking a position.

- я думаю, что ты понимаешь — *ya dúmayu, shto ty panimáyesh* — I think that you understand.

The comma before что is compulsory here as everywhere.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я думаю, что ты понимаешь
- *Build:* take any sentence you own and put я думаю, что in front of it
- *Build:* the same sentence without the frame, and hear it turn back into a flat claim

Before you move on

Say "I think that you understand." (That is я думаю, что ты понимаешь.) What had думать been missing until now? (**Anything to think about that was bigger than one word**.) Does the comma stay? (**Yes** — always.) And one look back: what does до свидания literally say? (**Until the re-seeing**.)

18.4 я не знаю, что … — admitting it, in a whole sentence

Two more farewells, and the divider from the last chapter.

- *Recall:* до скорого, built on a word meaning **quick** with no English cousin at all
- *Recall:* до завтра, and завтра built on the root behind English *east* and *aurora*
- *Recall:* другой, and the split один … другой …

Grammar lens — the other frame, and the negative one

знать takes что exactly as думать does, and the negative is where it earns its place:

- я знаю, что ты понимаешь — I know **that** you understand.
- я не знаю, что ты говоришь — *ya ne znáyu, shto ty gavarísh* — I do not know **what** you are saying.

Go back over those two English translations. The Russian word is **the same word both times**, and English needs *that* in the first and *what*

in the second. Russian makes no such split, which is one distinction fewer for you to get wrong.
The second sentence is the useful one. Until now this book could say я не знаю and stop — a flat shrug. With что you can say what it is you do not know, which is what turns an admission into something the other person can act on.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я не знаю, что ты говоришь
- *Say it:* the same sentence without не, and hear it turn into a claim
- *Build:* я не знаю, что plus anything you own

Before you move on

Say "I do not know what you are saying." (That is я не знаю, что ты говоришь.) How many Russian words cover English's *that* and *what* here? (**One** — что does both.) Which two verbs now take a whole sentence after them? (думать and знать.) And one look back: which farewell is built on the word for *morning*? (That is до завтра.)

18.5 — the dash that stands where the verb would have been

The last two farewells, and the marks from the previous writing lesson.

- *Recall:* до встречи, built from **into** plus **with** on a root with no secure English cousin
- *Recall:* спокойной ночи, whose ночь is one of the most secure cognates in the family and whose покой is the root of English *quiet*
- *Recall:* the dot at the end, and the single question mark
- *Recall:* three letters from the middle of the alphabet — ж, ч, and the soft sign that makes no sound at all

Writing — one long stroke on the line

Russian's dash is тире, and it is a genuinely long mark — longer than an English hyphen, with a space on each side of it:

брат — друг

Draw it at the height of the small letters, not at the top and not on the baseline, and give it the length of about two letters.

The mark is a French loan, **tiret**, borrowed whole. What Russian does with it is not French at all.

Grammar lens — the mark for a verb that is not there

You learned early that Russian says *I am a student* with no verb in the middle: the present tense of быть is absent altogether. On the page, that absence gets a mark of its own.
Where the sentence would have needed **is**, and both halves are nouns, a Russian writer puts a dash:

сестра — подруга

A sister is a friend. There is no verb in that sentence and there never will be. The dash is doing its work — and it is the only punctuation mark in the language whose job is to stand in for a word.
Say it aloud and there is a small pause exactly where the dash sits. The mark is not decoration; it is written-down silence.

Your turn

- *Write it:* сестра — подруга, with a space on each side of the dash
- *Say it:* the same sentence, and put a small pause where the dash is
- *Write it:* one sentence of your own with two nouns and a dash between them

Before you move on

What word is the dash standing in for? (**The verb *to be***, which Russian does not say in the present.) How is it drawn? (**Long, on the level of the small letters, with a space each side**.) And one look back: which farewell means *calm* plus *night*? (That is

спокойной ночи.)

Chapter 19

Why, Because, When

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask why and when in one word each, give a reason with potomu chto, put two things at the same moment with kogda, and write the comma Russian requires at the seam of every subordinate clause.
>
> *The question family the book opened at poka closes here at five members – kak, kakoy, chto, pochemu, kogda – all one ancient stem, and two of them do double duty as joiners without changing a letter. potomu chto is pochemu with the question-stem swapped for the pointing-stem, so the answer is made out of the question. The chapter ends by stating the one Russian punctuation rule that has no exceptions, which is only sayable once the track owns the subordinators it applies to.*

19.1 почему — "why," which is really "after what"

The two nursery words, and the newest mark on the page.

- *Recall:* мама, which is not inherited from anywhere — every language builds it out of the first sounds a baby makes
- *Recall:* папа, and the rule that a word can wear a feminine ending and still be a man
- *Recall:* the dash standing where the missing verb would be

- *Recall:* я and ты, English *thou*, and why вы is the safer one

You'll want to know first — почему

- почему — *pachemú* — **why**

Three syllables, stress right at the end: *pa-che-MÚ*. It is the longest question word in this book and the easiest to take apart.

- почему? — on its own, it is a complete question.

One word, one rising voice, one mark at the end, and you have asked for a reason about anything the other person has said. That is worth having before you can give a reason yourself.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

почему is по ("after, along") plus a case-form of что.

- по + чему = почему — literally, *after what*

So the question family you opened in the last chapter has produced its third member: как, что, and now почему. All three are the same ancient stem wearing different endings, and there are more still to come. Vasmer traces что to Proto-Slavic **čь*, "what", with a pointing *to* on the end.
English does exactly the same trick and then forgets it did: *wherefore* is *for-what*, and *therefore* is *for-that*. Asking *why* by asking *after what* is not a Russian oddity — it is what most of Europe does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- почему — *pa-che-MÚ*, stress at the end
- it as a one-word question after anything you say
- the three of the family — как, что, почему

Before you move on

Say "why." (That is почему.) Which two pieces is it built from? (по plus a form of что.) What does it literally say? (**After what**.) And one look back: which word is built out of the first sounds a baby makes rather than inherited? (That is мама.)

19.2 потому что — the answer, made out of the question

The two formal parent-words, and yesterday's question.

- *Recall:* мать, straight from the root behind English *mother*
- *Recall:* отец, which is **not** the father-root at all but a nursery word for *daddy* that won
- *Recall:* почему, and тоже

You'll want to know first — потому что

- потому что — *patamú shto* — **because**

Set the two words side by side and the shape gives itself away:

- почему — *after* ***what*** — the question
- потому — *after* ***that*** — the answer

Russian answers *why* by taking the same word, swapping the question-stem for the pointing-stem, and adding что to hang the reason on. почему asks; по тому points at the reason; что carries the sentence that names it. Both stems are inherited from Proto-Slavic: **tŭ*, "that", the stem of то, and **čĭ-*, the stem of что, "what".

Grammar lens — where the halves go, and where the comma goes

The thing that happened comes first; the reason follows:

- я не читаю, потому что я не понимаю — *ya ne chitáyu, patamú shto ya ne panimáyu* — I am not reading, **because** I do

not understand.

The comma stands before потому, not between потому and что — the two words are one joining word and nothing may come between them.
и went bare; но and а each took a comma; this one takes a comma too. A shape is starting to show through those four, and the writing lesson at the end of this chapter is where it gets stated.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я не читаю, потому что я не понимаю
- *Say it:* почему*?* and then answer yourself with потому что
- *Build:* any sentence you own, a comma, потому что, and a reason

Before you move on

Say "because." (That is потому что.) What is the one-word difference between it and *why*? (**Question-stem** against **pointing-stem** — *after what* against *after that*.) Where does the comma go? (**Before** потому, never inside the pair.) And one look back: which formal parent-word is really a nursery word that won? (That is отец.)

19.3 когда — "when," and the family's fifth member

Two things from the fridge, and the newest joining word.

- *Recall:* молоко, on the root behind English *milk*
- *Recall:* сыр, built on a word meaning **sour** — cheese named after what happens to the milk
- *Recall:* потому что, and один
- *Recall:* меня зовут — the they-form with nobody in it, and the object shape of я

You'll want to know first — когда

- когда — *kagdá* — **when**

Two syllables, stress on the second. Read the spelling and say the sound carefully, because they disagree again: the unstressed о at the front says *a*, exactly as it does in один.

- когда? — a complete question all by itself.

You now have three one-word questions: что?, почему? and когда? — each of them a whole turn in a conversation, none of them needing a verb.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

когда is the same ancient question-stem as как, что and почему, this time with an old time-ending welded on.
That makes four. Look at the front of each one and the family resemblance is on the page:

- как and когда — both beginning with the same к
- что — the same stem, worn down further, which is why the letters no longer match
- почему — the stem again, wearing по in front

Learning one question word in Russian is nearly learning the set.
Vasmer reconstructs an older **koda* and sets it beside Lithuanian *kadà* and Sanskrit *kadā*, both "when".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- когда — *kag-DÁ*, with the first vowel reduced
- the three one-word questions in a row — что? почему? когда?
- the four of the family — как, что, почему, когда

Before you move on

Say "when." (That is когда.) What does its first vowel say? (**A**, because it is unstressed.) How many members of the question family do you now own? (**Four**.) And one look back: what does the word behind сыр mean? (**Sour**.)

19.4 когда as a hinge — two things happening at once

The last two things on the food list.

- *Recall:* сок, a native word with no secure English cousin at all
- *Recall:* суп, borrowed from French, and recent enough that Russians still feel it as a loan
- *Recall:* другой, and the split один … другой …
- *Recall:* очень приятно, its root meaning **friend**, and the sentence with no verb in the middle

Grammar lens — the question word, joining

что asked a question and then hung a clause under a verb without changing a letter. когда does exactly the same:

- когда я читаю, я думаю — *kagdá ya chitáyu, ya dúmayu* — **when** I read, I think.

This time the joining word may go **first**. Russian is happy to lead with the *when*-half and follow with the main one — and when it does, the comma sits between the two halves rather than before the joining word. Turn the halves round and the comma travels with the seam:

- я думаю, когда я читаю — I think **when** I read.

Either order is correct and both mean the same thing. What never changes is that there is a comma at the seam.

Your turn

- *Say it:* когда я читаю, я думаю
- *Say it:* the same sentence with the halves the other way round
- *Build:* two things you do at the same time, joined with когда

Before you move on

May когда stand at the front of the whole sentence? (**Yes** — and then the comma goes at the seam between the halves.) Which other word you own asks a question and joins clauses without changing? (That is что — and both of them come off the same ancient question-stem.) And one look back: which food word is a French loan? (That is суп.)

19.5 , — the comma, and the rule with no exceptions

The marks you already draw, and two things they were drawn around.

- *Recall:* the dot on the line, the single question mark at the end, and the long dash with a space each side
- *Recall:* я не знаю, что … — and the pattern ни … ни …
- *Recall:* all eight of the last letters — а о г х ф ц й ю — and the one vowel among them that says something else when it is not stressed

Writing — the hooked-back stroke

The comma is запятая, and the name is a description of the stroke: it means roughly *the one hooked back*. Where точка is named for what it looks like — a dot — this one is named for what your hand does.

Start on the writing line, press, and pull the tail down and back to the left. It sits **below** the line, which is the whole difference from the dot.

,

Draw ten of them in a row and watch that every tail goes the same way.

Grammar lens — the rule that has no exceptions

English commas are a matter of taste and half of what people argue about is optional. Russian's central comma rule is not optional and has no exceptions:
A comma stands at the seam of every subordinate clause. Everything that hangs one clause under another takes one — что, потому что, когда — every time, in every sentence, whether or not a reader would pause there.
The words that join two equal halves are the other case, and they split:

- и — no comma
- но and а — comma, always

So one mark, three rules, and only the first of them is absolute. It is worth learning as a single fact because it is the one piece of Russian punctuation an examiner can mark wrong without any argument about style.

Your turn

Write these out:

- ten commas in a row, every tail below the line
- я читаю и понимаю — and put no comma in it
- я не читаю, потому что я не понимаю — and put one in

Before you move on

Which of the joining words you own never takes a comma? (That is и.) Which take one always? (но, а, and everything that hangs a clause underneath — что, потому что, когда.) Where does the tail of the comma go? (**Below the line**.)

Chapter 20

The Verb That Takes Another Verb

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I want, put a bare infinitive after it with nothing in between, give the purpose of an action with chtoby, say what I can and cannot do, and state an obligation in a sentence with no subject at all.
>
> *Fourteen infinitives had been taught and not one of them had ever stood after another verb, because the track had no khochu, mogu or nado to put one after: the pattern was missing, not the words. moch had been worse off than missing – the pomogat lesson spelled out that the verb is po- plus moch and then never taught moch, so the reader had been reading it for fifteen chapters. nado closes the chapter on a sentence with no subject in it, which is the same freedom as the absent copula the track already teaches.*

20.1 хотеть — "to want," the verb the book has been missing

Reach back four chapters, and then further.

- *Recall:* и, the one-letter joiner, and its old pointing stem
- *Recall:* знать, English *know*, and the -у / -ю that marks the *I* form of almost every Russian verb
- *Recall:* the comma at the seam of every clause hung under another

- *Recall:* почему, which is по plus a form of что, and я думаю, что …

You'll want to know first — хотеть

- хотеть — *khatét* — **to want**
- я хочу — *ya khachú* — **I want**
- ты хочешь — *ty khóchesh* — **you want**

Listen to the *I* form. The т of the infinitive has turned into a ч — the same consonant swap you met in the first verbs — and the ending is the familiar -у.

- я хочу чай — *ya khachú chai* — I want tea.

This book has taught you to say what you do, what you know, what you understand and what you love. Until this line it could not say what you **want**, which is the first thing a traveller needs and the last thing this book supplied.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хотеть is native Slavic and stops there. There is no secure Latin cousin, no Germanic one, no English one — the etymologists trace it inside the Slavic family and no further.
That is the third time this book has had to say so, after но and сок, and the pattern behind it is worth noticing: the words a language never borrows are the ones it needs every day.

Your turn

- *Say it:* хотеть, then я хочу, and hear the т turn into ч
- *Say it:* я хочу чай
- *Build:* name a drink or a food you own and say you want it

Before you move on

Say "I want tea." (That is я хочу чай.) Which letter changes between хотеть and хочу? (The т becomes ч.) Does this verb have

an English cousin? (**No** — it is native Slavic and traceable no further.) And one look back: which verb means *to know*, and what is its English cousin? (That is знать, and the cousin is *know*.)

20.2 я хочу читать — two verbs in a row, and no word between them

Yesterday's verb, and one from a long way back.

- *Recall:* хотеть, with no cousin outside Slavic, and я хочу
- *Recall:* говорить, which is **not** related to *govern*, and the two verb families Russian sorts its endings into
- *Recall:* и joining two whole clauses
- *Recall:* потому что, and the comma that stands in front of the pair
- *Recall:* быть and жить, the first two verbs, and the root behind жить that means **quick**

Grammar lens — the infinitive finally has somewhere to stand

This book has taught you fourteen verbs, and every one of them arrived in its **infinitive** — читать, писать, говорить, the dictionary form ending in **-ть**. Until now that form has had nothing to do except be the name of the verb.
Put it straight after a finite verb and it goes to work:

- я хочу читать — *ya khachú chitát* — I want **to read**.
- я хочу писать — *ya khachú pisát* — I want **to write**.

Count the words between the two verbs: **none**. English needs *to*; Russian needs nothing at all. The second verb stays in the form you learned it in.
That single fact turns every infinitive in this book into something you can say you want to do, which is fourteen new sentences from one pattern.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я хочу читать
- *Say it:* я хочу говорить
- *Build:* run through the verbs you own, each one after я хочу

Before you move on

What goes between the two verbs in я хочу читать? (**Nothing** — Russian has no word for English's *to*.) Which form does the second verb take? (**The infinitive**, exactly as the book taught it.) And one look back: is говорить related to English *govern*? (**No** — the resemblance is an accident.)

20.3 чтобы — "in order to," which is что wearing a wish

The very first word in the book, and one of the joiners.

- *Recall:* привет, the word you opened with
- *Recall:* понимать, whose root means **to take hold of**
- *Recall:* или, built from и plus ли, and the comma at every seam
- *Recall:* видеть, and когда on the same ancient question-stem as как
- *Recall:* видеть's cousin *wit*, the consonant that swaps in я вижу, and the г that is sometimes said as a в

Grammar lens — a purpose is a wish with что on the front

- чтобы — *shtóby* — **in order to, so that**

Two pieces, both nearly yours: что, and бы, the small particle Russian puts on anything that is wished for rather than done. A purpose, in Russian, is literally a *that*-clause said in the mood of a wish.
Put an infinitive after it and you have your reason for doing something:

- я читаю, чтобы понимать — *ya chitáyu, shtóby panimát* — I read **in order to** understand.

The comma before чтобы is compulsory, like every subordinator's. The verb after it is the infinitive, exactly as after хочу — so the pattern you learned in the last lesson is doing a second job here without changing.
Note the stress: чтобы is stressed on its **first** syllable, unlike что, which has only one.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я читаю, чтобы понимать
- *Say it:* чтобы with the stress on the front — *SHTÓ-by*
- *Build:* something you do, a comma, чтобы, and the reason you do it

Before you move on

Which two pieces make чтобы? (что plus бы.) What form of the verb follows it? (**The infinitive**.) Which syllable carries the stress? (**The first**.) And one look back: what was the very first word in this book? (That was привет.)

20.4 мочь — "can," and you have been reading it for fifteen chapters

Two verbs from the early chapters, and one pattern.

- *Recall:* идти, the one-way verb whose past comes from a different root
- *Recall:* помогать, and the fact that its second half was a verb meaning **to be able**
- *Recall:* ни … ни …, standing in front of both halves
- *Recall:* когда joining two clauses, with the comma at the seam

You'll want to know first — мочь

- мочь — *moch* — **to be able, can**

- я могу — *ya magú* — **I can**
- ты можешь — *ty mózhesh* — **you can**

You have seen this word already. When the book took помогать apart it said in so many words that the verb is по- plus мочь, "to be able" — and then moved on without ever giving мочь a lesson of its own. It is here now.

Like хотеть, it takes a bare infinitive after it:

- я могу читать — *ya magú chitát* — I can read.
- я не могу идти — *ya ne magú idtí* — I cannot go.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мочь is PIE ***mag^{h}-***, "to be able, to have power" — and the English descendants are three of the plainest words in the language:

- **may** — permission, which began as ability
- **might** — both the verb and the noun meaning *strength*
- **main**, as in *with might and main*

So я могу and *I may* are, underneath, the same sentence. Russian kept the whole verb; English wore it down into a modal that no longer conjugates at all.

Your turn

- *Say it:* я могу читать
- *Say it:* я не могу идти
- *Build:* something you can do, then the same thing denied

Before you move on

Say "I can read." (That is я могу читать.) Which taught verb has this one inside it? (That is помогать — по- plus мочь.) Name two English words from the same root. (*May*, *might* — or *main*.) What form follows it? (**The infinitive**, with nothing in between.)

20.5 надо — a whole sentence with nobody in it

The verb of the mind, and the two newest words.

- *Recall:* думать, the verb inside the name of the Russian parliament, and its partner verb
- *Recall:* мочь, English *may* and *might*, and тоже with не after it

You'll want to know first — надо

- надо — *náda* — **it is necessary, one must**

Stress the first syllable; the о at the end is unstressed and says *a*, so the word comes out *NÁ-da*. It is worn down from Old Russian *nadobě*, a form of надоба, "need", built on доба, "a time, a season" (Vasmer).

Like хотеть and мочь, it is followed by a bare infinitive:

- надо читать — *náda chitát* — one must read.

Grammar lens — the sentence with no subject

Look at надо читать again and count the people in it. There are none.
There is no я, no ты, and no verb agreeing with anybody. English cannot do this: it has to invent a subject — *one* must read, *it* is necessary, *you* should read — because an English sentence is not allowed to go without one.
Russian is allowed. надо is an **impersonal** word: the obligation is stated and left hanging in the air, belonging to nobody in particular. This is the same freedom you met when the present tense of быть turned out to be missing altogether.
Naming the person who must do it needs a case this book has not opened yet, so for now the impersonal form is the whole of it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* надо читать — *NÁ-da*, first syllable
- *Say it:* надо думать
- *Build:* three things one must do, using verbs you own

Before you move on

How many people are named in надо читать? (**None** — it is impersonal.) What must English add that Russian does not? (**A subject** — *one*, *it*, or *you*.) Which other missing word does that remind you of? (**The present tense of** быть, which Russian also leaves out.) And one look back: which council is named after the verb *to think*? (**The Duma**.)

Chapter 21

Excuse Me, and Say It Again

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise in both the light and the heavy way, open a request to a stranger, ask for a repeat, ask somebody to speak slowly, and ask for help.
>
> *The track could say ya ne ponimayu and ya ne znayu in full and had no word for sorry, no way to ask for a repeat and no way to open a request to a stranger: it could report a failure and do nothing about it. Five words close that. The chapter also names the -ite ending, which turns three words the reader would otherwise memorise separately into one set – and the last of the five, pomogite, is built entirely out of parts the reader already had.*

21.1 извините — the word the book has been missing since page one

The two courtesy words you have had since the first chapter, and a verb.

- *Recall:* понимать, on a root meaning **to take hold of**
- *Recall:* спасибо, and чтобы with an infinitive after it
- *Recall:* но, the contradicting *but*, probably kin to English *now*
- *Recall:* надо with nobody in the sentence, and хотеть, which has no cousin outside Slavic

You'll want to know first — извините

- извините — *izvinítye* — **excuse me, sorry**

Four syllables, stress on the third: *iz-vi-NÍ-tye*. It is the single most useful word left in this book, and it does two separate jobs:

- **an apology**, when you have got something wrong
- **an opening**, when you want to speak to somebody you do not know

The second is the one to notice. A Russian does not walk up to a stranger and start; they say извините first, every time. It is the equivalent of *excuse me* at the front of a question, and without it the question can sound abrupt in a way you did not intend.

The ending -ите is the polite one, the same вы that здравствуйте carries. Said to a friend it would be извини, without the те — but reach for the long one by default, exactly as you do with the greeting.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

извините is из- ("out of") plus вина ("guilt, fault"), with the polite ending on the end.
So the word literally asks the other person to take you **out of the blame** — which is a real picture, still visible in the Russian, and one English threw away when *excuse* stopped meaning anything at all on its own. вина is inherited; Vasmer relates it to Latvian *vaina*, "guilt".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- извините — *iz-vi-NÍ-tye*, stress on the third
- извините, пожалуйста — the two courtesy words together
- it as an opening, before anything else you know how to ask

Before you move on

Say "excuse me." (That is извините.) Name its two jobs. (**An apology**, and **the opening of a request to a stranger**.) What does it literally ask for? (**To be taken out of the guilt**.) And one

look back: what does понимать literally do? (**Takes hold**.)

21.2 простите — the heavier apology

Yesterday's word, and a verb from long before it.

- *Recall:* читать, which sits with the words for **honour** and **number** on a root meaning *to count, to heed*
- *Recall:* that Russian has no separate *I am reading*
- *Recall:* извините, and хотеть
- *Recall:* а, the *whereas* word, and the test that tells it from но

You'll want to know first — простите

- простите — *prastítye* — **forgive me**

Same shape as yesterday's word, same polite -ите ending, and the informal прости sitting behind it in exactly the same way.

- извините asks to be **let off**
- простите asks to be **forgiven**

Both come out as *sorry* in English and they are not interchangeable in Russian.

Why it's said this way

What separates them is **weight**, not politeness — both words are polite.

- извините for the small thing: bumping somebody, interrupting, opening a request to a stranger. Nobody is really being blamed.
- простите for the real one: you have let somebody down and you are asking them to release you from it.

Use простите for a trodden foot and you sound as though you had wrecked their week.

This is the same pair-with-a-rule that здравствуйте and привет form for greetings — Russian keeps two options side by side. The difference here is that the choice is about the size of the offence rather than about who you are talking to.
The etymology carries the same weight: простите is built on простой, Proto-Slavic **prostŭ*, "simple, free": to forgive is to set someone free, and Czech *prostiti* still means "to free" (Vasmer).

Your turn

- *Say it:* простите — *pras-TÍ-tye*
- *Say it:* both words in turn, and say what each is for
- *Build:* pick the right one for stepping on a foot, and for missing a meeting

Before you move on

Which of the two is the heavier apology? (That is простите.) What separates the two? (**The size of the offence**, not politeness.) What does the root of простите mean? (**Simple, straight** — to forgive is to make straight.) And one look back: which greeting is the formal one? (That is здравствуйте.)

21.3 повторите — asking for it again

A verb from the hand chapter, and yesterday's apology.

- *Recall:* писать, on a root meaning **to scratch** — the same root as *paint* — and the letter ш
- *Recall:* a bare infinitive after я хочу, with nothing in between
- *Recall:* простите, the heavier of the two apologies
- *Recall:* один, whose root became English *one*, *an*, *a*, *alone* and *only*
- *Recall:* чтобы, the purpose word built from что plus бы

You'll want to know first — повторите

- повторите — *paftarítye* — **say it again, repeat it**

Until now the book could only report a failure. This word asks for a fix.

- извините, повторите, пожалуйста — *izvinítye, paftarítye, pazhálusta* — sorry, please say that again.

That is a complete repair turn.

Grammar lens — the -ите ending is an order

Three words in two lessons now end in -ите: извините, простите, повторите. That is worth naming.
-ите is Russian's polite **imperative** — the ending that turns a verb into an instruction addressed to вы. Drop the -те and you get the ты form: извини, прости, повтори.
So the two apologies were never nouns: they were commands all along. The word itself is по- plus втор-, *second* — the same втор- in вторник, Tuesday, the second day. To repeat is to do a thing a second time. второй goes back to Proto-Slavic **vŭtorŭ*, whose deeper origin Vasmer calls uncertain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- повторите, пожалуйста
- the whole turn — извините, повторите, пожалуйста
- the three -ите words in a row, and hear the ending they share

Before you move on

Ask somebody to say it again, politely. (That is повторите, пожалуйста.) What does the ending -ите do? (**Turns a verb into a polite instruction** addressed to вы.) Which day of the week shares a piece with this word? (The day is вторник, Tuesday, the second day.) And one look back: which letter did писать teach you? (That is ш.)

21.4 медленно — asking for it slower

A verb from the hand chapter, and the divider from earlier.

- *Recall:* брать, English *bear*, whose partner verb comes from a completely different root
- *Recall:* другой, the split один … другой …, and повторите

You'll want to know first — медленно

- медленно — *myédlenna* — **slowly**

Stress the first syllable, and let the two unstressed о and е at the end soften: *MYÉD-len-na*. It is the adverb of the Russian word for "slow", Proto-Slavic **mŭdĭlĭnŭ*, with медлить, "to delay" (Vasmer).

Its shape is worth a moment. Russian makes an adverb by putting -о on the end of a describing word, and that is the whole rule — no ending to agree with anything, nothing to change. It is one of the most productive rules in the language.

Grammar lens — the second repair move

Take говорить, put the polite -ите on it, and add the adverb:

- говорите медленно, пожалуйста — *gavarítye myédlenna, pazhálusta* — please speak slowly.

That is a genuinely different move from повторите. Asking for a repeat gets you the same sentence at the same speed; asking for медленно changes what the other person is doing. A listener who owns both can steer a conversation instead of only reporting on it. The repair kit is now complete, and it is four words long: извините, повторите, говорите медленно, пожалуйста.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- медленно — *MYÉD-len-na*
- говорите медленно, пожалуйста

- the whole kit in order — sorry, again, slower, please

Before you move on

Ask somebody to speak slowly. (That is говорите медленно, пожалуйста.) How does Russian make an adverb? (**By putting -о on the end**.) What does asking for медленно get you that a repeat does not? (**A change in what the speaker is doing**, not the same sentence again.) And one look back: which verb means *to take*? (That is брать.)

21.5 помогите — the request you already knew how to make

The asking verb, and yesterday's adverb.

- *Recall:* спрашивать, on the root that gave Latin its word for **pray**
- *Recall:* говорите медленно, and тоже
- *Recall:* the dot on the line, and the single question mark at the end

You'll want to know first — помогите

- помогите — *pamagítye* — **help me**

There is almost nothing new in this word, and that is the point of putting it here. You have had помогать since the verbs of the hand. You learned -ите two lessons ago. Put them together and you have the most important single word in any emergency, built entirely out of parts you owned already.

- извините, помогите, пожалуйста — *izvinítye, pamagítye, pazhálusta* — excuse me, please help.

Say it once out loud. A course that can greet, thank, apologise, ask for a repeat, ask for slower speech and ask for help has covered every move a beginner needs to survive a conversation that goes wrong — and every one of those moves arrived in this chapter or the two behind it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

помогите is помогать, “to help”, with -ите: по- with the root of мочь, “to be able”, Proto-Slavic **mogti*, which Vasmer relates to Gothic *magan*, “to be able”.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- помогите — *pa-ma-GÍ-tye*
- извините, помогите, пожалуйста
- the four -ите words together — excuse, forgive, repeat, help

Before you move on

Ask for help, politely and completely. (That is извините, помогите, пожалуйста.) What two things is помогите made of, and did you own both? (помогать and the polite -ите — yes, both.) And one look back: which verb sits inside помогать, and what are its English cousins? (The verb is мочь; the cousins are *may*, *might* and *main*.)

Chapter 22

The Words That Ask, and the Word That Points Back

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask who, which and how many, hang a whole clause onto a noun with kotoryy, and both ask and embed a yes-or-no question with li.
>
> *The question family the book opened at poka closes here at seven members, all one ancient stem: kto, chto, kakoy, kak, kogda, pochemu, skolko. Two of them supply their own answers by swapping the question-stem for the pointing-stem. kotoryy is the eighth relative of the same root and the one that does the most work – it is how a Russian noun gets described at any length. li ends the chapter by turning out to have been inside ili since the joining chapter.*

22.1 кто — "who," the twin of что

The friend, the helping verb, and yesterday's request.

- *Recall:* помогать, and помогите with the polite -ите on it
- *Recall:* друг, on the root meaning **to accompany**
- *Recall:* надо, the sentence with nobody in it
- *Recall:* извините, which literally asks to be taken **out of the guilt**

You'll want to know first — кто

- кто — *kto* — **who**

Three letters, one syllable, and — unlike что — it is said **exactly as it is written**. No ш ambush here.

The two words are a matched pair, and Russian keeps the division sharper than English does:

- кто asks about **people**
- что asks about **things**
- кто**?** on its own is a complete question, exactly as что**?** is.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кто is PIE ***k^{w}is**; что is PIE ***k^{w}id**. The same stem, twice, with two different endings — one for people and one for things — and the split is older than Russian, older than Latin, older than English.
Latin kept the same pair as **quis** and **quid**. English kept **who** and **what**. Russian kept кто and что. Three languages, one ancient distinction, none of them has ever let it go.
That is now six of the family: как, какой, что, почему, когда, кто.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- кто and что in turn, and hear that only one of them lies about its spelling
- кто*?* as a whole question
- the six of the family in a row

Before you move on

Say "who." (That is кто.) Which of кто and что is said as it is spelled? (кто is; что is not.) Which asks about people? (кто.) Name the Latin pair that matches them. (*Quis* and *quid*.) And one look back: how do you ask for help? (That is помогите.)

22.2 какой — "which," and the word the book already told you about

The verb of the heart, and two recent words.

- *Recall:* любить, English *love* itself, and the л that appears from nowhere in я люблю
- *Recall:* простите, the heavier apology, and кто
- *Recall:* что hanging a whole clause under a verb, and the rule that tells извините from простите

You'll want to know first — какой

- какой — *kakóy* — **which, what kind of**

You have been told about this word once before, and by a farewell. When the book took пока apart it said that the old pronoun inside it became какой — so the word has been named in this book for six chapters without ever being taught. It is taught now.

Look at its ending and compare it with другой. The same **-ой** does the same job in both: it turns a stem into a word that stands in front of a noun.

- какой чай ты любишь? — *kakóy chai ty lyúbish* — **which** tea do you like?

Where что asks *what thing*, какой asks *which one of these* — and it is the natural partner of или when you are offering a choice out loud.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

какой ← Proto-Slavic **kakŭjь*, built on как, "how", on the old question stem of кто, "who"; Vasmer compares Lithuanian *kõks*, "what kind of".

Your turn

- *Say it:* какой — *ka-KÓY*, stress on the end
- *Say it:* какой чай ты любишь*?*
- *Build:* offer a choice with или, then ask the same thing with какой

Before you move on

Say "which." (That is какой.) Which farewell already told you about this word? (That was пока.) Which other word you own ends the same way and stands in front of a noun? (That is другой.) What is the difference between что and какой? (что asks *what thing*; какой asks *which one*.)

22.3 сколько — "how many," and the family assembled

The two siblings, and two recent words.

- *Recall:* брат and сестра, the securest cognate pair in the book
- *Recall:* медленно, and какой
- *Recall:* how a Russian noun's ending tells you its gender
- *Recall:* я думаю, что …, and повторите with its polite -ите

You'll want to know first — сколько

- сколько — *skólka* — **how many, how much**

Stress the first syllable; the final о is unstressed and says *a*. Vasmer traces it to Proto-Slavic **kolikŭ*, "how great", with an с- probably from *sŭ*, "about".

English splits this question in two and makes you choose: *how many* for things you can count, *how much* for things you cannot. Russian does not. One word covers both, and the noun after it changes shape instead — which is a case this book has not opened, so for now keep to the question on its own.

- сколько? — a complete question, like the rest of the family.

Its answer word is столько, "that many" — the same swap you saw when почему became потому: question-stem out, pointing-stem in.

Grammar lens — seven words, one stem

The whole set is now yours, and every member of it is the same ancient question-stem wearing a different ending:

- кто — who
- что — what
- какой — which
- как — how
- когда — when
- почему — why
- сколько — how many

Seven questions, one root. And two of them have pointing-word answers built by the same swap — потому for почему, столько for сколько — so the family supplies its own replies.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- сколько — *SKÓL-ka*
- the seven of the family in order
- the two pairs — почему / потому, сколько / столько

Before you move on

How many English questions does сколько cover? (**Two** — *how many* and *how much*.) How many members does the question family have now? (**Seven**.) What single move turns two of them into their own answers? (**Swapping the question-stem for the pointing-stem**.) And one look back: which word means *sister*? (That is сестра.)

22.4 который — the word that hangs a sentence onto a noun

The drink with the long journey, and the newest pattern.

- *Recall:* кофе, which travelled Arabic to Turkish to Dutch, and the letter ф it needed
- *Recall:* я хочу with a bare infinitive after it, and сколько
- *Recall:* я не знаю*,* что *…*, and говорите медленно

You'll want to know first — который

- который — *котóryy* — **who, which, that**

Four syllables, stress on the second. It is the last member of the question family, and the one that does the most work, because it does not only ask — it **joins**.

It goes back to PIE ***k^{w}o-teros**: the question-stem you now know well, plus an ending that means *which of two*. Greek made **poteros** from it. English made **whether** — which is why *whether* still means *which of the two* underneath.

Grammar lens — a whole clause, stuck onto a noun

что hangs a clause under a **verb**. который hangs one onto a **noun**:

- друг**,** который читает — *drug, котóryy chitáyet* — the friend **who** reads.

Name a thing, put a comma, say который, and say a whole sentence about it. That is how a noun in Russian gets described at any length at all, and it is the last of the joining devices this book owes you. The comma is compulsory, as it is in front of every subordinator. English lets you drop *that* — *the book I read* — and Russian never does: который stays, and its comma stays with it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* друг*,* который читает
- *Build:* name any person you own and hang a sentence on them

- *Say it:* который and English *whether*, and hear the shared ending

Before you move on

What does который attach a clause to? (**A noun** — where что attaches one to a verb.) May it be dropped the way English drops *that*? (**No** — never, and neither may its comma.) Which English word is its cousin? (*Whether*.) And one look back: which drink came by sea through three languages? (That is кофе.)

22.5 ли — the small word that has been hiding inside или

The overland drink, and the word from yesterday.

- *Recall:* чай, carried west along the Silk Road while English *tea* came by sea
- *Recall:* который hanging a clause onto a noun, and или built from и plus ли
- *Recall:* the long dash standing where the missing verb would be, and помогите
- *Recall:* вода, English *water*, and the request pattern you have used since the first chapter

Grammar lens — the doubting particle, alone

- ли — *li* — **whether**

You met this word six chapters ago, welded to the end of и, and the book promised nothing about it then. Here it is on its own.
ли does two jobs, and they are the same job seen from two sides.
One: it makes a yes-or-no question, without changing the word order at all. Put the word you are asking about first and ли second:

- понимаешь ли ты? — *panimáyesh li ty* — **do you understand?**

Two: it embeds one. English has to swap words for this — *do you understand* becomes *whether you understand*. Russian does not swap anything; it uses the same ли:

- я не знаю, понимаешь ли ты — *ya ne znáyu, panimáyesh li ty* — I do not know **whether** you understand.

The comma is there for the same reason as everywhere else in this book: a clause is hanging under a verb.
So Russian's smallest joining word is also its question particle, and the doubt inside или turns out to have been the same doubt all along.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- понимаешь ли ты*?*
- я не знаю*,* понимаешь ли ты
- или and then ли alone, and hear the piece that was always in there

Before you move on

Name the two jobs ли does. (**It makes a yes-or-no question**, and **it embeds one as *whether***.) Which word have you been carrying it inside since the joining chapter? (That is или.) Does Russian change the word order to embed a question? (**No** — the same ли does both.) And one look back: which drink came overland? (That is чай.)

22.6 One stem, a whole family of questions

The word for *which, what kind of* — the one this chapter finally taught after naming it two chapters earlier. Say it before reading on.

You'll want to know: they are all one stem with different endings

The question words are not a list to memorise separately. **Every one of them is the same ancient question-stem wearing a different ending**: кто who, что what, какой which, как how, and the rest of the set beside them.

Once the stem is visible, a word you have not met is half-readable on sight — which is what a family is for, and why the chapter taught them together rather than one per page.

Grammar Lens: который hangs a clause, ли hangs a doubt

Two of the family do more than ask:

- который — who, which, that. It takes a whole clause and hangs it on a noun, which is how a sentence stops being short.
- ли — whether. You met it six chapters earlier welded inside или, and the book left it alone until it could stand on its own.

ли is the one to hold. It marks a question you are not asking out loud — a doubt reported rather than posed — and English reaches for *whether* in the same place. Its relative который has the same cousin in English *whether*, which is a link worth keeping because it makes both words feel less arbitrary.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- four members of the question family, and the stem they share
- a noun, then hang a clause on it with который
- a doubt with ли, and the word English would use
- where ли was hiding before this chapter

Before you move on

What do the question words share? (**One ancient stem**, different endings.) What does который do to a noun? (**Hangs a whole clause on it.**) What does ли mark? (**Whether** — a question not asked out loud.) And where had you already met ли? (**Inside или**.)

Chapter 23

One to Five, and an Answer to Skolko

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say, hear, read and write the Russian numbers one to five, answer skolko with each of them, and name the English cousin of each.
>
> *Five numbers, five Indo-European roots and five everyday English cousins – the first answers this book can give to a question it has been able to ask since the last chapter.*

23.1 два — two, and the question this book could already ask

> Ask сколько — *how many.* Then say один and the root it goes back to.

You'll want to know first — one word

> два — *dva* — **two**

Twenty-two chapters in, this book can ask сколько? and could not understand any answer to it. один is in the corpus, but it arrived as half of the один **...** другой pattern — *one … the other* — which is a joining word wearing a number's clothes. два is the first number this track teaches as a number.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

два continues Indo-European **dwóh₁*, "two." English **two**, Latin **duo**, Greek **dýo** and Sanskrit **dvá** are the same word, and Russian's form is among the least worn of them.
Say *dva* and *two* one after the other. That is not something to learn; it is something to recognise, and it will be true of nearly every number in this slice.

Your turn

- *Say it:* два — two
- *Connect:* два ← **dwóh₁* → English **two**, Latin **duo**
- *Run through:* один, два

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: два; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

23.2 три — three

Say два and its English cousin.

You'll want to know first — one word

три — *tri* — **three**

Three letters, and every one of them is a Cyrillic shape this book taught long ago. *Read it:* т-р-и as you say it

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

три continues Indo-European **tréyes*, "three." English **three**, Latin **trēs**, Greek **treîs** and Sanskrit **tri** are the same word.
This is the plainest of the whole set. Nothing has shifted: the *t*, the *r* and the vowel are all where they were, which is why три and **three** sound like each other and сто and **hundred**, later in this slice, will not.

Your turn

- *Say it:* три — three
- *Connect:* три ← **tréyes* → English **three**, Latin **trēs**
- *Run through:* один, два, три

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: три; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

23.3 четыре — four, and one consonant's three fates

Say три and its Latin cousin, then два.

You'll want to know first — one word

четыре — *chetýre* — **four**

Three syllables, stressed on the second, and the vowel in that stressed syllable is ы — the sound this book warned has no English equivalent. Hold it there and the word falls into place.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

четыре continues Indo-European **k*^{w}*etwóres*, "four."
The opening **k*^{w} is the interesting part, because the branches split three ways over it. Latin kept it whole: **quattuor**. English lost the lip-rounding and softened the *k* to *f*: **four**. Slavic pushed it forward to a **ch**, which is what you are saying.

Your turn

- *Say it:* четыре — four, stress on the ы
- *Connect:* четыре ← **k*^{w}*etwóres* → Latin **quattuor**, English **four**
- *Run through:* два, три, четыре

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: четыре; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

23.4 пять — five, and a cousin English kept whole

Say четыре and what three branches did with its first sound.

You'll want to know first — one word

пять — *pyat* — **five**

One syllable, ending in the soft sign that this book has been putting on the ends of words since its first chapters. It softens the т and is not a sound of its own.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пять continues Indo-European **pénkʷe*, "five." Greek **pénte**, Latin **quīnque** and English **five** are the same word.
The Greek form is the one an English speaker already owns: **pentagon**, **pentathlon**, **Pentecost** — all of them carry *five* in a shape much closer to пять than English **five** is. The number was in the reader's vocabulary before the lesson was.

Your turn

- *Say it:* пять — five
- *Connect:* пять ← **pénkʷe* → Greek **pénte**, English **five**
- *Run through:* один, два, три, четыре, пять — the whole first five

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: пять; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

23.5 Payoff — one to five, and an answer to сколько

Ask сколько, say пять, then say what один goes back to.

Your turn

1. Hear each of the five named singly and out of order, and say what it is.
2. Count backwards from пять to один.
3. *Read it:* the five printed shuffled — пять, один, четыре, три, два — then say each
4. *Write it:* all five from dictation — no new Cyrillic letter appears in any of them
5. Hear сколько? and answer it with each of the five in turn.

Then say the English cousin of each: **one, two, three, four, five**. All five have one. That is not luck — Russian's numerals are among the least worn in the family, and this book's reader already owned most of them.

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

Chapter 24

Six to Ten, and the Pairs That Shaped Each Other

Modes: **voice** (6) **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count aloud from one to ten in Russian and say why vosem ends like sem and devyat begins like desyat.
>
> *Five more numbers with no new letter, two pairs shaped by standing next to each other, and the whole run of ten scored shuffled rather than recited.*

24.1 шесть — six

Count one to five, then five to one.

You'll want to know first — one word

шесть — *shest* — **six**

One syllable, ending like пять in the soft sign.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шесть continues Indo-European **swéḱs*, "six." English **six**, Latin **sex** and Greek **héx** are the same word.
Notice what survived: the *s*. Hold on to it, because the very last number in this slice is where that *s* turns into the fact that names half the Indo-European family.

Your turn

- *Say it:* шесть — six
- *Connect:* шесть ← **swéḱs* → English **six**, Latin **sex**
- *Run through:* четыре, пять, шесть

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: шесть; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

24.2 семь — seven

Say шесть and its Latin cousin.

You'll want to know first — one word

семь — *sem* — **seven**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

семь continues Indo-European **septm*, "seven." Latin **septem**, English **seven**, Greek **heptá** and Sanskrit **saptá** are the same word. The *p* has gone and the *s* has stayed. That combination is worth marking, because the Iranian branch did the opposite: Persian's seven is **haft**, from the same word, with the *s* turned into an *h*. Two branches, one word, and each kept the piece the other lost.

Your turn

- *Say it:* семь — seven
- *Connect:* семь ← **septm* → Latin **septem**, English **seven**
- *Run through:* пять, шесть, семь

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: семь; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

24.3 восемь — eight, and the seven inside it

Say семь, and which sound it lost that Latin kept.

You'll want to know first — one word

восемь — *vósem* — **eight**

Say семь and восемь one after the other. Seven is audible at the end of eight, and the unstressed о at the front reduces towards *a* — the reduction this book named long ago.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

восемь continues Indo-European **oḱtṓw*, "eight" — Latin **octō**, Greek **oktṓ**, English **eight**.
There is no *s* and no *m* anywhere in that history, so neither is inherited. They came from семь, standing next to it. Seven and eight are said together more often than almost any other pair of words in any language, and the pair pulls each other into shape: Persian's **hasht** borrowed its *h-* from **haft** for exactly the same reason, in a different family, with no contact between them.

Your turn

- *Say it:* восемь — eight
- *Connect:* восемь ← **oḱtṓw* → Latin **octō**, English **eight**
- *Run through:* шесть, семь, восемь

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: восемь; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

24.4 девять — nine

Say восемь, and where its ending came from.

You'll want to know first — one word

девять — *dévyat* — **nine**

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

девять continues Indo-European **h1newn*, "nine." Latin **novem**, English **nine** and Greek **ennéa** are the same word; the *n* at the front became a *d* in Slavic.
That change is not an accident either, and the next lesson is the reason: **ten** begins with a *d* in every branch, and **nine** stands directly in front of it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* девять — nine
- *Connect:* девять ← **h1newn* → Latin **novem**, English **nine**
- *Run through:* семь, восемь, девять

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: девять; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

24.5 десять — ten, and the letter nine borrowed

Say девять and which sound changed at its front.

You'll want to know first — one word

десять — *désyat* — **ten**

Say девять and десять back to back. They differ in one consonant in the middle and nothing else, which makes them the pair this whole run is likeliest to confuse — so drill them together rather than in order.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

десять continues Indo-European **dekm*, "ten." Latin **decem** — and through it **decimal**, **December**, **decade** — English **ten** and Greek **déka** are the same word.
The *d* here is the original one. девять copied it: nine stands in front of ten in every count anybody has ever said aloud, and it took its neighbour's first consonant, exactly as восемь took its ending from семь two lessons ago. Two of the last four numbers in this chapter

were shaped by the number standing beside them, which is what counting aloud does to words.

Your turn

- *Say it:* десять — ten
- *Connect:* десять ← **dekm* → Latin **decem**, English **ten**
- *Pair:* девять and десять, one consonant apart

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: десять; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

24.6 Payoff — one to ten

Count one to five, then ask сколько.

Your turn

1. Count aloud one to ten without a model, then ten to one.
2. Hear all ten named singly and out of order, and say each.
3. *Read it:* the ten printed shuffled, then say each
4. *Write it:* all ten from dictation — not one new Cyrillic letter appears in any of them; this whole slice adds no sign to the alphabet
5. Drill the two pairs that shaped each other: семь / восемь, where eight took seven's ending, and девять / десять, where nine took ten's *d*.
6. Answer сколько? ten times, once with each number.

Then say the English cousin of each. All ten have one.

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

Chapter 25

Twenty, a Hundred, and the Number That Named a Family

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say twenty and a hundred, take twenty apart into its two pieces, name which side of the centum/satem split Russian is on, and say what a Russian number still does to the noun after it that I cannot yet produce.
>
> *The tens taken apart into numbers already known, the hundred that gives the satem branch its name, and an explicit account of the case government the numerals impose and the chapter that owes it.*

25.1 двадцать — twenty, and both halves still audible

Count one to ten, then say ten on its own.

You'll want to know first — one word, and a piece

двадцать — *dvádtsat* — **twenty**

Take it apart and both pieces are words you have: два at the front, and -дцать, which is десять worn down, at the back. Two tens.

That worn ending does the same job further up: тридцать is three tens, thirty. Russian's tens are not a new vocabulary; they are numbers you already know with десять ground down onto the end of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

двадцать ← Proto-Slavic **dŭva deseti*, "two tens", in the old form for a pair (Vasmer). десять, "ten", is a cousin of Latin *decem*, "ten".

Your turn

- *Say it:* двадцать — twenty
- *Split:* два + -дцать
- *Build:* три + -дцать → тридцать, thirty

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: двадцать; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

25.2 сто — a hundred, and the number that named a family

Say двадцать and its two pieces.

You'll want to know first — one word

сто — *sto* — **a hundred**

Three letters, and the largest number this book teaches is the shortest word in it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сто continues Indo-European **kmtom*, "hundred." English **hundred**, Greek **hekatón** and Latin **centum** are the same word — and **centum** is where this stops being an etymology and becomes the name of a division.

Some branches kept that first **ḱ* as a *k* sound. Latin **centum**, Greek **hekatón**, Welsh **cant** — these are the **centum** languages, named after the Latin word for a hundred.

Others turned it into an *s* or an *sh*. Russian сто, Avestan **satəm**, Sanskrit **śatám**, Lithuanian **šimtas** — these are the **satem** languages, named after the Avestan word for the same number.

A word for a hundred is what the two halves of the Indo-European family are named after, and сто is on the satem side. It is the same *s* that survived in шесть and семь, doing the same work on a different consonant.

Your turn

- *Say it:* сто — a hundred
- *Connect:* сто ← **kmtom* → Latin **centum**, English **hundred**
- *Name:* **centum** and **satem**, and which side Russian is on
- *Run through:* десять, двадцать, сто

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: сто; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

25.3 Payoff — twelve numbers, and what they still cannot do

Count one to ten, then ask сколько.

Grammar Lens: what a Russian number does to the noun after it

A number in Russian does not simply sit in front of a noun. It **governs** it: два, три and четыре take one form of the following noun and пять upward takes another, and neither is the dictionary form. This book cannot teach that yet, and saying so is more useful than skirting it. The forms it needs are the genitive singular and the genitive plural, and this track has taught the genitive in exactly one place — after до, in до свидания. Counting THINGS is therefore a genitive chapter rather than a numeral one.
What the twelve numbers are already good for: answering сколько? with a bare figure, giving an age, saying a price, reading a room number, and every place a number stands alone.

Your turn

1. Count aloud one to ten, then say двадцать and сто.
2. Hear twelve amounts named singly and out of order; say each.
3. *Read it:* the twelve amounts, printed and shuffled, then say each
4. *Write it:* all twelve from dictation
5. Split двадцать into its two pieces and build тридцать from три.
6. Say which side of the centum/satem split Russian is on, and name the number the split is named after.

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

Chapter 26

Which One: the Ordinals, Said and Written

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say first, second and third, build the ordinal of any number I can count to, and read and write an ordinal as a figure with its ending hyphenated on.
>
> *Two forms outside the pattern, one adjective ending for everything above them, and the written 1-y whose letters after the hyphen are the agreement rather than decoration.*

26.1 первый — first

> Count one to ten, say двадцать and сто, say один and its root, and say what a number still does to the noun after it.

You'll want to know first — one word

> первый — *pérvyy* — **first**

Counting says *how many*. Ordering says *which one* — a floor number, a date, a queue, a chapter heading — and twelve numbers do not give you one of them.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

первый is not built from один. It goes back to Indo-European **per-*, "forward, in front," which is also behind English **fore**, **before** and

former — and behind **first** itself, which is *fore* with a superlative ending on it.
So Russian and English break in the same place and for the same reason: the word for *first* means *foremost* in both, and neither is built from the word for *one*. The series comes into line at *second*.

Your turn

- *Say it:* первый — first
- *Contrast:* один counts, первый orders
- *Connect:* первый ← **per-* → English **fore**, **first**

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: первый; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

26.2 второй and третий — second, third, and the ending above them

Say первый and why it is not built from один. Then say три.

You'll want to know first — two words and an ending

второй — *vtoróy* — **second**

третий — *trétiy* — **third**

три is audible whole inside третий. And from four upward the pattern settles completely: the ordinal is **the plain number with an adjective ending on it** — четвёртый, fourth; пятый, fifth; десятый, tenth.

That is worth saying plainly, because it means the reader who has twelve cardinals has twelve ordinals as soon as they have one ending, with only первый and второй outside it.

Russian ordinals are adjectives, and that carries a debt as well as a rule: an adjective changes its ending to agree with what it describes, and this book has not taught an adjective yet. So the forms here are the ones a masculine noun takes, and agreeing them with anything else is an adjective chapter rather than a numeral one.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

третий ← Proto-Slavic **tretiji* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *trẽčias*, Latin *tertius* and English *third* (Vasmer). второй is perhaps from **vĭtorŭ*, related to Sanskrit *vítaras*, "further"; others reconstruct **vŭtorŭ* and link it with Lithuanian *añtras*, "second, other" (Vasmer).

Your turn

- *Say it:* второй — second; третий — third
- *Hear:* три inside третий
- *Build:* четыре → четвёртый; десять → десятый

Before you move on

Sources: Wiktionary: второй; Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

26.3 1-й — writing an ordinal as a figure

Say первый and второй, then build пятый from пять.

Script — the figure and its ending

1-й — *pérvyy* — first **2-е** — *vtoróye* — second

A Russian ordinal written as a figure carries the tail of its own ending after a hyphen. **1-й** is первый with everything but the last letter replaced by the figure; **2-е** is второе in the same way.

This is not decoration. Ordinals are adjectives, so the ending is the agreement — change what is being ordered and the letters after the hyphen change with it. That is why the figure alone will not do, and why an English reader who writes **1st** for all of them is losing information the Russian page is carrying.

The hyphen is the short dash this book taught among its punctuation, not the long dash that stands for a missing verb.

Your turn

- *Write it:* **1-**й, **2-**е, **3-**й
- *Read it:* each aloud as the full word
- *Say it:* why the letters after the hyphen are not always the same

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

26.4 Payoff — which one, said and written

Count one to ten, say двадцать and сто, and name the side of the family Russian is on.

Your turn

1. Say первый, второй, третий in order, then out of order.
2. **Build**, do not recall: fourth, fifth, tenth, twentieth.
3. *Write it:* **1-**й, **2-**е, **3-**й, and read each aloud as a full word
4. Say which two of the series are not built from their numbers, and what English does in the same place.
5. Count one to ten, say двадцать and сто, and say what a number still does to the noun after it that this book has not taught.

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

26.5 Close the numeral slice

Say the first three ordinals, count one to five, and ask сколько.

Your turn

Everything this slice added, with nothing in front of you.

1. Count aloud one to ten, then say двадцать and сто.
2. *Write it:* all twelve from dictation, shuffled
3. Say the first three ordinals and build three more. *Write it:* **1-й** and **2-е**
4. Say the English cousin of each of the ten cardinals. Every one has one.
5. Say the two pairs that shaped each other — семь / восемь, девять / десять — and which side of the centum/satem split сто puts Russian on.
6. Say the one thing these numbers still cannot do, and which chapter owes it.

Then say what the whole slice cost the hand: **no new Cyrillic letter at all.**

Before you move on

Source: Omniglot, Numbers in Russian.

26.6 ли — the question you are not asking

> Two letters, and it means *whether*. Say it, then say the longer word it was hiding inside for six chapters before it stood alone.

You'll want to know: two ways to make a sentence longer

Both were taught in one chapter and neither has been asked for since. They are the two ways a short Russian sentence grows:

который	hangs a whole clause on a **noun**
ли	hangs a **doubt** on a verb — *whether*, a question not asked aloud

The difference is what each attaches to. **который** reaches back to a thing and says more about it. **ли** reaches forward into a question and reports it instead of posing it.

Four chapters of numbers have passed since either appeared. Saying them now, with nothing on the page, is the first real evidence they were learned rather than met.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *whether*, in Russian, with the page covered
- the word it used to live inside
- a noun, then hang a clause on it
- report a question instead of asking it

Before you move on

What does **ли** attach to, and what does **который** attach to? (**A doubt on a verb**; **a clause on a noun**.) Which of the two lets you report a question rather than ask it? (**ли**.) And which word did **ли** spend six chapters inside? (**или**.)

Chapter 27

Reading — Six Words, Six Lines, and a First Passage

Modes: **eyes** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read Russian words off a board, read the lines I would say to a stranger, and hold a whole passage without translating it word by word.
>
> *The introduction the book has been saying since chapter 2, read in order for the first time, with no new word in it.*

27.1 (reading) — six words off a board

You have written every letter in every one of these. Not one word is new.

What is new is that nobody says them before you read them.

Read this

вода хлеб чай кофе суп сыр

Read down the list once. Do not spell each one out — look at the whole word and let it arrive.
Again, and notice which came at once and which you had to spell. Both are fine. The difference is what practice removes.

What to know first

These six would be on a board over a counter, and they are the six you would want first.

Two of them are traps of exactly the kind this book warned you about. суп and сыр look like *cyn* and *cbip* to an eye trained on English, and they are *sup* and *syr*.

That is the whole reason to read a word cold rather than after hearing it. Heard first, you never test whether the letters actually reached you.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
Which two look most like English and are not? (суп and сыр.)

27.2 (reading) — three to open, three to rescue

The last lesson gave you six things on a board. These are six things you would say.

Nothing here is new. What is new is meeting them in writing.

Read this

привет спасибо пожалуйста извините медленно помогите

Read it: the six notices down once, without stopping
Read it: the six notices again, and notice the list turns over halfway
The first three open a conversation. The last three rescue one.

What to know first

пожалуйста is the longest word on the list and the one you will read most often. It is worth recognising by shape rather than by spelling it out, because it does two jobs: *please*, and *you're welcome*.

помогите and извините end the same way, and both are requests you make to somebody you have not met. That shared ending is the one piece of grammar visible on this page.

Six lines, and half of them exist for the moment something goes wrong.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six lines, once, in order, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)
Where does the list turn over? (**After пожалуйста** — three to open, three to rescue.)

27.3 (reading) — the first passage

Six words, then six lines. Now the whole thing at once.

Not one word in it is new.

Read this

Привет! Меня зовут Анна. Сестра и мама. Папа тоже. Я читаю. Я хочу читать. Вода, хлеб и чай. Кофе или чай? Я не знаю. Спасибо. До свидания.

Read it through once without stopping. Do not translate as you go. Again — and this time notice that two lines differ by one word, and that the one word changes when the reading happens.

What to know first

Я читаю is now. Я хочу читать is not yet. Russian marks that difference by changing the ending of the verb in the first and leaving it whole in the second, which is the opposite of what an English speaker expects.

Look at и and или as well. One letter apart on the page, and the difference between a list and a choice. Read quickly, that is the easiest mistake on this page to make.

This is the first whole passage the book has asked you to hold at once, and it works because every line was paid for.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the passage aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that passage were new? (**None.**)
Which two words are one letter apart and mean different things? (`и` and `или`.)

Chapter 28

The Small Ya

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (2) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the small ya, the word for I, as Russian writes it inside a sentence.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 28: I can write the small ya, the word for I, as Russian writes it inside a sentence.*

28.1 я (ya) — the word for I, written small

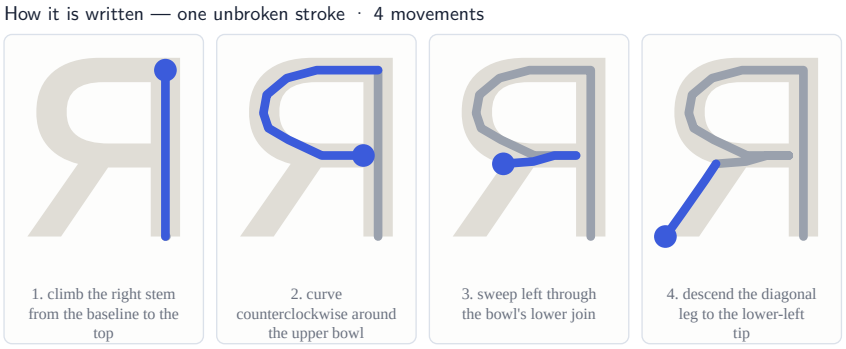
> Before the new one: write й and ю once each, and name them.
>
> Now say я (*ya*), "I". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: я

я — small *ya*.

я (*ya*) is also a whole word: "I". You wrote the capital Я in the letter chapters, but Russian writes "I" with the **small** letter: inside a sentence it is never capitalised, unlike English "I". So this is the shape you will write most.

Writing: я



How я *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start here: climb the right stem from the baseline to the top
- **2.** without lifting, curve counterclockwise around the upper bowl
- **3.** without lifting, sweep left through the bowl's lower join
- **4.** without lifting, descend the diagonal leg to the lower-left tip — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 0. The pen never leaves the paper.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: RussianIrina, 'Learning Russian - Alphabet letters, handwriting', lowercase я demonstration, 12:13–12:21, YouTube, 5 February 2013.

Your turn

- *Look:* at я and point at я inside it
- *Trace it:* я three times, saying *ya* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ю, then я, from memory
- *Read it:* я aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — **я**? (**ya**, *ya*.) Which word did it come from? (**я**, *ya*, "I".)

28.2 (one letter) — From the letter to the word — a first pass

Say **я** (*ya*), then write the letter it gave you.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
я	*ya*	**я** *ya*

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from
- *Read it:* each word in the table aloud, and point at its letter

Before you move on

Which word did each letter come from? (**я** from **я**.)

28.3 (one letter) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Write **я** without looking, then say the word it came from.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
я	*ya*	**я** *ya*

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* each letter once more, slowly, larger than it is printed

Before you move on

Say each word in the table once more, and name the letter you took from it.

Chapter 29

Head, Hand, Leg, Belly, Tooth

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the head, a hand, a leg, the belly and a tooth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 29: I can name the head, a hand, a leg, the belly and a tooth.*

29.1 голова (golová) — the head

Before the new one: say the Russian for first, then the Russian for second.

You'll want to know: голова

голова (*golová*) — "the head".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

голова ← Proto-Slavic **golva*, "head" — inherited, and a cousin of Lithuanian *galvà*, "head" (Vasmer). East Slavic says -оло- where Church Slavonic says -ла-, so the same word came back from church books as глава, "chapter; the head of something".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: golová*
- *Say it: golová*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golová*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for first, then the Russian for second, then say *golová* again

Before you move on

What does голова mean? ("The head".) Say it once more.

29.2 рука (ruká) — a hand, an arm

Before the new one: say the Russian for second, then the Russian for the head.

You'll want to know: рука

рука (*ruká*) — "a hand, an arm". One word for both.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рука ← Proto-Slavic **rǫka*, "hand" — inherited; the old nasal *ǫ* became Russian у. Vasmer pairs it with Lithuanian *rankà*, "hand", and links both with Lithuanian *riñkti*, "to gather": the hand as the gatherer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ruká*
- *Say it: ruká*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ruká*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for second, then the Russian for the head, then say *ruká* again

Before you move on

What does рука mean? (“A hand, an arm”.) Say it once more.

29.3 нога (nogá) — a leg, a foot

Before the new one: say the Russian for the head, then the Russian for a hand.

You’ll want to know: нога

нога (*nogá*) — “a leg, a foot”. One word for both, like рука.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нога ← Proto-Slavic **noga* — inherited. Vasmer gives “claw” as the first sense and lists Lithuanian *nagà*, “hoof”, Latin *unguis*, “nail”, and Old High German *nagal*, “nail”: English *nail* is a cousin, from PIE **h₃nog^{wh}-*, “nail, claw”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nogá*
- *Say it:* *nogá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nogá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the head, then the Russian for a hand, then say *nogá* again

Before you move on

What does нога mean? (“A leg, a foot”.) Say it once more.

29.4 живот (zhivót) — the belly

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hand, then the Russian for a leg.

You'll want to know: живот

живот (*zhivót*) — "the belly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

живот ← Proto-Slavic **životŭ*, "life" — inherited, from the root of жить, "to live". Old Russian *životŭ* meant "life, property"; "belly" came later (Vasmer). Lithuanian *gyvatà*, "life", and Latin *vīta*, "life", are cousins (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhivót*
- *Say it: zhivót*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhivót*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hand, then the Russian for a leg, then say *zhivót* again

Before you move on

What does живот mean? ("The belly".) Say it once more.

29.5 зуб (zub) — a tooth

Before the new one: say the Russian for a leg, then the Russian for the belly.

You'll want to know: зуб

зуб (*zub*) — "a tooth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зуб ← Proto-Slavic **zǫbŭ*, "tooth" — inherited. Vasmer sets it beside Sanskrit *jámbha-*, "tooth", Greek *gómphos*, "peg", and Old High German *kamb*, "comb", so English *comb* is a cousin, from PIE **ǵómbʰos*, "tooth, peg".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zub*
- *Say it: zub*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zub*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a leg, then the Russian for the belly, then say *zub* again

Before you move on

What does зуб mean? ("A tooth".) Say it once more.

Chapter 30

Hair, Finger, Neck, Shoulder, Knee

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name hair, a finger, the neck, a shoulder and a knee.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 30: I can name hair, a finger, the neck, a shoulder and a knee.*

30.1 волосы (vólosy) — hair

> Before the new one: say the Russian for the belly, then the Russian for a tooth.

You'll want to know: волосы

волосы (*vólosy*) — "hair". Plural, like English "locks".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

волосы is the plural of волос, "a hair", ← Proto-Slavic **volsŭ* — inherited. Vasmer compares Avestan *varəsa-*, "hair". Russian -оло- faces Church Slavonic -ла- again: the church form is власы, an old word for "hair".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vólosy*
- *Say it: vólosy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vólosy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the belly, then the Russian for a tooth, then say *vólosy* again

Before you move on

What does волосы mean? ("Hair".) Say it once more.

30.2 палец (pálets) — a finger

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tooth, then the Russian for hair.

You'll want to know: палец

палец (*pálets*) — "a finger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

палец ← Proto-Slavic **palьcь* — inherited; older Russian texts use it for "thumb" (Sokolova, in Trubachev's note to Vasmer). It is usually tied to Latin *pollex*, "thumb", though Vasmer notes doubts about that link.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pálets*
- *Say it: pálets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pálets*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tooth, then the Russian for hair, then say *pálets* again

Before you move on

What does палец mean? (“A finger”.) Say it once more.

30.3 шея (shéya) — the neck

Before the new one: say the Russian for hair, then the Russian for a finger.

You’ll want to know: шея

шея (*shéya*) — “the neck”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шея ← Proto-Slavic **šija* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it probably first meant “collar”, from the root of шить, “to sew”; the links proposed with Latin and Albanian words he calls unreliable.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shéya*
- *Say it: shéya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shéya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hair, then the Russian for a finger, then say *shéya* again

Before you move on

What does шея mean? (“The neck”.) Say it once more.

30.4 плечо (plechó) — a shoulder

Before the new one: say the Russian for a finger, then the Russian for the neck.

You'll want to know: плечо

плечо (*plechó*) — "a shoulder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плечо ← Proto-Slavic **pleťe* — inherited. Vasmer compares Latvian *plecs*, "shoulder", and words for "flat" such as Greek *plax*, "a level plain", but he also gives a second possible source, so the deeper origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plechó*
- *Say it: plechó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plechó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a finger, then the Russian for the neck, then say *plechó* again

Before you move on

What does плечо mean? ("A shoulder".) Say it once more.

30.5 колено (koléno) — a knee

Before the new one: say the Russian for the neck, then the Russian for a shoulder.

You'll want to know: колено

колено (*koléno*) — "a knee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

колено ← Proto-Slavic **koléno* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *kelỹs*, "knee", and Greek *kōlon*, "limb" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koléno*
- *Say it: koléno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koléno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the neck, then the Russian for a shoulder, then say *koléno* again

Before you move on

What does колено mean? ("A knee".) Say it once more.

Chapter 31

Back, Tongue, Lip, Face, Blood

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the back, the tongue, a lip, the face and blood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 31: I can name the back, the tongue, a lip, the face and blood.*

31.1 спина (spiná) — the back

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a shoulder, then the Russian for a knee.

You'll want to know: спина

спина (*spiná*) — "the back".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спина — origin disputed. One view takes it from Latin *spīna*, "thorn, backbone", through Old Polish *spina*, "backbone"; Vasmer also allows a native word, a cousin of the Latin one and of Latvian *spina*, "a switch". It is first recorded in the 1600s (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *spiná*
- *Say it:* *spiná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spiná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shoulder, then the Russian for a knee, then say *spiná* again

Before you move on

What does спина mean? (“The back”.) Say it once more.

31.2 язык (yazýk) — the tongue; a language

Before the new one: say the Russian for a knee, then the Russian for the back.

You’ll want to know: язык

язык (*yazýk*) — “the tongue; a language”. Both meanings, as in English “tongue”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

язык ← Proto-Slavic **języ̨kŭ*, “tongue” — inherited, from the old Indo-European word for “tongue” that also gave Old Latin *dingua*, later *lingua*, and English *tongue* (Vasmer). The Slavic shape is irregular. “Language” grew from the organ, as in English *tongue*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yazýk*
- *Say it:* *yazýk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yazýk*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a knee, then the Russian for the back, then say *yazýk* again

Before you move on

What does язык mean? ("The tongue; a language".) Say it once more.

31.3 губа (gubá) — a lip

Before the new one: say the Russian for the back, then the Russian for the tongue; a language.

You'll want to know: губа

губа (*gubá*) — "a lip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

губа ← Proto-Slavic **gǫba* — inherited; Ukrainian губа and Polish *gęba* mean "mouth" (Vasmer). The deeper origin is unclear: Vasmer weighs Greek *gamphai*, "jaws", and a link with the губа that means "sponge", without deciding.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gubá*
- *Say it: gubá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gubá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the back, then the Russian for the tongue; a language, then say *gubá* again

Before you move on

What does губа mean? ("A lip".) Say it once more.

31.4 лицо (litsó) — the face

Before the new one: say the Russian for the tongue; a language, then the Russian for a lip.

You'll want to know: лицо

лицо (*litsó*) — "the face".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лицо ← Proto-Slavic **lice*, built on **likŭ*, "face", the word Russian keeps as лик, "a face on an icon" (Vasmer). Vasmer compares Old Irish *lecco*, "cheek".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: litsó*
- *Say it: litsó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *litsó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the tongue; a language, then the Russian for a lip, then say *litsó* again

Before you move on

What does лицо mean? ("The face".) Say it once more.

31.5 кровь (krov) — blood

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lip, then the Russian for the face.

You'll want to know: кровь

кровь (*krov*) — "blood".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кровь ← Proto-Slavic **kry*, with the stem **krŭv-* in its other forms — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *kraũjas*, "blood", Latin *cruor*, "gore", Greek *kréas*, "meat", and Old Norse *hrár*, "raw", so English *raw* is a cousin, from PIE **kréwh₂-*, "raw flesh".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krov*
- *Say it: krov*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krov*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lip, then the Russian for the face, then say *krov* again

Before you move on

What does кровь mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 32

Pain, Illness, Medicine, Doctor

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name pain, an illness, medicine, a doctor and a hospital.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 32: I can name pain, an illness, medicine, a doctor and a hospital.*

32.1 боль (bol) — pain

Before the new one: say the Russian for the face, then the Russian for blood.

You'll want to know: боль

боль (*bol*) — "pain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

боль ← Proto-Slavic **bolĭ* — inherited, with the verb болеть, "to ache, to be ill". Vasmer sets it beside Gothic *balwjan*, "to torment", and Old English *bealu*, "evil", the *bale* of *baleful*, but notes that Berneker rejected the link.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bol*
- *Say it: bol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the face, then the Russian for blood, then say *bol* again

Before you move on

What does боль mean? ("Pain".) Say it once more.

32.2 болезнь (bolézn) — an illness

Before the new one: say the Russian for blood, then the Russian for pain.

You'll want to know: болезнь

болезнь (*bolézn*) — "an illness". Built on боль.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

болезнь — built from болеть, "to be ill", the verb of боль, "pain", with the old noun suffix -знь that also makes жизнь, "life".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolézn*
- *Say it: bolézn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bolézn*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for blood, then the Russian for pain, then say *bolézn* again

Before you move on

What does болезнь mean? ("An illness".) Say it once more.

32.3 лекарство (lekárstvo) — medicine

Before the new one: say the Russian for pain, then the Russian for an illness.

You'll want to know: лекарство

лекарство (*lekárstvo*) — "medicine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лекарство is лекарь, an old word for "doctor", with the noun suffix -ство. The root лек-, "cure", came into Slavic from Germanic; Vasmer calls the loan certain and compares Gothic *lēkeis*, "doctor". English *leech*, an old word for "physician", is from that Germanic word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lekárstvo*
- *Say it: lekárstvo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lekárstvo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pain, then the Russian for an illness, then say *lekárstvo* again

Before you move on

What does лекарство mean? ("Medicine".) Say it once more.

32.4 врач (vrach) — a doctor

Before the new one: say the Russian for an illness, then the Russian for medicine.

You'll want to know: врач

врач (*vrach*) — "a doctor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

врач — a Church Slavonic word, Old Church Slavonic *vračĭ*; its -ра-, where East Slavic would say -оро-, marks it. Vasmer derives it from the root of врать, "to talk nonsense", and ворчать, "to grumble", so the first sense was "charmer, healer by spells"; Bulgarian врач still means "sorcerer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vrach*
- *Say it: vrach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vrach*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an illness, then the Russian for medicine, then say *vrach* again

Before you move on

What does врач mean? ("A doctor".) Say it once more.

32.5 больница (bolnítsa) — a hospital

Before the new one: say the Russian for medicine, then the Russian for a doctor.

You'll want to know: больница

больница (*bolnítsa*) — "a hospital". Built on боль as well.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

больница is больной, "sick; a patient", with -ница, a suffix that names places: a place for the sick. The root is that of боль, "pain". Vasmer relates боль to Old English *bealu*, "harm".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolnítsa*
- *Say it: bolnítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bolnítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for medicine, then the Russian for a doctor, then say *bolnítsa* again

Before you move on

What does больница mean? ("A hospital".) Say it once more.

Chapter 33

Fever, Cough, Rest, Hunger, Thirst

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a temperature, a cough, rest, hunger and thirst.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 33: I can name a temperature, a cough, rest, hunger and thirst.*

33.1 температура (temperatúra) — a temperature, a fever

Before the new one: say the Russian for a doctor, then the Russian for a hospital.

You'll want to know: температура

температура (*temperatúra*) — "a temperature, a fever".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

температура ← Latin *temperātūra*, "due measure, mixing", from *temperāre*, "to mix in proportion" — borrowed in modern times, probably through German *Temperatur*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: temperatúra*
- *Say it: temperatúra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *temperatúra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a doctor, then the Russian for a hospital, then say *temperatúra* again

Before you move on

What does температура mean? ("A temperature, a fever".) Say it once more.

33.2 кашель (káshel) — a cough

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hospital, then the Russian for a temperature.

You'll want to know: кашель

кашель (*káshel*) — "a cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кашель ← Proto-Slavic **kašĭlĭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *kosulỹs*, Sanskrit *kāsa-* and Old High German *huosto*, all "cough" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: káshel*
- *Say it: káshel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *káshel*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hospital, then the Russian for a temperature, then say *káshel* again

Before you move on

What does кашель mean? (“A cough”.) Say it once more.

33.3 отдых (ótdykh) — rest

Before the new one: say the Russian for a temperature, then the Russian for a cough.

You’ll want to know: отдых

отдых (*ótdykh*) — “rest”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отдых is от-, “back, away”, with дых, “breath”, from the verb дышать, “to breathe”: rest is getting your breath back. For the root, Vasmer compares Lithuanian *dūsėti*, “to pant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ótdykh*
- *Say it: ótdykh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ótdykh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a temperature, then the Russian for a cough, then say *ótdykh* again

Before you move on

What does отдых mean? (“Rest”.) Say it once more.

33.4 голод (gólod) — hunger

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cough, then the Russian for rest.

You'll want to know: голод

голод (*gólod*) — "hunger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

голод ← Proto-Slavic **goldŭ* — inherited. Vasmer links it with Church Slavonic *žĭlděti*, "to crave", and Sanskrit *gṛdhyati*, "is greedy". The Church Slavonic shape is глад, "famine", with -ла- for Russian -оло-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gólod*
- *Say it:* *gólod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gólod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cough, then the Russian for rest, then say *gólod* again

Before you move on

What does голод mean? ("Hunger".) Say it once more.

33.5 жажда (zházhda) — thirst

Before the new one: say the Russian for rest, then the Russian for hunger.

You'll want to know: жажда

жажда (*zházhda*) — "thirst". вода answers it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жажда — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer: -жд- is the Church Slavonic sound where East Slavic has -ж-, and Old Russian had the native жажа. Both go back to Proto-Slavic **žędja*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zházhda*
- *Say it: zházhda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zházhda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rest, then the Russian for hunger, then say *zházhda* again

Before you move on

What does жажда mean? ("Thirst".) Say it once more.

Chapter 34

Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Tiredness

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness and tiredness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 34: I can name joy, fear, anger, sadness and tiredness.*

34.1 радость (rádost) — joy

> Before the new one: say the Russian for hunger, then the Russian for thirst.

You'll want to know: радость

радость (*rádost*) — "joy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

радость is рад, "glad", with -ость, the suffix that makes nouns of quality. рад goes back to Proto-Slavic **radŭ*; Vasmer finds a link with Old English *rōt*, "cheerful", likely, but reports a rival account.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rádost*
- *Say it: rádost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rádost*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hunger, then the Russian for thirst, then say *rádost* again

Before you move on

What does радость mean? ("Joy".) Say it once more.

34.2 страх (strakh) — fear

Before the new one: say the Russian for thirst, then the Russian for joy.

You'll want to know: страх

страх (*strakh*) — "fear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

страх ← Proto-Slavic **straxŭ* — inherited. Its deeper origin is not settled: one account Vasmer reports gives it a first sense of "numbness" and compares Lithuanian *stregti*, "to freeze stiff".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: strakh*
- *Say it: strakh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *strakh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for thirst, then the Russian for joy, then say *strakh* again

Before you move on

What does страх mean? (“Fear”.) Say it once more.

34.3 гнев (gnev) — anger

Before the new one: say the Russian for joy, then the Russian for fear.

You’ll want to know: гнев

гнев (*gnev*) — “anger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гнев ← Proto-Slavic **gněvŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it probably belongs with гнить, “to rot”, so the first sense would have been “rot, poison”; others start from a sense “to burn”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gnev*
- *Say it: gnev*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gnev*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for joy, then the Russian for fear, then say *gnev* again

Before you move on

What does гнев mean? (“Anger”.) Say it once more.

34.4 грусть (grust) — sadness

Before the new one: say the Russian for fear, then the Russian for anger.

You'll want to know: грусть

грусть (*grust*) — "sadness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грусть goes with the verb грустить, "to be sad". Vasmer reports the usual link with груда, "a heap", and with Lithuanian *graudùs*, "brittle; sad, moving", from a root "to crush" (Lithuanian *grūsti*, "to pound"). Vasmer himself thinks a link with the verb "to gnaw" more likely: a sadness that gnaws.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grust*
- *Say it: grust*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grust*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fear, then the Russian for anger, then say *grust* again

Before you move on

What does грусть mean? ("Sadness".) Say it once more.

34.5 усталость (ustálost) — tiredness

Before the new one: say the Russian for anger, then the Russian for sadness.

You'll want to know: усталость

усталость (*ustálost*) — "tiredness".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

усталость is устать, "to get tired", with -ость, the suffix for nouns of quality. устать is у- with стать, "to stand, to become" (Vasmer); Old Church Slavonic уставати meant "to cease": a tired person has come to a stop.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ustálost*
- *Say it: ustálost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ustálost*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for anger, then the Russian for sadness, then say *ustálost* again

Before you move on

What does усталость mean? ("Tiredness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 35

Son, Daughter, Grandmother, Husband, Wife

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a son, a daughter, a grandmother, a husband and a wife.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 35: I can name a son, a daughter, a grandmother, a husband and a wife.*

35.1 сын (syn) — a son

Before the new one: say the Russian for sadness, then the Russian for tiredness.

You'll want to know: сын

сын (*syn*) — "a son".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сын ← Proto-Slavic **synŭ* — inherited from PIE **suHnús*, "son". Vasmer lists Lithuanian *sūnùs*, Sanskrit *sūnú-* and Gothic *sunus*, so English *son* is a cousin, and he links the word with a Sanskrit verb "to give birth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: syn*
- *Say it: syn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *syn*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sadness, then the Russian for tiredness, then say *syn* again

Before you move on

What does сын mean? ("A son".) Say it once more.

35.2 дочь (doch) — a daughter

Before the new one: say the Russian for tiredness, then the Russian for a son.

You'll want to know: дочь

дочь (*doch*) — "a daughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дочь ← Proto-Slavic **dŭťi*, Old Russian дочи — inherited from PIE **$d^{h}ugh_{2}t\bar{e}r$*, "daughter". Vasmer lists Lithuanian *duktė*, Sanskrit *duhitā*, Greek *thygátēr* and Gothic *daúhtar*: English *daughter* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: doch*
- *Say it: doch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *doch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tiredness, then the Russian for a son, then say *doch* again

Before you move on

What does дочь mean? ("A daughter".) Say it once more.

35.3 бабушка (bábushka) — a grandmother

Before the new one: say the Russian for a son, then the Russian for a daughter.

You'll want to know: бабушка

бабушка (*bábushka*) — "a grandmother".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бабушка is баба, "old woman, granny", with -ушка, a fond diminutive. баба is a nursery word, says Vasmer, and Lithuanian *bóba*, "old woman", is the same kind of word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bábushka*
- *Say it: bábushka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bábushka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a son, then the Russian for a daughter, then say *bábushka* again

Before you move on

What does бабушка mean? ("A grandmother".) Say it once more.

35.4 муж (muzh) — a husband

Before the new one: say the Russian for a daughter, then the Russian for a grandmother.

You'll want to know: муж

муж (*muzh*) — "a husband".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

муж ← Proto-Slavic **mǫžĭ*, "a man" — inherited. Vasmer calls it undoubtedly related to Sanskrit *mánu-*, "man", and Gothic *manna*, so English *man* is a cousin. "Husband" grew out of "man".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muzh*
- *Say it: muzh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muzh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a daughter, then the Russian for a grandmother, then say *muzh* again

Before you move on

What does муж mean? ("A husband".) Say it once more.

35.5 жена (zhená) — a wife

Before the new one: say the Russian for a grandmother, then the Russian for a husband.

You'll want to know: жена

жена (*zhená*) — "a wife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жена ← Proto-Slavic **žena*, "woman, wife" — inherited from PIE **g^{w}énh$_2$*, "woman". Vasmer lists Greek *gynē*, Sanskrit *jani-* and Gothic *qinō*, "wife": English *queen* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhená*
- *Say it: zhená*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhená*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a grandmother, then the Russian for a husband, then say *zhená* again

Before you move on

What does жена mean? ("A wife".) Say it once more.

Chapter 36

Children, a Child, Aunt, Grandchildren

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name children, a child, an aunt, a grandson and a granddaughter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 36: I can name children, a child, an aunt, a grandson and a granddaughter.*

36.1 дети (déti) — children

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a husband, then the Russian for a wife.

You'll want to know: дети

дети (*déti*) — "children".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дети is the plural of дитя, "a child", ← Proto-Slavic **dětę*, **děti* — inherited. Vasmer traces it to the PIE root **dʰeh₁(i)-*, "to suckle", the root of доить, "to milk": a child is one who is nursed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déti*
- *Say it: déti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déti*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a husband, then the Russian for a wife, then say *déti* again

Before you move on

What does дети mean? ("Children".) Say it once more.

36.2 ребёнок (rebyónok) — a child

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wife, then the Russian for children.

You'll want to know: ребёнок

ребёнок (*rebyónok*) — "a child". One child; дети is the plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ребёнок grew from Old Russian робя, "child", Proto-Slavic **orbę*, with a diminutive ending; роб- became реб- by an old vowel assimilation (Vasmer). The same root gave раб, "slave", and Vasmer lists Latin *orbus*, "bereaved", and Greek *orphanós*, "orphan", as cousins.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rebyónok*
- *Say it: rebyónok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rebyónok*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wife, then the Russian for children, then say *rebyónok* again

Before you move on

What does ребёнок mean? (“A child”.) Say it once more.

36.3 тётя (tyótya) — an aunt

Before the new one: say the Russian for children, then the Russian for a child.

You’ll want to know: тётя

тётя (*tyótya*) — “an aunt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тётя is a nursery word, says Vasmer, like тятя, an old word for “dad”. Lithuanian *tetà*, “aunt”, and Greek *tétta*, “daddy”, are formed the same way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyótya*
- *Say it: tyótya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyótya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for children, then the Russian for a child, then say *tyótya* again

Before you move on

What does тётя mean? (“An aunt”.) Say it once more.

36.4 внук (vnuk) — a grandson

Before the new one: say the Russian for a child, then the Russian for an aunt.

You'll want to know: внук

внук (*vnuk*) — "a grandson".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

внук ← Proto-Slavic **vŭnukŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it may belong with an old nursery word for an elder, seen in Old High German *ano*, "ancestor", and Latin *anus*, "old woman"; he finds other proposals less likely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vnuk*
- *Say it: vnuk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vnuk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a child, then the Russian for an aunt, then say *vnuk* again

Before you move on

What does внук mean? ("A grandson".) Say it once more.

36.5 внучка (vnúchka) — a granddaughter

Before the new one: say the Russian for an aunt, then the Russian for a grandson.

You'll want to know: внучка

внучка (*vnúchka*) — "a granddaughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

внучка is внук, "grandson", with -ка, which makes the female word; к turns to ч before it, as in рука, "hand", and ручка, "a little hand; a pen". Vasmer traces внук to Proto-Slavic **vŭnukŭ* and tentatively links it with an old nursery word for an elder, kept in Latin *anus*, "old woman".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vnúchka*
- *Say it: vnúchka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vnúchka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an aunt, then the Russian for a grandson, then say *vnúchka* again

Before you move on

What does внучка mean? ("A granddaughter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 37

Neighbour, Guest, Teacher, Pupil, Work

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a neighbour, a guest, a teacher, a pupil and work.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 37: I can name a neighbour, a guest, a teacher, a pupil and work.*

37.1 сосед (soséd) — a neighbour

Before the new one: say the Russian for a grandson, then the Russian for a granddaughter.

You'll want to know: сосед

сосед (*soséd*) — "a neighbour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сосед ← Proto-Slavic **sǫsědŭ* — inherited: **sǫ-*, "together", with the root of сидеть, "to sit", so a neighbour is "one who sits beside you". Vasmer compares Sanskrit *saṃsád*, "assembly".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soséd*
- *Say it: soséd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soséd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a grandson, then the Russian for a granddaughter, then say *soséd* again

Before you move on

What does **сосед** mean? ("A neighbour".) Say it once more.

37.2 гость (gost) — a guest

Before the new one: say the Russian for a granddaughter, then the Russian for a neighbour.

You'll want to know: гость

гость (*gost*) — "a guest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гость ← Proto-Slavic **gostĭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Gothic *gasts* and Latin *hostis*, "stranger, enemy", and rejects a loan from Germanic: English *guest* is a cousin, from PIE **gʰóstis*. In Old Russian a **гость** was also a travelling merchant (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gost*
- *Say it: gost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gost*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a granddaughter, then the Russian for a neighbour, then say *gost* again

Before you move on

What does гость mean? (“A guest”.) Say it once more.

37.3 учитель (uchítel) — a teacher

Before the new one: say the Russian for a neighbour, then the Russian for a guest.

You’ll want to know: учитель

учитель (*uchítel*) — “a teacher”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

учитель is учить, “to teach”, with -тель, “one who does it”; Old Church Slavonic already had it. The verb goes back to Proto-Slavic **učiti*, “to accustom” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uchítel*
- *Say it: uchítel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uchítel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a neighbour, then the Russian for a guest, then say *uchítel* again

Before you move on

What does учитель mean? (“A teacher”.) Say it once more.

37.4 ученик (ucheník) — a pupil

Before the new one: say the Russian for a guest, then the Russian for a teacher.

You'll want to know: ученик

ученик (*ucheník*) — "a pupil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ученик is учить, "to teach, to learn", with -ник, a suffix for a person: the one who learns. The verb goes back to Proto-Slavic **učiti*, "to accustom" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ucheník*
- *Say it: ucheník*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ucheník*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a guest, then the Russian for a teacher, then say *ucheník* again

Before you move on

What does ученик mean? ("A pupil".) Say it once more.

37.5 работа (rabóta) — work, a job

Before the new one: say the Russian for a teacher, then the Russian for a pupil.

You'll want to know: работа

работа (*rabóta*) — "work, a job".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

работа ← Proto-Slavic **orbota*: Old Russian робота meant "work, slavery" (Vasmer). It is built on the root of раб, "slave", and Vasmer relates it to Gothic *arbaiþs*, "hardship", and German *Arbeit*, "work". Its ра- is the Church Slavonic shape; East Slavic dialects say робота.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rabóta*
- *Say it: rabóta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rabóta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a teacher, then the Russian for a pupil, then say *rabóta* again

Before you move on

What does работа mean? ("Work, a job".) Say it once more.

Chapter 38

Work, Sing, Dance, Laugh, Cry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to work, to sing, to dance, to laugh and to cry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 38: I can say to work, to sing, to dance, to laugh and to cry.*

38.1 работать (rabótat) — to work

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pupil, then the Russian for work.

You'll want to know: работать

работать (*rabótat*) — "to work". The verb of работа.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

работать is работа, "work", made into a verb with -ать. работа goes back to a Proto-Slavic word for "toil, slavery", built on the root of раб, "slave" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rabótat*
- *Say it:* *rabótat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rabótat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pupil, then the Russian for work, then say *rabótat* again

Before you move on

What does работать mean? (“To work”.) Say it once more.

38.2 петь (pet) — to sing

Before the new one: say the Russian for work, then the Russian for to work.

You’ll want to know: петь

петь (*pet*) — “to sing”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

петь ← Proto-Slavic **pěti*, with **pojǫ*, “I sing” — inherited. The deeper origin is unclear: Vasmer finds the proposed links unreliable, and Trubachev, in a note to Vasmer, explains it from пить, “to drink”, since пою means both “I sing” and “I give to drink”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pet*
- *Say it:* *pet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pet*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for work, then the Russian for to work, then say *pet* again

Before you move on

What does петь mean? ("To sing".) Say it once more.

38.3 танцевать (tantsevát) — to dance

Before the new one: say the Russian for to work, then the Russian for to sing.

You'll want to know: танцевать

танцевать (*tantsevát*) — "to dance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

танцевать is built on танец, "a dance", which came through Polish *taniec* from Middle High German *tanz*, "a dance" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tantsevát*
- *Say it: tantsevát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tantsevát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to work, then the Russian for to sing, then say *tantsevát* again

Before you move on

What does танцевать mean? ("To dance".) Say it once more.

38.4 смеяться (smeyátsya) — to laugh

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sing, then the Russian for to dance.

You'll want to know: смеяться

смеяться (*smeyátsya*) — "to laugh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

смеяться ← Proto-Slavic **smějati sę* — inherited; -ся is the old "oneself". Vasmer relates it to Latvian *smiêt*, "to laugh", Sanskrit *smáyate*, "smiles", Greek *meidiáō*, "I smile", and Middle English *smilen*, so English *smile* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: smeyátsya*
- *Say it: smeyátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *smeyátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sing, then the Russian for to dance, then say *smeyátsya* again

Before you move on

What does смеяться mean? ("To laugh".) Say it once more.

38.5 плакать (plákat) — to cry

Before the new one: say the Russian for to dance, then the Russian for to laugh.

You'll want to know: плакать

плакать (*plákat*) — "to cry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плакать ← Proto-Slavic **plakati* — inherited. Vasmer gives the first Slavic sense as "to beat one's breast" in mourning, and relates it to Lithuanian *plàkti*, "to beat", Greek *plēssō*, "I strike", and Latin *plangō*, "I beat my breast, lament".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plákat*
- *Say it: plákat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plákat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to dance, then the Russian for to laugh, then say *plákat* again

Before you move on

What does плакать mean? ("To cry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 39

Wash, Cook, Buy, Sell, Swim

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to wash, to cook, to buy, to sell and to swim.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 39: I can say to wash, to cook, to buy, to sell and to swim.*

39.1 мыть (myt) — to wash

Before the new one: say the Russian for to laugh, then the Russian for to cry.

You'll want to know: мыть

мыть (*myt*) — "to wash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мыть ← Proto-Slavic **myti*, present **myjǫ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *máudyti*, "to bathe, to wash", and Latvian *maût*, "to swim" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myt*
- *Say it: myt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to laugh, then the Russian for to cry, then say *myt* again

Before you move on

What does мыть mean? (“To wash”.) Say it once more.

39.2 готовить (gotóvit) — to cook, to prepare

Before the new one: say the Russian for to cry, then the Russian for to wash.

You’ll want to know: готовить

готовить (*gotóvit*) — “to cook, to prepare”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

готовить is готовый, “ready”, made into a verb: “to make ready”, and so “to cook”. готовый goes back to Proto-Slavic **gotovŭ*; Vasmer relates it to Albanian *gatuanj*, “I cook”, and rejects a loan from Gothic.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gotóvit*
- *Say it: gotóvit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gotóvit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cry, then the Russian for to wash, then say *gotóvit* again

Before you move on

What does готовить mean? (“To cook, to prepare”.) Say it once more.

39.3 покупать (pokupát) — to buy

Before the new one: say the Russian for to wash, then the Russian for to cook.

You’ll want to know: покупать

покупать (*pokupát*) — “to buy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

покупать is the ongoing partner of купить, “to buy”, with по-. купить was borrowed from Gothic *kaupōn*, “to trade”, and the Germanic word comes from Latin *caupō*, “innkeeper, petty trader” (Vasmer). German *kaufen*, “to buy”, has the same source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pokupát*
- *Say it: pokupát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pokupát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to wash, then the Russian for to cook, then say *pokupát* again

Before you move on

What does покупать mean? (“To buy”.) Say it once more.

39.4 продавать (prodavát) — to sell

Before the new one: say the Russian for to cook, then the Russian for to buy.

You'll want to know: продавать

продавать (*prodavát*) — "to sell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

продавать is про-, "through, forth", with давать, "to give", on the root of дать, "to give", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *dúoti* and Greek *didōmi*, "to give"; Latin *dare* is a cousin too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prodavát*
- *Say it: prodavát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prodavát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cook, then the Russian for to buy, then say *prodavát* again

Before you move on

What does продавать mean? ("To sell".) Say it once more.

39.5 плавать (plávat) — to swim

Before the new one: say the Russian for to buy, then the Russian for to sell.

You'll want to know: плавать

плавать (*plávat*) — "to swim".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плавать ← Proto-Slavic **plavati* — inherited, a repeated-action form on the root of плыть, "to swim, to sail" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates that root to Sanskrit *plávate*, "floats", Greek *pléō*, "I sail", and Latin *pluit*, "it rains".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plávat*
- *Say it: plávat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plávat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to buy, then the Russian for to sell, then say *plávat* again

Before you move on

What does плавать mean? ("To swim".) Say it once more.

Chapter 40

Sleep, Sit, Stand, Run, Play

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sleep, to sit, to stand, to run and to play.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 40: I can say to sleep, to sit, to stand, to run and to play.*

40.1 спать (spat) — to sleep

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sell, then the Russian for to swim.

You'll want to know: спать

спать (*spat*) — "to sleep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спать ← Proto-Slavic **sŭpati* — inherited from PIE **swep-*, "to sleep". Vasmer lists Sanskrit *svápiti*, "sleeps", Old English *swefan*, "to sleep", and Latin *sōpiō*, "I lull to sleep".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *spat*
- *Say it:* *spat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sell, then the Russian for to swim, then say *spat* again

Before you move on

What does спать mean? (“To sleep”.) Say it once more.

40.2 сидеть (sidét) — to sit

Before the new one: say the Russian for to swim, then the Russian for to sleep.

You’ll want to know: сидеть

сидеть (*sidét*) — “to sit”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сидеть ← Proto-Slavic **sěděti* — inherited from PIE **sed-*, “to sit”. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *sėdėti*, Latin *sedeō* and Gothic *sitan*: English *sit* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sidét*
- *Say it:* *sidét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sidét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to swim, then the Russian for to sleep, then say *sidét* again

Before you move on

What does сидеть mean? ("To sit".) Say it once more.

40.3 стоять (stoyát) — to stand

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sleep, then the Russian for to sit.

You'll want to know: стоять

стоять (*stoyát*) — "to stand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стоять ← Proto-Slavic **stojati* — inherited from PIE **steh₂-*, "to stand". Vasmer compares Oscan *staít*, "stands", Latin *stāre* and Greek *hístēmi*, "I set up": English *stand* is a cousin too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stoyát*
- *Say it: stoyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stoyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sleep, then the Russian for to sit, then say *stoyát* again

Before you move on

What does стоять mean? ("To stand".) Say it once more.

40.4 бежать (bezhát) — to run

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sit, then the Russian for to stand.

You'll want to know: бежать

бежать (*bezhát*) — "to run".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бежать ← Proto-Slavic **běžati* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *bėgti*, "to run", and of Greek *phébomai*, "I flee", and *phóbos*, "flight, fear" (Vasmer), the source of English *phobia*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bezhát*
- *Say it:* *bezhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bezhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sit, then the Russian for to stand, then say *bezhát* again

Before you move on

What does бежать mean? ("To run".) Say it once more.

40.5 играть (igrát) — to play

Before the new one: say the Russian for to stand, then the Russian for to run.

You'll want to know: играть

играть (*igrát*) — "to play".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

играть goes with игра, "a game", ← Proto-Slavic **jĭgra*, **jĭgrati* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *áikštytis*, "to be playful", and Sanskrit *ejati*, "stirs, moves".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: igrát*
- *Say it: igrát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *igrát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to stand, then the Russian for to run, then say *igrát* again

Before you move on

What does играть mean? ("To play".) Say it once more.

Chapter 41

Listen, Learn, Answer, Wait, Give

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to listen, to learn, to answer, to wait and to give.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 41: I can say to listen, to learn, to answer, to wait and to give.*

41.1 слушать (slúshat) — to listen

Before the new one: say the Russian for to run, then the Russian for to play.

You'll want to know: слушать

слушать (*slúshat*) — "to listen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слушать ← Proto-Slavic **slušati*, built on слух, "hearing" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *klausýti*, "to listen", and Old High German *hlosēn*, "to listen"; English *listen* is a cousin, from PIE **ḱlew-*, "to hear".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: slúshat*
- *Say it: slúshat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slúshat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to run, then the Russian for to play, then say *slúshat* again

Before you move on

What does слушать mean? ("To listen".) Say it once more.

41.2 учить (uchít) — to learn; to teach

Before the new one: say the Russian for to play, then the Russian for to listen.

You'll want to know: учить

учить (*uchít*) — "to learn; to teach". The same root as учитель.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

учить ← Proto-Slavic **učiti* — inherited, first "to accustom". Vasmer links it with привыкнуть, "to grow accustomed", Lithuanian *jaukìnti*, "to tame", and Sanskrit *úcyati*, "is accustomed": to teach was to accustom someone to a thing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uchít*
- *Say it: uchít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uchít*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to play, then the Russian for to listen, then say *uchít* again

Before you move on

What does учить mean? ("To learn; to teach".) Say it once more.

41.3 отвечать (otvechát) — to answer

Before the new one: say the Russian for to listen, then the Russian for to learn; to teach.

You'll want to know: отвечать

отвечать (*otvechát*) — "to answer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отвечать goes with ответ, "an answer": от-, "back", with an old root вет-, "counsel, word". Old Russian *větŭ* meant "counsel, agreement", and the same root is in привет, "hi", and совет, "advice" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otvechát*
- *Say it: otvechát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otvechát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to listen, then the Russian for to learn; to teach, then say *otvechát* again

Before you move on

What does отвечать mean? ("To answer".) Say it once more.

41.4 ждать (zhdat) — to wait

Before the new one: say the Russian for to learn; to teach, then the Russian for to answer.

You'll want to know: ждать

ждать (*zhdat*) — "to wait".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ждать ← Proto-Slavic **žĭdati* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *geĩsti*, "to long for", and Old Prussian *gēide*, "they wait": to wait was to long for something.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhdat*
- *Say it: zhdat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhdat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to learn; to teach, then the Russian for to answer, then say *zhdat* again

Before you move on

What does ждать mean? ("To wait".) Say it once more.

41.5 давать (davát) — to give

Before the new one: say the Russian for to answer, then the Russian for to wait.

You'll want to know: давать

давать (*davát*) — "to give".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

давать is the ongoing partner of дать, “to give”, built on the same root (Vasmer). Vasmer relates дать to Lithuanian *dúoti*, Greek *didōmi* and Sanskrit *dadāti*, all “to give”, from PIE **deh₃-*, “to give”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *davát*
- *Say it:* *davát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *davát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to answer, then the Russian for to wait, then say *davát* again

Before you move on

What does давать mean? (“To give”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 42

Open, Close, Drink, Question, Answer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to open, to close and to drink, and name a question and an answer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 42: I can say to open, to close and to drink, and name a question and an answer.

42.1 открывать (otkryvát) — to open

Before the new one: say the Russian for to wait, then the Russian for to give.

You'll want to know: открывать

открывать (*otkryvát*) — "to open".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

открывать is от-, "off, away", with -крывать, from крыть, "to cover": to open is to take the cover off. Vasmer relates крыть to Lithuanian *kráuti*, "to pile up", and Greek *krýptō*, "I hide", the source of English *crypt*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otkryvát*
- *Say it: otkryvát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otkryvát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to wait, then the Russian for to give, then say *otkryvát* again

Before you move on

What does открывать mean? ("To open".) Say it once more.

42.2 закрывать (zakryvát) — to close

Before the new one: say the Russian for to give, then the Russian for to open.

You'll want to know: закрывать

закрывать (*zakryvát*) — "to close".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

закрывать is за-, "behind, over", with -крывать, from крыть, "to cover": to close is to cover something over. Vasmer relates крыть to Greek *krýptō*, "I hide".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zakryvát*
- *Say it: zakryvát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zakryvát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to give, then the Russian for to open, then say *zakryvát* again

Before you move on

What does закрывать mean? (“To close”.) Say it once more.

42.3 пить (pit) — to drink

Before the new one: say the Russian for to open, then the Russian for to close.

You’ll want to know: пить

пить (*pit*) — “to drink”. What you do with вода and чай.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пить ← Proto-Slavic **piti* — inherited from PIE **peh₃(i)-*, “to drink”. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *píbati*, “drinks”, Greek *pínō*, “I drink”, and Latin *bibō*, “I drink”, from older **pibō*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pit*
- *Say it: pit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to open, then the Russian for to close, then say *pit* again

Before you move on

What does пить mean? (“To drink”.) Say it once more.

42.4 вопрос (voprós) — a question

Before the new one: say the Russian for to close, then the Russian for to drink.

You'll want to know: вопрос

вопрос (*voprós*) — "a question".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вопрос is во-, "in, toward", with -прос, the root of просить, "to ask, to request". Vasmer relates просить to Lithuanian *prašýti*, "to ask", Latin *precor*, "I pray", and German *fragen*, "to ask", from PIE **preḱ-*, "to ask".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voprós*
- *Say it: voprós*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voprós*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to close, then the Russian for to drink, then say *voprós* again

Before you move on

What does вопрос mean? ("A question".) Say it once more.

42.5 ответ (otvét) — an answer

Before the new one: say the Russian for to drink, then the Russian for a question.

You'll want to know: ответ

ответ (*otvét*) — "an answer". The noun behind отвечать.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ответ is от-, "back", with вет, an old word: Old Russian *větŭ* meant "counsel, agreement" (Vasmer). An answer is a word given back. The

same root is in привет, “hi”, and совет, “advice”. Vasmer compares Old Prussian *waitiāt*, “to speak”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otvét*
- *Say it: otvét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otvét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to drink, then the Russian for a question, then say *otvét* again

Before you move on

What does ответ mean? (“An answer”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 43

Meat, Fish, Egg, Butter, Salt

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name meat, fish, an egg, butter and salt.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 43: I can name meat, fish, an egg, butter and salt.*

43.1 мясо (myáso) — meat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a question, then the Russian for an answer.

You'll want to know: мясо

мясо (*myáso*) — "meat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мясо ← Proto-Slavic **męso* — inherited; the old nasal *ę* became Russian я. Vasmer lists Old Prussian *mensā*, Sanskrit *māṃsá-* and Gothic *mimz*, all "meat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myáso*
- *Say it: myáso*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myáso*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a question, then the Russian for an answer, then say *myáso* again

Before you move on

What does мясо mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

43.2 рыба (rýba) — fish

Before the new one: say the Russian for an answer, then the Russian for meat.

You’ll want to know: рыба

рыба (*rýba*) — “fish”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рыба ← Proto-Slavic **ryba* — inherited, but its deeper origin is unclear. Vasmer thought it was probably a taboo stand-in for an older word, the cousin of Lithuanian *žuvìs*, “fish”, which fishermen avoided because it sounded like звать, “to call”. A comparison with Old High German *rûppa*, “caterpillar”, is also reported.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rýba*
- *Say it: rýba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rýba*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for an answer, then the Russian for meat, then say *rýba* again

Before you move on

What does рыба mean? ("Fish".) Say it once more.

43.3 яйцо (yaytsó) — an egg

Before the new one: say the Russian for meat, then the Russian for fish.

You'll want to know: яйцо

яйцо (*yaytsó*) — "an egg".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

яйцо ← Proto-Slavic **aje*, "egg", with a diminutive ending — inherited. Vasmer lists Old High German *ei*, Old Norse *egg*, Latin *ōvum* and Greek *ōión*: English *egg* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yaytsó*
- *Say it: yaytsó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yaytsó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for meat, then the Russian for fish, then say *yaytsó* again

Before you move on

What does яйцо mean? ("An egg".) Say it once more.

43.4 масло (máslo) — butter; oil

Before the new one: say the Russian for fish, then the Russian for an egg.

You'll want to know: масло

масло (*máslo*) — "butter; oil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

масло ← Proto-Slavic **maslo*, from **maz-slo*, "what you smear", on the root of мазать, "to smear" (Vasmer). So butter and oil share one word: both are spread.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: máslo*
- *Say it: máslo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *máslo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fish, then the Russian for an egg, then say *máslo* again

Before you move on

What does масло mean? ("Butter; oil".) Say it once more.

43.5 соль (sol) — salt

Before the new one: say the Russian for an egg, then the Russian for butter; oil.

You'll want to know: соль

соль (*sol*) — "salt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

соль ← Proto-Slavic **solĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Latvian *sāls*, Latin *sāl*, Greek *háls* and Gothic *salt*, all "salt": English *salt* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sol*
- *Say it: sol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an egg, then the Russian for butter; oil, then say *sol* again

Before you move on

What does соль mean? ("Salt".) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Fruit, Apple, Pear, Cherry, Berry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name fruit, an apple, a pear, a cherry and a berry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 44: I can name fruit, an apple, a pear, a cherry and a berry.*

44.1 фрукты (frúkty) — fruit

Before the new one: say the Russian for butter; oil, then the Russian for salt.

You'll want to know: фрукты

фрукты (*frúkty*) — "fruit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фрукты came through Polish *frukt* from Latin *frūctus*, "fruit, enjoyment"; it is recorded from 1705, in Peter the Great's time (Vasmer). English *fruit* comes from the same Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: frúkty*
- *Say it: frúkty*, once more
- *Say it:* say *frúkty*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for butter; oil, then the Russian for salt, then say *frúkty* again

Before you move on

What does фрукты mean? ("Fruit".) Say it once more.

44.2 яблоко (yábloko) — an apple

Before the new one: say the Russian for salt, then the Russian for fruit.

You'll want to know: яблоко

яблоко (*yábloko*) — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

яблоко ← Proto-Slavic **ablŭko* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *obuolỹs*, Old High German *apful* and Old Irish *aball*, all "apple": English *apple* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yábloko*
- *Say it: yábloko*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yábloko*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for salt, then the Russian for fruit, then say *yábloko* again

Before you move on

What does яблоко mean? (“An apple”.) Say it once more.

44.3 груша (grúsha) — a pear

Before the new one: say the Russian for fruit, then the Russian for an apple.

You’ll want to know: груша

груша (*grúsha*) — “a pear”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

груша — probably a very old loan: the first sound wavers between г- and к- (Bulgarian круша), and Lithuanian *kriáušė*, “pear”, has the same source (Vasmer). Vasmer reports a comparison with a Kurdish word, but the donor is unknown.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grúsha*
- *Say it: grúsha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grúsha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fruit, then the Russian for an apple, then say *grúsha* again

Before you move on

What does груша mean? (“A pear”.) Say it once more.

44.4 вишня (víshnya) — a cherry

Before the new one: say the Russian for an apple, then the Russian for a pear.

You'll want to know: вишня

вишня (*víshnya*) — "a cherry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вишня ← Proto-Slavic **višĭnja* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old High German *wîhsila*, "sour cherry", and through it to Latin *viscum*, "birdlime", because cherry gum and mistletoe berries were both used to snare birds.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *víshnya*
- *Say it:* *víshnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *víshnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an apple, then the Russian for a pear, then say *víshnya* again

Before you move on

What does вишня mean? ("A cherry".) Say it once more.

44.5 ягода (yágoda) — a berry

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pear, then the Russian for a cherry.

You'll want to know: ягода

ягода (*yágoda*) — "a berry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ягода ← Proto-Slavic **agoda*, **aga* with an added *-oda* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *úoga*, "berry" (Vasmer). Russian added *j-* at the front, as in яблоко, "apple".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yágoda*
- *Say it: yágoda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yágoda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pear, then the Russian for a cherry, then say *yágoda* again

Before you move on

What does ягода mean? ("A berry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

Potatoes, Tomato, Onion, Cucumber, Carrot

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name potatoes, a tomato, an onion, a cucumber and a carrot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 45: I can name potatoes, a tomato, an onion, a cucumber and a carrot.*

45.1 картошка (kartóshka) — potatoes

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a cherry, then the Russian for a berry.

You'll want to know: картошка

картошка (*kartóshka*) — "potatoes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

картошка is картофель, "potato", with the fond -ошка. картофель came from German *Kartoffel*, which comes from Italian *tartufolo*, "truffle": the tubers looked like truffles (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kartóshka*
- *Say it: kartóshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kartóshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cherry, then the Russian for a berry, then say *kartóshka* again

Before you move on

What does картошка mean? ("Potatoes".) Say it once more.

45.2 помидор (pomidór) — a tomato

Before the new one: say the Russian for a berry, then the Russian for potatoes.

You'll want to know: помидор

помидор (*pomidór*) — "a tomato".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

помидор comes from Italian *pomi d'oro*, "golden apples", the plural of *pomo d'oro* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pomidór*
- *Say it: pomidór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pomidór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a berry, then the Russian for potatoes, then say *pomidór* again

Before you move on

What does помидор mean? ("A tomato".) Say it once more.

45.3 лук (luk) — an onion

Before the new one: say the Russian for potatoes, then the Russian for a tomato.

You'll want to know: лук

лук (*luk*) — "an onion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лук, "onion", was borrowed from early Germanic **lauka-* (Vasmer): Old Norse *laukr*, Old English *lēac*, English *leek*. The лук that means "a bow" is a separate, native word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: luk*
- *Say it: luk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *luk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for potatoes, then the Russian for a tomato, then say *luk* again

Before you move on

What does лук mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

45.4 огурец (oguréts) — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tomato, then the Russian for an onion.

You'll want to know: огурец

огурец (*oguréts*) — "a cucumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

огурец ← Byzantine Greek *ágouros*, "cucumber", from older Greek *áōros*, "unripe": cucumbers are eaten unripe, unlike melons (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *oguréts*
- *Say it:* *oguréts*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oguréts*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tomato, then the Russian for an onion, then say *oguréts* again

Before you move on

What does огурец mean? ("A cucumber".) Say it once more.

45.5 морковь (morkóv) — a carrot

Before the new one: say the Russian for an onion, then the Russian for a cucumber.

You'll want to know: морковь

морковь (*morkóv*) — "a carrot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

морковь ← Proto-Slavic **mŭrky* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old High German *moraha*, "carrot", and holds that a loan from Germanic cannot be proved.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: morkóv*
- *Say it: morkóv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *morkóv*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an onion, then the Russian for a cucumber, then say *morkóv* again

Before you move on

What does **морковь** mean? ("A carrot".) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name breakfast, lunch and dinner, porridge and a pie.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 46: I can name breakfast, lunch and dinner, porridge and a pie.*

46.1 завтрак (závtrak) — breakfast

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a cucumber, then the Russian for a carrot.

You'll want to know: завтрак

завтрак (*závtrak*) — "breakfast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

завтрак — built on the root of завтра, "tomorrow", which is за, "after", with утро, "morning". Old Russian said *zautrokŭ*, "the morning meal" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *závtrak*
- *Say it:* *závtrak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *závtrak*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cucumber, then the Russian for a carrot, then say *závtrak* again

Before you move on

What does завтрак mean? ("Breakfast".) Say it once more.

46.2 обед (obéd) — lunch, the midday meal

Before the new one: say the Russian for a carrot, then the Russian for breakfast.

You'll want to know: обед

обед (*obéd*) — "lunch, the midday meal".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обед ← Proto-Slavic **obědŭ* — об-, "around", with the root of еда, "food", and есть, "to eat" (Vasmer). That root is PIE **h₁ed-*, "to eat", so English *eat* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *obéd*
- *Say it:* *obéd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obéd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a carrot, then the Russian for breakfast, then say *obéd* again

Before you move on

What does обед mean? (“Lunch, the midday meal”.) Say it once more.

46.3 ужин (úzhin) — dinner, supper

Before the new one: say the Russian for breakfast, then the Russian for lunch.

You’ll want to know: ужин

ужин (*úzhin*) — “dinner, supper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ужин — built on Proto-Slavic **jugŭ*, “south, noon”, so it first meant “the midday meal” (Vasmer); Old Russian ужина was an afternoon meal. Latin *merīdiēs* is both “noon” and “south” in the same way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: úzhin*
- *Say it: úzhin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úzhin*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for breakfast, then the Russian for lunch, then say *úzhin* again

Before you move on

What does ужин mean? (“Dinner, supper”.) Say it once more.

46.4 каша (kásha) — porridge

Before the new one: say the Russian for lunch, then the Russian for dinner.

You'll want to know: каша

каша (*kásha*) — "porridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

каша ← Proto-Slavic **kaša* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *kóšti*, "to strain, to filter"; Trubachev, in a note, explains it otherwise.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kásha*
- *Say it: kásha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kásha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for lunch, then the Russian for dinner, then say *kásha* again

Before you move on

What does каша mean? ("Porridge".) Say it once more.

46.5 пирог (piróg) — a pie

Before the new one: say the Russian for dinner, then the Russian for porridge.

You'll want to know: пирог

пирог (*piróg*) — "a pie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пирог — Vasmer builds it on пир, “a feast”, with the suffix -ог; others start from Old Russian пыро, “spelt”, reshaped to match пир. Either way it is a Slavic word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: piróg*
- *Say it: piróg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *piróg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dinner, then the Russian for porridge, then say *piróg* again

Before you move on

What does пирог mean? (“A pie”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

Sugar, Honey, Rice, Mushrooms and a Glass

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name sugar, honey, rice, a mushroom and a glass.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 47: I can name sugar, honey, rice, a mushroom and a glass.

47.1 caxap (sákhar) — sugar

Before the new one: say the Russian for porridge, then the Russian for a pie.

You'll want to know: caxap

caxap (*sákhar*) — "sugar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

caxap ← Greek *sákcharon*, from Pali *sakkharā*, Sanskrit *śarkarā*, "gravel, grit, sugar" (Vasmer). The same Sanskrit word, through Arabic, gave English *sugar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sákhar*
- *Say it: sákhar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sákhar*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for porridge, then the Russian for a pie, then say *sákhar* again

Before you move on

What does сахар mean? ("Sugar".) Say it once more.

47.2 мёд (myod) — honey

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pie, then the Russian for sugar.

You'll want to know: мёд

мёд (*myod*) — "honey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мёд ← Proto-Slavic **medŭ*, "honey; mead" — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *medùs*, "honey", Sanskrit *mádhu*, "honey, mead", and Greek *méthy*, "wine": English *mead* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myod*
- *Say it: myod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pie, then the Russian for sugar, then say *myod* again

Before you move on

What does мёд mean? (“Honey”.) Say it once more.

47.3 рис (ris) — rice

Before the new one: say the Russian for sugar, then the Russian for honey.

You’ll want to know: рис

рис (*ris*) — “rice”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рис probably came through Low German *rîs* or Dutch *rijs*, from Italian *riso*, from Latin *oryza* and Greek *óryza*, which came out of India (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ris*
- *Say it: ris*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ris*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sugar, then the Russian for honey, then say *ris* again

Before you move on

What does рис mean? (“Rice”.) Say it once more.

47.4 гриб (grib) — a mushroom

Before the new one: say the Russian for honey, then the Russian for rice.

You'll want to know: гриб

гриб (*grib*) — "a mushroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гриб ← Proto-Slavic **gribŭ* — inherited, but its origin is unclear. Vasmer reports a possible link with Lithuanian *griẽti*, "to skim cream", from a sense "slime", among other proposals.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *grib*
- *Say it:* *grib*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grib*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for honey, then the Russian for rice, then say *grib* again

Before you move on

What does гриб mean? ("A mushroom".) Say it once more.

47.5 стакан (stakán) — a glass (for drinking)

Before the new one: say the Russian for rice, then the Russian for a mushroom.

You'll want to know: стакан

стакан (*stakán*) — "a glass (for drinking)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стакан — Old Russian *dostokanŭ*, recorded from the 1300s. It is usually taken from Turkic: Vasmer cites Chagatai *tostakan*, "a wooden bowl", and Kazakh *tustaghan*, "a cup, a ladle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stakán*
- *Say it: stakán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stakán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rice, then the Russian for a mushroom, then say *stakán* again

Before you move on

What does стакан mean? ("A glass (for drinking)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

House, Room, Kitchen, Window, Door

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a house, a room, a kitchen, a window and a door.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 48: I can name a house, a room, a kitchen, a window and a door.

48.1 дом (dom) — a house, home

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mushroom, then the Russian for a glass.

You'll want to know: дом

дом (*dom*) — "a house, home".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дом ← Proto-Slavic **domŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *dámas*, Greek *dómos* and Latin *domus*, all "house", from PIE **dem-*, "to build".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dom*
- *Say it: dom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mushroom, then the Russian for a glass, then say *dom* again

Before you move on

What does дом mean? ("A house, home".) Say it once more.

48.2 комната (kómnata) — a room

Before the new one: say the Russian for a glass, then the Russian for a house.

You'll want to know: комната

комната (*kómnata*) — "a room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

комната ← Latin *(camera) camīnāta*, "a room with a stove", from *camīnus*, "furnace". Vasmer takes the initial stress as a sign it came through Old High German *cheminmāta*, but the older stress fell on -на-, which points to Polish, as Kiparsky argued; Jakobson, in Trubachev's note, derived it from Czech.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kómnata*
- *Say it: kómnata*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kómnata*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a glass, then the Russian for a house, then say *kómnata* again

Before you move on

What does комната mean? ("A room".) Say it once more.

48.3 кухня (kúkhnya) — a kitchen

Before the new one: say the Russian for a house, then the Russian for a room.

You'll want to know: кухня

кухня (*kúkhnya*) — "a kitchen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кухня came, from 1717, through Polish *kuchnia* and Czech *kuchyně* from Old High German *kuchina*, from Latin *coquīna*, "kitchen"; before that Russians said поварня (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kúkhnya*
- *Say it: kúkhnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kúkhnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a house, then the Russian for a room, then say *kúkhnya* again

Before you move on

What does кухня mean? ("A kitchen".) Say it once more.

48.4 окно (oknó) — a window

Before the new one: say the Russian for a room, then the Russian for a kitchen.

You'll want to know: окно

окно (*oknó*) — "a window".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

окно ← Proto-Slavic **okŭno*, built on око, "eye" (Vasmer): a window is the eye of the house, as English *window* is Old Norse *vindauga*, "wind-eye".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oknó*
- *Say it: oknó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oknó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a room, then the Russian for a kitchen, then say *oknó* again

Before you move on

What does окно mean? ("A window".) Say it once more.

48.5 дверь (dver) — a door

Before the new one: say the Russian for a kitchen, then the Russian for a window.

You'll want to know: дверь

дверь (*dver*) — "a door".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дверь ← Proto-Slavic **dvĭrĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *dùrys*, Gothic *daúr*, Greek *thýra* and Latin *forēs*: English *door* is a cousin, from PIE **dʰwer-*, "door".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dver*
- *Say it: dver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dver*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a kitchen, then the Russian for a window, then say *dver* again

Before you move on

What does дверь mean? ("A door".) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Table, Chair, Bed, Lamp, Key

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a table, a chair, a bed, a lamp and a key.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 49: I can name a table, a chair, a bed, a lamp and a key.*

49.1 стол (stol) — a table

Before the new one: say the Russian for a window, then the Russian for a door.

You'll want to know: стол

стол (*stol*) — "a table".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стол ← Proto-Slavic **stolŭ* — inherited; Old Russian *stolŭ* also meant "throne, seat" (Vasmer). Vasmer compares Gothic *stōls*, "chair", and Lithuanian *stãlas*, "table", but also weighs the root of стелить, "to spread", so the deeper origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stol*
- *Say it: stol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a window, then the Russian for a door, then say *stol* again

Before you move on

What does стол mean? ("A table".) Say it once more.

49.2 стул (stul) — a chair

Before the new one: say the Russian for a door, then the Russian for a table.

You'll want to know: стул

стул (*stul*) — "a chair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стул — first recorded in 1578, perhaps borrowed from Old Norse *stóll* or Low German *stuhl*, "chair" (Vasmer). A High German loan would have begun шт-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stul*
- *Say it: stul*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stul*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a door, then the Russian for a table, then say *stul* again

Before you move on

What does стул mean? ("A chair".) Say it once more.

49.3 кровать (krovát) — a bed

Before the new one: say the Russian for a table, then the Russian for a chair.

You'll want to know: кровать

кровать (*krovát*) — "a bed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кровать ← Byzantine Greek *krabbátion*, from Greek *krábbatos*, "a pallet, a camp bed" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krovát*
- *Say it: krovát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krovát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a table, then the Russian for a chair, then say *krovát* again

Before you move on

What does кровать mean? ("A bed".) Say it once more.

49.4 лампа (lámpa) — a lamp

Before the new one: say the Russian for a chair, then the Russian for a bed.

You'll want to know: лампа

лампа (*lámpa*) — "a lamp".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лампа came from German *Lampe* or French *lampe*, from Latin *lampada* and Greek *lampás*, "a torch"; the old form лямпа came through Polish (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lámpa*
- *Say it: lámpa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lámpa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a chair, then the Russian for a bed, then say *lámpa* again

Before you move on

What does лампа mean? ("A lamp".) Say it once more.

49.5 ключ (klyuch) — a key

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bed, then the Russian for a lamp.

You'll want to know: ключ

ключ (*klyuch*) — "a key".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ключ ← Proto-Slavic **ključĭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Greek *kleís*, "key", and Latin *clāvis*, "key", and *claudō*, "I shut". The ключ that means "a spring" may be the same word or another.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klyuch*
- *Say it: klyuch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klyuch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bed, then the Russian for a lamp, then say *klyuch* again

Before you move on

What does ключ mean? ("A key".) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Wall, Roof, Garden, Bathroom, Clock

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a wall, a roof, a garden, the bathroom and a clock.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 50: I can name a wall, a roof, a garden, the bathroom and a clock.

50.1 стена (stená) — a wall

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lamp, then the Russian for a key.

You'll want to know: стена

стена (*stená*) — "a wall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стена ← Proto-Slavic **stěna* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Gothic *stains*, "stone", so English *stone* is a cousin, and he holds that a loan from Germanic cannot be proved.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stená*
- *Say it: stená*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stená*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lamp, then the Russian for a key, then say *stená* again

Before you move on

What does стена mean? (“A wall”.) Say it once more.

50.2 крыша (krýsha) — a roof

Before the new one: say the Russian for a key, then the Russian for a wall.

You’ll want to know: крыша

крыша (*krýsha*) — “a roof”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

крыша is built on крыть, “to cover”, with an *-s-* that became ш (Vasmer): the roof is the cover. The same verb is in открывать, “to open”, and закрывать, “to close”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krýsha*
- *Say it: krýsha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krýsha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a key, then the Russian for a wall, then say *krýsha* again

Before you move on

What does крыша mean? ("A roof".) Say it once more.

50.3 сад (sad) — a garden

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wall, then the Russian for a roof.

You'll want to know: сад

сад (*sad*) — "a garden".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сад ← Proto-Slavic **sadŭ*, "a planting" — inherited, from садить, "to plant", literally "to make sit", the partner of сидеть, "to sit" (Vasmer). Old Russian *sadŭ* also meant "a tree, a grove".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sad*
- *Say it: sad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sad*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wall, then the Russian for a roof, then say *sad* again

Before you move on

What does сад mean? ("A garden".) Say it once more.

50.4 ванная (vánnaya) — the bathroom

Before the new one: say the Russian for a roof, then the Russian for a garden.

You'll want to know: ванная

ванная (*vánnaya*) — "the bathroom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ванная is short for ванная комната, "the bath room": an adjective from ванна, "a bathtub", standing alone. ванна came from German *Wanne* or French *vanne* (Vasmer); Trubachev adds that it is recorded by 1697.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vánnaya*
- *Say it: vánnaya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vánnaya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a roof, then the Russian for a garden, then say *vánnaya* again

Before you move on

What does ванная mean? ("The bathroom".) Say it once more.

50.5 часы (chasý) — a clock, a watch

Before the new one: say the Russian for a garden, then the Russian for the bathroom.

You'll want to know: часы

часы (*chasý*) — "a clock, a watch". Always plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

часы is the plural of час, "an hour": a clock is "the hours". час ← Proto-Slavic **časŭ*, "time, a while", a cousin of Old Prussian *kīsman*,

"time", and Albanian *kohë*, "time, weather" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chasý*
- *Say it: chasý*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chasý*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a garden, then the Russian for the bathroom, then say *chasý* again

Before you move on

What does часы mean? ("A clock, a watch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 51

Cup, Plate, Spoon, Knife, Fork

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a cup, a plate, a spoon, a knife and a fork.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 51: I can name a cup, a plate, a spoon, a knife and a fork.*

51.1 чашка (cháshka) — a cup

> Before the new one: say the Russian for the bathroom, then the Russian for a clock.

You'll want to know: чашка

чашка (*cháshka*) — "a cup". For чай or кофе.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чашка is чаша, "a bowl, a goblet", with -ка, "little". чаша ← Proto-Slavic **čaša*, which Vasmer thinks is probably related to Old Prussian *kiosi*, "a goblet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cháshka*
- *Say it:* *cháshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cháshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the bathroom, then the Russian for a clock, then say *cháshka* again

Before you move on

What does чашка mean? (“A cup”.) Say it once more.

51.2 тарелка (tarélka) — a plate

Before the new one: say the Russian for a clock, then the Russian for a cup.

You’ll want to know: тарелка

тарелка (*tarélka*) — “a plate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тарелка — older тарель, recorded from 1509; Vasmer thinks it apparently came through Polish *talerz* and Czech *talíř* from Middle High German *talier*, from Italian *tagliere*, “a trencher”, from *tagliare*, “to cut”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tarélka*
- *Say it:* *tarélka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarélka*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a clock, then the Russian for a cup, then say *tarélka* again

Before you move on

What does тарелка mean? (“A plate”.) Say it once more.

51.3 ложка (lózhka) — a spoon

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cup, then the Russian for a plate.

You’ll want to know: ложка

ложка (*lózhka*) — “a spoon”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ложка ← Old Russian *lъžĭka*, beside *lъžica*, from Proto-Slavic **lъžĭka* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it is probably related to Albanian *lugë*, “spoon”, and perhaps to a root “to break, to split”, since Swedish *sked*, “spoon”, goes with a verb “to split”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lózhka*
- *Say it: lózhka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lózhka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cup, then the Russian for a plate, then say *lózhka* again

Before you move on

What does ложка mean? (“A spoon”.) Say it once more.

51.4 нож (nozh) — a knife

Before the new one: say the Russian for a plate, then the Russian for a spoon.

You'll want to know: нож

нож (*nozh*) — "a knife".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нож ← Proto-Slavic **nožĭ* — inherited. Vasmer will not separate it from **вонзить**, "to thrust in", and **заноза**, "a splinter", and reports the usual link with Greek *nýssō*, "I prick": the knife as the thing that pierces.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nozh*
- *Say it: nozh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nozh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a plate, then the Russian for a spoon, then say *nozh* again

Before you move on

What does **нож** mean? ("A knife".) Say it once more.

51.5 вилка (vílka) — a fork

Before the new one: say the Russian for a spoon, then the Russian for a knife.

You'll want to know: вилка

вилка (*vílka*) — "a fork".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вилка is вилы, "a pitchfork", with -ка, "little": a little pitchfork. вилы ← Proto-Slavic **vidla*, first "something bent", from the root of вить, "to twist" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vílka*
- *Say it: vílka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vílka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a spoon, then the Russian for a knife, then say *vílka* again

Before you move on

What does вилка mean? ("A fork".) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

Book, Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a book, a pen, paper, a notebook and a pencil.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 52: I can name a book, a pen, paper, a notebook and a pencil.

52.1 книга (kníga) — a book

Before the new one: say the Russian for a knife, then the Russian for a fork.

You'll want to know: книга

книга (*kníga*) — "a book".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

книга ← Proto-Slavic **kŭniga*. Vasmer, following Räsänen, takes it as a loan through early Turkic, Danube Bulgar **küiniv*, ultimately from Chinese *k'üen*, "a scroll"; Hungarian *könyv*, "book", has the same source. He finds the older Assyrian account less likely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kníga*
- *Say it: kníga*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kníga*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a knife, then the Russian for a fork, then say *kníga* again

Before you move on

What does книга mean? (“A book”.) Say it once more.

52.2 ручка (rúchka) — a pen

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fork, then the Russian for a book.

You’ll want to know: ручка

ручка (*rúchka*) — “a pen”. Literally “a little hand”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ручка is рука, “hand”, with -ка, “little”; к turns to ч before it. The word means “a little hand”, then “a handle”, then “a pen”, the thing you hold. Vasmer relates рука to Lithuanian *rankà*, “hand”, and a Lithuanian verb for gathering.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rúchka*
- *Say it: rúchka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rúchka*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fork, then the Russian for a book, then say *rúchka* again

Before you move on

What does ручка mean? (“A pen”.) Say it once more.

52.3 бумага (bumága) — paper

Before the new one: say the Russian for a book, then the Russian for a pen.

You’ll want to know: бумага

бумага (*bumága*) — “paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бумага — Vasmer thinks it is most probably from Italian: Korsch derived it from *bombagio*, “cotton”, and most early paper in Russia was Italian. Greek *bómbyx*, “silk”, cannot explain the Russian form, he says.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bumága*
- *Say it: bumága*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bumága*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a book, then the Russian for a pen, then say *bumága* again

Before you move on

What does бумага mean? (“Paper”.) Say it once more.

52.4 тетрадь (tetrád) — a notebook

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pen, then the Russian for paper.

You'll want to know: тетрадь

тетрадь (*tetrád*) — "a notebook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тетрадь ← Byzantine Greek *tetrádion*, from *tetrás*, "a group of four", a sheet folded into four leaves (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tetrád*
- *Say it: tetrád*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tetrád*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pen, then the Russian for paper, then say *tetrád* again

Before you move on

What does тетрадь mean? ("A notebook".) Say it once more.

52.5 карандаш (karandásh) — a pencil

Before the new one: say the Russian for paper, then the Russian for a notebook.

You'll want to know: карандаш

карандаш (*karandásh*) — "a pencil".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

карандаш ← Turkic *karadaš*, “black stone”, as in Turkish *karataş*, “black slate” (Vasmer): *kara*, “black”, and *taş*, “stone”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karandásh*
- *Say it: karandásh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karandásh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for paper, then the Russian for a notebook, then say *karandásh* again

Before you move on

What does карандаш mean? (“A pencil”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

Bag, Phone, Umbrella, Money, Gift

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a bag, a phone, an umbrella, money and a gift.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 53: I can name a bag, a phone, an umbrella, money and a gift.

53.1 сумка (súmka) — a bag

Before the new one: say the Russian for a notebook, then the Russian for a pencil.

You'll want to know: сумка

сумка (*súmka*) — "a bag".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сумка is сума, "a bag, a saddlebag", with -ка, "little". сума came through Polish *suma* from Old High German *soum*, "a pack load", from Late Latin *sauma*, Greek *ságma*, "a pack saddle" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: súmka*
- *Say it: súmka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *súmka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a notebook, then the Russian for a pencil, then say *súmka* again

Before you move on

What does сумка mean? (“A bag”.) Say it once more.

53.2 телефон (telefón) — a phone

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pencil, then the Russian for a bag.

You’ll want to know: телефон

телефон (*telefón*) — “a phone”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

телефон is an international coinage from Greek *tēle*, “far off”, and *phōnē*, “voice, sound”: a far voice.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: telefón*
- *Say it: telefón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *telefón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pencil, then the Russian for a bag, then say *telefón* again

Before you move on

What does телефон mean? (“A phone”.) Say it once more.

53.3 зонт (zont) — an umbrella

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bag, then the Russian for a phone.

You’ll want to know: зонт

зонт (*zont*) — “an umbrella”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зонт is cut back from зонтик, from older зондек, a sailors’ word from Dutch *zondek*, “an awning against the sun” (Vasmer). The -ик was heard as a diminutive, so зонт was made as the “full” form.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zont*
- *Say it: zont*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zont*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bag, then the Russian for a phone, then say *zont* again

Before you move on

What does зонт mean? (“An umbrella”.) Say it once more.

53.4 деньги (déngi) — money

Before the new one: say the Russian for a phone, then the Russian for an umbrella.

You'll want to know: деньги

деньги (*déngi*) — "money". Always plural.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

деньги is the plural of деньга, a coin, recorded from 1361; Vasmer takes it from Turkic: Tatar and Chagatai *täŋkä*, "money, a silver coin", Kazakh *teŋgä*. A Persian origin for the Turkic word has been proposed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: déngi*
- *Say it: déngi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *déngi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a phone, then the Russian for an umbrella, then say *déngi* again

Before you move on

What does деньги mean? ("Money".) Say it once more.

53.5 подарок (podárok) — a gift, a present

Before the new one: say the Russian for an umbrella, then the Russian for money.

You'll want to know: подарок

подарок (*podárok*) — "a gift, a present".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подарок is built on дарить, "to give as a gift", from дар, "a gift", with по- and the noun ending -ок. Vasmer relates дар to Greek *dōron*, "gift".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podárok*
- *Say it: podárok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podárok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an umbrella, then the Russian for money, then say *podárok* again

Before you move on

What does подарок mean? ("A gift, a present".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Lesson, Word, Address, Ticket, Map

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a lesson, a word, an address, a ticket and a map.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 54: I can name a lesson, a word, an address, a ticket and a map.*

54.1 урок (urók) — a lesson

> Before the new one: say the Russian for money, then the Russian for a gift.

You'll want to know: урок

урок (*urók*) — "a lesson".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

урок is у- with рок, from the root of old реку, "I say" (Vasmer). Old Russian *urokŭ* meant "an agreement, a rule, a set payment": a lesson is the set task.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *urók*
- *Say it:* *urók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *urók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for money, then the Russian for a gift, then say *urók* again

Before you move on

What does урок mean? (“A lesson”.) Say it once more.

54.2 слово (slóvo) — a word

Before the new one: say the Russian for a gift, then the Russian for a lesson.

You’ll want to know: слово

слово (*slóvo*) — “a word”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слово ← Proto-Slavic **slovo* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Latvian *slava*, “rumour, fame”, Sanskrit *śrávas*, “fame”, and Greek *kléos*, “fame”: what is heard. Its root is the PIE **klew-*, “to hear”, of слушать, “to listen”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *slóvo*
- *Say it:* *slóvo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slóvo*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a gift, then the Russian for a lesson, then say *slóvo* again

Before you move on

What does слово mean? (“A word”.) Say it once more.

54.3 адрес (ádres) — an address

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lesson, then the Russian for a word.

You’ll want to know: адрес

адрес (*ádres*) — “an address”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

адрес came in Peter the Great’s time from Polish *adres* or French *adresse* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ádres*
- *Say it: ádres*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ádres*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lesson, then the Russian for a word, then say *ádres* again

Before you move on

What does адрес mean? (“An address”.) Say it once more.

54.4 билет (bilét) — a ticket

Before the new one: say the Russian for a word, then the Russian for an address.

You'll want to know: билет

билет (*bilét*) — "a ticket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

билет — recorded from 1720; it came through Polish *bilet* or German *Billett* from French *billet*, "a note, a ticket" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bilét*
- *Say it: bilét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bilét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a word, then the Russian for an address, then say *bilét* again

Before you move on

What does билет mean? ("A ticket".) Say it once more.

54.5 карта (kárta) — a map; a card

Before the new one: say the Russian for an address, then the Russian for a ticket.

You'll want to know: карта

карта (*kárta*) — "a map; a card".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

карта came in Peter the Great's time through Polish *karta* or German *Karte* from Italian *carta* and Latin *charta*, "paper", from Greek *chártēs* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kárta*
- *Say it: kárta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kárta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an address, then the Russian for a ticket, then say *kárta* again

Before you move on

What does карта mean? ("A map; a card".) Say it once more.

54.6 The body, family and verbs — a first pass

Say the words for a ticket and a map; a card.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the head, a hand, a leg, the belly, a tooth
- hair, a finger, the neck, a shoulder, a knee
- the back, the tongue; a language, a lip, the face, blood
- pain, an illness, medicine, a doctor, a hospital
- a temperature, a cough, rest, hunger, thirst
- joy, fear, anger, sadness, tiredness

- a son, a daughter, a grandmother, a husband, a wife
- children, a child, an aunt, a grandson, a granddaughter
- a neighbour, a guest, a teacher, a pupil, work
- to work, to sing, to dance, to laugh, to cry
- to wash, to cook, to buy, to sell, to swim
- to sleep, to sit, to stand, to run, to play
- to listen, to learn; to teach, to answer, to wait, to give

Before you move on

The head? (голова.) A hand? (рука.) A leg? (нога.) The belly? (живот.) A tooth? (зуб.) Hair? (волосы.) A finger? (палец.) The neck? (шея.) A shoulder? (плечо.) A knee? (колено.) The back? (спина.) The tongue; a language? (язык.) A lip? (губа.) The face? (лицо.) Blood? (кровь.) Pain? (боль.) An illness? (болезнь.) Medicine? (лекарство.) A doctor? (врач.) A hospital? (больница.) A temperature? (температура.) A cough? (кашель.) Rest? (отдых.) Hunger? (голод.) Thirst? (жажда.) Joy? (радость.) Fear? (страх.) Anger? (гнев.) Sadness? (грусть.) Tiredness? (усталость.) A son? (сын.) A daughter? (дочь.) A grandmother? (бабушка.) A husband? (муж.) A wife? (жена.) Children? (дети.) A child? (ребёнок.) An aunt? (тётя.) A grandson? (внук.) A granddaughter? (внучка.) A neighbour? (сосед.) A guest? (гость.) A teacher? (учитель.) A pupil? (ученик.) Work? (работа.) To work? (работать.) To sing? (петь.) To dance? (танцевать.) To laugh? (смеяться.) To cry? (плакать.) To wash? (мыть.) To cook? (готовить.) To buy? (покупать.) To sell? (продавать.) To swim? (плавать.) To sleep? (спать.) To sit? (сидеть.) To stand? (стоять.) To run? (бежать.) To play? (играть.) To listen? (слушать.) To learn; to teach? (учить.) To answer? (отвечать.) To wait? (ждать.) To give? (давать.)

54.7 Food, the house and things — a second pass

Say the words for to open and to close.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to open, to close, to drink, a question, an answer
- meat, fish, an egg, butter; oil, salt
- fruit, an apple, a pear, a cherry, a berry
- potatoes, a tomato, an onion, a cucumber, a carrot
- breakfast, lunch, dinner, porridge, a pie
- sugar, honey, rice, a mushroom, a glass
- a house, a room, a kitchen, a window, a door
- a table, a chair, a bed, a lamp, a key
- a wall, a roof, a garden, the bathroom, a clock
- a cup, a plate, a spoon, a knife, a fork
- a book, a pen, paper, a notebook, a pencil
- a bag, a phone, an umbrella, money, a gift
- a lesson, a word, an address, a ticket, a map; a card

Before you move on

To open? (открывать.) To close? (закрывать.) To drink? (пить.) A question? (вопрос.) An answer? (ответ.) Meat? (мясо.) Fish? (рыба.) An egg? (яйцо.) Butter; oil? (масло.) Salt? (соль.) Fruit? (фрукты.) An apple? (яблоко.) A pear? (груша.) A cherry? (вишня.) A berry? (ягода.) Potatoes? (картошка.) A tomato? (помидор.) An onion? (лук.) A cucumber? (огурец.) A carrot? (морковь.) Breakfast? (завтрак.) Lunch? (обед.) Dinner? (ужин.) Porridge? (каша.) A pie? (пирог.) Sugar? (сахар.) Honey? (мёд.) Rice? (рис.) A mushroom? (гриб.) A glass? (стакан.) A house? (дом.) A room? (комната.) A kitchen? (кухня.) A window? (окно.) A door? (дверь.) A table? (стол.) A chair? (стул.) A bed? (кровать.) A lamp? (лампа.) A key? (ключ.) A wall? (стена.) A roof? (крыша.) A garden? (сад.)

The bathroom? (ванная.) A clock? (часы.) A cup? (чашка.) A plate? (тарелка.) A spoon? (ложка.) A knife? (нож.) A fork? (вилка.) A book? (книга.) A pen? (ручка.) Paper? (бумага.) A notebook? (тетрадь.) A pencil? (карандаш.) A bag? (сумка.) A phone? (телефон.) An umbrella? (зонт.) Money? (деньги.) A gift? (подарок.) A lesson? (урок.) A word? (слово.) An address? (адрес.) A ticket? (билет.) A map; a card? (карта.)

Chapter 55

Tree, Flower, Leaf, Grass, Village

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, grass and a village.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 55: I can name a tree, a flower, a leaf, grass and a village.*

55.1 дерево (dérevo) — a tree

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a ticket, then the Russian for a map.

You'll want to know: дерево

дерево (*dérevo*) — "a tree".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дерево ← Proto-Slavic **dervo* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *dervà*, "pine", Greek *dóry*, "wood, spear", *drŷs*, "oak", and Sanskrit *dāru*, "wood"; Trubachev adds Gothic *triu*, so English *tree* is a cousin, from PIE **dóru*, "tree, wood".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dérevo*
- *Say it:* *dérevo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dérevo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a ticket, then the Russian for a map, then say *dérevo* again

Before you move on

What does дерево mean? (“A tree”.) Say it once more.

55.2 цветок (tsvetók) — a flower

Before the new one: say the Russian for a map, then the Russian for a tree.

You’ll want to know: цветок

цветок (*tsvetók*) — “a flower”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

цветок is цвет, “bloom; colour”, with the diminutive -ок. цвет ← Proto-Slavic **květŭ*, “blossom”, which Vasmer relates to Latvian *kvitêt*, “to shimmer”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tsvetók*
- *Say it:* *tsvetók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsvetók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a map, then the Russian for a tree, then say *tsvetók* again

Before you move on

What does цветок mean? (“A flower”.) Say it once more.

55.3 лист (list) — a leaf; a sheet of paper

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tree, then the Russian for a flower.

You’ll want to know: лист

лист (*list*) — “a leaf; a sheet of paper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лист ← Proto-Slavic **listŭ* — inherited, related to Lithuanian *laĩškas*, “leaf”, and Latvian *laiska*, “a leaf of flax” (Vasmer). Paper took the same word, as in English *a leaf of a book*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: list*
- *Say it: list*, once more
- *Say it:* say *list*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tree, then the Russian for a flower, then say *list* again

Before you move on

What does лист mean? (“A leaf; a sheet of paper”.) Say it once more.

55.4 трава (travá) — grass

Before the new one: say the Russian for a flower, then the Russian for a leaf; a sheet of paper.

You'll want to know: трава

трава (*travá*) — "grass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

трава ← Proto-Slavic **trava* — inherited, from the root of Old Russian трути, "to use up, to consume" (Vasmer): grass as the fodder that is eaten. The same root is in травить, "to poison".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: travá*
- *Say it: travá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *travá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a flower, then the Russian for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then say *travá* again

Before you move on

What does трава mean? ("Grass".) Say it once more.

55.5 деревня (derévnya) — a village

Before the new one: say the Russian for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the Russian for grass.

You'll want to know: деревня

деревня (*derévnya*) — "a village".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

деревня first meant “a ploughed field”, then “a farmstead with its land”, then “a village” (Vasmer). It goes back to **dĭrvĭnja*, and Vasmer reports the usual link with Lithuanian *dirvà*, “a field”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *derévnya*
- *Say it:* *derévnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *derévnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a leaf; a sheet of paper, then the Russian for grass, then say *derévnya* again

Before you move on

What does деревня mean? (“A village”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

Mountain, Forest, River, Lake, Sea

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a mountain, a forest, a river, a lake and the sea.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 56: I can name a mountain, a forest, a river, a lake and the sea.*

56.1 гора (gorá) — a mountain

> Before the new one: say the Russian for grass, then the Russian for a village.

You'll want to know: гора

гора (*gorá*) — "a mountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гора ← Proto-Slavic **gora* — inherited, related to Sanskrit *girí-*, "mountain", Avestan *gairi-* and Lithuanian *girià*, "forest" (Vasmer). Bulgarian гора still means "forest".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gorá*
- *Say it:* *gorá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gorá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for grass, then the Russian for a village, then say *gorá* again

Before you move on

What does гора mean? ("A mountain".) Say it once more.

56.2 лес (les) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Russian for a village, then the Russian for a mountain.

You'll want to know: лес

лес (*les*) — "a forest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лес ← Proto-Slavic **lěsŭ* — inherited. Its deeper origin is not certain: Vasmer relates it to Old English *læs*, "pasture", and English dialect *leasow*, and finds a link with Lithuanian *laĩškas*, "leaf", doubtful, while Trubachev, in a note, thinks it the most likely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *les*
- *Say it:* *les*, once more
- *Say it:* say *les*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a village, then the Russian for a mountain, then say *les* again

Before you move on

What does лес mean? ("A forest".) Say it once more.

56.3 река (reká) — a river

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mountain, then the Russian for a forest.

You'll want to know: река

река (*reká*) — "a river".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

река ← Proto-Slavic **rěka* — inherited, from a root "to flow". Vasmer lists Sanskrit *rīyate*, "begins to flow", Latin *rīvus*, "a stream", and Gaulish *Rēnos*, the Rhine.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reká*
- *Say it: reká*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reká*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mountain, then the Russian for a forest, then say *reká* again

Before you move on

What does река mean? ("A river".) Say it once more.

56.4 озеро (ózero) — a lake

Before the new one: say the Russian for a forest, then the Russian for a river.

You'll want to know: озеро

озеро (*ózero*) — "a lake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

озеро ← Proto-Slavic **ezero* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *ẽžeras* and Latvian *ezers*, "lake" (Vasmer). East Slavic turned the first *je-* into о-: compare Old Church Slavonic *jezero*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ózero*
- *Say it:* *ózero*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ózero*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a forest, then the Russian for a river, then say *ózero* again

Before you move on

What does озеро mean? ("A lake".) Say it once more.

56.5 море (móre) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Russian for a river, then the Russian for a lake.

You'll want to know: море

море (*móre*) — "the sea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

море ← Proto-Slavic **morje* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *mãrios*, “lagoon”, Gothic *marei*, Old Irish *muir* and Latin *mare*, all “sea”: English *mere*, “a lake”, is a cousin. He gives “marsh” as a possible older sense.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: móre*
- *Say it: móre*, once more
- *Say it:* say *móre*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a river, then the Russian for a lake, then say *móre* again

Before you move on

What does море mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

Stone, Sand, Shore, Island, Field

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a stone, sand, a shore, an island and a field.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 57: I can name a stone, sand, a shore, an island and a field.*

57.1 камень (ка́мен) — a stone

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lake, then the Russian for the sea.

You'll want to know: камень

камень (*ка́мен*) — "a stone".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

камень ← Proto-Slavic **kamy*, with the stem **kamen-* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Norse *hamarr*, "hammer", so English *hammer* is a cousin, beside Lithuanian *akmuõ* and Greek *ákmōn*, "anvil", from a related form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kámen*
- *Say it: kámen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kámen*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lake, then the Russian for the sea, then say *kámen* again

Before you move on

What does камень mean? ("A stone".) Say it once more.

57.2 песок (pesók) — sand

Before the new one: say the Russian for the sea, then the Russian for a stone.

You'll want to know: песок

песок (*pesók*) — "sand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

песок ← Proto-Slavic **pěsŭkŭ* — inherited, a cousin of Sanskrit *pāṃsú-*, "dust, sand", and Avestan *pąsnu-* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pesók*
- *Say it: pesók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pesók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the sea, then the Russian for a stone, then say *pesók* again

Before you move on

What does песок mean? (“Sand”.) Say it once more.

57.3 берег (béreg) — a shore, a bank

Before the new one: say the Russian for a stone, then the Russian for sand.

You’ll want to know: берег

берег (*béreg*) — “a shore, a bank”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

берег ← Proto-Slavic **bergŭ*. Vasmer relates it to Old High German *berg*, “mountain”, Avestan *barəzah-*, “height”, and Sanskrit *bṛhant-*, “high”: a bank is the raised edge. Inherited, that root should have given Slavic з, not г, so Berneker and others take the word from Germanic, and Kiparsky from another Indo-European language; Vasmer, judging by its tone and meaning, doubts a loan.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: béreg*
- *Say it: béreg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *béreg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a stone, then the Russian for sand, then say *béreg* again

Before you move on

What does берег mean? (“A shore, a bank”.) Say it once more.

57.4 остров (óstrov) — an island

Before the new one: say the Russian for sand, then the Russian for a shore.

You'll want to know: остров

остров (*óstrov*) — "an island".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

остров ← Proto-Slavic **ostrovŭ*, "what the current flows around": о-, "around", with the root of струя, "a stream" (Vasmer). The root is in Sanskrit *srávati*, "flows", and Greek *rhóos*, "a current".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *óstrov*
- *Say it:* *óstrov*, once more
- *Say it:* say *óstrov*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sand, then the Russian for a shore, then say *óstrov* again

Before you move on

What does остров mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

57.5 поле (póle) — a field

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shore, then the Russian for an island.

You'll want to know: поле

поле (*póle*) — "a field".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поле ← Proto-Slavic **polje* — inherited, related to Old Russian *polŭ*, "open, empty" (Vasmer): a field is open land. Vasmer compares Latin *palam*, "openly", and the *-falen* of *Westphalia*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: póle*
- *Say it: póle*, once more
- *Say it:* say *póle*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shore, then the Russian for an island, then say *póle* again

Before you move on

What does поле mean? ("A field".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Sky, Sun, Moon, Star, Cloud

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the sky, the sun, the moon, a star and a cloud.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 58: I can name the sky, the sun, the moon, a star and a cloud.*

58.1 небо (nébo) — the sky

Before the new one: say the Russian for an island, then the Russian for a field.

You'll want to know: небо

небо (*nébo*) — "the sky".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

небо — borrowed from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer; the native East Slavic form is нёбо, now "the palate". Both go back to Proto-Slavic **nebo*, a cousin of Sanskrit *nábhas*, "mist, sky", Greek *néphos*, "cloud", and Latin *nebula*, "mist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nébo*
- *Say it:* *nébo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nébo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an island, then the Russian for a field, then say *nébo* again

Before you move on

What does небо mean? ("The sky".) Say it once more.

58.2 солнце (sólntse) — the sun

Before the new one: say the Russian for a field, then the Russian for the sky.

You'll want to know: солнце

солнце (*sólntse*) — "the sun". The л is written and not said.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

солнце ← Proto-Slavic **sŭlnĭce*, a diminutive of **sŭlnĭ*, "sun", built like сердце, "heart" (Vasmer). Vasmer lists Lithuanian *sáulė*, "sun", and Sanskrit *svar*, "sun, light"; Latin *sōl* and English *sun* go back to the same PIE word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sólntse*
- *Say it:* *sólntse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sólntse*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a field, then the Russian for the sky, then say *sólntse* again

Before you move on

What does солнце mean? (“The sun”.) Say it once more.

58.3 луна (luná) — the moon

Before the new one: say the Russian for the sky, then the Russian for the sun.

You’ll want to know: луна

луна (*luná*) — “the moon”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

луна ← Proto-Slavic **luna*, from **louksnā*, “the bright one” — inherited. Vasmer lists Latin *lūna*, Old Prussian *lauxnos*, “stars”, and Greek *lýchnos*, “a lamp”, all from a root “to shine”, with луч, “a ray”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: luná*
- *Say it: luná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *luná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the sky, then the Russian for the sun, then say *luná* again

Before you move on

What does луна mean? (“The moon”.) Say it once more.

58.4 звезда (zvezdá) — a star

Before the new one: say the Russian for the sun, then the Russian for the moon.

You'll want to know: звезда

звезда (*zvezdá*) — "a star".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

звезда ← Proto-Slavic **gvězda* — inherited; г before *ě* became з. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *žvaigždė*, "star", and Latvian *zvaigzne*, from a root "to shine".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zvezdá*
- *Say it: zvezdá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zvezdá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the sun, then the Russian for the moon, then say *zvezdá* again

Before you move on

What does звезда mean? ("A star".) Say it once more.

58.5 облако (óblako) — a cloud

Before the new one: say the Russian for the moon, then the Russian for a star.

You'll want to know: облако

облако (*óblako*) — "a cloud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

облако — borrowed from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer; the native form was Old Russian *obolokŭ*. Both are **ob-volkŭ*, "what is drawn over", from the root of волочь, "to drag", a cousin of Greek *hélkō*, "I drag".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: óblako*
- *Say it: óblako*, once more
- *Say it:* say *óblako*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the moon, then the Russian for a star, then say *óblako* again

Before you move on

What does облако mean? ("A cloud".) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

Rain, Snow, Wind, Weather, World

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name rain, snow, the wind and the weather, and the world.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 59: I can name rain, snow, the wind and the weather, and the world.*

59.1 дождь (dozhd) — rain

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a star, then the Russian for a cloud.

You'll want to know: дождь

дождь (*dozhd*) — "rain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дождь ← Proto-Slavic **dǔždžĭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it probably goes with Norwegian *dusk-regn* and Swedish *regn-dusk*, "drizzle"; he also reports a view that starts from **dus-dius*, "bad weather", so the origin is debated.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dozhd*
- *Say it:* *dozhd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dozhd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a star, then the Russian for a cloud, then say *dozhd* again

Before you move on

What does дождь mean? ("Rain".) Say it once more.

59.2 снег (sneg) — snow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cloud, then the Russian for rain.

You'll want to know: снег

снег (*sneg*) — "snow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

снег ← Proto-Slavic **sněgŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *sniẽgas*, Gothic *snaiws*, Greek *nípha* and Latin *nix*, all "snow": English *snow* is a cousin, from PIE **sneyg^{wh}-*, "to snow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sneg*
- *Say it:* *sneg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sneg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cloud, then the Russian for rain, then say *sneg* again

Before you move on

What does снег mean? (“Snow”.) Say it once more.

59.3 ветер (véter) — the wind

Before the new one: say the Russian for rain, then the Russian for snow.

You’ll want to know: ветер

ветер (*véter*) — “the wind”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ветер ← Proto-Slavic **větrŭ* — inherited, from the root of веять, “to blow” (Vasmer). Vasmer lists Lithuanian *vėjas*, “wind”, and Sanskrit *vāta-*, “wind”; English *wind* is probably a cousin, from the same PIE root **h₂weh₁-*, “to blow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *véter*
- *Say it:* *véter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *véter*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rain, then the Russian for snow, then say *véter* again

Before you move on

What does ветер mean? (“The wind”.) Say it once more.

59.4 погода (pogóda) — the weather

Before the new one: say the Russian for snow, then the Russian for the wind.

You'll want to know: погода

погода (*pogóda*) — "the weather".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

погода is по- with год, which in Old Russian meant "time, a fitting moment" (Vasmer); the same root is in годиться, "to be fit". Weather was first "fair, fitting time", as in непогода, "bad weather".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pogóda*
- *Say it: pogóda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pogóda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for snow, then the Russian for the wind, then say *pogóda* again

Before you move on

What does погода mean? ("The weather".) Say it once more.

59.5 мир (mir) — the world; peace

Before the new one: say the Russian for the wind, then the Russian for the weather.

You'll want to know: мир

мир (*mir*) — "the world; peace". Both meanings in one word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мир ← Proto-Slavic **mirŭ*, “peace” — inherited, related to Old Lithuanian *mieras*, “peace”, and Latvian *miêrs* (Vasmer). The sense “village community” grew from “peaceful community”, and from it “the world”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mir*
- *Say it: mir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mir*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the wind, then the Russian for the weather, then say *mir* again

Before you move on

What does мир mean? (“The world; peace”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 60

Dog, Cat, Horse, Cow, Pig

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a dog, a cat, a horse, a cow and a pig.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 60: I can name a dog, a cat, a horse, a cow and a pig.*

60.1 собака (sobáka) — a dog

Before the new one: say the Russian for the weather, then the Russian for the world; peace.

You'll want to know: собака

собака (*sobáka*) — "a dog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

собака — origin disputed. Vasmer takes it from a Middle Iranian **sabāka-*, compare Median *spaka*, "dog", which Herodotus records, a cousin of Greek *kýōn*, "dog". Trubachev, in a note, finds an Iranian source unlikely and prefers Turkic *köbäk*, "dog".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sobáka*
- *Say it: sobáka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sobáka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the weather, then the Russian for the world; peace, then say *sobáka* again

Before you move on

What does собака mean? (“A dog”.) Say it once more.

60.2 кошка (kóshka) — a cat

Before the new one: say the Russian for the world; peace, then the Russian for a dog.

You’ll want to know: кошка

кошка (*kóshka*) — “a cat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кошка — probably a fond form built on кот, “a tomcat”, as the pet name Маша is built on Мария, “Mary” (Vasmer). Old Russian had *kotŭka*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kóshka*
- *Say it: kóshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kóshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the world; peace, then the Russian for a dog, then say *kóshka* again

Before you move on

What does кошка mean? (“A cat”.) Say it once more.

60.3 лошадь (lóshad) — a horse

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dog, then the Russian for a cat.

You’ll want to know: лошадь

лошадь (*lóshad*) — “a horse”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лошадь — an old loan from Turkic, says Vasmer: compare Chuvash *laša*, “horse”, and Turkish and Tatar *alaša*, “a horse, a gelding”. It grew from лоша, with a suffix; the native word is конь, “a steed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lóshad*
- *Say it: lóshad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lóshad*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dog, then the Russian for a cat, then say *lóshad* again

Before you move on

What does лошадь mean? (“A horse”.) Say it once more.

60.4 корова (koróva) — a cow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cat, then the Russian for a horse.

You'll want to know: корова

корова (*koróva*) — "a cow". It gives молоко.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

корова ← Proto-Slavic **korva* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *kárvė*, "cow", and, Vasmer says, of Greek *keraós*, "horned", and Latin *cervus*, "deer": the horned one. Church Slavonic has крава, "cow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koróva*
- *Say it: koróva*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koróva*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cat, then the Russian for a horse, then say *koróva* again

Before you move on

What does корова mean? ("A cow".) Say it once more.

60.5 свинья (svinyá) — a pig

Before the new one: say the Russian for a horse, then the Russian for a cow.

You'll want to know: свинья

свинья (*svinyá*) — "a pig".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свинья ← Proto-Slavic **svinĭja* — inherited, built on the PIE word **suH-*, "pig", that gave Latin *sūs* and English *sow*; English *swine* is a close cousin of the Slavic form. Vasmer thinks the root most likely

imitates a pig's grunt *su-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svinyá*
- *Say it: svinyá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svinyá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a horse, then the Russian for a cow, then say *svinyá* again

Before you move on

What does **свинья** mean? ("A pig".) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

Bird, Mouse, Wolf, Bear, Fox

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a bird, a mouse, a wolf, a bear and a fox.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 61: I can name a bird, a mouse, a wolf, a bear and a fox.*

61.1 птица (ptítsa) — a bird

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cow, then the Russian for a pig.

You'll want to know: птица

птица (*ptítsa*) — "a bird".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

птица ← Proto-Slavic **pŭtica*, from **pŭta*, "bird" — inherited. Vasmer lists Latvian *putns*, "bird", Lithuanian *putýtis*, "little bird", and words for "child, young one": Latin *putus*, "boy", and Sanskrit *putrá-*, "son".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ptítsa*
- *Say it: ptítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ptítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cow, then the Russian for a pig, then say *ptítsa* again

Before you move on

What does птица mean? ("A bird".) Say it once more.

61.2 мышь (mysh) — a mouse

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pig, then the Russian for a bird.

You'll want to know: мышь

мышь (*mysh*) — "a mouse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мышь ← Proto-Slavic **myšĭ* — inherited from PIE **muHs*, "mouse". Vasmer lists Sanskrit *mūṣ-*, Greek *mŷs*, Latin *mūs* and Old High German *mûs*: English *mouse* is a cousin. Trubachev adds that it may first have meant "the grey one".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mysh*
- *Say it: mysh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mysh*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pig, then the Russian for a bird, then say *mysh* again

Before you move on

What does мышь mean? (“A mouse”.) Say it once more.

61.3 волк (volk) — a wolf

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bird, then the Russian for a mouse.

You’ll want to know: волк

волк (*volk*) — “a wolf”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

волк ← Proto-Slavic **vĭlkŭ* — inherited from PIE **wl̥kʷos*, “wolf”. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *vilkas*, Sanskrit *vṛkas*, Gothic *wulfs* and Greek *lýkos*: English *wolf* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: volk*
- *Say it: volk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *volk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bird, then the Russian for a mouse, then say *volk* again

Before you move on

What does волк mean? (“A wolf”.) Say it once more.

61.4 медведь (medvéd) — a bear

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mouse, then the Russian for a wolf.

You'll want to know: медведь

медведь (*medvéd*) — "a bear". Literally "honey-knower": the one who knows where the мёд is.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

медведь ← Proto-Slavic **medvědĭ*, "honey-eater", from мёд, "honey", and the root of есть, "to eat" (Vasmer). It is a taboo name: hunters avoided the old word for "bear", the one kept in Latin *ursus* and Greek *árktos*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: medvéd*
- *Say it: medvéd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *medvéd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mouse, then the Russian for a wolf, then say *medvéd* again

Before you move on

What does медведь mean? ("A bear".) Say it once more.

61.5 лиса (lisá) — a fox

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wolf, then the Russian for a bear.

You'll want to know: лиса

лиса (*lisá*) — "a fox".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лиса goes with лис, "a fox", Old Church Slavonic лиса. Vasmer calls the origin unclear: tracing it to the family of Latin *vulpēs* and Lithuanian *lãpė́*, "fox", is guesswork, he says, and other links are doubtful.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lisá*
- *Say it: lisá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lisá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wolf, then the Russian for a bear, then say *lisá* again

Before you move on

What does лиса mean? ("A fox".) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

Hare, Snake, Hen, Duck, Goat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a hare, a snake, a hen, a duck and a goat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 62: I can name a hare, a snake, a hen, a duck and a goat.*

62.1 заяц (záyats) — a hare

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a bear, then the Russian for a fox.

You'll want to know: заяц

заяц (*záyats*) — "a hare".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

заяц ← Proto-Slavic **zajęcĭ* — inherited. With a first sense "leaper", it has been compared with Sanskrit *háyas*, "horse", and *jíhīte*, "leaps up", and Lithuanian *žaĩsti*, "to frolic", but Vasmer cites doubts.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: záyats*
- *Say it: záyats*, once more
- *Say it:* say *záyats*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bear, then the Russian for a fox, then say *záyats* again

Before you move on

What does заяц mean? ("A hare".) Say it once more.

62.2 змея (zmeyá) — a snake

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fox, then the Russian for a hare.

You'll want to know: змея

змея (*zmeyá*) — "a snake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

змея — a taboo name, "the earthly one, the one that crawls on the ground", from the root of земля, "earth" (Vasmer). Albanian makes "caterpillar" from its word for "earth" in the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zmeyá*
- *Say it: zmeyá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zmeyá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fox, then the Russian for a hare, then say *zmeyá* again

Before you move on

What does змея mean? ("A snake".) Say it once more.

62.3 курица (kúritsa) — a hen

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hare, then the Russian for a snake.

You'll want to know: курица

курица (*kúritsa*) — "a hen". It lays the яйцо.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

курица is built on кура, "a hen", and the old кур, "a cock". Vasmer relates кур to Latvian *kaurêt*, "to roar", and Sanskrit *kāuti*, "cries out": the cock as the crier.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kúritsa*
- *Say it: kúritsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kúritsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hare, then the Russian for a snake, then say *kúritsa* again

Before you move on

What does курица mean? ("A hen".) Say it once more.

62.4 утка (útka) — a duck

Before the new one: say the Russian for a snake, then the Russian for a hen.

You'll want to know: утка

утка (*útka*) — "a duck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

утка is old утица, from Proto-Slavic **ǫty*, "duck" — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *ántis*, Latin *anas*, Old High German *anut* and Greek *nêssa*, all "duck". The утка that means a false news story copies French *canard*, Vasmer notes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: útka*
- *Say it: útka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *útka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a snake, then the Russian for a hen, then say *útka* again

Before you move on

What does утка mean? ("A duck".) Say it once more.

62.5 коза (kozá) — a goat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hen, then the Russian for a duck.

You'll want to know: коза

коза (*kozá*) — "a goat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

коза ← Proto-Slavic **koza* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Albanian *kedh*, "kid", and Old English *hæcen*, "kid", and to Gothic *hakuls*, "a

cloak”, since goatskin made cloaks.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kozá*
- *Say it: kozá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kozá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hen, then the Russian for a duck, then say *kozá* again

Before you move on

What does коза mean? (“A goat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

White, Black, Red, Blue, Green

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say white, black, red, blue and green.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 63: I can say white, black, red, blue and green.*

63.1 белый (bélyy) — white

Before the new one: say the Russian for a duck, then the Russian for a goat.

You'll want to know: белый

белый (*bélyy*) — "white".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

белый ← Proto-Slavic **bělŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *bãlas*, "white", Latvian *bãls*, "pale", Greek *phalós*, "white", and Sanskrit *bhāti*, "shines", from PIE **b^{h}el-*, "to shine".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bélyy*
- *Say it: bélyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bélyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a duck, then the Russian for a goat, then say *bélyy* again

Before you move on

What does белый mean? ("White".) Say it once more.

63.2 чёрный (chyórnyy) — black

Before the new one: say the Russian for a goat, then the Russian for white.

You'll want to know: чёрный

чёрный (*chyórnyy*) — "black".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чёрный ← Proto-Slavic **čьrnŭ*, from **čьrxnŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *kirsnan*, "black", and Sanskrit *kṛṣṇá-*, "black", the name of Krishna.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chyórnyy*
- *Say it: chyórnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chyórnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a goat, then the Russian for white, then say *chyórnyy* again

Before you move on

What does чёрный mean? (“Black”.) Say it once more.

63.3 красный (krásnyy) — red

Before the new one: say the Russian for white, then the Russian for black.

You’ll want to know: красный

красный (*krásnyy*) — “red”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

красный is built on краса, “beauty”, and first meant “beautiful”, as in прекрасный, “lovely”; the name of Moscow’s Red Square first meant “the beautiful square”. Vasmer thinks краса is probably related to Old Norse *hrósa*, “to boast”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krásnyy*
- *Say it: krásnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krásnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for white, then the Russian for black, then say *krásnyy* again

Before you move on

What does красный mean? (“Red”.) Say it once more.

63.4 синий (síniy) — blue (dark blue)

Before the new one: say the Russian for black, then the Russian for red.

You'll want to know: синий

синий (*síniy*) — "blue (dark blue)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

синий ← Proto-Slavic **sinъ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to сиять, "to shine", or to сивый, "grey", and to Sanskrit *śyāmá-*, "dark", and Lithuanian *šývas*, "light-coloured".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: síniy*
- *Say it: síniy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *síniy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for black, then the Russian for red, then say *síniy* again

Before you move on

What does синий mean? ("Blue (dark blue)".) Say it once more.

63.5 зелёный (zelyónyy) — green

Before the new one: say the Russian for red, then the Russian for blue.

You'll want to know: зелёный

зелёный (*zelyónyy*) — "green".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зелёный ← Proto-Slavic **zelenŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *žãlias*, “green”, and *žélti*, “to grow over”, and further to золото, “gold”, and Sanskrit *hári-*, “yellow”. German *gelb*, “yellow”, comes from the same PIE root, **ǵʰelh₃-*, “to be green, yellow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zelyónyy*
- *Say it: zelyónyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zelyónyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for red, then the Russian for blue, then say *zelyónyy* again

Before you move on

What does зелёный mean? (“Green”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

Yellow, Beautiful, Good, Bad, New

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say yellow, beautiful, good, bad and new.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 64: I can say yellow, beautiful, good, bad and new.*

64.1 жёлтый (zhyóltyy) — yellow

> Before the new one: say the Russian for blue, then the Russian for green.

You'll want to know: жёлтый

жёлтый (*zhyóltyy*) — "yellow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жёлтый ← Proto-Slavic **žĭltŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *geltas*, "yellow", Greek *cholḗ*, "bile", and Latin *fel*, "bile": bile was named for its colour. желчь, "bile", is its Russian twin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhyóltyy*
- *Say it: zhyóltyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhyóltyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for blue, then the Russian for green, then say *zhyóltyy* again

Before you move on

What does жёлтый mean? ("Yellow".) Say it once more.

64.2 красивый (krasívyy) — beautiful

Before the new one: say the Russian for green, then the Russian for yellow.

You'll want to know: красивый

красивый (*krasívyy*) — "beautiful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

красивый is краса, "beauty", with -ивый, "full of" (Vasmer); красный, "red", once "beautiful", comes from the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krasívyy*
- *Say it: krasívyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krasívyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for green, then the Russian for yellow, then say *krasívyy* again

Before you move on

What does красивый mean? (“Beautiful”.) Say it once more.

64.3 хороший (khoróshiy) — good

Before the new one: say the Russian for yellow, then the Russian for beautiful.

You’ll want to know: хороший

хороший (*khoróshiy*) — “good”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хороший — recorded from the 1200s. Vasmer thinks it most likely a short form of хоробрый, “brave”; a link with хоронить, “to guard”, he finds less likely, one with the sun god Khors he rejects, and a loan from Ossetian *xorz*, “good”, which Abaev later supported, he doubts.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khoróshiy*
- *Say it: khoróshiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khoróshiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for yellow, then the Russian for beautiful, then say *khoróshiy* again

Before you move on

What does хороший mean? (“Good”.) Say it once more.

64.4 плохой (plokhóy) — bad

Before the new one: say the Russian for beautiful, then the Russian for good.

You'll want to know: плохой

плохой (*plokhóy*) — "bad". The opposite of хороший.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плохой ← Old Russian *ploxŭ*, "bad"; Ukrainian плохий means "meek, quiet", and Polish *płochy*, "timid". Vasmer links it with переполох, "a fright", while others relate it to плоский, "flat", so the origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plokhóy*
- *Say it: plokhóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plokhóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beautiful, then the Russian for good, then say *plokhóy* again

Before you move on

What does плохой mean? ("Bad".) Say it once more.

64.5 новый (nóvyy) — new

Before the new one: say the Russian for good, then the Russian for bad.

You'll want to know: новый

новый (*nóvyy*) — "new".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

новый ← Proto-Slavic **novŭ* — inherited from PIE **néwos*, "new". Vasmer lists Sanskrit *náva-*, Greek *néos*, Latin *novus* and Gothic *niujis*: English *new* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nóvyy*
- *Say it:* *nóvyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nóvyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for good, then the Russian for bad, then say *nóvyy* again

Before you move on

What does **новый** mean? ("New".) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Big, Small, Old, Long, Short

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say big, small, old, long and short.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 65: I can say big, small, old, long and short.*

65.1 большой (bolshóy) — big

> Before the new one: say the Russian for bad, then the Russian for new.

You'll want to know: большой

большой (*bolshóy*) — "big".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

большой is built on the comparative больший, "greater", Proto-Slavic **bolьjьjь* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *bálīyān*, "stronger", and *bálam*, "strength", and Greek *beltíōn*, "better".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolshóy*
- *Say it: bolshóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bolshóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for bad, then the Russian for new, then say *bolshóy* again

Before you move on

What does большой mean? ("Big".) Say it once more.

65.2 маленький (málenkiy) — small

Before the new one: say the Russian for new, then the Russian for big.

You'll want to know: маленький

маленький (*málenkiy*) — "small".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

маленький is малый, "small", with the fond -енький. малый ← Proto-Slavic **malŭ*, related, Vasmer says, to Gothic *smals*, "small", and Greek *mêlon*, "sheep, small cattle": English *small* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: málenkiy*
- *Say it: málenkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *málenkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for new, then the Russian for big, then say *málenkiy* again

Before you move on

What does маленький mean? (“Small”.) Say it once more.

65.3 старый (stáryy) — old

Before the new one: say the Russian for big, then the Russian for small.

You’ll want to know: старый

старый (*stáryy*) — “old”. The opposite of новый.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

старый ← Proto-Slavic **starŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *stóras*, “thick, stout”, and Old Norse *stórr*, “big, strong”: old was first “grown, strong”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stáryy*
- *Say it: stáryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stáryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for big, then the Russian for small, then say *stáryy* again

Before you move on

What does старый mean? (“Old”.) Say it once more.

65.4 длинный (dlínnyy) — long

Before the new one: say the Russian for small, then the Russian for old.

You'll want to know: длинный

длинный (*dlínnyy*) — "long".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

длинный is длина, "length", with the adjective ending -ный, on the root of долгий, "long (in time)". Vasmer relates долгий to Lithuanian *ìlgas*, Sanskrit *dīrghá-* and Greek *dolichós*, all "long", from PIE **dl̥h₁gʰós*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dlínnyy*
- *Say it: dlínnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dlínnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for small, then the Russian for old, then say *dlínnyy* again

Before you move on

What does длинный mean? ("Long".) Say it once more.

65.5 короткий (korótkiy) — short

Before the new one: say the Russian for old, then the Russian for long.

You'll want to know: короткий

короткий (*korótkiy*) — "short".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

короткий ← Proto-Slavic **kortŭkŭ* — inherited; Church Slavonic has краткий, "brief". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *kartùs*, "bitter", and

Sanskrit *kaṭu-*, “sharp”, and perhaps to Latin *curtus*, “cut short”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: korótkiy*
- *Say it: korótkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *korótkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for old, then the Russian for long, then say *korótkiy* again

Before you move on

What does короткий mean? (“Short”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

Hot, Cold, Warm, Fast, Slow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say hot, cold, warm, fast and slow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 66: I can say hot, cold, warm, fast and slow.*

66.1 горячий (goryáchiy) — hot

> Before the new one: say the Russian for long, then the Russian for short.

You'll want to know: горячий

горячий (*goryáchiy*) — "hot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

горячий is built on гореть, "to burn", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *garėti*, "to flare up", Sanskrit *háras*, "heat", and Greek *thérmos*, "warm", from PIE *$*g^{wh}$er-*, "hot".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: goryáchiy*
- *Say it: goryáchiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *goryáchiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for long, then the Russian for short, then say *goryáchiy* again

Before you move on

What does горячий mean? ("Hot".) Say it once more.

66.2 холодный (kholódnyy) — cold

Before the new one: say the Russian for short, then the Russian for hot.

You'll want to know: холодный

холодный (*kholódnyy*) — "cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

холодный is холод, "cold", with -ный. холод ← Proto-Slavic **xoldŭ*; Vasmer thinks it is probably a variant of the root of Gothic *kalds*, "cold", and Latin *gelidus*, "icy", so English *cold* would be a cousin. Church Slavonic has хлад, "coolness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kholódnyy*
- *Say it: kholódnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kholódnyy*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for short, then the Russian for hot, then say *kholódnyy* again

Before you move on

What does холодный mean? (“Cold”.) Say it once more.

66.3 тёплый (tyóplyy) — warm

Before the new one: say the Russian for hot, then the Russian for cold.

You’ll want to know: тёплый

тёплый (*tyóplyy*) — “warm”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тёплый ← Proto-Slavic **teplŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *tápati*, “heats”, and Persian *tāftan*, “to burn”; Latin *tepidus*, “lukewarm”, comes from the same PIE root **tep-*, “to be warm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyóplyy*
- *Say it: tyóplyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyóplyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hot, then the Russian for cold, then say *tyóplyy* again

Before you move on

What does тёплый mean? (“Warm”.) Say it once more.

66.4 быстрый (býstryy) — fast

Before the new one: say the Russian for cold, then the Russian for warm.

You'll want to know: быстрый

быстрый (*býstryy*) — "fast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

быстрый ← Proto-Slavic **bystrŭ* — inherited; Serbo-Croatian бистар means "clear". Vasmer compares Old Norse *bysja*, "to gush out", and Norwegian *buse*, "to rush forward", but other links are proposed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *býstryy*
- *Say it:* *býstryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *býstryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cold, then the Russian for warm, then say *býstryy* again

Before you move on

What does быстрый mean? ("Fast".) Say it once more.

66.5 медленный (médlennyy) — slow

Before the new one: say the Russian for warm, then the Russian for fast.

You'll want to know: медленный

медленный (*médlennyy*) — "slow". The adjective beside медленно, slowly.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

медленный ← Old Russian *mьdilьnъ*, Proto-Slavic **mъdilьnъ* — inherited, with медлить, "to delay". Vasmer connects it with the Slavic verb **muditi*, "to linger".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: médlennyy*
- *Say it: médlennyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *médlennyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for warm, then the Russian for fast, then say *médlennyy* again

Before you move on

What does медленный mean? ("Slow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

Easy, Hard, Dear, Cheap, Badly

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say easy, hard, expensive and cheap, and badly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 67: I can say easy, hard, expensive and cheap, and badly.*

67.1 лёгкий (lyókhkiy) — light; easy

Before the new one: say the Russian for fast, then the Russian for slow.

You'll want to know: лёгкий

лёгкий (*lyókhkiy*) — "light; easy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лёгкий ← Proto-Slavic **lĭgŭkŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Latin *levis*, "light", Sanskrit *laghú-*, "light, quick", and Greek *elachýs*, "small", from PIE **h₁léngʷʰus*, "light in weight"; English *light* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lyókhkiy*
- *Say it: lyókhkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyókhkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fast, then the Russian for slow, then say *lyókhkiy* again

Before you move on

What does лёгкий mean? ("Light; easy".) Say it once more.

67.2 трудный (trúdnyy) — hard, difficult

Before the new one: say the Russian for slow, then the Russian for light; easy.

You'll want to know: трудный

трудный (*trúdnyy*) — "hard, difficult".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

трудный is труд, "labour, toil", with -ный. труд ← Proto-Slavic **trudŭ*; Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *triūsas*, "work, bother", and Gothic *usþriutan*, "to trouble".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trúdnyy*
- *Say it: trúdnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trúdnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for slow, then the Russian for light; easy, then say *trúdnyy* again

Before you move on

What does трудный mean? ("Hard, difficult".) Say it once more.

67.3 дорогой (dorogóy) — expensive; dear

Before the new one: say the Russian for light; easy, then the Russian for hard.

You'll want to know: дорогой

дорогой (*dorogóy*) — "expensive; dear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дорогой ← Proto-Slavic **dorgŭ* — inherited; Church Slavonic has драгой, "dear", as in драгоценный, "precious". Vasmer thinks it is probably related to Latvian *dārgs*, "dear, expensive". "Dear" and "expensive" share the word, as in English.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dorogóy*
- *Say it: dorogóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dorogóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for light; easy, then the Russian for hard, then say *dorogóy* again

Before you move on

What does дорогой mean? ("Expensive; dear".) Say it once more.

67.4 дешёвый (deshyóvyy) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Russian for hard, then the Russian for expensive; dear.

You'll want to know: дешёвый

дешёвый (*deshyóvyy*) — "cheap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дешёвый ← Old Russian *dešev̆ŭ*; Vasmer thinks it most likely comes from десить, "to find, to come upon": cheap is what is easily come by. He rejects a Turkic source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: deshyóvyy*
- *Say it: deshyóvyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *deshyóvyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hard, then the Russian for expensive; dear, then say *deshyóvyy* again

Before you move on

What does дешёвый mean? ("Cheap".) Say it once more.

67.5 плохо (plókho) — badly

Before the new one: say the Russian for expensive; dear, then the Russian for cheap.

You'll want to know: плохо

плохо (*plókho*) — "badly". The adverb of плохой.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плохо is плохой, “bad”, made into an adverb with -о. плохой is Old Russian *ploxŭ*; its origin is not settled (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plókho*
- *Say it: plókho*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plókho*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for expensive; dear, then the Russian for cheap, then say *plókho* again

Before you move on

What does плохо mean? (“Badly”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 68

Day, Week, Month, Year, Evening

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a day, a week, a month, a year and the evening.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 68: I can name a day, a week, a month, a year and the evening.*

68.1 день (den) — a day

Before the new one: say the Russian for cheap, then the Russian for badly.

You'll want to know: день

день (*den*) — "a day".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

день ← Proto-Slavic **dĭnĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *dínam*, Lithuanian *dienà* and Latin *diēs*, all "day", from the PIE root **dyew-*, "to shine".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: den*
- *Say it: den*, once more
- *Say it:* say *den*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cheap, then the Russian for badly, then say *den* again

Before you move on

What does день mean? ("A day".) Say it once more.

68.2 неделя (nedélya) — a week

Before the new one: say the Russian for badly, then the Russian for a day.

You'll want to know: неделя

неделя (*nedélya*) — "a week".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

неделя is не, "not", with дело, "work": first "the day of no work", Sunday, and then the week that runs from it (Vasmer). Vasmer thinks it most likely copies Latin *fēria*, "holiday".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nedélya*
- *Say it: nedélya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nedélya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for badly, then the Russian for a day, then say *nedélya* again

Before you move on

What does неделя mean? ("A week".) Say it once more.

68.3 месяц (mésyats) — a month

Before the new one: say the Russian for a day, then the Russian for a week.

You'll want to know: месяц

месяц (*mésyats*) — "a month".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

месяц ← Proto-Slavic **měsęcь*, "moon; month" — inherited. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *mās-*, Greek *mḗn* and Latin *mēnsis*, "month", and Lithuanian *mė́nuo*, "moon": English *moon* and *month* are cousins. A month is one round of the moon.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mésyats*
- *Say it: mésyats*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mésyats*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a day, then the Russian for a week, then say *mésyats* again

Before you move on

What does месяц mean? ("A month".) Say it once more.

68.4 год (god) — a year

Before the new one: say the Russian for a week, then the Russian for a month.

You'll want to know: год

год (*god*) — "a year".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

год ← Proto-Slavic **godŭ*, "a fitting time, a season" — inherited; Old Russian *godŭ* meant "time, term" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Latvian *gadīgs*, "capable", and Old High German *gigat*, "fitting"; the same root is in годиться, "to be fit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: god*
- *Say it: god*, once more
- *Say it:* say *god*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a week, then the Russian for a month, then say *god* again

Before you move on

What does год mean? ("A year".) Say it once more.

68.5 вечер (vécher) — the evening

Before the new one: say the Russian for a month, then the Russian for a year.

You'll want to know: вечер

вечер (*vécher*) — "the evening".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вечер ← Proto-Slavic **večerŭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *vãkaras*, "evening" (Vasmer). Vasmer thinks Greek *hespéra* and Latin *vespera*, "evening", probably belong here too, with a changed first sound.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vécher*
- *Say it: vécher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vécher*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a month, then the Russian for a year, then say *vécher* again

Before you move on

What does вечер mean? ("The evening".) Say it once more.

Chapter 69

Today, Yesterday, Hour, Minute, Time

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say today and yesterday, and name an hour, a minute and time.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 69: I can say today and yesterday, and name an hour, a minute and time.*

69.1 сегодня (sevódnya) — today

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a year, then the Russian for the evening.

You'll want to know: сегодня

сегодня (*sevódnya*) — "today". The г is said as *v*.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сегодня is old сего дьне, "of this day": a form of сей, "this", with день, "day" (Vasmer). The г is said в, as in его.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sevódnya*
- *Say it: sevódnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sevódnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a year, then the Russian for the evening, then say *sevódnya* again

Before you move on

What does сегодня mean? ("Today".) Say it once more.

69.2 вчера (vcherá) — yesterday

Before the new one: say the Russian for the evening, then the Russian for today.

You'll want to know: вчера

вчера (*vcherá*) — "yesterday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вчера comes from вечер, "evening": an old case form meaning "in the evening", as вечером, "in the evening", does today (Vasmer). Yesterday was "last evening".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vcherá*
- *Say it: vcherá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vcherá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the evening, then the Russian for today, then say *vcherá* again

Before you move on

What does вчера mean? ("Yesterday".) Say it once more.

69.3 час (chas) — an hour

Before the new one: say the Russian for today, then the Russian for yesterday.

You'll want to know: час

час (*chas*) — "an hour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

час ← Proto-Slavic **časŭ*, "time, a while" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *kīsman*, "time, a moment", and Albanian *kohë*, "time, weather". Ukrainian час still means "time".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chas*
- *Say it: chas*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chas*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for today, then the Russian for yesterday, then say *chas* again

Before you move on

What does час mean? ("An hour".) Say it once more.

69.4 минута (minúta) — a minute

Before the new one: say the Russian for yesterday, then the Russian for an hour.

You'll want to know: минута

минута (*minúta*) — "a minute".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

минута — first минюта, in the 1600s; it came through German *Minute* or French *minute* from Latin *(pars) minūta prīma*, "the first small part" of an hour, as секунда, "a second", is the second (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: minúta*
- *Say it: minúta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *minúta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for yesterday, then the Russian for an hour, then say *minúta* again

Before you move on

What does минута mean? ("A minute".) Say it once more.

69.5 время (vrémya) — time

Before the new one: say the Russian for an hour, then the Russian for a minute.

You'll want to know: время

время (*vrémya*) — "time".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

время — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of East Slavic веремя: -ре- against -ере- marks it. Vasmer relates it to вертеть, "to turn", and Sanskrit *vártman*, "a wheel track": time as

what turns.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vrémya*
- *Say it: vrémya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vrémya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an hour, then the Russian for a minute, then say *vrémya* again

Before you move on

What does время mean? ("Time".) Say it once more.

Chapter 70

Monday to Saturday

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name Monday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday and Saturday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 70: I can name Monday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday and Saturday.*

70.1 понедельник (ponedélnik) — Monday

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a minute, then the Russian for time.

You'll want to know: понедельник

понедельник (*ponedélnik*) — "Monday". "After the week-day": неделя once meant Sunday.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

понедельник is по-, "after", with неделя, which once meant "Sunday", and -ник: "the day after Sunday" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ponedélnik*
- *Say it: ponedélnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ponedélnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a minute, then the Russian for time, then say *ponedélnik* again

Before you move on

What does понедельник mean? ("Monday".) Say it once more.

70.2 среда (sredá) — Wednesday

Before the new one: say the Russian for time, then the Russian for Monday.

You'll want to know: среда

среда (*sredá*) — "Wednesday". "The middle" of the week.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

среда — the Church Slavonic shape, says Vasmer, of native середа, "middle", the word in середина, "the middle": Wednesday is the middle of the week. It is the same root as сердце, "heart".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sredá*
- *Say it: sredá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sredá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for time, then the Russian for Monday, then say *sredá* again

Before you move on

What does среда mean? (“Wednesday”.) Say it once more.

70.3 четверг (chetvérg) — Thursday

Before the new one: say the Russian for Monday, then the Russian for Wednesday.

You’ll want to know: четверг

четверг (*chetvérg*) — “Thursday”. “The fourth” day, from четыре.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

четверг ← Proto-Slavic **četvьrgŭ*, from the root of четыре, “four” (Vasmer): the fourth day after Sunday.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chetvérg*
- *Say it: chetvérg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chetvérg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Monday, then the Russian for Wednesday, then say *chetvérg* again

Before you move on

What does четверг mean? (“Thursday”.) Say it once more.

70.4 пятница (pyátnitsa) — Friday

Before the new one: say the Russian for Wednesday, then the Russian for Thursday.

You'll want to know: пятница

пятница (*pyátnitsa*) — "Friday". "The fifth" day, from пять.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пятница is built on пять, "five": the fifth day of a week that begins on Monday (Vasmer); Old Russian said *pjatŭkŭ*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyátnitsa*
- *Say it: pyátnitsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pyátnitsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Wednesday, then the Russian for Thursday, then say *pyátnitsa* again

Before you move on

What does пятница mean? ("Friday".) Say it once more.

70.5 суббота (subbóta) — Saturday

Before the new one: say the Russian for Thursday, then the Russian for Friday.

You'll want to know: суббота

суббота (*subbóta*) — "Saturday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

суббота — Vasmer supports a source in Byzantine Greek **sámbaton*; others prefer Balkan Latin **sambata*. Both come from Hebrew *shabbat*, "the day of rest".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: subbóta*
- *Say it: subbóta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *subbóta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Thursday, then the Russian for Friday, then say *subbóta* again

Before you move on

What does суббота mean? ("Saturday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 71

Sunday and the Four Seasons

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name Sunday, winter, spring, summer and autumn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 71: I can name Sunday, winter, spring, summer and autumn.*

71.1 воскресенье (voskresénye) — Sunday

Before the new one: say the Russian for Friday, then the Russian for Saturday.

You'll want to know: воскресенье

воскресенье (*voskresénye*) — "Sunday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

воскресенье — Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, as its вос- shows: it meant "resurrection", then "the day of the Resurrection", then Sunday. Earlier, неделя named Sunday.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: voskresénye*
- *Say it: voskresénye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voskresénye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Friday, then the Russian for Saturday, then say *voskresénye* again

Before you move on

What does воскресенье mean? ("Sunday".) Say it once more.

71.2 зима (zimá) — winter

Before the new one: say the Russian for Saturday, then the Russian for Sunday.

You'll want to know: зима

зима (*zimá*) — "winter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зима ← Proto-Slavic **zima* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *žiemà*, Sanskrit *himá-*, Greek *cheîma* and Latin *hiems*, all "winter", from PIE **ǵʰéyōm*, "winter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zimá*
- *Say it: zimá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zimá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Saturday, then the Russian for Sunday, then say *zimá* again

Before you move on

What does зима mean? (“Winter”.) Say it once more.

71.3 весна (vesná) — spring

Before the new one: say the Russian for Sunday, then the Russian for winter.

You’ll want to know: весна

весна (*vesná*) — “spring”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

весна ← Proto-Slavic **vesna* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *vasarà*, “summer”, Greek *éar*, Latin *vēr* and Old Norse *vár*, all “spring”, and Sanskrit *vasantá-*, “spring”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vesná*
- *Say it: vesná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vesná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for Sunday, then the Russian for winter, then say *vesná* again

Before you move on

What does весна mean? (“Spring”.) Say it once more.

71.4 лето (léto) — summer

Before the new one: say the Russian for winter, then the Russian for spring.

You'll want to know: лето

лето (*léto*) — "summer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лето ← Proto-Slavic **lěto*, "summer; year" — inherited. Its deeper origin is uncertain: Vasmer reports a possible link with Old Irish *laithe*, "day", and Old Gutnish *laþigs*, "in spring", and others with лить, "to pour". It also counts years: пять лет, "five years".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: léto*
- *Say it: léto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *léto*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for winter, then the Russian for spring, then say *léto* again

Before you move on

What does лето mean? ("Summer".) Say it once more.

71.5 осень (ósen) — autumn

Before the new one: say the Russian for spring, then the Russian for summer.

You'll want to know: осень

осень (*ósen*) — "autumn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

осень ← Proto-Slavic **esenĭ* — inherited; East Slavic turned *je-* into о-. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *assanis*, "autumn", Gothic *asans*,

"harvest", and Old High German *aran*, "harvest": autumn as the reaping season.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ósen*
- *Say it: ósen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ósen*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for spring, then the Russian for summer, then say *ósen* again

Before you move on

What does осень mean? ("Autumn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 72

Here, There, Far, Near, Up Above

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say here, there, far, near and up above.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 72: I can say here, there, far, near and up above.*

72.1 здесь (zdes) — here

Before the new one: say the Russian for summer, then the Russian for autumn.

You'll want to know: здесь

здесь (*zdes*) — "here".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

здесь ← Old Russian сьде, with a later -сь: Proto-Slavic **sĭde*, "here", from the old pronoun **sĭ*, "this", the one in сей and сегодня, "today", built as где, "where", is built from the question word (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zdes*
- *Say it: zdes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zdes*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for summer, then the Russian for autumn, then say *zdes* again

Before you move on

What does здесь mean? ("Here".) Say it once more.

72.2 там (tam) — there

Before the new one: say the Russian for autumn, then the Russian for here.

You'll want to know: там

там (*tam*) — "there".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

там ← Old Russian тамо, Proto-Slavic **tamo* — inherited, built on the pronoun stem *t-* of тот, "that" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tam*
- *Say it: tam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tam*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for autumn, then the Russian for here, then say *tam* again

Before you move on

What does там mean? (“There”.) Say it once more.

72.3 далеко (dalekó) — far

Before the new one: say the Russian for here, then the Russian for there.

You’ll want to know: далеко

далеко (*dalekó*) — “far”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

далеко is далёкий, “distant”, made into an adverb with -о; it is built on даль, “the distance”, which Vasmer reports is usually linked with долгий, “long”, and Greek *dolichós*, “long”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dalekó*
- *Say it: dalekó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dalekó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for here, then the Russian for there, then say *dalekó* again

Before you move on

What does далеко mean? (“Far”.) Say it once more.

72.4 близко (blízko) — near, close by

Before the new one: say the Russian for there, then the Russian for far.

You'll want to know: близко

близко (*blízko*) — "near, close by".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

близко is близкий, "close", made into an adverb, from близ, "near", Proto-Slavic **blizъ̌*. Vasmer relates it to Latvian *blaîzît*, "to press", and Latin *flīgere*, "to strike", but also cites a Lithuanian alternative, so the deeper origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *blízko*
- *Say it:* *blízko*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blízko*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for there, then the Russian for far, then say *blízko* again

Before you move on

What does близко mean? ("Near, close by".) Say it once more.

72.5 наверху (naverkhú) — up above, upstairs

Before the new one: say the Russian for far, then the Russian for near.

You'll want to know: наверху

наверху (*naverkhú*) — "up above, upstairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наверху is на, "on", with верху, a form of верх, "the top": "on top".
верх ← Proto-Slavic **vьrxъ̌*, a cousin of Lithuanian *viršùs*, "top"

(Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naverkhú*
- *Say it: naverkhú*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naverkhú*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for far, then the Russian for near, then say *naverkhú* again

Before you move on

What does наверху mean? ("Up above, upstairs".) Say it once more.

Chapter 73

Below, Left, Right, A Lot, A Little

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say below, on the left, on the right, a lot and a little.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 73: I can say below, on the left, on the right, a lot and a little.*

73.1 внизу (vnizú) — below, downstairs

Before the new one: say the Russian for near, then the Russian for up above.

You'll want to know: внизу

внизу (*vnizú*) — "below, downstairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

внизу is в, "in", with низу, a form of низ, "the bottom". Vasmer explains низ as an extension of the PIE **ni*, "down", in Sanskrit *ni-*, "down", and Old High German *nidar*, "down": English *nether* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vnizú*
- *Say it: vnizú*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vnizú*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for near, then the Russian for up above, then say *vnizú* again

Before you move on

What does внизу mean? ("Below, downstairs".) Say it once more.

73.2 слева (sléva) — on the left

Before the new one: say the Russian for up above, then the Russian for below.

You'll want to know: слева

слева (*sléva*) — "on the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слева is с, "from", with лева, a form of левый, "left": "from the left". левый ← Proto-Slavic **lěvъ*, related to Latin *laevus* and Greek *laiós*, both "left" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sléva*
- *Say it: sléva*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sléva*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for up above, then the Russian for below, then say *sléva* again

Before you move on

What does слева mean? ("On the left".) Say it once more.

73.3 справа (správa) — on the right

Before the new one: say the Russian for below, then the Russian for on the left.

You'll want to know: справа

справа (*správa*) — "on the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

справа is с, "from", with права, a form of правый, "right", first "straight, righteous". Vasmer derives правый, probably, from **prō-vos*, "forward", related to Latin *probus*, "upright, good".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: správa*
- *Say it: správa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *správa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for below, then the Russian for on the left, then say *správa* again

Before you move on

What does справа mean? ("On the right".) Say it once more.

73.4 много (mnógo) — a lot, many

Before the new one: say the Russian for on the left, then the Russian for on the right.

You'll want to know: много

много (*mnógo*) — "a lot, many".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

много ← Proto-Slavic **mŭnogŭ*, "much, many" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Gothic *manags*, "many", and Old Irish *menicc*, "frequent", and finds no grounds for a Germanic loan: English *many* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mnógo*
- *Say it:* *mnógo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mnógo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for on the left, then the Russian for on the right, then say *mnógo* again

Before you move on

What does много mean? ("A lot, many".) Say it once more.

73.5 мало (málo) — a little, few

Before the new one: say the Russian for on the right, then the Russian for a lot.

You'll want to know: мало

мало (*málo*) — "a little, few".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мало is малый, "small", made into an adverb with -о. малый is a cousin, Vasmer says, of Gothic *smals*, "small", and so of English *small*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: málo*
- *Say it: málo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *málo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for on the right, then the Russian for a lot, then say *málo* again

Before you move on

What does мало mean? ("A little, few".) Say it once more.

Chapter 74

Always, Sometimes, Never, Now, Later

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say always, sometimes, never, now and later.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 74: I can say always, sometimes, never, now and later.

74.1 всегда (vsegdá) — always

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lot, then the Russian for a little.

You'll want to know: всегда

всегда (*vsegdá*) — "always".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

всегда is весь, "all", with -гда, the time ending of когда, "when", and тогда, "then". Lithuanian *visadà*, "always", matches the forms without г in other Slavic languages, such as Czech *vezdy*; Vasmer ties -гда itself to Lithuanian *kadà*, "when".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vsegdá*
- *Say it: vsegdá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vsegdá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lot, then the Russian for a little, then say *vsegdá* again

Before you move on

What does всегда mean? ("Always".) Say it once more.

74.2 иногда (inogdá) — sometimes

Before the new one: say the Russian for a little, then the Russian for always.

You'll want to know: иногда

иногда (*inogdá*) — "sometimes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

иногда is иной, "other", with the time ending -гда of когда, "when" (Vasmer); Old Russian иногда meant "once, at another time".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inogdá*
- *Say it: inogdá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inogdá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a little, then the Russian for always, then say *inogdá* again

Before you move on

What does иногда mean? (“Sometimes”.) Say it once more.

74.3 никогда (nikogdá) — never

Before the new one: say the Russian for always, then the Russian for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: никогда

никогда (*nikogdá*) — “never”. Built on когда, when.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

никогда is ни, “not even”, with когда, “when”: “at no time”. Its к- is the old question stem of кто, “who”. Vasmer sets ни beside Latin *nī* and Gothic *nei*, “not”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nikogdá*
- *Say it: nikogdá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nikogdá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for always, then the Russian for sometimes, then say *nikogdá* again

Before you move on

What does никогда mean? (“Never”.) Say it once more.

74.4 сейчас (seychás) — now, right now

Before the new one: say the Russian for sometimes, then the Russian for never.

You'll want to know: сейчас

сейчас (*seychás*) — "now, right now".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сейчас is сей, an old word for "this", with час, "hour": "this hour". Vasmer traces сей to an Indo-European pointing word kept in Lithuanian *šìs*, "this", and час to Proto-Slavic **časŭ*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: seychás*
- *Say it: seychás*, once more
- *Say it:* say *seychás*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sometimes, then the Russian for never, then say *seychás* again

Before you move on

What does сейчас mean? ("Now, right now".) Say it once more.

74.5 потом (potóm) — later, then

Before the new one: say the Russian for never, then the Russian for now.

You'll want to know: потом

потом (*potóm*) — "later, then".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

потом is по, "after", with том, a form of тот, "that": "after that". Vasmer traces тот to Proto-Slavic **tŭ*, kin to Lithuanian *tàs*, "that".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: potóm*
- *Say it: potóm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *potóm*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for never, then the Russian for now, then say *potóm* again

Before you move on

What does ПОТОМ mean? ("Later, then".) Say it once more.

Chapter 75

Already, Quickly, Eleven, Twelve, Zero

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say already and quickly, and count eleven, twelve and zero.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 75: I can say already and quickly, and count eleven, twelve and zero.*

75.1 уже (uzhé) — already

> Before the new one: say the Russian for now, then the Russian for later.

You'll want to know: уже

уже (*uzhé*) — "already".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

уже — Vasmer finds two old words fused in it: Proto-Slavic **ju*, "already", a cousin of Lithuanian *jaũ* and Gothic *ju*, "already", and a particle **u*; -же adds weight.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *uzhé*
- *Say it:* *uzhé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uzhé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for now, then the Russian for later, then say *uzhé* again

Before you move on

What does уже mean? ("Already".) Say it once more.

75.2 быстро (býstro) — quickly

Before the new one: say the Russian for later, then the Russian for already.

You'll want to know: быстро

быстро (*býstro*) — "quickly". The adverb of быстрый.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

быстро is быстрый, "fast", made into an adverb with -о. быстрый is an old Slavic word whose deeper origin is not settled (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *býstro*
- *Say it:* *býstro*, once more
- *Say it:* say *býstro*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for later, then the Russian for already, then say *býstro* again

Before you move on

What does быстро mean? (“Quickly”.) Say it once more.

75.3 одиннадцать (odínnadtsat) — eleven

Before the new one: say the Russian for already, then the Russian for quickly.

You’ll want to know: одиннадцать

одиннадцать (*odínnadtsat*) — “eleven”. “One on ten”: один + на + десять.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

одиннадцать is один на десять, “one on ten”, worn down: Old Russian одинадесять, from Proto-Slavic **jedinŭ na desęte* (Trubachev, in Vasmer). All the teens are built this way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: odínnadtsat*
- *Say it: odínnadtsat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *odínnadtsat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for already, then the Russian for quickly, then say *odínnadtsat* again

Before you move on

What does одиннадцать mean? (“Eleven”.) Say it once more.

75.4 двенадцать (dvenádtsat) — twelve

Before the new one: say the Russian for quickly, then the Russian for eleven.

You'll want to know: двенадцать

двенадцать (*dvenádtsat*) — "twelve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

двенадцать is две на десять, "two on ten", worn down from Old Russian *dŭvěnadesęte* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dvenádtsat*
- *Say it: dvenádtsat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dvenádtsat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for quickly, then the Russian for eleven, then say *dvenádtsat* again

Before you move on

What does двенадцать mean? ("Twelve".) Say it once more.

75.5 ноль (nol) — zero

Before the new one: say the Russian for eleven, then the Russian for twelve.

You'll want to know: ноль

ноль (*nol*) — "zero".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ноль, also нуль, probably came through German *Null* from Italian *nulla*, “nothing”, from Latin *nūllus*, “none” (Vasmer). The о may reflect the short German *u*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nol*
- *Say it:* *nol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for eleven, then the Russian for twelve, then say *nol* again

Before you move on

What does ноль mean? (“Zero”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 76

Forty, Fifty, Ninety, a Thousand, a Country

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can count forty, fifty, ninety and a thousand, and name a country.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 76: I can count forty, fifty, ninety and a thousand, and name a country.

76.1 сорок (sórok) — forty

Before the new one: say the Russian for twelve, then the Russian for zero.

You'll want to know: сорок

сорок (*sórok*) — "forty". The odd one out: not built from четыре.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сорок — origin disputed. Old Russian *sorokŭ* was also "a bundle of forty sable pelts". Vasmer finds difficulties with Greek *(te)ssarákonta*, "forty", and probably links it with сорочка, "shirt", after Old Norse *serkr*, "a shirt; a bundle of furs"; Trubachev thinks a Turkic source, like Turkish *kırk*, "forty", possible.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sórok*
- *Say it: sórok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sórok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for twelve, then the Russian for zero, then say *sórok* again

Before you move on

What does сорок mean? ("Forty".) Say it once more.

76.2 пятьдесят (pyatdesyát) — fifty

Before the new one: say the Russian for zero, then the Russian for forty.

You'll want to know: пятьдесят

пятьдесят (*pyatdesyát*) — "fifty". пять + десять.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пятьдесят is пять, "five", with десят, an old form of десять, "ten": five tens. Both are inherited: Proto-Slavic **pętĭ*, kin to Greek *pénte*, and **desętĭ* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyatdesyát*
- *Say it: pyatdesyát*, once more

- *Say it:* say *pyatdesyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for zero, then the Russian for forty, then say *pyatdesyát* again

Before you move on

What does пятьдесят mean? (“Fifty”.) Say it once more.

76.3 девяносто (devyanósto) — ninety

Before the new one: say the Russian for forty, then the Russian for fifty.

You’ll want to know: девяносто

девяносто (*devyanósto*) — “ninety”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

девяносто is found only in East Slavic, from 1398 on; other Slavic languages say “nine tens”. Vasmer thinks it probably continues an old Indo-European “ninth ten”, like Latin *nōnāgintā*, “ninety”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: devyanósto*
- *Say it: devyanósto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *devyanósto*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for forty, then the Russian for fifty, then say *devyanósto* again

Before you move on

What does девяносто mean? (“Ninety”.) Say it once more.

76.4 тысяча (týsyacha) — a thousand

Before the new one: say the Russian for fifty, then the Russian for ninety.

You'll want to know: тысяча

тысяча (*týsyacha*) — "a thousand".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тысяча ← Proto-Slavic **tysęti* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *tūkstantis* and Gothic *þūsundi*, "thousand" (Vasmer): English *thousand* is a cousin. One proposal Vasmer reports reads it as "a swollen hundred".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: týsyacha*
- *Say it: týsyacha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *týsyacha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fifty, then the Russian for ninety, then say *týsyacha* again

Before you move on

What does тысяча mean? ("A thousand".) Say it once more.

76.5 страна (straná) — a country

Before the new one: say the Russian for ninety, then the Russian for a thousand.

You'll want to know: страна

страна (*straná*) — "a country".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

страна — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of native сторона, "side": -ра- against -оро-. A country was first a side, a region.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: straná*
- *Say it: straná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *straná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ninety, then the Russian for a thousand, then say *straná* again

Before you move on

What does страна mean? ("A country".) Say it once more.

Chapter 77

City, Street, Shop, Market, School

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a city, a street, a shop, a market and a school.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 77: I can name a city, a street, a shop, a market and a school.*

77.1 город (górod) — a city, a town

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a thousand, then the Russian for a country.

You'll want to know: город

город (*górod*) — "a city, a town".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

город ← Proto-Slavic **gordŭ*, "an enclosure, a fort" — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *gardas*, "a fold", Gothic *gards*, "house", and Sanskrit *gṛhá-*, "house": English *yard* is a cousin. Church Slavonic has град, "city", as in Петроград, "Peter's city".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: górod*
- *Say it: górod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *górod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a thousand, then the Russian for a country, then say *górod* again

Before you move on

What does город mean? ("A city, a town".) Say it once more.

77.2 улица (úlitsa) — a street

Before the new one: say the Russian for a country, then the Russian for a city.

You'll want to know: улица

улица (*úlitsa*) — "a street".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

улица ← Proto-Slavic **ulica*, built on **ula*, "a hollow, a channel" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to улей, "beehive", and Greek *aulós*, "pipe", *aulṓn*, "glen": a street as a passage between houses.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: úlitsa*
- *Say it: úlitsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úlitsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a country, then the Russian for a city, then say *úlitsa* again

Before you move on

What does улица mean? (“A street”.) Say it once more.

77.3 магазин (magazín) — a shop

Before the new one: say the Russian for a city, then the Russian for a street.

You’ll want to know: магазин

магазин (*magazín*) — “a shop”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

магазин — first in Peter the Great’s time; it came through German *Magasin* from French *magasin*, “a storehouse” (Vasmer). The French word goes back, through Italian, to Arabic *makhāzin*, “storehouses”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: magazín*
- *Say it: magazín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *magazín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a city, then the Russian for a street, then say *magazín* again

Before you move on

What does магазин mean? (“A shop”.) Say it once more.

77.4 рынок (rýnok) — a market

Before the new one: say the Russian for a street, then the Russian for a shop.

You'll want to know: рынок

рынок (*rýnok*) — "a market".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рынок came through Polish *rynek* and Czech *rynk*, "town square", from Middle High German *rinc*, "a ring, a square" (Vasmer): the market sat in the ring of the square. German *Ring* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rýnok*
- *Say it: rýnok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rýnok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a street, then the Russian for a shop, then say *rýnok* again

Before you move on

What does рынок mean? ("A market".) Say it once more.

77.5 школа (shkóla) — a school

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shop, then the Russian for a market.

You'll want to know: школа

школа (*shkóla*) — "a school". Where the учитель and the ученик meet.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

школа — recorded from 1388; it came through Polish *szkoła* from Latin *schola*, from Greek *scholḗ*, "leisure", then "lecture, school" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shkóla*
- *Say it: shkóla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shkóla*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shop, then the Russian for a market, then say *shkóla* again

Before you move on

What does школа mean? ("A school".) Say it once more.

Chapter 78

Bank, Station, Museum, Theatre, Restaurant

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a bank, a station, a museum, a theatre and a restaurant.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 78: I can name a bank, a station, a museum, a theatre and a restaurant.

78.1 банк (bank) — a bank

Before the new one: say the Russian for a market, then the Russian for a school.

You'll want to know: банк

банк (*bank*) — "a bank".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

банк — recorded from 1707; it came through German *Bank* from Italian *banco*, "a money-changer's table", then "a bank" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bank*
- *Say it:* *bank*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bank*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a market, then the Russian for a school, then say *bank* again

Before you move on

What does банк mean? ("A bank".) Say it once more.

78.2 вокзал (vokzál) — a railway station

Before the new one: say the Russian for a school, then the Russian for a bank.

You'll want to know: вокзал

вокзал (*vokzál*) — "a railway station". From Vauxhall, in London.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вокзал — first фоксал, in 1777, a pleasure hall; Vasmer takes it from English *Vauxhall*, a London pleasure garden. The station at Pavlovsk had such a hall with concerts, and the name passed to stations. Trubachev's note gives another account of the English name.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vokzál*
- *Say it:* *vokzál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vokzál*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a school, then the Russian for a bank, then say *vokzál* again

Before you move on

What does вокзал mean? ("A railway station".) Say it once more.

78.3 музей (muzéy) — a museum

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bank, then the Russian for a railway station.

You'll want to know: музей

музей (*muzéy*) — "a museum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

музей came from Polish *muzeum* or German *Museum*, from Latin *mūsēum*, Greek *mouseîon*, "a place of the Muses, a school with a library" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muzéy*
- *Say it: muzéy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muzéy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bank, then the Russian for a railway station, then say *muzéy* again

Before you move on

What does музей mean? ("A museum".) Say it once more.

78.4 театр (teátr) — a theatre

Before the new one: say the Russian for a railway station, then the Russian for a museum.

You'll want to know: театр

театр (*teátr*) — "a theatre".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

театр — from Peter the Great's time; it came through French *théâtre* from Latin *theātrum*, Greek *théatron*, "a place for seeing", or straight from the Greek (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teátr*
- *Say it: teátr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *teátr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a railway station, then the Russian for a museum, then say *teátr* again

Before you move on

What does театр mean? ("A theatre".) Say it once more.

78.5 ресторан (restorán) — a restaurant

Before the new one: say the Russian for a museum, then the Russian for a theatre.

You'll want to know: ресторан

ресторан (*restorán*) — "a restaurant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ресторан comes from French *restaurant*, "restoring", from *restaurer*, "to restore, to refresh", directly or through German *Restaurant* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: restorán*
- *Say it: restorán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *restorán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a museum, then the Russian for a theatre, then say *restorán* again

Before you move on

What does ресторан mean? ("A restaurant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 79

Bus, Train, Plane, Car, Bridge

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a bus, a train, a plane, a car and a bridge.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 79: I can name a bus, a train, a plane, a car and a bridge.*

79.1 автобус (avtóbus) — a bus

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a theatre, then the Russian for a restaurant.

You'll want to know: автобус

автобус (*avtóbus*) — "a bus".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

автобус is an international word of the early 1900s: авто-, from Greek *autós*, "self", as in *automobile*, with бус, cut from Latin *omnibus*, "for everyone".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: avtóbus*
- *Say it: avtóbus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *avtóbus*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a theatre, then the Russian for a restaurant, then say *avtóbus* again

Before you move on

What does автобус mean? ("A bus".) Say it once more.

79.2 поезд (póyezd) — a train

Before the new one: say the Russian for a restaurant, then the Russian for a bus.

You'll want to know: поезд

поезд (*póyezd*) — "a train".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поезд is по- with езд, from ездить, "to ride, to travel", and езда, "a ride" (Vasmer). It first meant "a journey", then "a procession of carriages", then a train.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: póyezd*
- *Say it: póyezd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *póyezd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a restaurant, then the Russian for a bus, then say *póyezd* again

Before you move on

What does поезд mean? ("A train".) Say it once more.

79.3 самолёт (samolyót) — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bus, then the Russian for a train.

You'll want to know: самолёт

самолёт (*samolyót*) — "an aeroplane". "Self-flier".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

самолёт is сам, "self", with -лёт, "flight", from летать, "to fly": "a self-flier". The fairy-tale flying carpet is the ковёр-самолёт, "carpet-plane".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samolyót*
- *Say it: samolyót*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samolyót*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bus, then the Russian for a train, then say *samolyót* again

Before you move on

What does самолёт mean? ("An aeroplane".) Say it once more.

79.4 машина (mashína) — a car

Before the new one: say the Russian for a train, then the Russian for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: машина

машина (*mashína*) — "a car".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

машина — from Peter the Great's time; it came through German *Maschine* from French *machine*, Latin *māchina*, "a device" (Vasmer). The sense "car" is modern.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mashína*
- *Say it:* *mashína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mashína*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a train, then the Russian for an aeroplane, then say *mashína* again

Before you move on

What does машина mean? ("A car".) Say it once more.

79.5 мост (most) — a bridge

Before the new one: say the Russian for an aeroplane, then the Russian for a car.

You'll want to know: мост

мост (*most*) — "a bridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мост ← Proto-Slavic **mostŭ*, "bridge; a plank floor" — inherited. Vasmer finds a Germanic source unreliable but compares Old High German *mast*, "a pole", so the deeper origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: most*
- *Say it: most*, once more
- *Say it:* say *most*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an aeroplane, then the Russian for a car, then say *most* again

Before you move on

What does MOCT mean? ("A bridge".) Say it once more.

Chapter 80

Hotel, Pharmacy, Church, Park, Taxi

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name a hotel, a pharmacy, a church, a park and a taxi.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 80: I can name a hotel, a pharmacy, a church, a park and a taxi.

80.1 гостиница (gostínitsa) — a hotel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a car, then the Russian for a bridge.

You'll want to know: гостиница

гостиница (*gostínitsa*) — "a hotel". Built on гость, guest.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гостиница is built on гость, "a guest", with -ница, a place: a house for guests. Old Russian гость also meant "a travelling merchant" (Vasmer), as in Гостиный двор, "the merchants' arcade".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gostínitsa*
- *Say it: gostínitsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gostínitsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a car, then the Russian for a bridge, then say *gostínitsa* again

Before you move on

What does гостиница mean? ("A hotel".) Say it once more.

80.2 аптека (aptéka) — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bridge, then the Russian for a hotel.

You'll want to know: аптека

аптека (*aptéka*) — "a pharmacy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

аптека — from Peter the Great's time, also оптека in the 1600s; it came from German *Apotheke* or Baltic German *aptheke*, from Latin *apothēca*, Greek *apothḗkē*, "a storehouse" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aptéka*
- *Say it: aptéka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aptéka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bridge, then the Russian for a hotel, then say *aptéka* again

Before you move on

What does аптека mean? (“A pharmacy”.) Say it once more.

80.3 церковь (tsérkov) — a church

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hotel, then the Russian for a pharmacy.

You’ll want to know: церковь

церковь (*tsérkov*) — “a church”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

церковь ← Old Russian цьркы. Its source is sought in a Gothic **kirikô* or an Old Bavarian *kirkô*, “church”, and the Germanic word comes from Greek *kyriakón*, “the Lord’s (house)” (Vasmer). German *Kirche* and English *church* come from the same Greek word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsérkov*
- *Say it: tsérkov*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsérkov*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hotel, then the Russian for a pharmacy, then say *tsérkov* again

Before you move on

What does церковь mean? (“A church”.) Say it once more.

80.4 парк (park) — a park

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pharmacy, then the Russian for a church.

You'll want to know: парк

парк (*park*) — "a park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

парк came through German *Park* or English *park* from French *parc*, Medieval Latin *parricus*, "an enclosure, a pen" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: park*
- *Say it: park*, once more
- *Say it:* say *park*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pharmacy, then the Russian for a church, then say *park* again

Before you move on

What does парк mean? ("A park".) Say it once more.

80.5 такси (taksí) — a taxi

Before the new one: say the Russian for a church, then the Russian for a park.

You'll want to know: такси

такси (*taksí*) — "a taxi".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

такси comes from French *taxi*, short for *taximètre*, "a fare meter": *taxe*, "a charge", with *mètre*, "measure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: taksí*
- *Say it: taksí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *taksí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a church, then the Russian for a park, then say *taksí* again

Before you move on

What does такси mean? ("A taxi".) Say it once more.

80.6 Nature, animals and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for a park and a taxi.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a tree, a flower, a leaf; a sheet of paper, grass, a village
- a mountain, a forest, a river, a lake, the sea
- a stone, sand, a shore, an island, a field
- the sky, the sun, the moon, a star, a cloud
- rain, snow, the wind, the weather, the world; peace

- a dog, a cat, a horse, a cow, a pig
- a bird, a mouse, a wolf, a bear, a fox
- a hare, a snake, a hen, a duck, a goat
- white, black, red, blue, green
- yellow, beautiful, good, bad, new
- big, small, old, long, short
- hot, cold, warm, fast, slow
- light; easy, hard, expensive; dear, cheap, badly

Before you move on

A tree? (дерево.) A flower? (цветок.) A leaf; a sheet of paper? (лист.) Grass? (трава.) A village? (деревня.) A mountain? (гора.) A forest? (лес.) A river? (река.) A lake? (озеро.) The sea? (море.) A stone? (камень.) Sand? (песок.) A shore? (берег.) An island? (остров.) A field? (поле.) The sky? (небо.) The sun? (солнце.) The moon? (луна.) A star? (звезда.) A cloud? (облако.) Rain? (дождь.) Snow? (снег.) The wind? (ветер.) The weather? (погода.) The world; peace? (мир.) A dog? (собака.) A cat? (кошка.) A horse? (лошадь.) A cow? (корова.) A pig? (свинья.) A bird? (птица.) A mouse? (мышь.) A wolf? (волк.) A bear? (медведь.) A fox? (лиса.) A hare? (заяц.) A snake? (змея.) A hen? (курица.) A duck? (утка.) A goat? (коза.) White? (белый.) Black? (чёрный.) Red? (красный.) Blue? (синий.) Green? (зелёный.) Yellow? (жёлтый.) Beautiful? (красивый.) Good? (хороший.) Bad? (плохой.) New? (новый.) Big? (большой.) Small? (маленький.) Old? (старый.) Long? (длинный.) Short? (короткий.) Hot? (горячий.) Cold? (холодный.) Warm? (тёплый.) Fast? (быстрый.) Slow? (медленный.) Light; easy? (лёгкий.) Hard? (трудный.) Expensive; dear? (дорогой.) Cheap? (дешёвый.) Badly? (плохо.)

80.7 Time, place, numbers and the town — a second pass

Say the words for a day and a week.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a day, a week, a month, a year, the evening
- today, yesterday, an hour, a minute, time
- Monday, Wednesday, Thursday, Friday, Saturday
- Sunday, winter, spring, summer, autumn
- here, there, far, near, up above
- below, on the left, on the right, a lot, a little
- always, sometimes, never, now, later
- already, quickly, eleven, twelve, zero
- forty, fifty, ninety, a thousand, a country
- a city, a street, a shop, a market, a school
- a bank, a railway station, a museum, a theatre, a restaurant
- a bus, a train, an aeroplane, a car, a bridge
- a hotel, a pharmacy, a church, a park, a taxi

Before you move on

A day? (день.) A week? (неделя.) A month? (месяц.) A year? (год.) The evening? (вечер.) Today? (сегодня.) Yesterday? (вчера.) An hour? (час.) A minute? (минута.) Time? (время.) Monday? (понедельник.) Wednesday? (среда.) Thursday? (четверг.) Friday? (пятница.) Saturday? (суббота.) Sunday? (воскресенье.) Winter? (зима.) Spring? (весна.) Summer? (лето.) Autumn? (осень.) Here? (здесь.) There? (там.) Far?

(далеко.) Near? (близко.) Up above? (наверху.) Below? (внизу.) On the left? (слева.) On the right? (справа.) A lot? (много.) A little? (мало.) Always? (всегда.) Sometimes? (иногда.) Never? (никогда.) Now? (сейчас.) Later? (потом.) Already? (уже.) Quickly? (быстро.) Eleven? (одиннадцать.) Twelve? (двенадцать.) Zero? (ноль.) Forty? (сорок.) Fifty? (пятьдесят.) Ninety? (девяносто.) A thousand? (тысяча.) A country? (страна.) A city? (город.) A street? (улица.) A shop? (магазин.) A market? (рынок.) A school? (школа.) A bank? (банк.) A railway station? (вокзал.) A museum? (музей.) A theatre? (театр.) A restaurant? (ресторан.) A bus? (автобус.) A train? (поезд.) An aeroplane? (самолёт.) A car? (машина.) A bridge? (мост.) A hotel? (гостиница.) A pharmacy? (аптека.) A church? (церковь.) A park? (парк.) A taxi? (такси.)

Chapter 81

The Letter Yo

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (2) ✓ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write yo, the letter with two dots, and find it in words I already say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 81: I can write yo, the letter with two dots, and find it in words I already say.*

81.1 ё (yo) — the yo inside ребёнок

Before the new one: write я and ю once each, and name them.

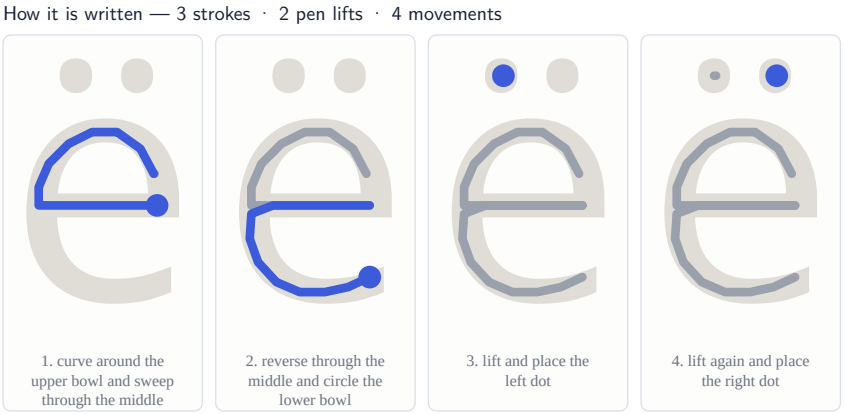
Now say ребёнок (*rebyónok*), "a child". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: ё

ё — *yo*.

It is inside ребёнок (*rebyónok*), "a child", and in мёд, чёрный and тёплый. It is е with **two dots** above it, and the syllable that carries it takes the stress. Many printed texts leave the dots off; this book keeps them, so you can see how the word is said.

Writing: ё



How ё *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ё yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start this letter and which way to travel**, in one attested order, and names its source beneath it. Teachers vary, so treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ребёнок and point at ё inside it
- *Trace it:* ё three times, saying *yo* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ю, then ё, from memory
- *Read it:* ребёнок aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ё? (**yo**, *yo*.) Which word did it come from? (ребёнок, *rebyónok*, "a child".)

81.2 (one letter) — From the letter to the word — a first pass

Say ребёнок (*rebyónok*), then write the letter it gave you.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
ё	*yo*	ребёнок *rebyónok*

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from
- *Read it:* each word in the table aloud, and point at its letter

Before you move on

Which word did each letter come from? (ё from ребёнок.)

81.3 (one letter) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Write ё without looking, then say the word it came from.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
ё	*yo*	ребёнок *rebyónok*

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* each letter once more, slowly, larger than it is printed

Before you move on

Say each word in the table once more, and name the letter you took from it.

Chapter 82

This, This, That, That, Such

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say this, this, that, that and such.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 82: I can say this, this, that, that and such.*

82.1 ЭТОТ (étot) — this (masculine)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a park, then the Russian for a taxi.

You'll want to know: ЭТОТ

ЭТОТ (*étot*) — "this (masculine)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ЭТОТ is the pointing sound Э, "look", with ТОТ, "that" (Vasmer); examples date from the 1500s.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *étot*
- *Say it:* *étot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *étot*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a park, then the Russian for a taxi, then say *étot* again

Before you move on

What does этот mean? ("This (masculine)".) Say it once more.

82.2 эта (éta) — this (feminine)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a taxi, then the Russian for this.

You'll want to know: эта

эта (*éta*) — "this (feminine)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

эта is the feminine of этот: the pointing э with та, the feminine of тот, "that" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *éta*
- *Say it:* *éta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *éta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a taxi, then the Russian for this, then say *éta* again

Before you move on

What does эта mean? (“This (feminine)”.) Say it once more.

82.3 тот (tot) — that (masculine)

Before the new one: say the Russian for this, then the Russian for this.

You’ll want to know: тот

тот (*tot*) — “that (masculine)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тот ← Proto-Slavic **tŭ*, **ta*, **to*, “that” — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *tàs*, Sanskrit *ta-*, Greek *tó* and Gothic *þata*: English *that* and *the* are cousins.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tot*
- *Say it: tot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tot*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for this, then the Russian for this, then say *tot* again

Before you move on

What does тот mean? (“That (masculine)”.) Say it once more.

82.4 та (ta) — that (feminine)

Before the new one: say the Russian for this, then the Russian for that.

You'll want to know: та

та (*ta*) — "that (feminine)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

та is the feminine of тот, Proto-Slavic **ta*, a cousin of Lithuanian *tà*, "that" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ta*
- *Say it: ta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for this, then the Russian for that, then say *ta* again

Before you move on

What does та mean? ("That (feminine)".) Say it once more.

82.5 такой (takóy) — such, like this

Before the new one: say the Russian for that, then the Russian for that.

You'll want to know: такой

такой (*takóy*) — "such, like this".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

такой is так, "so, thus", with an adjective ending, Proto-Slavic **takŭjĭ*; Vasmer compares Lithuanian *tóks*, "such". It is built as какой, "which", is.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: takóy*
- *Say it: takóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *takóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for that, then the Russian for that, then say *takóy* again

Before you move on

What does такой mean? ("Such, like this".) Say it once more.

Chapter 83

Midday, Midnight, Early, Late, In the morning

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say midday, midnight, early, late and in the morning.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 83: I can say midday, midnight, early, late and in the morning.*

83.1 полдень (pólden) — midday

> Before the new one: say the Russian for that, then the Russian for such.

You'll want to know: полдень

полдень (*pólden*) — "midday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полдень is пол-, "half", with день, "day": the middle of the day. Vasmer relates день to Lithuanian *dienà*, "day", and thinks пол- probably kin to Albanian *palë*, "side".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pólden*
- *Say it: pólden*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pólden*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for that, then the Russian for such, then say *pólden* again

Before you move on

What does полдень mean? (“Midday”.) Say it once more.

83.2 полночь (pólnoch) — midnight

Before the new one: say the Russian for such, then the Russian for midday.

You’ll want to know: полночь

полночь (*pólnoch*) — “midnight”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полночь is пол-, “half”, with ночь, “night”. ночь ← Proto-Slavic **noťь*, a cousin of Lithuanian *naktìs*, Latin *nox* and English *night* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pólnoch*
- *Say it: pólnoch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pólnoch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for such, then the Russian for midday, then say *pólnoch* again

Before you move on

What does полночь mean? (“Midnight”.) Say it once more.

83.3 рано (ráno) — early

Before the new one: say the Russian for midday, then the Russian for midnight.

You’ll want to know: рано

рано (*ráno*) — “early”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рано ← Proto-Slavic **rano*, “early” — inherited, but Vasmer calls it hard to explain: some link it with Lithuanian *rýtas*, “morning”, others with Greek *órthros*, “dawn”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ráno*
- *Say it: ráno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ráno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for midday, then the Russian for midnight, then say *ráno* again

Before you move on

What does рано mean? (“Early”.) Say it once more.

83.4 поздно (pózdno) — late

Before the new one: say the Russian for midnight, then the Russian for early.

You'll want to know: поздно

поздно (*pózdno*) — "late".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поздно is the adverb of поздний, "late", Proto-Slavic **pozdŭ* — inherited, from the PIE **pos*, "after, behind", which Vasmer also finds in Lithuanian *pàs*, "at", and Latin *post*, "after".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pózdno*
- *Say it: pózdno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pózdno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for midnight, then the Russian for early, then say *pózdno* again

Before you move on

What does поздно mean? ("Late".) Say it once more.

83.5 утром (útrom) — in the morning

Before the new one: say the Russian for early, then the Russian for late.

You'll want to know: утром

утром (*útrom*) — "in the morning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

утром is утро, "morning", in the form that says "by, during": "in the morning". утро ← Proto-Slavic **jutro*; Vasmer calls its origin difficult, with links to уже, "already", or to Latin *iugum*, "yoke", as "the time

of yoking".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *útrom*
- *Say it:* *útrom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *útrom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for early, then the Russian for late, then say *útrom* again

Before you move on

What does утром mean? ("In the morning".) Say it once more.

Chapter 84

In the daytime, In the evening, At night, Day after tomorrow, Day before yesterday

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say in the daytime, in the evening, at night, the day after tomorrow and the day before yesterday.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 84: I can say in the daytime, in the evening, at night, the day after tomorrow and the day before yesterday.*

84.1 днём (dnyom) — in the daytime

> Before the new one: say the Russian for late, then the Russian for in the morning.

You'll want to know: днём

днём (*dnyom*) — "in the daytime".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

днём is день, "day", in the form that says "by, during": "in the daytime". день is a cousin of Latin *diēs*, "day" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dnyom*
- *Say it: dnyom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dnyom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for late, then the Russian for in the morning, then say *dnyom* again

Before you move on

What does днём mean? ("In the daytime".) Say it once more.

84.2 вечером (vécherom) — in the evening

Before the new one: say the Russian for in the morning, then the Russian for in the daytime.

You'll want to know: вечером

вечером (*vécherom*) — "in the evening".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вечером is вечер, "evening", in the form that says "by, during": "in the evening". вечер is a cousin of Lithuanian *vãkaras*, "evening" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vécherom*
- *Say it: vécherom*, once more

- *Say it:* say *vécherom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for in the morning, then the Russian for in the daytime, then say *vécherom* again

Before you move on

What does вечером mean? ("In the evening".) Say it once more.

84.3 ночью (nóchyu) — at night

Before the new one: say the Russian for in the daytime, then the Russian for in the evening.

You'll want to know: ночью

ночью (*nóchyu*) — "at night".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ночью is ночь, "night", in the form that says "by, during": "at night". ночь is a cousin of Latin *nox* and English *night* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nóchyu*
- *Say it: nóchyu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nóchyu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for in the daytime, then the Russian for in the evening, then say *nóchyu* again

Before you move on

What does ночью mean? ("At night".) Say it once more.

84.4 послезавтра (poslezávtra) — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: say the Russian for in the evening, then the Russian for at night.

You'll want to know: послезавтра

послезавтра (*poslezávtra*) — "the day after tomorrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

послезавтра is после, "after", with завтра, "tomorrow", itself за, "after", with утро, "morning". Where утро comes from is uncertain (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poslezávtra*
- *Say it: poslezávtra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poslezávtra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for in the evening, then the Russian for at night, then say *poslezávtra* again

Before you move on

What does послезавтра mean? ("The day after tomorrow".) Say it once more.

84.5 позавчера (pozavcherá) — the day before yesterday

Before the new one: say the Russian for at night, then the Russian for the day after tomorrow.

You'll want to know: позавчера

позавчера (*pozavcherá*) — "the day before yesterday".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

позавчера is по- with за, "beyond", and вчера, "yesterday": the day on the far side of yesterday. вчера comes from вечер, "evening" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pozavcherá*
- *Say it: pozavcherá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pozavcherá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for at night, then the Russian for the day after tomorrow, then say *pozavcherá* again

Before you move on

What does позавчера mean? ("The day before yesterday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 85

Second, Weekend, Date, Century, Often

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a second, the weekend, a date, a century and often.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 85: I can say a second, the weekend, a date, a century and often.

85.1 секунда (sekúnda) — a second

Before the new one: say the Russian for the day after tomorrow, then the Russian for the day before yesterday.

You'll want to know: секунда

секунда (*sekúnda*) — "a second".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

секунда probably came through German *Sekunde* from Latin *(pars minūta) secunda*, "the second small part" of an hour, after Ptolemy's counting in sixties (Vasmer). The first small part is the минута, "minute".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sekúnda*
- *Say it: sekúnda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sekúnda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the day after tomorrow, then the Russian for the day before yesterday, then say *sekúnda* again

Before you move on

What does секунда mean? ("A second".) Say it once more.

85.2 выходные (vykhodnýye) — the weekend

Before the new one: say the Russian for the day before yesterday, then the Russian for a second.

You'll want to know: выходные

выходные (*vykhodnýye*) — "the weekend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выходные is short for выходные дни, "days for going out", from выход, "a way out": вы-, "out", with ход, "a going", the root of ходить, "to walk".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vykhodnýye*
- *Say it: vykhodnýye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vykhodnýye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the day before yesterday, then the Russian for a second, then say *vykhodnýye* again

Before you move on

What does выходные mean? ("The weekend".) Say it once more.

85.3 дата (dáta) — a date

Before the new one: say the Russian for a second, then the Russian for the weekend.

A date needs an ordinal: say первый, второй, третий. *Write it:* the first as a sign writes it, *1*-й

You'll want to know: дата

дата (*dáta*) — "a date".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дата comes from Latin *data*, "given", the word that began the dating line of letters, as in *data Rōmae*, "given at Rome"; German *Datum* has the same source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dáta*
- *Say it: dáta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dáta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a second, then the Russian for the weekend, then say *dáta* again

Before you move on

What does дата mean? ("A date".) Say it once more.

85.4 век (vek) — a century

Before the new one: say the Russian for the weekend, then the Russian for a date.

You'll want to know: век

век (*vek*) — "a century".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

век ← Proto-Slavic **věkŭ* — inherited; first "strength, a lifetime", then "an age", then "a century". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *viẽkas*, "strength, life", and Gothic *weihan*, "to fight".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vek*
- *Say it: vek*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vek*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the weekend, then the Russian for a date, then say *vek* again

Before you move on

What does век mean? ("A century".) Say it once more.

85.5 часто (chásto) — often

Before the new one: say the Russian for a date, then the Russian for a century.

You'll want to know: часто

часто (*chásto*) — "often".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

часто is частый, “dense, frequent”, made into an adverb with -о. частый ← Proto-Slavic **čęstŭ*, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *kimštas*, “stuffed full”: often is “thickly”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chásto*
- *Say it: chásto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chásto*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a date, then the Russian for a century, then say *chásto* again

Before you move on

What does часто mean? (“Often”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 86

Where, Where to, Where from, To the right, To the left

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where, where to, where from, to the right and to the left.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 86: I can say where, where to, where from, to the right and to the left.*

86.1 где (gde) — where

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a century, then the Russian for often.

You'll want to know: где

где (*gde*) — "where".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

где ← Old Russian *kŭde*, Proto-Slavic **kŭde* — inherited, on the old question stem **k^{w}-* of кто, "who". Vasmer lists Sanskrit *kúha*, Avestan *kudā* and Lithuanian *kur*, all "where".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gde*
- *Say it: gde*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gde*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a century, then the Russian for often, then say *gde* again

Before you move on

What does где mean? ("Where".) Say it once more.

86.2 куда (kudá) — where to

Before the new one: say the Russian for often, then the Russian for where.

You'll want to know: куда

куда (*kudá*) — "where to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

куда ← Proto-Slavic **kǫdu* — inherited, on the question stem of кто, "who" (Vasmer). Vasmer compares Old Prussian *isquendau*, "from where", and Latin *quandō*, "when".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kudá*
- *Say it: kudá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kudá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for often, then the Russian for where, then say *kudá* again

Before you move on

What does куда mean? (“Where to”.) Say it once more.

86.3 откуда (otkúda) — where from

Before the new one: say the Russian for where, then the Russian for where to.

You’ll want to know: откуда

откуда (*otkúda*) — “where from”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

откуда is от, “from”, with куда, “where to” (Vasmer): “from where”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otkúda*
- *Say it: otkúda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otkúda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for where, then the Russian for where to, then say *otkúda* again

Before you move on

What does откуда mean? (“Where from”.) Say it once more.

86.4 направо (napravo) — to the right

Before the new one: say the Russian for where to, then the Russian for where from.

You'll want to know: направо

направо (*napravo*) — "to the right".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

направо is на, "onto", with право, from правый, "right", first "straight" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: napravo*
- *Say it: napravo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *napravo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for where to, then the Russian for where from, then say *napravo* again

Before you move on

What does направо mean? ("To the right".) Say it once more.

86.5 налево (nalévo) — to the left

Before the new one: say the Russian for where from, then the Russian for to the right.

You'll want to know: налево

налево (*nalévo*) — "to the left".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

налево is на, "onto", with лево, from левый, "left", a cousin of Latin *laevus*, "left" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nalévo*
- *Say it: nalévo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nalévo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for where from, then the Russian for to the right, then say *nalévo* again

Before you move on

What does налево mean? ("To the left".) Say it once more.

Chapter 87

Straight on, Nearby, Airport, Stop, Square

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say straight on, nearby, an airport, a stop and a square.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 87: I can say straight on, nearby, an airport, a stop and a square.*

87.1 прямо (prýamo) — straight on

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to the right, then the Russian for to the left.

You'll want to know: прямо

прямо (*prýamo*) — "straight on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

прямо is прямой, "straight", made into an adverb. Vasmer calls the Proto-Slavic form disputed but thinks of a link with Greek *prómos*, "foremost", and Old Norse *framr*, "forward".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prýamo*
- *Say it: prýamo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prýamo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to the right, then the Russian for to the left, then say *prýamo* again

Before you move on

What does прямо mean? ("Straight on".) Say it once more.

87.2 рядом (ryádom) — nearby, next to

Before the new one: say the Russian for to the left, then the Russian for straight on.

You'll want to know: рядом

рядом (*ryádom*) — "nearby, next to".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рядом is ряд, "a row", in the form that says "by, with": "in the same row", side by side. Vasmer relates ряд to Lithuanian *rinda*, "a row, a line".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ryádom*
- *Say it: ryádom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ryádom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to the left, then the Russian for straight on, then say *ryádom* again

Before you move on

What does рядом mean? ("Nearby, next to".) Say it once more.

87.3 аэропорт (aeropórt) — an airport

Before the new one: say the Russian for straight on, then the Russian for nearby.

You'll want to know: аэропорт

аэропорт (*aeropórt*) — "an airport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

аэропорт comes from French *aéroport*: *aéro-*, from Greek *aḗr*, "air", with *port*, from Latin *portus*, "harbour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aeropórt*
- *Say it: aeropórt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aeropórt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for straight on, then the Russian for nearby, then say *aeropórt* again

Before you move on

What does аэропорт mean? ("An airport".) Say it once more.

87.4 остановка (ostanóvka) — a stop (bus, tram)

Before the new one: say the Russian for nearby, then the Russian for an airport.

You'll want to know: остановка

остановка (*ostanóvka*) — "a stop (bus, tram)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

остановка is остановить, "to stop", with the noun ending -ка. The verb is о- with -становить, from стать, "to stand", a cousin of Latin *stāre*, "to stand" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ostanóvka*
- *Say it: ostanóvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ostanóvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nearby, then the Russian for an airport, then say *ostanóvka* again

Before you move on

What does остановка mean? ("A stop (bus, tram)".) Say it once more.

87.5 площадь (plóshchad) — a square

Before the new one: say the Russian for an airport, then the Russian for a stop.

You'll want to know: площадь

площадь (*plóshchad*) — "a square".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

площадь — Old Russian and Church Slavonic площадь, from **ploskědĭ*, built on плоский, "flat" (Vasmer): a square is a flat open

place. The -щ- grew from *-sk-* before *ě*, a change shared by all Slavic, so it is no sign of Church Slavonic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plóshchad*
- *Say it: plóshchad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plóshchad*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an airport, then the Russian for a stop, then say *plóshchad* again

Before you move on

What does площадь mean? ("A square".) Say it once more.

Chapter 88

Post office, Cinema, Supermarket, Swimming pool, Stadium

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a post office, a cinema, a supermarket, a swimming pool and a stadium.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 88: I can say a post office, a cinema, a supermarket, a swimming pool and a stadium.

88.1 почта (póchta) — a post office

Before the new one: say the Russian for a stop, then the Russian for a square.

You'll want to know: почта

почта (*póchta*) — "a post office".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

почта — recorded from 1669; it came through Polish *poczta* from Italian *posta*, from Latin *posita*, "placed", for the horses placed at relay stations (Vasmer). German *Post* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: póchta*
- *Say it: póchta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *póchta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a stop, then the Russian for a square, then say *póchta* again

Before you move on

What does почта mean? ("A post office".) Say it once more.

88.2 кино (kinó) — a cinema

Before the new one: say the Russian for a square, then the Russian for a post office.

You'll want to know: кино

кино (*kinó*) — "a cinema".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кино is cut short from кинематограф, "cinematograph", from Greek *kínēma*, "motion", and *gráphein*, "to write"; German *Kino* was cut the same way (Trubachev, in Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kinó*
- *Say it: kinó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kinó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a square, then the Russian for a post office, then say *kinó* again

Before you move on

What does кино mean? (“A cinema”.) Say it once more.

88.3 супермаркет (supermárket) — a supermarket

Before the new one: say the Russian for a post office, then the Russian for a cinema.

You’ll want to know: супермаркет

супермаркет (*supermárket*) — “a supermarket”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

супермаркет comes from English *supermarket*: Latin *super*, “above, beyond”, with *market*, from Latin *mercātus*, “trade”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: supermárket*
- *Say it: supermárket*, once more
- *Say it:* say *supermárket*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a post office, then the Russian for a cinema, then say *supermárket* again

Before you move on

What does супермаркет mean? (“A supermarket”.) Say it once more.

88.4 бассейн (basséyn) — a swimming pool

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cinema, then the Russian for a supermarket.

You'll want to know: бассейн

бассейн (*basséyn*) — "a swimming pool".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бассейн — recorded from 1764; it comes from French *bassin*, "a basin, a bowl", which goes with Italian *bacino* and a Gaulish *bacca*, "a water vessel" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: basséyn*
- *Say it: basséyn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *basséyn*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cinema, then the Russian for a supermarket, then say *basséyn* again

Before you move on

What does бассейн mean? ("A swimming pool".) Say it once more.

88.5 стадион (stadión) — a stadium

Before the new one: say the Russian for a supermarket, then the Russian for a swimming pool.

You'll want to know: стадион

стадион (*stadión*) — "a stadium".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стадион comes from Greek *stádion*, a measure of about 185 metres, and so the footrace and racecourse of that length.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stadión*
- *Say it: stadión*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stadión*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a supermarket, then the Russian for a swimming pool, then say *stadión* again

Before you move on

What does стадион mean? ("A stadium".) Say it once more.

Chapter 89

Factory, Office, Corner, Crossroads, Traffic lights

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a factory, an office, a corner, a crossroads and traffic lights.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 89: I can say a factory, an office, a corner, a crossroads and traffic lights.*

89.1 завод (zavód) — a factory

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a swimming pool, then the Russian for a stadium.

You'll want to know: завод

завод (*zavód*) — "a factory".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

завод is за-, "start", with вод, the root of водить, "to lead" (Vasmer gives водить with вести, "to lead"): заводить is "to set going", and a завод is a works set going.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zavód*
- *Say it: zavód*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zavód*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a swimming pool, then the Russian for a stadium, then say *zavód* again

Before you move on

What does **завод** mean? ("A factory".) Say it once more.

89.2 офис (ófis) — an office

Before the new one: say the Russian for a stadium, then the Russian for a factory.

You'll want to know: офис

офис (*ófis*) — "an office".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

офис comes from English *office*, from Latin *officium*, "duty, service".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ófis*
- *Say it: ófis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ófis*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a stadium, then the Russian for a factory, then say *ófis* again

Before you move on

What does офис mean? ("An office".) Say it once more.

89.3 угол (úgol) — a corner

Before the new one: say the Russian for a factory, then the Russian for an office.

You'll want to know: угол

угол (*úgol*) — "a corner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

угол ← Proto-Slavic **ǫgŭlŭ* — inherited, a cousin of Latin *angulus*, "corner", and Sanskrit *aṅguli-*, "finger" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: úgol*
- *Say it: úgol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úgol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a factory, then the Russian for an office, then say *úgol* again

Before you move on

What does угол mean? ("A corner".) Say it once more.

89.4 перекрёсток (perekryóstok) — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the Russian for an office, then the Russian for a corner.

You'll want to know: перекрёсток

перекрёсток (*perekryóstok*) — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

перекрёсток is пере-, "across", with крест, "a cross", and -ок: where roads cross. Vasmer says крест first meant "Christ", from Old High German *krist*, then "crucifix", then "cross".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perekryóstok*
- *Say it: perekryóstok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perekryóstok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an office, then the Russian for a corner, then say *perekryóstok* again

Before you move on

What does перекрёсток mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

89.5 светофор (svetofór) — traffic lights

Before the new one: say the Russian for a corner, then the Russian for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: светофор

светофор (*svetofór*) — "traffic lights".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

светофор is свет, "light", with -фор, from Greek -*phóros*, "carrying": "light-bearer", a Soviet coinage.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svetofór*
- *Say it: svetofór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svetofór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a corner, then the Russian for a crossroads, then say *svetofór* again

Before you move on

What does светофор mean? ("Traffic lights".) Say it once more.

Chapter 90

Car park, Lift, North, South, East

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a car park, a lift, the north, the south and the east.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 90: I can say a car park, a lift, the north, the south and the east.*

90.1 стоянка (stoyánka) — a car park

Before the new one: say the Russian for a crossroads, then the Russian for traffic lights.

You'll want to know: стоянка

стоянка (*stoyánka*) — "a car park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стоянка is стоять, "to stand", with -нка: a place where something stands. Стоять ← Proto-Slavic **stojati* — inherited; Vasmer compares Latin *stō*, "I stand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stoyánka*
- *Say it: stoyánka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stoyánka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a crossroads, then the Russian for traffic lights, then say *stoyánka* again

Before you move on

What does стоянка mean? ("A car park".) Say it once more.

90.2 лифт (lift) — a lift

Before the new one: say the Russian for traffic lights, then the Russian for a car park.

You'll want to know: лифт

лифт (*lift*) — "a lift".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лифт comes from English *lift* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lift*
- *Say it: lift*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lift*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for traffic lights, then the Russian for a car park, then say *lift* again

Before you move on

What does лифт mean? ("A lift".) Say it once more.

90.3 север (séver) — the north

Before the new one: say the Russian for a car park, then the Russian for a lift.

You'll want to know: север

север (*séver*) — "the north".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

север ← Proto-Slavic **sěverŭ* — inherited; dialects still use сивер for "the north wind". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *šiaurỹs*, "north wind", and Latin *caurus*, "north-west wind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: séver*
- *Say it: séver*, once more
- *Say it:* say *séver*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a car park, then the Russian for a lift, then say *séver* again

Before you move on

What does север mean? ("The north".) Say it once more.

90.4 юг (yug) — the south

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lift, then the Russian for the north.

You'll want to know: ЮГ

ЮГ (*yug*) — "the south".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ЮГ ← Proto-Slavic **jugŭ*, "south" — inherited. Vasmer calls the proposed etymologies unreliable, among them a link with Latin *augeō*, "I increase". The same word gave УЖИН, "supper", first the midday meal.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yug*
- *Say it: yug*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yug*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lift, then the Russian for the north, then say *yug* again

Before you move on

What does ЮГ mean? ("The south".) Say it once more.

90.5 ВОСТОК (vostók) — the east

Before the new one: say the Russian for the north, then the Russian for the south.

You'll want to know: ВОСТОК

ВОСТОК (*vostók*) — "the east".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ВОСТОК — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer; dialects kept native ВСТОК. Old Church Slavonic *vŭstokŭ*, "the rising (of the sun)",

copies Greek *anatolḗ*, “rising, east”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vostók*
- *Say it: vostók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vostók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the north, then the Russian for the south, then say *vostók* again

Before you move on

What does **ВОСТОК** mean? (“The east”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 91

West, Underground, Tram, Ship, Boat

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say the west, the underground, a tram, a ship and a boat.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 91: I can say the west, the underground, a tram, a ship and a boat.

91.1 запад (západ) — the west

Before the new one: say the Russian for the south, then the Russian for the east.

You'll want to know: запад

запад (*západ*) — "the west".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

запад is за-, "behind", with пад, from падать, "to fall": first "sunset", like Latin *occidēns*, "the falling (sun)" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: západ*
- *Say it: západ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *západ*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the south, then the Russian for the east, then say *západ* again

Before you move on

What does запад mean? ("The west".) Say it once more.

91.2 метро (metró) — the underground

Before the new one: say the Russian for the east, then the Russian for the west.

You'll want to know: метро

метро (*metró*) — "the underground".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

метро comes from French *métro*, cut short from *métropolitain*, "of the capital" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: metró*
- *Say it: metró*, once more
- *Say it:* say *metró*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the east, then the Russian for the west, then say *metró* again

Before you move on

What does метро mean? (“The underground”.) Say it once more.

91.3 трамвай (tramváy) — a tram

Before the new one: say the Russian for the west, then the Russian for the underground.

You’ll want to know: трамвай

трамвай (*tramváy*) — “a tram”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

трамвай came through French *tramway* or straight from English *tramway*: *tram*, “a beam, a rail”, with *way* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tramváy*
- *Say it: tramváy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tramváy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the west, then the Russian for the underground, then say *tramváy* again

Before you move on

What does трамвай mean? (“A tram”.) Say it once more.

91.4 корабль (korábl’) — a ship

Before the new one: say the Russian for the underground, then the Russian for a tram.

You'll want to know: корабль

корабль (*korábl'*) — "a ship".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

корабль — an old loan from Greek *karábion*, *kárabos*, "a boat", first "a crab"; Vasmer dates it early because it has б, not в. Spanish *carabela*, "caravel", has the same source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: korábl'*
- *Say it: korábl'*, once more
- *Say it:* say *korábl'*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the underground, then the Russian for a tram, then say *korábl'* again

Before you move on

What does корабль mean? ("A ship".) Say it once more.

91.5 лодка (lódka) — a boat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tram, then the Russian for a ship.

You'll want to know: лодка

лодка (*lódka*) — "a boat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лодка is old *lodŭka*, a diminutive of лодья, now ладья, "a boat", from Proto-Slavic **oldĭji* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *aldijà*, "canoe", and Swedish *ålla*, "a trough".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lódka*
- *Say it: lódka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lódka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tram, then the Russian for a ship, then say *lódka* again

Before you move on

What does лодка mean? ("A boat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 92

Bicycle, Suitcase, Journey, Holidays, Rug

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bicycle, a suitcase, a journey, holidays and a rug.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 92: I can say a bicycle, a suitcase, a journey, holidays and a rug.

92.1 велосипед (velosipéd) — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a ship, then the Russian for a boat.

You'll want to know: велосипед

велосипед (*velosipéd*) — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

велосипед comes from French *vélocipède*, from Latin *vēlōx*, "swift", and *pēs*, *pedis*, "foot" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: velosipéd*
- *Say it: velosipéd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *velosipéd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a ship, then the Russian for a boat, then say *velosipéd* again

Before you move on

What does велосипед mean? ("A bicycle".) Say it once more.

92.2 чемодан (chemodán) — a suitcase

Before the new one: say the Russian for a boat, then the Russian for a bicycle.

You'll want to know: чемодан

чемодан (*chemodán*) — "a suitcase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чемодан came through Tatar *čamadan* from Persian *jāma-dān*, "a place for clothes": *jāma*, "garment", with *dān*, "holder" (Vasmer). An English traveller noted it in 1618.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chemodán*
- *Say it: chemodán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chemodán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a boat, then the Russian for a bicycle, then say *chemodán* again

Before you move on

What does чемодан mean? ("A suitcase".) Say it once more.

92.3 путешествие (puteshéstviye) — a journey

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bicycle, then the Russian for a suitcase.

You'll want to know: путешествие

путешествие (*puteshéstviye*) — "a journey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

путешествие is путь, "way, road", with шествие, "a procession", from шествовать, "to march". путь ← Proto-Slavic **pǫtь*, a cousin of Sanskrit *pánthās*, "path", and Latin *pōns*, "bridge" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puteshéstviye*
- *Say it: puteshéstviye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puteshéstviye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bicycle, then the Russian for a suitcase, then say *puteshéstviye* again

Before you move on

What does путешествие mean? ("A journey".) Say it once more.

92.4 отпуск (ótpusk) — holidays, leave

Before the new one: say the Russian for a suitcase, then the Russian for a journey.

You'll want to know: отпуск

отпуск (*ótpusk*) — "holidays, leave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отпуск is от, "away", with пуск, from пустить, "to let go", Proto-Slavic **pustiti* (Vasmer): leave is being let go for a while.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ótpusk*
- *Say it:* *ótpusk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ótpusk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a suitcase, then the Russian for a journey, then say *ótpusk* again

Before you move on

What does отпуск mean? ("Holidays, leave".) Say it once more.

92.5 ковёр (kovyór) — a rug, a carpet

Before the new one: say the Russian for a journey, then the Russian for holidays.

You'll want to know: ковёр

ковёр (*kovyór*) — "a rug, a carpet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ковёр ← Old Russian *kovьrъ*; its sounds are unusual, so it is probably a loan. Vasmer suggests, as possible, Danube or Volga Bulgar **kavər*, compare Turkic *kiviz*, "felt blanket", and Mongolian *kebis*, "carpet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kovyór*
- *Say it: kovyór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kovyór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a journey, then the Russian for holidays, then say *kovyór* again

Before you move on

What does ковёр mean? ("A rug, a carpet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 93

The Letters Shcha and E

Modes: **eyes** (2) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** none of the 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write shcha and e, and find them in words I already say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 93: I can write shcha and e, and find them in words I already say.*

93.1 э (e) — the e that opens этот

Before the new one: write я and ё once each, and name them.

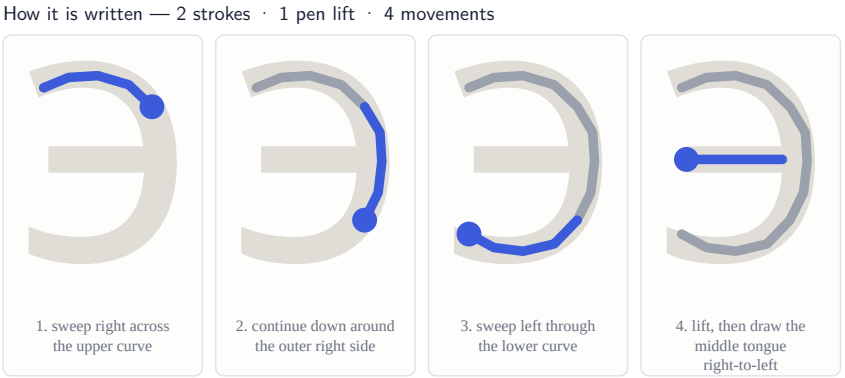
Now say этот (*étot*), "this". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: э

э — *e*.

It opens этот (*étot*), "this", and эта. It looks like a с turned to face the other way, with a short bar across the middle. It is the plain *e* sound, with no *y* in front of it, which is why it is mostly found at the start of a word.

Writing: э



How э is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write э yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start this letter and which way to travel**, in one attested order, and names its source beneath it. Teachers vary, so treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at этот and point at э inside it
- *Trace it:* э three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ё, then э, from memory
- *Read it:* этот aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — э? (**e**, *e.*) Which word did it come from? (этот, *étot*, "this".)

93.2 щ (shcha) — the shch inside площадь

Before the new one: write ё and э once each, and name them.

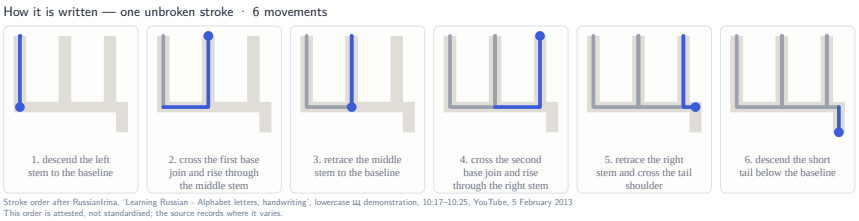
Now say площадь (*plóshchad*), "a square". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: щ

щ — *shch*.

It is inside площадь (*plóshchad*), "a square". It is ш with a small tail at the bottom right, and it sounds like a long, soft *sh*.

Writing: щ



How щ *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write щ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

The strip shows **where to start this letter and which way to travel**, in one attested order, and names its source beneath it. Teachers vary, so treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at площадь and point at щ inside it
- *Trace it:* щ three times, saying *shch* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* э, then щ, from memory
- *Read it:* площадь aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — щ? (**shcha**, *shch.*) Which word did it come from? (площадь, *plóshchad*, "a square".)

93.3 (two letters) — From the letter to the word — a first pass

Say этот (*étot*), then write the letter it gave you.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
э	*e*	этот *étot*
щ	*shcha*	площадь *plóshchad*

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from
- *Read it:* each word in the table aloud, and point at its letter

Before you move on

Which word did each letter come from? (э from этот; щ from площадь.)

93.4 (two letters) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Write щ without looking, then say the word it came from.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
э	*e*	этот *étot*
щ	*shcha*	площадь *plóshchad*

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* each letter once more, slowly, larger than it is printed

Before you move on

Say each word in the table once more, and name the letter you took from it.

Chapter 94

Television, Computer, Fridge, Cooker, Shower

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a television, a computer, a fridge, a cooker and a shower.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 94: I can say a television, a computer, a fridge, a cooker and a shower.

94.1 телевизор (televízor) — a television

Before the new one: say the Russian for holidays, leave, then the Russian for a rug, a carpet.

You'll want to know: телевизор

телевизор (*televízor*) — "a television".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

телевизор is an international coinage: Greek *tēle*, "far", with -визор, from Latin *vīsor*, "one who sees", from *vidēre*, "to see": a far-seer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: televízor*
- *Say it: televízor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *televízor*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for holidays, leave, then the Russian for a rug, a carpet, then say *televízor* again

Before you move on

What does телевизор mean? ("A television".) Say it once more.

94.2 компьютер (kompyúter) — a computer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rug, a carpet, then the Russian for a television.

You'll want to know: компьютер

компьютер (*kompyúter*) — "a computer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

компьютер comes from English *computer*, from Latin *computāre*, "to reckon".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kompyúter*
- *Say it: kompyúter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kompyúter*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rug, a carpet, then the Russian for a television, then say *kompyúter* again

Before you move on

What does компьютер mean? ("A computer".) Say it once more.

94.3 холодильник (kholodílnik) — a fridge

Before the new one: say the Russian for a television, then the Russian for a computer.

You'll want to know: холодильник

холодильник (*kholodílnik*) — "a fridge".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

холодильник is холодить, "to chill", from холод, "cold", with -льник, a suffix for a tool: "a chiller".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kholodílnik*
- *Say it: kholodílnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kholodílnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a television, then the Russian for a computer, then say *kholodílnik* again

Before you move on

What does холодильник mean? ("A fridge".) Say it once more.

94.4 плита (plitá) — a cooker

Before the new one: say the Russian for a computer, then the Russian for a fridge.

You'll want to know: плита

плита (*plitá*) — "a cooker".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плита — Old Russian плита, "a stone slab, a brick". Vasmer thinks it most likely a cousin of Greek *plínthos*, "brick"; the common view takes it as a loan from that Greek word. A плита is the slab you cook on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plitá*
- *Say it: plitá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plitá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a computer, then the Russian for a fridge, then say *plitá* again

Before you move on

What does плита mean? ("A cooker".) Say it once more.

94.5 душ (dush) — a shower

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fridge, then the Russian for a cooker.

You'll want to know: душ

душ (*dush*) — "a shower".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

душ comes from French *douche*, from Italian *doccia*, "a pipe, a spout" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dush*
- *Say it: dush*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dush*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fridge, then the Russian for a cooker, then say *dush* again

Before you move on

What does душ mean? ("A shower".) Say it once more.

Chapter 95

Bathtub, Shelf, Curtain, Pillow, Blanket

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain, a pillow and a blanket.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 95: I can say a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain, a pillow and a blanket.

95.1 ванна (vánna) — a bathtub

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cooker, then the Russian for a shower.

You'll want to know: ванна

ванна (*vánna*) — "a bathtub".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ванна comes from German *Wanne*, "a tub", or French *vanne* (Vasmer); Trubachev notes it by 1697.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vánna*
- *Say it:* *vánna*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vánna*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cooker, then the Russian for a shower, then say *vánna* again

Before you move on

What does ванна mean? (“A bathtub”.) Say it once more.

95.2 полка (pólka) — a shelf

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shower, then the Russian for a bathtub.

You’ll want to know: полка

полка (*pólka*) — “a shelf”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полка comes from полица, “a shelf”, built on пол, “floor, board” (Vasmer), which Vasmer relates to Sanskrit *phálakam*, “a board, a plank”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pólka*
- *Say it:* *pólka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pólka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shower, then the Russian for a bathtub, then say *pólka* again

Before you move on

What does полка mean? (“A shelf”.) Say it once more.

95.3 занавеска (zanavéska) — a curtain

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bathtub, then the Russian for a shelf.

You’ll want to know: занавеска

занавеска (*zanavéska*) — “a curtain”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

занавеска is занавес, “a curtain”, with -ка, “little”. занавес is за-, “across”, with навес, “what is hung”, from вешать, “to hang”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zanavéska*
- *Say it: zanavéska*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zanavéska*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bathtub, then the Russian for a shelf, then say *zanavéska* again

Before you move on

What does занавеска mean? (“A curtain”.) Say it once more.

95.4 подушка (podúshka) — a pillow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shelf, then the Russian for a curtain.

You'll want to know: подушка

подушка (*podúshka*) — "a pillow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подушка ← Proto-Slavic **podušĭka*. Vasmer reports the usual link with дух, "breath": a pillow as "a thing blown up". Machek's reading, под ухо, "under the ear", has been rejected by others.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podúshka*
- *Say it: podúshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podúshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shelf, then the Russian for a curtain, then say *podúshka* again

Before you move on

What does подушка mean? ("A pillow".) Say it once more.

95.5 одеяло (odeyálo) — a blanket

Before the new one: say the Russian for a curtain, then the Russian for a pillow.

You'll want to know: одеяло

одеяло (*odeyálo*) — "a blanket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

одеяло comes from Old Russian одеяти, "to cover, to clothe", the repeated-action form of одеть, "to dress" (Vasmer): a blanket is what covers you.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: odeyálo*
- *Say it: odeyálo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *odeyálo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a curtain, then the Russian for a pillow, then say *odeyálo* again

Before you move on

What does одеяло mean? ("A blanket".) Say it once more.

Chapter 96

Towel, Soap, Toothbrush, Comb, Rubbish

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a towel, soap, a toothbrush, a comb and rubbish.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 96: I can say a towel, soap, a toothbrush, a comb and rubbish.

96.1 полотенце (poloténtse) — a towel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pillow, then the Russian for a blanket.

You'll want to know: полотенце

полотенце (*poloténtse*) — "a towel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полотенце is полотно, "linen cloth", with the diminutive -енце. полотно ← Proto-Slavic **poltĭno*, which Vasmer relates to Sanskrit *paṭa-*, "cloth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poloténtse*
- *Say it: poloténtse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poloténtse*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pillow, then the Russian for a blanket, then say *poloténtse* again

Before you move on

What does полотенце mean? ("A towel".) Say it once more.

96.2 мыло (mýlo) — soap

Before the new one: say the Russian for a blanket, then the Russian for a towel.

You'll want to know: мыло

мыло (*mýlo*) — "soap".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мыло ← Proto-Slavic **mydlo*, built on мыть, "to wash" (Vasmer): the thing you wash with.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mýlo*
- *Say it: mýlo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mýlo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a blanket, then the Russian for a towel, then say *mýlo* again

Before you move on

What does мыло mean? (“Soap”.) Say it once more.

96.3 зубная щётка (zubnáya shchyótka) — a toothbrush

Before the new one: say the Russian for a towel, then the Russian for soap.

You’ll want to know: зубная щётка

зубная щётка (*zubnáya shchyótka*) — “a toothbrush”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зубная щётка is “tooth brush”: зубная, from зуб, “tooth”, with щётка, “brush”, from щеть, “bristle”, the root of щетина, “stubble”. Vasmer finds the proposed origins of that root doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zubnáya shchyótka*
- *Say it: zubnáya shchyótka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zubnáya shchyótka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a towel, then the Russian for soap, then say *zubnáya shchyótka* again

Before you move on

What does зубная щётка mean? (“A toothbrush”.) Say it once more.

96.4 расчёска (raschyóska) — a comb

Before the new one: say the Russian for soap, then the Russian for a toothbrush.

You'll want to know: расчёска

расчёска (*raschyóska*) — "a comb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

расчёска is рас-, "apart", with чесать, "to comb", and -ка. чесать ← Proto-Slavic **česati*, a cousin of Lithuanian *kasýti*, "to scratch" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: raschyóska*
- *Say it: raschyóska*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raschyóska*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for soap, then the Russian for a toothbrush, then say *raschyóska* again

Before you move on

What does расчёска mean? ("A comb".) Say it once more.

96.5 мусор (músor) — rubbish

Before the new one: say the Russian for a toothbrush, then the Russian for a comb.

You'll want to know: мусор

мусор (*músor*) — "rubbish".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мусор — Vasmer derives it from **mouds-* and compares Greek *mýsos*, "defilement"; Trubachev, in a note, ties it instead to dialect бусор, "junk".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: músor*
- *Say it: músor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *músor*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a toothbrush, then the Russian for a comb, then say *músor* again

Before you move on

What does мусор mean? ("Rubbish".) Say it once more.

Chapter 97

Broom, Washing machine, Sofa, Wardrobe, Saucepan

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a broom, a washing machine, a sofa, a wardrobe and a saucepan.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 97: I can say a broom, a washing machine, a sofa, a wardrobe and a saucepan.

97.1 веник (vénik) — a broom

Before the new one: say the Russian for a comb, then the Russian for rubbish.

You'll want to know: веник

веник (*vénik*) — "a broom".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

веник — Old Russian *venikŭ*, Czech *věník*, "a bundle". Vasmer links it with венок, "a wreath", and вить, "to twist": a broom is a bound bundle of twigs.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vénik*
- *Say it: vénik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vénik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a comb, then the Russian for rubbish, then say *vénik* again

Before you move on

What does веник mean? ("A broom".) Say it once more.

97.2 стиральная машина (stirálnaya mashína) — a washing machine

Before the new one: say the Russian for rubbish, then the Russian for a broom.

You'll want to know: стиральная машина

стиральная машина (*stirálnaya mashína*) — "a washing machine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стиральная машина is "washing machine": стиральная, from стирать, "to wash", from тереть, "to rub" (Latin *terō*, "I rub", is a cousin), with машина, "machine", from German *Maschine* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stirálnaya mashína*
- *Say it: stirálnaya mashína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stirálnaya mashína*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for rubbish, then the Russian for a broom, then say *stirálnaya mashína* again

Before you move on

What does стиральная машина mean? ("A washing machine".) Say it once more.

97.3 диван (diván) — a sofa

Before the new one: say the Russian for a broom, then the Russian for a washing machine.

You'll want to know: диван

диван (*diván*) — "a sofa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

диван — Vasmer thinks it more likely came from the West, French *divan*, "a couch", than straight from its Turkish and Persian source *divan*, "a council, a council chamber" with its cushioned benches.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diván*
- *Say it: diván*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diván*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a broom, then the Russian for a washing machine, then say *diván* again

Before you move on

What does диван mean? ("A sofa".) Say it once more.

97.4 шкаф (shkaf) — a wardrobe, a cupboard

Before the new one: say the Russian for a washing machine, then the Russian for a sofa.

You'll want to know: шкаф

шкаф (*shkaf*) — "a wardrobe, a cupboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шкаф — most likely reshaped from older **шкап** under the influence of German forms such as *Schaff*, Middle High German *schaf*, "a cupboard" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shkaf*
- *Say it: shkaf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shkaf*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a washing machine, then the Russian for a sofa, then say *shkaf* again

Before you move on

What does **шкаф** mean? ("A wardrobe, a cupboard".) Say it once more.

97.5 кастрюля (kastryúlya) — a saucepan

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sofa, then the Russian for a wardrobe.

You'll want to know: кастрюля

кастрюля (*kastryúlya*) — "a saucepan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кастрюля — first recorded in 1720; it probably came through German *Kastrol*, *Kasserolle*, from French *casserole*, "a saucepan" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kastryúlya*
- *Say it: kastryúlya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kastryúlya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sofa, then the Russian for a wardrobe, then say *kastryúlya* again

Before you move on

What does кастрюля mean? ("A saucepan".) Say it once more.

Chapter 98

Frying pan, Bucket, Rope, Nail, Hammer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a frying pan, a bucket, a rope, a nail and a hammer.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 98: I can say a frying pan, a bucket, a rope, a nail and a hammer.

98.1 сковорода (skovorodá) — a frying pan

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wardrobe, then the Russian for a saucepan.

You'll want to know: сковорода

сковорода (*skovorodá*) — "a frying pan".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сковорода ← Proto-Slavic **skovorda* — inherited, with Church Slavonic сковрада. Vasmer calls its further origin unclear; a comparison with Old High German *scart-îsan*, "a frying pan", has been made, and Szemerényi derived it from an Iranian word for "bowl".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skovorodá*
- *Say it: skovorodá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skovorodá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wardrobe, then the Russian for a saucepan, then say *skovorodá* again

Before you move on

What does сковорода mean? ("A frying pan".) Say it once more.

98.2 ведро (vedró) — a bucket

Before the new one: say the Russian for a saucepan, then the Russian for a frying pan.

You'll want to know: ведро

ведро (*vedró*) — "a bucket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ведро ← Proto-Slavic **vědro* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to вода, "water", German *Wasser* and Greek *hydría*, "a water jar": the bucket as the water vessel.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vedró*
- *Say it: vedró*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vedró*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a saucepan, then the Russian for a frying pan, then say *vedró* again

Before you move on

What does ведро mean? (“A bucket”.) Say it once more.

98.3 верёвка (veryóvka) — a rope

Before the new one: say the Russian for a frying pan, then the Russian for a bucket.

You’ll want to know: верёвка

верёвка (*veryóvka*) — “a rope”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

верёвка is built on Old Russian вьрвь, “a cord”, with -ка. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *virvė*, “rope”, and *vérti*, “to thread”, and Greek *eryō*, “I drag”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veryóvka*
- *Say it: veryóvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veryóvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a frying pan, then the Russian for a bucket, then say *veryóvka* again

Before you move on

What does верёвка mean? (“A rope”.) Say it once more.

98.4 гвоздь (gvozd) — a nail

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bucket, then the Russian for a rope.

You'll want to know: гвоздь

гвоздь (*gvozd*) — "a nail".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гвоздь ← Proto-Slavic **gvozdĭ* — inherited. Vasmer will not separate it from old Slavic *gvozd*, "a forest", and compares German *Quaste*, "a tassel", and Old Norse *kvistr*, "a twig": a nail was first a wooden peg.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gvozd*
- *Say it: gvozd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gvozd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bucket, then the Russian for a rope, then say *gvozd* again

Before you move on

What does гвоздь mean? ("A nail".) Say it once more.

98.5 молоток (molotók) — a hammer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rope, then the Russian for a nail.

You'll want to know: молоток

молоток (*molotók*) — "a hammer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молоток is молот, "a sledgehammer", with the diminutive -ок. Vasmer thinks молот probably comes from молоть, "to grind", so "the crusher", and compares Latin *malleus*, "a hammer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: molotók*
- *Say it: molotók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *molotók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rope, then the Russian for a nail, then say *molotók* again

Before you move on

What does МОЛОТОК mean? ("A hammer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 99

Glue, Scissors, Alarm clock, Camera, Purse

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say glue, scissors, an alarm clock, a camera and a purse.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 99: I can say glue, scissors, an alarm clock, a camera and a purse.

99.1 клей (kley) — glue

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nail, then the Russian for a hammer.

You'll want to know: клей

клей (*kley*) — "glue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

клей ← Proto-Slavic **kŭlějĭ* — inherited, a cousin of Greek *kólla*, "glue" (Vasmer), the source of *collage*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kley*
- *Say it: kley*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kley*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nail, then the Russian for a hammer, then say *kley* again

Before you move on

What does клей mean? (“Glue”.) Say it once more.

99.2 ножницы (nózhnitsy) — scissors

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hammer, then the Russian for glue.

You’ll want to know: ножницы

ножницы (*nózhnitsy*) — “scissors”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ножницы is built on нож, “a knife”, with -ницы, a plural ending for paired tools: a pair of blades.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nózhnitsy*
- *Say it: nózhnitsy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nózhnitsy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hammer, then the Russian for glue, then say *nózhnitsy* again

Before you move on

What does ножницы mean? (“Scissors”.) Say it once more.

99.3 будильник (budílnik) — an alarm clock

Before the new one: say the Russian for glue, then the Russian for scissors.

You’ll want to know: будильник

будильник (*budílnik*) — “an alarm clock”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

будильник is будить, “to wake someone”, with -льник, a suffix for a tool. будить makes бдеть, “to be awake”, causative, and Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *bodháyati*, “wakes, teaches”, the root of *Buddha*, “the awakened”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: budílnik*
- *Say it: budílnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *budílnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for glue, then the Russian for scissors, then say *budílnik* again

Before you move on

What does будильник mean? (“An alarm clock”.) Say it once more.

99.4 фотоаппарат (fotoapparát) — a camera

Before the new one: say the Russian for scissors, then the Russian for an alarm clock.

You'll want to know: фотоаппарат

фотоаппарат (*fotoapparát*) — "a camera".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фотоаппарат is фото-, from Greek *phōs*, *phōtós*, "light", with аппарат, "a device", from Latin *apparātus*, "equipment".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fotoapparát*
- *Say it: fotoapparát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fotoapparát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for scissors, then the Russian for an alarm clock, then say *fotoapparát* again

Before you move on

What does фотоаппарат mean? ("A camera".) Say it once more.

99.5 кошелёк (koshelyók) — a purse, a wallet

Before the new one: say the Russian for an alarm clock, then the Russian for a camera.

You'll want to know: кошелёк

кошелёк (*koshelyók*) — "a purse, a wallet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кошелёк is кошель, “a bag”, with the diminutive -ёк. кошель comes from кош, “a basket” (Vasmer), which he relates to Latin *quālum*, “a wicker basket”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koshelyók*
- *Say it: koshelyók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koshelyók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an alarm clock, then the Russian for a camera, then say *koshelyók* again

Before you move on

What does кошелёк mean? (“A purse, a wallet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 100

Ring, Photograph, Candle, Calendar, Rucksack

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a ring, a photograph, a candle, a calendar and a rucksack.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 100: I can say a ring, a photograph, a candle, a calendar and a rucksack.*

100.1 кольцо (koltsó) — a ring

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a camera, then the Russian for a purse.

You'll want to know: кольцо

кольцо (*koltsó*) — "a ring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кольцо is built on old коло, "a wheel, a circle" (Vasmer), the root of колесо, "wheel". Vasmer relates it to Greek *kýklos*, "circle", and Old Norse *hvel*, "wheel": English *wheel* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koltsó*
- *Say it: koltsó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koltsó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a camera, then the Russian for a purse, then say *koltsó* again

Before you move on

What does кольцо mean? ("A ring".) Say it once more.

100.2 фотография (fotográfiya) — a photograph

Before the new one: say the Russian for a purse, then the Russian for a ring.

You'll want to know: фотография

фотография (*fotográfiya*) — "a photograph".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фотография is an international coinage from Greek *phōs*, *phōtós*, "light", and *-graphía*, "writing": "writing with light".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fotográfiya*
- *Say it: fotográfiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fotográfiya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a purse, then the Russian for a ring, then say *fotográfiya* again

Before you move on

What does фотография mean? (“A photograph”.) Say it once more.

100.3 свеча (svechá) — a candle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a ring, then the Russian for a photograph.

You’ll want to know: свеча

свеча (*svechá*) — “a candle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свеча ← Proto-Slavic **světja*, built on свет, “light” (Vasmer); Vasmer compares Sanskrit *śvetya-*, “bright”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svechá*
- *Say it: svechá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svechá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a ring, then the Russian for a photograph, then say *svechá* again

Before you move on

What does свеча mean? (“A candle”.) Say it once more.

100.4 календарь (kalendár) — a calendar

Before the new one: say the Russian for a photograph, then the Russian for a candle.

You'll want to know: календарь

календарь (*kalendár*) — "a calendar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

календарь probably came through Polish *kalendarz* from Latin *calendārium*, "an account book", from *calendae*, "the first day of the month" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalendár*
- *Say it: kalendár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalendár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a photograph, then the Russian for a candle, then say *kalendár* again

Before you move on

What does календарь mean? ("A calendar".) Say it once more.

100.5 рюкзак (ryukzák) — a rucksack

Before the new one: say the Russian for a candle, then the Russian for a calendar.

You'll want to know: рюкзак

рюкзак (*ryukzák*) — "a rucksack".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рюкзак comes from German *Rucksack*: *Rücken*, "back", with *Sack*, "bag".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ryukzák*
- *Say it: ryukzák*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ryukzák*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a candle, then the Russian for a calendar, then say *ryukzák* again

Before you move on

What does рюкзак mean? ("A rucksack".) Say it once more.

Chapter 101

People, Jumper, Tie, Gloves, Scarf

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say people, a jumper, a tie, gloves and a scarf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 101: I can say people, a jumper, a tie, gloves and a scarf.*

101.1 люди (lyúdi) — people

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a calendar, then the Russian for a rucksack.

You'll want to know: люди

люди (*lyúdi*) — "people".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

люди ← Proto-Slavic **ljudĭje*, "people", the plural of old люд, "folk" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *liáudis*, "the people", Old High German *liut*, "people", and Greek *eleútheros*, "free", from a root "to grow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lyúdi*
- *Say it: lyúdi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyúdi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a calendar, then the Russian for a rucksack, then say *lyúdi* again

Before you move on

What does **люди** mean? ("People".) Say it once more.

101.2 свитер (svíter) — a jumper

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rucksack, then the Russian for people.

You'll want to know: свитер

свитер (*svíter*) — "a jumper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свитер comes from English *sweater*, from *sweat*: first a garment for working up a sweat.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svíter*
- *Say it: svíter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svíter*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rucksack, then the Russian for people, then say *svíter* again

Before you move on

What does свитер mean? (“A jumper”.) Say it once more.

101.3 галстук (gálstuk) — a tie

Before the new one: say the Russian for people, then the Russian for a jumper.

You’ll want to know: галстук

галстук (*gálstuk*) — “a tie”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

галстук — first галздуки, in 1705, from Dutch *halsdoek*, “neck cloth”, later reshaped after German *Halstuch* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gálstuk*
- *Say it: gálstuk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gálstuk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for people, then the Russian for a jumper, then say *gálstuk* again

Before you move on

What does галстук mean? (“A tie”.) Say it once more.

101.4 перчатки (perchátki) — gloves

Before the new one: say the Russian for a jumper, then the Russian for a tie.

You'll want to know: перчатки

перчатки (*perchátki*) — "gloves".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

перчатки comes from перст, an old word for "finger" (Vasmer): first **pĭrstŭčatŭ*, "fingered", as in Old Russian пьрстатица, "a glove". Vasmer relates перст to Lithuanian *pirštas*, "finger".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perchátki*
- *Say it: perchátki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perchátki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a jumper, then the Russian for a tie, then say *perchátki* again

Before you move on

What does перчатки mean? ("Gloves".) Say it once more.

101.5 шарф (sharf) — a scarf

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tie, then the Russian for gloves.

You'll want to know: шарф

шарф (*sharf*) — "a scarf".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шарф probably came through Polish *szarfa*, "a military sash", from German *Schärpe*, "a sash", which is traced to French *écharpe*, "an arm sling" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sharf*
- *Say it: sharf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sharf*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tie, then the Russian for gloves, then say *sharf* again

Before you move on

What does шарф mean? ("A scarf".) Say it once more.

Chapter 102

Boots, Skirt, Coat, Shoes, Socks

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say boots, a skirt, a coat, shoes and socks.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 102: I can say boots, a skirt, a coat, shoes and socks.*

102.1 сапоги (sapogí) — boots

Before the new one: say the Russian for gloves, then the Russian for a scarf.

You'll want to know: сапоги

сапоги (*sapogí*) — "boots".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сапоги is the plural of сапог, "a boot", Old Church Slavonic *sapogŭ*. Vasmer reports the usual link with сопеть, "to wheeze", through "a pipe" and so "a boot shaft"; Trubachev, in a note, takes it from early Bulgar or Turkic **sapag*, "a boot with a shaft", from a word for "stem".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sapogí*
- *Say it: sapogí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sapogí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for gloves, then the Russian for a scarf, then say *sapogí* again

Before you move on

What does сапоги mean? ("Boots".) Say it once more.

102.2 юбка (yúbka) — a skirt

Before the new one: say the Russian for a scarf, then the Russian for boots.

You'll want to know: юбка

юбка (*yúbka*) — "a skirt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

юбка — older юпка, from 1701; it came through Polish *jupa*, "a jacket", from Middle High German *joppe*, which goes back through Old French *jupe* to Italian *giuppa* and Arabic *jubba*, "an undergarment" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yúbka*
- *Say it: yúbka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yúbka*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a scarf, then the Russian for boots, then say *yúbka* again

Before you move on

What does юбка mean? (“A skirt”.) Say it once more.

102.3 пальто (paltó) — a coat

Before the new one: say the Russian for boots, then the Russian for a skirt.

You’ll want to know: пальто

пальто (*paltó*) — “a coat”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пальто comes from French *paletot*, “an overcoat”; Vasmer traces it further to Spanish *palletoque*, “a hooded cloak”, and Latin *palla*, “a mantle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paltó*
- *Say it: paltó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paltó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for boots, then the Russian for a skirt, then say *paltó* again

Before you move on

What does пальто mean? (“A coat”.) Say it once more.

102.4 туфли (túfli) — shoes

Before the new one: say the Russian for a skirt, then the Russian for a coat.

You'll want to know: туфли

туфли (*túfli*) — "shoes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

туфли — recorded from 1714; it comes from Low German *tuffel*, "a shoe", from older *pantuffel*, from Italian *pantofola*, "a slipper" (Vasmer). Its earlier source is disputed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: túfli*
- *Say it: túfli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *túfli*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a skirt, then the Russian for a coat, then say *túfli* again

Before you move on

What does туфли mean? ("Shoes".) Say it once more.

102.5 носки (noskí) — socks

Before the new one: say the Russian for a coat, then the Russian for shoes.

You'll want to know: носки

носки (*noskí*) — "socks".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

НОСКИ is the plural of НОСОК, “a sock”, built on НОС, “nose” (Vasmer): the tip of the foot or shoe, then the short stocking that covers it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: noskí*
- *Say it: noskí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *noskí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a coat, then the Russian for shoes, then say *noskí* again

Before you move on

What does НОСКИ mean? (“Socks”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 103

Hat, Jacket, Shirt, Trousers, Dress

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a hat, a jacket, a shirt, trousers and a dress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 103: I can say a hat, a jacket, a shirt, trousers and a dress.*

103.1 шапка (shápka) — a hat

Before the new one: say the Russian for shoes, then the Russian for socks.

You'll want to know: шапка

шапка (*shápka*) — "a hat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шапка — recorded from 1327. It is usually taken through Middle High German *schapël* from Old French *chape*, *chapel*, from Latin *cappa*, "a hooded cloak"; Vasmer notes that West Slavic has only *č-*, as in Polish *czapka*, which troubles that account.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shápka*
- *Say it: shápka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shápka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for shoes, then the Russian for socks, then say *shápka* again

Before you move on

What does шапка mean? ("A hat".) Say it once more.

103.2 куртка (kúrtka) — a jacket

Before the new one: say the Russian for socks, then the Russian for a hat.

You'll want to know: куртка

куртка (*kúrtka*) — "a jacket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

куртка came through Polish *kurta*, *kurtka* from Latin *curtus*, "short" (Vasmer); a Turkish source he finds unlikely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kúrtka*
- *Say it: kúrtka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kúrtka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for socks, then the Russian for a hat, then say *kúrtka* again

Before you move on

What does куртка mean? (“A jacket”.) Say it once more.

103.3 рубашка (rubáshka) — a shirt

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hat, then the Russian for a jacket.

You’ll want to know: рубашка

рубашка (*rubáshka*) — “a shirt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рубашка is рубаха, “a shirt”, with the fond -шка. Vasmer derives рубаха from руб, “a cut piece of cloth”, and рубить, “to chop”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rubáshka*
- *Say it: rubáshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rubáshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hat, then the Russian for a jacket, then say *rubáshka* again

Before you move on

What does рубашка mean? (“A shirt”.) Say it once more.

103.4 брюки (bryúki) — trousers

Before the new one: say the Russian for a jacket, then the Russian for a shirt.

You'll want to know: брюки

брюки (*bryúki*) — "trousers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

брюки — from Peter the Great's time, from Low German *brôk* or Dutch *broek*, "breeches"; the Germanic word goes with Latin-Gaulish *brāca*, "trousers" (Vasmer). English *breeches* is a cousin of the Dutch word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bryúki*
- *Say it:* *bryúki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bryúki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a jacket, then the Russian for a shirt, then say *bryúki* again

Before you move on

What does брюки mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

103.5 платье (plátye) — a dress

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shirt, then the Russian for trousers.

You'll want to know: платье

платье (*plátye*) — "a dress".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

платье ← Old Russian платие, "clothing", an old collective noun built on плат, "a piece of cloth" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plátye*
- *Say it: plátye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plátye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shirt, then the Russian for trousers, then say *plátye* again

Before you move on

What does платье mean? ("A dress".) Say it once more.

Chapter 104

Beef, Vegetables, Strawberries, Melon, Garlic

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say beef, vegetables, strawberries, a melon and garlic.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 104: I can say beef, vegetables, strawberries, a melon and garlic.

104.1 говядина (govyádina) — beef

Before the new one: say the Russian for trousers, then the Russian for a dress.

You'll want to know: говядина

говядина (*govyádina*) — "beef".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

говядина is built on old говядо, "cattle", with -ина, a suffix for meat. Vasmer relates говядо to Sanskrit *gáuḥ*, "cow", Greek *boûs* and Latin *bōs*, "ox", and Old High German *chuo*, "cow": English *cow* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *govyádina*
- *Say it:* *govyádina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *govyádina*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for trousers, then the Russian for a dress, then say *govyádina* again

Before you move on

What does говядина mean? (“Beef”.) Say it once more.

104.2 овощи (óvoshchi) — vegetables

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dress, then the Russian for beef.

You’ll want to know: овощи

овощи (*óvoshchi*) — “vegetables”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

овощи is the plural of овощ, “a vegetable, a fruit”. Vasmer rejects the common view that it comes from Old High German *obaz*, “fruit”, and suggests, with a “perhaps”, a Slavic **voksti-* from a root “to grow”, as in Gothic *wahsjan*, “to grow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *óvoshchi*
- *Say it:* *óvoshchi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *óvoshchi*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dress, then the Russian for beef, then say *óvoshchi* again

Before you move on

What does овощи mean? ("Vegetables".) Say it once more.

104.3 клубника (klubníka) — strawberries

Before the new one: say the Russian for beef, then the Russian for vegetables.

You'll want to know: клубника

клубника (*klubníka*) — "strawberries".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

клубника is built on клуб, "a ball, a clump" (Vasmer), the root of клубок, "a ball of thread": a name for the round garden strawberry.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klubníka*
- *Say it: klubníka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klubníka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beef, then the Russian for vegetables, then say *klubníka* again

Before you move on

What does клубника mean? ("Strawberries".) Say it once more.

104.4 дыня (dýnya) — a melon

Before the new one: say the Russian for vegetables, then the Russian for strawberries.

You'll want to know: дыня

дыня (*dýnya*) — "a melon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дыня — "a difficult word", says Vasmer. It is usually read as "a swollen fruit", from дуть, "to blow"; Knutsson derived it from Latin *cydōnea*, "quinces", through **kŭdynja*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dýnya*
- *Say it: dýnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dýnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for vegetables, then the Russian for strawberries, then say *dýnya* again

Before you move on

What does дыня mean? ("A melon".) Say it once more.

104.5 чеснок (chesnók) — garlic

Before the new one: say the Russian for strawberries, then the Russian for a melon.

You'll want to know: чеснок

чеснок (*chesnók*) — "garlic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чеснок ← Proto-Slavic **česnŭ*, with -ок — inherited. Vasmer reports the link with чесать, "to comb, to split": a garlic head splits into cloves, as Old High German *chlobolouh*, "garlic", goes with *klieben*, "to split".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chesnók*
- *Say it: chesnók*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chesnók*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for strawberries, then the Russian for a melon, then say *chesnók* again

Before you move on

What does чеснок mean? ("Garlic".) Say it once more.

104.6 The house and things you carry — a first pass

Say the words for a melon and garlic.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a television, a computer, a fridge, a cooker, a shower
- a bathtub, a shelf, a curtain, a pillow, a blanket
- a towel, soap, a toothbrush, a comb, rubbish
- a broom, a washing machine, a sofa, a wardrobe, a saucepan
- a frying pan, a bucket, a rope, a nail, a hammer

Before you move on

A television? (телевизор.) A computer? (компьютер.) A fridge? (холодильник.) A cooker? (плита.) A shower? (душ.) A bathtub? (ванна.) A shelf? (полка.) A curtain? (занавеска.) A pillow? (подушка.) A blanket? (одеяло.) A towel? (полотенце.) Soap? (мыло.) A toothbrush? (зубная щётка.) A comb? (расчёска.) Rubbish? (мусор.) A broom? (веник.) A washing machine? (стиральная машина.) A sofa? (диван.) A wardrobe? (шкаф.) A saucepan? (кастрюля.) A frying pan? (сковорода.) A bucket? (ведро.) A rope? (верёвка.) A nail? (гвоздь.) A hammer? (молоток.)

104.7 Clothes and food — a second pass

Say the words for glue and scissors.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- glue, scissors, an alarm clock, a camera, a purse
- a ring, a photograph, a candle, a calendar, a rucksack
- people, a jumper, a tie, gloves, a scarf
- boots, a skirt, a coat, shoes, socks
- a hat, a jacket, a shirt, trousers, a dress
- beef, vegetables, strawberries, a melon, garlic

Before you move on

Glue? (клей.) Scissors? (ножницы.) An alarm clock? (будильник.) A camera? (фотоаппарат.) A purse? (кошелёк.) A ring? (кольцо.) A photograph? (фотография.) A candle? (свеча.) A calendar? (календарь.) A rucksack? (рюкзак.) People? (люди.) A jumper? (свитер.) A tie? (галстук.) Gloves? (перчатки.) A scarf? (шарф.) Boots? (сапоги.) A skirt?

(юбка.) A coat? (пальто.) Shoes? (туфли.) Socks? (носки.) A hat? (шапка.) A jacket? (куртка.) A shirt? (рубашка.) Trousers? (брюки.) A dress? (платье.) Beef? (говядина.) Vegetables? (овощи.) Strawberries? (клубника.) A melon? (дыня.) Garlic? (чеснок.)

Chapter 105

Flour, Chocolate, Biscuits, Sandwich, Sauce

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say flour, chocolate, biscuits, a sandwich and a sauce.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 105: I can say flour, chocolate, biscuits, a sandwich and a sauce.*

105.1 мука (muká) — flour

Before the new one: say the Russian for a melon, then the Russian for garlic.

You'll want to know: мука

мука (*muká*) — "flour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мука, "flour", stressed on the last syllable ← Proto-Slavic **mǫka* — inherited, from the root of мягкий, "soft". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *minkyti*, "to knead", and Greek *mássō*, "I knead". мука, stressed on the first syllable, "torment", is a related word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muká*
- *Say it: muká*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muká*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a melon, then the Russian for garlic, then say *muká* again

Before you move on

What does мука mean? (“Flour”.) Say it once more.

105.2 шоколад (shokolád) — chocolate

Before the new one: say the Russian for garlic, then the Russian for flour.

You’ll want to know: шоколад

шоколад (*shokolád*) — “chocolate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шоколад — from Peter the Great’s time. The ш- form came through German *Schokolade*, the old ч- form from Italian *cioccolata*; both go back to Spanish *chocolate*, from Nahuatl, the language of the Aztecs (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shokolád*
- *Say it: shokolád*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shokolád*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for garlic, then the Russian for flour, then say *shokolád* again

Before you move on

What does шоколад mean? ("Chocolate".) Say it once more.

105.3 печенье (pechénye) — biscuits

Before the new one: say the Russian for flour, then the Russian for chocolate.

You'll want to know: печенье

печенье (*pechénye*) — "biscuits".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

печенье is a noun from печь, "to bake": "something baked". печь ← Proto-Slavic **pekti*, which Vasmer relates to Sanskrit *paktí-*, "cooking", and Greek *pépsis*, "cooking".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pechénye*
- *Say it: pechénye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pechénye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for flour, then the Russian for chocolate, then say *pechénye* again

Before you move on

What does печенье mean? ("Biscuits".) Say it once more.

105.4 бутерброд (buterbród) — a sandwich

Before the new one: say the Russian for chocolate, then the Russian for biscuits.

You'll want to know: бутерброд

бутерброд (*buterbród*) — "a sandwich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бутерброд comes from German *Butterbrot*, "buttered bread" (Vasmer): *Butter*, "butter", with *Brot*, "bread".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: buterbród*
- *Say it: buterbród*, once more
- *Say it:* say *buterbród*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for chocolate, then the Russian for biscuits, then say *buterbród* again

Before you move on

What does бутерброд mean? ("A sandwich".) Say it once more.

105.5 соус (sóus) — a sauce

Before the new one: say the Russian for biscuits, then the Russian for a sandwich.

You'll want to know: соус

соус (*sóus*) — "a sauce".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

соус comes from French *sauce*, from Latin *salsa*, “salted (broth)”, perhaps through English *sauce* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sóus*
- *Say it: sóus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sóus*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for biscuits, then the Russian for a sandwich, then say *sóus* again

Before you move on

What does соус mean? (“A sauce”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 106

Dessert, Yoghurt, Ice cream, Sausage, Peach

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a dessert, a yoghurt, ice cream, sausage and a peach.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 106: I can say a dessert, a yoghurt, ice cream, sausage and a peach.*

106.1 десерт (desért) — a dessert

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a sandwich, then the Russian for a sauce.

You'll want to know: десерт

десерт (*desért*) — "a dessert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

десерт came through German *Dessert* or straight from French *dessert* (Vasmer), from *desservir*, "to clear the table".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: desért*
- *Say it: desért*, once more
- *Say it:* say *desért*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sandwich, then the Russian for a sauce, then say *desért* again

Before you move on

What does десерт mean? ("A dessert".) Say it once more.

106.2 йогурт (yógurt) — a yoghurt

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sauce, then the Russian for a dessert.

You'll want to know: йогурт

йогурт (*yógurt*) — "a yoghurt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

йогурт comes from Turkish *yoğurt*, "yoghurt", through the western European languages.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yógurt*
- *Say it: yógurt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yógurt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sauce, then the Russian for a dessert, then say *yógurt* again

Before you move on

What does йогурт mean? (“A yoghurt”.) Say it once more.

106.3 мороженое (morózhenoye) — ice cream

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dessert, then the Russian for a yoghurt.

You’ll want to know: мороженое

мороженое (*morózhenoye*) — “ice cream”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мороженое is an adjective standing alone: “frozen (food)”, from морозить, “to freeze”, and мороз, “frost”, which Vasmer relates to Albanian *mardhem*, “I freeze”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: morózhenoye*
- *Say it: morózhenoye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *morózhenoye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dessert, then the Russian for a yoghurt, then say *morózhenoye* again

Before you move on

What does мороженое mean? (“Ice cream”.) Say it once more.

106.4 колбаса (kolbasá) — sausage

Before the new one: say the Russian for a yoghurt, then the Russian for ice cream.

You'll want to know: колбаса

колбаса (*kolbasá*) — "sausage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

колбаса — recorded from 1280; origin disputed. Some relate it to колоб, "a round loaf"; Vasmer finds grounds to suspect a loan and names Turkish *külbastı*, "grilled meat", as a possible source.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kolbasá*
- *Say it: kolbasá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kolbasá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a yoghurt, then the Russian for ice cream, then say *kolbasá* again

Before you move on

What does колбаса mean? ("Sausage".) Say it once more.

106.5 персик (pérsik) — a peach

Before the new one: say the Russian for ice cream, then the Russian for sausage.

You'll want to know: персик

персик (*pérsik*) — "a peach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

персик probably came through Middle Low German *persik* from Latin *(mālum) persicum*, "the Persian apple" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pérsik*
- *Say it: pérsik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pérsik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ice cream, then the Russian for sausage, then say *pérsik* again

Before you move on

What does персик mean? ("A peach".) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

Jam, Nut, Pepper, Nurse, Cook

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say jam, a nut, pepper, a nurse and a cook.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 107: I can say jam, a nut, pepper, a nurse and a cook.*

107.1 варенье (varénye) — jam

Before the new one: say the Russian for sausage, then the Russian for a peach.

You'll want to know: варенье

варенье (*varénye*) — "jam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

варенье is a noun from варить, "to boil, to cook": fruit boiled with sugar. Vasmer relates варить to Lithuanian *virti*, "to boil".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varénye*
- *Say it: varénye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varénye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sausage, then the Russian for a peach, then say *varénye* again

Before you move on

What does варенье mean? ("Jam".) Say it once more.

107.2 орех (orékh) — a nut

Before the new one: say the Russian for a peach, then the Russian for jam.

You'll want to know: орех

орех (*orékh*) — "a nut".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

орех ← Proto-Slavic **orěxŭ* — inherited. Vasmer compares Lithuanian *ríešutas*, "nut", and Albanian *arrë*, "walnut"; Machek saw in the Baltic and Slavic words a loan from an older, unknown language.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: orékh*
- *Say it: orékh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *orékh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a peach, then the Russian for jam, then say *orékh* again

Before you move on

What does орех mean? (“A nut”.) Say it once more.

107.3 перец (pérets) — pepper

Before the new one: say the Russian for jam, then the Russian for a nut.

You’ll want to know: перец

перец (*pérets*) — “pepper”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

перец ← Old Russian пьпьрь, from 1193 — an old loan from Latin *piper*, which goes back through Greek *péperi* to Sanskrit *pippalī*, “long pepper”; Vasmer allows an East Germanic go-between.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pérets*
- *Say it: pérets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pérets*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for jam, then the Russian for a nut, then say *pérets* again

Before you move on

What does перец mean? (“Pepper”.) Say it once more.

107.4 медсестра (medsestrá) — a nurse

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nut, then the Russian for pepper.

You'll want to know: медсестра

медсестра (*medsestrá*) — "a nurse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

медсестра is cut short from медицинская сестра, "medical sister": мед-, from медицина, "medicine", with сестра, "sister", a cousin of English *sister*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: medsestrá*
- *Say it: medsestrá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *medsestrá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nut, then the Russian for pepper, then say *medsestrá* again

Before you move on

What does медсестра mean? ("A nurse".) Say it once more.

107.5 повар (póvar) — a cook

Before the new one: say the Russian for pepper, then the Russian for a nurse.

You'll want to know: повар

повар (*póvar*) — "a cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

повар is по- with вар, from варить, "to boil, to cook": the one who cooks.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: póvar*
- *Say it: póvar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *póvar*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pepper, then the Russian for a nurse, then say *póvar* again

Before you move on

What does повар mean? ("A cook".) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer, Baker, Driver

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer, a baker and a driver.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 108: I can say a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer, a baker and a driver.

108.1 полицейский (politséyskiy) — a police officer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nurse, then the Russian for a cook.

You'll want to know: полицейский

полицейский (*politséyskiy*) — "a police officer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полицейский is an adjective from полиция, "police", standing alone: "a police officer". полиция came, from Peter the Great's time, through Polish *policja* or German *Polizei* from Latin *polītīa*, Greek *politeía*, "citizenship, government" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: politséyskiy*
- *Say it: politséyskiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *politséyskiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nurse, then the Russian for a cook, then say *politséyskiy* again

Before you move on

What does полицейский mean? ("A police officer".) Say it once more.

108.2 продавец (prodavéts) — a shop assistant

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cook, then the Russian for a police officer.

You'll want to know: продавец

продавец (*prodavéts*) — "a shop assistant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

продавец is продавать, "to sell", with -ец, "one who does it". The verb is про- with давать, "to give". Vasmer takes давать from дать, "to give", kin to Lithuanian *dovanà*, "a gift".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prodavéts*

- *Say it:* *prodavéts*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prodavéts*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cook, then the Russian for a police officer, then say *prodavéts* again

Before you move on

What does продавец mean? (“A shop assistant”.) Say it once more.

108.3 фермер (férmer) — a farmer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a police officer, then the Russian for a shop assistant.

You’ll want to know: фермер

фермер (*férmer*) — “a farmer”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фермер comes from English *farmer* or German *Farmer*, and was felt to go with ферма, “a farm” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *férmer*
- *Say it:* *férmer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *férmer*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a police officer, then the Russian for a shop assistant, then say *férmer* again

Before you move on

What does фермер mean? (“A farmer”.) Say it once more.

108.4 пекарь (pékar) — a baker

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shop assistant, then the Russian for a farmer.

You’ll want to know: пекарь

пекарь (*pékar*) — “a baker”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пекарь — from Peter the Great’s time; built on пеку, “I bake”, with -арь, on the model of German *Bäcker*, “baker” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pékar*
- *Say it: pékar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pékar*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shop assistant, then the Russian for a farmer, then say *pékar* again

Before you move on

What does пекарь mean? (“A baker”.) Say it once more.

108.5 водитель (vodítel) — a driver

Before the new one: say the Russian for a farmer, then the Russian for a baker.

You'll want to know: водитель

водитель (*vodítel*) — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

водитель is водить, "to lead; to drive", with -тель, "one who does it". Vasmer relates водить to Lithuanian *vadýti*, "to lead".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vodítel*
- *Say it: vodítel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vodítel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a farmer, then the Russian for a baker, then say *vodítel* again

Before you move on

What does водитель mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Lawyer, Engineer, Firefighter, Postman, Waiter

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a lawyer, an engineer, a firefighter, a postman and a waiter.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 109: I can say a lawyer, an engineer, a firefighter, a postman and a waiter.

109.1 юрист (yuríst) — a lawyer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a baker, then the Russian for a driver.

You'll want to know: юрист

юрист (*yuríst*) — "a lawyer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

юрист — from 1704; it comes from German *Jurist*, Medieval Latin *iūrista*, from *iūs*, *iūris*, "law" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yuríst*
- *Say it: yuríst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yuríst*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a baker, then the Russian for a driver, then say *yuríst* again

Before you move on

What does юрист mean? ("A lawyer".) Say it once more.

109.2 инженер (inzhenér) — an engineer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a driver, then the Russian for a lawyer.

You'll want to know: инженер

инженер (*inzhenér*) — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

инженер comes from German *Ingenieur*, from French *ingénieur*, from Latin *ingenium*, "talent, a clever device" (Vasmer); Kiparsky finds it as early as 1647.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inzhenér*
- *Say it: inzhenér*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inzhenér*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a driver, then the Russian for a lawyer, then say *inzhenér* again

Before you move on

What does инженер mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

109.3 пожарный (pozhárnyy) — a firefighter

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lawyer, then the Russian for an engineer.

You'll want to know: пожарный

пожарный (*pozhárnyy*) — "a firefighter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пожарный is an adjective from пожар, "a blaze", standing alone: "the fire man". пожар is по- with жар, "heat" (Vasmer), which he relates to Greek *thermós*, "warm", and Latin *formus*, "warm".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pozhárnyy*
- *Say it: pozhárnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pozhárnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lawyer, then the Russian for an engineer, then say *pozhárnyy* again

Before you move on

What does пожарный mean? ("A firefighter".) Say it once more.

109.4 почтальон (pochtalón) — a postman

Before the new one: say the Russian for an engineer, then the Russian for a firefighter.

You'll want to know: почтальон

почтальон (*pochtalón*) — "a postman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

почтальон — from 1705, also постильон; it came through German *Postillion* from French *postillon*, Italian *postiglione*, "a post rider", and took its -ч- and -а- from почта, "post" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pochtalón*
- *Say it: pochtalón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pochtalón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an engineer, then the Russian for a firefighter, then say *pochtalón* again

Before you move on

What does почтальон mean? ("A postman".) Say it once more.

109.5 официант (ofitsiánt) — a waiter

Before the new one: say the Russian for a firefighter, then the Russian for a postman.

You'll want to know: официант

официант (*ofitsiánt*) — "a waiter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

официант is built on Latin *officium*, "duty, service", probably through German *Offiziant*, "a minor official": the one who serves.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ofitsiánt*
- *Say it: ofitsiánt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ofitsiánt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a firefighter, then the Russian for a postman, then say *ofitsiánt* again

Before you move on

What does официант mean? ("A waiter".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Customer, Till, Boss, Profession, Class

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a customer, a till, a boss, a profession and a class.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 110: I can say a customer, a till, a boss, a profession and a class.*

110.1 клиент (kliyént) — a customer

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a postman, then the Russian for a waiter.

You'll want to know: клиент

клиент (*kliyént*) — "a customer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

клиент came through German *Klient* from Latin *cliēns*, *clientis*, "a dependant, a protégé" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kliyént*
- *Say it: kliyént*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kliyént*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a postman, then the Russian for a waiter, then say *kliyént* again

Before you move on

What does клиент mean? (“A customer”.) Say it once more.

110.2 касса (kássa) — a till, a checkout

Before the new one: say the Russian for a waiter, then the Russian for a customer.

You’ll want to know: касса

касса (*kássa*) — “a till, a checkout”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

касса — from Peter the Great’s time; it came through Polish *kasa* or German *Kasse*, or straight from Italian *cassa*, from Latin *capsa*, “a box, a case” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kássa*
- *Say it: kássa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kássa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a waiter, then the Russian for a customer, then say *kássa* again

Before you move on

What does касса mean? (“A till, a checkout”.) Say it once more.

110.3 начальник (nachálnik) — a boss

Before the new one: say the Russian for a customer, then the Russian for a till.

You’ll want to know: начальник

начальник (*nachálnik*) — “a boss”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

начальник is начало, “beginning; authority”, with -ник, “a person”: the one in charge. начало goes with начать, “to begin”, and конец, “end”, and Vasmer relates the root to Greek *kainós*, “new”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nachálnik*
- *Say it: nachálnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nachálnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a customer, then the Russian for a till, then say *nachálnik* again

Before you move on

What does начальник mean? (“A boss”.) Say it once more.

110.4 профессия (proféssiya) — a profession

Before the new one: say the Russian for a till, then the Russian for a boss.

You'll want to know: профессия

профессия (*профе́ссия*) — "a profession".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

профессия perhaps came through German *Profession* from Latin *professiō*, "a public declaration (of one's calling)" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: профе́ссия*
- *Say it: профе́ссия*, once more
- *Say it:* say *профе́ссия*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a till, then the Russian for a boss, then say *профе́ссия* again

Before you move on

What does профессия mean? ("A profession".) Say it once more.

110.5 класс (klass) — a class

Before the new one: say the Russian for a boss, then the Russian for a profession.

You'll want to know: класс

класс (*класс*) — "a class".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

класс — from Peter the Great's time; it comes from French *classe*, from Latin *classis*, "a rank, a division" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klass*
- *Say it: klass*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klass*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a boss, then the Russian for a profession, then say *klass* again

Before you move on

What does класс mean? ("A class".) Say it once more.

Chapter 111

Exam, Board, Rubber, Homework, Idea

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an exam, a board, a rubber, homework and an idea.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 111: I can say an exam, a board, a rubber, homework and an idea.

111.1 экзамен (ekzámen) — an exam

Before the new one: say the Russian for a profession, then the Russian for a class.

Read it: аэропорт, лифт, метро aloud as one line, without stopping between the words

You'll want to know: экзамен

экзамен (*ekzámen*) — "an exam".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

экзамен — from Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *egzamen* from Latin *exāmen*, "a weighing, a test" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ekzámen*
- *Say it:* *ekzámen*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ekzámen*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a profession, then the Russian for a class, then say *ekzámen* again

Before you move on

What does экзамен mean? (“An exam”.) Say it once more.

111.2 доска (doská) — a board

Before the new one: say the Russian for a class, then the Russian for an exam.

Read it: the two signs aloud, as one run — лифт направо, метро налево

You’ll want to know: доска

доска (*doská*) — “a board”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

доска ← Proto-Slavic **dŭska*, “a board, a table” — borrowed through Germanic (compare Old High German *tisc*, “table”, Old English *disc*, “dish”) from Latin *discus*, Greek *dískos*, “a disc” (Vasmer). German *Tisch*, “table”, is the same word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *doská*
- *Say it:* *doská*, once more

- *Say it:* say *doská*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a class, then the Russian for an exam, then say *doská* again

Before you move on

What does доска mean? ("A board".) Say it once more.

111.3 ластик (lástik) — a rubber, an eraser

Before the new one: say the Russian for an exam, then the Russian for a board.

You'll want to know: ластик

ластик (*lástik*) — "a rubber, an eraser".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ластик — in the sense "an eraser", it comes from Latin *elasticus*, "springy" (Trubachev, in Vasmer, citing Ushakov); rubber is elastic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lástik*
- *Say it: lástik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lástik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an exam, then the Russian for a board, then say *lástik* again

Before you move on

What does ластик mean? ("A rubber, an eraser".) Say it once more.

111.4 домашнее задание (domáshneye zadániye) — homework

Before the new one: say the Russian for a board, then the Russian for a rubber.

You'll want to know: домашнее задание

домашнее задание (*domáshneye zadániye*) — "homework".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

домашнее задание is "a home task": домашнее, from дом, "house", with задание, "a set task", from задать, "to set", on the root of дать, "to give".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: domáshneye zadániye*
- *Say it: domáshneye zadániye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *domáshneye zadániye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a board, then the Russian for a rubber, then say *domáshneye zadániye* again

Before you move on

What does домашнее задание mean? ("Homework".) Say it once more.

111.5 идея (idéya) — an idea

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rubber, then the Russian for homework.

You'll want to know: идея

идея (*idéya*) — "an idea".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

идея — recorded from 1710; it came from Polish *idea*, German *Idee* or French *idée*, from Latin *idea*, Greek *idéa*, "look, form", from *ideîn*, "to see" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: idéya*
- *Say it: idéya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *idéya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rubber, then the Russian for homework, then say *idéya* again

Before you move on

What does идея mean? ("An idea".) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Problem, Sentence, Page, Music, Sport

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a problem, a sentence, a page, music and sport.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 112: I can say a problem, a sentence, a page, music and sport.

112.1 проблема (probléma) — a problem

Before the new one: say the Russian for homework, then the Russian for an idea.

You'll want to know: проблема

проблема (*probléma*) — "a problem".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

проблема — from Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *problema* or older German *Problema* from Latin *problēma*, Greek *próblēma*, "something put forward" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: probléma*
- *Say it: probléma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *probléma*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for homework, then the Russian for an idea, then say *probléma* again

Before you move on

What does проблема mean? ("A problem".) Say it once more.

112.2 предложение (predlozhéniye) — a sentence

Before the new one: say the Russian for an idea, then the Russian for a problem.

You'll want to know: предложение

предложение (*predlozhéniye*) — "a sentence".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

предложение is пред-, "before", with ложение, "laying", from -ложить, "to lay": a sentence is a thing laid before the listener; it also means "an offer". The root is that of лежать, "to lie", a cousin of English *lie* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: predlozhéniye*
- *Say it: predlozhéniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *predlozhéniye*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for an idea, then the Russian for a problem, then say *predlozhéniye* again

Before you move on

What does предложение mean? (“A sentence”.) Say it once more.

112.3 страница (stranítsa) — a page

Before the new one: say the Russian for a problem, then the Russian for a sentence.

You’ll want to know: страница

страница (*stranítsa*) — “a page”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

страница is built on страна, the Church Slavonic shape of сторона, “side”: a page is one side of a leaf.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stranítsa*
- *Say it: stranítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stranítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a problem, then the Russian for a sentence, then say *stranítsa* again

Before you move on

What does страница mean? (“A page”.) Say it once more.

112.4 музыка (múzyka) — music

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sentence, then the Russian for a page.

You'll want to know: музыка

музыка (*múzyka*) — "music".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

музыка — Old Russian said мусикия; the form музыка, first stressed on -зы-, came through Ukrainian and Polish *muzyka* from Latin *mūsica*, Greek *mousikḗ*, "the art of the Muses"; the stress on му- used today may have come through Austrian German (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: múzyka*
- *Say it: múzyka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *múzyka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sentence, then the Russian for a page, then say *múzyka* again

Before you move on

What does музыка mean? ("Music".) Say it once more.

112.5 спорт (sport) — sport

Before the new one: say the Russian for a page, then the Russian for music.

You'll want to know: спорт

спорт (*sport*) — "sport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спорт comes from English *sport*, cut from *disport*, "amusement", from Old French *desporter*, "to carry away (from work)" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sport*
- *Say it: sport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sport*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a page, then the Russian for music, then say *sport* again

Before you move on

What does спорт mean? ("Sport".) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Game, Film, Song, Drawing, Life

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a game, a film, a song, a drawing and life.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 113: I can say a game, a film, a song, a drawing and life.*

113.1 игра (igrá) — a game

Before the new one: say the Russian for music, then the Russian for sport.

You'll want to know: игра

игра (*igrá*) — "a game".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

игра ← Proto-Slavic **jьigra* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *áikštytis*, "to be playful", and Sanskrit *ejati*, "stirs, moves".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: igrá*
- *Say it: igrá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *igrá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for music, then the Russian for sport, then say *igrá* again

Before you move on

What does игра mean? ("A game".) Say it once more.

113.2 фильм (film) — a film

Before the new one: say the Russian for sport, then the Russian for a game.

You'll want to know: фильм

фильм (*film*) — "a film".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фильм, older фильма, comes from English *film*, "a thin skin, a film" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: film*
- *Say it: film*, once more
- *Say it:* say *film*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sport, then the Russian for a game, then say *film* again

Before you move on

What does фильм mean? (“A film”.) Say it once more.

113.3 песня (pésnya) — a song

Before the new one: say the Russian for a game, then the Russian for a film.

You’ll want to know: песня

песня (*pésnya*) — “a song”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

песня comes from петь, “to sing”, пою, “I sing” (Vasmer): Old Russian песнь, “what is sung”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pésnya*
- *Say it: pésnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pésnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a game, then the Russian for a film, then say *pésnya* again

Before you move on

What does песня mean? (“A song”.) Say it once more.

113.4 рисунок (risúnok) — a drawing

Before the new one: say the Russian for a film, then the Russian for a song.

You'll want to know: рисунок

рисунок (*risúnok*) — "a drawing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рисунок — recorded from 1705; it comes from Polish *rysunek*, "a drawing", from *rysować*, "to draw", with an ending that reflects German *-ung* (Vasmer). Polish *rysować* goes back to German *reißen*, "to draw, to sketch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: risúnok*
- *Say it: risúnok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *risúnok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a film, then the Russian for a song, then say *risúnok* again

Before you move on

What does рисунок mean? ("A drawing".) Say it once more.

113.5 жизнь (zhizn) — life

Before the new one: say the Russian for a song, then the Russian for a drawing.

You'll want to know: жизнь

жизнь (*zhizn*) — "life".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жизнь comes from жить, "to live" (Vasmer), with the old noun suffix -знь, as in болезнь, "illness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhizn*
- *Say it: zhizn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhizn*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a song, then the Russian for a drawing, then say *zhizn* again

Before you move on

What does **жизнь** mean? ("Life".) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Price, Football, Concert, Holiday, Fog

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a price, football, a concert, a holiday and fog.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 114: I can say a price, football, a concert, a holiday and fog.

114.1 цена (tsená) — a price

Before the new one: say the Russian for a drawing, then the Russian for life.

You'll want to know: цена

цена (*tsená*) — "a price".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

цена ← Proto-Slavic **cěna* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *kainà*, "price", Avestan *kaēnā-*, "retribution", and Greek *poinḗ*, "penalty", the source of English *pain*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsená*
- *Say it: tsená*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsená*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a drawing, then the Russian for life, then say *tsená* again

Before you move on

What does цена mean? (“A price”.) Say it once more.

114.2 футбол (futból) — football

Before the new one: say the Russian for life, then the Russian for a price.

You’ll want to know: футбол

футбол (*futból*) — “football”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

футбол comes from English *football*, “foot ball” (Trubachev, in Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: futból*
- *Say it: futból*, once more
- *Say it:* say *futból*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for life, then the Russian for a price, then say *futból* again

Before you move on

What does футбол mean? (“Football”.) Say it once more.

114.3 концерт (kontsért) — a concert

Before the new one: say the Russian for a price, then the Russian for football.

You’ll want to know: концерт

концерт (*kontsért*) — “a concert”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

концерт came through German *Konzert* from Italian *concerto*, “a contest (of voices)”, from Latin *concertāre*, “to contend”; under Peter the Great it meant “an agreement” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kontsért*
- *Say it: kontsért*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kontsért*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a price, then the Russian for football, then say *kontsért* again

Before you move on

What does концерт mean? (“A concert”.) Say it once more.

114.4 праздник (prázdnik) — a holiday, a celebration

Before the new one: say the Russian for football, then the Russian for a concert.

You'll want to know: праздник

праздник (*prázdnik*) — "a holiday, a celebration".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

праздник is built on праздный, "idle, free", which Vasmer calls Church Slavonic, by its -ра-, beside native порожний, "empty": a holiday is a day free of work.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prázdnik*
- *Say it: prázdnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prázdnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for football, then the Russian for a concert, then say *prázdnik* again

Before you move on

What does праздник mean? ("A holiday, a celebration".) Say it once more.

114.5 туман (tumán) — fog

Before the new one: say the Russian for a concert, then the Russian for a holiday.

You'll want to know: туман

туман (*tumán*) — "fog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

туман comes from Turkic *tuman*, "fog, gloom", as in Kazakh and Kirghiz, Turkish *duman*; Vasmer thinks the Turkic words probably go back to Avestan *dunman-*, "mist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tumán*
- *Say it: tumán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tumán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a concert, then the Russian for a holiday, then say *tumán* again

Before you move on

What does туман mean? ("Fog".) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Thunderstorm, Ice, Hill, Rock, Wave

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thunderstorm, ice, a hill, a rock and a wave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 115: I can say a thunderstorm, ice, a hill, a rock and a wave.*

115.1 гроза (grozá) — a thunderstorm

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a holiday, then the Russian for fog.

You'll want to know: гроза

гроза (*grozá*) — "a thunderstorm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гроза ← Proto-Slavic **groza*, "terror, dread" — inherited; грозить, "to threaten", is its verb. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *gražóti*, "to threaten", and perhaps Greek *gorgós*, "fearsome", as in the Gorgon.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *grozá*
- *Say it:* *grozá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grozá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a holiday, then the Russian for fog, then say *grozá* again

Before you move on

What does гроза mean? (“A thunderstorm”.) Say it once more.

115.2 лёд (lyod) — ice

Before the new one: say the Russian for fog, then the Russian for a thunderstorm.

You’ll want to know: лёд

лёд (*lyod*) — “ice”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лёд ← Proto-Slavic **ledŭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *ledùs* and Latvian *ledus*, “ice” (Vasmer). A link with Greek *líthos*, “stone”, he finds doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *lyod*
- *Say it:* *lyod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fog, then the Russian for a thunderstorm, then say *lyod* again

Before you move on

What does лёд mean? ("Ice".) Say it once more.

115.3 холм (kholm) — a hill

Before the new one: say the Russian for a thunderstorm, then the Russian for ice.

You'll want to know: холм

холм (*kholm*) — "a hill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

холм ← Proto-Slavic **xŭlmŭ*, borrowed from early Germanic **hulma-*, as in Old English *holm*, "a height", and Old Norse *holmr*, "an islet" (Vasmer). He rejects attempts to make it native.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kholm*
- *Say it: kholm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kholm*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a thunderstorm, then the Russian for ice, then say *kholm* again

Before you move on

What does холм mean? ("A hill".) Say it once more.

115.4 скала (skalá) — a rock, a cliff

Before the new one: say the Russian for ice, then the Russian for a hill.

You'll want to know: скала

скала (*skalá*) — "a rock, a cliff".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скала ← Proto-Slavic **skala* — inherited, from a root "to split", as in осколок, "a splinter", and щель, "a crack" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *skélti*, "to split", and Old Norse *skilja*, "to separate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *skalá*
- *Say it:* *skalá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skalá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ice, then the Russian for a hill, then say *skalá* again

Before you move on

What does скала mean? ("A rock, a cliff".) Say it once more.

115.5 волна (volná) — a wave

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hill, then the Russian for a rock.

You'll want to know: волна

волна (*volná*) — "a wave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

волна ← Proto-Slavic **vĭlna* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *vilnìs*, "wave", Old High German *wella*, "wave", and Sanskrit *ūrmí-*, "wave" (Vasmer). It is a separate word from волна, "wool".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: volná*
- *Say it: volná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *volná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hill, then the Russian for a rock, then say *volná* again

Before you move on

What does волна mean? ("A wave".) Say it once more.

115.6 Food, work and school — a first pass

Say the words for a rock and a wave.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- flour, chocolate, biscuits, a sandwich, a sauce
- a dessert, a yoghurt, ice cream, sausage, a peach
- jam, a nut, pepper, a nurse, a cook
- a police officer, a shop assistant, a farmer, a baker, a driver
- a lawyer, an engineer, a firefighter, a postman, a waiter

Before you move on

Flour? (мука.) Chocolate? (шоколад.) Biscuits? (печенье.) A sandwich? (бутерброд.) A sauce? (соус.) A dessert? (десерт.) A yoghurt? (йогурт.) Ice cream? (мороженое.) Sausage? (колбаса.) A peach? (персик.) Jam? (варенье.) A nut? (орех.)

Pepper? (перец.) A nurse? (медсестра.) A cook? (повар.) A police officer? (полицейский.) A shop assistant? (продавец.) A farmer? (фермер.) A baker? (пекарь.) A driver? (водитель.) A lawyer? (юрист.) An engineer? (инженер.) A firefighter? (пожарный.) A postman? (почтальон.) A waiter? (официант.)

115.7 Free time and nature — a second pass

Say the words for a customer and a till.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a customer, a till, a boss, a profession, a class
- an exam, a board, a rubber, homework, an idea
- a problem, a sentence, a page, music, sport
- a game, a film, a song, a drawing, life
- a price, football, a concert, a holiday, fog
- a thunderstorm, ice, a hill, a rock, a wave

Before you move on

A customer? (клиент.) A till? (касса.) A boss? (начальник.) A profession? (профессия.) A class? (класс.) An exam? (экзамен.) A board? (доска.) A rubber? (ластик.) Homework? (домашнее задание.) An idea? (идея.) A problem? (проблема.) A sentence? (предложение.) A page? (страница.) Music? (музыка.) Sport? (спорт.) A game? (игра.) A film? (фильм.) A song? (песня.) A drawing? (рисунок.) Life? (жизнь.) A price? (цена.) Football? (футбол.) A concert? (концерт.) A holiday? (праздник.) Fog? (туман.) A thunderstorm? (гроза.) Ice? (лёд.) A hill? (холм.) A rock? (скала.) A wave? (волна.)

Chapter 116

Desert, Volcano, Cave, Waterfall, Donkey

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a desert, a volcano, a cave, a waterfall and a donkey.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 116: I can say a desert, a volcano, a cave, a waterfall and a donkey.

116.1 пустыня (pustýnya) — a desert

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rock, a cliff, then the Russian for a wave.

You'll want to know: пустыня

пустыня (*pustýnya*) — "a desert".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пустыня is built on пустой, "empty", Proto-Slavic **pustŭ* (Vasmer): a desert is the empty land.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pustýnya*
- *Say it: pustýnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pustýnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rock, a cliff, then the Russian for a wave, then say *pustýnya* again

Before you move on

What does пустыня mean? ("A desert".) Say it once more.

116.2 вулкан (vulkán) — a volcano

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wave, then the Russian for a desert.

You'll want to know: вулкан

вулкан (*vulkán*) — "a volcano".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вулкан comes, through western European languages, from Latin *Vulcānus*, the god of fire and the forge.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vulkán*
- *Say it: vulkán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vulkán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wave, then the Russian for a desert, then say *vulkán* again

Before you move on

What does вулкан mean? ("A volcano".) Say it once more.

116.3 пещера (peshchéra) — a cave

Before the new one: say the Russian for a desert, then the Russian for a volcano.

You'll want to know: пещера

пещера (*peshchéra*) — "a cave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пещера — Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, beside the East Slavic печора; he notes the link with печь, "a stove, an oven". The -щ- against -ч- marks the church form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peshchéra*
- *Say it: peshchéra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peshchéra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a desert, then the Russian for a volcano, then say *peshchéra* again

Before you move on

What does пещера mean? ("A cave".) Say it once more.

116.4 водопад (vodopád) — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the Russian for a volcano, then the Russian for a cave.

You'll want to know: водопад

водопад (*vodopád*) — "a waterfall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

водопад is вода, "water", with -о- and пад, from падать, "to fall": falling water.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vodopád*
- *Say it: vodopád*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vodopád*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a volcano, then the Russian for a cave, then say *vodopád* again

Before you move on

What does водопад mean? ("A waterfall".) Say it once more.

116.5 осёл (osyól) — a donkey

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cave, then the Russian for a waterfall.

You'll want to know: осёл

осёл (*osyól*) — "a donkey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

осёл ← Old Russian *osĭlŭ*, borrowed from Gothic *asilus*, from Latin *asinus*, "ass", and fitted to Slavic words in *-ĭlŭ* such as козёл, "billy goat" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: osyól*
- *Say it: osyól*, once more
- *Say it:* say *osyól*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cave, then the Russian for a waterfall, then say *osyól* again

Before you move on

What does осёл mean? ("A donkey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 117

Rabbit, Tiger, Butterfly, Frog, Tortoise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a rabbit, a tiger, a butterfly, a frog and a tortoise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 117: I can say a rabbit, a tiger, a butterfly, a frog and a tortoise.*

117.1 кролик (królik) — a rabbit

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a waterfall, then the Russian for a donkey.

You'll want to know: кролик

кролик (*królik*) — "a rabbit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кролик comes from Polish *królik*, "little king", which copies a German dialect *Künigl*, Middle High German *küniklîn*, from Latin *cunīculus*, "rabbit", heard as "little king" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: królik*
- *Say it: królik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *królik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a waterfall, then the Russian for a donkey, then say *królik* again

Before you move on

What does кролик mean? (“A rabbit”.) Say it once more.

117.2 тигр (tigr) — a tiger

Before the new one: say the Russian for a donkey, then the Russian for a rabbit.

You’ll want to know: тигр

тигр (*tigr*) — “a tiger”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тигр — Old Church Slavonic already had *tigrŭ*, from Greek *tígris*, which Vasmer traces to Avestan *tighri-*, “an arrow”; the modern word came again through French *tigre* or German *Tiger*, Latin *tigris*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tigr*
- *Say it: tigr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tigr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a donkey, then the Russian for a rabbit, then say *tigr* again

Before you move on

What does тигр mean? (“A tiger”.) Say it once more.

117.3 бабочка (bábochka) — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rabbit, then the Russian for a tiger.

You’ll want to know: бабочка

бабочка (*bábochka*) — “a butterfly”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бабочка is a diminutive of бабка, “granny” (Vasmer), from the belief that the soul of a dead person lives on as a butterfly; Greek *psychḗ* is both “soul” and “butterfly”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bábochka*
- *Say it: bábochka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bábochka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rabbit, then the Russian for a tiger, then say *bábochka* again

Before you move on

What does бабочка mean? (“A butterfly”.) Say it once more.

117.4 лягушка (lyagúshka) — a frog

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tiger, then the Russian for a butterfly.

You'll want to know: лягушка

лягушка (*lyagúshka*) — "a frog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лягушка comes from ляга, "a thigh", and лягать, "to kick" (Vasmer): the frog as the kicker.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lyagúshka*
- *Say it: lyagúshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyagúshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tiger, then the Russian for a butterfly, then say *lyagúshka* again

Before you move on

What does лягушка mean? ("A frog".) Say it once more.

117.5 черепаха (cherepákha) — a tortoise, a turtle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a butterfly, then the Russian for a frog.

You'll want to know: черепаха

черепаха (*cherepákha*) — "a tortoise, a turtle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

черепаха is built on череп, "a skull, a shell" (Vasmer), and replaced an older Slavic **žely*, "tortoise", for taboo reasons, after Zelenin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cherepákha*
- *Say it: cherepákha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cherepákha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a butterfly, then the Russian for a frog, then say *cherepákha* again

Before you move on

What does черепаха mean? ("A tortoise, a turtle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Squirrel, Owl, Whale, Dolphin, Elbow

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a squirrel, an owl, a whale, a dolphin and an elbow.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 118: I can say a squirrel, an owl, a whale, a dolphin and an elbow.

118.1 белка (bélka) — a squirrel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a frog, then the Russian for a tortoise.

You'll want to know: белка

белка (*bélka*) — "a squirrel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

белка comes from белый, "white": Old Russian chronicles speak of бела веверица, "a white squirrel", fur paid as tribute; Vasmer calls the link proven.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bélka*
- *Say it:* *bélka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bélka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a frog, then the Russian for a tortoise, then say *bélka* again

Before you move on

What does белка mean? ("A squirrel".) Say it once more.

118.2 сова (sová) — an owl

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tortoise, then the Russian for a squirrel.

You'll want to know: сова

сова (*sová*) — "an owl".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сова ← Proto-Slavic **sova* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Welsh *cuan*, "night owl", Old High German *hûwo*, "owl", and Lithuanian *šaũkti*, "to cry out": the owl as the hooter.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sová*
- *Say it:* *sová*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sová*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tortoise, then the Russian for a squirrel, then say *sová* again

Before you move on

What does сова mean? ("An owl".) Say it once more.

118.3 кит (kit) — a whale

Before the new one: say the Russian for a squirrel, then the Russian for an owl.

You'll want to know: кит

кит (*kit*) — "a whale".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кит ← Old Church Slavonic *kitŭ*, from Greek *kêtos*, "a sea monster, a whale" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kit*
- *Say it: kit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a squirrel, then the Russian for an owl, then say *kit* again

Before you move on

What does кит mean? ("A whale".) Say it once more.

118.4 дельфин (delfín) — a dolphin

Before the new one: say the Russian for an owl, then the Russian for a whale.

You'll want to know: дельфин

дельфин (*delfín*) — "a dolphin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дельфин comes from German *Delphin* (Vasmer), from Latin *delphīnus*, Greek *delphís*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: delfín*
- *Say it: delfín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *delfín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an owl, then the Russian for a whale, then say *delfín* again

Before you move on

What does дельфин mean? ("A dolphin".) Say it once more.

118.5 локоть (lókot) — an elbow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a whale, then the Russian for a dolphin.

You'll want to know: локоть

локоть (*lókot*) — "an elbow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

локоть ← Proto-Slavic **olkŭtĭ* — inherited; East Slavic *ol-* became ло-. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *alkūnė* and Old Prussian *alkunis*, "elbow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lókot*
- *Say it: lókot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lókot*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a whale, then the Russian for a dolphin, then say *lókot* again

Before you move on

What does **локоть** mean? ("An elbow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Ankle, Wrist, Cheek, Lips, Chest

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an ankle, a wrist, a cheek, lips and the chest.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 119: I can say an ankle, a wrist, a cheek, lips and the chest.*

119.1 лодыжка (lodýzhka) — an ankle

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a dolphin, then the Russian for an elbow.

You'll want to know: лодыжка

лодыжка (*lodýzhka*) — "an ankle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лодыжка is built on лодыга, "an ankle bone; a hollow stalk", with -ка. Vasmer calls лодыга unclear and finds the proposed sources, a Polish loan, Latin *lactūca*, "lettuce", or German, unconvincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lodýzhka*
- *Say it: lodýzhka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lodýzhka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dolphin, then the Russian for an elbow, then say *lodýzhka* again

Before you move on

What does лодыжка mean? ("An ankle".) Say it once more.

119.2 запястье (zapyástye) — a wrist

Before the new one: say the Russian for an elbow, then the Russian for an ankle.

You'll want to know: запястье

запястье (*zapyástye*) — "a wrist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

запястье is за-, "beyond", with пясть, "the palm, the metacarpus": the part beyond the hand. Vasmer relates пясть to Old High German *fûst*, "fist", so English *fist* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zapyástye*
- *Say it: zapyástye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zapyástye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an elbow, then the Russian for an ankle, then say *zapyástye* again

Before you move on

What does запястье mean? ("A wrist".) Say it once more.

119.3 щека (shcheká) — a cheek

Before the new one: say the Russian for an ankle, then the Russian for a wrist.

You'll want to know: щека

щека (*shcheká*) — "a cheek".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

щека ← Proto-Slavic **ščeka* — inherited. It is thought to be related to Old Norse *skegg*, "beard", and *skagi*, "a cape" (Vasmer); dialects use it for a steep river bank.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shcheká*
- *Say it: shcheká*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shcheká*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an ankle, then the Russian for a wrist, then say *shcheká* again

Before you move on

What does щека mean? ("A cheek".) Say it once more.

119.4 губы (gúby) — lips

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wrist, then the Russian for a cheek.

You'll want to know: губы

губы (*gúby*) — "lips".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

губы is the plural of губа, "lip", Proto-Slavic **gǫba*. Its deeper origin is unclear: Vasmer weighs Greek *gamphaí*, "jaws", and the губа that means "sponge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gúby*
- *Say it:* *gúby*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gúby*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wrist, then the Russian for a cheek, then say *gúby* again

Before you move on

What does губы mean? ("Lips".) Say it once more.

119.5 грудь (grud) — the chest

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cheek, then the Russian for lips.

You'll want to know: грудь

грудь (*grud*) — "the chest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грудь ← Proto-Slavic **grǫdь* — inherited. Vasmer compares Latin *grandis*, "great", and Greek *bré́nthos*, "pride"; Trubachev, in a note, reports that Vaillant links it instead with гряда, "a beam, a bed", so

the origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grud*
- *Say it: grud*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grud*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cheek, then the Russian for lips, then say *grud* again

Before you move on

What does грудь mean? ("The chest".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Lion, Monkey, Elephant, Bee, Ant

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lion, a monkey, an elephant, a bee and an ant.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 120: I can say a lion, a monkey, an elephant, a bee and an ant.*

120.1 лев (lev) — a lion

> Before the new one: say the Russian for lips, then the Russian for the chest.

You'll want to know: лев

лев (*lev*) — "a lion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лев ← Old High German *lëwo*, from Latin *leō*, Greek *léōn* (Vasmer). Vasmer thinks it came through books, since a spoken loan would have given лёв, and that the word's ultimate source is probably Semitic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lev*
- *Say it: lev*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lev*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for lips, then the Russian for the chest, then say *lev* again

Before you move on

What does лев mean? ("A lion".) Say it once more.

120.2 обезьяна (obezyána) — a monkey

Before the new one: say the Russian for the chest, then the Russian for a lion.

You'll want to know: обезьяна

обезьяна (*obezyána*) — "a monkey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обезьяна — Old Russian обезьяна, recorded by Afanasy Nikitin; it comes from Turkish and Persian *abuzine*, "monkey", reshaped, it is thought, to look like Russian words with о- and без-, an account Vasmer finds not fully satisfying.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obezyána*
- *Say it: obezyána*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obezyána*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for the chest, then the Russian for a lion, then say *obezyána* again

Before you move on

What does обезьяна mean? (“A monkey”.) Say it once more.

120.3 слон (slon) — an elephant

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lion, then the Russian for a monkey.

You’ll want to know: слон

слон (*slon*) — “an elephant”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слон — origin disputed. It is usually read as a bookish coinage from прислониться, “to lean”, after the old *Physiologus*, which says the elephant sleeps leaning on a tree; Vasmer thinks that link is folk etymology and finds a loan from Turkic *arslan*, “lion”, acceptable in its sounds.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: slon*
- *Say it: slon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slon*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lion, then the Russian for a monkey, then say *slon* again

Before you move on

What does слон mean? (“An elephant”.) Say it once more.

120.4 пчела (pchelá) — a bee

Before the new one: say the Russian for a monkey, then the Russian for an elephant.

You'll want to know: пчела

пчела (*pchelá*) — "a bee".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пчела ← Proto-Slavic **bǐčela* — inherited; б turned to п before ч. Vasmer relates it to Irish *bech*, Lithuanian *bìtė* and Old High German *bîa*, all "bee": English *bee* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pchelá*
- *Say it: pchelá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pchelá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a monkey, then the Russian for an elephant, then say *pchelá* again

Before you move on

What does пчела mean? ("A bee".) Say it once more.

120.5 муравей (muravéy) — an ant

Before the new one: say the Russian for an elephant, then the Russian for a bee.

You'll want to know: муравей

муравей (*muravéy*) — "an ant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

муравей ← Proto-Slavic **morvĭjĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Irish *moirb*, Avestan *maoiri-* and Old Norse *maurr*, all "ant"; Latin *formīca*, "ant", is related too.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muravéy*
- *Say it: muravéy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muravéy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an elephant, then the Russian for a bee, then say *muravéy* again

Before you move on

What does муравей mean? ("An ant".) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Shark, Nail, Skin, Stomach, Throat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a shark, a nail, skin, a stomach and a throat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 121: I can say a shark, a nail, skin, a stomach and a throat.*

121.1 акула (akúla) — a shark

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bee, then the Russian for an ant.

You'll want to know: акула

акула (*akúla*) — "a shark".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

акула comes from Old Norse *hákall*, "shark", with an -а added to match рыба, "fish" (Vasmer); Itkonen took it through Sami *akkli*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: akúla*
- *Say it: akúla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akúla*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bee, then the Russian for an ant, then say *akúla* again

Before you move on

What does акула mean? ("A shark".) Say it once more.

121.2 ноготь (nógot) — a nail

Before the new one: say the Russian for an ant, then the Russian for a shark.

You'll want to know: ноготь

ноготь (*nógot*) — "a nail".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ноготь ← Proto-Slavic **nogŭtĭ*, a diminutive built on нога, "leg", first "claw" (Vasmer); Lithuanian *nagùtis*, "nail, claw", is a cousin, and so is English *nail*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nógot*
- *Say it: nógot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nógot*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an ant, then the Russian for a shark, then say *nógot* again

Before you move on

What does ноготь mean? (“A nail”.) Say it once more.

121.3 кожа (kózha) — skin

Before the new one: say the Russian for a shark, then the Russian for a nail.

You’ll want to know: кожа

кожа (*kózha*) — “skin”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кожа comes from коза, “goat”, Proto-Slavic **kozja*, “goat’s (hide)” (Vasmer), as Greek *ōa*, “sheepskin”, comes from *óis*, “sheep”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kózha*
- *Say it: kózha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kózha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a shark, then the Russian for a nail, then say *kózha* again

Before you move on

What does кожа mean? (“Skin”.) Say it once more.

121.4 желудок (zhelúdok) — a stomach

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nail, then the Russian for skin.

You'll want to know: желудок

желудок (*zhelúdok*) — "a stomach".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

желудок — Old Russian also желудь, "stomach". Brückner and Mladenov linked it with жёлудь, "acorn", but others reject this because the accents differ, Vasmer reports; Lithuanian *skilándis*, "a stuffed pig's stomach", is built the same way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhelúdok*
- *Say it: zhelúdok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhelúdok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nail, then the Russian for skin, then say *zhelúdok* again

Before you move on

What does желудок mean? ("A stomach".) Say it once more.

121.5 горло (górlo) — a throat

Before the new one: say the Russian for skin, then the Russian for a stomach.

You'll want to know: горло

горло (*górlo*) — "a throat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

горло ← Proto-Slavic **gŭrdlo* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *gurklỹs*, "crop, throat", Old Prussian *gurcle*, "throat", and

to жрать, “to devour”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: górlo*
- *Say it: górlo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *górlo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for skin, then the Russian for a stomach, then say *górlo* again

Before you move on

What does горло mean? (“A throat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

Chin, Rainbow, Lightning, Thunder, Planet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a chin, a rainbow, lightning, thunder and a planet.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 122: I can say a chin, a rainbow, lightning, thunder and a planet.

122.1 подбородок (podboródok) — a chin

Before the new one: say the Russian for a stomach, then the Russian for a throat.

You'll want to know: подбородок

подбородок (*podboródok*) — "a chin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подбородок is под, "under", with борода, "beard", and -ок: the part under the beard. Vasmer relates борода to Lithuanian *barzdà*, Latin *barba* and Old High German *bart*: English *beard* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podboródok*
- *Say it: podboródok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podboródok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a stomach, then the Russian for a throat, then say *podboródok* again

Before you move on

What does подбородок mean? ("A chin".) Say it once more.

122.2 радуга (ráduga) — a rainbow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a throat, then the Russian for a chin.

You'll want to know: радуга

радуга (*ráduga*) — "a rainbow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

радуга — Vasmer finds most likely a derivation **radǫga* from рад, "glad", since dialects also call the rainbow весёлка, "the merry one". The form райдуга, with рай, "paradise", he takes as folk etymology.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ráduga*
- *Say it: ráduga*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ráduga*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a throat, then the Russian for a chin, then say *ráduga* again

Before you move on

What does радуга mean? (“A rainbow”.) Say it once more.

122.3 молния (mólniya) — lightning

Before the new one: say the Russian for a chin, then the Russian for a rainbow.

You’ll want to know: молния

молния (*mólniya*) — “lightning”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молния ← Proto-Slavic **mŭlnĭji* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *mealde*, “lightning”, Welsh *mellt*, “lightning”, and Old Norse *Mjǫllnir*, the name of Thor’s hammer.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mólniya*
- *Say it:* *mólniya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mólniya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a chin, then the Russian for a rainbow, then say *mólniya* again

Before you move on

What does молния mean? (“Lightning”.) Say it once more.

122.4 гром (grom) — thunder

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rainbow, then the Russian for lightning.

You'll want to know: гром

гром (*grom*) — "thunder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гром ← Proto-Slavic **gromŭ* — inherited, with греметь, "to rumble" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *grumins*, "thunder", Lithuanian *gruménti*, "to rumble", and Greek *chrómos*, "a crash".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grom*
- *Say it: grom*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grom*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rainbow, then the Russian for lightning, then say *grom* again

Before you move on

What does гром mean? ("Thunder".) Say it once more.

122.5 планета (planéta) — a planet

Before the new one: say the Russian for lightning, then the Russian for thunder.

You'll want to know: планета

планета (*planéta*) — "a planet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

планета came through Polish *planeta* from Latin *planēta*, Greek *planḗtēs*, "a wanderer": a planet is a wandering star (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: planéta*
- *Say it: planéta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *planéta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for lightning, then the Russian for thunder, then say *planéta* again

Before you move on

What does планета mean? ("A planet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

Space, Bottle, Mirror, Stairs, Pink

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say space, a bottle, a mirror, stairs and pink.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 123: I can say space, a bottle, a mirror, stairs and pink.*

123.1 КОСМОС (kósmos) — space

Before the new one: say the Russian for thunder, then the Russian for a planet.

You'll want to know: КОСМОС

КОСМОС (*kósmos*) — "space".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

КОСМОС comes from Greek *kósmos*, "order, ornament", and so "the ordered world".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kósmos*

- *Say it: kósmos*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kósmos*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for thunder, then the Russian for a planet, then say *kósmos* again

Before you move on

What does космос mean? (“Space”.) Say it once more.

123.2 бутылка (butýlka) — a bottle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a planet, then the Russian for space.

You’ll want to know: бутылка

бутылка (*butýlka*) — “a bottle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бутылка — from 1694; it came through Ukrainian and Polish *butelka* or straight from French *bouteille*, Medieval Latin *buticula*, from *buttis*, “a cask” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: butýlka*
- *Say it: butýlka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *butýlka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a planet, then the Russian for space, then say *butýlka* again

Before you move on

What does бутылка mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

123.3 зеркало (zérkalo) — a mirror

Before the new one: say the Russian for space, then the Russian for a bottle.

You'll want to know: зеркало

зеркало (*zérkalo*) — "a mirror".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зеркало is built on the root of зреть, "to look", and зоркий, "sharp-sighted"; Vasmer thinks it probably copies Latin *speculum*, "mirror", from *specere*, "to look". Church Slavonic has зерцало, "mirror".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zérkalo*
- *Say it: zérkalo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zérkalo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for space, then the Russian for a bottle, then say *zérkalo* again

Before you move on

What does зеркало mean? ("A mirror".) Say it once more.

123.4 лестница (léstnitsa) — stairs

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bottle, then the Russian for a mirror.

You'll want to know: лестница

лестница (*léstnitsa*) — "stairs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лестница ← Old Russian *lěstvica*, the same word as in Old Church Slavonic, built on **lěstva*, "a ladder", from the root of лезть, "to climb" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: léstnitsa*
- *Say it: léstnitsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *léstnitsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bottle, then the Russian for a mirror, then say *léstnitsa* again

Before you move on

What does лестница mean? ("Stairs".) Say it once more.

123.5 розовый (rózovyy) — pink

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mirror, then the Russian for stairs.

You'll want to know: розовый

розовый (*rózovyy*) — "pink".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

розовый is built on роза, “a rose”, perhaps through Ukrainian рожевий and Polish *różowy*, “pink” (Vasmer). роза goes back to Latin *rosa*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rózovyy*
- *Say it: rózovyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rózovyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mirror, then the Russian for stairs, then say *rózovyy* again

Before you move on

What does розовый mean? (“Pink”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Purple, Brown, Grey, Orange, Busy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say purple, brown, grey, orange and busy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 124: I can say purple, brown, grey, orange and busy.*

124.1 фиолетовый (fiolétovyy) — purple

> Before the new one: say the Russian for stairs, then the Russian for pink.

You'll want to know: фиолетовый

фиолетовый (*fiolétovyy*) — "purple".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фиолетовый — its ф- shows it came through German *violett* from French *violet*, from *violette*, Latin *viola*, "the violet" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fiolétovyy*
- *Say it: fiolétovyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fiolétovyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for stairs, then the Russian for pink, then say *fiolétovyy* again

Before you move on

What does фиолетовый mean? ("Purple".) Say it once more.

124.2 коричневый (koríchnevyy) — brown

Before the new one: say the Russian for pink, then the Russian for purple.

You'll want to know: коричневый

коричневый (*koríchnevyy*) — "brown".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

коричневый is "cinnamon-coloured", from корица, "cinnamon", a diminutive of кора, "bark" (Vasmer): cinnamon is a bark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koríchnevyy*
- *Say it: koríchnevyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koríchnevyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pink, then the Russian for purple, then say *koríchnevyy* again

Before you move on

What does коричневый mean? (“Brown”.) Say it once more.

124.3 серый (séryy) — grey

Before the new one: say the Russian for purple, then the Russian for brown.

You’ll want to know: серый

серый (*séryy*) — “grey”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

серый ← Proto-Slavic **sěrŭ*, from **xoiro-* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Norse *hárr*, “grey, hoary”, and Old English *hār*, so English *hoar* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: séryy*
- *Say it: séryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *séryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for purple, then the Russian for brown, then say *séryy* again

Before you move on

What does серый mean? (“Grey”.) Say it once more.

124.4 оранжевый (óranzhevyy) — orange (the colour)

Before the new one: say the Russian for brown, then the Russian for grey.

You'll want to know: оранжевый

оранжевый (*óranzhevyy*) — "orange (the colour)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

оранжевый is a late borrowing from French *orange*, "an orange", perhaps through German; the source is Persian and Arabic *nāranj*, whose home is sought in India, Sanskrit *nāraṅga-* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: óranzhevyy*
- *Say it: óranzhevyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *óranzhevyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for brown, then the Russian for grey, then say *óranzhevyy* again

Before you move on

What does оранжевый mean? ("Orange (the colour)".) Say it once more.

124.5 занятый (zányatyy) — busy

Before the new one: say the Russian for grey, then the Russian for orange.

You'll want to know: занятый

занятый (*zányatyy*) — "busy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

занятый is "taken up": за- with -нятый, from -нять, the old Slavic verb **jęti*, "to take", as in взять, "to take", and понимать, "to understand" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zányatyy*
- *Say it: zányatyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zányatyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for grey, then the Russian for orange, then say *zányatyy* again

Before you move on

What does занятый mean? ("Busy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Free, Open, Closed, Quiet, Noisy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say free, open, closed, quiet and noisy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 125: I can say free, open, closed, quiet and noisy.*

125.1 свободный (svobódnyy) — free

> Before the new one: say the Russian for orange, then the Russian for busy.

You'll want to know: свободный

свободный (*svobódnyy*) — "free".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свободный is built on свобода, "freedom", Proto-Slavic **svoboda*. Vasmer explains it from свой, "one's own": the standing of a free member of one's own kin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *svobódnyy*
- *Say it:* *svobódnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svobódnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for orange, then the Russian for busy, then say *svobódnyy* again

Before you move on

What does свободный mean? (“Free”.) Say it once more.

125.2 открытый (otkrýtyy) — open

Before the new one: say the Russian for busy, then the Russian for free.

You’ll want to know: открытый

открытый (*otkrýtyy*) — “open”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

открытый is “opened”, from открыть, “to open”: от-, “off”, with крыть, “to cover”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *otkrýtyy*
- *Say it:* *otkrýtyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otkrýtyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for busy, then the Russian for free, then say *otkrýtyy* again

Before you move on

What does открытый mean? ("Open".) Say it once more.

125.3 закрытый (zakrýtyy) — closed

Before the new one: say the Russian for free, then the Russian for open.

You'll want to know: закрытый

закрытый (*zakrýtyy*) — "closed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

закрытый is "closed", from закрыть, "to close": за-, "over", with крыть, "to cover".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zakrýtyy*
- *Say it: zakrýtyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zakrýtyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for free, then the Russian for open, then say *zakrýtyy* again

Before you move on

What does закрытый mean? ("Closed".) Say it once more.

125.4 тихий (tíkhiy) — quiet

Before the new one: say the Russian for open, then the Russian for closed.

You'll want to know: тихий

тихий (*tíkhiy*) — "quiet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тихий ← Proto-Slavic **tixŭ* — inherited, with тешить, "to comfort" (Vasmer). Vasmer thinks it is probably related to Lithuanian *teisùs*, "fair, righteous", and *tiesà*, "truth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tíkhiy*
- *Say it: tíkhiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tíkhiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for open, then the Russian for closed, then say *tíkhiy* again

Before you move on

What does тихий mean? ("Quiet".) Say it once more.

125.5 шумный (shúmnyy) — noisy

Before the new one: say the Russian for closed, then the Russian for quiet.

You'll want to know: шумный

шумный (*shúmnyy*) — "noisy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шумный is шум, "noise", with -ный. Vasmer calls a link of шум with Sanskrit *śúṣma-*, "hissing", guesswork; others take it as imitating a sound.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shúmnyy*
- *Say it: shúmnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shúmnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for closed, then the Russian for quiet, then say *shúmnyy* again

Before you move on

What does шумный mean? ("Noisy".) Say it once more.

125.6 Animals, the body and the table — a first pass

Say the words for quiet and noisy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a desert, a volcano, a cave, a waterfall, a donkey
- a rabbit, a tiger, a butterfly, a frog, a tortoise
- a squirrel, an owl, a whale, a dolphin, an elbow
- an ankle, a wrist, a cheek, lips, the chest
- a lion, a monkey, an elephant, a bee, an ant

Before you move on

A desert? (пустыня.) A volcano? (вулкан.) A cave? (пещера.) A waterfall? (водопад.) A donkey? (осёл.) A rabbit? (кролик.) A

tiger? (тигр.) A butterfly? (бабочка.) A frog? (лягушка.) A tortoise? (черепаха.) A squirrel? (белка.) An owl? (сова.) A whale? (кит.) A dolphin? (дельфин.) An elbow? (локоть.) An ankle? (лодыжка.) A wrist? (запястье.) A cheek? (щека.) Lips? (губы.) The chest? (грудь.) A lion? (лев.) A monkey? (обезьяна.) An elephant? (слон.) A bee? (пчела.) An ant? (муравей.)

125.7 The house and describing words — a second pass

Say the words for a shark and a nail.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a shark, a nail, skin, a stomach, a throat
- a chin, a rainbow, lightning, thunder, a planet
- space, a bottle, a mirror, stairs, pink
- purple, brown, grey, orange, busy
- free, open, closed, quiet, noisy

Before you move on

A shark? (акула.) A nail? (ноготь.) Skin? (кожа.) A stomach? (желудок.) A throat? (горло.) A chin? (подбородок.) A rainbow? (радуга.) Lightning? (молния.) Thunder? (гром.) A planet? (планета.) Space? (космос.) A bottle? (бутылка.) A mirror? (зеркало.) Stairs? (лестница.) Pink? (розовый.) Purple? (фиолетовый.) Brown? (коричневый.) Grey? (серый.) Orange? (оранжевый.) Busy? (занятый.) Free? (свободный.) Open? (открытый.) Closed? (закрытый.) Quiet? (тихий.) Noisy? (шумный.)

Chapter 126

Last, Famous, Important, Interesting, Boring

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say last, famous, important, interesting and boring.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 126: I can say last, famous, important, interesting and boring.

126.1 последний (poslédniy) — last

Before the new one: say the Russian for quiet, then the Russian for noisy.

You'll want to know: последний

последний (*poslédniy*) — "last".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

последний comes from Old Russian последь, "afterwards", which goes with след, "a track" (Vasmer): the last is the one at the back of the track.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poslédniy*
- *Say it: poslédniy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poslédniy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for quiet, then the Russian for noisy, then say *poslédniy* again

Before you move on

What does последний mean? ("Last".) Say it once more.

126.2 известный (izvéstnyy) — famous

Before the new one: say the Russian for noisy, then the Russian for last.

You'll want to know: известный

известный (*izvéstnyy*) — "famous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

известный is built on известие, "news", из- with весть, "a message", from ведать, "to know" (Vasmer): "known". Vasmer compares Sanskrit *vitti-*, "knowledge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: izvéstnyy*
- *Say it: izvéstnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *izvéstnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for noisy, then the Russian for last, then say *izvéstnyy* again

Before you move on

What does известный mean? ("Famous".) Say it once more.

126.3 важный (vázhnyy) — important

Before the new one: say the Russian for last, then the Russian for famous.

You'll want to know: важный

важный (*vázhnyy*) — "important".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

важный apparently came from Polish *ważny*, "weighty", from *waga*, "a scale", from German *Waage*, "scales" (Vasmer): important is "weighty".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vázhnyy*
- *Say it: vázhnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vázhnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for last, then the Russian for famous, then say *vázhnyy* again

Before you move on

What does важный mean? ("Important".) Say it once more.

126.4 интересный (interésnyy) — interesting

Before the new one: say the Russian for famous, then the Russian for important.

You'll want to know: интересный

интересный (*interésnyy*) — "interesting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

интересный is built on интерес, "interest", recorded from 1703, which came perhaps through Polish *interes* or German *Interesse* from Medieval Latin *interesse*, "to matter" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: interésnyy*
- *Say it: interésnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *interésnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for famous, then the Russian for important, then say *interésnyy* again

Before you move on

What does интересный mean? ("Interesting".) Say it once more.

126.5 скучный (skúchnyy) — boring

Before the new one: say the Russian for important, then the Russian for interesting.

You'll want to know: скучный

скучный (*skúchnyy*) — "boring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скучный is скука, "boredom", with -ный. Vasmer will not separate скука from докучать, "to pester", but rejects the proposed outside links, so its origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skúchnyy*
- *Say it: skúchnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skúchnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for important, then the Russian for interesting, then say *skúchnyy* again

Before you move on

What does скучный mean? ("Boring".) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Cheerful, Kind, Angry, Serious, Right

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say cheerful, kind, angry, serious and right.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 127: I can say cheerful, kind, angry, serious and right.*

127.1 весёлый (vesyólyy) — cheerful, fun

> Before the new one: say the Russian for interesting, then the Russian for boring.

You'll want to know: весёлый

весёлый (*vesyólyy*) — "cheerful, fun".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

весёлый ← Proto-Slavic **veselŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Latvian *vesels*, "healthy, whole", and Sanskrit *vásu-*, "good".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vesyólyy*
- *Say it: vesyólyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vesyólyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for interesting, then the Russian for boring, then say *vesyólyy* again

Before you move on

What does весёлый mean? ("Cheerful, fun".) Say it once more.

127.2 добрый (dóbryy) — kind

Before the new one: say the Russian for boring, then the Russian for cheerful.

You'll want to know: добрый

добрый (*dóbryy*) — "kind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

добрый ← Proto-Slavic **dobrŭ* — inherited, with доба, "a fitting time", and доблесть, "valour". Vasmer relates it to Latin *faber*, "a craftsman", and Armenian *darbin*, "a smith": good was first "fitting, well made".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dóbryy*
- *Say it: dóbryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dóbryy*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for boring, then the Russian for cheerful, then say *dóbryy* again

Before you move on

What does добрый mean? (“Kind”.) Say it once more.

127.3 злой (zloy) — angry; wicked

Before the new one: say the Russian for cheerful, then the Russian for kind.

You’ll want to know: злой

злой (*zloy*) — “angry; wicked”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

злой ← Proto-Slavic **zŭlŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *atžūlùs*, “harsh”, and Ossetic *æwzær*, “bad”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zloy*
- *Say it: zloy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zloy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cheerful, then the Russian for kind, then say *zloy* again

Before you move on

What does злой mean? (“Angry; wicked”.) Say it once more.

127.4 серьёзный (seryóznyy) — serious

Before the new one: say the Russian for kind, then the Russian for angry; wicked.

You'll want to know: серьёзный

серьёзный (*seryóznyy*) — "serious".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

серьёзный is a recent loan from French *sérieux*, from Medieval Latin *sēriōsus*, Latin *sērius*, "grave" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: seryóznyy*
- *Say it: seryóznyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *seryóznyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for kind, then the Russian for angry; wicked, then say *seryóznyy* again

Before you move on

What does серьёзный mean? ("Serious".) Say it once more.

127.5 правильный (právilnyy) — right, correct

Before the new one: say the Russian for angry; wicked, then the Russian for serious.

You'll want to know: правильный

правильный (*právilnyy*) — "right, correct".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

правильный is правило, “a rule”, with -ный. правило is built on правый, “right, straight”, which Vasmer derives, probably, from **prō-vos*, “forward”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: právilnyy*
- *Say it: právilnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *právilnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for angry; wicked, then the Russian for serious, then say *právilnyy* again

Before you move on

What does правильный mean? (“Right, correct”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 128

Wrong, Ready, Dangerous, Wet, Dry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say wrong, ready, dangerous, wet and dry.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can say wrong, ready, dangerous, wet and dry.

128.1 неправильный (neprávilnyy) — wrong

Before the new one: say the Russian for serious, then the Russian for right.

You'll want to know: неправильный

неправильный (*neprávilnyy*) — "wrong".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

неправильный is не, "not", with правильный, "correct", from правило, "a rule", and правый, "straight, right".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *neprávilnyy*
- *Say it:* *neprávilnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *neprávilnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for serious, then the Russian for right, then say *neprávilnyy* again

Before you move on

What does неправильный mean? ("Wrong".) Say it once more.

128.2 готовый (gotóvyy) — ready

Before the new one: say the Russian for right, then the Russian for wrong.

You'll want to know: готовый

готовый (*gotóvyy*) — "ready".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

готовый ← Proto-Slavic **gotovŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Albanian *gatuanj*, "I cook, prepare", and rejects a loan from Gothic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gotóvyy*
- *Say it:* *gotóvyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gotóvyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for right, then the Russian for wrong, then say *gotóvyy* again

Before you move on

What does готовый mean? (“Ready”.) Say it once more.

128.3 опасный (opásnyy) — dangerous

Before the new one: say the Russian for wrong, then the Russian for ready.

You’ll want to know: опасный

опасный (*opásnyy*) — “dangerous”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

опасный goes with опасаться, “to be wary”, from пасти, “to tend, to guard” (Vasmer); Old Russian опасно meant “carefully”. Dangerous is what you must be wary of.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: opásnyy*
- *Say it: opásnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *opásnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for wrong, then the Russian for ready, then say *opásnyy* again

Before you move on

What does опасный mean? (“Dangerous”.) Say it once more.

128.4 мокрый (mókryy) — wet

Before the new one: say the Russian for ready, then the Russian for dangerous.

You'll want to know: мокрый

мокрый (*mókryy*) — "wet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мокрый ← Proto-Slavic **mokrŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *makonė*, "a puddle", and Irish *móin*, "a bog".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mókryy*
- *Say it:* *mókryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mókryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ready, then the Russian for dangerous, then say *mókryy* again

Before you move on

What does мокрый mean? ("Wet".) Say it once more.

128.5 сухой (sukhóy) — dry

Before the new one: say the Russian for dangerous, then the Russian for wet.

You'll want to know: сухой

сухой (*sukhóy*) — "dry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сухой ← Proto-Slavic **suxŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *saũsas*, Greek *aûos* and Old English *sēar*, all "dry": English *sear* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sukhóy*
- *Say it: sukhóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sukhóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dangerous, then the Russian for wet, then say *sukhóy* again

Before you move on

What does сухой mean? ("Dry".) Say it once more.

Chapter 129

Soft, Hard, Round, Wide, Narrow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say soft, hard, round, wide and narrow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say soft, hard, round, wide and narrow.*

129.1 мягкий (myákhkiy) — soft

> Before the new one: say the Russian for wet, then the Russian for dry.

You'll want to know: мягкий

мягкий (*myákhkiy*) — "soft".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мягкий ← Proto-Slavic **mękŭkŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *mìnkštas*, "soft", and *mìnkyti*, "to knead", and Greek *mássō*, "I knead"; мука, "flour", shares its root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myákhkiy*
- *Say it: myákhkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myákhkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for wet, then the Russian for dry, then say *myákhkiy* again

Before you move on

What does мягкий mean? ("Soft".) Say it once more.

129.2 твёрдый (tvyórdyy) — hard

Before the new one: say the Russian for dry, then the Russian for soft.

You'll want to know: твёрдый

твёрдый (*tvyórdyy*) — "hard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

твёрдый ← Proto-Slavic **tvьrdŭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *tvìrtas*, "firm", and Latvian *tvirts*, "strong" (Vasmer); творить, "to create", shares its root, Vasmer says.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tvyórdyy*
- *Say it: tvyórdyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tvyórdyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dry, then the Russian for soft, then say *tvyórdyy* again

Before you move on

What does твёрдый mean? (“Hard”.) Say it once more.

129.3 круглый (krúglyy) — round

Before the new one: say the Russian for soft, then the Russian for hard.

You’ll want to know: круглый

круглый (*krúglyy*) — “round”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

круглый is built on круг, “a circle, a ring” (Vasmer), with the adjective ending -лый.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krúglyy*
- *Say it: krúglyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krúglyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for soft, then the Russian for hard, then say *krúglyy* again

Before you move on

What does круглый mean? (“Round”.) Say it once more.

129.4 широкий (shirókiy) — wide

Before the new one: say the Russian for hard, then the Russian for round.

You'll want to know: широкий

широкий (*shirókiy*) — "wide".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

широкий ← Proto-Slavic **širokŭ* — inherited, from **širŭ*, "wide". Vasmer calls its further links unclear; a comparison with Gothic *skeirs*, "clear", is hard to square with the sounds.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shirókiy*
- *Say it: shirókiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shirókiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hard, then the Russian for round, then say *shirókiy* again

Before you move on

What does широкий mean? ("Wide".) Say it once more.

129.5 узкий (úzkiy) — narrow

Before the new one: say the Russian for round, then the Russian for wide.

You'll want to know: узкий

узкий (*úzkiy*) — "narrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

узкий ← Proto-Slavic **ǫzŭkŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *aṃhú-*, "narrow", Gothic *aggwus*, Lithuanian *añkštas* and Latin *angustus*, all "narrow", and Greek *ánchō*, "I squeeze".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: úzkiy*
- *Say it: úzkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úzkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for round, then the Russian for wide, then say *úzkiy* again

Before you move on

What does узкий mean? ("Narrow".) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Bitter, Salty, Heavy, Thin, Fat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say bitter, salty, heavy, thin and fat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say bitter, salty, heavy, thin and fat.*

130.1 горький (górkiy) — bitter

> Before the new one: say the Russian for wide, then the Russian for narrow.

You'll want to know: горький

горький (*górkiy*) — "bitter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

горький goes with гореть, "to burn" (Vasmer): a bitter taste burns. Vasmer compares Irish *goirt*, "bitter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: górkiy*
- *Say it: górkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *górkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for wide, then the Russian for narrow, then say *górkiy* again

Before you move on

What does горький mean? ("Bitter".) Say it once more.

130.2 солёный (solyónyy) — salty

Before the new one: say the Russian for narrow, then the Russian for bitter.

You'll want to know: солёный

солёный (*solyónyy*) — "salty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

солёный is from солить, "to salt", and соль, "salt", a cousin of Latin *sāl* and English *salt* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: solyónyy*
- *Say it: solyónyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *solyónyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for narrow, then the Russian for bitter, then say *solyónyy* again

Before you move on

What does солёный mean? (“Salty”.) Say it once more.

130.3 тяжёлый (tyazhyólyy) — heavy

Before the new one: say the Russian for bitter, then the Russian for salty.

You’ll want to know: тяжёлый

тяжёлый (*tyazhyólyy*) — “heavy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тяжёлый ← Proto-Slavic **tęžьlŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *tingùs*, “lazy”, and Old Norse *þungr*, “heavy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyazhyólyy*
- *Say it: tyazhyólyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyazhyólyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for bitter, then the Russian for salty, then say *tyazhyólyy* again

Before you move on

What does тяжёлый mean? (“Heavy”.) Say it once more.

130.4 худой (khudóy) — thin

Before the new one: say the Russian for salty, then the Russian for heavy.

You'll want to know: худой

худой (*khudóy*) — "thin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

худой ← Proto-Slavic **xudŭ* — inherited; Old Russian *xudŭ* meant "bad, poor, small". It is held to be related to Sanskrit *kṣudrá-*, "small, low" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khudóy*
- *Say it: khudóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khudóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for salty, then the Russian for heavy, then say *khudóy* again

Before you move on

What does худой mean? ("Thin".) Say it once more.

130.5 толстый (tólstyy) — fat, thick

Before the new one: say the Russian for heavy, then the Russian for thin.

You'll want to know: толстый

толстый (*tólstyy*) — "fat, thick".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

толстый ← Proto-Slavic **tŭlstŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *tulžti*, "to swell", and Latvian *tùlzt*, "to swell up".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tólstyy*
- *Say it: tólstyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tólstyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for heavy, then the Russian for thin, then say *tólstyy* again

Before you move on

What does толстый mean? ("Fat, thick".) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

To begin, To visit, To put, To believe, To drive

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to begin, to visit, to put, to believe and to drive.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can say to begin, to visit, to put, to believe and to drive.*

131.1 начинать (nachinát) — to begin

> Before the new one: say the Russian for thin, then the Russian for fat.

You'll want to know: начинать

начинать (*nachinát*) — "to begin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

начинать is the ongoing partner of начать, "to begin": на- with -чать. Vasmer finds the same root in конец, "end", and искони, "from the very start", and compares Greek *kainós*, "new".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nachinát*
- *Say it:* *nachinát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nachinát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for thin, then the Russian for fat, then say *nachinát* again

Before you move on

What does начинать mean? (“To begin”.) Say it once more.

131.2 посещать (poseshchát) — to visit

Before the new one: say the Russian for fat, then the Russian for to begin.

You’ll want to know: посещать

посещать (*poseshchát*) — “to visit”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

посещать is the ongoing partner of посетить, “to visit”, which Vasmer thinks is apparently built on an old Slavic **sětь*, “a guest”, a cousin of Lithuanian *svẽčias*, “guest”, and Greek *hetaîros*, “companion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *poseshchát*
- *Say it:* *poseshchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poseshchát*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for fat, then the Russian for to begin, then say *poseshchát* again

Before you move on

What does посещать mean? (“To visit”.) Say it once more.

131.3 класть (klast) — to put (flat)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to begin, then the Russian for to visit.

You’ll want to know: класть

класть (*klast*) — “to put (flat)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

класть ← Proto-Slavic **klasti*, present **kladǫ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *klóti*, “to spread”, and Gothic *-hlaþan*, German *laden*, “to load”: English *lade* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klast*
- *Say it: klast*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klast*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to begin, then the Russian for to visit, then say *klast* again

Before you move on

What does класть mean? (“To put (flat)”.) Say it once more.

131.4 верить (vérit) — to believe

Before the new one: say the Russian for to visit, then the Russian for to put.

You'll want to know: верить

верить (*vérit*) — "to believe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

верить comes from вера, "faith" (Vasmer), Proto-Slavic **věra*, which Vasmer relates to Avestan *varənā-*, "faith", and probably to Latin *vērus*, "true", and German *wahr*, "true".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vérit*
- *Say it: vérit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vérit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to visit, then the Russian for to put, then say *vérit* again

Before you move on

What does верить mean? ("To believe".) Say it once more.

131.5 водить (vodít) — to drive

Before the new one: say the Russian for to put, then the Russian for to believe.

You'll want to know: водить

водить (*vodít*) — "to drive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

водить ← Proto-Slavic **voditi*, “to lead”, with вести, “to lead” — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *vadýti* and Avestan *vādayeiti*, “leads”. Driving a car is “leading” it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vodít*
- *Say it: vodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to put, then the Russian for to believe, then say *vodít* again

Before you move on

What does водить mean? (“To drive”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

To get dressed, To wash, To get up, To sit down, To fall

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to get dressed, to wash, to get up, to sit down and to fall.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can say to get dressed, to wash, to get up, to sit down and to fall.*

132.1 одеваться (odevátsya) — to get dressed

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to believe, then the Russian for to drive.

You'll want to know: одеваться

одеваться (*odevátsya*) — "to get dressed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

одеваться is о-, "around", with девать, "to put", and -ся, "oneself": to put clothes around yourself. The root де-, "to put", is in одеяло, "blanket". Vasmer sets that root beside Greek *títhēmi*, "I put", and Latin *faciō*, "I make".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *odevátsya*
- *Say it:* *odevátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *odevátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to believe, then the Russian for to drive, then say *odevátsya* again

Before you move on

What does одеваться mean? (“To get dressed”.) Say it once more.

132.2 умываться (umyvátsya) — to wash (oneself)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to drive, then the Russian for to get dressed.

You’ll want to know: умываться

умываться (*umyvátsya*) — “to wash (oneself)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

умываться is у- with мыть, “to wash”, and -ся, “oneself”: to wash your own face and hands. Мыть ← Proto-Slavic **myti* — inherited; Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *máudyti*, “to bathe”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *umyvátsya*
- *Say it:* *umyvátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umyvátsya*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to drive, then the Russian for to get dressed, then say *umyvátsya* again

Before you move on

What does умываться mean? (“To wash (oneself)”.) Say it once more.

132.3 вставать (vstavát) — to get up

Before the new one: say the Russian for to get dressed, then the Russian for to wash.

You’ll want to know: вставать

вставать (*vstavát*) — “to get up”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вставать is вс-, “up”, with -ставать, from стать, “to stand”, a cousin of Latin *stāre*, “to stand” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vstavát*
- *Say it: vstavát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vstavát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to get dressed, then the Russian for to wash, then say *vstavát* again

Before you move on

What does вставать mean? (“To get up”.) Say it once more.

132.4 садиться (sadítsya) — to sit down

Before the new one: say the Russian for to wash, then the Russian for to get up.

You'll want to know: садиться

садиться (*sadítsya*) — "to sit down".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

садиться is садить, "to seat", with -ся, "oneself": to seat yourself. садить ← Proto-Slavic **saditi*, the "make sit" form of сидеть, "to sit"; Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *sādáyati*, "seats", and Gothic *satjan*, "to set".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sadítsya*
- *Say it: sadítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sadítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to wash, then the Russian for to get up, then say *sadítsya* again

Before you move on

What does садиться mean? ("To sit down".) Say it once more.

132.5 падать (pádat) — to fall

Before the new one: say the Russian for to get up, then the Russian for to sit down.

You'll want to know: падать

падать (*pádat*) — "to fall".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

падать ← Proto-Slavic **padati* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *padyate*, “falls, goes”, and Old English *fetan*, “to fall”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pádat*
- *Say it: pádat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pádat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to get up, then the Russian for to sit down, then say *pádat* again

Before you move on

What does падать mean? (“To fall”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

To go up, To go down, To stay, To rent, To repair

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to go up, to go down, to stay, to rent and to repair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say to go up, to go down, to stay, to rent and to repair.*

133.1 подниматься (podnimátsya) — to go up

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to sit down, then the Russian for to fall.

You'll want to know: подниматься

подниматься (*podnimátsya*) — "to go up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подниматься is под-, "up from under", with -нимать, from the old verb **jęti*, "to take", and -ся, "oneself": to lift yourself up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *podnimátsya*
- *Say it:* *podnimátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podnimátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sit down, then the Russian for to fall, then say *podnimátsya* again

Before you move on

What does подниматься mean? (“To go up”.) Say it once more.

133.2 спускаться (spuskátsya) — to go down

Before the new one: say the Russian for to fall, then the Russian for to go up.

You’ll want to know: спускаться

спускаться (*spuskátsya*) — “to go down”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спускаться is с-, “down”, with пускать, “to let go”, and -ся, “oneself”: to let yourself down. Vasmer links пускать with пустить and пустой, “empty”; its deeper origin is uncertain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *spuskátsya*
- *Say it:* *spuskátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spuskátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to fall, then the Russian for to go up, then say *spuskátsya* again

Before you move on

What does спускаться mean? ("To go down".) Say it once more.

133.3 оставаться (ostavátsya) — to stay

Before the new one: say the Russian for to go up, then the Russian for to go down.

You'll want to know: оставаться

оставаться (*ostavátsya*) — "to stay".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

оставаться is о- with -ставать, from стать, "to stand", and -ся: to remain where you stand.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ostavátsya*
- *Say it: ostavátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ostavátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to go up, then the Russian for to go down, then say *ostavátsya* again

Before you move on

What does оставаться mean? ("To stay".) Say it once more.

133.4 снимать (snimát) — to rent; to take off

Before the new one: say the Russian for to go down, then the Russian for to stay.

You'll want to know: снимать

снимать (*snimát*) — "to rent; to take off".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

снимать is с-, "off", with -нимать, from the old verb **jęti*, "to take": "to take off", and so "to take" a flat for rent.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: snimát*
- *Say it: snimát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *snimát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to go down, then the Russian for to stay, then say *snimát* again

Before you move on

What does снимать mean? ("To rent; to take off".) Say it once more.

133.5 чинить (chinít) — to repair

Before the new one: say the Russian for to stay, then the Russian for to rent; to take off.

You'll want to know: чинить

чинить (*chinít*) — "to repair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чинить comes from чин, "order, rank" (Vasmer): to repair is to put back in order. Vasmer relates чин to Sanskrit *cinóti*, "arranges, piles", and Greek *poiéō*, "I make".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chinít*
- *Say it: chinít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chinít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to stay, then the Russian for to rent; to take off, then say *chinít* again

Before you move on

What does **чинить** mean? ("To repair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

To tell, To go for a walk, To tidy up, To find, To look for

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to tell, to go for a walk, to tidy up, to find and to look for.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say to tell, to go for a walk, to tidy up, to find and to look for.

134.1 рассказывать (rasskázyvat) — to tell (a story)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to rent; to take off, then the Russian for to repair.

You'll want to know: рассказывать

рассказывать (*rasskázyvat*) — "to tell (a story)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рассказывать is рас-, "out, through", with -сказывать, from сказать, "to say", which Vasmer derives from казать, "to show": telling is showing in words.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rasskázyvat*
- *Say it: rasskázyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rasskázyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to rent; to take off, then the Russian for to repair, then say *rasskázyvat* again

Before you move on

What does рассказывать mean? ("To tell (a story)".) Say it once more.

134.2 гулять (gulyát) — to go for a walk

Before the new one: say the Russian for to repair, then the Russian for to tell.

You'll want to know: гулять

гулять (*gulyát*) — "to go for a walk".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гулять — "a difficult word", says Vasmer. Berneker and Brückner tied it to гул, "a hum", Potebnya and Sobolevsky to a first sense "to drink"; each is disputed, and Trubachev's note traces the sense from "to play ball".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gulyát*
- *Say it: gulyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gulyát*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to repair, then the Russian for to tell, then say *gulyát* again

Before you move on

What does гулять mean? (“To go for a walk”.) Say it once more.

134.3 убирать (ubirát) — to tidy up

Before the new one: say the Russian for to tell, then the Russian for to go for a walk.

You’ll want to know: убирать

убирать (*ubirát*) — “to tidy up”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

убирать is у-, “away”, with -бирать, from брать, “to take”: to take things away, to clear up.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ubirát*
- *Say it: ubirát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ubirát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to tell, then the Russian for to go for a walk, then say *ubirát* again

Before you move on

What does убирать mean? (“To tidy up”.) Say it once more.

134.4 находить (nakhodít) — to find

Before the new one: say the Russian for to go for a walk, then the Russian for to tidy up.

You'll want to know: находить

находить (*nakhodít*) — "to find".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

находить is на-, "onto", with ходить, "to walk": to find is to come upon a thing. Vasmer ties ход to the Indo-European root **sed-*, "to sit", its х grown from an *s* after prefixes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakhodít*
- *Say it: nakhodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakhodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to go for a walk, then the Russian for to tidy up, then say *nakhodít* again

Before you move on

What does находить mean? ("To find".) Say it once more.

134.5 искать (iskát) — to look for

Before the new one: say the Russian for to tidy up, then the Russian for to find.

You'll want to know: искать

искать (*iskát*) — "to look for".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

искать ← Proto-Slavic **iskati* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *ieškóti*, “to seek”, Sanskrit *iccháti*, “seeks, wishes”, and Old English *āscian*, so English *ask* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: iskát*
- *Say it: iskát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iskát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to tidy up, then the Russian for to find, then say *iskát* again

Before you move on

What does искать mean? (“To look for”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

To lose, To win, To look, To draw, To travel

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to lose, to win, to look, to draw and to travel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can say to lose, to win, to look, to draw and to travel.*

135.1 терять (teryát) — to lose

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to find, then the Russian for to look for.

You'll want to know: терять

терять (*teryát*) — "to lose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

терять — Old Russian терять meant "to destroy, to ruin". Vasmer finds its link with the South Slavic verbs for "to chase" uncertain and puts the East Slavic word with тереть, "to rub, to wear away".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: teryát*
- *Say it: teryát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *teryát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to find, then the Russian for to look for, then say *teryát* again

Before you move on

What does терять mean? ("To lose".) Say it once more.

135.2 выигрывать (vyígryvat) — to win

Before the new one: say the Russian for to look for, then the Russian for to lose.

You'll want to know: выигрывать

выигрывать (*vyígryvat*) — "to win".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выигрывать is вы-, "out", with -игрывать, from играть, "to play": to play something out of the game, to win.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vyígryvat*
- *Say it: vyígryvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vyígryvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to look for, then the Russian for to lose, then say *vyígryvat* again

Before you move on

What does выигрывать mean? ("To win".) Say it once more.

135.3 смотреть (smotrét) — to look, to watch

Before the new one: say the Russian for to lose, then the Russian for to win.

You'll want to know: смотреть

смотреть (*smotrét*) — "to look, to watch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

смотреть is с- with Proto-Slavic **motriti*, "to watch" — inherited; dialects still say мотреть. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *matýti*, "to see", and Greek *mateúō*, "I seek".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: smotrét*
- *Say it: smotrét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *smotrét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to lose, then the Russian for to win, then say *smotrét* again

Before you move on

What does смотреть mean? ("To look, to watch".) Say it once more.

135.4 рисовать (risovát) — to draw

Before the new one: say the Russian for to win, then the Russian for to look.

You'll want to know: рисовать

рисовать (*risovát*) — "to draw".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рисовать came through Polish *rysować* from Middle High German *rîzen*, Old High German *rîzzan*, "to scratch, to draw", a cousin of English *write* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: risovát*
- *Say it: risovát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *risovát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to win, then the Russian for to look, then say *risovát* again

Before you move on

What does рисовать mean? ("To draw".) Say it once more.

135.5 путешествовать (puteshéstvovat) — to travel

Before the new one: say the Russian for to look, then the Russian for to draw.

You'll want to know: путешествовать

путешествовать (*puteshéstvovat*) — "to travel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

путешествовать is the verb of путешествие, "a journey": путь, "way", with шествовать, "to march, to proceed". Путь ← Proto-Slavic **pǫtĭ*, kin to Sanskrit *pánthās*, "path" (Vasmer); шествие is borrowed from Church Slavonic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puteshéstvovat*
- *Say it: puteshéstvovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puteshéstvovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to look, then the Russian for to draw, then say *puteshéstvovat* again

Before you move on

What does путешествовать mean? ("To travel".) Say it once more.

135.6 Describing words — a first pass

Say the words for to draw and to travel.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- last, famous, important, interesting, boring
- cheerful, kind, angry; wicked, serious, right
- wrong, ready, dangerous, wet, dry

- soft, hard, round, wide, narrow
- bitter, salty, heavy, thin, fat

Before you move on

Last? (последний.) Famous? (известный.) Important? (важный.) Interesting? (интересный.) Boring? (скучный.) Cheerful? (весёлый.) Kind? (добрый.) Angry; wicked? (злой.) Serious? (серьёзный.) Right? (правильный.) Wrong? (неправильный.) Ready? (готовый.) Dangerous? (опасный.) Wet? (мокрый.) Dry? (сухой.) Soft? (мягкий.) Hard? (твёрдый.) Round? (круглый.) Wide? (широкий.) Narrow? (узкий.) Bitter? (горький.) Salty? (солёный.) Heavy? (тяжёлый.) Thin? (худой.) Fat? (толстый.)

135.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for to begin and to visit.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to begin, to visit, to put, to believe, to drive
- to get dressed, to wash, to get up, to sit down, to fall
- to go up, to go down, to stay, to rent; to take off, to repair
- to tell, to go for a walk, to tidy up, to find, to look for
- to lose, to win, to look, to draw, to travel

Before you move on

To begin? (начинать.) To visit? (посещать.) To put? (класть.) To believe? (верить.) To drive? (водить.) To get dressed? (одеваться.) To wash? (умываться.) To get up? (вставать.) To sit down? (садиться.) To fall? (падать.) To go up? (подниматься.) To go down? (спускаться.) To stay?

(оставаться.) To rent; to take off? (снимать.) To repair? (чинить.) To tell? (рассказывать.) To go for a walk? (гулять.) To tidy up? (убирать.) To find? (находить.) To look for? (искать.) To lose? (терять.) To win? (выигрывать.) To look? (смотреть.) To draw? (рисовать.) To travel? (путешествовать.)

Chapter 136

Nobody, Nothing, Nowhere, To Nowhere, What For

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say that there is nobody and nothing, and ask what something is for.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can say that there is nobody and nothing, and ask what something is for.

136.1 никто (niktó) — nobody

Before the new one: say the Russian for to draw, then the Russian for to travel.

You'll want to know: никто

никто (*niktó*) — "nobody". Russian still puts не before the verb: Никто не знает. — *niktó ne znáyet* — "Nobody knows." Two negatives make one "no".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

никто is ни, "not even", with кто, "who" (Vasmer): "not anyone". Vasmer compares Lithuanian *niẽkas*, "nobody, nothing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niktó*
- *Say it: niktó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niktó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to draw, then the Russian for to travel, then say *niktó* again

Before you move on

What does никто mean? (“Nobody”.) Say it once more.

136.2 ничего (nichevó) — nothing

Before the new one: say the Russian for to travel, then the Russian for nobody.

You’ll want to know: ничего

ничего (*nichevó*) — “nothing”. Spelled with г, said with a *v*, like сегодня. Я ничего не знаю. — *ya nichevó ne znáyu* — “I don’t know anything.” On its own, Ничего! means “It’s all right!”, for instance after Извините!

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ничего is a form of ничто, “nothing”: ни, “not even”, with что, “what” (Vasmer). The г is said в.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nichevó*
- *Say it: nichevó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nichevó*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to travel, then the Russian for nobody, then say *nichevó* again

Before you move on

What does ничего mean? (“Nothing”.) Say it once more.

136.3 нигде (nigdé) — nowhere

Before the new one: say the Russian for nobody, then the Russian for nothing.

You’ll want to know: нигде

нигде (*nigdé*) — “nowhere”. It is где with ни-: Нигде нет такси. — *nigdé nyet taksí* — “There are no taxis anywhere.”

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нигде is ни, “not even”, with где, “where”: “not anywhere”. Vasmer relates где to Sanskrit *kúha*, “where”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nigdé*
- *Say it: nigdé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nigdé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nobody, then the Russian for nothing, then say *nigdé* again

Before you move on

What does нигде mean? (“Nowhere”.) Say it once more.

136.4 никуда (nikudá) — (to) nowhere

Before the new one: say the Russian for nothing, then the Russian for nowhere.

You'll want to know: никуда

никуда (*nikudá*) — "(to) nowhere". It is куда with ни-, so it answers "where to?": Я никуда не иду. — *ya nikudá ne idú* — "I'm not going anywhere."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

никуда is ни, "not even", with куда, "where to": "to no place". Vasmer compares куда with Latin *quandō*, "when".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nikudá*
- *Say it: nikudá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nikudá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nothing, then the Russian for nowhere, then say *nikudá* again

Before you move on

What does никуда mean? ("(to) nowhere".) Say it once more.

136.5 зачем (zachém) — what for

Before the new one: say the Russian for nowhere, then the Russian for (to) nowhere.

You'll want to know: зачем

зачем (*zachém*) — "what for". It asks about the purpose; **почему** asks about the cause. **Зачем?** — "What for?"

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зачем is **за**, "for, after", with **чем**, a form of **что**, "what": "for what". Vasmer traces **что** to Proto-Slavic **čь*, "what", with a pointing *to* on the end.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zachém*
- *Say it: zachém*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zachém*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nowhere, then the Russian for (to) nowhere, then say *zachém* again

Before you move on

What does **зачем** mean? ("What for".) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Recently, for a Long Time, Before, Last, To Happen

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what happened, and when: recently, last week, a long time ago.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say what happened, and when: recently, last week, a long time ago.*

137.1 недавно (nedávno) — recently

Before the new one: say the Russian for (to) nowhere, then the Russian for what for.

You'll want to know: недавно

недавно (*nedávno*) — "recently". Russian's past usually ends in **-л**, with **-ла** for a woman: Недавно я читал книгу. — *nedávno ya chitál knígu* — "Recently I read a book." A woman says читала.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

недавно is не, "not", with давно, "long ago": not long ago. давно goes with old даве, "earlier". Vasmer relates даве to Latin *dūdum*, "a while ago", and Greek *dēn*, "long".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nedávno*
- *Say it: nedávno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nedávno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for (to) nowhere, then the Russian for what for, then say *nedávno* again

Before you move on

What does недавно mean? ("Recently".) Say it once more.

137.2 давно (davnó) — long ago; for a long time

Before the new one: say the Russian for what for, then the Russian for recently.

You'll want to know: давно

давно (*davnó*) — "long ago; for a long time". With the present it means "for a long time": Я давно здесь живу. — *ya davnó zdes zhivú* — "I have lived here for a long time."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

давно comes from давний, "of long ago", which goes with давеча, "a while ago" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates that root to Greek *dḗn*, "for a long time", and Latin *dūdum*, "a while ago".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: davnó*
- *Say it: davnó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *davnó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for what for, then the Russian for recently, then say *davnó* again

Before you move on

What does давно mean? ("Long ago; for a long time".) Say it once more.

137.3 раньше (ránshe) — before, earlier

Before the new one: say the Russian for recently, then the Russian for long ago; for a long time.

You'll want to know: раньше

раньше (*ránshe*) — "before, earlier". Раньше здесь был парк. — *ránshe zdes byl park* — "There used to be a park here." был is the past of быть.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

раньше is the comparing form of рано, "early": "earlier, before". рано is an old Slavic word that Vasmer calls hard to explain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ránshe*
- *Say it: ránshe*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ránshe*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for recently, then the Russian for long ago; for a long time, then say *ránshe* again

Before you move on

What does раньше mean? ("Before, earlier".) Say it once more.

137.4 прошлый (próshlyy) — last, past

Before the new one: say the Russian for long ago; for a long time, then the Russian for before.

You'll want to know: прошлый

прошлый (*próshlyy*) — "last, past". It agrees with its noun: на прошлой неделе — *na próshloy nedéle* — "last week"; в прошлом году — "last year".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

прошлый is built on прошёл, "passed", the past tense of пройти, "to go past". Its -шёл is not from идти, "to go": Vasmer puts шёл with ходить, "to walk". What is past has gone by.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: próshlyy*
- *Say it: próshlyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *próshlyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for long ago; for a long time, then the Russian for before, then say *próshlyy* again

Before you move on

What does прошлый mean? ("Last, past".) Say it once more.

137.5 случиться (sluchítsya) — to happen

Before the new one: say the Russian for before, then the Russian for last.

You'll want to know: случиться

случиться (*sluchítsya*) — "to happen". Что случилось? — *shto sluchílos* — "What happened?" случилось is its past with "it".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

случиться — Old Church Slavonic лучити ся, "to come about". Vasmer links it with лучить, "to hit upon", and keeps it apart from German *Glück*, "luck".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sluchítsya*
- *Say it: sluchítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sluchítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for before, then the Russian for last, then say *sluchítsya* again

Before you move on

What does случиться mean? ("To happen".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Future, in a Week, a Plan, To Plan, To Hope

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what will happen, and when: next year, in a week, and what I plan.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say what will happen, and when: next year, in a week, and what I plan.*

138.1 будущий (búdushchiy) — future, next

> Before the new one: say the Russian for last, then the Russian for to happen.

You'll want to know: будущий

будущий (*búdushchiy*) — "future, next". One Russian future is буду and an infinitive: Я буду читать. — *ya búdu chitát* — "I will read." в будущем году is "next year".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

будущий is built on буду, "I will be", a form of быть, "to be", a cousin of English *be*: "what will be".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *búdushchiy*
- *Say it:* *búdushchiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *búdushchiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for last, then the Russian for to happen, then say *búdushchiy* again

Before you move on

What does будущий mean? ("Future, next".) Say it once more.

138.2 через (chérez) — in (a week), after

Before the new one: say the Russian for to happen, then the Russian for future.

You'll want to know: через

через (*chérez*) — "in (a week), after". Counted from now: через неделю — *chérez nedélyu* — "in a week". неделя changes to неделю after it.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

через ← Proto-Slavic **čersŭ*, "across" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *kērscha*, "across", and Lithuanian *skersas*, "crosswise"; чрез is the Church Slavonic shape.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chérez*
- *Say it:* *chérez*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chérez*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to happen, then the Russian for future, then say *chérez* again

Before you move on

What does через mean? ("In (a week), after".) Say it once more.

138.3 план (plan) — a plan

Before the new one: say the Russian for future, then the Russian for in.

You'll want to know: план

план (*plan*) — "a plan". Какой план? — *kakóy plan* — "What's the plan?" English *plan* is the same word.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

план — recorded from 1704; it perhaps came through Polish *plan* or German *Plan* from French *plan*, which Vasmer traces to Latin *planta*, "the sole of the foot, an outline".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plan*
- *Say it: plan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plan*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for future, then the Russian for in, then say *plan* again

Before you move on

What does план mean? ("A plan".) Say it once more.

138.4 планировать (planírovat) — to plan

Before the new one: say the Russian for in, then the Russian for a plan.

You'll want to know: планировать

планировать (*planírovat*) — "to plan". Я планирую путешествие. — *ya planíruyu puteshéstviye* — "I'm planning a trip." Verbs in -овать swap it for -ую, like рисовать, рисую.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

планировать is план, "a plan", with -ировать, a verb ending taken from German *-ieren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: planírovat*
- *Say it: planírovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *planírovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for in, then the Russian for a plan, then say *planírovat* again

Before you move on

What does планировать mean? ("To plan".) Say it once more.

138.5 надеяться (nadéyatsya) — to hope

Before the new one: say the Russian for a plan, then the Russian for to plan.

You'll want to know: надеяться

надеяться (*nadéyatsya*) — "to hope". Я надеюсь, что ... — *ya nadéyus, shto* — "I hope that ..." Like подниматься, it keeps its -ся, written -сь after a vowel: надеюсь.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

надеяться goes with надежда, "hope", which Vasmer calls Church Slavonic, beside the folk надёжа: на, "on", with the root of деть, "to put", so "to place one's trust on".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nadéyatsya*
- *Say it: nadéyatsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nadéyatsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a plan, then the Russian for to plan, then say *nadéyatsya* again

Before you move on

What does надеяться mean? ("To hope".) Say it once more.

Chapter 139

A Timetable, an Advert, an Entrance, an Exit, a Receipt

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a timetable, an advert, door signs and a receipt, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can read a timetable, an advert, door signs and a receipt, and act on what they say.*

139.1 расписание (raspisániye) — a timetable

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to plan, then the Russian for to hope.

You'll want to know: расписание

расписание (*raspisániye*) — "a timetable".

Read it: the board

The board says Автобус: **8:00.** The bus leaves at eight, so be there before eight.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

расписание is рас-, "out", with писание, "writing", from писать, "to write": a timetable is written out. Vasmer relates писать to Lithuanian *piešti*, "to draw", and Sanskrit *piṃśáti*, "adorns".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: raspisániye*
- *Say it: raspisániye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raspisániye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to plan, then the Russian for to hope, then say *raspisániye* again

Before you move on

What does расписание mean? ("A timetable".) Say it once more.

139.2 реклама (rekláma) — an advert

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hope, then the Russian for a timetable.

You'll want to know: реклама

реклама (*rekláma*) — "an advert".

Read it: the advert

The advert says **Новый магазин. Закрыт по воскресеньям.** A new shop, closed on Sundays, so go on another day.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

реклама came through German *Reklame* from French *réclame*, first "the call to a hunting falcon", from *réclamer*, "to call back", Latin *clāmāre*, "to shout" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *rekláma*
- *Say it:* *rekláma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rekláma*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hope, then the Russian for a timetable, then say *rekláma* again

Before you move on

What does реклама mean? (“An advert”.) Say it once more.

139.3 вход (vkhod) — an entrance

Before the new one: say the Russian for a timetable, then the Russian for an advert.

You’ll want to know: вход

вход (*vkhod*) — “an entrance”.

Read it: the sign over a door

The sign over a door says ВХОД: you go in here. Вход свободный means entry is free.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вход is в, “in”, with ход, “a going”, from ходить, “to walk”: the way in.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vkhod*
- *Say it:* *vkhod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vkhod*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a timetable, then the Russian for an advert, then say *vkhod* again

Before you move on

What does **вход** mean? ("An entrance".) Say it once more.

139.4 выход (výkhod) — an exit

Before the new one: say the Russian for an advert, then the Russian for an entrance.

You'll want to know: выход

выход (*výkhod*) — "an exit".

Read it: the sign

The sign says **ВЫХОД**: the way out. It is **вы-**, "out", with the same **ход** as **вход**.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выход is **вы-**, "out", with **ход**, "a going": the way out. Vasmer ties **ход** to the Indo-European root **sed-*, "to sit", its **х** grown from an *s* after prefixes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: výkhod*
- *Say it: výkhod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *výkhod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an advert, then the Russian for an entrance, then say *výkhod* again

Before you move on

What does выход mean? ("An exit".) Say it once more.

139.5 чек (chek) — a receipt

Before the new one: say the Russian for an entrance, then the Russian for an exit.

You'll want to know: чек

чек (*chek*) — "a receipt". Ask for it when you pay: Чек, пожалуйста. — *chek, pozhálusta* — "The receipt, please."

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чек came through English *check*, "cheque". Vasmer traced the English word, through Arabic, to Persian *čäk*, "a document"; English dictionaries take *cheque* from *check*, "a control", from the chess word *check*, Persian *shāh*, "king".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chek*
- *Say it: chek*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chek*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an entrance, then the Russian for an exit, then say *chek* again

Before you move on

What does чек mean? ("A receipt".) Say it once more.

139.6 Saying no and looking back — a first pass

Say the words for an exit and a receipt.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nobody, nothing, nowhere, (to) nowhere, what for
- recently, long ago; for a long time, before, last, to happen

Before you move on

Nobody? (никто.) Nothing? (ничего.) Nowhere? (нигде.) (to) nowhere? (никуда.) What for? (зачем.) Recently? (недавно.) Long ago; for a long time? (давно.) Before? (раньше.) Last? (прошлый.) To happen? (случиться.)

139.7 Looking ahead and reading signs — a second pass

Say the words for future and in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- future, in, a plan, to plan, to hope
- a timetable, an advert, an entrance, an exit, a receipt

Before you move on

Future? (будущий.) In? (через.) A plan? (план.) To plan? (планировать.) To hope? (надеяться.) A timetable? (расписание.) An advert? (реклама.) An entrance? (вход.) An exit? (выход.) A receipt? (чек.)

Chapter 140

To have lunch, To have breakfast, To have dinner, To do the laundry, To iron

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to have lunch, to have breakfast, to have dinner, to do the laundry and to iron.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say to have lunch, to have breakfast, to have dinner, to do the laundry and to iron.*

140.1 обедать (obédat) — to have lunch

> Before the new one: say the Russian for an exit, then the Russian for a receipt.

You'll want to know: обедать

обедать (*obédat*) — "to have lunch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обедать is обед, "lunch", made into a verb with -ать. обед is об- with the root of есть, "to eat" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obédat*
- *Say it: obédat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obédat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an exit, then the Russian for a receipt, then say *obédat* again

Before you move on

What does обедать mean? ("To have lunch".) Say it once more.

140.2 завтракать (závtrakat) — to have breakfast

Before the new one: say the Russian for a receipt, then the Russian for to have lunch.

You'll want to know: завтракать

завтракать (*závtrakat*) — "to have breakfast".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

завтракать is завтрак, "breakfast", made into a verb; Old Russian already had завтрокать (Vasmer). завтрак is built on завтра, from за утро, "after the morning".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: závtrakat*
- *Say it: závtrakat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *závtrakat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a receipt, then the Russian for to have lunch, then say *závtrakat* again

Before you move on

What does завтракать mean? (“To have breakfast”.) Say it once more.

140.3 ужинать (úzhinat) — to have dinner

Before the new one: say the Russian for to have lunch, then the Russian for to have breakfast.

You’ll want to know: ужинать

ужинать (*úzhinat*) — “to have dinner”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ужинать is ужин, “supper”, made into a verb with -ать. ужин comes from Proto-Slavic **jugŭ*, “south, noon”: first the midday meal (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: úzhinat*
- *Say it: úzhinat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úzhinat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to have lunch, then the Russian for to have breakfast, then say *úzhinat* again

Before you move on

What does ужинать mean? (“To have dinner”.) Say it once more.

140.4 стирать (stirát) — to do the laundry, to wash (clothes)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to have breakfast, then the Russian for to have dinner.

You'll want to know: стирать

стирать (*stirát*) — "to do the laundry, to wash (clothes)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стирать comes from тирать, the repeated form of тереть, "to rub" (Vasmer): clothes were washed by rubbing. Latin *terō*, "I rub", is a cousin of тереть.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stirát*
- *Say it: stirát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stirát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to have breakfast, then the Russian for to have dinner, then say *stirát* again

Before you move on

What does стирать mean? ("To do the laundry, to wash (clothes)".) Say it once more.

140.5 гладить (gládit) — to iron; to stroke

Before the new one: say the Russian for to have dinner, then the Russian for to do the laundry.

You'll want to know: гладить

гладить (*гла́дит*) — "to iron; to stroke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гладить ← Proto-Slavic **gladiti*, "to smooth" — inherited, with гладкий, "smooth". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *glósti*, "to stroke", and Latvian *glãstît*, "to caress".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *гла́дит*
- *Say it:* *гла́дит*, once more
- *Say it:* say *гла́дит*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to have dinner, then the Russian for to do the laundry, then say *гла́дит* again

Before you move on

What does гладить mean? ("To iron; to stroke".) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

To meet, To get acquainted, To invite, To thank, To apologise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to meet, to get acquainted, to invite, to thank and to apologise.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say to meet, to get acquainted, to invite, to thank and to apologise.

141.1 встречать (vstrechát) — to meet

Before the new one: say the Russian for to do the laundry, then the Russian for to iron; to stroke.

You'll want to know: встречать

встречать (*vstrechát*) — "to meet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

встречать is the ongoing partner of встретить, "to meet", Proto-Slavic **sŭrěsti*. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *surėsti*, "to seize, to catch", and finds a link with *randù*, "I find", less convincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vstrechát*
- *Say it: vstrechát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vstrechát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to do the laundry, then the Russian for to iron; to stroke, then say *vstrechát* again

Before you move on

What does встречать mean? ("To meet".) Say it once more.

141.2 знакомиться (znakómitsya) — to get acquainted

Before the new one: say the Russian for to iron; to stroke, then the Russian for to meet.

You'll want to know: знакомиться

знакомиться (*znakómitsya*) — "to get acquainted".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

знакомиться is знакомый, "acquainted", made into a verb with -иться. знакомый is built on знать, "to know", a cousin of English *know*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: znakómitsya*
- *Say it: znakómitsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *znakómitsya*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to iron; to stroke, then the Russian for to meet, then say *znakómitsya* again

Before you move on

What does знакомиться mean? (“To get acquainted”.) Say it once more.

141.3 приглашать (priglashát) — to invite

Before the new one: say the Russian for to meet, then the Russian for to get acquainted.

You’ll want to know: приглашать

приглашать (*priglashát*) — “to invite”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

приглашать is при-, “to, toward”, with -глашать, from глас, the Church Slavonic shape of голос, “voice”: to call someone over. Vasmer relates голос to Old Norse *kalla*, “to call”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: priglashát*
- *Say it: priglashát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *priglashát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to meet, then the Russian for to get acquainted, then say *priglashát* again

Before you move on

What does приглашать mean? (“To invite”.) Say it once more.

141.4 благодарить (blagodarít) — to thank

Before the new one: say the Russian for to get acquainted, then the Russian for to invite.

You'll want to know: благодарить

благодарить (*blagodarít*) — "to thank".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

благодарить is благо, "good", with дарить, "to give": "to give good" in return. благо is Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, for native болого; благо- often translates Greek *eu-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *blagodarít*
- *Say it:* *blagodarít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blagodarít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to get acquainted, then the Russian for to invite, then say *blagodarít* again

Before you move on

What does благодарить mean? ("To thank".) Say it once more.

141.5 извиняться (izvinyátsya) — to apologise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to invite, then the Russian for to thank.

You'll want to know: извиняться

извиняться (*izvinyátsya*) — "to apologise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

извиняться is из-, “out of”, with вина, “guilt”, and -ся, “oneself”: to get out of the blame. Vasmer relates вина to Lithuanian *vaina*, “a fault”, and Latvian *vaĩna*, “guilt”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: izvinyátsya*
- *Say it: izvinyátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *izvinyátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to invite, then the Russian for to thank, then say *izvinyátsya* again

Before you move on

What does извиняться mean? (“To apologise”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

To carry, To hold, To throw, To catch, To push

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to carry, to hold, to throw, to catch and to push.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can say to carry, to hold, to throw, to catch and to push.*

142.1 носить (nosít) — to carry; to wear

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to thank, then the Russian for to apologise.

You'll want to know: носить

носить (*nosít*) — "to carry; to wear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

носить ← Proto-Slavic **nositi*, "to carry around", the repeated-action partner of нести, "to carry" — inherited. Wearing is carrying your clothes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nosít*
- *Say it:* *nosít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nosít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to thank, then the Russian for to apologise, then say *nosít* again

Before you move on

What does носить mean? (“To carry; to wear”.) Say it once more.

142.2 держать (derzhát) — to hold

Before the new one: say the Russian for to apologise, then the Russian for to carry; to wear.

You’ll want to know: держать

держать (*derzhát*) — “to hold”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

держать ← Proto-Slavic **dьržati* — inherited. Vasmer reports a comparison with Avestan *dražaite*, “holds, keeps by one”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *derzhát*
- *Say it:* *derzhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *derzhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to apologise, then the Russian for to carry; to wear, then say *derzhát* again

Before you move on

What does держать mean? (“To hold”.) Say it once more.

142.3 бросать (brosát) — to throw

Before the new one: say the Russian for to carry; to wear, then the Russian for to hold.

You’ll want to know: бросать

бросать (*brosát*) — “to throw”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бросать ← Proto-Slavic **brŭsati* — inherited. Vasmer reports a comparison with Baltic and Slavic words for “to scrape”, while Kopečný thought it might imitate a sound, so its origin is unsettled.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brosát*
- *Say it: brosát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brosát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to carry; to wear, then the Russian for to hold, then say *brosát* again

Before you move on

What does бросать mean? (“To throw”.) Say it once more.

142.4 ловить (lovít) — to catch

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hold, then the Russian for to throw.

You'll want to know: ловить

ловить (*lovít*) — "to catch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ловить comes from лов, "a catch, a hunt" (Vasmer), which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *lavùs*, "agile", Greek *leía*, "booty", and Gothic *laun*, "reward".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lovít*
- *Say it: lovít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lovít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hold, then the Russian for to throw, then say *lovít* again

Before you move on

What does ловить mean? ("To catch".) Say it once more.

142.5 толкать (tolkát) — to push

Before the new one: say the Russian for to throw, then the Russian for to catch.

You'll want to know: толкать

толкать (*tolkát*) — "to push".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

толкать goes with толочь, "to pound, to crush" (Vasmer), Proto-Slavic **tĭlkǫ*. Vasmer compares Lithuanian *tìlkti*, "to become tame".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tolkát*
- *Say it: tolkát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tolkát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to throw, then the Russian for to catch, then say *tolkát* again

Before you move on

What does толкать mean? ("To push".) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

To fly, To ride, To walk, To come, To leave

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to fly, to ride, to walk, to come and to leave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say to fly, to ride, to walk, to come and to leave.*

143.1 летать (letát) — to fly

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to catch, then the Russian for to push.

You'll want to know: летать

летать (*letát*) — "to fly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

летать is the repeated-action partner of лететь, "to fly", Proto-Slavic **letěti* — inherited (Vasmer). The same root is in самолёт, "aeroplane".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: letát*
- *Say it: letát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *letát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to catch, then the Russian for to push, then say *letát* again

Before you move on

What does летать mean? (“To fly”.) Say it once more.

143.2 ездить (yézdit) — to ride, to go (by transport)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to push, then the Russian for to fly.

You’ll want to know: ездить

ездить (*yézdit*) — “to ride, to go (by transport)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ездить goes with езда, “a ride” (Vasmer), Old Russian *ezdŭ*, “a journey”. Vasmer thinks езда probably comes from the root of ехать, “to go (by vehicle)”, and Sanskrit *yāti*, “travels”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yézdit*
- *Say it: yézdit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yézdit*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to push, then the Russian for to fly, then say *yézdit* again

Before you move on

What does ездить mean? (“To ride, to go (by transport)”.) Say it once more.

143.3 ходить (khodít) — to walk, to go (on foot)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to fly, then the Russian for to ride.

You’ll want to know: ходить

ходить (*khodít*) — “to walk, to go (on foot)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ходить ← Proto-Slavic **xoditi*, built on ход, “a going” (Vasmer) — inherited. The same root is in вход, “entrance”, and выход, “exit”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khodít*
- *Say it: khodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to fly, then the Russian for to ride, then say *khodít* again

Before you move on

What does ходить mean? (“To walk, to go (on foot)”.) Say it once more.

143.4 приходить (prikhodít) — to come, to arrive

Before the new one: say the Russian for to ride, then the Russian for to walk.

You'll want to know: приходить

приходить (*prikhodít*) — "to come, to arrive".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

приходить is при-, "to, toward", with ходить, "to walk": to come to a place. Vasmer ties ход to the Indo-European root **sed-*, "to sit", its х grown from an *s* after prefixes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prikhodít*
- *Say it: prikhodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prikhodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to ride, then the Russian for to walk, then say *prikhodít* again

Before you move on

What does приходить mean? ("To come, to arrive".) Say it once more.

143.5 уходить (ukhodít) — to leave, to go away

Before the new one: say the Russian for to walk, then the Russian for to come.

You'll want to know: уходить

уходить (*ukhodít*) — "to leave, to go away".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

уходить is у-, “away”, with ходить, “to walk”: to go away. Vasmer ties ход to the Indo-European root **sed-*, “to sit”, its х grown from an *s* after prefixes.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ukhodít*
- *Say it: ukhodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ukhodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to walk, then the Russian for to come, then say *ukhodít* again

Before you move on

What does уходить mean? (“To leave, to go away”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

To be afraid, To please, To hate, To praise, To scold

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be afraid, to please, to hate, to praise and to scold.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say to be afraid, to please, to hate, to praise and to scold.*

144.1 бояться (boyátsya) — to be afraid

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to come, then the Russian for to leave.

You'll want to know: бояться

бояться (*boyátsya*) — "to be afraid".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бояться ← Proto-Slavic **bojati sę* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *bijótis*, "to fear", and Sanskrit *bibhéti*, "fears".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: boyátsya*
- *Say it: boyátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *boyátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to come, then the Russian for to leave, then say *boyátsya* again

Before you move on

What does бояться mean? (“To be afraid”.) Say it once more.

144.2 нравиться (nrávitsya) — to please, to be liked

Before the new one: say the Russian for to leave, then the Russian for to be afraid.

You’ll want to know: нравиться

нравиться (*nrávitsya*) — “to please, to be liked”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нравиться comes from нрав, “temper, disposition”, the Church Slavonic shape, Vasmer says, beside native норов, “stubborn temper”: to please is to suit someone’s liking.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nrávitsya*
- *Say it: nrávitsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nrávitsya*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to leave, then the Russian for to be afraid, then say *nrávitsya* again

Before you move on

What does нравиться mean? (“To please, to be liked”.) Say it once more.

144.3 ненавидеть (nenavídet) — to hate

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be afraid, then the Russian for to please.

You’ll want to know: ненавидеть

ненавидеть (*nenavídet*) — “to hate”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ненавидеть is не, “not”, with old навидеть, “to look at gladly”, from видеть, “to see” (Vasmer): to hate is not to bear the sight of someone.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nenavídet*
- *Say it: nenavídet*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nenavídet*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be afraid, then the Russian for to please, then say *nenavídet* again

Before you move on

What does ненавидеть mean? (“To hate”.) Say it once more.

144.4 хвалить (khvalít) — to praise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to please, then the Russian for to hate.

You'll want to know: хвалить

хвалить (*khvalít*) — "to praise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хвалить comes from хвала, "praise". Vasmer says it has no reliable etymology; one view reshapes слава, "glory", with the х- of хула, "blame".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khvalít*
- *Say it: khvalít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khvalít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to please, then the Russian for to hate, then say *khvalít* again

Before you move on

What does хвалить mean? ("To praise".) Say it once more.

144.5 ругать (rugát) — to scold

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hate, then the Russian for to praise.

You'll want to know: ругать

ругать (*rugát*) — "to scold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ругать ← Old Russian ругатися, “to mock”, from *rugй*, “mockery”. Vasmer compares Latin *ringor*, “I bare my teeth, snarl”; Machek suggested other links, so the origin is not settled.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rugát*
- *Say it: rugát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rugát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hate, then the Russian for to praise, then say *rugát* again

Before you move on

What does ругать mean? (“To scold”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

To sign, To print, To keep, To download, To be beaten

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sign, to print, to keep, to download and to be beaten.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say to sign, to print, to keep, to download and to be beaten.*

145.1 подписывать (podpísyvat) — to sign

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to praise, then the Russian for to scold.

You'll want to know: подписывать

подписывать (*podpísyvat*) — "to sign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подписывать is под-, "under", with -писывать, from писать, "to write": you sign at the foot of a page.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podpísyvat*
- *Say it: podpísyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podpísyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to praise, then the Russian for to scold, then say *podpísyvat* again

Before you move on

What does подписывать mean? ("To sign".) Say it once more.

145.2 печатать (pechátat) — to print, to type

Before the new one: say the Russian for to scold, then the Russian for to sign.

You'll want to know: печатать

печатать (*pechátat*) — "to print, to type".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

печатать comes from печать, "a seal, a stamp", which Vasmer thinks probably comes from печь, "to burn": a tool for burning a mark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pechátat*
- *Say it: pechátat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pechátat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to scold, then the Russian for to sign, then say *pechátat* again

Before you move on

What does печатать mean? ("To print, to type".) Say it once more.

145.3 сохранять (sokhranyát) — to keep; to save (a file)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sign, then the Russian for to print.

You'll want to know: сохранять

сохранять (*sokhranyát*) — "to keep; to save (a file)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сохранять is с- with хранять, from хранить, "to keep", a Church Slavonic word, says Vasmer, beside the native хоронить, now "to bury".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sokhranyát*
- *Say it: sokhranyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sokhranyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sign, then the Russian for to print, then say *sokhranyát* again

Before you move on

What does сохранять mean? ("To keep; to save (a file)".) Say it once more.

145.4 скачивать (skáchivat) — to download

Before the new one: say the Russian for to print, then the Russian for to keep; to save.

You'll want to know: скачивать

скачивать (*skáchivat*) — "to download".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скачивать is с-, "off, down", with -качивать, from качать, "to swing, to pump", which Vasmer derives from катать, "to roll". Downloading is pumping data off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skáchivat*
- *Say it: skáchivat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skáchivat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to print, then the Russian for to keep; to save, then say *skáchivat* again

Before you move on

What does скачивать mean? ("To download".) Say it once more.

145.5 проигрывать (proígryvat) — to be beaten, to lose (a game)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to keep; to save, then the Russian for to download.

You'll want to know: проигрывать

проигрывать (*proígryvat*) — "to be beaten, to lose (a game)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

проигрывать is про-, "through, away", with -игрывать, from играть, "to play": to play your stake away, to lose.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proígryvat*
- *Say it: proígryvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proígryvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to keep; to save, then the Russian for to download, then say *proígryvat* again

Before you move on

What does проигрывать mean? ("To be beaten, to lose (a game)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

To book, To turn, To cross, To stop, To park

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to book, to turn, to cross, to stop and to park.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say to book, to turn, to cross, to stop and to park.

146.1 бронировать (bronírovat) — to book, to reserve

Before the new one: say the Russian for to download, then the Russian for to be beaten.

You'll want to know: бронировать

бронировать (*bronírovat*) — "to book, to reserve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бронировать is built on бронь, "a reservation", from броня, "armour": a booking shields a seat. броня was probably borrowed, Vasmer says, from Gothic *brunjō*, "a breastplate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bronírovat*
- *Say it: bronírovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bronírovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to download, then the Russian for to be beaten, then say *bronírovat* again

Before you move on

What does бронировать mean? ("To book, to reserve".) Say it once more.

146.2 поворачивать (povoráchivat) — to turn

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be beaten, then the Russian for to book.

You'll want to know: поворачивать

поворачивать (*povoráchivat*) — "to turn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поворачивать is по- with -ворачивать, "to turn", on the root of вертеть, "to turn, to spin", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *versti*, "to turn", and Latin *vertō*, "I turn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: povoráchivat*
- *Say it: povoráchivat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *povoráchivat*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be beaten, then the Russian for to book, then say *povoráchivat* again

Before you move on

What does поворачивать mean? (“To turn”.) Say it once more.

146.3 пересекать (peresekát) — to cross

Before the new one: say the Russian for to book, then the Russian for to turn.

You’ll want to know: пересекать

пересекать (*peresekát*) — “to cross”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пересекать is пере-, “across”, with -секать, from сечь, “to cut”: to cross is to cut across.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peresekát*
- *Say it: peresekát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peresekát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to book, then the Russian for to turn, then say *peresekát* again

Before you move on

What does пересекать mean? (“To cross”.) Say it once more.

146.4 останавливаться (ostanávlivatsya) — to stop

Before the new one: say the Russian for to turn, then the Russian for to cross.

You'll want to know: останавливаться

останавливаться (*ostanávlivatsya*) — "to stop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

останавливаться is о- with -станавливать, from стать, "to stand", and -ся, "oneself": to bring yourself to a standstill.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ostanávlivatsya*
- *Say it: ostanávlivatsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ostanávlivatsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to turn, then the Russian for to cross, then say *ostanávlivatsya* again

Before you move on

What does останавливаться mean? ("To stop".) Say it once more.

146.5 парковать (parkovát) — to park

Before the new one: say the Russian for to cross, then the Russian for to stop.

You'll want to know: парковать

парковать (*parkovát*) — "to park".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

парковать is built on парк, “a park”, here “a parking place”, with the verb ending -овать; English *to park* has the same history.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parkovát*
- *Say it: parkovát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parkovát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cross, then the Russian for to stop, then say *parkovát* again

Before you move on

What does парковать mean? (“To park”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

Ill, Cold, Flu, Runny nose, Pill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ill, a cold, flu, a runny nose and a pill.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say ill, a cold, flu, a runny nose and a pill.*

147.1 больной (bolnóy) — ill; a patient

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to stop, then the Russian for to park.

You'll want to know: больной

больной (*bolnóy*) — "ill; a patient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

больной is built on боль, "pain", and болеть, "to be ill" (Vasmer): "the one in pain".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolnóy*
- *Say it: bolnóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bolnóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to stop, then the Russian for to park, then say *bolnóy* again

Before you move on

What does больной mean? ("Ill; a patient".) Say it once more.

147.2 простуда (prostúda) — a cold

Before the new one: say the Russian for to park, then the Russian for ill; a patient.

You'll want to know: простуда

простуда (*prostúda*) — "a cold".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

простуда is про-, "through", with студ, "cold", from стыть, "to grow cold", as in студёный, "icy": a cold is being chilled through.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prostúda*
- *Say it: prostúda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prostúda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to park, then the Russian for ill; a patient, then say *prostúda* again

Before you move on

What does простуда mean? (“A cold”.) Say it once more.

147.3 грипп (gripp) — flu

Before the new one: say the Russian for ill; a patient, then the Russian for a cold.

You’ll want to know: грипп

грипп (*gripp*) — “flu”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грипп comes from French *grippe*, “flu”, from *gripper*, “to seize”, a word of Germanic origin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gripp*
- *Say it: gripp*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gripp*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ill; a patient, then the Russian for a cold, then say *gripp* again

Before you move on

What does грипп mean? (“Flu”.) Say it once more.

147.4 насморк (násmork) — a runny nose

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cold, then the Russian for flu.

You'll want to know: насморк

насморк (*násmork*) — "a runny nose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

насморк goes with сморкать, "to blow the nose" (Vasmer), with на-: a runny nose.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: násmork*
- *Say it: násmork*, once more
- *Say it:* say *násmork*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cold, then the Russian for flu, then say *násmork* again

Before you move on

What does насморк mean? ("A runny nose".) Say it once more.

147.5 таблетка (tablétka) — a pill

Before the new one: say the Russian for flu, then the Russian for a runny nose.

You'll want to know: таблетка

таблетка (*tablétka*) — "a pill".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

таблетка is built on German *Tablette* or French *tablette*, "a little tablet", with -ка; both come from Latin *tabula*, "a board, a tablet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tablétka*
- *Say it: tablétka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tablétka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for flu, then the Russian for a runny nose, then say *tablétka* again

Before you move on

What does таблетка mean? ("A pill".) Say it once more.

Chapter 148

Healthy, Weak, Strong, Pale, Tired

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say healthy, weak, strong, pale and tired.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say healthy, weak, strong, pale and tired.*

148.1 здоровый (zdoróvyy) — healthy

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a runny nose, then the Russian for a pill.

You'll want to know: здоровый

здоровый (*zdoróvyy*) — "healthy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

здоровый ← Proto-Slavic **sŭdorvŭ* — inherited: **sŭ-*, "good", with **dorvo-*, the root of дерево, "tree", so "of good timber" (Vasmer). Church Slavonic has здравый, "sound, sensible".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zdoróvyy*
- *Say it:* *zdoróvyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zdoróvyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a runny nose, then the Russian for a pill, then say *zdoróvyy* again

Before you move on

What does здоровый mean? (“Healthy”.) Say it once more.

148.2 слабый (slábyy) — weak

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pill, then the Russian for healthy.

You’ll want to know: слабый

слабый (*slábyy*) — “weak”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слабый ← Proto-Slavic **slabŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *slõbti*, “to weaken”, Old High German *slaf*, “slack”, and Gothic *slēpan*, “to sleep”: English *sleep* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *slábyy*
- *Say it:* *slábyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slábyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pill, then the Russian for healthy, then say *slábyy* again

Before you move on

What does слабый mean? (“Weak”.) Say it once more.

148.3 сильный (sílnyy) — strong

Before the new one: say the Russian for healthy, then the Russian for weak.

You’ll want to know: сильный

сильный (*sílnyy*) — “strong”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сильный is сила, “strength”, with -ный. сила ← Proto-Slavic **sila*, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *síela*, “soul, spirit”, and Old Prussian *seilin*, “diligence”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sílnyy*
- *Say it: sílnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sílnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for healthy, then the Russian for weak, then say *sílnyy* again

Before you move on

What does сильный mean? (“Strong”.) Say it once more.

148.4 бледный (blédnyy) — pale

Before the new one: say the Russian for weak, then the Russian for strong.

You'll want to know: бледный

бледный (*blédnyy*) — "pale".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бледный is бледый, Proto-Slavic **blědŭ*, "pale", with -ный — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old English *blāt*, "pale", and Old High German *bleiza*, "paleness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blédnyy*
- *Say it: blédnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blédnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for weak, then the Russian for strong, then say *blédnyy* again

Before you move on

What does бледный mean? ("Pale".) Say it once more.

148.5 усталый (ustályy) — tired

Before the new one: say the Russian for strong, then the Russian for pale.

You'll want to know: усталый

усталый (*ustályy*) — "tired".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

усталый is built on устать, "to get tired", у- with стать, "to stand" (Vasmer): the tired person has come to a stop.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ustályy*
- *Say it: ustályy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ustályy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for strong, then the Russian for pale, then say *ustályy* again

Before you move on

What does усталый mean? ("Tired".) Say it once more.

148.6 Words from chapters 140-143 — a first pass

Say the words for pale and tired.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to have lunch, to have breakfast, to have dinner, to do the laundry, to iron; to stroke
- to meet, to get acquainted, to invite, to thank, to apologise
- to carry; to wear, to hold, to throw, to catch, to push
- to fly, to ride, to walk, to come, to leave

Before you move on

To have lunch? (обедать.) To have breakfast? (завтракать.) To have dinner? (ужинать.) To do the laundry? (стирать.) To iron; to stroke? (гладить.) To meet? (встречать.) To get acquainted? (знакомиться.) To invite? (приглашать.) To thank?

(благодарить.) To apologise? (извиняться.) To carry; to wear? (носить.) To hold? (держать.) To throw? (бросать.) To catch? (ловить.) To push? (толкать.) To fly? (летать.) To ride? (ездить.) To walk? (ходить.) To come? (приходить.) To leave? (уходить.)

148.7 Words from chapters 144-148 — a second pass

Say the words for to be afraid and to please.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to be afraid, to please, to hate, to praise, to scold
- to sign, to print, to keep; to save, to download, to be beaten
- to book, to turn, to cross, to stop, to park
- ill; a patient, a cold, flu, a runny nose, a pill
- healthy, weak, strong, pale, tired

Before you move on

To be afraid? (бояться.) To please? (нравиться.) To hate? (ненавидеть.) To praise? (хвалить.) To scold? (ругать.) To sign? (подписывать.) To print? (печатать.) To keep; to save? (сохранять.) To download? (скачивать.) To be beaten? (проигрывать.) To book? (бронировать.) To turn? (поворачивать.) To cross? (пересекать.) To stop? (останавливаться.) To park? (парковать.) Ill; a patient? (больной.) A cold? (простуда.) Flu? (грипп.) A runny nose? (насморк.) A pill? (таблетка.) Healthy? (здоровый.) Weak? (слабый.) Strong? (сильный.) Pale? (бледный.) Tired? (усталый.)

Chapter 149

Half an hour, Quarter, Day and a night, Dawn, Sunset

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say half an hour, a quarter, a day and a night, dawn and sunset.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say half an hour, a quarter, a day and a night, dawn and sunset.

149.1 полчаса (polchasá) — half an hour

Before the new one: say the Russian for pale, then the Russian for tired.

You'll want to know: полчаса

полчаса (*polchasá*) — "half an hour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полчаса is пол-, "half", with часа, a form of час, "hour". Vasmer traces час to Proto-Slavic **časŭ* and thinks пол- probably kin to Albanian *palë*, "side".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: polchasá*
- *Say it: polchasá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *polchasá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pale, then the Russian for tired, then say *polchasá* again

Before you move on

What does полчаса mean? ("Half an hour".) Say it once more.

149.2 четверть (chétvert) — a quarter

Before the new one: say the Russian for tired, then the Russian for half an hour.

You'll want to know: четверть

четверть (*chétvert*) — "a quarter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

четверть is built on четвёртый, "fourth", from четыре, "four": a fourth part.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chétvert*
- *Say it: chétvert*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chétvert*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tired, then the Russian for half an hour, then say *chétvert* again

Before you move on

What does четверть mean? (“A quarter”.) Say it once more.

149.3 сутки (sútki) — a day and a night, 24 hours

Before the new one: say the Russian for half an hour, then the Russian for a quarter.

You’ll want to know: сутки

сутки (*sútki*) — “a day and a night, 24 hours”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сутки is су-, “together”, with **tŭka*, from тыкать, “to poke, to butt”: “the joining of day and night” (Vasmer). Dialects use сутки for the corners of a hut.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sútki*
- *Say it: sútki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sútki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for half an hour, then the Russian for a quarter, then say *sútki* again

Before you move on

What does сутки mean? (“A day and a night, 24 hours”.) Say it once more.

149.4 рассвет (rassvét) — dawn

Before the new one: say the Russian for a quarter, then the Russian for a day and a night.

You'll want to know: рассвет

рассвет (*rassvét*) — "dawn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рассвет is рас-, "apart, spreading", with свет, "light": dawn is light spreading. Vasmer relates свет to Sanskrit *śvetá-*, "white".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rassvét*
- *Say it: rassvét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rassvét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a quarter, then the Russian for a day and a night, then say *rassvét* again

Before you move on

What does рассвет mean? ("Dawn".) Say it once more.

149.5 закат (zakát) — sunset

Before the new one: say the Russian for a day and a night, then the Russian for dawn.

You'll want to know: закат

закат (*zakát*) — "sunset".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

закат is за-, “behind”, with кат, from катиться, “to roll”: sunset is the sun rolling down behind the horizon.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zakát*
- *Say it: zakát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zakát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a day and a night, then the Russian for dawn, then say *zakát* again

Before you move on

What does закат mean? (“Sunset”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

Rarely, Every, At first, At last, Still

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rarely, every, at first, at last and still.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say rarely, every, at first, at last and still.*

150.1 редко (rédko) — rarely

> Before the new one: say the Russian for dawn, then the Russian for sunset.

You'll want to know: редко

редко (*rédko*) — "rarely".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

редко is редкий, "sparse, rare", made into an adverb. Vasmer relates редкий to Lithuanian *rẽtas*, "sparse, rare", and Latin *rēte*, "a net": a net is all gaps.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rédko*
- *Say it: rédko*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rédko*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dawn, then the Russian for sunset, then say *rédko* again

Before you move on

What does редко mean? ("Rarely".) Say it once more.

150.2 каждый (kázhdyy) — every, each

Before the new one: say the Russian for sunset, then the Russian for rarely.

You'll want to know: каждый

каждый (*kázhdyy*) — "every, each".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

каждый ← Proto-Slavic **kŭžĭdo* — inherited: the old question stem of кто, "who", with же, a stressing particle, and -де, as in где, "where" (Vasmer). Gothic *hvarjis*, "which", is built in a similar way.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kázhdyy*
- *Say it: kázhdyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kázhdyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sunset, then the Russian for rarely, then say *kázhdyy* again

Before you move on

What does каждый mean? ("Every, each".) Say it once more.

150.3 сначала (snachála) — at first

Before the new one: say the Russian for rarely, then the Russian for every.

You'll want to know: сначала

сначала (*snachála*) — "at first".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сначала is с, "from", with начала, a form of начало, "the beginning": "from the start". Начало comes from начать, "to begin", which Vasmer puts in one family with конец, "end".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: snachála*
- *Say it: snachála*, once more
- *Say it:* say *snachála*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rarely, then the Russian for every, then say *snachála* again

Before you move on

What does сначала mean? ("At first".) Say it once more.

150.4 наконец (nakonéts) — at last, finally

Before the new one: say the Russian for every, then the Russian for at first.

You'll want to know: наконец

наконец (*nakonéts*) — "at last, finally".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наконец is на, "at, on", with конец, "the end". Vasmer relates конец to Latin *recēns*, "fresh", and Old Irish *cinim*, "I arise".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nakonéts*
- *Say it: nakonéts*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nakonéts*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for every, then the Russian for at first, then say *nakonéts* again

Before you move on

What does наконец mean? ("At last, finally".) Say it once more.

150.5 ещё (yeshchyó) — still; more

Before the new one: say the Russian for at first, then the Russian for at last.

You'll want to know: ещё

ещё (*yeshchyó*) — "still; more".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ещё ← Old Russian още, Old Church Slavonic *ješte*. Vasmer allows a link with Greek *éti*, "still", and Latin *et*, "and", plus an old $*k^we$, "and", but notes the sounds are hard to explain; Grappin traced it instead to **jest-je*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yeshchyó*
- *Say it: yeshchyó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yeshchyó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for at first, then the Russian for at last, then say *yeshchyó* again

Before you move on

What does **ещё** mean? ("Still; more".) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

Place, Centre, Outskirts, District, Avenue

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a place, the centre, the outskirts, a district and an avenue.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say a place, the centre, the outskirts, a district and an avenue.

151.1 МЕСТО (místo) — a place; a seat

Before the new one: say the Russian for at last, then the Russian for still; more.

You'll want to know: МЕСТО

МЕСТО (*místo*) — "a place; a seat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

МЕСТО ← Proto-Slavic **město*, "a place" — inherited. Its sense "town", in Ukrainian *misto* and Polish *miasto*, Vasmer explains as a copy of Middle High German *stat*, "place; town".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mésto*
- *Say it:* *mésto*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mésto*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for at last, then the Russian for still; more, then say *mésto* again

Before you move on

What does место mean? (“A place; a seat”.) Say it once more.

151.2 центр (tsentr) — the centre

Before the new one: say the Russian for still; more, then the Russian for a place; a seat.

You’ll want to know: центр

центр (*tsentr*) — “the centre”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

центр — recorded from the 1600s; it came through German *Zentrum* from Latin *centrum*, Greek *kéntron*, “a sharp point; the fixed leg of a compass” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *tsentr*
- *Say it:* *tsentr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsentr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for still; more, then the Russian for a place; a seat, then say *tsentr* again

Before you move on

What does центр mean? ("The centre".) Say it once more.

151.3 окраина (okráina) — the outskirts

Before the new one: say the Russian for a place; a seat, then the Russian for the centre.

You'll want to know: окраина

окраина (*okráina*) — "the outskirts".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

окраина is о-, "around", with край, "edge", and -ина: the land at the edge. Vasmer connects край with кроить, "to cut": an edge is where something is cut off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: okráina*
- *Say it: okráina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *okráina*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a place; a seat, then the Russian for the centre, then say *okráina* again

Before you move on

What does окраина mean? ("The outskirts".) Say it once more.

151.4 район (rayón) — a district

Before the new one: say the Russian for the centre, then the Russian for the outskirts.

You'll want to know: район

район (*rayón*) — "a district".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

район comes from French *rayon*, "a ray, a sector", from Latin *radius*, "a spoke, a ray" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rayón*
- *Say it: rayón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rayón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the centre, then the Russian for the outskirts, then say *rayón* again

Before you move on

What does район mean? ("A district".) Say it once more.

151.5 проспект (prospékt) — an avenue

Before the new one: say the Russian for the outskirts, then the Russian for a district.

You'll want to know: проспект

проспект (*prospékt*) — "an avenue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

проспект probably came through German *Prospekt*, "a view, a vista", from Latin *prōspectus*, "a view" (Vasmer): a long straight avenue gives a view; прешпект was the folk form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prospékt*
- *Say it: prospékt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prospékt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the outskirts, then the Russian for a district, then say *prospékt* again

Before you move on

What does проспект mean? ("An avenue".) Say it once more.

Chapter 152

Beside, Around, Inside, Outside, Behind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say beside, around, inside, outside and behind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say beside, around, inside, outside and behind.*

152.1 около (ókolo) — beside; roughly (with numbers)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a district, then the Russian for an avenue.

You'll want to know: около

около (*ókolo*) — "beside; roughly (with numbers)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

около is о-, "around", with коло, "a circle, a wheel" (Vasmer), the root of колесо, "wheel": "round about", and so "approximately".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ókolo*
- *Say it: ókolo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ókolo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a district, then the Russian for an avenue, then say *ókolo* again

Before you move on

What does **около** mean? (“Beside; roughly (with numbers)”.) Say it once more.

152.2 вокруг (vokrúg) — around

Before the new one: say the Russian for an avenue, then the Russian for beside; roughly.

You’ll want to know: вокруг

вокруг (*vokrúg*) — “around”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вокруг is **в**, “in”, with **круг**, “a circle”: “in a ring around”. Vasmer relates **круг** to Old Norse *hringr*, “a ring”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vokrúg*
- *Say it: vokrúg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vokrúg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an avenue, then the Russian for beside; roughly, then say *vokrúg* again

Before you move on

What does вокруг mean? (“Around”.) Say it once more.

152.3 внутри (vnutrí) — inside

Before the new one: say the Russian for beside; roughly, then the Russian for around.

You’ll want to know: внутри

внутри (*vnutrí*) — “inside”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

внутри is в, “in”, with a form of нутро, “the inside”, from **vŭn-ǫtrŭ*, “within” (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Greek *éntera*, “entrails”, and Latin *interus*, “inner”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vnutrí*
- *Say it: vnutrí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vnutrí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beside; roughly, then the Russian for around, then say *vnutrí* again

Before you move on

What does внутри mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

152.4 снаружи (snarúzhi) — outside

Before the new one: say the Russian for around, then the Russian for inside.

You'll want to know: снаружи

снаружи (*snarúzhi*) — "outside".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

снаружи is с, "from", with наружи, "outside", built on dialect ружь, "the outward look" (Vasmer), which he relates to Latvian *raũdzît*, "to look".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: snarúzhi*
- *Say it: snarúzhi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *snarúzhi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for around, then the Russian for inside, then say *snarúzhi* again

Before you move on

What does снаружи mean? ("Outside".) Say it once more.

152.5 сзади (szádi) — behind

Before the new one: say the Russian for inside, then the Russian for outside.

You'll want to know: сзади

сзади (*szádi*) — "behind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сзади is с, "from", with зади, from зад, "the back, the rear".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: szádi*
- *Say it: szádi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *szádi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for inside, then the Russian for outside, then say *szádi* again

Before you move on

What does сзади mean? ("Behind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 153

Gym, Mosque, Temple, Monument, Fountain

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a gym, a mosque, a temple, a monument and a fountain.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say a gym, a mosque, a temple, a monument and a fountain.

153.1 спортзал (sportzál) — a gym

Before the new one: say the Russian for outside, then the Russian for behind.

You'll want to know: спортзал

спортзал (*sportzál*) — "a gym".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спортзал is спорт, "sport", from English, with зал, "a hall", from German *Saal* and French *salle*, words of Germanic origin (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sportzál*
- *Say it: sportzál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sportzál*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for outside, then the Russian for behind, then say *sportzál* again

Before you move on

What does спортзал mean? ("A gym".) Say it once more.

153.2 мечеть (mechét) — a mosque

Before the new one: say the Russian for behind, then the Russian for a gym.

You'll want to know: мечеть

мечеть (*mechét*) — "a mosque".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мечеть — recorded from 1584; it comes from Turkish and Arabic *mäsdžid*, "a place of prostration, a mosque", through Tatar *mäčit* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mechét*
- *Say it: mechét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mechét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for behind, then the Russian for a gym, then say *mechét* again

Before you move on

What does мечеть mean? ("A mosque".) Say it once more.

153.3 храм (khram) — a temple, a church

Before the new one: say the Russian for a gym, then the Russian for a mosque.

You'll want to know: храм

храм (*khram*) — "a temple, a church".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

храм — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, beside native хоромы, "a large wooden house": -ра- against -оро-. A temple is the house of God.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khram*
- *Say it: khram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khram*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a gym, then the Russian for a mosque, then say *khram* again

Before you move on

What does храм mean? ("A temple, a church".) Say it once more.

153.4 памятник (pámyatnik) — a monument

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mosque, then the Russian for a temple.

You'll want to know: памятник

памятник (*pámyatnik*) — "a monument".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

памятник is память, "memory", with -ник: a thing that keeps memory. Vasmer relates память to Lithuanian *atmintìs*, "memory", Sanskrit *matí-*, "thought", and Latin *mēns*, "mind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pámyatnik*
- *Say it:* *pámyatnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pámyatnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mosque, then the Russian for a temple, then say *pámyatnik* again

Before you move on

What does памятник mean? ("A monument".) Say it once more.

153.5 фонтан (fontán) — a fountain

Before the new one: say the Russian for a temple, then the Russian for a monument.

You'll want to know: фонтан

фонтан (*fontán*) — "a fountain".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фонтан — from Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *fontana* or straight from Italian *fontana*, from Latin *fōns*, *fontis*, "a spring" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fontán*
- *Say it: fontán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fontán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a temple, then the Russian for a monument, then say *fontán* again

Before you move on

What does фонтан mean? ("A fountain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

So, Since, If, Although, Otherwise

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say so, since, if, although and otherwise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say so, since, if, although and otherwise.*

154.1 поэтому (poétomu) — so, therefore

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a monument, then the Russian for a fountain.

You'll want to know: поэтому

поэтому (*poétomu*) — "so, therefore".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поэтому is по, "by, after", with этому, a form of этот, "this": "for this reason". Vasmer builds этот from a pointing э and the old **tŭ* of тот.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poétomu*
- *Say it: poétomu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poétomu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a monument, then the Russian for a fountain, then say *poétomu* again

Before you move on

What does поэтому mean? (“So, therefore”.) Say it once more.

154.2 так как (tak kak) — since, as

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fountain, then the Russian for so.

You’ll want to know: так как

так как (*tak kak*) — “since, as”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

так как is так, “so”, with как, “how, as”: “so as, since”. так comes from the pronoun тот, “that”, and как from the question stem of кто, “who” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tak kak*
- *Say it: tak kak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tak kak*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fountain, then the Russian for so, then say *tak kak* again

Before you move on

What does так как mean? ("Since, as".) Say it once more.

154.3 если (yésli) — if

Before the new one: say the Russian for so, then the Russian for since.

You'll want to know: если

если (*yésli*) — "if".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

если is old естьли, still in Karamzin: есть, "is", with ли, the asking word (Vasmer). It spread in the 1500s and 1600s, perhaps under Polish *jeśli*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yésli*
- *Say it: yésli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yésli*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for so, then the Russian for since, then say *yésli* again

Before you move on

What does если mean? ("If".) Say it once more.

154.4 хотя (khotyá) — although

Before the new one: say the Russian for since, then the Russian for if.

You'll want to know: хотя

хотя (*khotyá*) — "although".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хотя is the old present participle of хотеть, "to want", Old Russian хотя, "wanting" (Vasmer); хоть, "at least, even", is its short form.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khotyá*
- *Say it: khotyá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khotyá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for since, then the Russian for if, then say *khotyá* again

Before you move on

What does хотя mean? ("Although".) Say it once more.

154.5 иначе (ináche) — otherwise

Before the new one: say the Russian for if, then the Russian for although.

You'll want to know: иначе

иначе (*ináche*) — "otherwise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

иначе comes from иной, "other", with an adverb ending: "in another way, otherwise".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ináche*
- *Say it: ináche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ináche*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for if, then the Russian for although, then say *ináche* again

Before you move on

What does иначе mean? ("Otherwise".) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

Nice, Clever, Silly, Lazy, Polite

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say nice, clever, silly, lazy and polite.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say nice, clever, silly, lazy and polite.*

155.1 милый (mílyy) — nice, sweet (of a person)

Before the new one: say the Russian for although, then the Russian for otherwise.

You'll want to know: милый

милый (*mílyy*) — "nice, sweet (of a person)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

милый ← Proto-Slavic **milŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *míelas*, "dear", *méilė*, "love", Sanskrit *máyas*, "delight", and Latin *mītis*, "gentle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mílyy*
- *Say it:* *mílyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mílyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for although, then the Russian for otherwise, then say *mílyy* again

Before you move on

What does милый mean? ("Nice, sweet (of a person)".) Say it once more.

155.2 умный (úmnyy) — clever

Before the new one: say the Russian for otherwise, then the Russian for nice.

You'll want to know: умный

умный (*úmnyy*) — "clever".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

умный is ум, "mind", with -ный. ум ← Proto-Slavic **umŭ*, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *aumuõ*, "reason", and East Lithuanian *aumenis*, "memory".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *úmnyy*
- *Say it:* *úmnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *úmnyy*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for otherwise, then the Russian for nice, then say *úmnyy* again

Before you move on

What does умный mean? (“Clever”.) Say it once more.

155.3 глупый (glúpyy) — silly, stupid

Before the new one: say the Russian for nice, then the Russian for clever.

You’ll want to know: глупый

глупый (*glúpyy*) — “silly, stupid”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

глупый ← Proto-Slavic **glupŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it is probably related to Old Norse *glópr*, “an idiot”, and perhaps to глухой, “deaf”, and finds a Germanic loan unlikely.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glúpyy*
- *Say it: glúpyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glúpyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nice, then the Russian for clever, then say *glúpyy* again

Before you move on

What does глупый mean? (“Silly, stupid”.) Say it once more.

155.4 ленивый (lenívyy) — lazy

Before the new one: say the Russian for clever, then the Russian for silly.

You'll want to know: ленивый

ленивый (*lenívyy*) — "lazy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ленивый comes from лень, "laziness" (Vasmer), with -ивый, "full of". Vasmer relates лень to Lithuanian *lėnas*, "slow, quiet", and Latin *lēnis*, "soft, gentle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lenívyy*
- *Say it: lenívyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lenívyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for clever, then the Russian for silly, then say *lenívyy* again

Before you move on

What does ленивый mean? ("Lazy".) Say it once more.

155.5 вежливый (vézhlivyy) — polite

Before the new one: say the Russian for silly, then the Russian for lazy.

You'll want to know: вежливый

вежливый (*vézhlivyy*) — "polite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вежливый — Old Russian вежливой also meant “experienced, knowing”; it is built on **vědja*, from ведать, “to know” (Vasmer). Polite was first “knowing how to behave”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vézhlivyy*
- *Say it: vézhlivyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vézhlivyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for silly, then the Russian for lazy, then say *vézhlivyy* again

Before you move on

What does вежливый mean? (“Polite”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

Rich, Poor, Clean, Dirty, Empty

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rich, poor, clean, dirty and empty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say rich, poor, clean, dirty and empty.*

156.1 богатый (bogátyy) — rich

> Before the new one: say the Russian for lazy, then the Russian for polite.

You'll want to know: богатый

богатый (*bogátyy*) — "rich".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

богатый comes from Proto-Slavic **bogŭ*: Vasmer gives both readings, "god", so "favoured by the gods" like Latin *fortūnātus*, and "a share, wealth", as in убогий, "poor", "without a share".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bogátyy*
- *Say it: bogátyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bogátyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for lazy, then the Russian for polite, then say *bogátyy* again

Before you move on

What does богатый mean? (“Rich”.) Say it once more.

156.2 бедный (bédnyy) — poor

Before the new one: say the Russian for polite, then the Russian for rich.

You’ll want to know: бедный

бедный (*bédnyy*) — “poor”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бедный is беда, “misfortune”, with -ный: “unfortunate”, then “poor”. Vasmer compares Lithuanian *bėdà*, “trouble”, and Latvian *będa*, “sorrow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bédnyy*
- *Say it: bédnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bédnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for polite, then the Russian for rich, then say *bédnyy* again

Before you move on

What does бедный mean? ("Poor".) Say it once more.

156.3 чистый (chístyy) — clean

Before the new one: say the Russian for rich, then the Russian for poor.

You'll want to know: чистый

чистый (*chístyy*) — "clean".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чистый ← Proto-Slavic **čistŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *skijstan*, "clean", and Lithuanian *skýstas*, "liquid", and perhaps to цедить, "to strain".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chístyy*
- *Say it: chístyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chístyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rich, then the Russian for poor, then say *chístyy* again

Before you move on

What does чистый mean? ("Clean".) Say it once more.

156.4 грязный (gryáznyy) — dirty

Before the new one: say the Russian for poor, then the Russian for clean.

You'll want to know: грязный

грязный (*gryáznyy*) — "dirty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грязный is грязь, "mud", with -ный. Vasmer puts грязь with грязнуть, "to get stuck, to sink in": mud is what you sink into.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gryáznyy*
- *Say it:* *gryáznyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gryáznyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for poor, then the Russian for clean, then say *gryáznyy* again

Before you move on

What does грязный mean? ("Dirty".) Say it once more.

156.5 пустой (pustóy) — empty

Before the new one: say the Russian for clean, then the Russian for dirty.

You'll want to know: пустой

пустой (*pustóy*) — "empty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пустой ← Proto-Slavic **pustŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *pausto*, "wild", and *paustre*, "a wilderness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pustóy*
- *Say it: pustóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pustóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for clean, then the Russian for dirty, then say *pustóy* again

Before you move on

What does пустой mean? ("Empty".) Say it once more.

Chapter 157

Light blue, Sweet, Sour, Tasty, Comfortable

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say light blue, sweet, sour, tasty and comfortable.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say light blue, sweet, sour, tasty and comfortable.*

157.1 голубой (golubóy) — light blue

> Before the new one: say the Russian for dirty, then the Russian for empty.

You'll want to know: голубой

голубой (*golubóy*) — "light blue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

голубой comes from голубь, "a dove", after the blue sheen of a dove's neck feathers (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: golubóy*
- *Say it: golubóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golubóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dirty, then the Russian for empty, then say *golubóy* again

Before you move on

What does голубой mean? ("Light blue".) Say it once more.

157.2 сладкий (sládkiy) — sweet (taste)

Before the new one: say the Russian for empty, then the Russian for light blue.

You'll want to know: сладкий

сладкий (*sládkiy*) — "sweet (taste)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сладкий — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of native солодкий: -ла- against -оло-. The native root is in солод, "malt", and Lithuanian *saldùs*, "sweet", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sládkiy*
- *Say it: sládkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sládkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for empty, then the Russian for light blue, then say *sládkiy* again

Before you move on

What does сладкий mean? (“Sweet (taste)”.) Say it once more.

157.3 кислый (kíslyy) — sour

Before the new one: say the Russian for light blue, then the Russian for sweet.

You’ll want to know: кислый

кислый (*kíslyy*) — “sour”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кислый ← Proto-Slavic **kyslŭ* — inherited, with кисель, “a fruit jelly”. Vasmer relates it to Latvian *kûsât*, “to boil, to bubble”: sour as fermented.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kíslyy*
- *Say it: kíslyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kíslyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for light blue, then the Russian for sweet, then say *kíslyy* again

Before you move on

What does кислый mean? (“Sour”.) Say it once more.

157.4 вкусный (vkúsnyy) — tasty

Before the new one: say the Russian for sweet, then the Russian for sour.

You'll want to know: вкусный

вкусный (*vkúsnyy*) — "tasty".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вкусный is вкус, "taste", with -ный. вкус comes from кусить, "to bite, to try", which Vasmer relates to Gothic *kausjan*, "to taste"; its sense "taste in art" copies French *goût*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vkúsnyy*
- *Say it: vkúsnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vkúsnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sweet, then the Russian for sour, then say *vkúsnyy* again

Before you move on

What does вкусный mean? ("Tasty".) Say it once more.

157.5 удобный (udóbnyy) — comfortable, convenient

Before the new one: say the Russian for sour, then the Russian for tasty.

You'll want to know: удобный

удобный (*udóbnyy*) — "comfortable, convenient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

удобный comes from Old Russian удобь, "easily", у- with доба, "a fitting time, fitness" (Vasmer): convenient is "fitting".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *udóbnyy*
- *Say it:* *udóbnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *udóbnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sour, then the Russian for tasty, then say *udóbnyy* again

Before you move on

What does удобный mean? ("Comfortable, convenient".) Say it once more.

157.6 Words from chapters 149-152 — a first pass

Say the words for tasty and comfortable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- half an hour, a quarter, a day and a night, dawn, sunset
- rarely, every, at first, at last, still; more
- a place; a seat, the centre, the outskirts, a district, an avenue
- beside; roughly, around, inside, outside, behind

Before you move on

Half an hour? (полчаса.) A quarter? (четверть.) A day and a night? (сутки.) Dawn? (рассвет.) Sunset? (закат.) Rarely? (редко.) Every? (каждый.) At first? (сначала.) At last? (наконец.) Still; more? (ещё.) A place; a seat? (место.) The

centre? (центр.) The outskirts? (окраина.) A district? (район.) An avenue? (проспект.) Beside; roughly? (около.) Around? (вокруг.) Inside? (внутри.) Outside? (снаружи.) Behind? (сзади.)

157.7 Words from chapters 153-157 — a second pass

Say the words for a gym and a mosque.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a gym, a mosque, a temple, a monument, a fountain
- so, since, if, although, otherwise
- nice, clever, silly, lazy, polite
- rich, poor, clean, dirty, empty
- light blue, sweet, sour, tasty, comfortable

Before you move on

A gym? (спортзал.) A mosque? (мечеть.) A temple? (храм.) A monument? (памятник.) A fountain? (фонтан.) So? (поэтому.) Since? (так как.) If? (если.) Although? (хотя.) Otherwise? (иначе.) Nice? (милый.) Clever? (умный.) Silly? (глупый.) Lazy? (ленивый.) Polite? (вежливый.) Rich? (богатый.) Poor? (бедный.) Clean? (чистый.) Dirty? (грязный.) Empty? (пустой.) Light blue? (голубой.) Sweet? (сладкий.) Sour? (кислый.) Tasty? (вкусный.) Comfortable? (удобный.)

Chapter 158

Alive, Dead, Hungry, Well-fed, Familiar

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say alive, dead, hungry, well-fed and familiar.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say alive, dead, hungry, well-fed and familiar.

158.1 живой (zhivóy) — alive, lively

Before the new one: say the Russian for tasty, then the Russian for comfortable, convenient.

You'll want to know: живой

живой (*zhivóy*) — "alive, lively".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

живой ← Proto-Slavic **živъ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *gývas*, Sanskrit *jīvá-*, Latin *vīvus* and Gothic *qius*, all "alive": English *quick*, in its old sense "alive", is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhivóy*
- *Say it: zhivóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhivóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tasty, then the Russian for comfortable, convenient, then say *zhivóy* again

Before you move on

What does живой mean? ("Alive, lively".) Say it once more.

158.2 мёртвый (myórtvyy) — dead

Before the new one: say the Russian for comfortable, convenient, then the Russian for alive.

You'll want to know: мёртвый

мёртвый (*myórtvyy*) — "dead".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мёртвый ← Proto-Slavic **mĭrtvŭ* — inherited from PIE **mr̥tós*, "dead", reshaped after живой, "alive", as Latin *mortuus* was (Vasmer). Vasmer lists Sanskrit *mr̥tá-*, "dead", and Greek *brotós*, "mortal".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myórtvyy*
- *Say it: myórtvyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myórtvyy*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for comfortable, convenient, then the Russian for alive, then say *myórtvyy* again

Before you move on

What does мёртвый mean? (“Dead”.) Say it once more.

158.3 голодный (golódnyy) — hungry

Before the new one: say the Russian for alive, then the Russian for dead.

You’ll want to know: голодный

голодный (*golódnyy*) — “hungry”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

голодный is голод, “hunger”, with -ный. голод ← Proto-Slavic **goldŭ*, which Vasmer relates to Sanskrit *gṛdhyati*, “is greedy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: golódnyy*
- *Say it: golódnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golódnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for alive, then the Russian for dead, then say *golódnyy* again

Before you move on

What does голодный mean? (“Hungry”.) Say it once more.

158.4 сытый (sýtyy) — well-fed, full up

Before the new one: say the Russian for dead, then the Russian for hungry.

You'll want to know: сытый

сытый (*sýtyy*) — "well-fed, full up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сытый ← Proto-Slavic **sytŭ* — inherited. Vasmer finds the comparison with Lithuanian *sotùs*, "full", Gothic *saþs*, "sated", and Latin *satis*, "enough", suggests itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sýtyy*
- *Say it: sýtyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sýtyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dead, then the Russian for hungry, then say *sýtyy* again

Before you move on

What does **сытый** mean? ("Well-fed, full up".) Say it once more.

158.5 знакомый (znakómyy) — familiar; an acquaintance

Before the new one: say the Russian for hungry, then the Russian for well-fed.

You'll want to know: знакомый

знакомый (*znakómyy*) — "familiar; an acquaintance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

знакомый is built on знак, "a sign, a mark", from знать, "to know": a person you know. знать is a cousin of English *know* and Latin *(g)nōscere*, "to get to know".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: znakómyy*
- *Say it: znakómyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *znakómyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hungry, then the Russian for well-fed, then say *znakómyy* again

Before you move on

What does знакомый mean? ("Familiar; an acquaintance".) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Thing, Object, Furniture, Armchair, Chest of drawers

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thing, an object, furniture, an armchair and a chest of drawers.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say a thing, an object, furniture, an armchair and a chest of drawers.*

159.1 вещь (veshch) — a thing

> Before the new one: say the Russian for well-fed, then the Russian for familiar; an acquaintance.

You'll want to know: вещь

вещь (*veshch*) — "a thing".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вещь — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, as the -щ- shows. He relates it to Gothic *waíhts*, "a thing", and Old High German *wiht*, "a being, a thing": English *wight* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veshch*
- *Say it: veshch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veshch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for well-fed, then the Russian for familiar; an acquaintance, then say *veshch* again

Before you move on

What does вещь mean? ("A thing".) Say it once more.

159.2 предмет (predmét) — an object; a school subject

Before the new one: say the Russian for familiar; an acquaintance, then the Russian for a thing.

You'll want to know: предмет

предмет (*predmét*) — "an object; a school subject".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

предмет is пред-, "before", with -мет, "thrown", from метать, "to throw": it copies, through Polish *przedmiot*, Latin *obiectum*, "something thrown before" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: predmét*
- *Say it: predmét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *predmét*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for familiar; an acquaintance, then the Russian for a thing, then say *predmét* again

Before you move on

What does предмет mean? (“An object; a school subject”.) Say it once more.

159.3 мебель (mébel) — furniture

Before the new one: say the Russian for a thing, then the Russian for an object; a school subject.

You’ll want to know: мебель

мебель (*mébel*) — “furniture”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мебель — from Peter the Great’s time; it came through German *Möbel* or straight from French *meuble*, from Latin *mōbile*, “movable (property)” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mébel*
- *Say it: mébel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mébel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a thing, then the Russian for an object; a school subject, then say *mébel* again

Before you move on

What does мебель mean? (“Furniture”.) Say it once more.

159.4 кресло (kréslo) — an armchair

Before the new one: say the Russian for an object; a school subject, then the Russian for furniture.

You'll want to know: кресло

кресло (*kréslo*) — "an armchair".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кресло ← Proto-Slavic **křěslo* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *krėslas* and Latvian *krēsls*, "chair" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kréslo*
- *Say it: kréslo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kréslo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an object; a school subject, then the Russian for furniture, then say *kréslo* again

Before you move on

What does кресло mean? ("An armchair".) Say it once more.

159.5 комод (komód) — a chest of drawers

Before the new one: say the Russian for furniture, then the Russian for an armchair.

You'll want to know: комод

комод (*komód*) — "a chest of drawers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

КОМОД comes from French *commode*, “a chest of drawers”, from *commode*, “convenient”, perhaps through German *Kommode* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: komód*
- *Say it: komód*, once more
- *Say it:* say *komód*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for furniture, then the Russian for an armchair, then say *komód* again

Before you move on

What does КОМОД mean? (“A chest of drawers”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

Wine glass, Bag, Box, Drawer, Light bulb

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a wine glass, a bag, a box, a drawer and a light bulb.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say a wine glass, a bag, a box, a drawer and a light bulb.*

160.1 бокал (bokál) — a wine glass

> Before the new one: say the Russian for an armchair, then the Russian for a chest of drawers.

You'll want to know: бокал

бокал (*bokál*) — "a wine glass".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бокал comes from French *bocal* or Italian *boccale*, "a goblet"; the rarer покал, under Peter the Great, came from German *Pokal* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bokál*
- *Say it: bokál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bokál*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an armchair, then the Russian for a chest of drawers, then say *bokál* again

Before you move on

What does бокал mean? ("A wine glass".) Say it once more.

160.2 пакет (pakét) — a bag (plastic or paper)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a chest of drawers, then the Russian for a wine glass.

You'll want to know: пакет

пакет (*pakét*) — "a bag (plastic or paper)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пакет — older покет, from 1700; it probably came through German *Paket* from French *paquet*, "a bundle" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakét*
- *Say it: pakét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a chest of drawers, then the Russian for a wine glass, then say *pakét* again

Before you move on

What does пакет mean? (“A bag (plastic or paper)”.) Say it once more.

160.3 коробка (коро́бка) — a box

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wine glass, then the Russian for a bag.

You’ll want to know: коробка

коробка (*коро́бка*) — “a box”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

коробка is короб, “a box of bark”, with -ка. Vasmer thinks короб is perhaps related to Latin *corbis*, “a basket”, and Lithuanian *karbas*, “a basket”; Miklosich, Berneker and others take it instead as a loan through Old High German *korb* from Latin *corbis*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: коро́бка*
- *Say it: коро́бка*, once more
- *Say it:* say *коро́бка*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wine glass, then the Russian for a bag, then say *коро́бка* again

Before you move on

What does коробка mean? (“A box”.) Say it once more.

160.4 ящик (yáshchik) — a drawer; a crate

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bag, then the Russian for a box.

You'll want to know: ящик

ящик (*yáshchik*) — "a drawer; a crate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ящик ← Old Russian *askŭ*, *jaskŭ*, "a basket", borrowed from Old Norse *askr*, "a wooden vessel", from *askr*, "ash tree", or from Old Norse *eski*, "a box" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yáshchik*
- *Say it: yáshchik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yáshchik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bag, then the Russian for a box, then say *yáshchik* again

Before you move on

What does ящик mean? ("A drawer; a crate".) Say it once more.

160.5 лампочка (lámpochka) — a light bulb

Before the new one: say the Russian for a box, then the Russian for a drawer; a crate.

You'll want to know: лампочка

лампочка (*lámpochka*) — "a light bulb".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лампочка is лампа, “a lamp”, with -очка, “little”: a little lamp, a bulb. лампа came from German *Lampe* or French *lampe*, Greek *lampás*, “a torch” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lámpochka*
- *Say it: lámpochka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lámpochka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a box, then the Russian for a drawer; a crate, then say *lámpochka* again

Before you move on

What does лампочка mean? (“A light bulb”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 161

Form, Envelope, Postage stamp, Postcard, Parcel

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a form, an envelope, a postage stamp, a postcard and a parcel.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say a form, an envelope, a postage stamp, a postcard and a parcel.*

161.1 анкета (ankéta) — a form, a questionnaire

Before the new one: say the Russian for a drawer; a crate, then the Russian for a light bulb.

You'll want to know: анкета

анкета (*ankéta*) — "a form, a questionnaire".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

анкета comes from French *enquête*, "an inquiry", which goes back, Vasmer says, to the Latin family of *quaestiō*, "a question".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ankéta*
- *Say it: ankéta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ankéta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a drawer; a crate, then the Russian for a light bulb, then say *ankéta* again

Before you move on

What does анкета mean? ("A form, a questionnaire".) Say it once more.

161.2 конверт (konvért) — an envelope

Before the new one: say the Russian for a light bulb, then the Russian for a form.

You'll want to know: конверт

конверт (*konvért*) — "an envelope".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

конверт — from Peter the Great's time; it came through German *Kuvert* or from French *couvert*, "a cover", from *couvrir*, "to cover", Latin *coopertum*, "covered" (Vasmer). Vasmer calls its н unexplained.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: konvért*
- *Say it: konvért*, once more
- *Say it:* say *konvért*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a light bulb, then the Russian for a form, then say *konvért* again

Before you move on

What does конверт mean? (“An envelope”.) Say it once more.

161.3 марка (márka) — a postage stamp; a brand

Before the new one: say the Russian for a form, then the Russian for an envelope.

You’ll want to know: марка

марка (*márka*) — “a postage stamp; a brand”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

марка comes from German *Marke*, “a mark, a sign”, Middle High German *marc*, from *merken*, “to notice” (Vasmer). The марка that names the old German coin is German *Mark*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: márka*
- *Say it: márka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *márka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a form, then the Russian for an envelope, then say *márka* again

Before you move on

What does марка mean? (“A postage stamp; a brand”.) Say it once more.

161.4 открытка (otkrýtka) — a postcard

Before the new one: say the Russian for an envelope, then the Russian for a postage stamp; a brand.

You'll want to know: открытка

открытка (*otkrýtka*) — "a postcard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

открытка is cut down from открытое письмо, "an open letter", with -ка: a postcard has no envelope. открытый is "opened", from открыть, "to open", on крыть, "to cover".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otkrýtka*
- *Say it: otkrýtka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otkrýtka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an envelope, then the Russian for a postage stamp; a brand, then say *otkrýtka* again

Before you move on

What does открытка mean? ("A postcard".) Say it once more.

161.5 посылка (posýlka) — a parcel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a postage stamp; a brand, then the Russian for a postcard.

You'll want to know: посылка

посылка (*posýlka*) — "a parcel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

посылка comes from посылать, “to send”, with the noun ending -ка: something sent.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: posýlka*
- *Say it: posýlka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *posýlka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a postage stamp; a brand, then the Russian for a postcard, then say *posýlka* again

Before you move on

What does посылка mean? (“A parcel”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

Blouse, T-shirt, Tights, Trainers, Slippers

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a blouse, a T-shirt, tights, trainers and slippers.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say a blouse, a T-shirt, tights, trainers and slippers.

162.1 блузка (blúzka) — a blouse

Before the new one: say the Russian for a postcard, then the Russian for a parcel.

You'll want to know: блузка

блузка (*blúzka*) — "a blouse".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

блузка is блуза, "a blouse", with -ка. блуза came from German *Bluse* or French *blouse*, which Vasmer, with Kluge, traces, probably, to Medieval Latin *pelusia*, cloth from the Egyptian town of Pelusium.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blúzka*
- *Say it: blúzka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blúzka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a postcard, then the Russian for a parcel, then say *blúzka* again

Before you move on

What does блузка mean? (“A blouse”.) Say it once more.

162.2 футболка (futbólka) — a T-shirt

Before the new one: say the Russian for a parcel, then the Russian for a blouse.

You’ll want to know: футболка

футболка (*futbólka*) — “a T-shirt”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

футболка is футбол, “football”, from English, with -ка: first the shirt footballers wore.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: futbólka*
- *Say it: futbólka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *futbólka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a parcel, then the Russian for a blouse, then say *futbólka* again

Before you move on

What does футболка mean? ("A T-shirt".) Say it once more.

162.3 колготки (kolgótki) — tights

Before the new one: say the Russian for a blouse, then the Russian for a T-shirt.

You'll want to know: колготки

колготки (*kolgótki*) — "tights".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

колготки comes from Czech *kalhotky*, "panties", the diminutive of *kalhoty*, "trousers".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kolgótki*
- *Say it: kolgótki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kolgótki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a blouse, then the Russian for a T-shirt, then say *kolgótki* again

Before you move on

What does колготки mean? ("Tights".) Say it once more.

162.4 кроссовки (krossóvki) — trainers

Before the new one: say the Russian for a T-shirt, then the Russian for tights.

You'll want to know: кроссовки

кроссовки (*krossóvki*) — "trainers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кроссовки is built on кросс, "a cross-country run", from English *cross(-country)*, with -овки: shoes for running.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krossóvki*
- *Say it: krossóvki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krossóvki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a T-shirt, then the Russian for tights, then say *krossóvki* again

Before you move on

What does кроссовки mean? ("Trainers".) Say it once more.

162.5 тапочки (tápochki) — slippers

Before the new one: say the Russian for tights, then the Russian for trainers.

You'll want to know: тапочки

тапочки (*tápochki*) — "slippers".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тапочки is a diminutive of тапки, "slippers". Vasmer has no entry for тапки, and its origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tápochki*
- *Say it: tápochki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tápochki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tights, then the Russian for trainers, then say *tápochki* again

Before you move on

What does тапочки mean? ("Slippers".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

Frankfurter, Prawn, Borscht, Cabbage soup, Pancake

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a frankfurter, a prawn, borscht, cabbage soup and a pancake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say a frankfurter, a prawn, borscht, cabbage soup and a pancake.*

163.1 сосиска (sosíska) — a frankfurter

Before the new one: say the Russian for trainers, then the Russian for slippers.

You'll want to know: сосиска

сосиска (*sosíska*) — "a frankfurter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сосиска comes from French *saucisse*, "a sausage", from Medieval Latin *salsīcia*, from *salsus*, "salted" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sosíska*
- *Say it: sosíska*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sosíska*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for trainers, then the Russian for slippers, then say *sosíska* again

Before you move on

What does сосиска mean? ("A frankfurter".) Say it once more.

163.2 креветка (krevétka) — a prawn

Before the new one: say the Russian for slippers, then the Russian for a frankfurter.

You'll want to know: креветка

креветка (*krevétka*) — "a prawn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

креветка comes from French *crevette*, "a prawn", with -ка.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krevétka*
- *Say it: krevétka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krevétka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for slippers, then the Russian for a frankfurter, then say *krevétka* again

Before you move on

What does креветка mean? (“A prawn”.) Say it once more.

163.3 борщ (borshch) — borscht

Before the new one: say the Russian for a frankfurter, then the Russian for a prawn.

You’ll want to know: борщ

борщ (*borshch*) — “borscht”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

борщ first named a plant, hogweed, борщевик; the soup once cooked from it passed its name to the beet soup (Vasmer). Because the plant has sharp leaves, the name is derived from a root “bristly, prickly”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: borshch*
- *Say it: borshch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *borshch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a frankfurter, then the Russian for a prawn, then say *borshch* again

Before you move on

What does борщ mean? (“Borscht”.) Say it once more.

163.4 щи (shchi) — cabbage soup

Before the new one: say the Russian for a prawn, then the Russian for borscht.

You'll want to know: щи

щи (*shchi*) — "cabbage soup".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

щи ← Old Russian шти, "a soup". Its origin is not settled: Vasmer thinks it perhaps goes back to Old Russian *sŭto*, "food", and finds a link with щавель, "sorrel", a soup green, less likely, though Jakobson, in Trubachev's note, accepted it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shchi*
- *Say it: shchi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shchi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a prawn, then the Russian for borscht, then say *shchi* again

Before you move on

What does щи mean? ("Cabbage soup".) Say it once more.

163.5 блин (blin) — a pancake

Before the new one: say the Russian for borscht, then the Russian for cabbage soup.

You'll want to know: блин

блин (*blin*) — "a pancake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

блин ← Old Russian *mlinŭ*, the older form: it is linked with молоть, "to grind", and мелю, "I grind" (Vasmer). A pancake is made of

milled flour.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blin*
- *Say it: blin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blin*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for borscht, then the Russian for cabbage soup, then say *blin* again

Before you move on

What does блин mean? ("A pancake".) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

Beer, Wine, Climate, Air, Earth

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say beer, wine, a climate, air and the earth.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say beer, wine, a climate, air and the earth.*

164.1 пиво (pívo) — beer

> Before the new one: say the Russian for cabbage soup, then the Russian for a pancake.

You'll want to know: пиво

пиво (*pívo*) — "beer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пиво comes from пить, "to drink" (Vasmer): first "a drink", then "beer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pívo*

- *Say it: pívo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pívo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cabbage soup, then the Russian for a pancake, then say *pívo* again

Before you move on

What does **пиво** mean? ("Beer".) Say it once more.

164.2 вино (vinó) — wine

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pancake, then the Russian for beer.

You'll want to know: вино

вино (*vinó*) — "wine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вино is usually taken as an ancient Mediterranean word, as in Latin *vīnum*, Greek *oînos* and Gothic *wein*. Vasmer thinks Slavic more likely borrowed it than inherited it, from Latin or from Germanic. English *wine* comes from the Latin word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vinó*
- *Say it: vinó*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vinó*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pancake, then the Russian for beer, then say *vinó* again

Before you move on

What does вино mean? ("Wine".) Say it once more.

164.3 климат (klímat) — a climate

Before the new one: say the Russian for beer, then the Russian for wine.

You'll want to know: климат

климат (*klímat*) — "a climate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

климат comes, by its written shape, from French *climat*, Latin *clima*, from Greek *klíma*, "a slope", the earth's slope from equator to pole (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klímat*
- *Say it: klímat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klímat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beer, then the Russian for wine, then say *klímat* again

Before you move on

What does климат mean? ("A climate".) Say it once more.

164.4 воздух (vózdukh) — air

Before the new one: say the Russian for wine, then the Russian for a climate.

You'll want to know: воздух

воздух (*vózdukh*) — "air".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

воздух — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer: воз-, "up", with дух, "breath, spirit". It renders Greek *aḗr*, "air".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vózdukh*
- *Say it:* *vózdukh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vózdukh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for wine, then the Russian for a climate, then say *vózdukh* again

Before you move on

What does воздух mean? ("Air".) Say it once more.

164.5 земля (zemlyá) — the earth; land

Before the new one: say the Russian for a climate, then the Russian for air.

You'll want to know: земля

земля (*zemlyá*) — "the earth; land".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

земля ← Proto-Slavic **zemja* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *žẽmė*, "earth", Avestan *zam-*, Greek *chamaí*, "on the ground", and Latin *humus*, "soil".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zemlyá*
- *Say it: zemlyá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zemlyá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a climate, then the Russian for air, then say *zemlyá* again

Before you move on

What does земля mean? ("The earth; land".) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

Crow, Eagle, Parrot, Hamster, Hedgehog

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a crow, an eagle, a parrot, a hamster and a hedgehog.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say a crow, an eagle, a parrot, a hamster and a hedgehog.*

165.1 ворона (voróna) — a crow

> Before the new one: say the Russian for air, then the Russian for the earth; land.

You'll want to know: ворона

ворона (*voróna*) — "a crow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ворона ← Proto-Slavic **vorna* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *várna* and Old Prussian *warne*, "crow" (Vasmer); it goes with ворон, "raven". Church Slavonic has врана, "crow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *voróna*
- *Say it:* *voróna*, once more
- *Say it:* say *voróna*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for air, then the Russian for the earth; land, then say *voróna* again

Before you move on

What does ворона mean? (“A crow”.) Say it once more.

165.2 орёл (oryól) — an eagle

Before the new one: say the Russian for the earth; land, then the Russian for a crow.

You’ll want to know: орёл

орёл (*oryól*) — “an eagle”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

орёл ← Proto-Slavic **orĭlŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *erẽlis*, Gothic *ara* and German *Aar*, “eagle”, and Greek *órnis*, “bird”; English *erne*, “sea eagle”, is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *oryól*
- *Say it:* *oryól*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oryól*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the earth; land, then the Russian for a crow, then say *oryól* again

Before you move on

What does орёл mean? (“An eagle”.) Say it once more.

165.3 попугай (popugáy) — a parrot

Before the new one: say the Russian for a crow, then the Russian for an eagle.

You’ll want to know: попугай

попугай (*popugáy*) — “a parrot”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

попугай — recorded from 1589; it probably came through Dutch *papegaai* and Low German *papagoie* from Old French *papegai* and Spanish *papagayo*, from Arabic *babaghā*, “parrot” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: popugáy*
- *Say it: popugáy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *popugáy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a crow, then the Russian for an eagle, then say *popugáy* again

Before you move on

What does попугай mean? (“A parrot”.) Say it once more.

165.4 хомяк (khomyák) — a hamster

Before the new one: say the Russian for an eagle, then the Russian for a parrot.

You'll want to know: хомяк

хомяк (*khomyák*) — "a hamster".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хомяк — Old Russian хомекы; Vasmer thinks it is probably an old loan from Iranian, compare Avestan *hamaēstar-*, "a foe who throws to the ground".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khomyák*
- *Say it: khomyák*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khomyák*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an eagle, then the Russian for a parrot, then say *khomyák* again

Before you move on

What does хомяк mean? ("A hamster".) Say it once more.

165.5 ёж (yozh) — a hedgehog

Before the new one: say the Russian for a parrot, then the Russian for a hamster.

You'll want to know: ёж

ёж (*yozh*) — "a hedgehog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ёж ← Proto-Slavic **ežĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *ežỹs*, German *Igel* and Greek *echînos*, "hedgehog", and ties them to Greek *échis*, "snake": perhaps a taboo name, "the snake-eater".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yozh*
- *Say it: yozh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yozh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a parrot, then the Russian for a hamster, then say *yozh* again

Before you move on

What does **ёж** mean? ("A hedgehog".) Say it once more.

Chapter 166

Skis, Skates, Team, Match, Training session

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say skis, skates, a team, a match and a training session.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can say skis, skates, a team, a match and a training session.*

166.1 лыжи (lýzhi) — skis

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hamster, then the Russian for a hedgehog.

You'll want to know: лыжи

лыжи (*lýzhi*) — "skis".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лыжи is the plural of лыжа, "a ski". Vasmer links it with dialect лызгать, "to slide on ice", and Bulgarian *lŭzgam se*, "I skate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lýzhi*
- *Say it: lýzhi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lýzhi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hamster, then the Russian for a hedgehog, then say *lýzhi* again

Before you move on

What does лыжи mean? (“Skis”.) Say it once more.

166.2 коньки (konkí) — skates

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hedgehog, then the Russian for skis.

You’ll want to know: коньки

коньки (*konkí*) — “skates”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

коньки comes from конь, “a horse” (Vasmer), as “little horses”; a common explanation is that old skates had a horse’s head carved at the toe.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: konkí*
- *Say it: konkí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *konkí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hedgehog, then the Russian for skis, then say *konkí* again

Before you move on

What does коньки mean? ("Skates".) Say it once more.

166.3 команда (kománda) — a team

Before the new one: say the Russian for skis, then the Russian for skates.

You'll want to know: команда

команда (*kománda*) — "a team".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

команда — from 1700; it came through French *commande* or German *Kommando* from Italian *comando*, "an order" (Vasmer). A team is a group under one command.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kománda*
- *Say it: kománda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kománda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for skis, then the Russian for skates, then say *kománda* again

Before you move on

What does команда mean? ("A team".) Say it once more.

166.4 матч (match) — a match

Before the new one: say the Russian for skates, then the Russian for a team.

You'll want to know: матч

матч (*match*) — "a match".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

матч comes from English *match*, "a contest between equals".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: match*
- *Say it: match*, once more
- *Say it:* say *match*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for skates, then the Russian for a team, then say *match* again

Before you move on

What does матч mean? ("A match".) Say it once more.

166.5 тренировка (treniróvka) — a training session

Before the new one: say the Russian for a team, then the Russian for a match.

You'll want to know: тренировка

тренировка (*treniróvka*) — "a training session".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тренировка is built on тренировать, "to train", from English *train*, through German *trainieren*. The English verb comes from French *traîner*, "to drag".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: treniróvka*
- *Say it: treniróvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *treniróvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a team, then the Russian for a match, then say *treniróvka* again

Before you move on

What does тренировка mean? ("A training session".) Say it once more.

166.6 Words from chapters 158-161 — a first pass

Say the words for a match and a training session.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- alive, dead, hungry, well-fed, familiar; an acquaintance
- a thing, an object; a school subject, furniture, an armchair, a chest of drawers
- a wine glass, a bag, a box, a drawer; a crate, a light bulb
- a form, an envelope, a postage stamp; a brand, a postcard, a parcel

Before you move on

Alive? (живой.) Dead? (мёртвый.) Hungry? (голодный.) Well-fed? (сытый.) Familiar; an acquaintance? (знакомый.) A thing? (вещь.) An object; a school subject? (предмет.)

Furniture? (мебель.) An armchair? (кресло.) A chest of drawers? (комод.) A wine glass? (бокал.) A bag? (пакет.) A box? (коробка.) A drawer; a crate? (ящик.) A light bulb? (лампочка.) A form? (анкета.) An envelope? (конверт.) A postage stamp; a brand? (марка.) A postcard? (открытка.) A parcel? (посылка.)

166.7 Words from chapters 162-166 — a second pass

Say the words for a blouse and a T-shirt.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a blouse, a T-shirt, tights, trainers, slippers
- a frankfurter, a prawn, borscht, cabbage soup, a pancake
- beer, wine, a climate, air, the earth; land
- a crow, an eagle, a parrot, a hamster, a hedgehog
- skis, skates, a team, a match, a training session

Before you move on

A blouse? (блузка.) A T-shirt? (футболка.) Tights? (колготки.) Trainers? (кроссовки.) Slippers? (тапочки.) A frankfurter? (сосиска.) A prawn? (креветка.) Borscht? (борщ.) Cabbage soup? (щи.) A pancake? (блин.) Beer? (пиво.) Wine? (вино.) A climate? (климат.) Air? (воздух.) The earth; land? (земля.) A crow? (ворона.) An eagle? (орёл.) A parrot? (попугай.) A hamster? (хомяк.) A hedgehog? (ёж.) Skis? (лыжи.) Skates? (коньки.) A team? (команда.) A match? (матч.) A training session? (тренировка.)

Chapter 167

Suburban train, Motorbike, Lorry, Petrol, Petrol station

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a suburban train, a motorbike, a lorry, petrol and a petrol station.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can say a suburban train, a motorbike, a lorry, petrol and a petrol station.*

167.1 электричка (elektríchka) — a suburban train

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a match, then the Russian for a training session.

You'll want to know: электричка

электричка (*elektríchka*) — "a suburban train".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

электричка is электрический поезд, "an electric train", folded into one word with -ка. электрический, "electric", goes back to Greek *ḗlektron*, "amber", which gives a spark when rubbed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: elektríchka*
- *Say it: elektríchka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *elektríchka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a match, then the Russian for a training session, then say *elektríchka* again

Before you move on

What does электричка mean? ("A suburban train".) Say it once more.

167.2 мотоцикл (mototsíkl) — a motorbike

Before the new one: say the Russian for a training session, then the Russian for a suburban train.

You'll want to know: мотоцикл

мотоцикл (*mototsíkl*) — "a motorbike".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мотоцикл is an international coinage, from French *motocycle* or German *Motozykel*: Latin *mōtor*, "a mover", with Greek *kýklos*, "a wheel".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mototsíkl*
- *Say it: mototsíkl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mototsíkl*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a training session, then the Russian for a suburban train, then say *mototsíkl* again

Before you move on

What does мотоцикл mean? (“A motorbike”.) Say it once more.

167.3 грузовик (gruzovík) — a lorry

Before the new one: say the Russian for a suburban train, then the Russian for a motorbike.

You’ll want to know: грузовик

грузовик (*gruzovík*) — “a lorry”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грузовик is груз, “a load, a cargo”, with -овик: a vehicle for loads. Vasmer relates груз to грязнуть, “to sink in”, and Lithuanian *gramzdýti*, “to sink”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gruzovík*
- *Say it: gruzovík*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gruzovík*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a suburban train, then the Russian for a motorbike, then say *gruzovík* again

Before you move on

What does грузовик mean? (“A lorry”.) Say it once more.

167.4 бензин (benzín) — petrol

Before the new one: say the Russian for a motorbike, then the Russian for a lorry.

You'll want to know: бензин

бензин (*benzín*) — "petrol".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бензин comes from French *benzine*, from Medieval Latin *benzoe*, a resin, from Arabic *lubān jāwī*, "incense of Java" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: benzín*
- *Say it: benzín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *benzín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a motorbike, then the Russian for a lorry, then say *benzín* again

Before you move on

What does бензин mean? ("Petrol".) Say it once more.

167.5 заправка (zaprávka) — a petrol station

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lorry, then the Russian for petrol.

You'll want to know: заправка

заправка (*zaprávka*) — "a petrol station".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

заправка comes from заправить, “to fill up, to refuel”, за- with править, “to set right”, from правый, “straight”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zaprávka*
- *Say it: zaprávka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zaprávka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lorry, then the Russian for petrol, then say *zaprávka* again

Before you move on

What does заправка mean? (“A petrol station”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 168

Wedding, Bridegroom, Bride, Relative, Pensioner

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a wedding, a bridegroom, a bride, a relative and a pensioner.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say a wedding, a bridegroom, a bride, a relative and a pensioner.

168.1 свадьба (svádba) — a wedding

Before the new one: say the Russian for petrol, then the Russian for a petrol station.

You'll want to know: свадьба

свадьба (*svádba*) — "a wedding".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свадьба — Old Russian сватьба; it comes from сват, "a matchmaker, an in-law" (Vasmer), and first meant "match-making". Vasmer connects сват with свой, "one's own".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *svádba*
- *Say it:* *svádba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svádba*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for petrol, then the Russian for a petrol station, then say *svádba* again

Before you move on

What does свадьба mean? ("A wedding".) Say it once more.

168.2 жених (zheníkh) — a bridegroom, a fiancé

Before the new one: say the Russian for a petrol station, then the Russian for a wedding.

You'll want to know: жених

жених (*zheníkh*) — "a bridegroom, a fiancé".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жених is built on женить, "to marry (a man) off", from жена, "wife" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zheníkh*
- *Say it:* *zheníkh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zheníkh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a petrol station, then the Russian for a wedding, then say *zheníkh* again

Before you move on

What does жених mean? (“A bridegroom, a fiancé”.) Say it once more.

168.3 невеста (nevésta) — a bride, a fiancée

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wedding, then the Russian for a bridegroom.

You’ll want to know: невеста

невеста (*nevésta*) — “a bride, a fiancée”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

невеста — Vasmer still finds the old explanation best: “the unknown one”, не, “not”, with the root of ведать, “to know”, for the new bride is a stranger in her husband’s house. Trubachev’s note cites other views.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nevésta*
- *Say it: nevésta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nevésta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wedding, then the Russian for a bridegroom, then say *nevésta* again

Before you move on

What does невеста mean? (“A bride, a fiancée”.) Say it once more.

168.4 родственник (ródstvennik) — a relative

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bridegroom, then the Russian for a bride.

You'll want to know: родственник

родственник (*ródstvennik*) — "a relative".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

родственник is built on родство, "kinship", from род, "family, kin", with -ник. Vasmer relates род to Latvian *rads*, "a relative", and Sanskrit *várdhati*, "grows".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ródstvennik*
- *Say it: ródstvennik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ródstvennik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bridegroom, then the Russian for a bride, then say *ródstvennik* again

Before you move on

What does родственник mean? ("A relative".) Say it once more.

168.5 пенсионер (pensionér) — a pensioner

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bride, then the Russian for a relative.

You'll want to know: пенсионер

пенсионер (*pensionér*) — "a pensioner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пенсионер comes from French *pensionnaire*, built on *pension*, from Latin *pēnsiō*, "a payment", from *pendere*, "to weigh, to pay".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pensionér*
- *Say it: pensionér*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pensionér*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bride, then the Russian for a relative, then say *pensionér* again

Before you move on

What does пенсионер mean? ("A pensioner".) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

Request, Help, Opinion, Truth, Lie

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a request, help, an opinion, the truth and a lie.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say a request, help, an opinion, the truth and a lie.*

169.1 просьба (prósba) — a request

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a relative, then the Russian for a pensioner.

You'll want to know: просьба

просьба (*prósba*) — "a request".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

просьба is a noun from просить, "to ask, to request", which Vasmer relates to Latin *precor*, "I pray", and German *fragen*, "to ask".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prósba*
- *Say it: prósba*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prósba*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a relative, then the Russian for a pensioner, then say *prósba* again

Before you move on

What does просьба mean? (“A request”.) Say it once more.

169.2 помощь (pómoshch) — help

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pensioner, then the Russian for a request.

You’ll want to know: помощь

помощь (*pómoshch*) — “help”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

помощь is по- with мощь, “might”, whose -щ- is the Church Slavonic shape of native мочь, “power”, from могу, “I can”. Vasmer relates it to Gothic *mahts*, “might”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pómoshch*
- *Say it: pómoshch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pómoshch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pensioner, then the Russian for a request, then say *pómoshch* again

Before you move on

What does помощь mean? ("Help".) Say it once more.

169.3 мнение (mnéniye) — an opinion

Before the new one: say the Russian for a request, then the Russian for help.

You'll want to know: мнение

мнение (*mnéniye*) — "an opinion".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мнение comes from мнить, "to suppose, to think" (Vasmer), the root also of память, "memory".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mnéniye*
- *Say it: mnéniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mnéniye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a request, then the Russian for help, then say *mnéniye* again

Before you move on

What does мнение mean? ("An opinion".) Say it once more.

169.4 правда (právda) — the truth

Before the new one: say the Russian for help, then the Russian for an opinion.

You'll want to know: правда

правда (*právda*) — "the truth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

правда — Old Russian правьда, "justice, truth, law"; it is built on правый, "right, straight": the truth is what is right.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *právda*
- *Say it:* *právda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *právda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for help, then the Russian for an opinion, then say *právda* again

Before you move on

What does правда mean? ("The truth".) Say it once more.

169.5 ложь (lozh) — a lie

Before the new one: say the Russian for an opinion, then the Russian for the truth.

You'll want to know: ложь

ложь (*lozh*) — "a lie".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ложь goes with лгать, "to tell lies" (Vasmer), Proto-Slavic **lŭgati*; Gothic *liugan*, "to lie", and English *lie*, "a falsehood", come from the same root.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lozh*
- *Say it: lozh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lozh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an opinion, then the Russian for the truth, then say *lozh* again

Before you move on

What does **ложь** mean? ("A lie".) Say it once more.

Chapter 170

Post, Salary, Tax, Bill, Cash

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a post, a salary, a tax, a bill and cash.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say a post, a salary, a tax, a bill and cash.*

170.1 должность (dólzhnost) — a post, a position

> Before the new one: say the Russian for the truth, then the Russian for a lie.

You'll want to know: должность

должность (*dólzhnost*) — "a post, a position".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

должность comes from долг, "a debt, a duty", and first meant "an obligation" (Vasmer). Vasmer relates долг to Gothic *dulgs*, "a debt", and Old Irish *dligid*, "a duty".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dólzhnost*
- *Say it: dólzhnost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dólzhnost*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the truth, then the Russian for a lie, then say *dólzhnost* again

Before you move on

What does должность mean? (“A post, a position”.) Say it once more.

170.2 зарплата (zarpláta) — a salary

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lie, then the Russian for a post.

You’ll want to know: зарплата

зарплата (*zarpláta*) — “a salary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зарплата is заработная плата, “earned pay”, cut short. Vasmer explains плата, “pay”, from плат, “a cloth”, since pieces of cloth once served as money.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zarpláta*
- *Say it: zarpláta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zarpláta*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lie, then the Russian for a post, then say *zarpláta* again

Before you move on

What does зарплата mean? (“A salary”.) Say it once more.

170.3 налог (nalóg) — a tax

Before the new one: say the Russian for a post, then the Russian for a salary.

You’ll want to know: налог

налог (*nalóg*) — “a tax”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

налог is на-, “on”, with -лог, from the root of лежать, “to lie”, and положить, “to lay”: a tax is what is laid on you. Vasmer derives лог from лежать, Proto-Slavic **ležati*, kin to Greek *léchos*, “a bed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nalóg*
- *Say it: nalóg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nalóg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a post, then the Russian for a salary, then say *nalóg* again

Before you move on

What does налог mean? (“A tax”.) Say it once more.

170.4 счёт (schyot) — a bill; an account

Before the new one: say the Russian for a salary, then the Russian for a tax.

You'll want to know: счёт

счёт (*schyot*) — "a bill; an account".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

счёт is с- with чёт, "a count", from считать, "to count", on the root of читать, "to read", which once meant "to count".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schyot*
- *Say it: schyot*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schyot*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a salary, then the Russian for a tax, then say *schyot* again

Before you move on

What does счёт mean? ("A bill; an account".) Say it once more.

170.5 наличные (nalíchnyye) — cash

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tax, then the Russian for a bill; an account.

You'll want to know: наличные

наличные (*nalíchnyye*) — "cash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наличные is short for наличные деньги, “money at hand”, from налицо, “present, in view”, на, “on”, with лицо, “face”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nalíchnyye*
- *Say it: nalíchnyye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nalíchnyye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tax, then the Russian for a bill; an account, then say *nalíchnyye* again

Before you move on

What does наличные mean? (“Cash”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

Singer, Vet, Judge, Soldier, Builder

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a singer, a vet, a judge, a soldier and a builder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say a singer, a vet, a judge, a soldier and a builder.*

171.1 певец (pevéts) — a singer

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a bill; an account, then the Russian for cash.

You'll want to know: певец

певец (*pevéts*) — "a singer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

певец comes from петь, "to sing" (Vasmer), with -ец, "one who does it".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pevéts*
- *Say it: pevéts*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pevéts*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bill; an account, then the Russian for cash, then say *pevéts* again

Before you move on

What does певец mean? (“A singer”.) Say it once more.

171.2 ветеринар (veterinár) — a vet

Before the new one: say the Russian for cash, then the Russian for a singer.

You’ll want to know: ветеринар

ветеринар (*veterinár*) — “a vet”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ветеринар comes, as German *Veterinär* does, from Latin *veterīnārius*, from *veterīnus*, “a beast of burden” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: veterinár*
- *Say it: veterinár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *veterinár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cash, then the Russian for a singer, then say *veterinár* again

Before you move on

What does ветеринар mean? (“A vet”.) Say it once more.

171.3 судья (sudyá) — a judge; a referee

Before the new one: say the Russian for a singer, then the Russian for a vet.

You’ll want to know: судья

судья (*sudyá*) — “a judge; a referee”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

судья ← Proto-Slavic **sǫdĭji*, built on суд, “judgement, court” — inherited (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sudyá*
- *Say it: sudyá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sudyá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a singer, then the Russian for a vet, then say *sudyá* again

Before you move on

What does судья mean? (“A judge; a referee”.) Say it once more.

171.4 солдат (soldát) — a soldier

Before the new one: say the Russian for a vet, then the Russian for a judge; a referee.

You'll want to know: солдат

солдат (*soldát*) — "a soldier".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

солдат — known from 1515; it came through German *Soldat* or Dutch *soldaat* from Italian *soldato*, "one hired for pay", from *soldare*, "to hire" (Vasmer), and *soldo*, "a coin", Latin *solidus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *soldát*
- *Say it:* *soldát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soldát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a vet, then the Russian for a judge; a referee, then say *soldát* again

Before you move on

What does солдат mean? ("A soldier".) Say it once more.

171.5 строитель (stroítel) — a builder

Before the new one: say the Russian for a judge; a referee, then the Russian for a soldier.

You'll want to know: строитель

строитель (*stroítel*) — "a builder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

строитель is строить, "to build", with -тель, "one who does it". строить comes from строй, "order, structure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stroítel*
- *Say it: stroítel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stroítel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a judge; a referee, then the Russian for a soldier, then say *stroítel* again

Before you move on

What does строитель mean? ("A builder".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

CV, Career, Pension, Business trip, Contract

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a CV, a career, a pension, a business trip and a contract.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say a CV, a career, a pension, a business trip and a contract.*

172.1 резюме (rezyumé) — a CV

Before the new one: say the Russian for a soldier, then the Russian for a builder.

You'll want to know: резюме

резюме (*rezyumé*) — "a CV".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

резюме comes from French *résumé*, "a summary", from *résumer*, "to sum up", Latin *resūmere*, "to take up again".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rezyumé*
- *Say it: rezyumé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rezyumé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a soldier, then the Russian for a builder, then say *rezyumé* again

Before you move on

What does резюме mean? (“A CV”.) Say it once more.

172.2 карьера (karyéra) — a career

Before the new one: say the Russian for a builder, then the Russian for a CV.

You’ll want to know: карьера

карьера (*karyéra*) — “a career”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

карьера comes from French *carrière*, “a racecourse, a career”, which goes back to Latin *carrus*, “a wagon”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karyéra*
- *Say it: karyéra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karyéra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a builder, then the Russian for a CV, then say *karyéra* again

Before you move on

What does карьера mean? ("A career".) Say it once more.

172.3 пенсия (pénsiya) — a pension

Before the new one: say the Russian for a CV, then the Russian for a career.

You'll want to know: пенсия

пенсия (*pénsiya*) — "a pension".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пенсия — older пенсион, from Peter the Great's time; it came from Polish *pensja* or German *Pension*, Latin *pēnsiō*, "a payment", from *pendere*, "to weigh out" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pénsiya*
- *Say it: pénsiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pénsiya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a CV, then the Russian for a career, then say *pénsiya* again

Before you move on

What does пенсия mean? ("A pension".) Say it once more.

172.4 командировка (komandiróvka) — a business trip

Before the new one: say the Russian for a career, then the Russian for a pension.

You'll want to know: командировка

командировка (*komandiróvka*) — "a business trip".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

командировка is built on командировать, "to send on official duty", from German *kommandieren*, "to command", with -ка.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: komandiróvka*
- *Say it: komandiróvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *komandiróvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a career, then the Russian for a pension, then say *komandiróvka* again

Before you move on

What does командировка mean? ("A business trip".) Say it once more.

172.5 договор (dogovór) — a contract

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pension, then the Russian for a business trip.

You'll want to know: договор

договор (*dogovór*) — "a contract".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

договор is до-, "up to, through", with говор, "talk": an agreement reached by talking a matter through. Говор is inherited; Vasmer relates it to Latvian *gaura*, "chatter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dogovór*
- *Say it: dogovór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dogovór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pension, then the Russian for a business trip, then say *dogovór* again

Before you move on

What does договор mean? ("A contract".) Say it once more.

172.6 Words from chapters 167-169 — a first pass

Say the words for a business trip and a contract.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a suburban train, a motorbike, a lorry, petrol, a petrol station
- a wedding, a bridegroom, a bride, a relative, a pensioner
- a request, help, an opinion, the truth, a lie

Before you move on

A suburban train? (электричка.) A motorbike? (мотоцикл.) A lorry? (грузовик.) Petrol? (бензин.) A petrol station? (заправка.) A wedding? (свадьба.) A bridegroom? (жених.) A bride? (невеста.) A relative? (родственник.) A pensioner? (пенсионер.) A request? (просьба.) Help? (помощь.) An opinion? (мнение.) The truth? (правда.) A lie? (ложь.)

172.7 Words from chapters 170-172 — a second pass

Say the words for a post and a salary.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a post, a salary, a tax, a bill; an account, cash
- a singer, a vet, a judge; a referee, a soldier, a builder
- a CV, a career, a pension, a business trip, a contract

Before you move on

A post? (должность.) A salary? (зарплата.) A tax? (налог.) A bill; an account? (счёт.) Cash? (наличные.) A singer? (певец.) A vet? (ветеринар.) A judge; a referee? (судья.) A soldier? (солдат.) A builder? (строитель.) A CV? (резюме.) A career? (карьера.) A pension? (пенсия.) A business trip? (командировка.) A contract? (договор.)

Chapter 173

To sew, To cut, To boil, To fry, To pour

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sew, to cut, to boil, to fry and to pour.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say to sew, to cut, to boil, to fry and to pour.*

173.1 шить (shit) — to sew

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a business trip, then the Russian for a contract.

You'll want to know: шить

шить (*shit*) — "to sew".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шить ← Proto-Slavic **šiti* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *siūti*, Sanskrit *sīvyati*, "sews", and Latin *suō*, "I sew": English *sew* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shit*
- *Say it: shit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a business trip, then the Russian for a contract, then say *shit* again

Before you move on

What does **шить** mean? ("To sew".) Say it once more.

173.2 резать (rézat) — to cut

Before the new one: say the Russian for a contract, then the Russian for to sew.

You'll want to know: резать

резать (*rézat*) — "to cut".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

резать ← Proto-Slavic **rězati* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *rėžti*, "to cut, to scratch", and Greek *rhḗgnymi*, "I break".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rézat*
- *Say it: rézat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rézat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a contract, then the Russian for to sew, then say *rézat* again

Before you move on

What does резать mean? ("To cut".) Say it once more.

173.3 варить (varít) — to boil, to cook

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sew, then the Russian for to cut.

You'll want to know: варить

варить (*varít*) — "to boil, to cook".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

варить ← Proto-Slavic **variti*, from вар, "boiling heat" — inherited. Vasmer relates вар to Lithuanian *vìrti*, "to boil", and Latvian *virt*, "to boil".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: varít*
- *Say it: varít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *varít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sew, then the Russian for to cut, then say *varít* again

Before you move on

What does варить mean? ("To boil, to cook".) Say it once more.

173.4 жарить (zhárit) — to fry

Before the new one: say the Russian for to cut, then the Russian for to boil.

You'll want to know: жарить

жарить (*zhárit*) — "to fry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жарить comes from жар, "heat", Proto-Slavic **žarŭ*, which Vasmer relates to Greek *thermós*, "warm", and Sanskrit *háras*, "heat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhárit*
- *Say it: zhárit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhárit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cut, then the Russian for to boil, then say *zhárit* again

Before you move on

What does жарить mean? ("To fry".) Say it once more.

173.5 наливать (nalivát) — to pour

Before the new one: say the Russian for to boil, then the Russian for to fry.

You'll want to know: наливать

наливать (*nalivát*) — "to pour".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наливать is на-, "into", with -ливать, from лить, "to pour", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *líeti*, "to pour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nalivát*
- *Say it: nalivát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nalivát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to boil, then the Russian for to fry, then say *nalivát* again

Before you move on

What does наливать mean? ("To pour".) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

To advise, To describe, To repeat, To translate, To remember

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to advise, to describe, to repeat, to translate and to remember.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say to advise, to describe, to repeat, to translate and to remember.

174.1 советовать (sovétovat) — to advise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to fry, then the Russian for to pour.

You'll want to know: советовать

советовать (*sovétovat*) — "to advise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

советовать comes from совет, "advice", со-, "together", with old вет, "counsel, word" (Vasmer), the root also of ответ, "answer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sovétovat*
- *Say it: sovétovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sovétovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to fry, then the Russian for to pour, then say *sovétovat* again

Before you move on

What does советовать mean? ("To advise".) Say it once more.

174.2 описывать (opísyvat) — to describe

Before the new one: say the Russian for to pour, then the Russian for to advise.

You'll want to know: описывать

описывать (*opísyvat*) — "to describe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

описывать is о-, "around", with -писывать, from писать, "to write": to describe is to write all round a thing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: opísyvat*
- *Say it: opísyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *opísyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to pour, then the Russian for to advise, then say *opísyvat* again

Before you move on

What does описывать mean? ("To describe".) Say it once more.

174.3 повторять (povtoryát) — to repeat

Before the new one: say the Russian for to advise, then the Russian for to describe.

You'll want to know: повторять

повторять (*povtoryát*) — "to repeat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

повторять is по- with -вторять, from второй, "second": to repeat is to do a thing a second time.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: povtoryát*
- *Say it: povtoryát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *povtoryát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to advise, then the Russian for to describe, then say *povtoryát* again

Before you move on

What does повторять mean? ("To repeat".) Say it once more.

174.4 переводить (perevodít) — to translate

Before the new one: say the Russian for to describe, then the Russian for to repeat.

You'll want to know: переводить

переводить (*perevodít*) — "to translate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

переводить is пере-, "across", with водить, "to lead": to translate is to lead words across, as Latin *trānslātus* is "carried across".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perevodít*
- *Say it: perevodít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perevodít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to describe, then the Russian for to repeat, then say *perevodít* again

Before you move on

What does переводить mean? ("To translate".) Say it once more.

174.5 помнить (pómnit) — to remember

Before the new one: say the Russian for to repeat, then the Russian for to translate.

You'll want to know: помнить

помнить (*pómnit*) — "to remember".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

помнить is по- with мнить, "to think, to suppose". Vasmer relates мнить to Lithuanian *minėti*, "to recall", Sanskrit *mányate*, "thinks", and Latin *mēns*, "mind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pómnit*
- *Say it: pómnit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pómnit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to repeat, then the Russian for to translate, then say *pómnit* again

Before you move on

What does **помнить** mean? ("To remember".) Say it once more.

Chapter 175

To pull, To lift, To switch on, To switch off, To light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to pull, to lift, to switch on, to switch off and to light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say to pull, to lift, to switch on, to switch off and to light.*

175.1 тянуть (tyanút) — to pull

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to translate, then the Russian for to remember.

You'll want to know: тянуть

тянуть (*tyanút*) — "to pull".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тянуть ← Proto-Slavic **tęgnǫti*, with тяга, "a pull" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Avestan *thanjayeiti*, "draws (a cart, a bow)", and Latin *tēmō*, "a wagon pole".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyanút*
- *Say it: tyanút*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyanút*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to translate, then the Russian for to remember, then say *tyanút* again

Before you move on

What does тянуть mean? ("To pull".) Say it once more.

175.2 поднимать (podnimát) — to lift, to raise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to remember, then the Russian for to pull.

You'll want to know: поднимать

поднимать (*podnimát*) — "to lift, to raise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поднимать is под-, "up from under", with -нимать, from the old verb **jęti*, "to take", as in взять, "to take": to lift is to take up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podnimát*
- *Say it: podnimát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podnimát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to remember, then the Russian for to pull, then say *podnimát* again

Before you move on

What does поднимать mean? ("To lift, to raise".) Say it once more.

175.3 включать (vklyuchát) — to switch on

Before the new one: say the Russian for to pull, then the Russian for to lift.

You'll want to know: включать

включать (*vklyuchát*) — "to switch on".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

включать is в-, "in", with -ключать, from ключ, "a key", and so "to shut in, to include", then "to switch on".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vklyuchát*
- *Say it: vklyuchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vklyuchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to pull, then the Russian for to lift, then say *vklyuchát* again

Before you move on

What does включать mean? ("To switch on".) Say it once more.

175.4 выключать (vyklyuchát) — to switch off

Before the new one: say the Russian for to lift, then the Russian for to switch on.

You'll want to know: выключать

выключать (*vyklyuchát*) — "to switch off".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выключать is вы-, "out", with -ключать, from ключ, "a key": to shut out, to switch off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vyklyuchát*
- *Say it: vyklyuchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vyklyuchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to lift, then the Russian for to switch on, then say *vyklyuchát* again

Before you move on

What does выключать mean? ("To switch off".) Say it once more.

175.5 зажигать (zazhigát) — to light, to set alight

Before the new one: say the Russian for to switch on, then the Russian for to switch off.

You'll want to know: зажигать

зажигать (*zazhigát*) — "to light, to set alight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зажигать is за-, "start", with -жигать, from жечь, "to burn" (Vasmer gives жечь under жгу, "I burn"): to set something burning.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zazhigát*
- *Say it: zazhigát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zazhigát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to switch on, then the Russian for to switch off, then say *zazhigát* again

Before you move on

What does зажигать mean? ("To light, to set alight".) Say it once more.

Chapter 176

To come back, To be late, To hurry, To rest, To get tired

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to come back, to be late, to hurry, to rest and to get tired.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say to come back, to be late, to hurry, to rest and to get tired.*

176.1 возвращаться (vozvrashchátsya) — to come back, to return

Before the new one: say the Russian for to switch off, then the Russian for to light.

You'll want to know: возвращаться

возвращаться (*vozvrashchátsya*) — "to come back, to return".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

возвращаться is воз-, "back", with вращать, "to turn", and -ся: to turn yourself back. вращать is the Church Slavonic shape of native ворочать (Vasmer), on the root of вертеть, "to turn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vozvrashchátsya*
- *Say it: vozvrashchátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vozvrashchátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to switch off, then the Russian for to light, then say *vozvrashchátsya* again

Before you move on

What does возвращаться mean? ("To come back, to return".) Say it once more.

176.2 опаздывать (opázdyvat) — to be late

Before the new one: say the Russian for to light, then the Russian for to come back.

You'll want to know: опаздывать

опаздывать (*opázdyvat*) — "to be late".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

опаздывать is о- with -паздывать, from поздно, "late", Proto-Slavic **pozdŭ*, which Vasmer traces to the PIE word for "after" in Latin *post*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: opázdyvat*
- *Say it: opázdyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *opázdyvat*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to light, then the Russian for to come back, then say *opázdyvat* again

Before you move on

What does опаздывать mean? (“To be late”.) Say it once more.

176.3 спешить (speshít) — to hurry

Before the new one: say the Russian for to come back, then the Russian for to be late.

You’ll want to know: спешить

спешить (*speshít*) — “to hurry”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спешить comes from спех, “haste” (Vasmer), the root of old **spěti*, “to succeed, to get on”, as in успех, “success”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: speshít*
- *Say it: speshít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *speshít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to come back, then the Russian for to be late, then say *speshít* again

Before you move on

What does спешить mean? (“To hurry”.) Say it once more.

176.4 отдыхать (otdykhát) — to rest

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be late, then the Russian for to hurry.

You'll want to know: отдыхать

отдыхать (*otdykhát*) — "to rest".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отдыхать is от-, "back", with -дыхать, from дышать, "to breathe": to rest is to get your breath back.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otdykhát*
- *Say it: otdykhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otdykhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be late, then the Russian for to hurry, then say *otdykhát* again

Before you move on

What does отдыхать mean? ("To rest".) Say it once more.

176.5 уставать (ustavát) — to get tired

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hurry, then the Russian for to rest.

You'll want to know: уставать

уставать (*ustavát*) — "to get tired".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

уставать is у- with -ставать, from стать, “to stand” (Vasmer): to tire is to come to a stop.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ustavát*
- *Say it: ustavát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ustavát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hurry, then the Russian for to rest, then say *ustavát* again

Before you move on

What does уставать mean? (“To get tired”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

To hug, To kiss, To argue, To quarrel, To make up

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to hug, to kiss, to argue, to quarrel and to make up.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say to hug, to kiss, to argue, to quarrel and to make up.*

177.1 обнимать (obnimát) — to hug

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to rest, then the Russian for to get tired.

You'll want to know: обнимать

обнимать (*obnimát*) — "to hug".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обнимать is об-, "around", with -нимать, from the old verb **jęti*, "to take": to take someone around.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obnimát*
- *Say it: obnimát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obnimát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to rest, then the Russian for to get tired, then say *obnimát* again

Before you move on

What does обнимать mean? ("To hug".) Say it once more.

177.2 целовать (tselovát) — to kiss

Before the new one: say the Russian for to get tired, then the Russian for to hug.

You'll want to know: целовать

целовать (*tselovát*) — "to kiss".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

целовать comes from целый, "whole, unharmed" (Vasmer); Old Russian целовати meant "to greet, to kiss". Vasmer compares Old High German *heilazzen* and Latin *salūtāre*, "to greet", both built on words for "whole, well".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tselovát*
- *Say it: tselovát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tselovát*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to get tired, then the Russian for to hug, then say *tselovát* again

Before you move on

What does целовать mean? ("To kiss".) Say it once more.

177.3 спорить (spórit) — to argue

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hug, then the Russian for to kiss.

You'll want to know: спорить

спорить (*spórit*) — "to argue".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спорить comes from спор, "a dispute", which Vasmer links with переть, "to push, to press", and Sanskrit *pṛt-*, "a battle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: spórit*
- *Say it: spórit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spórit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hug, then the Russian for to kiss, then say *spórit* again

Before you move on

What does спорить mean? ("To argue".) Say it once more.

177.4 ссориться (ssóritsya) — to quarrel

Before the new one: say the Russian for to kiss, then the Russian for to argue.

You'll want to know: ссориться

ссориться (*ssóritsya*) — "to quarrel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ссориться comes from ссора, "a quarrel", probably from **sŭsora*, which Vasmer relates to Latin *sermō*, "talk", and Gothic *swaran*, "to swear": a quarrel is a talk gone wrong.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ssóritsya*
- *Say it: ssóritsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ssóritsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to kiss, then the Russian for to argue, then say *ssóritsya* again

Before you move on

What does ссориться mean? ("To quarrel".) Say it once more.

177.5 мириться (mirítsya) — to make up (after a quarrel)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to argue, then the Russian for to quarrel.

You'll want to know: мириться

мириться (*mirítsya*) — "to make up (after a quarrel)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мириться comes from мир, "peace", with -иться: to make peace with each other. мир is related to Lithuanian *mieras*, "peace" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mirítsya*
- *Say it: mirítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mirítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to argue, then the Russian for to quarrel, then say *mirítsya* again

Before you move on

What does мириться mean? ("To make up (after a quarrel)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

To train, To run about, To jump, To go for a ride, To sunbathe

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to train, to run about, to jump, to go for a ride and to sunbathe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say to train, to run about, to jump, to go for a ride and to sunbathe.*

178.1 тренироваться (trenirovátsya) — to train, to practise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to quarrel, then the Russian for to make up.

You'll want to know: тренироваться

тренироваться (*trenirovátsya*) — "to train, to practise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тренироваться is тренировать, "to train", with -ся, "oneself"; the verb comes from English *train*, through German *trainieren*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trenirovátsya*
- *Say it: trenirovátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trenirovátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to quarrel, then the Russian for to make up, then say *trenirovátsya* again

Before you move on

What does тренироваться mean? ("To train, to practise".) Say it once more.

178.2 бегать (bégat) — to run about, to jog

Before the new one: say the Russian for to make up, then the Russian for to train.

You'll want to know: бегать

бегать (*bégat*) — "to run about, to jog".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бегать is the repeated-action partner of бежать, "to run" (Vasmer): running about. Vasmer relates the root to Lithuanian *bėgti*, "to run", and Greek *phóbos*, "flight".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bégat*
- *Say it: bégat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bégat*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for to make up, then the Russian for to train, then say *bégat* again

Before you move on

What does бегать mean? ("To run about, to jog".) Say it once more.

178.3 прыгать (prýgat) — to jump

Before the new one: say the Russian for to train, then the Russian for to run about.

You'll want to know: прыгать

прыгать (*prýgat*) — "to jump".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

прыгать ← Proto-Slavic **prygati* — inherited, with прыжок, "a jump". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *sprùkti*, "to slip away", and Latvian *sprukt*, "to escape".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prýgat*
- *Say it: prýgat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prýgat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to train, then the Russian for to run about, then say *prýgat* again

Before you move on

What does прыгать mean? ("To jump".) Say it once more.

178.4 кататься (katátsya) — to go for a ride, to skate

Before the new one: say the Russian for to run about, then the Russian for to jump.

You'll want to know: кататься

кататься (*katátsya*) — "to go for a ride, to skate".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кататься is катать, "to roll", with -ся: to roll along, to go for a ride. Vasmer doubts a link with English *skate*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: katátsya*
- *Say it: katátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *katátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to run about, then the Russian for to jump, then say *katátsya* again

Before you move on

What does кататься mean? ("To go for a ride, to skate".) Say it once more.

178.5 загорать (zagorát) — to sunbathe

Before the new one: say the Russian for to jump, then the Russian for to go for a ride.

You'll want to know: загорать

загорать (*zagorát*) — "to sunbathe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

загорать is за- with -горать, from гореть, "to burn": to sunbathe is to get burnt brown.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zagorát*
- *Say it: zagorát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zagorát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to jump, then the Russian for to go for a ride, then say *zagorát* again

Before you move on

What does загорать mean? ("To sunbathe".) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

Prescription, Injection, Wound, Bruise, Fracture

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a prescription, an injection, a wound, a bruise and a fracture.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say a prescription, an injection, a wound, a bruise and a fracture.*

179.1 рецепт (retsépt) — a prescription; a recipe

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to go for a ride, then the Russian for to sunbathe.

You'll want to know: рецепт

рецепт (*retsépt*) — "a prescription; a recipe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рецепт — from Peter the Great's time; it came through German *Rezept* from Latin *receptum*, "taken" (Vasmer): a doctor's note began *recipe*, "take".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: retsépt*
- *Say it: retsépt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *retsépt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to go for a ride, then the Russian for to sunbathe, then say *retsépt* again

Before you move on

What does рецепт mean? ("A prescription; a recipe".) Say it once more.

179.2 укол (ukól) — an injection

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sunbathe, then the Russian for a prescription; a recipe.

You'll want to know: укол

укол (*ukól*) — "an injection".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

укол is у- with кол, from колоть, "to prick, to stab". Vasmer relates колоть to Lithuanian *kálti*, "to strike, to forge".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ukól*
- *Say it: ukól*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ukól*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sunbathe, then the Russian for a prescription; a recipe, then say *ukól* again

Before you move on

What does укол mean? ("An injection".) Say it once more.

179.3 рана (rána) — a wound

Before the new one: say the Russian for a prescription; a recipe, then the Russian for an injection.

You'll want to know: рана

рана (*rána*) — "a wound".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рана ← Proto-Slavic **rana* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *vraṇá-*, "a wound, a crack", and Albanian *varrë*, "a wound".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rána*
- *Say it: rána*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rána*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a prescription; a recipe, then the Russian for an injection, then say *rána* again

Before you move on

What does рана mean? ("A wound".) Say it once more.

179.4 синяк (sinyák) — a bruise

Before the new one: say the Russian for an injection, then the Russian for a wound.

You'll want to know: синяк

синяк (*sinyák*) — "a bruise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

синяк comes from синий, "dark blue", with -як: a bruise is a blue mark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sinyák*
- *Say it: sinyák*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sinyák*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an injection, then the Russian for a wound, then say *sinyák* again

Before you move on

What does синяк mean? ("A bruise".) Say it once more.

179.5 перелом (perelóm) — a fracture

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wound, then the Russian for a bruise.

You'll want to know: перелом

перелом (*perelóm*) — "a fracture".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

перелом is пере-, "across, through", with лом, "a break", from ломать, "to break": a break right through the bone.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: perelóm*
- *Say it: perelóm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *perelóm*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wound, then the Russian for a bruise, then say *perelóm* again

Before you move on

What does перелом mean? ("A fracture".) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

Headache, Sleep, Diet, Vitamin, Lungs

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a headache, sleep, a diet, a vitamin and the lungs.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say a headache, sleep, a diet, a vitamin and the lungs.

180.1 головная боль (golovnáya bol) — a headache

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bruise, then the Russian for a fracture.

You'll want to know: головная боль

головная боль (*golovnáya bol*) — "a headache".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

головная боль is "head pain": головная, from голова, "head", with боль, "pain". Vasmer relates боль to Old English *bealu*, "evil", a link Berneker rejected.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: golovnáya bol*
- *Say it: golovnáya bol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golovnáya bol*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bruise, then the Russian for a fracture, then say *golovnáya bol* again

Before you move on

What does головная боль mean? ("A headache".) Say it once more.

180.2 сон (son) — sleep; a dream

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fracture, then the Russian for a headache.

You'll want to know: сон

сон (*son*) — "sleep; a dream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сон ← Proto-Slavic **sŭnŭ*, from **sŭpnŭ*, with спать, "to sleep" — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *sãpnas*, "a dream", Sanskrit *svápna-*, Greek *hýpnos* and Latin *somnus*, "sleep".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: son*
- *Say it: son*, once more
- *Say it:* say *son*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fracture, then the Russian for a headache, then say *son* again

Before you move on

What does сон mean? ("Sleep; a dream".) Say it once more.

180.3 диета (diyéta) — a diet

Before the new one: say the Russian for a headache, then the Russian for sleep; a dream.

You'll want to know: диета

диета (*diyéta*) — "a diet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

диета is a bookish loan from French *diète* or Latin *diaeta*, from Greek *díaita*, "a way of living" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diyéta*
- *Say it: diyéta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diyéta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a headache, then the Russian for sleep; a dream, then say *diyéta* again

Before you move on

What does диета mean? ("A diet".) Say it once more.

180.4 витамин (vitamín) — a vitamin

Before the new one: say the Russian for sleep; a dream, then the Russian for a diet.

You'll want to know: витамин

витамин (*vitamín*) — "a vitamin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

витамин is an international coinage of 1912: Latin *vīta*, "life", with *amine*, a chemical name.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vitamín*
- *Say it: vitamín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vitamín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sleep; a dream, then the Russian for a diet, then say *vitamín* again

Before you move on

What does витамин mean? ("A vitamin".) Say it once more.

180.5 лёгкие (lyógkiye) — the lungs

Before the new one: say the Russian for a diet, then the Russian for a vitamin.

You'll want to know: лёгкие

лёгкие (*lyógkiye*) — "the lungs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лёгкие is “the light ones”, from лёгкий, “light”: the lungs are the lightest organ, as in English *lights*, “lungs”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lyógkiye*
- *Say it: lyógkiye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyógkiye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a diet, then the Russian for a vitamin, then say *lyógkiye* again

Before you move on

What does лёгкие mean? (“The lungs”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

January, February, March, April, May

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say January, February, March, April and May.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say January, February, March, April and May.

181.1 январь (yanvár) — January

Before the new one: say the Russian for a vitamin, then the Russian for the lungs.

You'll want to know: январь

январь (*yanvár*) — "January".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

январь — Church Slavonic генуарь, from 1117; it came through Byzantine Greek *ianouários* from Latin *iānuārius*, the month of Janus (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yanvár*
- *Say it:* *yanvár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yanvár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a vitamin, then the Russian for the lungs, then say *yanvár* again

Before you move on

What does январь mean? (“January”.) Say it once more.

181.2 февраль (fevrál) — February

Before the new one: say the Russian for the lungs, then the Russian for January.

You’ll want to know: февраль

февраль (*fevrál*) — “February”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

февраль — Old Russian февраръ; it came through Byzantine Greek *phebrouários* from Latin *februārius*, the month of the *februa*, purification rites (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *fevrál*
- *Say it:* *fevrál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fevrál*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the lungs, then the Russian for January, then say *fevrál* again

Before you move on

What does февраль mean? (“February”.) Say it once more.

181.3 март (mart) — March

Before the new one: say the Russian for January, then the Russian for February.

You’ll want to know: март

март (*mart*) — “March”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

март — Old Russian *marŭtŭ*; it came through Byzantine Greek *mártios* from Latin *mārtius*, the month of Mars (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mart*
- *Say it: mart*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mart*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for January, then the Russian for February, then say *mart* again

Before you move on

What does март mean? (“March”.) Say it once more.

181.4 апрель (aprél) — April

Before the new one: say the Russian for February, then the Russian for March.

You'll want to know: апрель

апрель (*aprél*) — "April".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

апрель — Old Russian априль; it came through Byzantine Greek *aprílios* from Latin *aprīlis*, "April" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aprél*
- *Say it: aprél*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aprél*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for February, then the Russian for March, then say *aprél* again

Before you move on

What does апрель mean? ("April".) Say it once more.

181.5 май (may) — May

Before the new one: say the Russian for March, then the Russian for April.

You'll want to know: май

май (*may*) — "May".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

май — Old Church Slavonic маи; it came through Byzantine Greek *máïos* from Latin *māius*, "May" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: may*
- *Say it: may*, once more
- *Say it:* say *may*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for March, then the Russian for April, then say *may* again

Before you move on

What does май mean? ("May".) Say it once more.

181.6 Words from chapters 173-176 — a first pass

Say the words for April and May.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to sew, to cut, to boil, to fry, to pour
- to advise, to describe, to repeat, to translate, to remember
- to pull, to lift, to switch on, to switch off, to light
- to come back, to be late, to hurry, to rest, to get tired

Before you move on

To sew? (шить.) To cut? (резать.) To boil? (варить.) To fry? (жарить.) To pour? (наливать.) To advise? (советовать.) To describe? (описывать.) To repeat? (повторять.) To translate? (переводить.) To remember? (помнить.) To pull? (тянуть.) To lift? (поднимать.) To switch on? (включать.) To switch off?

(выключать.) To light? (зажигать.) To come back? (возвращаться.) To be late? (опаздывать.) To hurry? (спешить.) To rest? (отдыхать.) To get tired? (уставать.)

181.7 Words from chapters 177-181 — a second pass

Say the words for to hug and to kiss.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to hug, to kiss, to argue, to quarrel, to make up
- to train, to run about, to jump, to go for a ride, to sunbathe
- a prescription; a recipe, an injection, a wound, a bruise, a fracture
- a headache, sleep; a dream, a diet, a vitamin, the lungs
- January, February, March, April, May

Before you move on

To hug? (обнимать.) To kiss? (целовать.) To argue? (спорить.) To quarrel? (ссориться.) To make up? (мириться.) To train? (тренироваться.) To run about? (бегать.) To jump? (прыгать.) To go for a ride? (кататься.) To sunbathe? (загорать.) A prescription; a recipe? (рецепт.) An injection? (укол.) A wound? (рана.) A bruise? (синяк.) A fracture? (перелом.) A headache? (головная боль.) Sleep; a dream? (сон.) A diet? (диета.) A vitamin? (витамин.) The lungs? (лёгкие.) January? (январь.) February? (февраль.) March? (март.) April? (апрель.) May? (май.)

Chapter 182

Nowadays, School holidays, Birthday, Day off, On time

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say nowadays, school holidays, a birthday, a day off and on time.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say nowadays, school holidays, a birthday, a day off and on time.*

182.1 теперь (tepér) — nowadays, now (after a change)

Before the new one: say the Russian for April, then the Russian for May.

You'll want to know: теперь

теперь (*tepér*) — "nowadays, now (after a change)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

теперь ← older топерво, "only now": Vasmer explains it from тот, "that", with первый, "first".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tepér*
- *Say it: tepér*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tepér*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for April, then the Russian for May, then say *tepér* again

Before you move on

What does теперь mean? ("Nowadays, now (after a change)".) Say it once more.

182.2 каникулы (kanikuly) — school holidays

Before the new one: say the Russian for May, then the Russian for nowadays.

You'll want to know: каникулы

каникулы (*kanikuly*) — "school holidays".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

каникулы probably came through Polish *kanikuła* from Latin *canīcula*, "little dog", the star Sirius: *diēs canīculārēs*, "the dog days", the hottest weeks of the year (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kanikuly*
- *Say it: kanikuly*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kanikuly*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for May, then the Russian for nowadays, then say *kaníkuly* again

Before you move on

What does каникулы mean? (“School holidays”.) Say it once more.

182.3 день рождения (den rozhdéniya) — a birthday

Before the new one: say the Russian for nowadays, then the Russian for school holidays.

You’ll want to know: день рождения

день рождения (*den rozhdéniya*) — “a birthday”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

день рождения is “the day of birth”: день, “day”, with рождения, a form of рождение, “birth”, from родить, “to give birth”, and род, “kin”. The -жд- is Church Slavonic.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: den rozhdéniya*
- *Say it: den rozhdéniya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *den rozhdéniya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nowadays, then the Russian for school holidays, then say *den rozhdéniya* again

Before you move on

What does день рождения mean? (“A birthday”.) Say it once more.

182.4 выходной (vykhodnóy) — a day off

Before the new one: say the Russian for school holidays, then the Russian for a birthday.

You'll want to know: выходной

выходной (*vykhodnóy*) — "a day off".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выходной is short for выходной день, "a day off", from выход, "a going out": вы-, "out", with ход, "a going".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vykhodnóy*
- *Say it: vykhodnóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vykhodnóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for school holidays, then the Russian for a birthday, then say *vykhodnóy* again

Before you move on

What does выходной mean? ("A day off".) Say it once more.

182.5 вовремя (vóvremya) — on time

Before the new one: say the Russian for a birthday, then the Russian for a day off.

You'll want to know: вовремя

вовремя (*vóvremya*) — "on time".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вовремя is во, “in”, with время, “time”, a Church Slavonic word beside Old Russian веремя (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vóvremya*
- *Say it: vóvremya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vóvremya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a birthday, then the Russian for a day off, then say *vóvremya* again

Before you move on

What does вовремя mean? (“On time”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

Side street, Pavement, Road, Highway, Port

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a side street, a pavement, a road, a highway and a port.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say a side street, a pavement, a road, a highway and a port.*

183.1 переулок (pereúlok) — a side street

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a day off, then the Russian for on time.

You'll want to know: переулок

переулок (*pereúlok*) — "a side street".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

переулок is пере-, "across", with -улок, from улица, "street" (Vasmer): a lane that crosses between streets.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pereúlok*
- *Say it: pereúlok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pereúlok*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a day off, then the Russian for on time, then say *pereúlok* again

Before you move on

What does переулок mean? ("A side street".) Say it once more.

183.2 тротуар (trotuár) — a pavement

Before the new one: say the Russian for on time, then the Russian for a side street.

You'll want to know: тротуар

тротуар (*trotuár*) — "a pavement".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тротуар comes from French *trottoir*, "a footway", from *trotter*, "to trot" (Vasmer); folk speech said протуар.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trotuár*
- *Say it: trotuár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trotuár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for on time, then the Russian for a side street, then say *trotuár* again

Before you move on

What does тротуар mean? (“A pavement”.) Say it once more.

183.3 дорога (doróga) — a road; the way

Before the new one: say the Russian for a side street, then the Russian for a pavement.

You’ll want to know: дорога

дорога (*doróga*) — “a road; the way”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дорога, “road”, ← Proto-Slavic **dorga* — inherited. Vasmer links it with дёргать, “to pull, to tear”: first “a strip torn through the forest”. Serbo-Croatian драга means “a valley”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: doróga*
- *Say it: doróga*, once more
- *Say it:* say *doróga*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a side street, then the Russian for a pavement, then say *doróga* again

Before you move on

What does дорога mean? (“A road; the way”.) Say it once more.

183.4 шоссе (shossé) — a highway

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pavement, then the Russian for a road; the way.

You'll want to know: шоссе

шоссе (*shossé*) — "a highway".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шоссе came through German *Chaussée* or straight from French *chaussée*, "a paved road", from Latin *calciāta (via)*, "a road laid with lime" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shossé*
- *Say it: shossé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shossé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pavement, then the Russian for a road; the way, then say *shossé* again

Before you move on

What does шоссе mean? ("A highway".) Say it once more.

183.5 порт (port) — a port

Before the new one: say the Russian for a road; the way, then the Russian for a highway.

You'll want to know: порт

порт (*port*) — "a port".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

порт, "harbour", is recorded from 1702; it came through English *port* or German *Port* from French *port*, Latin *portus* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: port*
- *Say it: port*, once more
- *Say it:* say *port*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a road; the way, then the Russian for a highway, then say *port* again

Before you move on

What does порт mean? ("A port".) Say it once more.

Chapter 184

In front, Everywhere, To there, To here, From there

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say in front, everywhere, to there, to here and from there.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say in front, everywhere, to there, to here and from there.

184.1 впереди (vperedí) — in front, ahead

Before the new one: say the Russian for a highway, then the Russian for a port.

You'll want to know: впереди

впереди (*vperedí*) — "in front, ahead".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

впереди is в, "in", with переди, from Old Russian передь, "the front part" (Vasmer): in front.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vperedí*
- *Say it:* *vperedí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vperedí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a highway, then the Russian for a port, then say *vperedí* again

Before you move on

What does впереди mean? (“In front, ahead”.) Say it once more.

184.2 везде (vezdé) — everywhere

Before the new one: say the Russian for a port, then the Russian for in front.

You’ll want to know: везде

везде (*vezdé*) — “everywhere”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

везде — Old Russian вьсьде: весь, “all”, with -де, the place ending of где, “where” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vezdé*
- *Say it:* *vezdé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vezdé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a port, then the Russian for in front, then say *vezdé* again

Before you move on

What does везде mean? ("Everywhere".) Say it once more.

184.3 туда (tudá) — to there, that way

Before the new one: say the Russian for in front, then the Russian for everywhere.

You'll want to know: туда

туда (*tudá*) — "to there, that way".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

туда ← Old Russian туда — inherited, built on the stem of тот, "that" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tudá*
- *Say it: tudá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tudá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for in front, then the Russian for everywhere, then say *tudá* again

Before you move on

What does туда mean? ("To there, that way".) Say it once more.

184.4 сюда (syudá) — to here, this way

Before the new one: say the Russian for everywhere, then the Russian for to there.

You'll want to know: сюда

сюда (*syudá*) — "to here, this way".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сюда is built like куда, "where to", and туда, "there", on the old pronoun **sĭ*, "this" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: syudá*
- *Say it: syudá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *syudá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for everywhere, then the Russian for to there, then say *syudá* again

Before you move on

What does сюда mean? ("To here, this way".) Say it once more.

184.5 оттуда (ottúda) — from there

Before the new one: say the Russian for to there, then the Russian for to here.

You'll want to know: оттуда

оттуда (*ottúda*) — "from there".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

оттуда is от, "from", with туда, "there", on the stem of тот, "that" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ottúda*
- *Say it: ottúda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ottúda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to there, then the Russian for to here, then say *ottúda* again

Before you move on

What does оттуда mean? ("From there".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Reason, Goal, Result, That means, For example

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a reason, a goal, a result, that means and for example.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say a reason, a goal, a result, that means and for example.*

185.1 причина (prichína) — a reason

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to here, then the Russian for from there.

You'll want to know: причина

причина (*prichína*) — "a reason".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

причина is при- with чин, "order", the root of чинить, "to set in order" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prichína*
- *Say it: prichína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prichína*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to here, then the Russian for from there, then say *prichína* again

Before you move on

What does причина mean? ("A reason".) Say it once more.

185.2 цель (tsel) — a goal, an aim

Before the new one: say the Russian for from there, then the Russian for a reason.

You'll want to know: цель

цель (*tsel*) — "a goal, an aim".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

цель came through Polish *cel* from Middle High German *zil*, "a target" (Vasmer). German *Ziel* is the same word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsel*
- *Say it: tsel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for from there, then the Russian for a reason, then say *tsel* again

Before you move on

What does цель mean? ("A goal, an aim".) Say it once more.

185.3 результат (rezultát) — a result

Before the new one: say the Russian for a reason, then the Russian for a goal.

You'll want to know: результат

результат (*rezultát*) — "a result".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

результат comes, through German *Resultat* or French *résultat*, from Medieval Latin *resultātum*, from *resultāre*, "to spring back".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rezultát*
- *Say it: rezultát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rezultát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a reason, then the Russian for a goal, then say *rezultát* again

Before you move on

What does результат mean? ("A result".) Say it once more.

185.4 значит (znáchit) — that means, so

Before the new one: say the Russian for a goal, then the Russian for a result.

You'll want to know: значит

значит (*знáчит*) — "that means, so".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

значит is "it means", a form of значить, from знак, "a sign", which Vasmer puts with знать, "to know".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *знáчит*
- *Say it:* *знáчит*, once more
- *Say it:* say *знáчит*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a goal, then the Russian for a result, then say *знáчит* again

Before you move on

What does значит mean? ("That means, so".) Say it once more.

185.5 например (напримéр) — for example

Before the new one: say the Russian for a result, then the Russian for that means.

You'll want to know: например

например (*напримéр*) — "for example".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

например is на, "for", with пример, "an example", from при- and мера, "a measure": something held up to measure by. Vasmer relates мера to Latin *mētior*, "I measure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naprimér*
- *Say it: naprimér*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naprimér*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a result, then the Russian for that means, then say *naprimér* again

Before you move on

What does например mean? ("For example".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Rude, Honest, Brave, Generous, Greedy

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rude, honest, brave, generous and greedy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say rude, honest, brave, generous and greedy.*

186.1 грубый (grúbyy) — rude

Before the new one: say the Russian for that means, then the Russian for for example.

You'll want to know: грубый

грубый (*grúbyy*) — "rude".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грубый ← Proto-Slavic **grǫbŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it possibly related to Lithuanian *grubùs*, "rough, uneven", and *grùpti*, "to grow rough".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grúbyy*
- *Say it: grúbyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grúbyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for that means, then the Russian for for example, then say *grúbyy* again

Before you move on

What does грубый mean? (“Rude”.) Say it once more.

186.2 честный (chéstnyy) — honest

Before the new one: say the Russian for for example, then the Russian for rude.

You’ll want to know: честный

честный (*chéstnyy*) — “honest”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

честный is честь, “honour”, with -ный. Vasmer puts честь with чтить, “to honour”, and relates it to Sanskrit *cítti-*, “thought, understanding”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chéstnyy*
- *Say it: chéstnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chéstnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for for example, then the Russian for rude, then say *chéstnyy* again

Before you move on

What does честный mean? ("Honest".) Say it once more.

186.3 храбрый (khrábryy) — brave

Before the new one: say the Russian for rude, then the Russian for honest.

You'll want to know: храбрый

храбрый (*khrábryy*) — "brave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

храбрый — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, beside native хоробрый: -ра- against -оро-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khrábryy*
- *Say it: khrábryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khrábryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for rude, then the Russian for honest, then say *khrábryy* again

Before you move on

What does храбрый mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

186.4 щедрый (shchédryy) — generous

Before the new one: say the Russian for honest, then the Russian for brave.

You'll want to know: щедрый

щедрый (*shchédryy*) — "generous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

щедрый — its е shows it came through Church Slavonic, Vasmer says; Old Russian had щедрый. He thinks it apparently related to Latvian *šķedērns*, "a chip", and Greek *skedánnymi*, "I scatter": the generous man scatters his goods.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shchédryy*
- *Say it: shchédryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shchédryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for honest, then the Russian for brave, then say *shchédryy* again

Before you move on

What does щедрый mean? ("Generous".) Say it once more.

186.5 жадный (zhádnyy) — greedy

Before the new one: say the Russian for brave, then the Russian for generous.

You'll want to know: жадный

жадный (*zhádnyy*) — "greedy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жадный ← Old Russian *žadĭnŭ*, "thirsting"; Vasmer links it with жажда, "thirst". The greedy one thirsts for more.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhádnyy*
- *Say it: zhádnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhádnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for brave, then the Russian for generous, then say *zhádnyy* again

Before you move on

What does жадный mean? ("Greedy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

Full, Deep, Even, Square, Sharp

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say full, deep, even, square and sharp.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say full, deep, even, square and sharp.*

187.1 полный (pólnyy) — full

> Before the new one: say the Russian for generous, then the Russian for greedy.

You'll want to know: полный

полный (*pólnyy*) — "full".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полный ← Proto-Slavic **pŭlnŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *pìlnas*, Sanskrit *pūrṇá-*, Gothic *fulls*, Latin *plēnus* and Greek *plḗrēs*, all "full": English *full* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pólnyy*
- *Say it: pólnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pólnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for generous, then the Russian for greedy, then say *pólnyy* again

Before you move on

What does полный mean? ("Full".) Say it once more.

187.2 глубокий (glubókiy) — deep

Before the new one: say the Russian for greedy, then the Russian for full.

You'll want to know: глубокий

глубокий (*glubókiy*) — "deep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

глубокий ← Proto-Slavic **glǫbokŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it is probably related, with an inserted nasal, to Greek *glýphō*, "I hollow out", Latin *glūbō*, "I peel", and Old Norse *kljúfa*, "to split".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: glubókiy*
- *Say it: glubókiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glubókiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for greedy, then the Russian for full, then say *glubókiy* again

Before you move on

What does глубокий mean? (“Deep”.) Say it once more.

187.3 ровный (rónvnyy) — even, level

Before the new one: say the Russian for full, then the Russian for deep.

You’ll want to know: ровный

ровный (*rónvnyy*) — “even, level”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ровный ← Proto-Slavic **orvĭnŭ* — inherited; East Slavic turned *or-* into ро-. Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *arwis*, “true”, Avestan *ravah-*, “open space”, and Irish *róe*, “a level field”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rónvnyy*
- *Say it: rónvnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rónvnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for full, then the Russian for deep, then say *rónvnyy* again

Before you move on

What does ровный mean? (“Even, level”.) Say it once more.

187.4 квадратный (kvadrátnyy) — square

Before the new one: say the Russian for deep, then the Russian for even.

You'll want to know: квадратный

квадратный (*kvadrátnyy*) — "square".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

квадратный is квадрат, "a square", with -ный. квадрат, recorded from 1720, came through German *Quadrat* from Latin *quadrātum*, "a four-cornered figure" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kvadrátnyy*
- *Say it: kvadrátnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kvadrátnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for deep, then the Russian for even, then say *kvadrátnyy* again

Before you move on

What does квадратный mean? ("Square".) Say it once more.

187.5 острый (óstryy) — sharp; spicy

Before the new one: say the Russian for even, then the Russian for square.

You'll want to know: острый

острый (*óstryy*) — "sharp; spicy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

острый ← Proto-Slavic **ostrŭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *aštrùs*, "sharp", Greek *ákros*, "topmost", and Latin *ācer*, "sharp", from PIE **h₂eḱ-*, "sharp".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: óstryy*
- *Say it: óstryy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *óstryy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for even, then the Russian for square, then say *óstryy* again

Before you move on

What does острый mean? ("Sharp; spicy".) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

Useful, Harmful, Necessary, Possible, Complicated

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say useful, harmful, necessary, possible and complicated.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say useful, harmful, necessary, possible and complicated.

188.1 полезный (poléznyy) — useful

Before the new one: say the Russian for square, then the Russian for sharp; spicy.

You'll want to know: полезный

полезный (*poléznyy*) — "useful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

полезный is польза, "use, benefit", with -ный. Vasmer explains польза as по- with **lĭga*, the root of лёгкий, "light, easy": a benefit is a relief.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: polézznyy*
- *Say it: polézznyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *polézznyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for square, then the Russian for sharp; spicy, then say *polézznyy* again

Before you move on

What does полезный mean? ("Useful".) Say it once more.

188.2 вредный (vrédnyy) — harmful

Before the new one: say the Russian for sharp; spicy, then the Russian for useful.

You'll want to know: вредный

вредный (*vrédnyy*) — "harmful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вредный is вред, "harm", with -ный. вред is Church Slavonic, Vasmer says, beside the native веред, "a boil, a sore".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vrédnyy*
- *Say it: vrédnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vrédnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sharp; spicy, then the Russian for useful, then say *vrédnyy* again

Before you move on

What does вредный mean? (“Harmful”.) Say it once more.

188.3 нужный (núzhnyy) — necessary

Before the new one: say the Russian for useful, then the Russian for harmful.

You’ll want to know: нужный

нужный (*núzhnyy*) — “necessary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нужный is built on нужда, “need”, with -ный. Vasmer relates the root to нудить, “to force”, and Sanskrit *nudáti*, “pushes away”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: núzhnyy*
- *Say it: núzhnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *núzhnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for useful, then the Russian for harmful, then say *núzhnyy* again

Before you move on

What does нужный mean? (“Necessary”.) Say it once more.

188.4 возможный (vozmózhnyy) — possible

Before the new one: say the Russian for harmful, then the Russian for necessary.

You'll want to know: возможный

возможный (*vozmózhnyy*) — "possible".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

возможный is воз- with мож-, from мочь, "to be able", могу, "I can": "what can be".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vozmózhnyy*
- *Say it: vozmózhnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vozmózhnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for harmful, then the Russian for necessary, then say *vozmózhnyy* again

Before you move on

What does возможный mean? ("Possible".) Say it once more.

188.5 сложный (slózhnyy) — complicated

Before the new one: say the Russian for necessary, then the Russian for possible.

You'll want to know: сложный

сложный (*slózhnyy*) — "complicated".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сложный is с-, "together", with лож-, from ложить, "to lay": complicated is "put together from parts".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: slózhnyy*
- *Say it: slózhnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slózhnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for necessary, then the Russian for possible, then say *slózhnyy* again

Before you move on

What does **сложный** mean? ("Complicated".) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

Someone else's, Native, Local, Foreign, Russian

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say someone else's, native, local, foreign and Russian.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say someone else's, native, local, foreign and Russian.*

189.1 чужой (chuzhóy) — someone else's; unfamiliar

Before the new one: say the Russian for possible, then the Russian for complicated.

You'll want to know: чужой

чужой (*chuzhóy*) — "someone else's; unfamiliar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чужой ← Proto-Slavic **tjudjй*, Old Church Slavonic штуждь. It is usually explained as built on a loan from Gothic *þiuda*, "a people": "belonging to another people" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuzhóy*
- *Say it: chuzhóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chuzhóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for possible, then the Russian for complicated, then say *chuzhóy* again

Before you move on

What does чужой mean? ("Someone else's; unfamiliar".) Say it once more.

189.2 родной (rodnóy) — native; dear

Before the new one: say the Russian for complicated, then the Russian for someone else's; unfamiliar.

You'll want to know: родной

родной (*rodnóy*) — "native; dear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

родной is built on род, "kin, family", with -ной: "of one's own kin". Vasmer relates род to Latvian *rads*, "a relative".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rodnóy*
- *Say it: rodnóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rodnóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for complicated, then the Russian for someone else's; unfamiliar, then say *rodnóy* again

Before you move on

What does родной mean? (“Native; dear”.) Say it once more.

189.3 местный (méstnyy) — local

Before the new one: say the Russian for someone else’s; unfamiliar, then the Russian for native; dear.

You’ll want to know: местный

местный (*méstnyy*) — “local”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

местный is место, “a place”, with -ный: “of the place”. Vasmer relates место to Lithuanian *mìsti*, “to feed oneself”, despite a mismatch in accent.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: méstnyy*
- *Say it: méstnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *méstnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for someone else’s; unfamiliar, then the Russian for native; dear, then say *méstnyy* again

Before you move on

What does местный mean? (“Local”.) Say it once more.

189.4 иностранный (inostránnyy) — foreign

Before the new one: say the Russian for native; dear, then the Russian for local.

You'll want to know: иностранный

иностранный (*inostránnyy*) — "foreign".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

иностранный is иной, "other", with страна, "a country", the Church Slavonic shape of сторона, "side": "of another land". Vasmer confirms страна as borrowed from Church Slavonic, and relates иной to Latin *ūnus*, "one".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inostránnyy*
- *Say it: inostránnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inostránnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for native; dear, then the Russian for local, then say *inostránnyy* again

Before you move on

What does иностранный mean? ("Foreign".) Say it once more.

189.5 русский (rússkiy) — Russian

Before the new one: say the Russian for local, then the Russian for foreign.

You'll want to know: русский

русский (*rússkiy*) — "Russian".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

русский comes from Русь, the old name of the land and its people (Vasmer). Vasmer traces Русь to Old Norse *Róþsmenn*, "rowers,

seafarers", the name of the Scandinavian newcomers, which reached the Slavs through the Finns, who still call Sweden *Ruotsi*; Trubachev's note cites critics of that account, so it is still debated.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rússkiy*
- *Say it: rússkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rússkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for local, then the Russian for foreign, then say *rússkiy* again

Before you move on

What does русский mean? ("Russian".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Heavy curtain, Sink, Tap, Toilet, Shampoo

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a heavy curtain, a sink, a tap, a toilet and shampoo.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say a heavy curtain, a sink, a tap, a toilet and shampoo.*

190.1 штора (shtóra) — a heavy curtain, a blind

> Before the new one: say the Russian for foreign, then the Russian for Russian.

You'll want to know: штора

штора (*shtóra*) — "a heavy curtain, a blind".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

штора — its ш- shows it came through German *Store*, "a window blind" (Vasmer); French *store* alone would not give ш-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shtóra*
- *Say it: shtóra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shtóra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for foreign, then the Russian for Russian, then say *shtóra* again

Before you move on

What does штора mean? (“A heavy curtain, a blind”.) Say it once more.

190.2 раковина (rákovina) — a sink

Before the new one: say the Russian for Russian, then the Russian for a heavy curtain.

You’ll want to know: раковина

раковина (*rákovina*) — “a sink”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

раковина ← Old Russian раковина, “mother-of-pearl”, built on **raky*, “a case, a shell”, which Vasmer traces through Germanic **arkō*, Gothic *arka*, to Latin *arca*, “a box”. Jakobson tied it instead to рак, “a crayfish”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rákovina*
- *Say it: rákovina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rákovina*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for Russian, then the Russian for a heavy curtain, then say *rákovina* again

Before you move on

What does раковина mean? (“A sink”.) Say it once more.

190.3 кран (kran) — a tap

Before the new one: say the Russian for a heavy curtain, then the Russian for a sink.

You’ll want to know: кран

кран (*kran*) — “a tap”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кран comes from Dutch *kraan* or Low German *kran*, “a crane”, which goes with German *Kranich*, “crane (the bird)” (Vasmer). A tap is a little crane that lets water out.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kran*
- *Say it: kran*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kran*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a heavy curtain, then the Russian for a sink, then say *kran* again

Before you move on

What does кран mean? (“A tap”.) Say it once more.

190.4 туалет (tualét) — a toilet

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sink, then the Russian for a tap.

You'll want to know: туалет

туалет (*tualét*) — "a toilet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

туалет comes from French *toilette*, first "a small cloth" for the dressing table, from *toile*, "linen", Latin *tēla*, "a web" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tualét*
- *Say it: tualét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tualét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sink, then the Russian for a tap, then say *tualét* again

Before you move on

What does туалет mean? ("A toilet".) Say it once more.

190.5 шампунь (shampún) — shampoo

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tap, then the Russian for a toilet.

You'll want to know: шампунь

шампунь (*shampún*) — "shampoo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шампунь comes from English *shampoo*, from Hindi *chāmpo*, “press, knead!”, first a massage in the bath.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shampún*
- *Say it: shampún*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shampún*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tap, then the Russian for a toilet, then say *shampún* again

Before you move on

What does шампунь mean? (“Shampoo”.) Say it once more.

190.6 Words from chapters 182-185 — a first pass

Say the words for a toilet and shampoo.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nowadays, school holidays, a birthday, a day off, on time
- a side street, a pavement, a road; the way, a highway, a port
- in front, everywhere, to there, to here, from there
- a reason, a goal, a result, that means, for example

Before you move on

Nowadays? (теперь.) School holidays? (каникулы.) A birthday? (день рождения.) A day off? (выходной.) On time? (вовремя.) A side street? (переулок.) A pavement? (тротуар.) A road; the way? (дорога.) A highway? (шоссе.) A port? (порт.) In front? (впереди.) Everywhere? (везде.) To there? (туда.) To here? (сюда.) From there? (оттуда.) A reason? (причина.) A goal? (цель.) A result? (результат.) That means? (значит.) For example? (например.)

190.7 Words from chapters 186-190 — a second pass

Say the words for rude and honest.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- rude, honest, brave, generous, greedy
- full, deep, even, square, sharp; spicy
- useful, harmful, necessary, possible, complicated
- someone else's; unfamiliar, native; dear, local, foreign, Russian
- a heavy curtain, a sink, a tap, a toilet, shampoo

Before you move on

Rude? (грубый.) Honest? (честный.) Brave? (храбрый.) Generous? (щедрый.) Greedy? (жадный.) Full? (полный.) Deep? (глубокий.) Even? (ровный.) Square? (квадратный.) Sharp; spicy? (острый.) Useful? (полезный.) Harmful? (вредный.) Necessary? (нужный.) Possible? (возможный.) Complicated? (сложный.) Someone else's; unfamiliar? (чужой.) Native; dear? (родной.) Local? (местный.) Foreign? (иностранный.) Russian? (русский.) A heavy curtain? (штора.) A sink? (раковина.) A tap? (кран.) A toilet? (туалет.)

Shampoo? (шампунь.)

Chapter 191

Radiator, Socket, Wire, Charger, Laptop

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a radiator, a socket, a wire, a charger and a laptop.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say a radiator, a socket, a wire, a charger and a laptop.*

191.1 батарея (bataréya) — a radiator; a battery

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a toilet, then the Russian for shampoo.

You'll want to know: батарея

батарея (*bataréya*) — "a radiator; a battery".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

батарея — from 1697; it came from German *Batterie* or French *batterie*, from *battre*, "to beat" (Vasmer): first a group of guns, then a row of cells or heating pipes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bataréya*
- *Say it: bataréya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bataréya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a toilet, then the Russian for shampoo, then say *bataréya* again

Before you move on

What does батарея mean? ("A radiator; a battery".) Say it once more.

191.2 розетка (rozétka) — a socket

Before the new one: say the Russian for shampoo, then the Russian for a radiator; a battery.

You'll want to know: розетка

розетка (*rozétka*) — "a socket".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

розетка came through German *Rosette* or straight from French *rosette*, "a little rose", from *rose*, "a rose" (Vasmer): an electric socket was a round rose-shaped fitting.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rozétka*
- *Say it: rozétka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rozétka*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for shampoo, then the Russian for a radiator; a battery, then say *rozétka* again

Before you move on

What does розетка mean? (“A socket”.) Say it once more.

191.3 провод (próvod) — a wire, a cable

Before the new one: say the Russian for a radiator; a battery, then the Russian for a socket.

You’ll want to know: провод

провод (*próvod*) — “a wire, a cable”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

провод is про-, “through”, with вод, from водить, “to lead”: a wire leads current through.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: próvod*
- *Say it: próvod*, once more
- *Say it:* say *próvod*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a radiator; a battery, then the Russian for a socket, then say *próvod* again

Before you move on

What does провод mean? (“A wire, a cable”.) Say it once more.

191.4 зарядка (zaryádka) — a charger; morning exercises

Before the new one: say the Russian for a socket, then the Russian for a wire.

You'll want to know: зарядка

зарядка (*zaryádka*) — "a charger; morning exercises".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зарядка is built on зарядить, "to charge, to load", за- with the root of ряд, "a row, an order", and снаряд, "equipment"; зарядка also means "morning exercises", charging the body.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zaryádka*
- *Say it: zaryádka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zaryádka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a socket, then the Russian for a wire, then say *zaryádka* again

Before you move on

What does зарядка mean? ("A charger; morning exercises".) Say it once more.

191.5 ноутбук (noutbúk) — a laptop

Before the new one: say the Russian for a wire, then the Russian for a charger; morning exercises.

You'll want to know: ноутбук

ноутбук (*noutbúk*) — "a laptop".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ноутбук comes from English *notebook*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: noutbúk*
- *Say it: noutbúk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *noutbúk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a wire, then the Russian for a charger; morning exercises, then say *noutbúk* again

Before you move on

What does ноутбук mean? ("A laptop".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Newspaper, Magazine, Dictionary, Ruler, Folder

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a newspaper, a magazine, a dictionary, a ruler and a folder.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say a newspaper, a magazine, a dictionary, a ruler and a folder.*

192.1 газета (gazéta) — a newspaper

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a charger; morning exercises, then the Russian for a laptop.

You'll want to know: газета

газета (*gazéta*) — "a newspaper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

газета comes from Italian *gazzetta*, the source also of French *gazette*; Vasmer traces it to Venetian *gazeta*, a small coin paid for the news sheet.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gazéta*
- *Say it:* *gazéta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gazéta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a charger; morning exercises, then the Russian for a laptop, then say *gazéta* again

Before you move on

What does газета mean? ("A newspaper".) Say it once more.

192.2 журнал (zhurnál) — a magazine

Before the new one: say the Russian for a laptop, then the Russian for a newspaper.

You'll want to know: журнал

журнал (*zhurnál*) — "a magazine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

журнал — from 1720, written юрнал by Peter the Great; it comes from French *journal*, from Medieval Latin *diurnālis*, "daily" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zhurnál*
- *Say it:* *zhurnál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhurnál*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a laptop, then the Russian for a newspaper, then say *zhurnál* again

Before you move on

What does журнал mean? (“A magazine”.) Say it once more.

192.3 словарь (slovár) — a dictionary

Before the new one: say the Russian for a newspaper, then the Russian for a magazine.

You’ll want to know: словарь

словарь (*slovár*) — “a dictionary”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

словарь is слово, “a word”, with -арь, a suffix for a thing or keeper: a book of words. Слово ← Proto-Slavic **slovo* — inherited; Vasmer relates it to Sanskrit *śrávas*, “fame”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: slovár*
- *Say it: slovár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slovár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a newspaper, then the Russian for a magazine, then say *slovár* again

Before you move on

What does словарь mean? (“A dictionary”.) Say it once more.

192.4 линейка (linéyka) — a ruler

Before the new one: say the Russian for a magazine, then the Russian for a dictionary.

You'll want to know: линейка

линейка (*linéyka*) — "a ruler".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

линейка comes from линея, an older form of линия, "a line" (Vasmer), with -йка; линия came through Polish *linia* or German *Linie* from Latin *līnea*, "a linen thread", from *līnum*, "flax".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: linéyka*
- *Say it: linéyka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *linéyka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a magazine, then the Russian for a dictionary, then say *linéyka* again

Before you move on

What does линейка mean? ("A ruler".) Say it once more.

192.5 папка (pápka) — a folder

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dictionary, then the Russian for a ruler.

You'll want to know: папка

папка (*pápka*) — "a folder".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

папка comes from German *Pappe*, "pasteboard", named for the paste that once glued its layers, from *Pappe*, "mush" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pápka*
- *Say it: pápka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pápka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dictionary, then the Russian for a ruler, then say *pápka* again

Before you move on

What does папка mean? ("A folder".) Say it once more.

Chapter 193

Brimmed hat, Belt, Pocket, Button, Earrings

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a brimmed hat, a belt, a pocket, a button and earrings.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a brimmed hat, a belt, a pocket, a button and earrings.

193.1 шляпа (shlyápa) — a brimmed hat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a ruler, then the Russian for a folder.

You'll want to know: шляпа

шляпа (*shlyápa*) — "a brimmed hat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шляпа — recorded from 1589; it comes from Bavarian *Schlappe*, "a cap", Middle High German *slappe*, "a soft, drooping hat" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shlyápa*
- *Say it: shlyápa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shlyápa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a ruler, then the Russian for a folder, then say *shlyápa* again

Before you move on

What does шляпа mean? ("A brimmed hat".) Say it once more.

193.2 ремень (remén) — a belt

Before the new one: say the Russian for a folder, then the Russian for a brimmed hat.

You'll want to know: ремень

ремень (*remén*) — "a belt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ремень ← Proto-Slavic **remy*, **remene* — inherited. Vasmer holds that a loan from Old High German *riumo*, "a strap", is impossible on the evidence of Old Church Slavonic and old word-building.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remén*
- *Say it: remén*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remén*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a folder, then the Russian for a brimmed hat, then say *remén* again

Before you move on

What does ремень mean? (“A belt”.) Say it once more.

193.3 карман (karmán) — a pocket

Before the new one: say the Russian for a brimmed hat, then the Russian for a belt.

You’ll want to know: карман

карман (*karmán*) — “a pocket”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

карман — Old Russian already had the name *Kormanŭ*. Turkic *karman*, “a pocket, a purse”, was once taken as the source; Radloff saw it as a loan from Russian, and Räsänen again argued for a Turkic origin (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karmán*
- *Say it: karmán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karmán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a brimmed hat, then the Russian for a belt, then say *karmán* again

Before you move on

What does карман mean? (“A pocket”.) Say it once more.

193.4 пуговица (púgovitsa) — a button

Before the new one: say the Russian for a belt, then the Russian for a pocket.

You'll want to know: пуговица

пуговица (*púgovitsa*) — "a button".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пуговица ← Old Russian *pugŭvĭ*, пугы, "a button", with -ица. It is usually compared with Latvian *puoga*, "a button", and Sanskrit *puñja-*, "a lump" (Vasmer), though Persson separated the Sanskrit.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *púgovitsa*
- *Say it:* *púgovitsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *púgovitsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a belt, then the Russian for a pocket, then say *púgovitsa* again

Before you move on

What does пуговица mean? ("A button".) Say it once more.

193.5 серьги (sérgi) — earrings

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pocket, then the Russian for a button.

You'll want to know: серьги

серьги (*sérgi*) — "earrings".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

серьги is the plural of серьга, “an earring”. One view reshapes Old Russian усерязь, “an earring”, but Vasmer finds the г hard to explain and prefers a loan from an Old Chuvash word for “a ring”; Räsänen, in Trubachev’s note, derives it from Chagatai and other Turkic *isirga*, “ear pendants”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sérgi*
- *Say it: sérgi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sérgi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pocket, then the Russian for a button, then say *sérgi* again

Before you move on

What does серьги mean? (“Earrings”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

Dumplings, Salad, Cabbage, Beetroot, Peas

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say dumplings, a salad, cabbage, beetroot and peas.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say dumplings, a salad, cabbage, beetroot and peas.

194.1 пельмени (pelméni) — dumplings

Before the new one: say the Russian for a button, then the Russian for earrings.

You'll want to know: пельмени

пельмени (*pelméni*) — "dumplings".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пельмени comes from Komi and Udmurt *peľńań*, from *pel*, "ear", with *ńań*, "bread", for their shape (Vasmer, after Kalima).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pelméni*
- *Say it: pelméni*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pelméni*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a button, then the Russian for earrings, then say *pelméni* again

Before you move on

What does пельмени mean? ("Dumplings".) Say it once more.

194.2 салат (salát) — a salad

Before the new one: say the Russian for earrings, then the Russian for dumplings.

You'll want to know: салат

салат (*salát*) — "a salad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

салат came through French *salade* from Italian *salata*, "something salted" (Vasmer), from Latin *sāl*, "salt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: salát*
- *Say it: salát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *salát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for earrings, then the Russian for dumplings, then say *salát* again

Before you move on

What does салат mean? (“A salad”.) Say it once more.

194.3 капуста (kapústa) — cabbage

Before the new one: say the Russian for dumplings, then the Russian for a salad.

You’ll want to know: капуста

капуста (*kapústa*) — “cabbage”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

капуста — recorded from 1193; Vasmer thinks it probably blends Medieval Latin *composita*, Italian *composta*, “a mixture, pickled greens”, with Old High German *chapuz*, “cabbage”, from Latin *caputium*, “a cabbage head”, from *caput*, “head”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kapústa*
- *Say it: kapústa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kapústa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dumplings, then the Russian for a salad, then say *kapústa* again

Before you move on

What does капуста mean? (“Cabbage”.) Say it once more.

194.4 свёкла (svyókla) — beetroot

Before the new one: say the Russian for a salad, then the Russian for cabbage.

You'll want to know: свёкла

свёкла (*svyókla*) — "beetroot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свёкла — Old Russian *seuklŭ*, from 1073 — comes from Greek *seûklon*, *seûtlon*, "beet" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *svyókla*
- *Say it:* *svyókla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svyókla*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a salad, then the Russian for cabbage, then say *svyókla* again

Before you move on

What does свёкла mean? ("Beetroot".) Say it once more.

194.5 горох (gorókh) — peas

Before the new one: say the Russian for cabbage, then the Russian for beetroot.

You'll want to know: горох

горох (*gorókh*) — "peas".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

горох ← Proto-Slavic **gorxŭ* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it probably related to Lithuanian *geršvà*, a weed, and Sanskrit *gharṣati*, "rubs". Bulgarian has грах, "peas", with -ра- for Russian -оро-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gorókh*
- *Say it: gorókh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gorókh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cabbage, then the Russian for beetroot, then say *gorókh* again

Before you move on

What does горох mean? ("Peas".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

Nature, Branch, Root, Rose, Oak

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say nature, a branch, a root, a rose and an oak.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say nature, a branch, a root, a rose and an oak.*

195.1 природа (priróda) — nature

Before the new one: say the Russian for beetroot, then the Russian for peas.

You'll want to know: природа

природа (*priróda*) — "nature".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

природа is при- with род, "birth, kin": what one is born with, then nature itself. It copies Greek *phýsis* and Latin *nātūra*, both "birth, nature".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: priróda*
- *Say it: priróda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *priróda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beetroot, then the Russian for peas, then say *priróda* again

Before you move on

What does природа mean? ("Nature".) Say it once more.

195.2 ветка (vétka) — a branch

Before the new one: say the Russian for peas, then the Russian for nature.

You'll want to know: ветка

ветка (*vétka*) — "a branch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ветка comes from ветвь, "a bough", which Vasmer puts with вить, "to twist", and relates to Lithuanian *vytìs*, "a willow switch", and Latin *vītis*, "a vine".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vétka*
- *Say it: vétka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vétka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for peas, then the Russian for nature, then say *vétka* again

Before you move on

What does ветка mean? (“A branch”.) Say it once more.

195.3 корень (kóren) — a root

Before the new one: say the Russian for nature, then the Russian for a branch.

You’ll want to know: корень

корень (*kóren*) — “a root”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

корень ← Proto-Slavic **korenĭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *kẽras*, “a bush, a root”, and Latvian *cers*, “a bush” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kóren*
- *Say it: kóren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kóren*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nature, then the Russian for a branch, then say *kóren* again

Before you move on

What does корень mean? (“A root”.) Say it once more.

195.4 роза (róza) — a rose

Before the new one: say the Russian for a branch, then the Russian for a root.

You'll want to know: роза

роза (*róza*) — "a rose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

роза came through German *Rose* from Latin *rosa*, "a rose" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: róza*
- *Say it: róza*, once more
- *Say it:* say *róza*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a branch, then the Russian for a root, then say *róza* again

Before you move on

What does роза mean? ("A rose".) Say it once more.

195.5 дуб (dub) — an oak

Before the new one: say the Russian for a root, then the Russian for a rose.

You'll want to know: дуб

дуб (*dub*) — "an oak".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дуб ← Proto-Slavic **dǫbŭ* — inherited. Vasmer apparently starts from **dombros*, from the root of Greek *démō*, "I build", and Old Norse *timbr*: English *timber* would be a cousin; the account is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dub*
- *Say it: dub*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dub*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a root, then the Russian for a rose, then say *dub* again

Before you move on

What does дуб mean? ("An oak".) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

Rat, Spider, Mosquito, Fly, Beetle

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a rat, a spider, a mosquito, a fly and a beetle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a rat, a spider, a mosquito, a fly and a beetle.*

196.1 крыса (krýsa) — a rat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rose, then the Russian for an oak.

You'll want to know: крыса

крыса (*krýsa*) — "a rat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

крыса — Vasmer finds none of the existing explanations reliable: a reshaping of the root of грызть, "to gnaw", links with крот, "mole", or кровь, "blood", and others.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krýsa*
- *Say it: krýsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krýsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rose, then the Russian for an oak, then say *krýsa* again

Before you move on

What does крыса mean? (“A rat”.) Say it once more.

196.2 паук (paúk) — a spider

Before the new one: say the Russian for an oak, then the Russian for a rat.

You’ll want to know: паук

паук (*paúk*) — “a spider”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

паук is па- with **ǫkŭ*, “a hook”, for the spider’s bent legs (Vasmer). Vasmer relates the root to Greek *ónkos*, “a hook”, and Latin *uncus*, “hooked”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paúk*
- *Say it: paúk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paúk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an oak, then the Russian for a rat, then say *paúk* again

Before you move on

What does паук mean? (“A spider”.) Say it once more.

196.3 комар (komár) — a mosquito

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rat, then the Russian for a spider.

You’ll want to know: комар

комар (*komár*) — “a mosquito”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

комар ← Proto-Slavic **komarŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *kamãnė*, “a bumblebee”, and Old Prussian *camus*, “bumblebee”, and probably Middle High German *hummen*, “to hum”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: komár*
- *Say it: komár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *komár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rat, then the Russian for a spider, then say *komár* again

Before you move on

What does комар mean? (“A mosquito”.) Say it once more.

196.4 муха (múkha) — a fly

Before the new one: say the Russian for a spider, then the Russian for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: муха

муха (*múkha*) — "a fly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

муха ← Proto-Slavic **muxa* — inherited, with мошка, "a midge" (Vasmer). Latin *musca*, "fly", and Greek *muîa*, "fly", go back to the same PIE word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: múkha*
- *Say it: múkha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *múkha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a spider, then the Russian for a mosquito, then say *múkha* again

Before you move on

What does муха mean? ("A fly".) Say it once more.

196.5 жук (zhuk) — a beetle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mosquito, then the Russian for a fly.

You'll want to know: жук

жук (*zhuk*) — "a beetle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жук is built on a sound-imitating stem, the one in жужжать, "to buzz" (Vasmer): the beetle as the buzzer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhuk*
- *Say it: zhuk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhuk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mosquito, then the Russian for a fly, then say *zhuk* again

Before you move on

What does жук mean? ("A beetle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

Hobby, Exhibition, Play, Guitar, Piano

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a hobby, an exhibition, a play, a guitar and a piano.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a hobby, an exhibition, a play, a guitar and a piano.*

197.1 хобби (khóbbi) — a hobby

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a fly, then the Russian for a beetle.

You'll want to know: хобби

хобби (*khóbbi*) — "a hobby".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хобби comes from English *hobby*, cut short from *hobby-horse*, a toy horse ridden for fun.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khóbbi*
- *Say it: khóbbi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khóbbi*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fly, then the Russian for a beetle, then say *khóbbi* again

Before you move on

What does хобби mean? (“A hobby”.) Say it once more.

197.2 выставка (výstavka) — an exhibition

Before the new one: say the Russian for a beetle, then the Russian for a hobby.

You’ll want to know: выставка

выставка (*výstavka*) — “an exhibition”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выставка comes from выставить, “to put out on show”, вы-, “out”, with ставить, “to set”, from стать, “to stand”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: výstavka*
- *Say it: výstavka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *výstavka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a beetle, then the Russian for a hobby, then say *výstavka* again

Before you move on

What does выставка mean? ("An exhibition".) Say it once more.

197.3 спектакль (spektákl) — a play, a show

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hobby, then the Russian for an exhibition.

You'll want to know: спектакль

спектакль (*spektákl*) — "a play, a show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спектакль comes from French *spectacle*, from Latin *spectāculum*, "a show", perhaps through German *Spektakel* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: spektákl*
- *Say it: spektákl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spektákl*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hobby, then the Russian for an exhibition, then say *spektákl* again

Before you move on

What does спектакль mean? ("A play, a show".) Say it once more.

197.4 гитара (gitára) — a guitar

Before the new one: say the Russian for an exhibition, then the Russian for a play.

You'll want to know: гитара

гитара (*gitára*) — "a guitar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гитара — first китара, in Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *gitara* or German *Gitarre* from Latin *cithara*, Greek *kithára*, "a lyre" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gitára*
- *Say it: gitára*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gitára*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an exhibition, then the Russian for a play, then say *gitára* again

Before you move on

What does гитара mean? ("A guitar".) Say it once more.

197.5 пианино (pianíno) — a piano

Before the new one: say the Russian for a play, then the Russian for a guitar.

You'll want to know: пианино

пианино (*pianíno*) — "a piano".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пианино comes from Italian *pianino*, "a little piano", from *pianoforte*, "soft-loud", Latin *plānus*, "flat, soft".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pianíno*
- *Say it: pianíno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pianíno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a play, then the Russian for a guitar, then say *pianíno* again

Before you move on

What does пианино mean? ("A piano".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

Passenger, Carriage, Transfer, Traffic jam, Accident

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a passenger, a carriage, a transfer, a traffic jam and an accident.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say a passenger, a carriage, a transfer, a traffic jam and an accident.

198.1 пассажир (passazhír) — a passenger

Before the new one: say the Russian for a guitar, then the Russian for a piano.

You'll want to know: пассажир

пассажир (*passazhír*) — "a passenger".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пассажир — first пасажера, in 1706; it came through German *Passagier* or Dutch *passagier* from French *passager*, Italian *passaggiere*, "one passing through" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: passazhír*
- *Say it: passazhír*, once more
- *Say it:* say *passazhír*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a guitar, then the Russian for a piano, then say *passazhír* again

Before you move on

What does пассажир mean? ("A passenger".) Say it once more.

198.2 вагон (vagón) — a carriage (of a train)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a piano, then the Russian for a passenger.

You'll want to know: вагон

вагон (*vagón*) — "a carriage (of a train)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вагон came from German *Waggon* or French *wagon*, which go back to English *waggon*; German *Wagen* and Russian воз, "a cart", are cousins of the English word (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vagón*
- *Say it: vagón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vagón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a piano, then the Russian for a passenger, then say *vagón* again

Before you move on

What does вагон mean? ("A carriage (of a train)".) Say it once more.

198.3 пересадка (peresádka) — a transfer, a change (of trains)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a passenger, then the Russian for a carriage.

You'll want to know: пересадка

пересадка (*peresádka*) — "a transfer, a change (of trains)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пересадка is пере-, "across", with -садка, from садить, "to seat": changing from one seat to another.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: peresádka*
- *Say it: peresádka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peresádka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a passenger, then the Russian for a carriage, then say *peresádka* again

Before you move on

What does пересадка mean? ("A transfer, a change (of trains)".) Say it once more.

198.4 пробка (próbka) — a traffic jam; a cork

Before the new one: say the Russian for a carriage, then the Russian for a transfer.

You'll want to know: пробка

пробка (*próbka*) — "a traffic jam; a cork".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пробка apparently came through Low German *propke*, *prop*, "a stopper", since Russia long imported corks from Bremen (Vasmer). A traffic jam corks the road.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: próbka*
- *Say it: próbka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *próbka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a carriage, then the Russian for a transfer, then say *próbka* again

Before you move on

What does пробка mean? ("A traffic jam; a cork".) Say it once more.

198.5 авария (avária) — an accident, a crash

Before the new one: say the Russian for a transfer, then the Russian for a traffic jam; a cork.

You'll want to know: авария

авария (*ávariya*) — "an accident, a crash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

авария comes from Italian *avaria* or French *avarie*, "damage to a ship or cargo", from Arabic *ʿawār*, "damage, a flaw" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ávariya*
- *Say it: ávariya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ávariya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a transfer, then the Russian for a traffic jam; a cork, then say *ávariya* again

Before you move on

What does авария mean? ("An accident, a crash".) Say it once more.

Chapter 199

Young people, Citizen, Foreigner, Tourist, Text

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say young people, a citizen, a foreigner, a tourist and a text.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say young people, a citizen, a foreigner, a tourist and a text.

199.1 молодёжь (molodyózh) — young people

Before the new one: say the Russian for a traffic jam; a cork, then the Russian for an accident.

You'll want to know: молодёжь

молодёжь (*molodyózh*) — "young people".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молодёжь is built on молодой, "young", with -ёжь, a collective ending. Vasmer relates молодой to Old Prussian *maldai*, "youths", Sanskrit *mṛdú-*, "soft", and Latin *mollis*, "soft".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: molodyózh*
- *Say it: molodyózh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *molodyózh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a traffic jam; a cork, then the Russian for an accident, then say *molodyózh* again

Before you move on

What does молодёжь mean? ("Young people".) Say it once more.

199.2 гражданин (grazhdanín) — a citizen

Before the new one: say the Russian for an accident, then the Russian for young people.

You'll want to know: гражданин

гражданин (*grazhdanín*) — "a citizen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гражданин — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, beside native горожанин, "a town-dweller", from град, "city", the Church Slavonic shape of город. It copies Greek *polítēs*, "a citizen", from *pólis*, "city".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grazhdanín*
- *Say it: grazhdanín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grazhdanín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an accident, then the Russian for young people, then say *grazhdanín* again

Before you move on

What does гражданин mean? ("A citizen".) Say it once more.

199.3 иностранец (inostránets) — a foreigner

Before the new one: say the Russian for young people, then the Russian for a citizen.

You'll want to know: иностранец

иностранец (*inostránets*) — "a foreigner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

иностранец is иной, "other", with страна, "a country", and -ец, "one who": a person from another land. Vasmer takes страна as borrowed from Church Slavonic, and relates иной to Latin *ūnus*, "one".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: inostránets*
- *Say it: inostránets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *inostránets*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for young people, then the Russian for a citizen, then say *inostránets* again

Before you move on

What does иностранец mean? ("A foreigner".) Say it once more.

199.4 турист (turíst) — a tourist

Before the new one: say the Russian for a citizen, then the Russian for a foreigner.

You'll want to know: турист

турист (*turíst*) — "a tourist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

турист comes from French *touriste* or English *tourist*, from *tour*, "a turn, a round trip", Latin *tornāre*, "to turn".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: turíst*
- *Say it: turíst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *turíst*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a citizen, then the Russian for a foreigner, then say *turíst* again

Before you move on

What does турист mean? ("A tourist".) Say it once more.

199.5 текст (tekst) — a text

Before the new one: say the Russian for a foreigner, then the Russian for a tourist.

You'll want to know: текст

текст (*tekst*) — "a text".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

текст came through German *Text* or straight from Latin *textus*, "a web, a weaving of words", from *texō*, "I weave" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tekst*
- *Say it: tekst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tekst*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a foreigner, then the Russian for a tourist, then say *tekst* again

Before you move on

What does текст mean? ("A text".) Say it once more.

199.6 Words from chapters 191-194 — a first pass

Say the words for a tourist and a text.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a radiator; a battery, a socket, a wire, a charger; morning exercises, a laptop
- a newspaper, a magazine, a dictionary, a ruler, a folder
- a brimmed hat, a belt, a pocket, a button, earrings
- dumplings, a salad, cabbage, beetroot, peas

Before you move on

A radiator; a battery? (батарея.) A socket? (розетка.) A wire? (провод.) A charger; morning exercises? (зарядка.) A laptop? (ноутбук.) A newspaper? (газета.) A magazine? (журнал.) A dictionary? (словарь.) A ruler? (линейка.) A folder? (папка.) A

brimmed hat? (шляпа.) A belt? (ремень.) A pocket? (карман.) A button? (пуговица.) Earrings? (серьги.) Dumplings? (пельмени.) A salad? (салат.) Cabbage? (капуста.) Beetroot? (свёкла.) Peas? (горох.)

199.7 Words from chapters 195-199 — a second pass

Say the words for nature and a branch.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- nature, a branch, a root, a rose, an oak
- a rat, a spider, a mosquito, a fly, a beetle
- a hobby, an exhibition, a play, a guitar, a piano
- a passenger, a carriage, a transfer, a traffic jam; a cork, an accident
- young people, a citizen, a foreigner, a tourist, a text

Before you move on

Nature? (природа.) A branch? (ветка.) A root? (корень.) A rose? (роза.) An oak? (дуб.) A rat? (крыса.) A spider? (паук.) A mosquito? (комар.) A fly? (муха.) A beetle? (жук.) A hobby? (хобби.) An exhibition? (выставка.) A play? (спектакль.) A guitar? (гитара.) A piano? (пианино.) A passenger? (пассажир.) A carriage? (вагон.) A transfer? (пересадка.) A traffic jam; a cork? (пробка.) An accident? (авария.) Young people? (молодёжь.) A citizen? (гражданин.) A foreigner? (иностранец.) A tourist? (турист.) A text? (текст.)

Chapter 200

Secret, Joke, Laughter, Tears, Smile

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a secret, a joke, laughter, tears and a smile.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say a secret, a joke, laughter, tears and a smile.

200.1 секрет (sekrét) — a secret

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tourist, then the Russian for a text.

You'll want to know: секрет

секрет (*sekrét*) — "a secret".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

секрет — from Peter the Great's time; it perhaps came through Polish *sekret*, or from French *secret*, from Latin *sēcrētus*, "set apart, hidden" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sekrét*
- *Say it: sekrét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sekrét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tourist, then the Russian for a text, then say *sekrét* again

Before you move on

What does секрет mean? ("A secret".) Say it once more.

200.2 шутка (shútka) — a joke

Before the new one: say the Russian for a text, then the Russian for a secret.

You'll want to know: шутка

шутка (*shútka*) — "a joke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шутка comes from шутить, "to joke", and шут, "a jester", recorded from 1076. Vasmer reports a suggested link with Lithuanian *siaũsti*, "to rage, to frolic", and doubts a loan from German *Schaute*, "a fool".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shútka*
- *Say it: shútka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shútka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a text, then the Russian for a secret, then say *shútka* again

Before you move on

What does шутка mean? ("A joke".) Say it once more.

200.3 смех (smekh) — laughter

Before the new one: say the Russian for a secret, then the Russian for a joke.

You'll want to know: смех

смех (*smekh*) — "laughter".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

смех ← Proto-Slavic **směxŭ*, with смеяться, "to laugh" — inherited (Vasmer). Vasmer relates the root to Sanskrit *smáyate*, "smiles", and Middle English *smilen*, "to smile".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: smekh*
- *Say it: smekh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *smekh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a secret, then the Russian for a joke, then say *smekh* again

Before you move on

What does смех mean? ("Laughter".) Say it once more.

200.4 слёзы (slyózy) — tears

Before the new one: say the Russian for a joke, then the Russian for laughter.

You'll want to know: слёзы

слёзы (*slyózy*) — "tears".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слёзы is the plural of слеза, "a tear", Proto-Slavic **slьza* — inherited. Vasmer thinks it more likely belongs with слизь, "slime", and Middle Low German *slîk*, "slime".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *slyózy*
- *Say it:* *slyózy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slyózy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a joke, then the Russian for laughter, then say *slyózy* again

Before you move on

What does слёзы mean? ("Tears".) Say it once more.

200.5 улыбка (ulýbka) — a smile

Before the new one: say the Russian for laughter, then the Russian for tears.

You'll want to know: улыбка

улыбка (*ulýbka*) — "a smile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

улыбка goes with улыбаться, "to smile", from dialect лыбить, "to smile". Vasmer calls лыбить unclear and finds the proposed links, with луб, "bast", or Latin *labō*, "I totter", unconvincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ulýbka*
- *Say it: ulýbka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ulýbka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for laughter, then the Russian for tears, then say *ulýbka* again

Before you move on

What does улыбка mean? ("A smile".) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

Change, Discount, Purchase, Colleague, Director

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say change, a discount, a purchase, a colleague and a director.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say change, a discount, a purchase, a colleague and a director.

201.1 сдача (sdácha) — change (money)

Before the new one: say the Russian for tears, then the Russian for a smile.

You'll want to know: сдача

сдача (*sdácha*) — "change (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сдача comes from сдать, "to hand over", с- with дать, "to give": change is the money handed back.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sdácha*
- *Say it: sdácha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sdácha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tears, then the Russian for a smile, then say *sdácha* again

Before you move on

What does сдача mean? ("Change (money)".) Say it once more.

201.2 скидка (skídka) — a discount

Before the new one: say the Russian for a smile, then the Russian for change.

You'll want to know: скидка

скидка (*skídka*) — "a discount".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скидка comes from скидывать, "to throw off", с-, "off", with кидать, "to throw": a discount is knocked off the price. Vasmer relates кидать to Sanskrit *códati*, "urges on".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skídka*
- *Say it: skídka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skídka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a smile, then the Russian for change, then say *skídka* again

Before you move on

What does скидка mean? ("A discount".) Say it once more.

201.3 покупка (pokúpka) — a purchase

Before the new one: say the Russian for change, then the Russian for a discount.

You'll want to know: покупка

покупка (*pokúpka*) — "a purchase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

покупка comes from покупать, "to buy", with -ка: a thing bought. купить came from Gothic *kaupōn*, "to trade", from Latin *caupō*, "a trader" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pokúpka*
- *Say it: pokúpka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pokúpka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for change, then the Russian for a discount, then say *pokúpka* again

Before you move on

What does покупка mean? ("A purchase".) Say it once more.

201.4 коллега (kolléga) — a colleague

Before the new one: say the Russian for a discount, then the Russian for a purchase.

You'll want to know: коллега

коллега (*колléга*) — "a colleague".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

коллега — from Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *kolega* or straight from Latin *collēga*, "a partner in office" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *колléга*
- *Say it:* *колléга*, once more
- *Say it:* say *колléга*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a discount, then the Russian for a purchase, then say *колléга* again

Before you move on

What does коллега mean? ("A colleague".) Say it once more.

201.5 директор (диréктор) — a director, a head

Before the new one: say the Russian for a purchase, then the Russian for a colleague.

You'll want to know: директор

директор (*диréктор*) — "a director, a head".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

директор — from 1720; it came through German *Direktor* or Polish *dyrektor* from Latin *dīrēctor*, "one who directs", from *regere*, "to guide" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: diréktor*
- *Say it: diréktor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *diréktor*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a purchase, then the Russian for a colleague, then say *diréktor* again

Before you move on

What does директор mean? ("A director, a head".) Say it once more.

Chapter 202

Electrician, Plumber, Pilot, Sailor, Fisherman

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an electrician, a plumber, a pilot, a sailor and a fisherman.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say an electrician, a plumber, a pilot, a sailor and a fisherman.*

202.1 электрик (elektrík) — an electrician

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a colleague, then the Russian for a director.

You'll want to know: электрик

электрик (*elektrík*) — "an electrician".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

электрик is built on электричество, "electricity", from Greek *ēlektron*, "amber", which gives a spark when rubbed.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: elektrík*
- *Say it: elektrík*, once more
- *Say it:* say *elektrík*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a colleague, then the Russian for a director, then say *elektrík* again

Before you move on

What does электрик mean? ("An electrician".) Say it once more.

202.2 сантехник (santékhnik) — a plumber

Before the new one: say the Russian for a director, then the Russian for an electrician.

You'll want to know: сантехник

сантехник (*santékhnik*) — "a plumber".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сантехник is санитарно-технический, "sanitary-technical", cut short: сан-, from Latin *sānitās*, "health", with техник, "technician", from Greek *téchnē*, "craft".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: santékhnik*
- *Say it: santékhnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *santékhnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a director, then the Russian for an electrician, then say *santékhnik* again

Before you move on

What does сантехник mean? ("A plumber".) Say it once more.

202.3 лётчик (lyótchik) — a pilot

Before the new one: say the Russian for an electrician, then the Russian for a plumber.

You'll want to know: лётчик

лётчик (*lyótchik*) — "a pilot".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лётчик is лёт, "flight", from летать, "to fly", with -чик, "one who": a flier.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lyótchik*
- *Say it: lyótchik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lyótchik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an electrician, then the Russian for a plumber, then say *lyótchik* again

Before you move on

What does лётчик mean? ("A pilot".) Say it once more.

202.4 моряк (moryák) — a sailor

Before the new one: say the Russian for a plumber, then the Russian for a pilot.

You'll want to know: моряк

моряк (*moryák*) — "a sailor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

моряк is море, "sea", with -як, "a person": a seaman. море is a cousin of Latin *mare*, "sea" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moryák*
- *Say it: moryák*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moryák*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a plumber, then the Russian for a pilot, then say *moryák* again

Before you move on

What does моряк mean? ("A sailor".) Say it once more.

202.5 рыбак (rybák) — a fisherman

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pilot, then the Russian for a sailor.

You'll want to know: рыбак

рыбак (*rybák*) — "a fisherman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рыбак is рыба, "fish", with -ак, "a person": a fisherman. Where рыба comes from is uncertain; Vasmer reports a doubtful comparison with Old High German *rūppa*, "caterpillar".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rybák*
- *Say it: rybák*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rybák*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pilot, then the Russian for a sailor, then say *rybák* again

Before you move on

What does рыбак mean? ("A fisherman".) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

Signature, Seal, Business, Cash machine, Coin

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a signature, a seal, business, a cash machine and a coin.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a signature, a seal, business, a cash machine and a coin.*

203.1 подпись (pódpis) — a signature

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a sailor, then the Russian for a fisherman.

You'll want to know: подпись

подпись (*pódpis*) — "a signature".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подпись is под-, "under", with -пись, from писать, "to write": the name written at the foot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pódpis*
- *Say it: pódpis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pódpis*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sailor, then the Russian for a fisherman, then say *pódpis* again

Before you move on

What does подпись mean? ("A signature".) Say it once more.

203.2 печать (pechát) — a seal, a stamp; print

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fisherman, then the Russian for a signature.

You'll want to know: печать

печать (*pechát*) — "a seal, a stamp; print".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

печать ← Proto-Slavic **pečatь*. Vasmer thinks it probably comes from пеку, "I bake, I burn", so "a tool for burning a mark"; he finds a comparison with Latvian *pęka*, "a paw", unconvincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pechát*
- *Say it: pechát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pechát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fisherman, then the Russian for a signature, then say *pechát* again

Before you move on

What does печать mean? ("A seal, a stamp; print".) Say it once more.

203.3 бизнес (bíznes) — business

Before the new one: say the Russian for a signature, then the Russian for a seal.

You'll want to know: бизнес

бизнес (*bíznes*) — "business".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бизнес comes from English *business*, from *busy*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bíznes*
- *Say it: bíznes*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bíznes*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a signature, then the Russian for a seal, then say *bíznes* again

Before you move on

What does бизнес mean? ("Business".) Say it once more.

203.4 банкомат (bankomát) — a cash machine

Before the new one: say the Russian for a seal, then the Russian for business.

You'll want to know: банкомат

банкомат (*bankomát*) — "a cash machine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

банкомат is банк, "a bank", with -о- and -мат, from автомат, "an automatic machine", Greek *autómatos*, "self-moving".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bankomát*
- *Say it: bankomát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bankomát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a seal, then the Russian for business, then say *bankomát* again

Before you move on

What does банкомат mean? ("A cash machine".) Say it once more.

203.5 монета (monéta) — a coin

Before the new one: say the Russian for business, then the Russian for a cash machine.

You'll want to know: монета

монета (*monéta*) — "a coin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

монета — from the early 1700s; it came through Polish *moneta* from Latin *monēta*, "a mint, coined money" (Vasmer), after the temple of Juno Moneta where Rome struck its coins.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: monéta*
- *Say it: monéta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *monéta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for business, then the Russian for a cash machine, then say *monéta* again

Before you move on

What does монета mean? ("A coin".) Say it once more.

203.6 Words from chapters 200-201 — a first pass

Say the words for a cash machine and a coin.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a secret, a joke, laughter, tears, a smile
- change, a discount, a purchase, a colleague, a director

Before you move on

A secret? (секрет.) A joke? (шутка.) Laughter? (смех.) Tears? (слёзы.) A smile? (улыбка.) Change? (сдача.) A discount? (скидка.) A purchase? (покупка.) A colleague? (коллега.) A director? (директор.)

203.7 Words from chapters 202-203 — a second pass

Say the words for an electrician and a plumber.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- an electrician, a plumber, a pilot, a sailor, a fisherman
- a signature, a seal, business, a cash machine, a coin

Before you move on

An electrician? (электрик.) A plumber? (сантехник.) A pilot? (лётчик.) A sailor? (моряк.) A fisherman? (рыбак.) A signature? (подпись.) A seal? (печать.) Business? (бизнес.) A cash machine? (банкомат.) A coin? (монета.)

Chapter 204

To try, To order, To pay, To cost, To spend

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to try, to order, to pay, to cost and to spend.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say to try, to order, to pay, to cost and to spend.*

204.1 пробовать (próbovat) — to try, to taste

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a cash machine, then the Russian for a coin.

You'll want to know: пробовать

пробовать (*próbovat*) — "to try, to taste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пробовать comes from проба, "a test", probably through Polish *próba* or German *Probe*, from Medieval Latin *proba*, from *probāre*, "to test" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: próbovat*
- *Say it: próbovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *próbovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cash machine, then the Russian for a coin, then say *próbovat* again

Before you move on

What does пробовать mean? ("To try, to taste".) Say it once more.

204.2 заказывать (zakázyvat) — to order (food, goods)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a coin, then the Russian for to try.

You'll want to know: заказывать

заказывать (*zakázyvat*) — "to order (food, goods)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

заказывать is за- with -казывать, from казать, "to show, to say": to order is to tell someone what you want ahead.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zakázyvat*
- *Say it: zakázyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zakázyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a coin, then the Russian for to try, then say *zakázyvat* again

Before you move on

What does заказывать mean? (“To order (food, goods)”.) Say it once more.

204.3 платить (platít) — to pay

Before the new one: say the Russian for to try, then the Russian for to order.

You’ll want to know: платить

платить (*platít*) — “to pay”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

платить comes from плата, “pay” (Vasmer), which is held to go with плат, “a piece of cloth”, because cloth was once used in payment.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: platít*
- *Say it: platít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *platít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to try, then the Russian for to order, then say *platít* again

Before you move on

What does платить mean? (“To pay”.) Say it once more.

204.4 стоить (stóit) — to cost

Before the new one: say the Russian for to order, then the Russian for to pay.

You'll want to know: стоить

стоить (*stóit*) — "to cost".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стоить, "to cost", is perhaps borrowed from Polish *stoi*, "it costs"; the West Slavic sense copies Latin *cōnstāre*, "to stand firm; to cost", the source of German *kosten* (Vasmer). It goes with стоять, "to stand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stóit*
- *Say it: stóit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stóit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to order, then the Russian for to pay, then say *stóit* again

Before you move on

What does стоить mean? ("To cost".) Say it once more.

204.5 тратить (trátit) — to spend (money)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to pay, then the Russian for to cost.

You'll want to know: тратить

тратить (*trátit*) — "to spend (money)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тратить ← Proto-Slavic **tratiti* — inherited; Ukrainian тратити also means "to lose, to ruin". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *trótinti*, "to tease", and Latvian *truots*, "a whetstone", and reports a further link

with **тереть**, “to rub”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trátit*
- *Say it: trátit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trátit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to pay, then the Russian for to cost, then say *trátit* again

Before you move on

What does **тратить** mean? (“To spend (money)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 205

To forget, To be a student, To study, To teach, To hand in

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to forget, to be a student, to study, to teach and to hand in.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say to forget, to be a student, to study, to teach and to hand in.*

205.1 забывать (zabyvát) — to forget

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to cost, then the Russian for to spend.

You'll want to know: забывать

забывать (*zabyvát*) — "to forget".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

забывать is за-, "beyond", with -бывать, from быть, "to be" (Vasmer): to forget is to let a thing go past being.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zabyvát*
- *Say it: zabyvát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zabyvát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cost, then the Russian for to spend, then say *zabyvát* again

Before you move on

What does забывать mean? ("To forget".) Say it once more.

205.2 учиться (uchítsya) — to be a student, to study

Before the new one: say the Russian for to spend, then the Russian for to forget.

You'll want to know: учиться

учиться (*uchítsya*) — "to be a student, to study".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

учиться is учить, "to teach", with -ся, "oneself". учить ← Proto-Slavic **učiti*, first "to accustom" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uchítsya*
- *Say it: uchítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uchítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to spend, then the Russian for to forget, then say *uchítsya* again

Before you move on

What does учиться mean? ("To be a student, to study".) Say it once more.

205.3 изучать (izuchát) — to study (a subject)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to forget, then the Russian for to be a student.

You'll want to know: изучать

изучать (*izuchát*) — "to study (a subject)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

изучать is из-, "out, thoroughly", with -учать, from учить, "to teach, to learn": to study a subject through.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: izuchát*
- *Say it: izuchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *izuchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to forget, then the Russian for to be a student, then say *izuchát* again

Before you move on

What does изучать mean? ("To study (a subject)".) Say it once more.

205.4 преподавать (prepodavát) — to teach (a subject)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be a student, then the Russian for to study.

You'll want to know: преподавать

преподавать (*prepodavát*) — "to teach (a subject)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

преподавать is пре- and по- with давать, "to give": to teach is to hand knowledge on. Vasmer takes давать from дать, "to give", kin to Lithuanian *dovanà*, "a gift".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prepodavát*
- *Say it: prepodavát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prepodavát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be a student, then the Russian for to study, then say *prepodavát* again

Before you move on

What does преподавать mean? ("To teach (a subject)".) Say it once more.

205.5 сдавать (sdavát) — to hand in; to take (an exam)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to study, then the Russian for to teach.

You'll want to know: сдавать

сдавать (*sdavát*) — "to hand in; to take (an exam)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сдавать is с-, "off, over", with давать, "to give": to hand in, and so to take an exam. Vasmer takes давать from дать, "to give", kin to Lithuanian *dovanà*, "a gift".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sdavát*
- *Say it: sdavát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sdavát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to study, then the Russian for to teach, then say *sdavát* again

Before you move on

What does сдавать mean? ("To hand in; to take (an exam)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 206

To put out, To build, To break, To paint, To clean

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to put out, to build, to break, to paint and to clean.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say to put out, to build, to break, to paint and to clean.

206.1 гасить (gasít) — to put out

Before the new one: say the Russian for to teach, then the Russian for to hand in; to take.

You'll want to know: гасить

гасить (*gasít*) — "to put out".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гасить ← Proto-Slavic **gasiti* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *gèsti*, "to go out", and Greek *sbénnymi*, "I put out".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gasít*
- *Say it: gasít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gasít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to teach, then the Russian for to hand in; to take, then say *gasít* again

Before you move on

What does гасить mean? (“To put out”.) Say it once more.

206.2 строить (stróit) — to build

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hand in; to take, then the Russian for to put out.

You’ll want to know: строить

строить (*stróit*) — “to build”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

строить comes from строй, “order, arrangement” (Vasmer), which Vasmer relates to Latvian *strāja*, “a straw-bedded stall”, and Latin *stria*, “a furrow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stróit*
- *Say it: stróit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stróit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hand in; to take, then the Russian for to put out, then say *stróit* again

Before you move on

What does строить mean? (“To build”.) Say it once more.

206.3 ломать (lomát) — to break

Before the new one: say the Russian for to put out, then the Russian for to build.

You’ll want to know: ломать

ломать (*lomát*) — “to break”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ломать goes with ломить, “to break”, from лом, “a break, scrap” (Vasmer), which he relates to Lithuanian *lìmti*, “to break down”, and Old High German *lam*, “lame”: English *lame* is a cousin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lomát*
- *Say it: lomát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lomát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to put out, then the Russian for to build, then say *lomát* again

Before you move on

What does ломать mean? (“To break”.) Say it once more.

206.4 красить (krásit) — to paint, to dye

Before the new one: say the Russian for to build, then the Russian for to break.

You'll want to know: красить

красить (*krásit*) — "to paint, to dye".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

красить comes from краса, "beauty" (Vasmer): first "to adorn", then "to paint, to dye".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krásit*
- *Say it: krásit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krásit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to build, then the Russian for to break, then say *krásit* again

Before you move on

What does красить mean? ("To paint, to dye".) Say it once more.

206.5 чистить (chístit) — to clean, to peel

Before the new one: say the Russian for to break, then the Russian for to paint.

You'll want to know: чистить

чистить (*chístit*) — "to clean, to peel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чистить comes from чистый, "clean": to make clean. Vasmer relates чистый to Old Prussian *skijstan*, "clean".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chístit*
- *Say it: chístit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chístit*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to break, then the Russian for to paint, then say *chístit* again

Before you move on

What does чистить mean? ("To clean, to peel".) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

To be ill, To treat, To breathe, To cough, To sneeze

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to be ill, to treat, to breathe, to cough and to sneeze.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say to be ill, to treat, to breathe, to cough and to sneeze.*

207.1 болеть (bolét) — to be ill; to ache

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to paint, then the Russian for to clean.

You'll want to know: болеть

болеть (*bolét*) — "to be ill; to ache".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

болеть ← Proto-Slavic **bolěti*, with боль, "pain" — inherited (Vasmer). Vasmer sets it beside Old English *bealu*, "evil", a link Berneker rejected.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolét*
- *Say it: bolét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bolét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to paint, then the Russian for to clean, then say *bolét* again

Before you move on

What does болеть mean? (“To be ill; to ache”.) Say it once more.

207.2 лечить (lechít) — to treat (an illness)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to clean, then the Russian for to be ill; to ache.

You’ll want to know: лечить

лечить (*lechít*) — “to treat (an illness)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лечить comes from **lěkŭ*, “a cure”, the root of лекарство, “medicine”, which Vasmer calls a certain loan from Germanic, as in Gothic *lēkeis*, “a doctor”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lechít*
- *Say it: lechít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lechít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to clean, then the Russian for to be ill; to ache, then say *lechít* again

Before you move on

What does лечить mean? (“To treat (an illness)”.) Say it once more.

207.3 дышать (dyshát) — to breathe

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be ill; to ache, then the Russian for to treat.

You’ll want to know: дышать

дышать (*dyshát*) — “to breathe”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

дышать ← Proto-Slavic **dyšati*, with дух, “breath”, and душа, “soul” — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *dūsėti*, “to pant”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dyshát*
- *Say it: dyshát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dyshát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be ill; to ache, then the Russian for to treat, then say *dyshát* again

Before you move on

What does дышать mean? (“To breathe”.) Say it once more.

207.4 кашлять (káshlyat) — to cough

Before the new one: say the Russian for to treat, then the Russian for to breathe.

You'll want to know: кашлять

кашлять (*káshlyat*) — "to cough".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кашлять comes from кашель, "a cough", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *kosulỹs*, "a cough", and Sanskrit *kāsa-*, "cough".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: káshlyat*
- *Say it: káshlyat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *káshlyat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to treat, then the Russian for to breathe, then say *káshlyat* again

Before you move on

What does кашлять mean? ("To cough".) Say it once more.

207.5 чихать (chikhát) — to sneeze

Before the new one: say the Russian for to breathe, then the Russian for to cough.

You'll want to know: чихать

чихать (*chikhát*) — "to sneeze".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чихать — a sound-imitating verb, Proto-Slavic **čĭx-*, like Sanskrit *chikkā*, "a sneeze" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chikhát*
- *Say it: chikhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chikhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to breathe, then the Russian for to cough, then say *chikhát* again

Before you move on

What does чихать mean? ("To sneeze".) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

To feel, To notice, To hear, To sniff, To touch

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to feel, to notice, to hear, to sniff and to touch.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say to feel, to notice, to hear, to sniff and to touch.

208.1 чувствовать (chúvstvovat) — to feel

Before the new one: say the Russian for to cough, then the Russian for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: чувствовать

чувствовать (*chúvstvovat*) — "to feel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чувствовать comes from чувство, "a feeling", which Vasmer puts with чуять, "to sense", and чуть, "barely". He relates чуять to Sanskrit *kaví-*, "a seer", Greek *koéō*, "I perceive", and Latin *caveō*, "I beware".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chúvstvovat*
- *Say it: chúvstvovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chúvstvovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to cough, then the Russian for to sneeze, then say *chúvstvovat* again

Before you move on

What does чувствовать mean? ("To feel".) Say it once more.

208.2 замечать (zamechát) — to notice

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sneeze, then the Russian for to feel.

You'll want to know: замечать

замечать (*zamechát*) — "to notice".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

замечать is за- with -мечать, from метить, "to mark": to notice is to mark a thing in the mind. Vasmer reports a comparison of метить with Latin *mētior*, "I measure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zamechát*
- *Say it: zamechát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zamechát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sneeze, then the Russian for to feel, then say *zamechát* again

Before you move on

What does замечать mean? ("To notice".) Say it once more.

208.3 слышать (slýshat) — to hear

Before the new one: say the Russian for to feel, then the Russian for to notice.

You'll want to know: слышать

слышать (*slýshat*) — "to hear".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слышать ← Proto-Slavic **slyšati*, with слух, "hearing", and слушать, "to listen" — inherited, from PIE **klew-*, "to hear".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: slýshat*
- *Say it: slýshat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slýshat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to feel, then the Russian for to notice, then say *slýshat* again

Before you move on

What does слышать mean? ("To hear".) Say it once more.

208.4 нюхать (nyúkhat) — to sniff, to smell

Before the new one: say the Russian for to notice, then the Russian for to hear.

You'll want to know: нюхать

нюхать (*nyúkhat*) — "to sniff, to smell".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нюхать ← Proto-Slavic **njuxati* — inherited. Vasmer calls its links unclear; a link with **ǫxati*, "to smell", is possible, he says.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *nyúkhat*
- *Say it:* *nyúkhat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nyúkhat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to notice, then the Russian for to hear, then say *nyúkhat* again

Before you move on

What does нюхать mean? ("To sniff, to smell".) Say it once more.

208.5 трогать (trógat) — to touch

Before the new one: say the Russian for to hear, then the Russian for to sniff.

You'll want to know: трогать

трогать (*trógat*) — "to touch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

трогать — Ukrainian трогати means "to pull". It has been compared with Latvian *treksne*, "a push", and Old Norse *þreka*, "to press"; Goryaev proposed a link with Latin *trahō*, "I drag", and one with Latin *tergeō*, "I wipe", Vasmer finds doubtful, so the origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trógat*
- *Say it: trógat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trógat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to hear, then the Russian for to sniff, then say *trógat* again

Before you move on

What does трогать mean? ("To touch".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

To photograph, To gather, To promise, To joke, To get married

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to photograph, to gather, to promise, to joke and to get married.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say to photograph, to gather, to promise, to joke and to get married.

209.1 фотографировать (fotografírovat) — to photograph

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sniff, then the Russian for to touch.

You'll want to know: фотографировать

фотографировать (*fotografírovat*) — "to photograph".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фотографировать is фотография, "a photograph", made a verb with -ировать: Greek *phōs*, "light", with *gráphein*, "to write".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fotografírovat*
- *Say it: fotografírovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fotografírovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sniff, then the Russian for to touch, then say *fotografírovat* again

Before you move on

What does фотографировать mean? ("To photograph".) Say it once more.

209.2 собирать (sobirát) — to gather, to collect

Before the new one: say the Russian for to touch, then the Russian for to photograph.

You'll want to know: собирать

собирать (*sobirát*) — "to gather, to collect".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

собирать is со-, "together", with -бирать, from брать, "to take": to gather is to take things together.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sobirát*
- *Say it: sobirát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sobirát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to touch, then the Russian for to photograph, then say *sobirát* again

Before you move on

What does собирать mean? ("To gather, to collect".) Say it once more.

209.3 обещать (obeshchát) — to promise

Before the new one: say the Russian for to photograph, then the Russian for to gather.

You'll want to know: обещать

обещать (*obeshchát*) — "to promise".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обещать — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of an Old Russian *обечати; the -щ- marks it. It goes with обет, "a vow", on the old root вет-, "counsel, word".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obeshchát*
- *Say it: obeshchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obeshchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to photograph, then the Russian for to gather, then say *obeshchát* again

Before you move on

What does обещать mean? ("To promise".) Say it once more.

209.4 шутить (shutít) — to joke

Before the new one: say the Russian for to gather, then the Russian for to promise.

You'll want to know: шутить

шутить (*shutít*) — "to joke".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шутить comes from шут, "a jester" (Vasmer). Vasmer reports a suggested link with Lithuanian *siaũsti*, "to frolic", and doubts a loan from German *Schaute*, "a fool".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shutít*
- *Say it: shutít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shutít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to gather, then the Russian for to promise, then say *shutít* again

Before you move on

What does шутить mean? ("To joke".) Say it once more.

209.5 жениться (zhenítsya) — to get married (of a man)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to promise, then the Russian for to joke.

You'll want to know: жениться

жениться (*zhenítsya*) — "to get married (of a man)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жениться comes from жена, "wife", with -иться: to take a wife. жена is a cousin of Greek *gynḗ*, "woman".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhenítsya*
- *Say it: zhenítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhenítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to promise, then the Russian for to joke, then say *zhenítsya* again

Before you move on

What does жениться mean? ("To get married (of a man)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 210

Burn, Allergy, Dentist, Sticking plaster, Bandage

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a burn, an allergy, a dentist, a sticking plaster and a bandage.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say a burn, an allergy, a dentist, a sticking plaster and a bandage.

210.1 ожог (ozhóg) — a burn

Before the new one: say the Russian for to joke, then the Russian for to get married.

You'll want to know: ожог

ожог (*ozhóg*) — "a burn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ожог is о- with жог, from жечь, "to burn": a burn mark.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ozhóg*
- *Say it: ozhóg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ozhóg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to joke, then the Russian for to get married, then say *ozhóg* again

Before you move on

What does ожог mean? (“A burn”.) Say it once more.

210.2 аллергия (allergíya) — an allergy

Before the new one: say the Russian for to get married, then the Russian for a burn.

You’ll want to know: аллергия

аллергия (*allergíya*) — “an allergy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

аллергия is an international coinage of 1906: Greek *állos*, “other”, with *érgon*, “work, action”: a changed reaction.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: allergíya*
- *Say it: allergíya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *allergíya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to get married, then the Russian for a burn, then say *allergíya* again

Before you move on

What does аллергия mean? ("An allergy".) Say it once more.

210.3 стоматолог (stomatólog) — a dentist

Before the new one: say the Russian for a burn, then the Russian for an allergy.

You'll want to know: стоматолог

стоматолог (*stomatólog*) — "a dentist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стоматолог is an international coinage from Greek *stóma*, *stómatos*, "mouth", with *-lógos*, "one who studies".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stomatólog*
- *Say it: stomatólog*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stomatólog*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a burn, then the Russian for an allergy, then say *stomatólog* again

Before you move on

What does стоматолог mean? ("A dentist".) Say it once more.

210.4 пластырь (plástyr) — a sticking plaster

Before the new one: say the Russian for an allergy, then the Russian for a dentist.

You'll want to know: пластырь

пластырь (*plástyr*) — "a sticking plaster".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пластырь — Church Slavonic пластырь, for Greek *émplastron*, "a salve plaster"; Vasmer takes it from Vulgar Latin **plastrum* or, through Old High German *pflâster*, from Latin *emplastrum*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plástyr*
- *Say it: plástyr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plástyr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an allergy, then the Russian for a dentist, then say *plástyr* again

Before you move on

What does пластырь mean? ("A sticking plaster".) Say it once more.

210.5 бинт (bint) — a bandage

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dentist, then the Russian for a sticking plaster.

You'll want to know: бинт

бинт (*bint*) — "a bandage".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бинт comes from German *Binde*, "a bandage" (Vasmer), from *binden*, "to bind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bint*
- *Say it: bint*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bint*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dentist, then the Russian for a sticking plaster, then say *bint* again

Before you move on

What does бинт mean? ("A bandage".) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

Muscle, Bone, Pulse, Pressure, Strength

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a muscle, a bone, a pulse, pressure and strength.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say a muscle, a bone, a pulse, pressure and strength.

211.1 мышца (mýshtsa) — a muscle

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sticking plaster, then the Russian for a bandage.

You'll want to know: мышца

мышца (*mýshtsa*) — "a muscle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мышца is built on мышь, "a mouse", as Latin *mūsculus*, "a little mouse; a muscle", and Greek *mŷs*, "mouse; muscle" (Vasmer): a flexing muscle looks like a mouse under the skin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mýshtsa*
- *Say it: mýshtsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mýshtsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sticking plaster, then the Russian for a bandage, then say *mýshtsa* again

Before you move on

What does мышца mean? (“A muscle”.) Say it once more.

211.2 кость (kost) — a bone

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bandage, then the Russian for a muscle.

You’ll want to know: кость

кость (*kost*) — “a bone”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кость ← Proto-Slavic **kostĭ* — inherited, related to Latin *costa*, “a rib” (Vasmer). Some also link it with Greek *ostéon* and Latin *os*, “bone”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kost*
- *Say it: kost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kost*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bandage, then the Russian for a muscle, then say *kost* again

Before you move on

What does кость mean? (“A bone”.) Say it once more.

211.3 пульс (puls) — a pulse

Before the new one: say the Russian for a muscle, then the Russian for a bone.

You’ll want to know: пульс

пульс (*puls*) — “a pulse”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пульс came through German *Puls* or French *pouls* from Medieval Latin *pulsus (vēnārum)*, “the beat of the veins” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puls*
- *Say it: puls*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puls*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a muscle, then the Russian for a bone, then say *puls* again

Before you move on

What does пульс mean? (“A pulse”.) Say it once more.

211.4 давление (davléniye) — pressure; blood pressure

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bone, then the Russian for a pulse.

You'll want to know: давление

давление (*davléniye*) — "pressure; blood pressure".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

давление is a noun from давить, "to press, to squeeze". Vasmer relates давить to Avestan *dav-*, "to press".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: davléniye*
- *Say it: davléniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *davléniye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bone, then the Russian for a pulse, then say *davléniye* again

Before you move on

What does давление mean? ("Pressure; blood pressure".) Say it once more.

211.5 сила (síla) — strength

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pulse, then the Russian for pressure; blood pressure.

You'll want to know: сила

сила (*síla*) — "strength".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сила ← Proto-Slavic **síla* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *síela*, "soul, feeling", and Old Prussian *seilin*, "diligence".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: síla*
- *Say it: síla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *síla*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pulse, then the Russian for pressure; blood pressure, then say *síla* again

Before you move on

What does сила mean? ("Strength".) Say it once more.

Chapter 212

June, July, August, September, October

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say June, July, August, September and October.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say June, July, August, September and October.

212.1 июнь (iyún) — June

Before the new one: say the Russian for pressure; blood pressure, then the Russian for strength.

You'll want to know: июнь

июнь (*iyún*) — "June".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

июнь — Old Russian июнь; it came through Byzantine Greek *ioúnios* from Latin *iūnius*, "June" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iyún*
- *Say it:* *iyún*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iyún*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pressure; blood pressure, then the Russian for strength, then say *iyún* again

Before you move on

What does **июнь** mean? ("June".) Say it once more.

212.2 июль (iyúl) — July

Before the new one: say the Russian for strength, then the Russian for June.

You'll want to know: июль

июль (*iyúl*) — "July".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

июль — Old Russian **июль**; it came through Byzantine Greek *ioúlios* from Latin *iūlius*, the month named for Julius Caesar (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *iyúl*
- *Say it:* *iyúl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *iyúl*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for strength, then the Russian for June, then say *iyúl* again

Before you move on

What does июль mean? ("July".) Say it once more.

212.3 август (ávgust) — August

Before the new one: say the Russian for June, then the Russian for July.

You'll want to know: август

август (*ávgust*) — "August".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

август — Old Russian *avŭgustŭ*; it came through Greek *aúgoustos* from Latin *augustus*, the month named for the emperor Augustus (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ávgust*
- *Say it: ávgust*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ávgust*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for June, then the Russian for July, then say *ávgust* again

Before you move on

What does август mean? ("August".) Say it once more.

212.4 сентябрь (sentyábr) — September

Before the new one: say the Russian for July, then the Russian for August.

You'll want to know: сентябрь

сентябрь (*sentyábr*) — "September".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сентябрь — Old Russian сєптябрь; it came through Byzantine Greek *septémbrios* from Latin *september*, "the seventh month", when the year began in March (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sentyábr*
- *Say it:* *sentyábr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sentyábr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for July, then the Russian for August, then say *sentyábr* again

Before you move on

What does сентябрь mean? ("September".) Say it once more.

212.5 октябрь (oktyábr) — October

Before the new one: say the Russian for August, then the Russian for September.

You'll want to know: октябрь

октябрь (*oktyábr*) — "October".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

октябрь — Old Russian октябрь; it came through Byzantine Greek *oktṓbrios* from Latin *octōber*, "the eighth month" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oktyábr*
- *Say it: oktyábr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oktyábr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for August, then the Russian for September, then say *oktyábr* again

Before you move on

What does октябрь mean? ("October".) Say it once more.

212.6 Words from chapters 204-207 — a first pass

Say the words for September and October.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to try, to order, to pay, to cost, to spend
- to forget, to be a student, to study, to teach, to hand in; to take
- to put out, to build, to break, to paint, to clean
- to be ill; to ache, to treat, to breathe, to cough, to sneeze

Before you move on

To try? (пробовать.) To order? (заказывать.) To pay? (платить.) To cost? (стоить.) To spend? (тратить.) To forget? (забывать.) To be a student? (учиться.) To study? (изучать.) To teach? (преподавать.) To hand in; to take? (сдавать.) To put out? (гасить.) To build? (строить.) To break? (ломать.) To

paint? (красить.) To clean? (чистить.) To be ill; to ache? (болеть.) To treat? (лечить.) To breathe? (дышать.) To cough? (кашлять.) To sneeze? (чихать.)

212.7 Words from chapters 208-212 — a second pass

Say the words for to feel and to notice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to feel, to notice, to hear, to sniff, to touch
- to photograph, to gather, to promise, to joke, to get married
- a burn, an allergy, a dentist, a sticking plaster, a bandage
- a muscle, a bone, a pulse, pressure; blood pressure, strength
- June, July, August, September, October

Before you move on

To feel? (чувствовать.) To notice? (замечать.) To hear? (слышать.) To sniff? (нюхать.) To touch? (трогать.) To photograph? (фотографировать.) To gather? (собирать.) To promise? (обещать.) To joke? (шутить.) To get married? (жениться.) A burn? (ожог.) An allergy? (аллергия.) A dentist? (стоматолог.) A sticking plaster? (пластырь.) A bandage? (бинт.) A muscle? (мышца.) A bone? (кость.) A pulse? (пульс.) Pressure; blood pressure? (давление.) Strength? (сила.) June? (июнь.) July? (июль.) August? (август.) September? (сентябрь.) October? (октябрь.)

Chapter 213

Border, Customs, Capital, Flat, Floor

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a border, customs, a capital, a flat and a floor.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say a border, customs, a capital, a flat and a floor.*

213.1 граница (granítsa) — a border

> Before the new one: say the Russian for September, then the Russian for October.

You'll want to know: граница

граница (*granítsa*) — "a border".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

граница is built on грань, "an edge, a facet" (Vasmer), which first probably meant "a point"; Vasmer relates it to Old High German *grana*, "whisker". German *Grenze*, "border", was borrowed from this Slavic word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: granítsa*
- *Say it: granítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *granítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for September, then the Russian for October, then say *granítsa* again

Before you move on

What does граница mean? ("A border".) Say it once more.

213.2 таможня (tamózhnya) — customs

Before the new one: say the Russian for October, then the Russian for a border.

You'll want to know: таможня

таможня (*tamózhnya*) — "customs".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

таможня comes from Old Russian тамга, "a stamp, a customs duty" (Vasmer), from Turkic *tamga*, "an owner's brand, a seal, a tax".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tamózhnya*
- *Say it: tamózhnya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tamózhnya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for October, then the Russian for a border, then say *tamózhnya* again

Before you move on

What does таможня mean? (“Customs”.) Say it once more.

213.3 столица (stolítsa) — a capital (city)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a border, then the Russian for customs.

You’ll want to know: столица

столица (*stolítsa*) — “a capital (city)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

столица is built on стол, which in Old Russian meant “a throne, a princely seat” as well as “a table” (Vasmer): the capital is where the ruler sits.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stolítsa*
- *Say it: stolítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stolítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a border, then the Russian for customs, then say *stolítsa* again

Before you move on

What does столица mean? (“A capital (city)”.) Say it once more.

213.4 квартира (kvartíra) — a flat

Before the new one: say the Russian for customs, then the Russian for a capital.

You'll want to know: квартира

квартира (*kvartíra*) — "a flat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

квартира — from 1704, also folk фатера; it came through German *Quartier* or Dutch *kwartier* from Old French *quartier*, "a quarter, lodgings", Latin *quartārius*, "a fourth" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kvartíra*
- *Say it: kvartíra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kvartíra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for customs, then the Russian for a capital, then say *kvartíra* again

Before you move on

What does квартира mean? ("A flat".) Say it once more.

213.5 этаж (etázh) — a floor, a storey

Before the new one: say the Russian for a capital, then the Russian for a flat.

You'll want to know: этаж

этаж (*etázh*) — "a floor, a storey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

этаж comes from French *étage*, "a storey", from a Latin **staticum*, from *statiō*, "a standing, a post" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: etázh*
- *Say it: etázh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *etázh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a capital, then the Russian for a flat, then say *etázh* again

Before you move on

What does этаж mean? ("A floor, a storey".) Say it once more.

Chapter 214

From here, Back, Forward, Up, Down

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say from here, back, forward, up and down.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say from here, back, forward, up and down.*

214.1 отсюда (otsyúda) — from here

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a flat, then the Russian for a floor.

You'll want to know: отсюда

отсюда (*otsyúda*) — "from here".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отсюда is от, "from", with -сюда, built on the old pronoun сей, "this", like откуда, "from where" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otsyúda*
- *Say it: otsyúda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otsyúda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a flat, then the Russian for a floor, then say *otsyúda* again

Before you move on

What does отсюда mean? ("From here".) Say it once more.

214.2 назад (nazád) — back, backwards

Before the new one: say the Russian for a floor, then the Russian for from here.

You'll want to know: назад

назад (*nazád*) — "back, backwards".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

назад is на, "onto", with зад, "the back, the rear": backwards. Vasmer reports the usual comparison of зад with Greek *chódanos*, "rump".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nazád*
- *Say it: nazád*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nazád*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a floor, then the Russian for from here, then say *nazád* again

Before you move on

What does назад mean? ("Back, backwards".) Say it once more.

214.3 вперёд (vperyód) — forward

Before the new one: say the Russian for from here, then the Russian for back.

You'll want to know: вперёд

вперёд (*vperyód*) — "forward".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вперёд is в, "into", with перёд, "the front", Proto-Slavic **perdŭ*, which Vasmer relates to пере-, "across, before".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vperyód*
- *Say it: vperyód*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vperyód*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for from here, then the Russian for back, then say *vperyód* again

Before you move on

What does вперёд mean? ("Forward".) Say it once more.

214.4 вверх (vverkh) — up, upwards

Before the new one: say the Russian for back, then the Russian for forward.

You'll want to know: вверх

вверх (*vverkh*) — "up, upwards".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вверх is в, "into", with верх, "the top": upward. верх is a cousin of Lithuanian *viršùs*, "top" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vverkh*
- *Say it: vverkh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vverkh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for back, then the Russian for forward, then say *vverkh* again

Before you move on

What does вверх mean? ("Up, upwards".) Say it once more.

214.5 вниз (vniz) — down, downwards

Before the new one: say the Russian for forward, then the Russian for up.

You'll want to know: вниз

вниз (*vniz*) — "down, downwards".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вниз is в, "into", with низ, "the bottom": downward. Vasmer derives низ from the PIE **ni*, "down".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *vniz*
- *Say it:* *vniz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vniz*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for forward, then the Russian for up, then say *vniz* again

Before you move on

What does **вниз** mean? ("Down, downwards".) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

Of course, Probably, Maybe, Unfortunately, Fortunately

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say of course, probably, maybe, unfortunately and fortunately.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say of course, probably, maybe, unfortunately and fortunately.

215.1 конечно (konéchno) — of course

Before the new one: say the Russian for up, then the Russian for down.

You'll want to know: конечно

конечно (*konéchno*) — "of course".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

конечно is the adverb of конечный, "final", from конец, "end": "finally, surely", and so "of course".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: konéchno*
- *Say it: konéchno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *konéchno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for up, then the Russian for down, then say *konéchno* again

Before you move on

What does конечно mean? ("Of course".) Say it once more.

215.2 наверное (navérnoye) — probably

Before the new one: say the Russian for down, then the Russian for of course.

You'll want to know: наверное

наверное (*navérnoye*) — "probably".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наверное is на, "on", with верное, "the sure thing", from верный, "true, sure", and вера, "faith": first "for certain", now "probably".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: navérnoye*
- *Say it: navérnoye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *navérnoye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for down, then the Russian for of course, then say *navérnoye* again

Before you move on

What does наверное mean? (“Probably”.) Say it once more.

215.3 может быть (mózhet byt) — maybe

Before the new one: say the Russian for of course, then the Russian for probably.

You’ll want to know: может быть

может быть (*mózhet byt*) — “maybe”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

может быть is “it can be”: может, “can”, from мочь, with быть, “to be”, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *būti*, “to be”, and Latin *fuī*, “I was”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mózhet byt*
- *Say it: mózhet byt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mózhet byt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for of course, then the Russian for probably, then say *mózhet byt* again

Before you move on

What does может быть mean? (“Maybe”.) Say it once more.

215.4 к сожалению (k sozhaléniyu) — unfortunately

Before the new one: say the Russian for probably, then the Russian for maybe.

You'll want to know: к сожалению

к сожалению (*k sozhaléniyu*) — "unfortunately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

к сожалению is "to (my) regret": к, "to", with сожалению, from сожаление, "regret", built on жалеть, "to pity". Vasmer relates жаль, "pity", to Lithuanian *gėlà*, "torment", and *gélti*, "to sting".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: k sozhaléniyu*
- *Say it: k sozhaléniyu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *k sozhaléniyu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for probably, then the Russian for maybe, then say *k sozhaléniyu* again

Before you move on

What does к сожалению mean? ("Unfortunately".) Say it once more.

215.5 к счастью (k schástyu) — fortunately

Before the new one: say the Russian for maybe, then the Russian for unfortunately.

You'll want to know: к счастью

к счастью (*k schástyu*) — "fortunately".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

к счастью is "to (my) luck": к, "to", with счастью, from счастье, "luck, happiness", which is usually explained as *sŭ-*, "good", with часть, "a share": "a good lot" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: k schástyu*
- *Say it: k schástyu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *k schástyu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for maybe, then the Russian for unfortunately, then say *k schástyu* again

Before you move on

What does к счастью mean? ("Fortunately".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

Calm, Nervous, Happy, Sad, Strict

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say calm, nervous, happy, sad and strict.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say calm, nervous, happy, sad and strict.*

216.1 спокойный (spokóynyy) — calm

> Before the new one: say the Russian for unfortunately, then the Russian for fortunately.

You'll want to know: спокойный

спокойный (*spokóynyy*) — "calm".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

спокойный is built on покой, "rest, peace", which Vasmer relates to Latin *quiēs*, "rest", and Gothic *hveila*, "a while": English *while* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: spokóynyy*
- *Say it: spokóynyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *spokóynyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for unfortunately, then the Russian for fortunately, then say *spokóynyy* again

Before you move on

What does спокойный mean? ("Calm".) Say it once more.

216.2 нервный (nérvnyy) — nervous

Before the new one: say the Russian for fortunately, then the Russian for calm.

You'll want to know: нервный

нервный (*nérvnyy*) — "nervous".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

нервный is нерв, "a nerve", with -ный. нерв is a bookish loan through German *Nerv* or French *nerf* from Latin *nervus*, "a sinew, a nerve" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nérvnyy*
- *Say it: nérvnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nérvnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fortunately, then the Russian for calm, then say *nérvnyy* again

Before you move on

What does нервный mean? (“Nervous”.) Say it once more.

216.3 счастливый (schastlívyy) — happy

Before the new one: say the Russian for calm, then the Russian for nervous.

You’ll want to know: счастливый

счастливый (*schastlívyy*) — “happy”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

счастливый is built on счастье, “luck, happiness”, usually explained as “a good share”, from часть, “a share” (Vasmer). Vasmer relates часть to Lithuanian *kąsti*, “to bite”: a share is a bite.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schastlívyy*
- *Say it: schastlívyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schastlívyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for calm, then the Russian for nervous, then say *schastlívyy* again

Before you move on

What does счастливый mean? (“Happy”.) Say it once more.

216.4 грустный (grústnyy) — sad

Before the new one: say the Russian for nervous, then the Russian for happy.

You'll want to know: грустный

грустный (*grústnyy*) — "sad".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

грустный is грусть, "sadness", with -ный. Vasmer reports the usual link of грусть with Lithuanian *graudùs*, "brittle; sad".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grústnyy*
- *Say it: grústnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grústnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for nervous, then the Russian for happy, then say *grústnyy* again

Before you move on

What does грустный mean? ("Sad".) Say it once more.

216.5 строгий (strógiy) — strict

Before the new one: say the Russian for happy, then the Russian for sad.

You'll want to know: строгий

строгий (*strógiy*) — "strict".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

строгий — it is usually taken as a loan from Polish *srogi*, "severe", and the whole group is linked with стеречь, "to guard", and сторож, "a watchman" (Vasmer); Trubachev's note cites other views.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: strógiy*
- *Say it: strógiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *strógiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for happy, then the Russian for sad, then say *strógiy* again

Before you move on

What does строгий mean? ("Strict".) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

Blunt, Smooth, Cool, Fresh, Modern

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say blunt, smooth, cool, fresh and modern.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say blunt, smooth, cool, fresh and modern.

217.1 тупой (tupóy) — blunt

Before the new one: say the Russian for sad, then the Russian for strict.

You'll want to know: тупой

тупой (*tupóy*) — "blunt".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тупой ← Proto-Slavic **tǫpŭ* — inherited. It has been compared with Old Norse *þambr*, "swollen", and Lithuanian *tampýti*, "to stretch", among others (Vasmer); the origin is not settled.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tupóy*
- *Say it: tupóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tupóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sad, then the Russian for strict, then say *tupóy* again

Before you move on

What does тупой mean? ("Blunt".) Say it once more.

217.2 гладкий (gládkiy) — smooth

Before the new one: say the Russian for strict, then the Russian for blunt.

You'll want to know: гладкий

гладкий (*gládkiy*) — "smooth".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гладкий ← Proto-Slavic **gladŭkŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *glodùs*, "smooth", Latin *glaber*, "smooth, bald", and Old High German *glat*, "smooth, shining": English *glad* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gládkiy*
- *Say it: gládkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gládkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for strict, then the Russian for blunt, then say *gládkiy* again

Before you move on

What does гладкий mean? (“Smooth”.) Say it once more.

217.3 прохладный (prokhládnyy) — cool

Before the new one: say the Russian for blunt, then the Russian for smooth.

You’ll want to know: прохладный

прохладный (*prokhládnyy*) — “cool”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

прохладный is про- with хлад, the Church Slavonic shape of холод, “cold” (Vasmer): -ла- against -оло-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prokhládnyy*
- *Say it: prokhládnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prokhládnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for blunt, then the Russian for smooth, then say *prokhládnyy* again

Before you move on

What does прохладный mean? (“Cool”.) Say it once more.

217.4 свежий (svézhiy) — fresh

Before the new one: say the Russian for smooth, then the Russian for cool.

You'll want to know: свежий

свежий (*svézhiy*) — "fresh".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свежий ← Proto-Slavic **svěžĭ* — inherited. It has been compared with Gothic *swikns*, "pure", and Lithuanian *sveĩkas*, "healthy", but Vasmer notes doubts about the Latvian evidence, so the origin is open.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svézhiy*
- *Say it: svézhiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svézhiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for smooth, then the Russian for cool, then say *svézhiy* again

Before you move on

What does свежий mean? ("Fresh".) Say it once more.

217.5 современный (sovreménnyy) — modern

Before the new one: say the Russian for cool, then the Russian for fresh.

You'll want to know: современный

современный (*sovreménnyy*) — "modern".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

современный is со-, "together", with времен-, from время, "time", a Church Slavonic word (Vasmer): "of the same time", contemporary.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sovreménnyy*
- *Say it: sovreménnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sovreménnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cool, then the Russian for fresh, then say *sovreménnyy* again

Before you move on

What does современный mean? ("Modern".) Say it once more.

Chapter 218

Different, Same, Similar, Main, Ordinary

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say different, the same, similar, main and ordinary.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say different, the same, similar, main and ordinary.

218.1 разный (ráznyy) — different, various

Before the new one: say the Russian for fresh, then the Russian for modern.

You'll want to know: разный

разный (*ráznyy*) — "different, various".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

разный is the Church Slavonic form, Vasmer says, in place of native розный, as in рознь, "discord", and порознь, "apart".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ráznyy*
- *Say it: ráznyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ráznyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for fresh, then the Russian for modern, then say *ráznyy* again

Before you move on

What does разный mean? ("Different, various".) Say it once more.

218.2 одинаковый (odinákovyy) — the same, identical

Before the new one: say the Russian for modern, then the Russian for different.

You'll want to know: одинаковый

одинаковый (*odinákovyy*) — "the same, identical".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

одинаковый is built on один, "one", with -аковый: "all one", the same.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: odinákovyy*
- *Say it: odinákovyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *odinákovyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for modern, then the Russian for different, then say *odinákovyy* again

Before you move on

What does одинаковый mean? ("The same, identical".) Say it once more.

218.3 похожий (pokhózhiy) — similar, alike

Before the new one: say the Russian for different, then the Russian for the same.

You'll want to know: похожий

похожий (*pokhózhiy*) — "similar, alike".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

похожий comes from походить *(на)*, "to take after", по- with ходить, "to walk": to resemble is to go after someone.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pokhózhiy*
- *Say it: pokhózhiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pokhózhiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for different, then the Russian for the same, then say *pokhózhiy* again

Before you move on

What does похожий mean? ("Similar, alike".) Say it once more.

218.4 главный (glávnyy) — main

Before the new one: say the Russian for the same, then the Russian for similar.

You'll want to know: главный

главный (*glávnyy*) — "main".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

главный comes from глава, "head; chapter", which Vasmer calls a loan from Church Slavonic in place of Russian голова, "head": the main thing is the head one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *glávnyy*
- *Say it:* *glávnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *glávnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for the same, then the Russian for similar, then say *glávnyy* again

Before you move on

What does главный mean? ("Main".) Say it once more.

218.5 обычный (obýchnyy) — ordinary, usual

Before the new one: say the Russian for similar, then the Russian for main.

You'll want to know: обычный

обычный (*obýchnyy*) — "ordinary, usual".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обычный is built on обычай, "a custom", from **ob-vyčajǐ* (Vasmer), on the root of привыкнуть, "to get used to", which is also the root of учить, "to teach".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obýchnyy*
- *Say it: obýchnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obýchnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for similar, then the Russian for main, then say *obýchnyy* again

Before you move on

What does обычный mean? ("Ordinary, usual".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

Toothpaste, Razor, Iron, Vacuum cleaner, Oven

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say toothpaste, a razor, an iron, a vacuum cleaner and an oven.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say toothpaste, a razor, an iron, a vacuum cleaner and an oven.

219.1 зубная паста (zubnáya pásta) — toothpaste

Before the new one: say the Russian for main, then the Russian for ordinary.

You'll want to know: зубная паста

зубная паста (*zubnáya pásta*) — "toothpaste".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зубная паста is "tooth paste": зубная, from зуб, "tooth", with паста, "a paste", which Vasmer thinks more likely from Italian *pasta*, "dough", than from Greek.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zubnáya pásta*
- *Say it: zubnáya pásta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zubnáya pásta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for main, then the Russian for ordinary, then say *zubnáya pásta* again

Before you move on

What does зубная паста mean? ("Toothpaste".) Say it once more.

219.2 бритва (brítva) — a razor

Before the new one: say the Russian for ordinary, then the Russian for toothpaste.

You'll want to know: бритва

бритва (*brítva*) — "a razor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бритва comes from брить, "to shave", брею, "I shave" (Vasmer), with -тва, a suffix for a tool.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brítva*
- *Say it: brítva*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brítva*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ordinary, then the Russian for toothpaste, then say *brítva* again

Before you move on

What does бритва mean? (“A razor”.) Say it once more.

219.3 утюг (utyúg) — an iron

Before the new one: say the Russian for toothpaste, then the Russian for a razor.

You’ll want to know: утюг

утюг (*utyúg*) — “an iron”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

утюг comes from Turkic **ütüg*, as in Turkish *ütü*, “a flat iron” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utyúg*
- *Say it: utyúg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utyúg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for toothpaste, then the Russian for a razor, then say *utyúg* again

Before you move on

What does утюг mean? (“An iron”.) Say it once more.

219.4 пылесос (pylesós) — a vacuum cleaner

Before the new one: say the Russian for a razor, then the Russian for an iron.

You'll want to know: пылесос

пылесос (*pylesós*) — "a vacuum cleaner".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пылесос is пыль, "dust", with -о- and сос, from сосать, "to suck": a dust-sucker. Vasmer traces сосать to a PIE sound-word **su-*, as in Latin *sūgō*, "I suck".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pylesós*
- *Say it: pylesós*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pylesós*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a razor, then the Russian for an iron, then say *pylesós* again

Before you move on

What does пылесос mean? ("A vacuum cleaner".) Say it once more.

219.5 духовка (dukhóvka) — an oven

Before the new one: say the Russian for an iron, then the Russian for a vacuum cleaner.

You'll want to know: духовка

духовка (*dukhóvka*) — "an oven".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

духовка is built on дух, "breath, air", here hot air, with -овка: an oven that bakes with hot air.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dukhóvka*
- *Say it: dukhóvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dukhóvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an iron, then the Russian for a vacuum cleaner, then say *dukhóvka* again

Before you move on

What does духовка mean? ("An oven".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

Tablet, Screen, Keyboard, Printer, Remote control

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a tablet, a screen, a keyboard, a printer and a remote control.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say a tablet, a screen, a keyboard, a printer and a remote control.*

220.1 планшет (planshét) — a tablet (computer)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a vacuum cleaner, then the Russian for an oven.

You'll want to know: планшет

планшет (*planshét*) — "a tablet (computer)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

планшет comes from French *planchette*, "a small board, a drawing board", from *planche*, "a plank".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: planshét*
- *Say it: planshét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *planshét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a vacuum cleaner, then the Russian for an oven, then say *planshét* again

Before you move on

What does планшет mean? ("A tablet (computer)".) Say it once more.

220.2 экран (ekrán) — a screen

Before the new one: say the Russian for an oven, then the Russian for a tablet.

You'll want to know: экран

экран (*ekrán*) — "a screen".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

экран comes from French *écran*, "a screen", which is traced to a form close to Middle High German *schranc*, "a barrier" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ekrán*
- *Say it: ekrán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ekrán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an oven, then the Russian for a tablet, then say *ekrán* again

Before you move on

What does экран mean? ("A screen".) Say it once more.

220.3 клавиатура (klaviatúra) — a keyboard

Before the new one: say the Russian for a tablet, then the Russian for a screen.

You'll want to know: клавиатура

клавиатура (*klaviatúra*) — "a keyboard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

клавиатура comes from German *Klaviatur*, "a keyboard", built on Latin *clāvis*, "a key".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: klaviatúra*
- *Say it: klaviatúra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *klaviatúra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a tablet, then the Russian for a screen, then say *klaviatúra* again

Before you move on

What does клавиатура mean? ("A keyboard".) Say it once more.

220.4 принтер (prínter) — a printer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a screen, then the Russian for a keyboard.

You'll want to know: принтер

принтер (*prínter*) — "a printer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

принтер comes from English *printer*, from *print*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prínter*
- *Say it: prínter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prínter*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a screen, then the Russian for a keyboard, then say *prínter* again

Before you move on

What does принтер mean? ("A printer".) Say it once more.

220.5 пульт (pult) — a remote control

Before the new one: say the Russian for a keyboard, then the Russian for a printer.

You'll want to know: пульт

пульт (*pult*) — "a remote control".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пульт came through German *Pult*, "a desk", older *pulpet*, from Latin *pulpitum*, "a platform" (Vasmer). A remote is a little control desk.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pult*
- *Say it: pult*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pult*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a keyboard, then the Russian for a printer, then say *pult* again

Before you move on

What does пульт mean? (“A remote control”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Toy, Ball, Doll, Vase, Painting

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a toy, a ball, a doll, a vase and a painting.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say a toy, a ball, a doll, a vase and a painting.*

221.1 игрушка (igrúshka) — a toy

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a printer, then the Russian for a remote control.

You'll want to know: игрушка

игрушка (*igrúshka*) — "a toy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

игрушка is built on игра, "a game", with -ушка: a thing to play with.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: igrúshka*

- *Say it: igrúshka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *igrúshka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a printer, then the Russian for a remote control, then say *igrúshka* again

Before you move on

What does игрушка mean? (“A toy”.) Say it once more.

221.2 мяч (myach) — a ball

Before the new one: say the Russian for a remote control, then the Russian for a toy.

You’ll want to know: мяч

мяч (*myach*) — “a ball”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мяч first meant “something squeezed together”, from смякать, “to press”, on the root of мягкий, “soft” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: myach*
- *Say it: myach*, once more
- *Say it:* say *myach*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a remote control, then the Russian for a toy, then say *myach* again

Before you move on

What does мяч mean? (“A ball”.) Say it once more.

221.3 кукла (kúkla) — a doll

Before the new one: say the Russian for a toy, then the Russian for a ball.

You'll want to know: кукла

кукла (*kúkla*) — "a doll".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кукла ← Byzantine Greek *koúkla*, "a doll", from Latin *cuculla*, "a hood" (Vasmer); Old Russian кукольник meant "a conjurer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kúkla*
- *Say it: kúkla*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kúkla*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a toy, then the Russian for a ball, then say *kúkla* again

Before you move on

What does кукла mean? ("A doll".) Say it once more.

221.4 ваза (váza) — a vase

Before the new one: say the Russian for a ball, then the Russian for a doll.

You'll want to know: ваза

ваза (*váza*) — "a vase".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ваза came from German *Vase* or French *vase*, from Latin *vās*, plural *vāsa*, "a vessel" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: váza*
- *Say it: váza*, once more
- *Say it:* say *váza*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a ball, then the Russian for a doll, then say *váza* again

Before you move on

What does ваза mean? ("A vase".) Say it once more.

221.5 картина (kartína) — a painting

Before the new one: say the Russian for a doll, then the Russian for a vase.

You'll want to know: картина

картина (*kartína*) — "a painting".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

картина — from Peter the Great's time; Vasmer takes it from Italian *cartina*, "fine paper", from *carta*, "paper"; Preobrazhensky saw a Russian derivative of карта, "a map".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kartína*
- *Say it: kartína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kartína*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a doll, then the Russian for a vase, then say *kartína* again

Before you move on

What does картина mean? ("A painting".) Say it once more.

221.6 Words from chapters 213-216 — a first pass

Say the words for a vase and a painting.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a border, customs, a capital, a flat, a floor
- from here, back, forward, up, down
- of course, probably, maybe, unfortunately, fortunately
- calm, nervous, happy, sad, strict

Before you move on

A border? (граница.) Customs? (таможня.) A capital? (столица.) A flat? (квартира.) A floor? (этаж.) From here? (отсюда.) Back? (назад.) Forward? (вперёд.) Up? (вверх.) Down? (вниз.) Of course? (конечно.) Probably? (наверное.) Maybe? (может быть.) Unfortunately? (к сожалению.) Fortunately? (к счастью.) Calm? (спокойный.) Nervous? (нервный.) Happy? (счастливый.) Sad? (грустный.) Strict? (строгий.)

221.7 Words from chapters 217-221 — a second pass

Say the words for blunt and smooth.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- blunt, smooth, cool, fresh, modern
- different, the same, similar, main, ordinary
- toothpaste, a razor, an iron, a vacuum cleaner, an oven
- a tablet, a screen, a keyboard, a printer, a remote control
- a toy, a ball, a doll, a vase, a painting

Before you move on

Blunt? (тупой.) Smooth? (гладкий.) Cool? (прохладный.) Fresh? (свежий.) Modern? (современный.) Different? (разный.) The same? (одинаковый.) Similar? (похожий.) Main? (главный.) Ordinary? (обычный.) Toothpaste? (зубная паста.) A razor? (бритва.) An iron? (утюг.) A vacuum cleaner? (пылесос.) An oven? (духовка.) A tablet? (планшет.) A screen? (экран.) A keyboard? (клавиатура.) A printer? (принтер.) A remote control? (пульт.) A toy? (игрушка.) A ball? (мяч.) A doll? (кукла.) A vase? (ваза.) A painting? (картина.)

Chapter 222

Food, Dish, Menu, Bun, Kefir

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say food, a dish, a menu, a bun and kefir.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say food, a dish, a menu, a bun and kefir.*

222.1 еда (yedá) — food

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a vase, then the Russian for a painting.

You'll want to know: еда

еда (*yedá*) — "food".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

еда ← Proto-Slavic **ěda*, "food", on the root of есть, "to eat" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *ėdà*, "food (for animals)", and Old Norse *át*, "food"; English *eat* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yedá*
- *Say it:* *yedá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yedá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a vase, then the Russian for a painting, then say *yedá* again

Before you move on

What does еда mean? (“Food”.) Say it once more.

222.2 блюдо (blyúdo) — a dish

Before the new one: say the Russian for a painting, then the Russian for food.

You’ll want to know: блюдо

блюдо (*blyúdo*) — “a dish”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

блюдо — an old loan from Gothic *biuþs*, “a table, a dish”, from *biudan*, “to offer” (Vasmer); Finnish *pöytä*, “table”, has the same source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *blyúdo*
- *Say it:* *blyúdo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blyúdo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a painting, then the Russian for food, then say *blyúdo* again

Before you move on

What does блюдо mean? ("A dish".) Say it once more.

222.3 меню (menyú) — a menu

Before the new one: say the Russian for food, then the Russian for a dish.

You'll want to know: меню

меню (*menyú*) — "a menu".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

меню comes from French *menu*, "a detailed list", from *menu*, "small, detailed", Latin *minūtus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: menyú*
- *Say it: menyú*, once more
- *Say it:* say *menyú*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for food, then the Russian for a dish, then say *menyú* again

Before you move on

What does меню mean? ("A menu".) Say it once more.

222.4 булка (búlka) — a bun, a roll

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dish, then the Russian for a menu.

You'll want to know: булка

булка (*búlka*) — "a bun, a roll".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

булка — not found in older texts in this sense, so a loan from Polish *bułka*, and the Polish from Italian *bulla* or French *boule*, "a ball", has been assumed. Vasmer finds no evidence in the sounds for a loan and allows a native link with булава, "a mace".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: búlka*
- *Say it: búlka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *búlka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dish, then the Russian for a menu, then say *búlka* again

Before you move on

What does булка mean? ("A bun, a roll".) Say it once more.

222.5 кефир (kefír) — kefir

Before the new one: say the Russian for a menu, then the Russian for a bun.

You'll want to know: кефир

кефир (*kefír*) — "kefir".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кефир — the drink and its name came from the Caucasus, but the first source is not established (Trubachev, in Vasmer); Mingrelian

kipuri, “sour milk”, has been compared.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kefír*
- *Say it: kefír*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kefír*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a menu, then the Russian for a bun, then say *kefír* again

Before you move on

What does кефир mean? (“Kefir”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 223

Beans, Orange, Lemon, Banana, Grapes

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say beans, an orange, a lemon, a banana and grapes.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say beans, an orange, a lemon, a banana and grapes.

223.1 фасоль (fasól) — beans

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bun, then the Russian for kefir.

You'll want to know: фасоль

фасоль (*fasól*) — "beans".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фасоль came through Polish *fasola* from Middle High German *fasôl*, from Latin *phaseolus*, Greek *phásēlos*, "a bean" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fasól*
- *Say it: fasól*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fasól*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bun, then the Russian for kefir, then say *fasól* again

Before you move on

What does фасоль mean? (“Beans”.) Say it once more.

223.2 апельсин (apelsín) — an orange

Before the new one: say the Russian for kefir, then the Russian for beans.

You’ll want to know: апельсин

апельсин (*apelsín*) — “an orange”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

апельсин comes from Dutch *appelsien*, “apple of China”, like German *Apfelsine*, after French *pomme de Sine*; the Portuguese brought the fruit from China (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: apelsín*
- *Say it: apelsín*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apelsín*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for kefir, then the Russian for beans, then say *apelsín* again

Before you move on

What does апельсин mean? (“An orange”.) Say it once more.

223.3 лимон (limón) — a lemon

Before the new one: say the Russian for beans, then the Russian for an orange.

You’ll want to know: лимон

лимон (*limón*) — “a lemon”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лимон — recorded from the 1500s; it came through Modern Greek *limóni* or straight from Italian *limone* (Vasmer). The source is Arabic and Persian *līmūn*, a word from India (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: limón*
- *Say it: limón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *limón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for beans, then the Russian for an orange, then say *limón* again

Before you move on

What does лимон mean? (“A lemon”.) Say it once more.

223.4 банан (banán) — a banana

Before the new one: say the Russian for an orange, then the Russian for a lemon.

You'll want to know: банан

банан (*банán*) — "a banana".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

банан probably came from French *banane*, from a word of Kikongo, a language of the Congo (Vasmer); German *Banane* would have given a feminine noun.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *банán*
- *Say it:* *банán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *банán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an orange, then the Russian for a lemon, then say *банán* again

Before you move on

What does банан mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

223.5 виноград (vinográd) — grapes

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lemon, then the Russian for a banana.

You'll want to know: виноград

виноград (*виногрáд*) — "grapes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

виноград — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, where it meant "a vine, a vineyard": вино, "wine", with град, "an enclosure". Some see a model in Gothic *weinagards*, "vineyard".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vinográd*
- *Say it: vinográd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vinográd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lemon, then the Russian for a banana, then say *vinográd* again

Before you move on

What does виноград mean? ("Grapes".) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

Birch, Spruce, Pine, Bush, Sheep

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a birch, a spruce, a pine, a bush and a sheep.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say a birch, a spruce, a pine, a bush and a sheep.*

224.1 берёза (beryóza) — a birch

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a banana, then the Russian for grapes.

You'll want to know: берёза

берёза (*beryóza*) — "a birch".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

берёза ← Proto-Slavic **berza* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *béržas*, Sanskrit *bhūrja-*, Old Norse *bjǫrk* and Old High German *birihha*: English *birch* is a cousin, from a root "bright, white".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beryóza*
- *Say it:* *beryóza*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beryóza*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a banana, then the Russian for grapes, then say *beryóza* again

Before you move on

What does берёза mean? (“A birch”.) Say it once more.

224.2 ель (yel) — a spruce, a fir tree

Before the new one: say the Russian for grapes, then the Russian for a birch.

You’ll want to know: ель

ель (*yel*) — “a spruce, a fir tree”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ель ← Proto-Slavic **jedlĭ* — inherited, a cousin of Lithuanian *ẽglė* and Old Prussian *addle*, “fir, spruce” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yel*
- *Say it:* *yel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for grapes, then the Russian for a birch, then say *yel* again

Before you move on

What does ель mean? ("A spruce, a fir tree".) Say it once more.

224.3 сосна (sosná) — a pine

Before the new one: say the Russian for a birch, then the Russian for a spruce.

You'll want to know: сосна

сосна (*sosná*) — "a pine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сосна ← Proto-Slavic **sosna*. Vasmer derives it most likely from a PIE **ḱasnos*, "grey", as in Latin *cānus*, "grey", and Old High German *haso*, "hare"; Trubachev, in a note, doubts this.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sosná*
- *Say it: sosná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sosná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a birch, then the Russian for a spruce, then say *sosná* again

Before you move on

What does сосна mean? ("A pine".) Say it once more.

224.4 куст (kust) — a bush

Before the new one: say the Russian for a spruce, then the Russian for a pine.

You'll want to know: куст

куст (*kust*) — "a bush".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

куст ← Proto-Slavic **kŭstŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *kúokštas*, "a bush", and *kùkštas*, "a tuft of straw".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kust*
- *Say it: kust*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kust*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a spruce, then the Russian for a pine, then say *kust* again

Before you move on

What does куст mean? ("A bush".) Say it once more.

224.5 овца (ovtsá) — a sheep

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pine, then the Russian for a bush.

You'll want to know: овца

овца (*ovtsá*) — "a sheep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

овца ← Proto-Slavic **ovĭca*, a diminutive of the old word for "sheep" — inherited. Vasmer lists Sanskrit *ávi-*, Lithuanian *avìs*, Greek *óis* and Latin *ovis*: English *ewe* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ovtsá*
- *Say it: ovtsá*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ovtsá*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pine, then the Russian for a bush, then say *ovtsá* again

Before you move on

What does овца mean? ("A sheep".) Say it once more.

Chapter 225

Crocodile, Giraffe, Zebra, Camel, Deer

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a crocodile, a giraffe, a zebra, a camel and a deer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say a crocodile, a giraffe, a zebra, a camel and a deer.*

225.1 крокодил (krokodíl) — a crocodile

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a bush, then the Russian for a sheep.

You'll want to know: крокодил

крокодил (*krokodíl*) — "a crocodile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

крокодил is a western loan, perhaps through German *Krokodil*, from Latin *crocodīlus*, Greek *krokódeilos*; Old Russian *korkodilŭ* came straight from Greek (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krokodíl*
- *Say it: krokodíl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krokodíl*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bush, then the Russian for a sheep, then say *krokodíl* again

Before you move on

What does крокодил mean? ("A crocodile".) Say it once more.

225.2 жираф (zhiráf) — a giraffe

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sheep, then the Russian for a crocodile.

You'll want to know: жираф

жираф (*zhiráf*) — "a giraffe".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

жираф came through French *girafe*, and the older жирафа through German or Italian, from Arabic *zurāfa*, "giraffe" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhiráf*
- *Say it: zhiráf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhiráf*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sheep, then the Russian for a crocodile, then say *zhiráf* again

Before you move on

What does жираф mean? (“A giraffe”.) Say it once more.

225.3 зебра (zébra) — a zebra

Before the new one: say the Russian for a crocodile, then the Russian for a giraffe.

You’ll want to know: зебра

зебра (*zébra*) — “a zebra”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зебра more likely came through English or Dutch *zebra* than straight from French *zèbre*; Vasmer traces the word to an Angolan *zerba*, and others to Latin.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zébra*
- *Say it: zébra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zébra*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a crocodile, then the Russian for a giraffe, then say *zébra* again

Before you move on

What does зебра mean? (“A zebra”.) Say it once more.

225.4 верблюд (verblyúd) — a camel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a giraffe, then the Russian for a zebra.

You'll want to know: верблюд

верблюд (*verblyúd*) — "a camel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

верблюд — Old Russian *velĭbludŭ*; an old loan from Gothic *ulbandus*, reshaped after велий, "great" (Vasmer). The Gothic word goes back to Greek *eléphas*, "elephant": the name passed from one large beast to another.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: verblyúd*
- *Say it: verblyúd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *verblyúd*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a giraffe, then the Russian for a zebra, then say *verblyúd* again

Before you move on

What does верблюд mean? ("A camel".) Say it once more.

225.5 олень (olén) — a deer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a zebra, then the Russian for a camel.

You'll want to know: олень

олень (*olén*) — "a deer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

олень ← Proto-Slavic **olenĭ* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *élnis*, "deer, elk", Greek *élaphos*, "deer", and Welsh *elain*, "hind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: olén*
- *Say it: olén*, once more
- *Say it:* say *olén*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a zebra, then the Russian for a camel, then say *olén* again

Before you move on

What does олень mean? ("A deer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

Violin, Drum, Dance, Novel, Poems

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a violin, a drum, a dance, a novel and poems.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say a violin, a drum, a dance, a novel and poems.*

226.1 скрипка (skrípka) — a violin

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a camel, then the Russian for a deer.

You'll want to know: скрипка

скрипка (*skrípka*) — "a violin".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скрипка goes with скрипеть, "to creak, to squeak" (Vasmer): the violin as the squeaker.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skrípka*
- *Say it: skrípka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skrípka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a camel, then the Russian for a deer, then say *skrípka* again

Before you move on

What does скрипка mean? ("A violin".) Say it once more.

226.2 барабан (barabán) — a drum

Before the new one: say the Russian for a deer, then the Russian for a violin.

You'll want to know: барабан

барабан (*barabán*) — "a drum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

барабан — recorded by Kotoshikhin in the 1600s; probably from Turkic, compare Tatar *daraban*, "a drum"; Turkish *balaban*, "a big drum", has also been proposed (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: barabán*
- *Say it: barabán*, once more
- *Say it:* say *barabán*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a deer, then the Russian for a violin, then say *barabán* again

Before you move on

What does барабан mean? (“A drum”.) Say it once more.

226.3 танец (tánets) — a dance

Before the new one: say the Russian for a violin, then the Russian for a drum.

You’ll want to know: танец

танец (*tánets*) — “a dance”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

танец — recorded by Kotoshikhin in the 1600s; it came through Polish *taniec* from Middle High German *tanz*, “a dance”, with the Slavic ending -ец (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tánets*
- *Say it: tánets*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tánets*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a violin, then the Russian for a drum, then say *tánets* again

Before you move on

What does танец mean? (“A dance”.) Say it once more.

226.4 роман (román) — a novel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a drum, then the Russian for a dance.

You'll want to know: роман

роман (*román*) — "a novel".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

роман came from German *Roman* or, more likely, straight from French *roman*, Old French *romanz*, first "a story in the common Romance tongue" rather than Latin, from Latin *rōmānicē*, "in the Roman way" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: román*
- *Say it: román*, once more
- *Say it:* say *román*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a drum, then the Russian for a dance, then say *román* again

Before you move on

What does роман mean? ("A novel".) Say it once more.

226.5 стихи (stikhí) — poems, poetry

Before the new one: say the Russian for a dance, then the Russian for a novel.

You'll want to know: стихи

стихи (*stikhí*) — "poems, poetry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стихи is the plural of стих, "a line of verse", Old Church Slavonic *stixŭ*, from Greek *stíchos*, "a row, a line" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stikhí*
- *Say it: stikhí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stikhí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a dance, then the Russian for a novel, then say *stikhí* again

Before you move on

What does стихи mean? ("Poems, poetry".) Say it once more.

226.6 Words from chapters 222-223 — a first pass

Say the words for a novel and poems.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- food, a dish, a menu, a bun, kefir
- beans, an orange, a lemon, a banana, grapes

Before you move on

Food? (еда.) A dish? (блюдо.) A menu? (меню.) A bun? (булка.) Kefir? (кефир.) Beans? (фасоль.) An orange? (апельсин.) A lemon? (лимон.) A banana? (банан.) Grapes? (виноград.)

226.7 Words from chapters 224-226 — a second pass

Say the words for a birch and a spruce.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a birch, a spruce, a pine, a bush, a sheep
- a crocodile, a giraffe, a zebra, a camel, a deer
- a violin, a drum, a dance, a novel, poems

Before you move on

A birch? (берёза.) A spruce? (ель.) A pine? (сосна.) A bush? (куст.) A sheep? (овца.) A crocodile? (крокодил.) A giraffe? (жираф.) A zebra? (зебра.) A camel? (верблюд.) A deer? (олень.) A violin? (скрипка.) A drum? (барабан.) A dance? (танец.) A novel? (роман.) Poems? (стихи.)

Chapter 227

Fine, Person, Man, Woman, Boy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fine, a person, a man, a woman and a boy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say a fine, a person, a man, a woman and a boy.*

227.1 штраф (shtraf) — a fine

Before the new one: say the Russian for a novel, then the Russian for poems, poetry.

You'll want to know: штраф

штраф (*shtraf*) — "a fine".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

штраф — from 1711, under Peter the Great; it comes from German *Strafe*, "punishment, a fine" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shtraf*
- *Say it: shtraf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shtraf*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a novel, then the Russian for poems, poetry, then say *shtraf* again

Before you move on

What does штраф mean? ("A fine".) Say it once more.

227.2 человек (chelovék) — a person

Before the new one: say the Russian for poems, poetry, then the Russian for a fine.

You'll want to know: человек

человек (*chelovék*) — "a person".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

человек ← Proto-Slavic **čelověkŭ* — inherited. Vasmer reports the usual reading: the first part goes with челядь, "household people", and Sanskrit *kúla-*, "family"; the second with Lithuanian *vaĩkas*, "child, boy". Other accounts he finds less likely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chelovék*
- *Say it: chelovék*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chelovék*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for poems, poetry, then the Russian for a fine, then say *chelovék* again

Before you move on

What does человек mean? ("A person".) Say it once more.

227.3 мужчина (muzhchína) — a man

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fine, then the Russian for a person.

You'll want to know: мужчина

мужчина (*muzhchína*) — "a man".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мужчина is built on муж, "a man, a husband", with -чина, a suffix for persons. муж is a cousin of English *man* (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muzhchína*
- *Say it: muzhchína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muzhchína*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fine, then the Russian for a person, then say *muzhchína* again

Before you move on

What does мужчина mean? ("A man".) Say it once more.

227.4 женщина (zhénshchina) — a woman

Before the new one: say the Russian for a person, then the Russian for a man.

You'll want to know: женщина

женщина (*zhénshchina*) — "a woman".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

женщина is built on жена, "woman, wife", with -щина, a suffix for persons. жена is a cousin of Greek *gynḗ*, "woman".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhénshchina*
- *Say it: zhénshchina*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhénshchina*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a person, then the Russian for a man, then say *zhénshchina* again

Before you move on

What does женщина mean? ("A woman".) Say it once more.

227.5 мальчик (málchik) — a boy

Before the new one: say the Russian for a man, then the Russian for a woman.

You'll want to know: мальчик

мальчик (*málchik*) — "a boy".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мальчик is built on малый, “small”, with the diminutive -чик: “a little one”, a boy.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: málchik*
- *Say it: málchik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *málchik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a man, then the Russian for a woman, then say *málchik* again

Before you move on

What does мальчик mean? (“A boy”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 228

Mistake, Rule, Example, Meaning, First name

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mistake, a rule, an example, a meaning and a first name.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say a mistake, a rule, an example, a meaning and a first name.*

228.1 ошибка (oshíbka) — a mistake

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a woman, then the Russian for a boy.

You'll want to know: ошибка

ошибка (*oshíbka*) — "a mistake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ошибка comes from ошибиться, "to make a mistake", first "to miss, to strike past the target", from шибать, "to strike" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: oshíbka*
- *Say it: oshíbka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *oshíbka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a woman, then the Russian for a boy, then say *oshíbka* again

Before you move on

What does ошибка mean? ("A mistake".) Say it once more.

228.2 правило (právilo) — a rule

Before the new one: say the Russian for a boy, then the Russian for a mistake.

You'll want to know: правило

правило (*právilo*) — "a rule".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

правило is править, "to set straight, to rule", with -ло, a suffix for a tool: "what sets things straight". правый is "straight, right". Vasmer thinks правый probably kin to Latin *probus*, "upright".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: právilo*
- *Say it: právilo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *právilo*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a boy, then the Russian for a mistake, then say *právilo* again

Before you move on

What does правило mean? (“A rule”.) Say it once more.

228.3 пример (primér) — an example

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mistake, then the Russian for a rule.

You’ll want to know: пример

пример (*primér*) — “an example”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пример is при-, “by, against”, with мер, from мера, “a measure”: something to measure against. Vasmer relates мера to Latin *mētior*, “I measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: primér*
- *Say it: primér*, once more
- *Say it:* say *primér*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mistake, then the Russian for a rule, then say *primér* again

Before you move on

What does пример mean? (“An example”.) Say it once more.

228.4 значение (znachéniye) — a meaning

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rule, then the Russian for an example.

You'll want to know: значение

значение (*znachéniye*) — "a meaning".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

значение comes from значить, "to mean", from знак, "a sign", which goes with знать, "to know" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: znachéniye*
- *Say it: znachéniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *znachéniye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rule, then the Russian for an example, then say *znachéniye* again

Before you move on

What does значение mean? ("A meaning".) Say it once more.

228.5 имя (ímya) — a first name

Before the new one: say the Russian for an example, then the Russian for a meaning.

You'll want to know: имя

имя (*ímya*) — "a first name".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

имя ← Proto-Slavic **jьmę* — inherited. Vasmer lists Old Prussian *emmens*, Latin *nōmen*, Gothic *namō* and Old High German *-nuomen*: English *name* is a cousin, from PIE **h₁nómn̥*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ímya*
- *Say it: ímya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ímya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an example, then the Russian for a meaning, then say *ímya* again

Before you move on

What does имя mean? ("A first name".) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

Secretary, Accountant, Manager, Programmer, Lecturer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a secretary, an accountant, a manager, a programmer and a lecturer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say a secretary, an accountant, a manager, a programmer and a lecturer.*

229.1 секретарь (sekretár) — a secretary

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a meaning, then the Russian for a first name.

You'll want to know: секретарь

секретарь (*sekretár*) — "a secretary".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

секретарь — known from 1614; it came through German *Sekretär* or Polish *sekretarz* from Latin *sēcrētārius*, "a keeper of secrets" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sekretár*
- *Say it: sekretár*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sekretár*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a meaning, then the Russian for a first name, then say *sekretár* again

Before you move on

What does секретарь mean? ("A secretary".) Say it once more.

229.2 бухгалтер (bukhgálter) — an accountant

Before the new one: say the Russian for a first name, then the Russian for a secretary.

You'll want to know: бухгалтер

бухгалтер (*bukhgálter*) — "an accountant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бухгалтер — from Peter the Great's time; it comes from German *Buchhalter*, "book-keeper" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bukhgálter*
- *Say it: bukhgálter*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bukhgálter*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a first name, then the Russian for a secretary, then say *bukhgálter* again

Before you move on

What does бухгалтер mean? ("An accountant".) Say it once more.

229.3 менеджер (ménedzher) — a manager

Before the new one: say the Russian for a secretary, then the Russian for an accountant.

You'll want to know: менеджер

менеджер (*ménedzher*) — "a manager".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

менеджер comes from English *manager*, from *manage*, Italian *maneggiare*, "to handle", from Latin *manus*, "hand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ménedzher*
- *Say it: ménedzher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ménedzher*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a secretary, then the Russian for an accountant, then say *ménedzher* again

Before you move on

What does менеджер mean? ("A manager".) Say it once more.

229.4 программист (programmíst) — a programmer

Before the new one: say the Russian for an accountant, then the Russian for a manager.

You'll want to know: программист

программист (*programmíst*) — "a programmer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

программист is программа, "a program", with -ист, "one who works at". программа goes back to Greek *prógramma*, "a public notice", from *prográphein*, "to write before".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: programmíst*
- *Say it: programmíst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *programmíst*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an accountant, then the Russian for a manager, then say *programmíst* again

Before you move on

What does программист mean? ("A programmer".) Say it once more.

229.5 преподаватель (prepodavátel) — a lecturer, a teacher

Before the new one: say the Russian for a manager, then the Russian for a programmer.

You'll want to know: преподаватель

преподаватель (*prepodavátel*) — "a lecturer, a teacher".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

преподаватель is преподавать, “to teach”, with -тель, “one who does it”. The verb is пре- and по- with давать, “to give”. Vasmer takes давать from дать, “to give”, kin to Lithuanian *dovanà*, “a gift”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prepodavátel*
- *Say it: prepodavátel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prepodavátel*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a manager, then the Russian for a programmer, then say *prepodavátel* again

Before you move on

What does преподаватель mean? (“A lecturer, a teacher”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

Gardener, Cashier, Hairdresser, Security guard, Nanny

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a gardener, a cashier, a hairdresser, a security guard and a nanny.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say a gardener, a cashier, a hairdresser, a security guard and a nanny.*

230.1 садовник (sadóvnik) — a gardener

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a programmer, then the Russian for a lecturer.

You'll want to know: садовник

садовник (*sadóvnik*) — "a gardener".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

садовник is сад, "a garden", with -овник, "a person": a gardener. сад comes from садить, "to plant", the "make sit" form of сидеть, "to sit" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sadóvnik*
- *Say it: sadóvnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sadóvnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a programmer, then the Russian for a lecturer, then say *sadóvnik* again

Before you move on

What does садовник mean? ("A gardener".) Say it once more.

230.2 кассир (kassír) — a cashier

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lecturer, then the Russian for a gardener.

You'll want to know: кассир

кассир (*kassír*) — "a cashier".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кассир — older касирер, from Peter the Great's time; it comes from German *Kassierer*, from *Kasse*, "a cash box" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kassír*
- *Say it: kassír*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kassír*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lecturer, then the Russian for a gardener, then say *kassír* again

Before you move on

What does кассир mean? (“A cashier”.) Say it once more.

230.3 парикмахер (parikmákher) — a hairdresser

Before the new one: say the Russian for a gardener, then the Russian for a cashier.

You’ll want to know: парикмахер

парикмахер (*parikmákher*) — “a hairdresser”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

парикмахер comes from German *Perückenmacher*, “wig-maker”, reshaped after парик, “a wig”; older парукмакар came from Dutch *paruikmaker* (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parikmákher*
- *Say it: parikmákher*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parikmákher*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a gardener, then the Russian for a cashier, then say *parikmákher* again

Before you move on

What does парикмахер mean? (“A hairdresser”.) Say it once more.

230.4 охранник (okhránnik) — a security guard

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cashier, then the Russian for a hairdresser.

You'll want to know: охранник

охранник (*okhránnik*) — "a security guard".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

охранник is built on охрана, "a guard", on хранить, "to keep", which Vasmer calls Church Slavonic, beside native хоронить, now "to bury".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: okhránnik*
- *Say it: okhránnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *okhránnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cashier, then the Russian for a hairdresser, then say *okhránnik* again

Before you move on

What does охранник mean? ("A security guard".) Say it once more.

230.5 няня (nyánya) — a nanny

Before the new one: say the Russian for a hairdresser, then the Russian for a security guard.

You'll want to know: няня

няня (*nyánya*) — "a nanny".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

няня is a nursery word, says Vasmer, of uncertain age, like Greek *nánnē*, "aunt", Sanskrit *nanā*, "mummy", and Latin *nonna*, "a nun".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nyánya*
- *Say it: nyánya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nyánya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a hairdresser, then the Russian for a security guard, then say *nyánya* again

Before you move on

What does няня mean? ("A nanny".) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

Kopeck, Rouble, Lecture, Class, Mark

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a kopeck, a rouble, a lecture, a class and a mark.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say a kopeck, a rouble, a lecture, a class and a mark.*

231.1 копейка (kopéyka) — a kopeck

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a security guard, then the Russian for a nanny.

You'll want to know: копейка

копейка (*kopéyka*) — "a kopeck".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

копейка — first a silver coin minted from 1535, showing the ruler on horseback with a spear; Vasmer derives it from копьё, "a spear", and calls a Turkic source less likely.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kopéyka*
- *Say it: kopéyka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kopéyka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a security guard, then the Russian for a nanny, then say *kopéyka* again

Before you move on

What does копейка mean? ("A kopeck".) Say it once more.

231.2 рубль (rubl) — a rouble

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nanny, then the Russian for a kopeck.

You'll want to know: рубль

рубль (*rubl*) — "a rouble".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рубль — Old Russian рубль, "a cut-off piece"; it comes from рубить, "to chop": a piece chopped from a silver ingot (Vasmer). Vasmer rejects the common tie to Sanskrit *rūpya-*, "silver".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rubl*
- *Say it: rubl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rubl*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nanny, then the Russian for a kopeck, then say *rubl* again

Before you move on

What does рубль mean? (“A rouble”.) Say it once more.

231.3 лекция (léktsiya) — a lecture

Before the new one: say the Russian for a kopeck, then the Russian for a rouble.

You’ll want to know: лекция

лекция (*léktsiya*) — “a lecture”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лекция — from Peter the Great’s time; it came through Polish *lekcja* from Latin *lēctiō*, “a reading”, from *legō*, “I read” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: léktsiya*
- *Say it: léktsiya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *léktsiya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a kopeck, then the Russian for a rouble, then say *léktsiya* again

Before you move on

What does лекция mean? (“A lecture”.) Say it once more.

231.4 занятие (zanyátiye) — a class, a lesson

Before the new one: say the Russian for a rouble, then the Russian for a lecture.

You'll want to know: занятие

занятие (*zanyátiye*) — "a class, a lesson".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

занятие comes from занять, "to occupy, to take up", за- with the old verb **jęti*, "to take": an occupation, a class.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zanyátiye*
- *Say it: zanyátiye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zanyátiye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a rouble, then the Russian for a lecture, then say *zanyátiye* again

Before you move on

What does занятие mean? ("A class, a lesson".) Say it once more.

231.5 оценка (otsénka) — a mark, a grade

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lecture, then the Russian for a class.

You'll want to know: оценка

оценка (*otsénka*) — "a mark, a grade".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

оценка comes from оценить, "to assess", from цена, "a price, a value" (Vasmer relates цена to Greek *poinḗ*, "a penalty").

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otsénka*
- *Say it: otsénka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otsénka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lecture, then the Russian for a class, then say *otsénka* again

Before you move on

What does оценка mean? ("A mark, a grade".) Say it once more.

231.6 Words from chapters 227-228 — a first pass

Say the words for a class and a mark.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a fine, a person, a man, a woman, a boy
- a mistake, a rule, an example, a meaning, a first name

Before you move on

A fine? (штраф.) A person? (человек.) A man? (мужчина.) A woman? (женщина.) A boy? (мальчик.) A mistake? (ошибка.) A rule? (правило.) An example? (пример.) A meaning? (значение.) A first name? (имя.)

231.7 Words from chapters 229-231 — a second pass

Say the words for a secretary and an accountant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a secretary, an accountant, a manager, a programmer, a lecturer
- a gardener, a cashier, a hairdresser, a security guard, a nanny
- a kopeck, a rouble, a lecture, a class, a mark

Before you move on

A secretary? (секретарь.) An accountant? (бухгалтер.) A manager? (менеджер.) A programmer? (программист.) A lecturer? (преподаватель.) A gardener? (садовник.) A cashier? (кассир.) A hairdresser? (парикмахер.) A security guard? (охранник.) A nanny? (няня.) A kopeck? (копейка.) A rouble? (рубль.) A lecture? (лекция.) A class? (занятие.) A mark? (оценка.)

Chapter 232

To save up, To borrow, To ring, To send, To receive

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to save up, to borrow, to ring, to send and to receive.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say to save up, to borrow, to ring, to send and to receive.*

232.1 копить (kopít) — to save up

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a class, a lesson, then the Russian for a mark, a grade.

You'll want to know: копить

копить (*kopít*) — "to save up".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

копить comes from копа, "a heap, a stack" (Vasmer), which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *kõpti*, "to rake together".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kopít*
- *Say it: kopít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kopít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a class, a lesson, then the Russian for a mark, a grade, then say *kopít* again

Before you move on

What does копить mean? ("To save up".) Say it once more.

232.2 занимать (zanimát) — to borrow; to take up (space)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mark, a grade, then the Russian for to save up.

You'll want to know: занимать

занимать (*zanimát*) — "to borrow; to take up (space)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

занимать is за- with -нимать, from the old verb **jęti*, "to take": to take up space, or to take money as a loan.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zanimát*
- *Say it: zanimát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zanimát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mark, a grade, then the Russian for to save up, then say *zanimát* again

Before you move on

What does **занимать** mean? (“To borrow; to take up (space)”.) Say it once more.

232.3 звонить (zvonít) — to ring, to phone

Before the new one: say the Russian for to save up, then the Russian for to borrow; to take up.

You’ll want to know: звонить

звонить (*zvonít*) — “to ring, to phone”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

звонить comes from **звон**, “a ringing”, Proto-Slavic **zvonŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Albanian *zë*, “voice”, and Armenian *jayn*, “voice”, and a variant root in Latin *sonus*, “sound”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zvonít*
- *Say it: zvonít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zvonít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to save up, then the Russian for to borrow; to take up, then say *zvonít* again

Before you move on

What does **звонить** mean? (“To ring, to phone”.) Say it once more.

232.4 отправлять (otpravlyát) — to send

Before the new one: say the Russian for to borrow; to take up, then the Russian for to ring.

You'll want to know: отправлять

отправлять (*otpravlyát*) — "to send".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отправлять is от-, "off, away", with -правлять, from править, "to direct, to steer", on правый, "straight": to send is to direct off.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otpravlyát*
- *Say it: otpravlyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otpravlyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to borrow; to take up, then the Russian for to ring, then say *otpravlyát* again

Before you move on

What does отправлять mean? ("To send".) Say it once more.

232.5 получать (poluchát) — to receive, to get

Before the new one: say the Russian for to ring, then the Russian for to send.

You'll want to know: получать

получать (*poluchát*) — "to receive, to get".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

получать is по- with -лучать, from лучить, “to hit upon”, the root of случиться, “to happen” (Vasmer): to receive is to come upon.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poluchát*
- *Say it: poluchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poluchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to ring, then the Russian for to send, then say *poluchát* again

Before you move on

What does получать mean? (“To receive, to get”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 233

To decide, To choose, To change, To show, To bring

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to decide, to choose, to change, to show and to bring.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say to decide, to choose, to change, to show and to bring.*

233.1 решать (reshát) — to decide; to solve

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to send, then the Russian for to receive.

You'll want to know: решать

решать (*reshát*) — "to decide; to solve".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

решать is the ongoing partner of решить, "to decide", first "to untie, to loosen". Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *rìšti*, "to tie", and *raišýti*, "to tie, untie": deciding unties a knot.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reshát*
- *Say it: reshát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *reshát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to send, then the Russian for to receive, then say *reshát* again

Before you move on

What does решать mean? ("To decide; to solve".) Say it once more.

233.2 выбирать (vybirát) — to choose

Before the new one: say the Russian for to receive, then the Russian for to decide; to solve.

You'll want to know: выбирать

выбирать (*vybirát*) — "to choose".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

выбирать is вы-, "out", with -бирать, from брать, "to take": to choose is to take one out.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vybirát*
- *Say it: vybirát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vybirát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to receive, then the Russian for to decide; to solve, then say *vybirát* again

Before you move on

What does выбирать mean? (“To choose”.) Say it once more.

233.3 менять (menyát) — to change

Before the new one: say the Russian for to decide; to solve, then the Russian for to choose.

You’ll want to know: менять

менять (*menyát*) — “to change”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

менять ← Old Russian меняти, менити — inherited. Vasmer compares Lithuanian *mainýti*, “to exchange”, and Latvian *maĩnît*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: menyát*
- *Say it: menyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *menyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to decide; to solve, then the Russian for to choose, then say *menyát* again

Before you move on

What does менять mean? (“To change”.) Say it once more.

233.4 показывать (pokázyvat) — to show

Before the new one: say the Russian for to choose, then the Russian for to change.

You'll want to know: показывать

показывать (*pokázyvat*) — "to show".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

показывать is по- with -казывать, from казать, "to show".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pokázyvat*
- *Say it: pokázyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pokázyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to choose, then the Russian for to change, then say *pokázyvat* again

Before you move on

What does показывать mean? ("To show".) Say it once more.

233.5 приносить (prinosít) — to bring

Before the new one: say the Russian for to change, then the Russian for to show.

You'll want to know: приносить

приносить (*prinosít*) — "to bring".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

приносить is при-, "to, toward", with носить, "to carry": to carry to someone. Носить goes with нести, "to carry", which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *nèšti*, "to carry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prinosít*
- *Say it: prinosít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prinosít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to change, then the Russian for to show, then say *prinosít* again

Before you move on

What does приносить mean? ("To bring".) Say it once more.

Chapter 234

To sweep, To plant, To water, To grow, To feed

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to sweep, to plant, to water, to grow and to feed.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say to sweep, to plant, to water, to grow and to feed.*

234.1 подметать (podmetát) — to sweep

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to show, then the Russian for to bring.

You'll want to know: подметать

подметать (*podmetát*) — "to sweep".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подметать is под-, "under", with -метать, the ongoing partner of мести, "to sweep": to sweep up. Vasmer relates мести to метать, "to throw".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podmetát*
- *Say it: podmetát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podmetát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to show, then the Russian for to bring, then say *podmetát* again

Before you move on

What does подметать mean? ("To sweep".) Say it once more.

234.2 сажать (sazhát) — to plant

Before the new one: say the Russian for to bring, then the Russian for to sweep.

You'll want to know: сажать

сажать (*sazhát*) — "to plant".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сажать goes with садить, "to seat, to plant" (Vasmer), the "make sit" form of сидеть, "to sit": a planted seedling is set to sit in the ground.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sazhát*
- *Say it: sazhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sazhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to bring, then the Russian for to sweep, then say *sazhát* again

Before you move on

What does сажать mean? (“To plant”.) Say it once more.

234.3 поливать (polivát) — to water

Before the new one: say the Russian for to sweep, then the Russian for to plant.

You’ll want to know: поливать

поливать (*polivát*) — “to water”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поливать is по- with -ливать, from лить, “to pour”: to pour over. лить is a cousin of Lithuanian *líeti*, “to pour” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: polivát*
- *Say it: polivát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *polivát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to sweep, then the Russian for to plant, then say *polivát* again

Before you move on

What does поливать mean? (“To water”.) Say it once more.

234.4 расти (rastí) — to grow

Before the new one: say the Russian for to plant, then the Russian for to water.

You'll want to know: расти

расти (*rastí*) — "to grow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

расти ← Proto-Slavic **orsti*, "to grow" — inherited, but its а is Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of native росте. Vasmer reports comparisons with Greek *órnymi*, "I stir", and Latin *orior*, "I rise".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rastí*
- *Say it: rastí*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rastí*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to plant, then the Russian for to water, then say *rastí* again

Before you move on

What does расти mean? ("To grow".) Say it once more.

234.5 кормить (kormít) — to feed

Before the new one: say the Russian for to water, then the Russian for to grow.

You'll want to know: кормить

кормить (*kormít*) — "to feed".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кормить comes from корм, "fodder, food" (Vasmer), which Vasmer compares with Irish *cuirm*, "beer", and Gaulish *kourmi*, a kind of beer.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kormít*
- *Say it: kormít*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kormít*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to water, then the Russian for to grow, then say *kormít* again

Before you move on

What does кормить mean? ("To feed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

To shout, To whisper, To be silent, To smile, To be angry

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to shout, to whisper, to be silent, to smile and to be angry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say to shout, to whisper, to be silent, to smile and to be angry.*

235.1 кричать (krichát) — to shout

> Before the new one: say the Russian for to grow, then the Russian for to feed.

You'll want to know: кричать

кричать (*krichát*) — "to shout".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кричать comes from крик, "a cry" (Vasmer), a cousin of Lithuanian *krỹkti*, "to shriek".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krichát*
- *Say it: krichát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krichát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to grow, then the Russian for to feed, then say *krichát* again

Before you move on

What does кричать mean? ("To shout".) Say it once more.

235.2 шептать (sheptát) — to whisper

Before the new one: say the Russian for to feed, then the Russian for to shout.

You'll want to know: шептать

шептать (*sheptát*) — "to whisper".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шептать ← Proto-Slavic **šĭpŭtati* — a sound-imitating word, like шепелявый, "lisping" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sheptát*
- *Say it: sheptát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sheptát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to feed, then the Russian for to shout, then say *sheptát* again

Before you move on

What does шептать mean? ("To whisper".) Say it once more.

235.3 молчать (molchát) — to be silent

Before the new one: say the Russian for to shout, then the Russian for to whisper.

You'll want to know: молчать

молчать (*molchát*) — "to be silent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молчать ← Proto-Slavic **mьlčati* — inherited. Vasmer says its relatives are not reliably established; comparisons with Old High German *molawên*, "to soften", and Greek *malakós*, "soft", have been made.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: molchát*
- *Say it: molchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *molchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to shout, then the Russian for to whisper, then say *molchát* again

Before you move on

What does молчать mean? ("To be silent".) Say it once more.

235.4 улыбаться (ulybátsya) — to smile

Before the new one: say the Russian for to whisper, then the Russian for to be silent.

You'll want to know: улыбаться

улыбаться (*ulybátsya*) — "to smile".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

улыбаться is у- with dialect лыбить, "to smile", and -ся. Vasmer calls лыбить unclear and finds the proposed links unconvincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ulybátsya*
- *Say it: ulybátsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ulybátsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to whisper, then the Russian for to be silent, then say *ulybátsya* again

Before you move on

What does улыбаться mean? ("To smile".) Say it once more.

235.5 сердиться (serdítsya) — to be angry

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be silent, then the Russian for to smile.

You'll want to know: сердиться

сердиться (*serdítsya*) — "to be angry".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сердиться goes with сердце, “heart”, the seat of anger (Vasmer); Lithuanian *širdaĩ*, “a quarrel”, is built on *širdìs*, “heart”, in the same way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: serdítsya*
- *Say it: serdítsya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *serdítsya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be silent, then the Russian for to smile, then say *serdítsya* again

Before you move on

What does сердиться mean? (“To be angry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

To count, To measure, To compare, To check, To fill in

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to count, to measure, to compare, to check and to fill in.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say to count, to measure, to compare, to check and to fill in.

236.1 считать (schitát) — to count; to consider

Before the new one: say the Russian for to smile, then the Russian for to be angry.

You'll want to know: считать

считать (*schitát*) — "to count; to consider".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

считать is с- with читать, "to read", which once meant "to count", as in число, "a number". Vasmer links читать with an old Slavic verb meaning "to count, to honour".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: schitát*
- *Say it: schitát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *schitát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to smile, then the Russian for to be angry, then say *schitát* again

Before you move on

What does считать mean? (“To count; to consider”.) Say it once more.

236.2 измерять (izmeryát) — to measure

Before the new one: say the Russian for to be angry, then the Russian for to count; to consider.

You’ll want to know: измерять

измерять (*izmeryát*) — “to measure”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

измерять is из-, “out, through”, with мерять, from мера, “a measure”, which Vasmer relates to Latin *mētior*, “I measure”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: izmeryát*
- *Say it: izmeryát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *izmeryát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to be angry, then the Russian for to count; to consider, then say *izmeryát* again

Before you move on

What does измерять mean? (“To measure”.) Say it once more.

236.3 сравнивать (srávnivat) — to compare

Before the new one: say the Russian for to count; to consider, then the Russian for to measure.

You’ll want to know: сравнивать

сравнивать (*srávnivat*) — “to compare”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сравнивать is с- with -равнивать, from равный, “equal”, the Church Slavonic shape of ровный, “level”: to compare is to set things level.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: srávnivat*
- *Say it: srávnivat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *srávnivat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to count; to consider, then the Russian for to measure, then say *srávnivat* again

Before you move on

What does сравнивать mean? (“To compare”.) Say it once more.

236.4 проверять (proveryát) — to check

Before the new one: say the Russian for to measure, then the Russian for to compare.

You'll want to know: проверять

проверять (*proveryát*) — "to check".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

проверять is про-, "through", with -верять, from вера, "trust, faith": to check is to test whether a thing can be trusted.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proveryát*
- *Say it: proveryát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proveryát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to measure, then the Russian for to compare, then say *proveryát* again

Before you move on

What does проверять mean? ("To check".) Say it once more.

236.5 заполнять (zapolnyát) — to fill in

Before the new one: say the Russian for to compare, then the Russian for to check.

You'll want to know: заполнять

заполнять (*zapolnyát*) — "to fill in".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

заполнять is за- with -полнять, from полный, "full": to fill in.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zapolnyát*
- *Say it: zapolnyát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zapolnyát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to compare, then the Russian for to check, then say *zapolnyát* again

Before you move on

What does заполнять mean? (“To fill in”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

To die, To knock, To renovate, To move, To earn

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say to die, to knock, to renovate, to move and to earn.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say to die, to knock, to renovate, to move and to earn.

237.1 умирать (umirát) — to die

Before the new one: say the Russian for to check, then the Russian for to fill in.

You'll want to know: умирать

умирать (*umirát*) — "to die".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

умирать is у- with -мирать, from мереть, "to die", Proto-Slavic **merti*, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *mìrti* and Latin *morī*, "to die".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: umirát*
- *Say it: umirát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *umirát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to check, then the Russian for to fill in, then say *umirát* again

Before you move on

What does умирать mean? (“To die”.) Say it once more.

237.2 стучать (stuchát) — to knock

Before the new one: say the Russian for to fill in, then the Russian for to die.

You’ll want to know: стучать

стучать (*stuchát*) — “to knock”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

стучать comes from стук, “a knock” (Vasmer), which he compares with sound words like Czech *ťukati*, “to tap”, and French *toc*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stuchát*
- *Say it: stuchát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stuchát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to fill in, then the Russian for to die, then say *stuchát* again

Before you move on

What does стучать mean? (“To knock”.) Say it once more.

237.3 ремонтировать (remontírovat) — to renovate, to repair

Before the new one: say the Russian for to die, then the Russian for to knock.

You’ll want to know: ремонтировать

ремонтировать (*remontírovat*) — “to renovate, to repair”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ремонтировать is ремонт, “repair”, made into a verb. ремонт comes from French *remonte*, “a fresh supply of horses” (Vasmer); under Peter the Great it meant supplying horses to regiments.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: remontírovat*
- *Say it: remontírovat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *remontírovat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to die, then the Russian for to knock, then say *remontírovat* again

Before you move on

What does ремонтировать mean? (“To renovate, to repair”.) Say it once more.

237.4 переезжать (pereyezzhát) — to move (house)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to knock, then the Russian for to renovate.

You'll want to know: переезжать

переезжать (*pereyezzhát*) — "to move (house)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

переезжать is пере-, "across", with -езжать, from ездить, "to travel": to move from one home to another.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pereyezzhát*
- *Say it: pereyezzhát*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pereyezzhát*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to knock, then the Russian for to renovate, then say *pereyezzhát* again

Before you move on

What does переезжать mean? ("To move (house)".) Say it once more.

237.5 зарабатывать (zarabátyvat) — to earn

Before the new one: say the Russian for to renovate, then the Russian for to move.

You'll want to know: зарабатывать

зарабатывать (*zarabátyvat*) — "to earn".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зарабатывать is за- with -рабатывать, from работать, "to work": to earn is to get by working.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zarabátyvat*
- *Say it: zarabátyvat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zarabátyvat*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to renovate, then the Russian for to move, then say *zarabátyvat* again

Before you move on

What does зарабатывать mean? ("To earn".) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

Ointment, Drops, Thermometer, Clinic, Ambulance

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say an ointment, drops, a thermometer, a clinic and an ambulance.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say an ointment, drops, a thermometer, a clinic and an ambulance.

238.1 мазь (maz) — an ointment

Before the new one: say the Russian for to move, then the Russian for to earn.

You'll want to know: мазь

мазь (*maz*) — "an ointment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

мазь comes from мазать, "to smear" (Vasmer): what is smeared on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maz*
- *Say it: maz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maz*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to move, then the Russian for to earn, then say *maz* again

Before you move on

What does мазь mean? (“An ointment”.) Say it once more.

238.2 капли (kápli) — drops (medicine)

Before the new one: say the Russian for to earn, then the Russian for an ointment.

You’ll want to know: капли

капли (*kápli*) — “drops (medicine)”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

капли is the plural of капля, “a drop”, from капать, “to drip” (Vasmer); Berneker took the word as sound-imitation.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kápli*
- *Say it: kápli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kápli*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for to earn, then the Russian for an ointment, then say *kápli* again

Before you move on

What does капли mean? ("Drops (medicine)".) Say it once more.

238.3 термометр (termómetr) — a thermometer

Before the new one: say the Russian for an ointment, then the Russian for drops.

You'll want to know: термометр

термометр (*termómetr*) — "a thermometer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

термометр is an international coinage from Greek *thermós*, "warm", and *métron*, "measure". *thermós* is a cousin of Russian жар, "heat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: termómetr*
- *Say it: termómetr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *termómetr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an ointment, then the Russian for drops, then say *termómetr* again

Before you move on

What does термометр mean? ("A thermometer".) Say it once more.

238.4 поликлиника (poliklínika) — a clinic

Before the new one: say the Russian for drops, then the Russian for a thermometer.

You'll want to know: поликлиника

поликлиника (*poliklínika*) — "a clinic".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

поликлиника is an international coinage: Greek *polýs*, "many", or *pólis*, "city", with *klinikḗ*, "medicine at the bedside", from *klínē*, "a bed".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: poliklínika*
- *Say it: poliklínika*, once more
- *Say it:* say *poliklínika*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for drops, then the Russian for a thermometer, then say *poliklínika* again

Before you move on

What does поликлиника mean? ("A clinic".) Say it once more.

238.5 скорая помощь (skóraya pómoshch) — an ambulance

Before the new one: say the Russian for a thermometer, then the Russian for a clinic.

You'll want to know: скорая помощь

скорая помощь (*skóraya pómoshch*) — "an ambulance".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

скорая помощь is "quick help": скорая, "quick", with помощь, "help", from мочь, "might".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skóraya pómoshch*
- *Say it: skóraya pómoshch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skóraya pómoshch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a thermometer, then the Russian for a clinic, then say *skóraya pómoshch* again

Before you move on

What does скорая помощь mean? ("An ambulance".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

Weight, Height, Eyebrow, Eyelash, Forehead

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say weight, height, an eyebrow, an eyelash and a forehead.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say weight, height, an eyebrow, an eyelash and a forehead.

239.1 вес (ves) — weight

Before the new one: say the Russian for a clinic, then the Russian for an ambulance.

You'll want to know: вес

вес (*ves*) — "weight".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

вес goes with висеть, "to hang" (Vasmer), as Latin *pondus*, "weight", goes with *pendēre*, "to hang": weight is what hangs on the scales.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ves*
- *Say it: ves*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ves*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a clinic, then the Russian for an ambulance, then say *ves* again

Before you move on

What does вес mean? ("Weight".) Say it once more.

239.2 рост (rost) — height

Before the new one: say the Russian for an ambulance, then the Russian for weight.

You'll want to know: рост

рост (*rost*) — "height".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

рост ← Proto-Slavic **orstŭ*, "growth" — inherited; Old Church Slavonic has *rastŭ*, "growth". Vasmer thinks it most likely comes from **ord-to-*, related to Latin *arduus*, "high, steep", and Irish *ard*, "high".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rost*
- *Say it: rost*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rost*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an ambulance, then the Russian for weight, then say *rost* again

Before you move on

What does рост mean? ("Height".) Say it once more.

239.3 бровь (brov) — an eyebrow

Before the new one: say the Russian for weight, then the Russian for height.

You'll want to know: бровь

бровь (*brov*) — "an eyebrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бровь ← Proto-Slavic **bråvь* — inherited. Vasmer lists Lithuanian *bruvìs*, Sanskrit *bhrū-*, Greek *ophrŷs* and Old English *brū*: English *brow* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: brov*
- *Say it: brov*, once more
- *Say it:* say *brov*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for weight, then the Russian for height, then say *brov* again

Before you move on

What does бровь mean? ("An eyebrow".) Say it once more.

239.4 ресница (resnítsa) — an eyelash

Before the new one: say the Russian for height, then the Russian for an eyebrow.

You'll want to know: ресница

ресница (*resnítsa*) — "an eyelash".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ресница — Old Russian рясница; it comes from ряса, "a fringe", which Vasmer thinks probably goes with ряд, "a row".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: resnítsa*
- *Say it: resnítsa*, once more
- *Say it:* say *resnítsa*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for height, then the Russian for an eyebrow, then say *resnítsa* again

Before you move on

What does ресница mean? ("An eyelash".) Say it once more.

239.5 лоб (lob) — a forehead

Before the new one: say the Russian for an eyebrow, then the Russian for an eyelash.

You'll want to know: лоб

лоб (*lob*) — "a forehead".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

лоб ← Proto-Slavic **lobъ́* — inherited. It has been compared with Greek *lóphos*, "the back of the neck, a crest", and Tocharian *lap*, "skull" (Vasmer); Berneker rejected the Greek link.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lob*
- *Say it: lob*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lob*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an eyebrow, then the Russian for an eyelash, then say *lob* again

Before you move on

What does лоб mean? ("A forehead".) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

November, December, Season, At once, Usually

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say November, December, a season, at once and usually.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say November, December, a season, at once and usually.

240.1 ноябрь (noyábr) — November

Before the new one: say the Russian for an eyelash, then the Russian for a forehead.

You'll want to know: ноябрь

ноябрь (*noyábr*) — "November".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ноябрь — Old Russian ноябрь; it came through Byzantine Greek *noémbrios* from Latin *november*, "the ninth month" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *noyábr*
- *Say it:* *noyábr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *noyábr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an eyelash, then the Russian for a forehead, then say *noyábr* again

Before you move on

What does ноябрь mean? (“November”.) Say it once more.

240.2 декабрь (dekábr) — December

Before the new one: say the Russian for a forehead, then the Russian for November.

You’ll want to know: декабрь

декабрь (*dekábr*) — “December”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

декабрь — Old Russian декябрь; it came through Byzantine Greek *dekémbrios* from Latin *december*, “the tenth month” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dekábr*
- *Say it:* *dekábr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dekábr*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a forehead, then the Russian for November, then say *dekábr* again

Before you move on

What does декабрь mean? (“December”.) Say it once more.

240.3 сезон (sezón) — a season

Before the new one: say the Russian for November, then the Russian for December.

You’ll want to know: сезон

сезон (*sezón*) — “a season”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сезон comes from French *saison*, “season”, from Latin *satiō*, *satiōnem*, “a sowing; sowing time” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sezón*
- *Say it: sezón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sezón*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for November, then the Russian for December, then say *sezón* again

Before you move on

What does сезон mean? (“A season”.) Say it once more.

240.4 сразу (srázu) — at once

Before the new one: say the Russian for December, then the Russian for a season.

You'll want to know: сразу

сразу (*srázu*) — "at once".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сразу is с, "from", with разу, a form of раз, "one time", which first meant "a blow" and goes with резать, "to cut" (Vasmer): "at one stroke".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *srázu*
- *Say it:* *srázu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *srázu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for December, then the Russian for a season, then say *srázu* again

Before you move on

What does сразу mean? ("At once".) Say it once more.

240.5 обычно (obýchno) — usually

Before the new one: say the Russian for a season, then the Russian for at once.

You'll want to know: обычно

обычно (*obýchno*) — "usually".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

обычно is the adverb of обычный, "usual", from обычай, "a custom", built from **ob-vyčajь*, on the root of привыкнуть, "to get used to" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: obýchno*
- *Say it: obýchno*, once more
- *Say it:* say *obýchno*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a season, then the Russian for at once, then say *obýchno* again

Before you move on

What does обычно mean? ("Usually".) Say it once more.

240.6 Words from chapters 232-235 — a first pass

Say the words for at once and usually.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to save up, to borrow; to take up, to ring, to send, to receive
- to decide; to solve, to choose, to change, to show, to bring
- to sweep, to plant, to water, to grow, to feed
- to shout, to whisper, to be silent, to smile, to be angry

Before you move on

To save up? (копить.) To borrow; to take up? (занимать.) To ring? (звонить.) To send? (отправлять.) To receive? (получать.) To decide; to solve? (решать.) To choose? (выбирать.) To change? (менять.) To show? (показывать.) To bring? (приносить.) To sweep? (подметать.) To plant?

(сажать.) To water? (поливать.) To grow? (расти.) To feed? (кормить.) To shout? (кричать.) To whisper? (шептать.) To be silent? (молчать.) To smile? (улыбаться.) To be angry? (сердиться.)

240.7 Words from chapters 236-240 — a second pass

Say the words for to count; to consider and to measure.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to count; to consider, to measure, to compare, to check, to fill in
- to die, to knock, to renovate, to move, to earn
- an ointment, drops, a thermometer, a clinic, an ambulance
- weight, height, an eyebrow, an eyelash, a forehead
- November, December, a season, at once, usually

Before you move on

To count; to consider? (считать.) To measure? (измерять.) To compare? (сравнивать.) To check? (проверять.) To fill in? (заполнять.) To die? (умирать.) To knock? (стучать.) To renovate? (ремонтировать.) To move? (переезжать.) To earn? (зарабатывать.) An ointment? (мазь.) Drops? (капли.) A thermometer? (термометр.) A clinic? (поликлиника.) An ambulance? (скорая помощь.) Weight? (вес.) Height? (рост.) An eyebrow? (бровь.) An eyelash? (ресница.) A forehead? (лоб.) November? (ноябрь.) December? (декабрь.) A season? (сезон.) At once? (сразу.) Usually? (обычно.)

Chapter 241

Basement, Balcony, Yard, Opposite, Between

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a basement, a balcony, a yard, opposite and between.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say a basement, a balcony, a yard, opposite and between.

241.1 подвал (podvál) — a basement, a cellar

Before the new one: say the Russian for at once, then the Russian for usually.

You'll want to know: подвал

подвал (*podvál*) — "a basement, a cellar".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

подвал is под, "under", with вал, "a rampart, an earth bank", which Vasmer thinks came through Polish from German *Wall*, Latin *vallum*: a room under the house.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: podvál*
- *Say it: podvál*, once more
- *Say it:* say *podvál*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for at once, then the Russian for usually, then say *podvál* again

Before you move on

What does подвал mean? ("A basement, a cellar".) Say it once more.

241.2 балкон (balkón) — a balcony

Before the new one: say the Russian for usually, then the Russian for a basement.

You'll want to know: балкон

балкон (*balkón*) — "a balcony".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

балкон — known from 1725; it came from German *Balkon* or French *balcon*, from Italian *balcone*, which goes back to Lombardic and Old High German *balko*, "a beam" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: balkón*
- *Say it: balkón*, once more
- *Say it:* say *balkón*

- *Recall:* say the Russian for usually, then the Russian for a basement, then say *balkón* again

Before you move on

What does балкон mean? (“A balcony”.) Say it once more.

241.3 двор (dvor) — a yard, a courtyard

Before the new one: say the Russian for a basement, then the Russian for a balcony.

You’ll want to know: двор

двор (*dvor*) — “a yard, a courtyard”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

двор ← Proto-Slavic **dvorŭ* — inherited, with дверь, “door” (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Latvian *dvars*, “a gate”, and Sanskrit *dvāra-*, “gate”: a yard is the space inside the gate.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dvor*
- *Say it: dvor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dvor*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a basement, then the Russian for a balcony, then say *dvor* again

Before you move on

What does двор mean? (“A yard, a courtyard”.) Say it once more.

241.4 напротив (naprótiv) — opposite

Before the new one: say the Russian for a balcony, then the Russian for a yard.

You'll want to know: напротив

напротив (*naprótiv*) — "opposite".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

напротив is на, "on", with против, "against", Proto-Slavic **protivŭ*, from **proti*, which Vasmer relates to Latvian *pretī*, "towards, opposite".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naprótiv*
- *Say it: naprótiv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naprótiv*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a balcony, then the Russian for a yard, then say *naprótiv* again

Before you move on

What does напротив mean? ("Opposite".) Say it once more.

241.5 между (mézhdu) — between

Before the new one: say the Russian for a yard, then the Russian for opposite.

You'll want to know: между

между (*mézhdu*) — "between".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

между — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, beside native межу, from межа, "a boundary strip". Vasmer relates межа to Sanskrit *mádhya-*, Greek *mésos* and Latin *medius*, "middle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mézhdu*
- *Say it: mézhdu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mézhdu*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a yard, then the Russian for opposite, then say *mézhdu* again

Before you move on

What does между mean? ("Between".) Say it once more.

Chapter 242

Library, University, Café, Zoo, Circus

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a library, a university, a café, a zoo and a circus.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say a library, a university, a café, a zoo and a circus.

242.1 библиотека (bibliotéka) — a library

Before the new one: say the Russian for opposite, then the Russian for between.

You'll want to know: библиотека

библиотека (*bibliotéka*) — "a library".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

библиотека — from Peter the Great's time; it came through Polish *biblioteka* from Latin *bibliothēca*, Greek *bibliothḗkē*, "a store of books" (Vasmer). Older Russian borrowed the Greek word as вивлиофика.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bibliotéka*
- *Say it: bibliotéka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bibliotéka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for opposite, then the Russian for between, then say *bibliotéka* again

Before you move on

What does библиотека mean? ("A library".) Say it once more.

242.2 университет (universitét) — a university

Before the new one: say the Russian for between, then the Russian for a library.

You'll want to know: университет

университет (*universitét*) — "a university".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

университет — the first was in Moscow in 1755; it came through German *Universität* from Latin *ūniversitās (litterārum)*, "the whole body (of learning)" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: universitét*
- *Say it: universitét*, once more
- *Say it:* say *universitét*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for between, then the Russian for a library, then say *universitét* again

Before you move on

What does университет mean? ("A university".) Say it once more.

242.3 кафе (kafé) — a café

Before the new one: say the Russian for a library, then the Russian for a university.

You'll want to know: кафе

кафе (*kafé*) — "a café".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кафе comes from French *café* or German *Kaffee*, "coffee" (Vasmer), a word that goes back through Turkish *kahve* to Arabic *qahwa*. A café is a coffee house.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kafé*
- *Say it: kafé*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kafé*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a library, then the Russian for a university, then say *kafé* again

Before you move on

What does кафе mean? ("A café".) Say it once more.

242.4 зоопарк (zoopárk) — a zoo

Before the new one: say the Russian for a university, then the Russian for a café.

You'll want to know: зоопарк

зоопарк (*zoopárk*) — "a zoo".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

зоопарк is зоо-, from Greek *zôion*, "an animal", with парк, "a park", from French *parc*, "an enclosure".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *zoopárk*
- *Say it:* *zoopárk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zoopárk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a university, then the Russian for a café, then say *zoopárk* again

Before you move on

What does зоопарк mean? ("A zoo".) Say it once more.

242.5 цирк (tsirk) — a circus

Before the new one: say the Russian for a café, then the Russian for a zoo.

You'll want to know: цирк

цирк (*tsirk*) — "a circus".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

цирк probably came through German *Zirkus* from Latin *circus*, "a ring, a circle" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tsirk*
- *Say it: tsirk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tsirk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a café, then the Russian for a zoo, then say *tsirk* again

Before you move on

What does цирк mean? ("A circus".) Say it once more.

Chapter 243

Young, Elderly, Tall, Low, Ugly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say young, elderly, tall, low and ugly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say young, elderly, tall, low and ugly.*

243.1 молодой (molodóy) — young

Before the new one: say the Russian for a zoo, then the Russian for a circus.

You'll want to know: молодой

молодой (*molodóy*) — "young".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

молодой ← Proto-Slavic **moldŭ* — inherited; Church Slavonic has младой, "young". Vasmer relates it to Old Prussian *maldai*, "youths", Sanskrit *mṛdú-*, "soft", and Latin *mollis*, "soft".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: molodóy*
- *Say it: molodóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *molodóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a zoo, then the Russian for a circus, then say *molodóy* again

Before you move on

What does молодой mean? ("Young".) Say it once more.

243.2 пожилой (pozhilóy) — elderly

Before the new one: say the Russian for a circus, then the Russian for young.

You'll want to know: пожилой

пожилой (*pozhilóy*) — "elderly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

пожилой is по- with жилой, from жить, "to live": one who has lived a good while.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pozhilóy*
- *Say it: pozhilóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pozhilóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a circus, then the Russian for young, then say *pozhilóy* again

Before you move on

What does пожилой mean? ("Elderly".) Say it once more.

243.3 высокий (vysókiy) — tall, high

Before the new one: say the Russian for young, then the Russian for elderly.

You'll want to know: высокий

высокий (*vysókiy*) — "tall, high".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

высокий ← Proto-Slavic **vysokŭ* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Greek *hypsēlós*, "high", Old Irish *uasal*, "high", and Gaulish *Uxello-*, "high", in place names.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vysókiy*
- *Say it: vysókiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vysókiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for young, then the Russian for elderly, then say *vysókiy* again

Before you move on

What does высокий mean? ("Tall, high".) Say it once more.

243.4 низкий (nízkiy) — low, short

Before the new one: say the Russian for elderly, then the Russian for tall.

You'll want to know: низкий

низкий (*nízkiy*) — "low, short".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

низкий comes from низ, "the bottom" (Vasmer), which Vasmer explains from the PIE **ni*, "down".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nízkiy*
- *Say it: nízkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nízkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for elderly, then the Russian for tall, then say *nízkiy* again

Before you move on

What does низкий mean? ("Low, short".) Say it once more.

243.5 некрасивый (nekrasívyy) — ugly

Before the new one: say the Russian for tall, then the Russian for low.

You'll want to know: некрасивый

некрасивый (*nekrasívyy*) — "ugly".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

некрасивый is не, "not", with красивый, "beautiful", from краса, "beauty".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nekrasívyy*
- *Say it: nekrasívyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nekrasívyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tall, then the Russian for low, then say *nekrasívyy* again

Before you move on

What does некрасивый mean? ("Ugly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

Ancient, Loud, Bright, Dark, Light

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ancient, loud, bright, dark and light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say ancient, loud, bright, dark and light.*

244.1 древний (drévniy) — ancient

Before the new one: say the Russian for low, then the Russian for ugly.

You'll want to know: древний

древний (*drévniy*) — "ancient".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

древний — Old Church Slavonic древьнь, "ancient", with the Church Slavonic -ре-. Vasmer derives it, with a "perhaps", from **drewos*, compare Gothic *triggws*, "faithful", and Lithuanian *drẽvė*, "a hollow tree".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: drévniy*
- *Say it: drévniy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *drévniy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for low, then the Russian for ugly, then say *drévniy* again

Before you move on

What does древний mean? ("Ancient".) Say it once more.

244.2 громкий (grómkiy) — loud

Before the new one: say the Russian for ugly, then the Russian for ancient.

You'll want to know: громкий

громкий (*grómkiy*) — "loud".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

громкий comes from гром, "thunder" (Vasmer): loud as thunder.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grómkiy*
- *Say it: grómkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grómkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ugly, then the Russian for ancient, then say *grómkiy* again

Before you move on

What does громкий mean? (“Loud”.) Say it once more.

244.3 яркий (yárkiy) — bright

Before the new one: say the Russian for ancient, then the Russian for loud.

You’ll want to know: яркий

яркий (*yárkiy*) — “bright”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

яркий goes with ярый, “fierce, fiery” (Vasmer), Proto-Slavic **jarŭ*, which Vasmer relates to Greek *zōrós*, “fiery, strong”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yárkiy*
- *Say it: yárkiy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yárkiy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ancient, then the Russian for loud, then say *yárkiy* again

Before you move on

What does яркий mean? (“Bright”.) Say it once more.

244.4 тёмный (tyómnyy) — dark

Before the new one: say the Russian for loud, then the Russian for bright.

You'll want to know: тёмный

тёмный (*tyómnyy*) — "dark".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

тёмный is built on тьма, "darkness", Proto-Slavic **tьma*, which Vasmer relates to Lithuanian *tamsà*, Sanskrit *támas*, "darkness", and Latin *tenebrae*, "darkness".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyómnyy*
- *Say it: tyómnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyómnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for loud, then the Russian for bright, then say *tyómnyy* again

Before you move on

What does тёмный mean? ("Dark".) Say it once more.

244.5 светлый (svétlyy) — light, bright (of a colour or room)

Before the new one: say the Russian for bright, then the Russian for dark.

You'll want to know: светлый

светлый (*svétlyy*) — "light, bright (of a colour or room)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

светлый ← Proto-Slavic **světьlъ*, from свет, "light" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svétlyy*
- *Say it: svétlyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svétlyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for bright, then the Russian for dark, then say *svétlyy* again

Before you move on

What does **светлый** mean? ("Light, bright (of a colour or room)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Strange, Funny, Wonderful, Terrible, Excellent

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say strange, funny, wonderful, terrible and excellent.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say strange, funny, wonderful, terrible and excellent.*

245.1 странный (stránnyy) — strange

Before the new one: say the Russian for dark, then the Russian for light.

You'll want to know: странный

странный (*stránnyy*) — "strange".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

странный — Old Church Slavonic *stranĭnŭ*, "foreign", from страна, "a land, a side" (Vasmer): strange was first "from another land".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: stránnyy*
- *Say it: stránnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *stránnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for dark, then the Russian for light, then say *stránnyy* again

Before you move on

What does странный mean? (“Strange”.) Say it once more.

245.2 смешной (smeshnóy) — funny

Before the new one: say the Russian for light, then the Russian for strange.

You’ll want to know: смешной

смешной (*smeshnóy*) — “funny”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

смешной comes from смех, “laughter”, with -ной: what makes people laugh.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: smeshnóy*
- *Say it: smeshnóy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *smeshnóy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for light, then the Russian for strange, then say *smeshnóy* again

Before you move on

What does смешной mean? ("Funny".) Say it once more.

245.3 прекрасный (prekrásnyy) — wonderful

Before the new one: say the Russian for strange, then the Russian for funny.

You'll want to know: прекрасный

прекрасный (*prekrásnyy*) — "wonderful".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

прекрасный is пре-, "very", with красный, which first meant "beautiful", from краса, "beauty" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prekrásnyy*
- *Say it: prekrásnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prekrásnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for strange, then the Russian for funny, then say *prekrásnyy* again

Before you move on

What does прекрасный mean? ("Wonderful".) Say it once more.

245.4 ужасный (uzhásnyy) — terrible

Before the new one: say the Russian for funny, then the Russian for wonderful.

You'll want to know: ужасный

ужасный (*uzhásnyy*) — "terrible".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ужасный is ужас, "horror", with -ный. Vasmer calls ужас "a difficult word" and thinks it possibly related to гасить, "to put out", and Greek *sbénnymi*, "I quench": the terror that chokes.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uzhásnyy*
- *Say it: uzhásnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uzhásnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for funny, then the Russian for wonderful, then say *uzhásnyy* again

Before you move on

What does ужасный mean? ("Terrible".) Say it once more.

245.5 отличный (otlíchnyy) — excellent

Before the new one: say the Russian for wonderful, then the Russian for terrible.

You'll want to know: отличный

отличный (*otlíchnyy*) — "excellent".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

отличный comes from отличить, "to set apart", on the root of лик, "a face, an image": what stands out from the rest.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: otlíchnyy*
- *Say it: otlíchnyy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *otlíchnyy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for wonderful, then the Russian for terrible, then say *otlíchnyy* again

Before you move on

What does отличный mean? ("Excellent".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Microwave, Kettle, Bowl, Saucer, Mug

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a microwave, a kettle, a bowl, a saucer and a mug.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say a microwave, a kettle, a bowl, a saucer and a mug.

246.1 микроволновка (mikrovolnóvka) — a microwave

Before the new one: say the Russian for terrible, then the Russian for excellent.

You'll want to know: микроволновка

микроволновка (*mikrovolnóvka*) — "a microwave".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

микроволновка is микроволновая печь, "microwave oven", folded into one word with -ка: Greek *mikrós*, "small", with волна, "a wave".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mikrovolnóvka*
- *Say it: mikrovolnóvka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mikrovolnóvka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for terrible, then the Russian for excellent, then say *mikrovolnóvka* again

Before you move on

What does микроволновка mean? ("A microwave".) Say it once more.

246.2 чайник (cháynik) — a kettle

Before the new one: say the Russian for excellent, then the Russian for a microwave.

You'll want to know: чайник

чайник (*cháynik*) — "a kettle".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

чайник is чай, "tea", with -ник, a suffix for a vessel. чай came from Chinese *chá*, through Persian and Turkic.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cháynik*
- *Say it: cháynik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cháynik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for excellent, then the Russian for a microwave, then say *cháynik* again

Before you move on

What does чайник mean? (“A kettle”.) Say it once more.

246.3 миска (míska) — a bowl

Before the new one: say the Russian for a microwave, then the Russian for a kettle.

You’ll want to know: миска

миска (*míska*) — “a bowl”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

миска is a diminutive of миса, “a bowl”, an old loan from Vulgar Latin *mēsa*, Latin *mēnsa*, “a table”, perhaps through Gothic *mēs*, “a table, a dish” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: míska*
- *Say it: míska*, once more
- *Say it:* say *míska*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a microwave, then the Russian for a kettle, then say *míska* again

Before you move on

What does миска mean? (“A bowl”.) Say it once more.

246.4 блюдце (blyúdtse) — a saucer

Before the new one: say the Russian for a kettle, then the Russian for a bowl.

You'll want to know: блюдце

блюдце (*blyúdtse*) — "a saucer".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

блюдце is блюдо, "a dish", with -це, "little". блюдо is an old loan from Gothic *biuþs*, "a table, a dish" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: blyúdtse*
- *Say it: blyúdtse*, once more
- *Say it:* say *blyúdtse*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a kettle, then the Russian for a bowl, then say *blyúdtse* again

Before you move on

What does блюдце mean? ("A saucer".) Say it once more.

246.5 кружка (krúzhka) — a mug

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bowl, then the Russian for a saucer.

You'll want to know: кружка

кружка (*krúzhka*) — "a mug".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

кружка — from the 1400s; it perhaps came through Polish *kruż*, "a jug", or straight from Middle High German *krûse*, which is traced to Greek *krōssós*, "a water jar" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: krúzhka*
- *Say it: krúzhka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *krúzhka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bowl, then the Russian for a saucer, then say *krúzhka* again

Before you move on

What does кружка mean? ("A mug".) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Radio, Headphones, Passport, Visa, Document

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a radio, headphones, a passport, a visa and a document.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say a radio, headphones, a passport, a visa and a document.*

247.1 радио (rádio) — a radio

> Before the new one: say the Russian for a saucer, then the Russian for a mug.

You'll want to know: радио

радио (*rádio*) — "a radio".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

радио is an international word from Latin *radius*, "a ray, a spoke": signals sent in rays.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rádio*
- *Say it: rádio*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rádio*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a saucer, then the Russian for a mug, then say *rádio* again

Before you move on

What does радио mean? ("A radio".) Say it once more.

247.2 наушники (naúshniki) — headphones

Before the new one: say the Russian for a mug, then the Russian for a radio.

You'll want to know: наушники

наушники (*naúshniki*) — "headphones".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

наушники is на, "on", with уши, "ears", and -ники: things on the ears. ухо is a cousin of Latin *auris*, "ear" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naúshniki*
- *Say it: naúshniki*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naúshniki*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a mug, then the Russian for a radio, then say *naúshniki* again

Before you move on

What does наушники mean? ("Headphones".) Say it once more.

247.3 паспорт (pásport) — a passport

Before the new one: say the Russian for a radio, then the Russian for headphones.

You'll want to know: паспорт

паспорт (*pásport*) — "a passport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

паспорт — пашпорт in 1633, паспорт by 1710; it came through German *Passport* (Vasmer), from French *passeport*, "pass (through) the port".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pásport*
- *Say it: pásport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pásport*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a radio, then the Russian for headphones, then say *pásport* again

Before you move on

What does паспорт mean? ("A passport".) Say it once more.

247.4 виза (víza) — a visa

Before the new one: say the Russian for headphones, then the Russian for a passport.

You'll want to know: виза

виза (*víza*) — "a visa".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

виза is a recent loan from French *visa*, "an endorsement", from Latin *vīsa*, "things seen" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: víza*
- *Say it: víza*, once more
- *Say it:* say *víza*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for headphones, then the Russian for a passport, then say *víza* again

Before you move on

What does виза mean? ("A visa".) Say it once more.

247.5 документ (dokuмént) — a document

Before the new one: say the Russian for a passport, then the Russian for a visa.

You'll want to know: документ

документ (*dokuмént*) — "a document".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

документ — from Peter the Great's time; it came through German *Dokument* or Polish *dokument* from Latin *documentum*, "a proof, a lesson", from *docēre*, "to teach, to show" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dokumént*
- *Say it: dokumént*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dokumént*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a passport, then the Russian for a visa, then say *dokumént* again

Before you move on

What does документ mean? ("A document".) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

Clothes, Raincoat, Suit, Jeans, Shorts

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say clothes, a raincoat, a suit, jeans and shorts.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say clothes, a raincoat, a suit, jeans and shorts.

248.1 одежда (odézhda) — clothes

Before the new one: say the Russian for a visa, then the Russian for a document.

You'll want to know: одежда

одежда (*odézhda*) — "clothes".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

одежда is built on одеть, "to dress", from деть, "to put"; its -жд- is the Church Slavonic sound, beside folk одёжа.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: odézhda*
- *Say it: odézhda*, once more
- *Say it:* say *odézhda*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a visa, then the Russian for a document, then say *odézhda* again

Before you move on

What does одежда mean? ("Clothes".) Say it once more.

248.2 плащ (plashch) — a raincoat

Before the new one: say the Russian for a document, then the Russian for clothes.

You'll want to know: плащ

плащ (*plashch*) — "a raincoat".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плащ ← Old Church Slavonic *plaštĭ*, "a cloak". It is usually linked with плат, "a cloth", which Vasmer says is not free of difficulties; others link it with плоский, "flat".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plashch*
- *Say it: plashch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plashch*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a document, then the Russian for clothes, then say *plashch* again

Before you move on

What does плащ mean? ("A raincoat".) Say it once more.

248.3 костюм (kostyúm) — a suit

Before the new one: say the Russian for clothes, then the Russian for a raincoat.

You'll want to know: костюм

костюм (*kostyúm*) — "a suit".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

костюм comes from French *costume*, from Italian *costume*, "custom, dress", Latin *cōnsuētūdō*, "custom" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kostyúm*
- *Say it: kostyúm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kostyúm*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for clothes, then the Russian for a raincoat, then say *kostyúm* again

Before you move on

What does костюм mean? ("A suit".) Say it once more.

248.4 джинсы (dzhínsy) — jeans

Before the new one: say the Russian for a raincoat, then the Russian for a suit.

You'll want to know: джинсы

джинсы (*dzhínsy*) — "jeans".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

джинсы comes from English *jeans*, named after *Genoa*, the Italian city where the cloth was first made.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dzhínsy*
- *Say it: dzhínsy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dzhínsy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a raincoat, then the Russian for a suit, then say *dzhínsy* again

Before you move on

What does джинсы mean? ("Jeans".) Say it once more.

248.5 шорты (shórty) — shorts

Before the new one: say the Russian for a suit, then the Russian for jeans.

You'll want to know: шорты

шорты (*shórty*) — "shorts".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шорты comes from English *shorts*, "short trousers".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shórty*
- *Say it: shórty*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shórty*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a suit, then the Russian for jeans, then say *shórty* again

Before you move on

What does шорты mean? (“Shorts”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

Sour cream, Cottage cheese, Pork, Lamb, Ham

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sour cream, cottage cheese, pork, lamb and ham.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say sour cream, cottage cheese, pork, lamb and ham.*

249.1 сметана (smetána) — sour cream

> Before the new one: say the Russian for jeans, then the Russian for shorts.

You'll want to know: сметана

сметана (*smetána*) — "sour cream".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сметана ← Proto-Slavic **sŭmetana* — inherited, usually derived from **sŭmětati*, "to throw off, to take off", a relative of метать, "to throw" (Vasmer): sour cream is the layer taken off the milk. Others reconstruct **sŭmętana* and link it with an old verb "to stir".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: smetána*
- *Say it: smetána*, once more
- *Say it:* say *smetána*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for jeans, then the Russian for shorts, then say *smetána* again

Before you move on

What does сметана mean? (“Sour cream”.) Say it once more.

249.2 творог (tvoróg) — cottage cheese

Before the new one: say the Russian for shorts, then the Russian for sour cream.

You’ll want to know: творог

творог (*tvoróg*) — “cottage cheese”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

творог — Vasmer reports the usual link of Proto-Slavic **tvarogŭ* with творить, “to shape, to make”, as French *fromage*, “cheese”, comes from Latin *fōrmāticum*, “formed (in a mould)”; Jakobson insists on it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tvoróg*
- *Say it: tvoróg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tvoróg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for shorts, then the Russian for sour cream, then say *tvoróg* again

Before you move on

What does творог mean? ("Cottage cheese".) Say it once more.

249.3 свинина (svinína) — pork

Before the new one: say the Russian for sour cream, then the Russian for cottage cheese.

You'll want to know: свинина

свинина (*svinína*) — "pork".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

свинина is свинья, "a pig", with -ина, a suffix for meat. свинья is a cousin of English *swine*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: svinína*
- *Say it: svinína*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svinína*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for sour cream, then the Russian for cottage cheese, then say *svinína* again

Before you move on

What does свинина mean? ("Pork".) Say it once more.

249.4 баранина (baránina) — lamb (meat)

Before the new one: say the Russian for cottage cheese, then the Russian for pork.

You'll want to know: баранина

баранина (*баранина*) — "lamb (meat)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

баранина is баран, "a ram", with -ина, a suffix for meat. Vasmer reports the view that баран is an ancient Alpine word, compared with Albanian *berr*, "sheep"; Trubachev, in a note, explains it otherwise.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: баранина*
- *Say it: баранина*, once more
- *Say it:* say *баранина*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for cottage cheese, then the Russian for pork, then say *баранина* again

Before you move on

What does баранина mean? ("Lamb (meat)".) Say it once more.

249.5 ветчина (vetchiná) — ham

Before the new one: say the Russian for pork, then the Russian for lamb.

You'll want to know: ветчина

ветчина (*vetchiná*) — "ham".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

ветчина — Vasmer thinks it very likely comes from ветхий, "old", built like свежина, "fresh meat": ham is meat kept a long time. A link with Polish *wędzić*, "to smoke", he finds less convincing.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vetchiná*
- *Say it: vetchiná*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vetchiná*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pork, then the Russian for lamb, then say *vetchiná* again

Before you move on

What does ветчина mean? ("Ham".) Say it once more.

249.6 Words from chapters 241-244 — a first pass

Say the words for lamb and ham.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a basement, a balcony, a yard, opposite, between
- a library, a university, a café, a zoo, a circus
- young, elderly, tall, low, ugly
- ancient, loud, bright, dark, light

Before you move on

A basement? (подвал.) A balcony? (балкон.) A yard? (двор.) Opposite? (напротив.) Between? (между.) A library? (библиотека.) A university? (университет.) A café? (кафе.) A zoo? (зоопарк.) A circus? (цирк.) Young? (молодой.) Elderly? (пожилой.) Tall? (высокий.) Low? (низкий.) Ugly?

(некрасивый.) Ancient? (древний.) Loud? (громкий.) Bright? (яркий.) Dark? (тёмный.) Light? (светлый.)

249.7 Words from chapters 245-249 — a second pass

Say the words for strange and funny.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- strange, funny, wonderful, terrible, excellent
- a microwave, a kettle, a bowl, a saucer, a mug
- a radio, headphones, a passport, a visa, a document
- clothes, a raincoat, a suit, jeans, shorts
- sour cream, cottage cheese, pork, lamb, ham

Before you move on

Strange? (странный.) Funny? (смешной.) Wonderful? (прекрасный.) Terrible? (ужасный.) Excellent? (отличный.) A microwave? (микроволновка.) A kettle? (чайник.) A bowl? (миска.) A saucer? (блюдце.) A mug? (кружка.) A radio? (радио.) Headphones? (наушники.) A passport? (паспорт.) A visa? (виза.) A document? (документ.) Clothes? (одежда.) A raincoat? (плащ.) A suit? (костюм.) Jeans? (джинсы.) Shorts? (шорты.) Sour cream? (сметана.) Cottage cheese? (творог.) Pork? (свинина.) Lamb? (баранина.) Ham? (ветчина.)

Chapter 250

Watermelon, Plum, Pasta, Cake, Sweet

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a watermelon, a plum, pasta, a cake and a sweet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say a watermelon, a plum, pasta, a cake and a sweet.*

250.1 арбуз (arbúz) — a watermelon

> Before the new one: say the Russian for lamb (meat), then the Russian for ham.

You'll want to know: арбуз

арбуз (*arbúz*) — "a watermelon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

арбуз — recorded in the Domostroy; it came through Kipchak *xarbuz* and Turkish *karpuz* from Persian *xarbuza*, "a melon", literally "donkey melon" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *arbúz*
- *Say it:* *arbúz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arbúz*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for lamb (meat), then the Russian for ham, then say *arbúz* again

Before you move on

What does арбуз mean? ("A watermelon".) Say it once more.

250.2 слива (slíva) — a plum

Before the new one: say the Russian for ham, then the Russian for a watermelon.

You'll want to know: слива

слива (*slíva*) — "a plum".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

слива ← Proto-Slavic **sliva* — inherited; it first named a colour (Vasmer). Vasmer relates it to Latin *līvidus*, "bluish", and Old High German *slêha*, "sloe": English *sloe* is a cousin.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *slíva*
- *Say it:* *slíva*, once more
- *Say it:* say *slíva*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for ham, then the Russian for a watermelon, then say *slíva* again

Before you move on

What does слива mean? (“A plum”.) Say it once more.

250.3 макароны (makaróny) — pasta

Before the new one: say the Russian for a watermelon, then the Russian for a plum.

You’ll want to know: макароны

макароны (*makaróny*) — “pasta”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

макароны comes, like German *Makkaroni* and French *macaroni*, from Italian *maccaroni*, which is traced to Greek *makaría*, “a dish of barley” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: makaróny*
- *Say it: makaróny*, once more
- *Say it:* say *makaróny*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a watermelon, then the Russian for a plum, then say *makaróny* again

Before you move on

What does макароны mean? (“Pasta”.) Say it once more.

250.4 торт (tort) — a cake

Before the new one: say the Russian for a plum, then the Russian for pasta.

You'll want to know: торт

торт (*tort*) — "a cake".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

торт apparently came through German *Torte* from Italian *torta*, from Latin *tortus*, "twisted", that is, a round piece of pastry (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tort*
- *Say it: tort*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tort*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a plum, then the Russian for pasta, then say *tort* again

Before you move on

What does торт mean? ("A cake".) Say it once more.

250.5 конфета (konféta) — a sweet

Before the new one: say the Russian for pasta, then the Russian for a cake.

You'll want to know: конфета

конфета (*konféta*) — "a sweet".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

конфета — first конфекты, under Peter the Great, through German *Konfekt*; the form without -к- came through Italian *confetto*, from Latin *cōnfectum*, "something prepared" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: konféta*
- *Say it: konféta*, once more
- *Say it:* say *konféta*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for pasta, then the Russian for a cake, then say *konféta* again

Before you move on

What does конфета mean? ("A sweet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 251

Bull, Cockerel, Goose, Pigeon, Sparrow

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a bull, a cockerel, a goose, a pigeon and a sparrow.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say a bull, a cockerel, a goose, a pigeon and a sparrow.

251.1 бык (byk) — a bull

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cake, then the Russian for a sweet.

You'll want to know: бык

бык (*byk*) — "a bull".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бык ← Proto-Slavic **bykŭ* — inherited, from a root for a deep sound. Vasmer relates it to Latvian *bucêt*, "to boom", and Lithuanian *bukti*, "to low": the bull as the bellower.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: byk*
- *Say it: byk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *byk*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cake, then the Russian for a sweet, then say *byk* again

Before you move on

What does бык mean? (“A bull”.) Say it once more.

251.2 петух (petúkh) — a cockerel

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sweet, then the Russian for a bull.

You’ll want to know: петух

петух (*petúkh*) — “a cockerel”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

петух first meant “the singer”, from петь, “to sing” (Vasmer); Latin *gallus* and Gothic *hana*, “cock”, are named in the same way.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: petúkh*
- *Say it: petúkh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *petúkh*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sweet, then the Russian for a bull, then say *petúkh* again

Before you move on

What does петух mean? (“A cockerel”.) Say it once more.

251.3 гусь (gus) — a goose

Before the new one: say the Russian for a bull, then the Russian for a cockerel.

You’ll want to know: гусь

гусь (*gus*) — “a goose”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

гусь ← Proto-Slavic **gǫsĭ*. If it were inherited from the Indo-European word for “goose”, Slavic would have з-, as Lithuanian *žąsìs*, Latin *ānser* and German *Gans* lead one to expect; Vasmer thinks it likeliest that a native **zǫsĭ* was reshaped after Germanic *gans*; others take the whole word from Germanic.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gus*
- *Say it: gus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gus*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a bull, then the Russian for a cockerel, then say *gus* again

Before you move on

What does гусь mean? (“A goose”.) Say it once more.

251.4 голубь (gólub) — a pigeon

Before the new one: say the Russian for a cockerel, then the Russian for a goose.

You'll want to know: голубь

голубь (*gólub*) — "a pigeon".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

голубь ← Proto-Slavic **golǫbĭ* — inherited, first probably named for a colour. Vasmer thinks it probably related to Lithuanian *gulbė́*, "swan", and жёлтый, "yellow".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gólub*
- *Say it: gólub*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gólub*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a cockerel, then the Russian for a goose, then say *gólub* again

Before you move on

What does голубь mean? ("A pigeon".) Say it once more.

251.5 воробей (vorobéy) — a sparrow

Before the new one: say the Russian for a goose, then the Russian for a pigeon.

You'll want to know: воробей

воробей (*vorobéy*) — "a sparrow".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

воробей ← Proto-Slavic **vorbьjь* — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *žvìrblis*, “sparrow”, and Greek *rhóbillos*, a small bird.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vorobéy*
- *Say it: vorobéy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vorobéy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a goose, then the Russian for a pigeon, then say *vorobéy* again

Before you move on

What does воробей mean? (“A sparrow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 252

Hockey, Tennis, Basketball, Running, Swimming

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say hockey, tennis, basketball, running and swimming.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say hockey, tennis, basketball, running and swimming.

252.1 хоккей (khokkéy) — hockey

Before the new one: say the Russian for a pigeon, then the Russian for a sparrow.

You'll want to know: хоккей

хоккей (*khokkéy*) — "hockey".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

хоккей comes from English *hockey*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khokkéy*
- *Say it: khokkéy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khokkéy*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a pigeon, then the Russian for a sparrow, then say *khokkéy* again

Before you move on

What does хоккей mean? (“Hockey”.) Say it once more.

252.2 теннис (ténnis) — tennis

Before the new one: say the Russian for a sparrow, then the Russian for hockey.

You’ll want to know: теннис

теннис (*ténnis*) — “tennis”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

теннис comes from English *tennis* (Vasmer), which goes back to French *tenez*, “hold!”, called out by the server.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ténnis*
- *Say it: ténnis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ténnis*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a sparrow, then the Russian for hockey, then say *ténnis* again

Before you move on

What does теннис mean? (“Tennis”.) Say it once more.

252.3 баскетбол (basketból) — basketball

Before the new one: say the Russian for hockey, then the Russian for tennis.

You’ll want to know: баскетбол

баскетбол (*basketból*) — “basketball”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

баскетбол comes from English *basketball*, “basket ball”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: basketból*
- *Say it: basketból*, once more
- *Say it:* say *basketból*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for hockey, then the Russian for tennis, then say *basketból* again

Before you move on

What does баскетбол mean? (“Basketball”.) Say it once more.

252.4 бег (beg) — running

Before the new one: say the Russian for tennis, then the Russian for basketball.

You'll want to know: бег

бег (*beg*) — "running".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

бег ← Proto-Slavic **bĕgŭ*, with бежать, "to run" — inherited. Vasmer relates it to Lithuanian *bėgas*, "a running, flight".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *beg*
- *Say it:* *beg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *beg*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for tennis, then the Russian for basketball, then say *beg* again

Before you move on

What does бег mean? ("Running".) Say it once more.

252.5 плавание (plávaniye) — swimming

Before the new one: say the Russian for basketball, then the Russian for running.

You'll want to know: плавание

плавание (*plávaniye*) — "swimming".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

плавание is a noun from плавать, "to swim", on the root of плыть, "to float". Vasmer relates плыть to Sanskrit *plávatē*, "floats", and Greek *pléō*, "I sail".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plávaniye*
- *Say it: plávaniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plávaniye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for basketball, then the Russian for running, then say *plávaniye* again

Before you move on

What does плавание mean? ("Swimming".) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

Fairy tale, Story, Chess, Transport, Trolleybus

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a fairy tale, a story, chess, transport and a trolleybus.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can say a fairy tale, a story, chess, transport and a trolleybus.*

253.1 сказка (skázka) — a fairy tale

> Before the new one: say the Russian for running, then the Russian for swimming.

You'll want to know: сказка

сказка (*skázka*) — "a fairy tale".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сказка comes from **sŭkazŭka*, from казать, "to show, to say" (Vasmer); it is recorded from the 1600s, before which a tale was a баснь.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skázka*
- *Say it: skázka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skázka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for running, then the Russian for swimming, then say *skázka* again

Before you move on

What does сказка mean? ("A fairy tale".) Say it once more.

253.2 история (istóriya) — a story; history

Before the new one: say the Russian for swimming, then the Russian for a fairy tale.

You'll want to know: история

история (*istóriya*) — "a story; history".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

история — from Peter the Great's time; perhaps through German *Historie* from Latin *historia*, Greek *historía*, "inquiry, a narrative" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: istóriya*
- *Say it: istóriya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *istóriya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for swimming, then the Russian for a fairy tale, then say *istóriya* again

Before you move on

What does **история** mean? ("A story; history".) Say it once more.

253.3 шахматы (shákhmaty) — chess

Before the new one: say the Russian for a fairy tale, then the Russian for a story; history.

You'll want to know: шахматы

шахматы (*shákhmaty*) — "chess".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

шахматы — Old Russian **шахматы**, from 1280; it is built on **шах** **мат**, "checkmate", from Persian *shāh*, "king", probably through a German source (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: shákhmaty*
- *Say it: shákhmaty*, once more
- *Say it:* say *shákhmaty*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a fairy tale, then the Russian for a story; history, then say *shákhmaty* again

Before you move on

What does **шахматы** mean? ("Chess".) Say it once more.

253.4 транспорт (tránsport) — transport

Before the new one: say the Russian for a story; history, then the Russian for chess.

You'll want to know: транспорт

транспорт (*tránsport*) — "transport".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

транспорт — from 1720; it came from French or Dutch *transport* or German *Transport* (Vasmer), from Latin *trānsportāre*, "to carry across".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tránsport*
- *Say it: tránsport*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tránsport*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a story; history, then the Russian for chess, then say *tránsport* again

Before you move on

What does транспорт mean? ("Transport".) Say it once more.

253.5 троллейбус (trolléybus) — a trolleybus

Before the new one: say the Russian for chess, then the Russian for transport.

You'll want to know: троллейбус

троллейбус (*trolléybus*) — "a trolleybus".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

троллейбус comes from English *trolleybus*: *trolley*, the wheel on a pole that runs along the wire, with *bus*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: trolléybus*
- *Say it: trolléybus*, once more
- *Say it:* say *trolléybus*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for chess, then the Russian for transport, then say *trolléybus* again

Before you move on

What does троллейбус mean? ("A trolleybus".) Say it once more.

Chapter 254

Girl, Lad, Young woman, Parents, Nephew

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a girl, a lad, a young woman, parents and a nephew.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say a girl, a lad, a young woman, parents and a nephew.

254.1 девочка (dévochka) — a girl

Before the new one: say the Russian for transport, then the Russian for a trolleybus.

You'll want to know: девочка

девочка (*dévochka*) — "a girl".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

девочка is a diminutive built on дева, "a maiden". Vasmer ties дева to дитя, "a child", and the PIE root **dʰeh₁(i)-*, "to suckle", with Latin *fēmina*, "woman".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dévochka*
- *Say it:* *dévochka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dévochka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for transport, then the Russian for a trolleybus, then say *dévochka* again

Before you move on

What does девочка mean? ("A girl".) Say it once more.

254.2 парень (páren) — a lad, a boyfriend

Before the new one: say the Russian for a trolleybus, then the Russian for a girl.

You'll want to know: парень

парень (*páren*) — "a lad, a boyfriend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

парень — Vasmer thinks it probably comes from **parę*, a diminutive of паробок, "a young man, a farmhand".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *páren*
- *Say it:* *páren*, once more
- *Say it:* say *páren*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a trolleybus, then the Russian for a girl, then say *páren* again

Before you move on

What does парень mean? ("A lad, a boyfriend".) Say it once more.

254.3 девушка (dévushka) — a young woman, a girlfriend

Before the new one: say the Russian for a girl, then the Russian for a lad.

You'll want to know: девушка

девушка (*dévushka*) — "a young woman, a girlfriend".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

девушка is дева, "a maiden", with the fond -ушка. Vasmer derives дева from an Indo-European root "to suckle", the root behind Latin *fēmina*, "woman".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dévushka*
- *Say it: dévushka*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dévushka*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a girl, then the Russian for a lad, then say *dévushka* again

Before you move on

What does девушка mean? ("A young woman, a girlfriend".) Say it once more.

254.4 родители (rodíteli) — parents

Before the new one: say the Russian for a lad, then the Russian for a young woman.

You'll want to know: родители

родители (*rodíteli*) — "parents".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

родители is the plural of родитель, "a parent", from родить, "to give birth", with -тель, "one who" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rodíteli*
- *Say it: rodíteli*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rodíteli*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a lad, then the Russian for a young woman, then say *rodíteli* again

Before you move on

What does родители mean? ("Parents".) Say it once more.

254.5 племянник (plemyánnik) — a nephew

Before the new one: say the Russian for a young woman, then the Russian for parents.

You'll want to know: племянник

племянник (*plemyánnik*) — "a nephew".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

племянник is built on племя, “a tribe, kin”. Vasmer derives племя from **pled-men-*, related to плод, “fruit, offspring”; Trubachev proposed another root.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plemyánnik*
- *Say it: plemyánnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plemyánnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a young woman, then the Russian for parents, then say *plemyánnik* again

Before you move on

What does племянник mean? (“A nephew”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

Surname, Age, Number, Message, Conversation

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a surname, an age, a number, a message and a conversation.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can say a surname, an age, a number, a message and a conversation.*

255.1 фамилия (famíliya) — a surname

> Before the new one: say the Russian for parents, then the Russian for a nephew.

You'll want to know: фамилия

фамилия (*famíliya*) — "a surname".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фамилия — first "a family", from the early 1700s; it came through Polish *familia* or German *Familie* from Latin *familia*, "a household" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: famíliya*
- *Say it: famíliya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *famíliya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for parents, then the Russian for a nephew, then say *famíliya* again

Before you move on

What does фамилия mean? ("A surname".) Say it once more.

255.2 возраст (vózrast) — an age

Before the new one: say the Russian for a nephew, then the Russian for a surname.

You'll want to know: возраст

возраст (*vózrast*) — "an age".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

возраст — taken from Church Slavonic, says Vasmer, in place of native взрост: воз-, "up", with раст, "growth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vózrast*
- *Say it: vózrast*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vózrast*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a nephew, then the Russian for a surname, then say *vózrast* again

Before you move on

What does возраст mean? ("An age".) Say it once more.

255.3 номер (nómer) — a number; a hotel room

Before the new one: say the Russian for a surname, then the Russian for an age.

You'll want to know: номер

номер (*nómer*) — "a number; a hotel room".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

номер — нумер in 1704; the form with -о- comes from German *Nummer*, from Latin *numerus*, "a number" (Vasmer). A hotel room is a numbered room.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nómer*
- *Say it: nómer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nómer*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a surname, then the Russian for an age, then say *nómer* again

Before you move on

What does номер mean? ("A number; a hotel room".) Say it once more.

255.4 сообщение (soobshchéniye) — a message

Before the new one: say the Russian for an age, then the Russian for a number; a hotel room.

You'll want to know: сообщение

сообщение (*soobshchéniye*) — "a message".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

сообщение comes from сообщить, "to share, to report", from общий, "common", Proto-Slavic **obĭtjĭ*, "what is around" (Vasmer): to make something common. общий itself is the Church Slavonic form, with щ; the native Old Russian form was обчий (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: soobshchéniye*
- *Say it: soobshchéniye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *soobshchéniye*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an age, then the Russian for a number; a hotel room, then say *soobshchéniye* again

Before you move on

What does сообщение mean? ("A message".) Say it once more.

255.5 разговор (razgovór) — a conversation

Before the new one: say the Russian for a number; a hotel room, then the Russian for a message.

You'll want to know: разговор

разговор (*razgovór*) — "a conversation".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

разговор is раз-, "about, back and forth", with говор, "talk". Говор is inherited; Vasmer relates it to Latvian *gaura*, "chatter".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: razgovór*
- *Say it: razgovór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *razgovór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a number; a hotel room, then the Russian for a message, then say *razgovór* again

Before you move on

What does разговор mean? ("A conversation".) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

Professor, Journalist, Artist, Musician, Actor

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a professor, a journalist, an artist, a musician and an actor.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can say a professor, a journalist, an artist, a musician and an actor.

256.1 профессор (профéссор) — a professor

Before the new one: say the Russian for a message, then the Russian for a conversation.

You'll want to know: профессор

профессор (*профéссор*) — "a professor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

профессор — from 1720; it came through German *Professor* from Latin *professor*, "a public teacher", from *profitērī*, "to declare openly" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proféssor*
- *Say it: proféssor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proféssor*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a message, then the Russian for a conversation, then say *proféssor* again

Before you move on

What does профессор mean? ("A professor".) Say it once more.

256.2 журналист (zhurnalíst) — a journalist

Before the new one: say the Russian for a conversation, then the Russian for a professor.

You'll want to know: журналист

журналист (*zhurnalíst*) — "a journalist".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

журналист is журнал, "a journal", with -ист. журнал comes from French *journal*, Medieval Latin *diurnālis*, "daily" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zhurnalíst*
- *Say it: zhurnalíst*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zhurnalíst*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a conversation, then the Russian for a professor, then say *zhurnalíst* again

Before you move on

What does журналист mean? (“A journalist”.) Say it once more.

256.3 художник (khudózhnik) — an artist, a painter

Before the new one: say the Russian for a professor, then the Russian for a journalist.

You’ll want to know: художник

художник (*khudózhnik*) — “an artist, a painter”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

художник comes from Old Russian *xudogŭ*, “skilled”, from **xǫdogŭ*, borrowed from a Gothic **handags*, “handy”, from *handus*, “hand” (Vasmer). English *hand* is a cousin of the Gothic word.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khudózhnik*
- *Say it: khudózhnik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khudózhnik*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a professor, then the Russian for a journalist, then say *khudózhnik* again

Before you move on

What does художник mean? (“An artist, a painter”.) Say it once more.

256.4 музыкант (muzykánt) — a musician

Before the new one: say the Russian for a journalist, then the Russian for an artist.

You'll want to know: музыкант

музыкант (*muzykánt*) — "a musician".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

музыкант — from Peter the Great's time; it comes from German *Musikant*, from Latin *mūsicus*, "a musician" (Vasmer).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muzykánt*
- *Say it: muzykánt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muzykánt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a journalist, then the Russian for an artist, then say *muzykánt* again

Before you move on

What does музыкант mean? ("A musician".) Say it once more.

256.5 актёр (aktyór) — an actor

Before the new one: say the Russian for an artist, then the Russian for a musician.

You'll want to know: актёр

актёр (*aktyór*) — "an actor".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

актёр comes from French *acteur* (Vasmer), from Latin *āctor*, "a doer, a performer".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aktyór*
- *Say it: aktyór*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aktyór*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an artist, then the Russian for a musician, then say *aktyór* again

Before you move on

What does актёр mean? ("An actor".) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

Company, Firm, Project, Task, Experience

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can say a company, a firm, a project, a task and experience.

Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can say a company, a firm, a project, a task and experience.

257.1 компания (kompániya) — a company

Before the new one: say the Russian for a musician, then the Russian for an actor.

You'll want to know: компания

компания (*kompániya*) — "a company".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

компания — first, in 1634, "a trading company"; it came through Polish *kompania* (Vasmer), from Italian *compagnia*, from Latin *com-*, "with", and *pānis*, "bread": people who share bread.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kompániya*
- *Say it: kompániya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kompániya*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a musician, then the Russian for an actor, then say *kompániya* again

Before you move on

What does компания mean? (“A company”.) Say it once more.

257.2 фирма (fírma) — a firm

Before the new one: say the Russian for an actor, then the Russian for a company.

You’ll want to know: фирма

фирма (*fírma*) — “a firm”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

фирма came through German *Firma* or straight from Italian *firma*, “a signature” (Vasmer), from *firmare*, “to confirm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fírma*
- *Say it: fírma*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fírma*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for an actor, then the Russian for a company, then say *fírma* again

Before you move on

What does фирма mean? (“A firm”.) Say it once more.

257.3 проект (proyékt) — a project

Before the new one: say the Russian for a company, then the Russian for a firm.

You’ll want to know: проект

проект (*proyékt*) — “a project”.

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

проект — from Peter the Great’s time; it probably came through German *Projekt* from Latin *prōiectum*, “something thrown forward” (Vasmer).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: proyékt*
- *Say it: proyékt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *proyékt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a company, then the Russian for a firm, then say *proyékt* again

Before you move on

What does проект mean? (“A project”.) Say it once more.

257.4 задача (zadácha) — a task; a problem (to solve)

Before the new one: say the Russian for a firm, then the Russian for a project.

You'll want to know: задача

задача (*zadácha*) — "a task; a problem (to solve)".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

задача comes from задать, "to set, to assign", за- with дать, "to give": a task is what you are given.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zadácha*
- *Say it: zadácha*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zadácha*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a firm, then the Russian for a project, then say *zadácha* again

Before you move on

What does задача mean? ("A task; a problem (to solve)".) Say it once more.

257.5 опыт (ópyt) — experience; an experiment

Before the new one: say the Russian for a project, then the Russian for a task; a problem.

You'll want to know: опыт

опыт (*ópyt*) — "experience; an experiment".

The word, taken apart — and its English cousins

опыт comes from пытать, "to test, to try" (Vasmer); Trubachev's note cites a first sense "a trial threshing". Vasmer compares Latin *putāre*, "to reckon, to prune".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ópyt*
- *Say it:* *ópyt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ópyt*
- *Recall:* say the Russian for a project, then the Russian for a task; a problem, then say *ópyt* again

Before you move on

What does опыт mean? ("Experience; an experiment".) Say it once more.

257.6 Words from chapters 250-253 — a first pass

Say the words for a task; a problem and experience; an experiment.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a watermelon, a plum, pasta, a cake, a sweet
- a bull, a cockerel, a goose, a pigeon, a sparrow
- hockey, tennis, basketball, running, swimming

- a fairy tale, a story; history, chess, transport, a trolleybus

Before you move on

A watermelon? (арбуз.) A plum? (слива.) Pasta? (макароны.) A cake? (торт.) A sweet? (конфета.) A bull? (бык.) A cockerel? (петух.) A goose? (гусь.) A pigeon? (голубь.) A sparrow? (воробей.) Hockey? (хоккей.) Tennis? (теннис.) Basketball? (баскетбол.) Running? (бег.) Swimming? (плавание.) A fairy tale? (сказка.) A story; history? (история.) Chess? (шахматы.) Transport? (транспорт.) A trolleybus? (троллейбус.)

257.7 Words from chapters 254-257 — a second pass

Say the words for a girl and a lad.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a girl, a lad, a young woman, parents, a nephew
- a surname, an age, a number; a hotel room, a message, a conversation
- a professor, a journalist, an artist, a musician, an actor
- a company, a firm, a project, a task; a problem, experience; an experiment

Before you move on

A girl? (девочка.) A lad? (парень.) A young woman? (девушка.) Parents? (родители.) A nephew? (племянник.) A surname? (фамилия.) An age? (возраст.) A number; a hotel room? (номер.) A message? (сообщение.) A conversation? (разговор.) A professor? (профессор.) A journalist? (журналист.) An artist? (художник.) A musician? (музыкант.) An actor? (актёр.) A company? (компания.) A firm? (фирма.) A project? (проект.) A task; a problem? (задача.) Experience; an

experiment? (опыт.)

Chapter 258

Writing — My Own Line

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write one line about myself by hand from a closed supply of known words, with nothing to copy, and check л, м, т and я before anything else.
>
> *Complete RU-W258-own-line: я, a verb with its I-ending and the rest, chosen rather than copied, with the handwritten shapes checked first.*

258.1 Your own line — the first writing with no model

> Everything you have written so far had something to reach for — a letter to trace, a word to copy, a word you heard.
>
> This does not. You choose the words, from a supply that is closed: only what this book has taught you.

Writing — controlled composition

Write **one line** about yourself, by hand, on paper. Start with я, then a verb you own with its *I*-ending, then the rest. End on a dot.

Copying hid one thing from you: the model always had the right shapes in it. Now your hand chooses them, and three are worth checking on purpose.

л and м — л comes to a **point**, м has a **dip**.

т — if your hand writes it like an *m*, give it the bar over the top. The bar is a habit, not a rule, but it keeps the shape apart from ш in a run of humps.

я — it faces the other way from Latin *R*. A hand that knows English will try to turn it round.

Write the line. Then read it back and check those three letters **before** you check anything else.

Before you move on

What tells л from м by hand? (The top — a **point** or a **dip**.)
And what did you choose here that the earlier lessons chose for you? (**The words**, and so **the shapes**.)

Chapter 259

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✓ **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write lines I own to a named reader inside a three-minute practice clock, and say why, under this book's 66%-everywhere target, the weakest TORFL subtest decides.
>
> *Complete RU-W259-with-a-clock: ten minutes on the book's clock, stop on time, then check the handwritten shapes before counting anything.*

259.1 The same writing, with a clock

You wrote your own line with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do.

Writing — timed production

What the target publishes. Russian's A1 exam is the state test TORFL at its Elementary Level, ТЭУ. The Pushkin Institute describes it as **five separate subtests** — Lexis and Grammar, Reading, Writing, Listening and Speaking — taking about three and a half hours in all.

What this book does **not** quote is the writing paper's own minutes or length. It has not yet transcribed the current paper into `task-shapes/a1.json`, so check the provider's current materials before the exam you book.

So the clock here is this book's, not the exam's, and it is short. Set a **three-minute timer**. Write by hand to one reader you name: who you are, what you do, what you like. Lines you own, a dot at the end of each.

When the three-minute timer rings, **stop**, even mid-word.

Before you move on

Spend at most one minute checking, and do not rewrite the timed lines. Hurry shows in the hand first: check л against м, and the bar over т, before you check anything else.

Now the rule worth carrying out of this lesson, because it changes how you study rather than how you write today.

TORFL scores each subtest **on its own**, and this book's target is **66 percent in every one of the five**. Some TORFL materials describe a narrower allowance for one subtest; this book does not plan around it.

So the paper that decides your result is **the one you are worst at**, and there are five of them, not four. Strong reading cannot carry weak writing.

Chapter 260

Writing — Four Lines And The Comma You Cannot Hear

Modes: ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write four connected lines to a named reader, joining with и, но or а and giving a reason with потому что, with a comma in front of every joiner that takes one.
>
> *Complete RU-W260-four-lines: four lines to one reader using* и, но *or* а, *and* потому что, *then check the comma in front of each joiner.*

260.1 Four lines, and the comma you cannot hear

> The last lesson asked for writing **finished on time**. This one asks for writing that **holds together**.
>
> Pick one person who will read it.

What to know first

Connected writing is not **longer** writing. Four short lines can be connected; one long line can fail to be. What makes it connected is that a sentence stops standing on its own.

You hold four joiners. и adds. но denies. а stands one thing beside another. потому что gives the reason.

And here is the Russian thing to notice. Said aloud, a join is just a word. Written down, three of these four carry a **mark**: a comma before но, before а, and before потому что — before потому; at this level, never inside the pair.

и between two halves about the same person takes none.

So the ear never hears the comma, and the examiner always sees it. It is the one piece of this lesson a reader can mark wrong without any argument.

Writing — connected composition

Write **four lines** by hand to the person you picked.

At least one must use и, joining two things the same person does. At least one must use но or а. At least one must use потому что — both words, spelled out.

Use only words you already write. This lesson adds no vocabulary; the whole exercise is the joining.

Before you move on

Cover your first line and read the second alone. Does it still make sense without the first? If it does, you wrote a **list** — which is where you were one lesson ago.

Then find every joiner and look just in front of it. A comma before но, а and потому; none before an и that joins two things one person does. Each comma's tail below the line.

Pronunciation & Cyrillic Reference

A **reference**, not a chapter — a place to look things up. You are *not* meant to read this before the lessons: the lessons teach reading through real words, introducing each letter as a word needs it. This page gathers the system in one spot. Full letter-by-letter decomposition (components + stroke order) lives in the machine-readable Cyrillic script reference.

The one thing that trips everyone: false friends

Cyrillic descends, like the Latin and Greek alphabets, from the Greek alphabet — so some letters are shared, but others look identical to Latin letters and say something completely different. These four cause 90% of beginner misreadings:

- **Cyrillic:** в
  looks like Latin...: B
  actually says: v
  mnemonic: Greek *beta* drifted to a "v" sound
- **Cyrillic:** р
  looks like Latin...: P
  actually says: r
  mnemonic: Greek *rho*
- **Cyrillic:** с
  looks like Latin...: C
  actually says: s
  mnemonic: Greek *sigma* (a "c" that hisses)
- **Cyrillic:** н
  looks like Latin...: H
  actually says: n
  mnemonic: Greek *eta* / Latin N with a level bar

Two vowels also mislead: у looks like Latin *y* but says **"oo"**; х looks like Latin *x* but says a raspy **"kh."**

The letters, grouped by how they behave

- **Same look, same sound**: а (a), е (ye), к (k), м (m), о (o), т (t).
- **False friends** (look Latin, sound different): в (v), р (r), с (s), н (n), у (oo), х (kh).
- **Greek-shaped**: г (g, gamma Γ), д (d, delta Δ), л (l, lambda Λ), п (p, pi Π), ф (f, phi Φ).
- **Sounds English writes with two letters**: ж (zh, as in *measure*), ч (ch), ш (sh), щ (shch), ц (ts), ю (yu), я (ya), ё (yo).
- **The vowel English hasn't got**: ы (`very-vowel`) — not the *ee* of и, but a tighter sound made with the tongue **drawn back**. Say English *ill*, then say it again with your tongue pulled towards your throat. It is the single hardest Russian vowel for an English speaker, and it carries real meaning: ты (*you*) and вы (*you*, formal) both turn on it.
- **The two signs** — ъ (hard sign) and ь (soft sign) — spell *no sound of their own*; they only tell you how to pronounce the consonant before them (ь softens it).

Two rules that make you sound native

- **Stress is unmarked and it matters.** Russian never prints its stress accent, but stress governs the vowels — so you learn each word *with* its stress. (This reference marks it with an acute, *privét*, but real text won't.)
- **Unstressed о → "a" (akanye).** An о not under stress reduces toward an *a*-ish sound: спасибо is said *"spa-SEE-ba,"* хорошо as *"kha-ra-SHO."*

Sound ids used in the lessons

The lessons' `sounds:` frontmatter points here: `cyrillic-false-friends` (the table above), `stress-unmarked` and `o-reduction` (the two rules), `e-ye` (е carries a *y*-glide), `zh-sound` (ж), `b-vs-v` (б vs в), `silent-v` (the dropped в in здравствуйте), `syllable-drop` (spoken contractions like *pa-ZHAL-sta*), `a-clear` / `a-father` (the pure *a*).

Russian in the Slavic family

Slavic is a branch of **Indo-European**, so Russian is a distant cousin of English, Latin, and Sanskrit — which is why its deepest words (нет ← **ne*, есть "is" ← the same root as English *is*) line up with words you already own. Cyrillic itself was built in the 9th century from Greek letters (plus a few invented for Slavic sounds Greek lacked) to write Old Church Slavonic — which is why so many letters are Greek in disguise.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

а *a*
and-but — the second half of English's but, and the second joining word that is a single letter
Introduced in Chapter 17.

один *adín*
one — and the English words one, an, a, alone and only are all the same word
Introduced in Chapter 17.

адрес *ádres*
an address
Introduced in Chapter 54.

аэропорт *aeropórt*
an airport
Introduced in Chapter 87.

актёр *aktyór*
an actor
Introduced in Chapter 256.

акула *akúla*
a shark
Introduced in Chapter 121.

аллергия *allergíya*
an allergy
Introduced in Chapter 210.

анкета *ankéta*
a form, a questionnaire
Introduced in Chapter 161.

апельсин *apelsín*
an orange
Introduced in Chapter 223.

апрель *aprél*
April
Introduced in Chapter 181.

аптека *aptéka*
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 80.

арбуз *arbúz*
a watermelon
Introduced in Chapter 250.

отец *atéts*
father — formal register, and an old word that is NOT related to English father at all
Introduced in Chapter 12.

авария *aváriya*
an accident, a crash
Introduced in Chapter 198.

август *ávgust*
August
Introduced in Chapter 212.

автобус *avtóbus*
a bus
Introduced in Chapter 79.

бабочка *bábochka*
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 117.

бабушка *bábushka*
a grandmother
Introduced in Chapter 35.

балкон *balkón*
a balcony
Introduced in Chapter 241.

банан *banán*
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 223.

банк *bank*
a bank
Introduced in Chapter 78.

банкомат *bankomát*
a cash machine
Introduced in Chapter 203.

барабан *barabán*
a drum
Introduced in Chapter 226.

баранина *baránina*
lamb (meat)
Introduced in Chapter 249.

баскетбол *basketból*
basketball
Introduced in Chapter 252.

бассейн *basséyn*
a swimming pool
Introduced in Chapter 88.

батарея *bataréya*
a radiator; a battery
Introduced in Chapter 191.

бедный *bédnyy*
poor
Introduced in Chapter 156.

бег *beg*
running
Introduced in Chapter 252.

бегать *bégat*
to run about, to jog
Introduced in Chapter 178.

белка *bélka*
a squirrel
Introduced in Chapter 118.

белый *bélyy*
white
Introduced in Chapter 63.

бензин *benzín*
petrol
Introduced in Chapter 167.

берег *béreg*
a shore, a bank
Introduced in Chapter 57.

берёза *beryóza*
a birch
Introduced in Chapter 224.

бежать *bezhát*
to run
Introduced in Chapter 40.

библиотека *bibliotéka*
a library
Introduced in Chapter 242.

билет *bilét*
a ticket
Introduced in Chapter 54.

бинт *bint*
a bandage
Introduced in Chapter 210.

бизнес *bíznes*
business
Introduced in Chapter 203.

благодарить *blagodarít*
to thank
Introduced in Chapter 141.

бледный *blédnyy*
pale
Introduced in Chapter 148.

блин *blin*
a pancake
Introduced in Chapter 163.

близко *blízko*
near, close by
Introduced in Chapter 72.

блузка *blúzka*
a blouse
Introduced in Chapter 162.

блюдо *blyúdo*
a dish
Introduced in Chapter 222.

блюдце *blyúdtse*
a saucer
Introduced in Chapter 246.

богатый *bogátyy*
rich
Introduced in Chapter 156.

бокал *bokál*
a wine glass
Introduced in Chapter 160.

боль *bol*
pain
Introduced in Chapter 32.

болеть *bolét*
to be ill; to ache
Introduced in Chapter 207.

болезнь *bolézn*
an illness
Introduced in Chapter 32.

больница *bolnítsa*
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 32.

больной *bolnóy*
ill; a patient
Introduced in Chapter 147.

большой *bolshóy*
big
Introduced in Chapter 65.

борщ *borshch*
borscht
Introduced in Chapter 163.

бояться *boyátsya*
to be afraid
Introduced in Chapter 144.

брат *brat*
brother — masculine, one soft sign away from a verb you already know, and this time it really is your English cousin
Introduced in Chapter 7.

брать *brat'*
to take — English bear, and a partner from a completely different root
Introduced in Chapter 5.

бритва *brítva*
a razor
Introduced in Chapter 219.

бронировать *bronírovat*
to book, to reserve
Introduced in Chapter 146.

бросать *brosát*
to throw
Introduced in Chapter 142.

бровь *brov*
an eyebrow
Introduced in Chapter 239.

брюки *bryúki*
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 103.

будильник *budílnik*
an alarm clock
Introduced in Chapter 99.

будущий *búdushchiy*
future, next
Introduced in Chapter 138.

бухгалтер *bukhgálter*
an accountant
Introduced in Chapter 229.

булка *búlka*
a bun, a roll
Introduced in Chapter 222.

бумага *bumága*
paper
Introduced in Chapter 52.

бутерброд *buterbród*
a sandwich
Introduced in Chapter 105.

бутылка *butýlka*
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 123.

бык *byk*
a bull
Introduced in Chapter 251.

быстро *býstro*
quickly
Introduced in Chapter 75.

быстрый *býstryy*
fast
Introduced in Chapter 66.

быть *byt'*
to be — and the one tense in which Russian refuses to say it
Introduced in Chapter 3.

чай *chai*
tea — masculine, regular this time, and the overland twin of кофе's sea route
Introduced in Chapter 6.

час *chas*
an hour
Introduced in Chapter 69.

чашка *cháshka*
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 51.

часто *chásto*
often
Introduced in Chapter 85.

часы *chasý*
a clock, a watch
Introduced in Chapter 50.

чайник *cháynik*
a kettle
Introduced in Chapter 246.

чек *chek*
a receipt
Introduced in Chapter 139.

человек *chelovék*
a person
Introduced in Chapter 227.

чемодан *chemodán*
a suitcase
Introduced in Chapter 92.

черепаха *cherepákha*
a tortoise, a turtle
Introduced in Chapter 117.

через *chérez*
in (a week), after
Introduced in Chapter 138.

чеснок *chesnók*
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 104.

честный *chéstnyy*
honest
Introduced in Chapter 186.

четверг *chetvérg*
Thursday
Introduced in Chapter 70.

четверть *chétvert*
a quarter
Introduced in Chapter 149.

четыре *chetýre*
four — where a kw became a ch, as it did in every Slavic language
Introduced in Chapter 23.

чихать *chikhát*
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 207.

чинить *chinít*
to repair
Introduced in Chapter 133.

чистить *chístit*
to clean, to peel
Introduced in Chapter 206.

чистый *chístyy*
clean
Introduced in Chapter 156.

читать *chitát'*
to read — and why Russian has no separate way to say I am reading
Introduced in Chapter 4.

чувствовать *chúvstvovat*
to feel
Introduced in Chapter 208.

чужой *chuzhóy*
someone else's; unfamiliar
Introduced in Chapter 189.

чёрный *chyórnyy*
black
Introduced in Chapter 63.

да *da*
yes (da)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

до встречи *da fstréchi*
see you later — literally 'until the meeting'
Introduced in Chapter 11.

до скорого *da skórava*
see you soon — literally 'until the soon [one]'
Introduced in Chapter 11.

до свидания *da svidániya*
goodbye (formal / neutral) — literally 'until [our] seeing each other again'
Introduced in Chapter 11.

до завтра *da záftra*
see you tomorrow — literally 'until [the] morning-after'
Introduced in Chapter 11.

далеко *dalekó*
far
Introduced in Chapter 72.

дата *dáta*
a date
Introduced in Chapter 85.

давать *davát*
to give
Introduced in Chapter 41.

давление *davléniye*
pressure; blood pressure
Introduced in Chapter 211.

давно *davnó*
long ago; for a long time
Introduced in Chapter 137.

декабрь *dekábr*
December
Introduced in Chapter 240.

дельфин *delfín*
a dolphin
Introduced in Chapter 118.

день *den*
a day
Introduced in Chapter 68.

день рождения *den rozhdéniya*
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 182.

деньги *déngi*
money
Introduced in Chapter 53.

деревня *derévnya*
a village
Introduced in Chapter 55.

дерево *dérevo*
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 55.

держать *derzhát*
to hold
Introduced in Chapter 142.

десерт *desért*
a dessert
Introduced in Chapter 106.

дешёвый *deshyóvyy*
cheap
Introduced in Chapter 67.

десять *désyat*
ten — the word behind decimal, and the one nine copied
Introduced in Chapter 24.

дети *déti*
children
Introduced in Chapter 36.

девочка *dévochka*
a girl
Introduced in Chapter 254.

девушка *dévushka*
a young woman, a girlfriend
Introduced in Chapter 254.

девяносто *devyanósto*
ninety
Introduced in Chapter 76.

девять *dévyat*
nine — and the ten it is about to rhyme with
Introduced in Chapter 24.

директор *diréktor*
a director, a head
Introduced in Chapter 201.

диван *diván*
a sofa
Introduced in Chapter 97.

диета *diyéta*
a diet
Introduced in Chapter 180.

длинный *dlínnyy*
long
Introduced in Chapter 65.

днём *dnyom*
in the daytime
Introduced in Chapter 84.

добрый *dóbryy*
kind
Introduced in Chapter 127.

дочь *doch*
a daughter
Introduced in Chapter 35.

договор *dogovór*
a contract
Introduced in Chapter 172.

документ *dokuménт*
a document
Introduced in Chapter 247.

должность *dólzhnost*
a post, a position
Introduced in Chapter 170.

дом *dom*
a house, home
Introduced in Chapter 48.

домашнее задание *domáshneye zadániye*
homework
Introduced in Chapter 111.

дорога *doróga*
a road; the way
Introduced in Chapter 183.

дорогой *dorogóy*
expensive; dear
Introduced in Chapter 67.

доска *doská*
a board
Introduced in Chapter 111.

дождь *dozhd*
rain
Introduced in Chapter 59.

древний *drévniy*
ancient
Introduced in Chapter 244.

друг *drug*
friend (male, or unspecified) — masculine, and the reason you own ты at all
Introduced in Chapter 7.

другой *drugóy*
other, another — your word for friend, doing a second job, and half of a joining pattern
Introduced in Chapter 17.

дуб *dub*
an oak
Introduced in Chapter 195.

духовка *dukhóvka*
an oven
Introduced in Chapter 219.

думать *dúmat'*
to think — and the fact that shapes every Russian verb you will ever meet
Introduced in Chapter 4.

душ *dush*
a shower
Introduced in Chapter 94.

два *dva*
two — the second number in the book, twenty-two chapters after the first
Introduced in Chapter 23.

двадцать *dvádtsat*
twenty — two tens, with both halves still audible
Introduced in Chapter 25.

двенадцать *dvenádtsat*
twelve
Introduced in Chapter 75.

дверь *dver*
a door
Introduced in Chapter 48.

двор *dvor*
a yard, a courtyard
Introduced in Chapter 241.

дыня *dýnya*
a melon
Introduced in Chapter 104.

дышать *dyshát*
to breathe
Introduced in Chapter 207.

джинсы *dzhínsy*
jeans
Introduced in Chapter 248.

экран *ekrán*
a screen
Introduced in Chapter 220.

экзамен *ekzámen*
an exam
Introduced in Chapter 111.

электричка *elektríchka*
a suburban train
Introduced in Chapter 167.

электрик *elektrík*
an electrician
Introduced in Chapter 202.

эта *éta*
this (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 82.

этаж *etázh*
a floor, a storey
Introduced in Chapter 213.

этот *étot*
this (masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 82.

фамилия *famíliya*
a surname
Introduced in Chapter 255.

фасоль *fasól*
beans
Introduced in Chapter 223.

фермер *férmer*
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 108.

февраль *fevrál*
February
Introduced in Chapter 181.

фильм *film*
a film
Introduced in Chapter 113.

фиолетовый *fiolétovyy*
purple
Introduced in Chapter 124.

фирма *fírma*
a firm
Introduced in Chapter 257.

фонтан *fontán*
a fountain
Introduced in Chapter 153.

фотоаппарат *fotoapparát*
a camera
Introduced in Chapter 99.

фотографировать *fotografírovat*
to photograph
Introduced in Chapter 209.

фотография *fotográfiya*
a photograph
Introduced in Chapter 100.

фрукты *frúkty*
fruit
Introduced in Chapter 44.

футбол *futból*
football
Introduced in Chapter 114.

футболка *futbólka*
a T-shirt
Introduced in Chapter 162.

галстук *gálstuk*
a tie
Introduced in Chapter 101.

гасить *gasít*
to put out
Introduced in Chapter 206.

газета *gazéta*
a newspaper
Introduced in Chapter 192.

где *gde*
where
Introduced in Chapter 86.

гитара *gitára*
a guitar
Introduced in Chapter 197.

гладить *gládit*
to iron; to stroke
Introduced in Chapter 140.

гладкий *gládkiy*
smooth
Introduced in Chapter 217.

главный *glávnyy*
main
Introduced in Chapter 218.

глаз *glaz*
eye — masculine, and the word that quietly evicted Russian's inherited word for eye
Introduced in Chapter 9.

глубокий *glubókiy*
deep
Introduced in Chapter 187.

глупый *glúpyy*
silly, stupid
Introduced in Chapter 155.

гнев *gnev*
anger
Introduced in Chapter 34.

год *god*
a year
Introduced in Chapter 68.

голод *gólod*
hunger
Introduced in Chapter 33.

голодный *golódnyy*
hungry
Introduced in Chapter 158.

голова *golová*
the head
Introduced in Chapter 29.

головная боль *golovnáya bol*
a headache
Introduced in Chapter 180.

голубь *gólub*
a pigeon
Introduced in Chapter 251.

голубой *golubóy*
light blue
Introduced in Chapter 157.

гора *gorá*
a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 56.

горький *górkiy*
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 130.

горло *górlo*
a throat
Introduced in Chapter 121.

город *górod*
a city, a town
Introduced in Chapter 77.

горох *gorókh*
peas
Introduced in Chapter 194.

горячий *goryáchiy*
hot
Introduced in Chapter 66.

гость *gost*
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 37.

гостиница *gostínitsa*
a hotel
Introduced in Chapter 80.

готовить *gotóvit*
to cook, to prepare
Introduced in Chapter 39.

готовый *gotóvyy*
ready
Introduced in Chapter 128.

говорить *govorít'*
to speak — one new letter, and a false friend worth killing early
Introduced in Chapter 3.

говядина *govyádina*
beef
Introduced in Chapter 104.

граница *granítsa*
a border
Introduced in Chapter 213.

гражданин *grazhdanín*
a citizen
Introduced in Chapter 199.

гриб *grib*
a mushroom
Introduced in Chapter 47.

грипп *gripp*
flu
Introduced in Chapter 147.

гром *grom*
thunder
Introduced in Chapter 122.

громкий *grómkiy*
loud
Introduced in Chapter 244.

гроза *grozá*
a thunderstorm
Introduced in Chapter 115.

грубый *grúbyy*
rude
Introduced in Chapter 186.

грудь *grud*
the chest
Introduced in Chapter 119.

груша *grúsha*
a pear
Introduced in Chapter 44.

грусть *grust*
sadness
Introduced in Chapter 34.

грустный *grústnyy*
sad
Introduced in Chapter 216.

грузовик *gruzovík*
a lorry
Introduced in Chapter 167.

грязный *gryáznyy*
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 156.

губа *gubá*
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 31.

губы *gúby*
lips
Introduced in Chapter 119.

гулять *gulyát*
to go for a walk
Introduced in Chapter 134.

гусь *gus*
a goose
Introduced in Chapter 251.

гвоздь *gvozd*
a nail
Introduced in Chapter 98.

и *i*
and — one letter, one sound, and the commonest word in the language
Introduced in Chapter 16.

идея *idéya*
an idea
Introduced in Chapter 111.

идти *idtí*
to go — the one-way verb, and a past tense from a different root entirely
Introduced in Chapter 3.

игра *igrá*
a game
Introduced in Chapter 113.

играть *igrát*
to play
Introduced in Chapter 40.

игрушка *igrúshka*
a toy
Introduced in Chapter 221.

или *íli*
or — and it is и with a small question-word stuck on the end
Introduced in Chapter 16.

имя *ímya*
a first name
Introduced in Chapter 228.

иначе *ináche*
otherwise
Introduced in Chapter 154.

иногда *inogdá*
sometimes
Introduced in Chapter 74.

иностранец *inostránets*
a foreigner
Introduced in Chapter 199.

иностранный *inostránnyy*
foreign
Introduced in Chapter 189.

интересный *interésnyy*
interesting
Introduced in Chapter 126.

инженер *inzhenér*
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 109.

искать *iskát*
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 134.

история *istóriya*
a story; history
Introduced in Chapter 253.

июль *iyúl*
July
Introduced in Chapter 212.

июнь *iyún*
June
Introduced in Chapter 212.

измерять *izmeryát*
to measure
Introduced in Chapter 236.

изучать *izuchát*
to study (a subject)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

известный *izvéstnyy*
famous
Introduced in Chapter 126.

извините *izvinítye*
excuse me, sorry — the word this book had no way of saying, and the way every request to a stranger starts
Introduced in Chapter 21.

извиняться *izvinyátsya*
to apologise
Introduced in Chapter 141.

к счастью *k schástyu*
fortunately
Introduced in Chapter 215.

к сожалению *k sozhaléniyu*
unfortunately
Introduced in Chapter 215.

кафе *kafé*
a café
Introduced in Chapter 242.

когда *kagdá*
when — the fifth of the question family, and the one whose spelling and sound part company again
Introduced in Chapter 19.

как вас зовут? *kak vas zovút*
what's your name? — literally 'HOW do they call you?', not 'what'
Introduced in Chapter 2.

какой *kakóy*
which, what kind of — the family member the book named two chapters before it taught it
Introduced in Chapter 22.

календарь *kalendár*
a calendar
Introduced in Chapter 100.

камень *kámen*
a stone
Introduced in Chapter 57.

каникулы *kanníkuly*
school holidays
Introduced in Chapter 182.

капли *kápli*
drops (medicine)
Introduced in Chapter 238.

капуста *kapústa*
cabbage
Introduced in Chapter 194.

карандаш *karandásh*
a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 52.

карман *karmán*
a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 193.

карта *kárta*
a map; a card
Introduced in Chapter 54.

картина *kartína*
a painting
Introduced in Chapter 221.

картошка *kartóshka*
potatoes
Introduced in Chapter 45.

карьера *karyéra*
a career
Introduced in Chapter 172.

каша *kásha*
porridge
Introduced in Chapter 46.

кашель *káshel*
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 33.

кашлять *káshlyat*
to cough
Introduced in Chapter 207.

касса *kássa*
a till, a checkout
Introduced in Chapter 110.

кассир *kassír*
a cashier
Introduced in Chapter 230.

кастрюля *kastryúlya*
a saucepan
Introduced in Chapter 97.

кататься *katátsya*
to go for a ride, to skate
Introduced in Chapter 178.

который *katóryy*
who, which, that — the word that hangs a whole clause onto a noun, and English 'whether' is its cousin
Introduced in Chapter 22.

каждый *kázhdyy*
every, each
Introduced in Chapter 150.

кефир *kefír*
kefir
Introduced in Chapter 222.

хотеть *khatét*
to want — the verb this book has been able to describe everything except desire without
Introduced in Chapter 20.

хлеб *khleb*
bread — masculine, and not a Slavic word at all
Introduced in Chapter 6.

хобби *khóbbi*
a hobby
Introduced in Chapter 197.

ходить *khodít*
to walk, to go (on foot)
Introduced in Chapter 143.

хоккей *khokkéy*
hockey
Introduced in Chapter 252.

холм *kholm*
a hill
Introduced in Chapter 115.

холодильник *kholodílnik*
a fridge
Introduced in Chapter 94.

холодный *kholódnyy*
cold
Introduced in Chapter 66.

хомяк *khomyák*
a hamster
Introduced in Chapter 165.

хороший *khoróshiy*
good
Introduced in Chapter 64.

хотя *khotyá*
although
Introduced in Chapter 154.

храбрый *khrábryy*
brave
Introduced in Chapter 186.

храм *khram*
a temple, a church
Introduced in Chapter 153.

худой *khudóy*
thin
Introduced in Chapter 130.

художник *khudózhnik*
an artist, a painter
Introduced in Chapter 256.

хвалить *khvalít*
to praise
Introduced in Chapter 144.

кино *kinó*
a cinema
Introduced in Chapter 88.

кислый *kíslyy*
sour
Introduced in Chapter 157.

кит *kit*
a whale
Introduced in Chapter 118.

класс *klass*
a class
Introduced in Chapter 110.

класть *klast*
to put (flat)
Introduced in Chapter 131.

клавиатура *klaviatúra*
a keyboard
Introduced in Chapter 220.

клей *kley*
glue
Introduced in Chapter 99.

климат *klímat*
a climate
Introduced in Chapter 164.

клиент *kliyént*
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 110.

клубника *klubníka*
strawberries
Introduced in Chapter 104.

ключ *klyuch*
a key
Introduced in Chapter 49.

книга *kníga*
a book
Introduced in Chapter 52.

кофе *kófe*
coffee — masculine, the one exception worth meeting on purpose
Introduced in Chapter 6.

колбаса *kolbasá*
sausage
Introduced in Chapter 106.

колено *koléno*
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 30.

колготки *kolgótki*
tights
Introduced in Chapter 162.

коллега *kolléga*
a colleague
Introduced in Chapter 201.

кольцо *koltsó*
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 100.

команда *kománda*
a team
Introduced in Chapter 166.

командировка *komandiróvka*
a business trip
Introduced in Chapter 172.

комар *komár*
a mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 196.

комната *kómnata*
a room
Introduced in Chapter 48.

комод *komód*
a chest of drawers
Introduced in Chapter 159.

компания *kompániya*
a company
Introduced in Chapter 257.

компьютер *kompyúter*
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 94.

конечно *konéchno*
of course
Introduced in Chapter 215.

конфета *konféta*
a sweet
Introduced in Chapter 250.

коньки *konkí*
skates
Introduced in Chapter 166.

концерт *kontsért*
a concert
Introduced in Chapter 114.

конверт *konvért*
an envelope
Introduced in Chapter 161.

копейка *kopéyka*
a kopeck
Introduced in Chapter 231.

копить *kopít*
to save up
Introduced in Chapter 232.

корабль *korábl'*
a ship
Introduced in Chapter 91.

корень *kóren*
a root
Introduced in Chapter 195.

коричневый *koríchnevyy*
brown
Introduced in Chapter 124.

кормить *kormít*
to feed
Introduced in Chapter 234.

коробка *koróbka*
a box
Introduced in Chapter 160.

короткий *korótkiy*
short
Introduced in Chapter 65.

корова *koróva*
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 60.

кошелёк *koshelyók*
a purse, a wallet
Introduced in Chapter 99.

кошка *kóshka*
a cat
Introduced in Chapter 60.

космос *kósmos*
space
Introduced in Chapter 123.

кость *kost*
a bone
Introduced in Chapter 211.

костюм *kostyúm*
a suit
Introduced in Chapter 248.

ковёр *kovyór*
a rug, a carpet
Introduced in Chapter 92.

коза *kozá*
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 62.

кожа *kózha*
skin
Introduced in Chapter 121.

кран *kran*
a tap
Introduced in Chapter 190.

красить *krásit*
to paint, to dye
Introduced in Chapter 206.

красивый *krasívyy*
beautiful
Introduced in Chapter 64.

красный *krásnyy*
red
Introduced in Chapter 63.

кресло *kréslo*
an armchair
Introduced in Chapter 159.

креветка *krevétka*
a prawn
Introduced in Chapter 163.

кричать *krichát*
to shout
Introduced in Chapter 235.

крокодил *krokodíl*
a crocodile
Introduced in Chapter 225.

кролик *królik*
a rabbit
Introduced in Chapter 117.

кроссовки *krossóvki*
trainers
Introduced in Chapter 162.

кровь *krov*
blood
Introduced in Chapter 31.

кровать *krovát*
a bed
Introduced in Chapter 49.

круглый *krúglyy*
round
Introduced in Chapter 129.

кружка *krúzhka*
a mug
Introduced in Chapter 246.

крыса *krýsa*
a rat
Introduced in Chapter 196.

крыша *krýsha*
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 50.

кто *kto*
who — что's twin, and the one Russian says exactly as it is spelled
Introduced in Chapter 22.

куда *kudá*
where to
Introduced in Chapter 86.

кухня *kúkhnya*
a kitchen
Introduced in Chapter 48.

кукла *kúkla*
a doll
Introduced in Chapter 221.

курица *kúritsa*
a hen
Introduced in Chapter 62.

куртка *kúrtka*
a jacket
Introduced in Chapter 103.

куст *kust*
a bush
Introduced in Chapter 224.

квадратный *kvadrátnyy*
square
Introduced in Chapter 187.

квартира *kvartíra*
a flat
Introduced in Chapter 213.

лампа *lámpa*
a lamp
Introduced in Chapter 49.

лампочка *lámpochka*
a light bulb
Introduced in Chapter 160.

ластик *lástik*
a rubber, an eraser
Introduced in Chapter 111.

лечить *lechít*
to treat (an illness)
Introduced in Chapter 207.

лекарство *lekárstvo*
medicine
Introduced in Chapter 32.

лекция *léktsiya*
a lecture
Introduced in Chapter 231.

ленивый *lenívyy*
lazy
Introduced in Chapter 155.

лес *les*
a forest
Introduced in Chapter 56.

лестница *léstnitsa*
stairs
Introduced in Chapter 123.

летать *letát*
to fly
Introduced in Chapter 143.

лето *léto*
summer
Introduced in Chapter 71.

лев *lev*
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 120.

лифт *lift*
a lift
Introduced in Chapter 90.

лимон *limón*
a lemon
Introduced in Chapter 223.

линейка *linéyka*
a ruler
Introduced in Chapter 192.

лиса *lisá*
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 61.

лист *list*
a leaf; a sheet of paper
Introduced in Chapter 55.

лицо *litsó*
the face
Introduced in Chapter 31.

лоб *lob*
a forehead
Introduced in Chapter 239.

лодка *lódka*
a boat
Introduced in Chapter 91.

лодыжка *lodýzhka*
an ankle
Introduced in Chapter 119.

локоть *lókot*
an elbow
Introduced in Chapter 118.

ломать *lomát*
to break
Introduced in Chapter 206.

лошадь *lóshad*
a horse
Introduced in Chapter 60.

ловить *lovít*
to catch
Introduced in Chapter 142.

ложь *lozh*
a lie
Introduced in Chapter 169.

ложка *lózhka*
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 51.

лук *luk*
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 45.

луна *luná*
the moon
Introduced in Chapter 58.

лягушка *lyagúshka*
a frog
Introduced in Chapter 117.

лёд *lyod*
ice
Introduced in Chapter 115.

лёгкие *lyógkiye*
the lungs
Introduced in Chapter 180.

лёгкий *lyókhkiy*
light; easy
Introduced in Chapter 67.

лётчик *lyótchik*
a pilot
Introduced in Chapter 202.

любить *lyubít'*
to love, and to like — English love itself, with a letter that appears from nowhere
Introduced in Chapter 5.

люди *lyúdi*
people
Introduced in Chapter 101.

лыжи *lýzhi*
skis
Introduced in Chapter 166.

магазин *magazín*
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 77.

макароны *makaróny*
pasta
Introduced in Chapter 250.

молоко *malakó*
milk — neuter, and a straight cousin of the English word, hand-motion and all
Introduced in Chapter 13.

мальчик *málchik*
a boy
Introduced in Chapter 227.

маленький *málenkiy*
small
Introduced in Chapter 65.

мало *málo*
a little, few
Introduced in Chapter 73.

мама *máma*
mom — feminine, and a word that is not really a language-family cousin of anything
Introduced in Chapter 12.

марка *márka*
a postage stamp; a brand
Introduced in Chapter 161.

март *mart*
March
Introduced in Chapter 181.

машина *mashína*
a car
Introduced in Chapter 79.

масло *máslo*
butter; oil
Introduced in Chapter 43.

мать *mat'*
mother — formal register, and the real, ancient cousin behind the babble-word мама
Introduced in Chapter 12.

матч *match*
a match
Introduced in Chapter 166.

май *may*
May
Introduced in Chapter 181.

мазь *maz*
an ointment
Introduced in Chapter 238.

мебель *mébel*
furniture
Introduced in Chapter 159.

мечеть *mechét*
a mosque
Introduced in Chapter 153.

медленный *médlennyy*
slow
Introduced in Chapter 66.

медсестра *medsestrá*
a nurse
Introduced in Chapter 107.

медведь *medvéd*
a bear
Introduced in Chapter 61.

менеджер *ménedzher*
a manager
Introduced in Chapter 229.

меня зовут… *menyá zovút*
my name is… — literally 'they call me', with no word for 'my' and no word for 'name'
Introduced in Chapter 2.

меня́ть *menyát*
to change
Introduced in Chapter 233.

меню́ *menyú*
a menu
Introduced in Chapter 222.

ме́стный *méstnyy*
local
Introduced in Chapter 189.

ме́сто *mésto*
a place; a seat
Introduced in Chapter 151.

ме́сяц *mésyats*
a month
Introduced in Chapter 68.

метро́ *metró*
the underground
Introduced in Chapter 91.

ме́жду *mézhdu*
between
Introduced in Chapter 241.

микроволно́вка *mikrovolnóvka*
a microwave
Introduced in Chapter 246.

ми́лый *mílyy*
nice, sweet (of a person)
Introduced in Chapter 155.

мину́та *minúta*
a minute
Introduced in Chapter 69.

мир *mir*
the world; peace
Introduced in Chapter 59.

мири́ться *mirítsya*
to make up (after a quarrel)
Introduced in Chapter 177.

ми́ска *míska*
a bowl
Introduced in Chapter 246.

мне́ние *mnéniye*
an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 169.

много *mnógo*
a lot, many
Introduced in Chapter 73.

мочь *moch*
to be able, can — the verb the book has been printing inside помогать without ever owning it
Introduced in Chapter 20.

мокрый *mókryy*
wet
Introduced in Chapter 128.

молчать *molchát*
to be silent
Introduced in Chapter 235.

молния *mólniya*
lightning
Introduced in Chapter 122.

молодой *molodóy*
young
Introduced in Chapter 243.

молодёжь *molodyózh*
young people
Introduced in Chapter 199.

молоток *molotók*
a hammer
Introduced in Chapter 98.

монета *monéta*
a coin
Introduced in Chapter 203.

море *móre*
the sea
Introduced in Chapter 56.

морковь *morkóv*
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 45.

мороженое *morózhenoye*
ice cream
Introduced in Chapter 106.

моряк *moryák*
a sailor
Introduced in Chapter 202.

мост *most*
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 79.

мотоцикл *mototsíkl*
a motorbike
Introduced in Chapter 167.

может быть *mózhet byt*
maybe
Introduced in Chapter 215.

мука *muká*
flour
Introduced in Chapter 105.

муха *múkha*
a fly
Introduced in Chapter 196.

муравей *muravéy*
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 120.

мусор *músor*
rubbish
Introduced in Chapter 96.

музей *muzéy*
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 78.

муж *muzh*
a husband
Introduced in Chapter 35.

мужчина *muzhchína*
a man
Introduced in Chapter 227.

музыка *múzyka*
music
Introduced in Chapter 112.

музыкант *muzykánt*
a musician
Introduced in Chapter 256.

мяч *myach*
a ball
Introduced in Chapter 221.

мягкий *myákhkiy*
soft
Introduced in Chapter 129.

мясо *myáso*
meat
Introduced in Chapter 43.

медленно *myédlenna*
slowly — the second half of the repair kit, and the request that actually fixes listening
Introduced in Chapter 21.

мыло *mýlo*
soap
Introduced in Chapter 96.

мёд *myod*
honey
Introduced in Chapter 47.

мёртвый *myórtvyy*
dead
Introduced in Chapter 158.

мышь *mysh*
a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 61.

мышца *mýshtsa*
a muscle
Introduced in Chapter 211.

мыть *myt*
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 39.

начальник *nachálnik*
a boss
Introduced in Chapter 110.

начинать *nachinát*
to begin
Introduced in Chapter 131.

надо *náda*
it is necessary — a sentence with a verb, an infinitive, and no subject at all
Introduced in Chapter 20.

надеяться *nadéyatsya*
to hope
Introduced in Chapter 138.

находить *nakhodít*
to find
Introduced in Chapter 134.

наконец *nakonéts*
at last, finally
Introduced in Chapter 150.

налево *nalévo*
to the left
Introduced in Chapter 86.

наличные *nalíchnyye*
cash
Introduced in Chapter 170.

наливать *nalivát*
to pour
Introduced in Chapter 173.

налог *nalóg*
a tax
Introduced in Chapter 170.

направо *napravo*
to the right
Introduced in Chapter 86.

например *naprimér*
for example
Introduced in Chapter 185.

напротив *naprótiv*
opposite
Introduced in Chapter 241.

насморк *násmork*
a runny nose
Introduced in Chapter 147.

наушники *naúshniki*
headphones
Introduced in Chapter 247.

наверху *naverkhú*
up above, upstairs
Introduced in Chapter 72.

наверное *navérnoye*
probably
Introduced in Chapter 215.

назад *nazád*
back, backwards
Introduced in Chapter 214.

небо *nébo*
the sky
Introduced in Chapter 58.

недавно *nedávno*
recently
Introduced in Chapter 137.

неделя *nedélya*
a week
Introduced in Chapter 68.

некрасивый *nekrasívyy*
ugly
Introduced in Chapter 243.

ненавидеть *nenavídet*
to hate
Introduced in Chapter 144.

неправильный *neprávilnyy*
wrong
Introduced in Chapter 128.

нервный *nérvnyy*
nervous
Introduced in Chapter 216.

невеста *nevésta*
a bride, a fiancée
Introduced in Chapter 168.

ничего *nichevó*
nothing
Introduced in Chapter 136.

нигде *nigdé*
nowhere
Introduced in Chapter 136.

никогда *nikogdá*
never
Introduced in Chapter 74.

никто *niktó*
nobody
Introduced in Chapter 136.

никуда *nikudá*
(to) nowhere
Introduced in Chapter 136.

низкий *nízkiy*
low, short
Introduced in Chapter 243.

но *no*
but — the flat contradiction, one of two words English hides under a single but
Introduced in Chapter 17.

ночью *nóchyu*
at night
Introduced in Chapter 84.

нога *nogá*
a leg, a foot
Introduced in Chapter 29.

ноготь *nógot*
a nail
Introduced in Chapter 121.

ноль *nol*
zero
Introduced in Chapter 75.

номер *nómer*
a number; a hotel room
Introduced in Chapter 255.

нос *nos*
nose — masculine, and the same word as English nose and Latin nasus
Introduced in Chapter 9.

носить *nosít*
to carry; to wear
Introduced in Chapter 142.

носки *noskí*
socks
Introduced in Chapter 102.

ноутбук *noutbúk*
a laptop
Introduced in Chapter 191.

новый *nóvyy*
new
Introduced in Chapter 64.

ноябрь *noyábr*
November
Introduced in Chapter 240.

нож *nozh*
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 51.

ножницы *nózhnitsy*
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 99.

нравиться *nrávitsya*
to please, to be liked
Introduced in Chapter 144.

нужный *núzhnyy*
necessary
Introduced in Chapter 188.

няня *nyánya*
a nanny
Introduced in Chapter 230.

нет *nyet*
no (nyet)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

нюхать *nyúkhat*
to sniff, to smell
Introduced in Chapter 208.

обед *obéd*
lunch, the midday meal
Introduced in Chapter 46.

обедать *obédat*
to have lunch
Introduced in Chapter 140.

обещать *obeshchát*
to promise
Introduced in Chapter 209.

обезьяна *obezyána*
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 120.

облако *óblako*
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 58.

обнимать *obnimát*
to hug
Introduced in Chapter 177.

обычно *obýchno*
usually
Introduced in Chapter 240.

обычный *obýchnyy*
ordinary, usual
Introduced in Chapter 218.

очень приятно *óchen priyátno*
pleased to meet you — literally 'very pleasant', and a cousin of English FRIEND
Introduced in Chapter 2.

одеваться *odevátsya*
to get dressed
Introduced in Chapter 132.

одеяло *odeyálo*
a blanket
Introduced in Chapter 95.

одежда *odézhda*
clothes
Introduced in Chapter 248.

одинаковый *odinákovyy*
the same, identical
Introduced in Chapter 218.

одиннадцать *odínnadtsat*
eleven
Introduced in Chapter 75.

офис *ófis*
an office
Introduced in Chapter 89.

официант *ofitsiánt*
a waiter
Introduced in Chapter 109.

огурец *oguréts*
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 45.

охранник *okhránnik*
a security guard
Introduced in Chapter 230.

окно *oknó*
a window
Introduced in Chapter 48.

около *ókolo*
beside; roughly (with numbers)
Introduced in Chapter 152.

окраина *okráina*
the outskirts
Introduced in Chapter 151.

октябрь *oktyábr*
October
Introduced in Chapter 212.

олень *olén*
a deer
Introduced in Chapter 225.

опасный *opásnyy*
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 128.

опаздывать *opázdyvat*
to be late
Introduced in Chapter 176.

описывать *opísyvat*
to describe
Introduced in Chapter 174.

опыт *ópyt*
experience; an experiment
Introduced in Chapter 257.

оранжевый *oránzhevyy*
orange (the colour)
Introduced in Chapter 124.

орех *orékh*
a nut
Introduced in Chapter 107.

орёл *oryól*
an eagle
Introduced in Chapter 165.

осень *ósen*
autumn
Introduced in Chapter 71.

ошибка *oshíbka*
a mistake
Introduced in Chapter 228.

останавливаться *ostanávlivatsya*
to stop
Introduced in Chapter 146.

остановка *ostanóvka*
a stop (bus, tram)
Introduced in Chapter 87.

оставаться *ostavátsya*
to stay
Introduced in Chapter 133.

остров *óstrov*
an island
Introduced in Chapter 57.

острый *óstryy*
sharp; spicy
Introduced in Chapter 187.

осёл *osyól*
a donkey
Introduced in Chapter 116.

отдых *ótdykh*
rest
Introduced in Chapter 33.

отдыхать *otdykhát*
to rest
Introduced in Chapter 176.

открытка *otkrýtka*
a postcard
Introduced in Chapter 161.

открытый *otkrýtyy*
open
Introduced in Chapter 125.

открывать *otkryvát*
to open
Introduced in Chapter 42.

откуда *otkúda*
where from
Introduced in Chapter 86.

отличный *otlíchnyy*
excellent
Introduced in Chapter 245.

отправлять *otpravlyát*
to send
Introduced in Chapter 232.

отпуск *ótpusk*
holidays, leave
Introduced in Chapter 92.

оценка *otsénka*
a mark, a grade
Introduced in Chapter 231.

отсюда *otsyúda*
from here
Introduced in Chapter 214.

оттуда *ottúda*
from there
Introduced in Chapter 184.

отвечать *otvechát*
to answer
Introduced in Chapter 41.

ответ *otvét*
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 42.

овощи *óvoshchi*
vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 104.

овца *ovtsá*
a sheep
Introduced in Chapter 224.

озеро *ózero*
a lake
Introduced in Chapter 56.

ожог *ozhóg*
a burn
Introduced in Chapter 210.

почему *pachemú*
why — literally 'after what', and the fourth member of the question family
Introduced in Chapter 19.

падать *pádat*
to fall
Introduced in Chapter 132.

повторите *paftarítye*
say it again — the first thing you can do about not understanding, and the book's first named imperative
Introduced in Chapter 21.

пока *paká*
bye — casual, and much younger than it sounds
Introduced in Chapter 11.

пакет *pakét*
a bag (plastic or paper)
Introduced in Chapter 160.

палец *pálets*
a finger
Introduced in Chapter 30.

пальто *paltó*
a coat
Introduced in Chapter 102.

помогите *pamagítye*
help me — a verb you have owned since the hand chapter, wearing the ending you learned two lessons ago
Introduced in Chapter 21.

памятник *pámyatnik*
a monument
Introduced in Chapter 153.

папа *pápa*
dad — masculine despite the -а ending, the first noun in this book where biology beats the spelling rule
Introduced in Chapter 12.

папка *pápka*
a folder
Introduced in Chapter 192.

парень *páren*
a lad, a boyfriend
Introduced in Chapter 254.

парикмахер *parikmákher*
a hairdresser
Introduced in Chapter 230.

парк *park*
a park
Introduced in Chapter 80.

парковать *parkovát*
to park
Introduced in Chapter 146.

паспорт *pásport*
a passport
Introduced in Chapter 247.

пассажир *passazhír*
a passenger
Introduced in Chapter 198.

потому что *patamú shto*
because — the question **почему** answered by turning it round, word for word
Introduced in Chapter 19.

паук *paúk*
a spider
Introduced in Chapter 196.

пчела *pchelá*
a bee
Introduced in Chapter 120.

печать *pechát*
a seal, a stamp; print
Introduced in Chapter 203.

печатать *pechátat*
to print, to type
Introduced in Chapter 145.

печенье *pechénye*
biscuits
Introduced in Chapter 105.

пекарь *pékar*
a baker
Introduced in Chapter 108.

пельмени *pelméni*
dumplings
Introduced in Chapter 194.

пенсионер *pensionér*
a pensioner
Introduced in Chapter 168.

пенсия *pénsiya*
a pension
Introduced in Chapter 172.

перчатки *perchátki*
gloves
Introduced in Chapter 101.

перекрёсток *perekryóstok*
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 89.

перелом *perelóm*
a fracture
Introduced in Chapter 179.

пересадка *peresádka*
a transfer, a change (of trains)
Introduced in Chapter 198.

пересекать *peresekát*
to cross
Introduced in Chapter 146.

перец *pérets*
pepper
Introduced in Chapter 107.

переулок *pereúlok*
a side street
Introduced in Chapter 183.

переводить *perevodít*
to translate
Introduced in Chapter 174.

переезжать *pereyezzhát*
to move (house)
Introduced in Chapter 237.

персик *pérsik*
a peach
Introduced in Chapter 106.

первый *pérvyy*
first — which one, not how many, and a word not built from odin
Introduced in Chapter 26.

пещера *peshchéra*
a cave
Introduced in Chapter 116.

песня *pésnya*
a song
Introduced in Chapter 113.

песок *pesók*
sand
Introduced in Chapter 57.

петь *pet*
to sing
Introduced in Chapter 38.

петух *petúkh*
a cockerel
Introduced in Chapter 251.

певец *pevéts*
a singer
Introduced in Chapter 171.

пианино *pianíno*
a piano
Introduced in Chapter 197.

пирог *piróg*
a pie
Introduced in Chapter 46.

писать *pisát'*
to write — one new letter, and the one stress mistake you must not make
Introduced in Chapter 4.

пить *pit*
to drink
Introduced in Chapter 42.

пиво *pívo*
beer
Introduced in Chapter 164.

плакать *plákat*
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 38.

план *plan*
a plan
Introduced in Chapter 138.

планета *planéta*
a planet
Introduced in Chapter 122.

планировать *planírovat*
to plan
Introduced in Chapter 138.

планшет *planshét*
a tablet (computer)
Introduced in Chapter 220.

плащ *plashch*
a raincoat
Introduced in Chapter 248.

пластырь *plástyr*
a sticking plaster
Introduced in Chapter 210.

платить *platít*
to pay
Introduced in Chapter 204.

платье *plátye*
a dress
Introduced in Chapter 103.

плавание *plávaniye*
swimming
Introduced in Chapter 252.

плавать *plávat*
to swim
Introduced in Chapter 39.

плечо *plechó*
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 30.

племянник *plemyánnik*
a nephew
Introduced in Chapter 254.

плита *plitá*
a cooker
Introduced in Chapter 94.

плохо *plókho*
badly
Introduced in Chapter 67.

плохой *plokhóy*
bad
Introduced in Chapter 64.

площадь *plóshchad*
a square
Introduced in Chapter 87.

почта *póchta*
a post office
Introduced in Chapter 88.

почтальон *pochtalón*
a postman
Introduced in Chapter 109.

подарок *podárok*
a gift, a present
Introduced in Chapter 53.

подбородок *podboródok*
a chin
Introduced in Chapter 122.

подметать *podmetát*
to sweep
Introduced in Chapter 234.

поднимать *podnimát*
to lift, to raise
Introduced in Chapter 175.

подниматься *podnimátsya*
to go up
Introduced in Chapter 133.

подпись *pódpis*
a signature
Introduced in Chapter 203.

подписывать *podpísyvat*
to sign
Introduced in Chapter 145.

подруга *podrúga*
friend (female) — feminine, and друг with a prefix and an ending stitched on
Introduced in Chapter 7.

подушка *podúshka*
a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 95.

подвал *podvál*
a basement, a cellar
Introduced in Chapter 241.

поэтому *poétomu*
so, therefore
Introduced in Chapter 154.

погода *pogóda*
the weather
Introduced in Chapter 59.

показывать *pokázyvat*
to show
Introduced in Chapter 233.

похожий *pokhózhiy*
similar, alike
Introduced in Chapter 218.

покупать *pokupát*
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 39.

покупка *pokúpka*
a purchase
Introduced in Chapter 201.

полчаса *polchasá*
half an hour
Introduced in Chapter 149.

полдень *pólden*
midday
Introduced in Chapter 83.

поле *póle*
a field
Introduced in Chapter 57.

полезный *poléznyy*
useful
Introduced in Chapter 188.

поликлиника *poliklínika*
a clinic
Introduced in Chapter 238.

полицейский *politséyskiy*
a police officer
Introduced in Chapter 108.

поливать *polivát*
to water
Introduced in Chapter 234.

полка *pólka*
a shelf
Introduced in Chapter 95.

полночь *pólnoch*
midnight
Introduced in Chapter 83.

полный *pólnyy*
full
Introduced in Chapter 187.

полотенце *poloténtse*
a towel
Introduced in Chapter 96.

получать *poluchát*
to receive, to get
Introduced in Chapter 232.

помидор *pomidór*
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 45.

помнить *pómnit*
to remember
Introduced in Chapter 174.

помогать *pomogát'*
to help — built on can, which is English may and might
Introduced in Chapter 5.

помощь *pómoshch*
help
Introduced in Chapter 169.

понедельник *ponedélnik*
Monday
Introduced in Chapter 70.

понимать *ponimát'*
to understand — literally to take hold of, which is what comprehend means too
Introduced in Chapter 4.

попугай *popugáy*
a parrot
Introduced in Chapter 165.

порт *port*
a port
Introduced in Chapter 183.

посещать *poseshchát*
to visit
Introduced in Chapter 131.

последний *poslédniy*
last
Introduced in Chapter 126.

послезавтра *poslezávtra*
the day after tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 84.

посылка *posýlka*
a parcel
Introduced in Chapter 161.

потом *potóm*
later, then
Introduced in Chapter 74.

повар *póvar*
a cook
Introduced in Chapter 107.

поворачивать *povoráchivat*
to turn
Introduced in Chapter 146.

повторять *povtoryát*
to repeat
Introduced in Chapter 174.

поезд *póyezd*
a train
Introduced in Chapter 79.

позавчера *pozavcherá*
the day before yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 84.

поздно *pózdno*
late
Introduced in Chapter 83.

пожалуйста *pozhálusta*
please / you're welcome (pozhálusta)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

пожарный *pozhárnyy*
a firefighter
Introduced in Chapter 109.

пожилой *pozhilóy*
elderly
Introduced in Chapter 243.

простите *prastítye*
forgive me — the heavier of the two apologies, and the one that asks for something
Introduced in Chapter 21.

правда *právda*
the truth
Introduced in Chapter 169.

правильный *právilnyy*
right, correct
Introduced in Chapter 127.

правило *právilo*
a rule
Introduced in Chapter 228.

праздник *prázdnik*
a holiday, a celebration
Introduced in Chapter 114.

предложение *predlozhéniye*
a sentence
Introduced in Chapter 112.

предмет *predmét*
an object; a school subject
Introduced in Chapter 159.

прекрасный *prekrásnyy*
wonderful
Introduced in Chapter 245.

преподавать *prepodavát*
to teach (a subject)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

преподаватель *prepodavátel*
a lecturer, a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 229.

причина *prichína*
a reason
Introduced in Chapter 185.

приглашать *priglashát*
to invite
Introduced in Chapter 141.

приходить *prikhodít*
to come, to arrive
Introduced in Chapter 143.

пример *primér*
an example
Introduced in Chapter 228.

приносить *prinosít*
to bring
Introduced in Chapter 233.

принтер *prínter*
a printer
Introduced in Chapter 220.

природа *priróda*
nature
Introduced in Chapter 195.

привет *privét*
hi / hello (privét — informal)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

пробка *próbka*
a traffic jam; a cork
Introduced in Chapter 198.

проблема *probléma*
a problem
Introduced in Chapter 112.

пробовать *próbovat*
to try, to taste
Introduced in Chapter 204.

продавать *prodavát*
to sell
Introduced in Chapter 39.

продавец *prodavéts*
a shop assistant
Introduced in Chapter 108.

профессия *proféssiya*
a profession
Introduced in Chapter 110.

профессор *proféssor*
a professor
Introduced in Chapter 256.

программист *programmíst*
a programmer
Introduced in Chapter 229.

проигрывать *proígryvat*
to be beaten, to lose (a game)
Introduced in Chapter 145.

прохладный *prokhládnyy*
cool
Introduced in Chapter 217.

просьба *prósba*
a request
Introduced in Chapter 169.

прошлый *próshlyy*
last, past
Introduced in Chapter 137.

проспект *prospékt*
an avenue
Introduced in Chapter 151.

простуда *prostúda*
a cold
Introduced in Chapter 147.

проверять *proveryát*
to check
Introduced in Chapter 236.

провод *próvod*
a wire, a cable
Introduced in Chapter 191.

проект *proyékt*
a project
Introduced in Chapter 257.

прямо *prýamo*
straight on
Introduced in Chapter 87.

прыгать *prýgat*
to jump
Introduced in Chapter 178.

птица *ptítsa*
a bird
Introduced in Chapter 61.

пуговица *púgovitsa*
a button
Introduced in Chapter 193.

пульс *puls*
a pulse
Introduced in Chapter 211.

пульт *pult*
a remote control
Introduced in Chapter 220.

пустой *pustóy*
empty
Introduced in Chapter 156.

пустыня *pustýnya*
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 116.

путешествие *puteshéstviye*
a journey
Introduced in Chapter 92.

путешествовать *puteshéstvovat*
to travel
Introduced in Chapter 135.

пять *pyat*
five — the number inside a word English borrowed whole
Introduced in Chapter 23.

пятьдесят *pyatdesyát*
fifty
Introduced in Chapter 76.

пятница *pyátnitsa*
Friday
Introduced in Chapter 70.

пылесос *pylesós*
a vacuum cleaner
Introduced in Chapter 219.

работа *rabóta*
work, a job
Introduced in Chapter 37.

работать *rabótat*
to work
Introduced in Chapter 38.

радио *rádio*
a radio
Introduced in Chapter 247.

радость *rádost*
joy
Introduced in Chapter 34.

радуга *ráduga*
a rainbow
Introduced in Chapter 122.

раковина *rákovina*
a sink
Introduced in Chapter 190.

рана *rána*
a wound
Introduced in Chapter 179.

рано *ráno*
early
Introduced in Chapter 83.

раньше *ránshe*
before, earlier
Introduced in Chapter 137.

расчёска *raschyóska*
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 96.

расписание *raspisániye*
a timetable
Introduced in Chapter 139.

рассказывать *rasskázyvat*
to tell (a story)
Introduced in Chapter 134.

рассвет *rassvét*
dawn
Introduced in Chapter 149.

расти *rastí*
to grow
Introduced in Chapter 234.

район *rayón*
a district
Introduced in Chapter 151.

разговор *razgovór*
a conversation
Introduced in Chapter 255.

разный *ráznyy*
different, various
Introduced in Chapter 218.

ребёнок *rebyónok*
a child
Introduced in Chapter 36.

редко *rédko*
rarely
Introduced in Chapter 150.

река *reká*
a river
Introduced in Chapter 56.

реклама *rekláma*
an advert
Introduced in Chapter 139.

ремень *remén*
a belt
Introduced in Chapter 193.

ремонтировать *remontírovat*
to renovate, to repair
Introduced in Chapter 237.

решать *reshát*
to decide; to solve
Introduced in Chapter 233.

ресница *resnítsa*
an eyelash
Introduced in Chapter 239.

ресторан *restorán*
a restaurant
Introduced in Chapter 78.

рецепт *retsépt*
a prescription; a recipe
Introduced in Chapter 179.

резать *rézat*
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 173.

результат *rezultát*
a result
Introduced in Chapter 185.

резюме *rezyumé*
a CV
Introduced in Chapter 172.

рис *ris*
rice
Introduced in Chapter 47.

рисовать *risovát*
to draw
Introduced in Chapter 135.

рисунок *risúnok*
a drawing
Introduced in Chapter 113.

родители *rodíteli*
parents
Introduced in Chapter 254.

родной *rodnóy*
native; dear
Introduced in Chapter 189.

родственник *ródstvennik*
a relative
Introduced in Chapter 168.

роман *román*
a novel
Introduced in Chapter 226.

рост *rost*
height
Introduced in Chapter 239.

рот *rot*
mouth — masculine, and this time the resemblance to English is not there to trust
Introduced in Chapter 9.

ровный *róvnyy*
even, level
Introduced in Chapter 187.

роза *róza*
a rose
Introduced in Chapter 195.

розетка *rozétka*
a socket
Introduced in Chapter 191.

розовый *rózovyy*
pink
Introduced in Chapter 123.

рубашка *rubáshka*
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 103.

рубль *rubl*
a rouble
Introduced in Chapter 231.

ручка *rúchka*
a pen
Introduced in Chapter 52.

ругать *rugát*
to scold
Introduced in Chapter 144.

рука *ruká*
a hand, an arm
Introduced in Chapter 29.

русский *rússkiy*
Russian
Introduced in Chapter 189.

рядом *ryádom*
nearby, next to
Introduced in Chapter 87.

рыба *rýba*
fish
Introduced in Chapter 43.

рыбак *rybák*
a fisherman
Introduced in Chapter 202.

рынок *rýnok*
a market
Introduced in Chapter 77.

рюкзак *ryukzák*
a rucksack
Introduced in Chapter 100.

сад *sad*
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 50.

садиться *sadítsya*
to sit down
Introduced in Chapter 132.

садовник *sadóvnik*
a gardener
Introduced in Chapter 230.

сахар *sákhar*
sugar
Introduced in Chapter 47.

салат *salát*
a salad
Introduced in Chapter 194.

самолёт *samolyót*
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 79.

сантехник *santékhnik*
a plumber
Introduced in Chapter 202.

сапоги *sapogí*
boots
Introduced in Chapter 102.

сажать *sazhát*
to plant
Introduced in Chapter 234.

счастливый *schastlívyy*
happy
Introduced in Chapter 216.

считать *schitát*
to count; to consider
Introduced in Chapter 236.

счёт *schyot*
a bill; an account
Introduced in Chapter 170.

сдача *sdácha*
change (money)
Introduced in Chapter 201.

сдавать *sdavát*
to hand in; to take (an exam)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

секрет *sekrét*
a secret
Introduced in Chapter 200.

секретарь *sekretár*
a secretary
Introduced in Chapter 229.

секунда *sekúnda*
a second
Introduced in Chapter 85.

семь *sem*
seven — the s that Persian turned into an h, kept
Introduced in Chapter 24.

семья *sem'yá*
family — feminine, and an unexpected cousin of the English word home
Introduced in Chapter 8.

сентябрь *sentyábr*
September
Introduced in Chapter 212.

сердиться *serdítsya*
to be angry
Introduced in Chapter 235.

сердце *sérdtse*
heart — neuter, a silent letter, and one of the surest cognates in the entire Indo-European family
Introduced in Chapter 10.

серьги *sérgi*
earrings
Introduced in Chapter 193.

серьёзный *seryóznyy*
serious
Introduced in Chapter 127.

серый *séryy*
grey
Introduced in Chapter 124.

сестра *sestrá*
sister — feminine, brat's other half, and a cognate just as secure
Introduced in Chapter 7.

север *séver*
the north
Introduced in Chapter 90.

сегодня *sevódnya*
today
Introduced in Chapter 69.

сейчас *seychás*
now, right now
Introduced in Chapter 74.

сезон *sezón*
a season
Introduced in Chapter 240.

шахматы *shákhmaty*
chess
Introduced in Chapter 253.

шампунь *shampún*
shampoo
Introduced in Chapter 190.

шапка *shápka*
a hat
Introduced in Chapter 103.

шарф *sharf*
a scarf
Introduced in Chapter 101.

щедрый *shchédryy*
generous
Introduced in Chapter 186.

щека *shcheká*
a cheek
Introduced in Chapter 119.

щи *shchi*
cabbage soup
Introduced in Chapter 163.

шептать *sheptát*
to whisper
Introduced in Chapter 235.

шесть *shest*
six — and the first sign of the split that names half the family
Introduced in Chapter 24.

шея *shéya*
the neck
Introduced in Chapter 30.

широкий *shirókiy*
wide
Introduced in Chapter 129.

шить *shit*
to sew
Introduced in Chapter 173.

шкаф *shkaf*
a wardrobe, a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 97.

школа *shkóla*
a school
Introduced in Chapter 77.

шляпа *shlyápa*
a brimmed hat
Introduced in Chapter 193.

шоколад *shokolád*
chocolate
Introduced in Chapter 105.

шорты *shórty*
shorts
Introduced in Chapter 248.

шоссе *shossé*
a highway
Introduced in Chapter 183.

что *shto*
what — the question word, and the one Russian spells with a ч and says with a sh
Introduced in Chapter 18.

штора *shtóra*
a heavy curtain, a blind
Introduced in Chapter 190.

штраф *shtraf*
a fine
Introduced in Chapter 227.

шумный *shúmnyy*
noisy
Introduced in Chapter 125.

шутить *shutít*
to joke
Introduced in Chapter 209.

шутка *shútka*
a joke
Introduced in Chapter 200.

сидеть *sidét*
to sit
Introduced in Chapter 40.

сила *síla*
strength
Introduced in Chapter 211.

сильный *sílnyy*
strong
Introduced in Chapter 148.

синий *síniy*
blue (dark blue)
Introduced in Chapter 63.

синяк *sinyák*
a bruise
Introduced in Chapter 179.

скачивать *skáchivat*
to download
Introduced in Chapter 145.

скала *skalá*
a rock, a cliff
Introduced in Chapter 115.

сказка *skázka*
a fairy tale
Introduced in Chapter 253.

скидка *skídka*
a discount
Introduced in Chapter 201.

сколько *skólka*
how many, how much — the question word Russian uses for both, where English needs two
Introduced in Chapter 22.

скорая помощь *skóraya pómoshch*
an ambulance
Introduced in Chapter 238.

сковорода *skovorodá*
a frying pan
Introduced in Chapter 98.

скрипка *skrípka*
a violin
Introduced in Chapter 226.

скучный *skúchnyy*
boring
Introduced in Chapter 126.

слабый *slábyy*
weak
Introduced in Chapter 148.

сладкий *sládkiy*
sweet (taste)
Introduced in Chapter 157.

слева *sléva*
on the left
Introduced in Chapter 73.

слива *slíva*
a plum
Introduced in Chapter 250.

слон *slon*
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 120.

словарь *slovár*
a dictionary
Introduced in Chapter 192.

слово *slóvo*
a word
Introduced in Chapter 54.

сложный *slózhnyy*
complicated
Introduced in Chapter 188.

случиться *sluchítsya*
to happen
Introduced in Chapter 137.

слушать *slúshat*
to listen
Introduced in Chapter 41.

слёзы *slyózy*
tears
Introduced in Chapter 200.

слышать *slýshat*
to hear
Introduced in Chapter 208.

смех *smekh*
laughter
Introduced in Chapter 200.

смешной *smeshnóy*
funny
Introduced in Chapter 245.

сметана *smetána*
sour cream
Introduced in Chapter 249.

смеяться *smeyátsya*
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 38.

смотреть *smotrét*
to look, to watch
Introduced in Chapter 135.

сначала *snachála*
at first
Introduced in Chapter 150.

снаружи *snarúzhi*
outside
Introduced in Chapter 152.

снег *sneg*
snow
Introduced in Chapter 59.

снимать *snimát*
to rent; to take off
Introduced in Chapter 133.

собака *sobáka*
a dog
Introduced in Chapter 60.

собирать *sobirát*
to gather, to collect
Introduced in Chapter 209.

сок *sok*
juice — masculine, an ancient root that never surfaces in English
Introduced in Chapter 13.

сохранять *sokhranyát*
to keep; to save (a file)
Introduced in Chapter 145.

соль *sol*
salt
Introduced in Chapter 43.

солдат *soldát*
a soldier
Introduced in Chapter 171.

солнце *sólntse*
the sun
Introduced in Chapter 58.

солёный *solyónyy*
salty
Introduced in Chapter 130.

сон *son*
sleep; a dream
Introduced in Chapter 180.

сообщение *soobshchéniye*
a message
Introduced in Chapter 255.

сорок *sórok*
forty
Introduced in Chapter 76.

сосед *soséd*
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 37.

сосиска *sosíska*
a frankfurter
Introduced in Chapter 163.

сосна *sosná*
a pine
Introduced in Chapter 224.

соус *sóus*
a sauce
Introduced in Chapter 105.

сова *sová*
an owl
Introduced in Chapter 118.

советовать *sovétovat*
to advise
Introduced in Chapter 174.

современный *sovreménnyy*
modern
Introduced in Chapter 217.

спокойной ночи *spakóynay nóchi*
good night — literally 'of a calm night,' the last thing you say before sleep
Introduced in Chapter 11.

спасибо *spasíbo*
thank you (spasíbo)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

спать *spat*
to sleep
Introduced in Chapter 40.

спектакль *spektákl*
a play, a show
Introduced in Chapter 197.

спешить *speshít*
to hurry
Introduced in Chapter 176.

спина *spiná*
the back
Introduced in Chapter 31.

спокойный *spokóynyy*
calm
Introduced in Chapter 216.

спорить *spórit*
to argue
Introduced in Chapter 177.

спорт *sport*
sport
Introduced in Chapter 112.

спортзал *sportzál*
a gym
Introduced in Chapter 153.

спрашивать *spráshivat'*
to ask a question — the verb behind the question you have asked since Chapter 2
Introduced in Chapter 5.

справа *správa*
on the right
Introduced in Chapter 73.

спускаться *spuskátsya*
to go down
Introduced in Chapter 133.

сравнивать *srávnivat*
to compare
Introduced in Chapter 236.

сразу *srázu*
at once
Introduced in Chapter 240.

среда *sredá*
Wednesday
Introduced in Chapter 70.

ссориться *ssóritsya*
to quarrel
Introduced in Chapter 177.

стадион *stadión*
a stadium
Introduced in Chapter 88.

стакан *stakán*
a glass (for drinking)
Introduced in Chapter 47.

старый *stáryy*
old
Introduced in Chapter 65.

стена *stená*
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 50.

стихи *stikhí*
poems, poetry
Introduced in Chapter 226.

стиральная машина *stirálnaya mashína*
a washing machine
Introduced in Chapter 97.

стирать *stirát*
to do the laundry, to wash (clothes)
Introduced in Chapter 140.

сто *sto*
a hundred — three letters, and the word that names half the Indo-European family
Introduced in Chapter 25.

стоить *stóit*
to cost
Introduced in Chapter 204.

стол *stol*
a table
Introduced in Chapter 49.

столица *stolítsa*
a capital (city)
Introduced in Chapter 213.

стоматолог *stomatólog*
a dentist
Introduced in Chapter 210.

стоянка *stoyánka*
a car park
Introduced in Chapter 90.

стоять *stoyát*
to stand
Introduced in Chapter 40.

страх *strakh*
fear
Introduced in Chapter 34.

страна *straná*
a country
Introduced in Chapter 76.

страница *stranítsa*
a page
Introduced in Chapter 112.

странный *stránnyy*
strange
Introduced in Chapter 245.

строгий *strógiy*
strict
Introduced in Chapter 216.

строить *stróit*
to build
Introduced in Chapter 206.

строитель *stroítel*
a builder
Introduced in Chapter 171.

стучать *stuchát*
to knock
Introduced in Chapter 237.

стул *stul*
a chair
Introduced in Chapter 49.

суббота *subbóta*
Saturday
Introduced in Chapter 70.

судья *sudyá*
a judge; a referee
Introduced in Chapter 171.

сухой *sukhóy*
dry
Introduced in Chapter 128.

сумка *súmka*
a bag
Introduced in Chapter 53.

суп *sup*
soup — masculine, and an 18th-century French loan, exactly like кофе before it
Introduced in Chapter 13.

супермаркет *supermárket*
a supermarket
Introduced in Chapter 88.

сутки *sútki*
a day and a night, 24 hours
Introduced in Chapter 149.

свадьба *svádba*
a wedding
Introduced in Chapter 168.

свеча *svechá*
a candle
Introduced in Chapter 100.

светлый *svétlyy*
light, bright (of a colour or room)
Introduced in Chapter 244.

светофор *svetofór*
traffic lights
Introduced in Chapter 89.

свежий *svézhiy*
fresh
Introduced in Chapter 217.

свинина *svinína*
pork
Introduced in Chapter 249.

свинья *svinyá*
a pig
Introduced in Chapter 60.

свитер *svíter*
a jumper
Introduced in Chapter 101.

свободный *svobódnyy*
free
Introduced in Chapter 125.

свёкла *svyókla*
beetroot
Introduced in Chapter 194.

сын *syn*
a son
Introduced in Chapter 35.

сыр *syr*
cheese — masculine, and secretly the same word as сырой, 'raw'
Introduced in Chapter 13.

сытый *sýtyy*
well-fed, full up
Introduced in Chapter 158.

сюда *syudá*
to here, this way
Introduced in Chapter 184.

сзади *szádi*
behind
Introduced in Chapter 152.

та *ta*
that (feminine)
Introduced in Chapter 82.

таблетка *tablétka*
a pill
Introduced in Chapter 147.

так как *tak kak*
since, as
Introduced in Chapter 154.

такой *takóy*
such, like this
Introduced in Chapter 82.

такси *taksí*
a taxi
Introduced in Chapter 80.

там *tam*
there
Introduced in Chapter 72.

таможня *tamózhnya*
customs
Introduced in Chapter 213.

танец *tánets*
a dance
Introduced in Chapter 226.

танцевать *tantsevát*
to dance
Introduced in Chapter 38.

тапочки *tápochki*
slippers
Introduced in Chapter 162.

тарелка *tarélka*
a plate
Introduced in Chapter 51.

театр *teátr*
a theatre
Introduced in Chapter 78.

текст *tekst*
a text
Introduced in Chapter 199.

телефон *telefón*
a phone
Introduced in Chapter 53.

телевизор *televízor*
a television
Introduced in Chapter 94.

температура *temperatúra*
a temperature, a fever
Introduced in Chapter 33.

теннис *ténnis*
tennis
Introduced in Chapter 252.

теперь *tepér*
nowadays, now (after a change)
Introduced in Chapter 182.

термометр *termómetr*
a thermometer
Introduced in Chapter 238.

терять *teryát*
to lose
Introduced in Chapter 135.

тетрадь *tetrád*
a notebook
Introduced in Chapter 52.

тигр *tigr*
a tiger
Introduced in Chapter 117.

тихий *tíkhiy*
quiet
Introduced in Chapter 125.

толкать *tolkát*
to push
Introduced in Chapter 142.

толстый *tólstyy*
fat, thick
Introduced in Chapter 130.

торт *tort*
a cake
Introduced in Chapter 250.

тот *tot*
that (masculine)
Introduced in Chapter 82.

тоже *tózhe*
also, too — two little words fused, and the way to say 'me neither'
Introduced in Chapter 16.

трамвай *tramváy*
a tram
Introduced in Chapter 91.

транспорт *tránsport*
transport
Introduced in Chapter 253.

тратить *trátit*
to spend (money)
Introduced in Chapter 204.

трава *travá*
grass
Introduced in Chapter 55.

тренироваться *trenirovátsya*
to train, to practise
Introduced in Chapter 178.

тренировка *treniróvka*
a training session
Introduced in Chapter 166.

три *tri*
three — three letters, and three of them shared with English
Introduced in Chapter 23.

трогать *trógat*
to touch
Introduced in Chapter 208.

троллейбус *trolléybus*
a trolleybus
Introduced in Chapter 253.

тротуар *trotuár*
a pavement
Introduced in Chapter 183.

трудный *trúdnyy*
hard, difficult
Introduced in Chapter 67.

цель *tsel*
a goal, an aim
Introduced in Chapter 185.

целовать *tselovát*
to kiss
Introduced in Chapter 177.

цена *tsená*
a price
Introduced in Chapter 114.

центр *tsentr*
the centre
Introduced in Chapter 151.

церковь *tsérkov*
a church
Introduced in Chapter 80.

цирк *tsirk*
a circus
Introduced in Chapter 242.

цветок *tsvetók*
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 55.

туалет *tualét*
a toilet
Introduced in Chapter 190.

туда *tudá*
to there, that way
Introduced in Chapter 184.

туфли *túfli*
shoes
Introduced in Chapter 102.

туман *tumán*
fog
Introduced in Chapter 114.

тупой *tupóy*
blunt
Introduced in Chapter 217.

турист *turíst*
a tourist
Introduced in Chapter 199.

творог *tvoróg*
cottage cheese
Introduced in Chapter 249.

твёрдый *tvyórdyy*
hard
Introduced in Chapter 129.

ты, вы *ty, vy*
you (informal) and you (formal) — the split English threw away
Introduced in Chapter 2.

тянуть *tyanút*
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 175.

тяжёлый *tyazhyólyy*
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 130.

тёмный *tyómnyy*
dark
Introduced in Chapter 244.

тёплый *tyóplyy*
warm
Introduced in Chapter 66.

тётя *tyótya*
an aunt
Introduced in Chapter 36.

тысяча *týsyacha*
a thousand
Introduced in Chapter 76.

убирать *ubirát*
to tidy up
Introduced in Chapter 134.

ученик *ucheník*
a pupil
Introduced in Chapter 37.

учить *uchít*
to learn; to teach
Introduced in Chapter 41.

учитель *uchítel*
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 37.

учиться *uchítsya*
to be a student, to study
Introduced in Chapter 205.

удобный *udóbnyy*
comfortable, convenient
Introduced in Chapter 157.

угол *úgol*
a corner
Introduced in Chapter 89.

ухо *úkho*
ear — neuter, the first word Russian gives its third gender, and a word-for-word cousin of the English ear
Introduced in Chapter 9.

уходить *ukhodít*
to leave, to go away
Introduced in Chapter 143.

укол *ukól*
an injection
Introduced in Chapter 179.

улица *úlitsa*
a street
Introduced in Chapter 77.

улыбаться *ulybátsya*
to smile
Introduced in Chapter 235.

улыбка *ulýbka*
a smile
Introduced in Chapter 200.

умирать *umirát*
to die
Introduced in Chapter 237.

умный *úmnyy*
clever
Introduced in Chapter 155.

умываться *umyvátsya*
to wash (oneself)
Introduced in Chapter 132.

университет *universitét*
a university
Introduced in Chapter 242.

урок *urók*
a lesson
Introduced in Chapter 54.

усталость *ustálost*
tiredness
Introduced in Chapter 34.

усталый *ustályy*
tired
Introduced in Chapter 148.

уставать *ustavát*
to get tired
Introduced in Chapter 176.

утка *útka*
a duck
Introduced in Chapter 62.

утром *útrom*
in the morning
Introduced in Chapter 83.

утюг *utyúg*
an iron
Introduced in Chapter 219.

ужасный *uzhásnyy*
terrible
Introduced in Chapter 245.

уже *uzhé*
already
Introduced in Chapter 75.

ужин *úzhin*
dinner, supper
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ужинать *úzhinat*
to have dinner
Introduced in Chapter 140.

узкий *úzkiy*
narrow
Introduced in Chapter 129.

вагон *vagón*
a carriage (of a train)
Introduced in Chapter 198.

ванна *vánna*
a bathtub
Introduced in Chapter 95.

ванная *vánnaya*
the bathroom
Introduced in Chapter 50.

варенье *varénye*
jam
Introduced in Chapter 107.

варить *varít*
to boil, to cook
Introduced in Chapter 173.

ваза *váza*
a vase
Introduced in Chapter 221.

важный *vázhnyy*
important
Introduced in Chapter 126.

вчера *vcherá*
yesterday
Introduced in Chapter 69.

вечер *vécher*
the evening
Introduced in Chapter 68.

вечером *vécherom*
in the evening
Introduced in Chapter 84.

ведро *vedró*
a bucket
Introduced in Chapter 98.

век *vek*
a century
Introduced in Chapter 85.

велосипед *velosipéd*
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 92.

веник *vénik*
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 97.

верблюд *verblyúd*
a camel
Introduced in Chapter 225.

верить *vérit*
to believe
Introduced in Chapter 131.

верёвка *veryóvka*
a rope
Introduced in Chapter 98.

вес *ves*
weight
Introduced in Chapter 239.

вещь *veshch*
a thing
Introduced in Chapter 159.

весна *vesná*
spring
Introduced in Chapter 71.

весёлый *vesyólyy*
cheerful, fun
Introduced in Chapter 127.

ветчина *vetchiná*
ham
Introduced in Chapter 249.

ветер *véter*
the wind
Introduced in Chapter 59.

ветеринар *veterinár*
a vet
Introduced in Chapter 171.

ветка *vétka*
a branch
Introduced in Chapter 195.

везде *vezdé*
everywhere
Introduced in Chapter 184.

вежливый *vézhlivyy*
polite
Introduced in Chapter 155.

видеть *vídet'*
to see — the root behind both vision and wisdom
Introduced in Chapter 3.

вилка *vílka*
a fork
Introduced in Chapter 51.

вино *vinó*
wine
Introduced in Chapter 164.

виноград *vinográd*
grapes
Introduced in Chapter 223.

вишня *víshnya*
a cherry
Introduced in Chapter 44.

витамин *vitamín*
a vitamin
Introduced in Chapter 180.

виза *víza*
a visa
Introduced in Chapter 247.

вход *vkhod*
an entrance
Introduced in Chapter 139.

включать *vklyuchát*
to switch on
Introduced in Chapter 175.

вкусный *vkúsnyy*
tasty
Introduced in Chapter 157.

вниз *vniz*
down, downwards
Introduced in Chapter 214.

внизу *vnizú*
below, downstairs
Introduced in Chapter 73.

внучка *vnúchka*
a granddaughter
Introduced in Chapter 36.

внук *vnuk*
a grandson
Introduced in Chapter 36.

внутри *vnutrí*
inside
Introduced in Chapter 152.

вода *vodá*
water — feminine, and the first noun in this book, so it also teaches how every Russian noun announces itself
Introduced in Chapter 6.

водить *vodít*
to drive
Introduced in Chapter 131.

водитель *vodítel*
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 108.

водопад *vodopád*
a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 116.

вокруг *vokrúg*
around
Introduced in Chapter 152.

вокзал *vokzál*
a railway station
Introduced in Chapter 78.

волк *volk*
a wolf
Introduced in Chapter 61.

волна *volná*
a wave
Introduced in Chapter 115.

волосы *vólosy*
hair
Introduced in Chapter 30.

вопрос *voprós*
a question
Introduced in Chapter 42.

воробей *vorobéy*
a sparrow
Introduced in Chapter 251.

ворона *voróna*
a crow
Introduced in Chapter 165.

восемь *vósem*
eight — and the seven standing inside it
Introduced in Chapter 24.

воскресенье *voskresénye*
Sunday
Introduced in Chapter 71.

восток *vostók*
the east
Introduced in Chapter 90.

вовремя *vóvremya*
on time
Introduced in Chapter 182.

воздух *vózdukh*
air
Introduced in Chapter 164.

возможный *vozmózhnyy*
possible
Introduced in Chapter 188.

возраст *vózrast*
an age
Introduced in Chapter 255.

возвращаться *vozvrashchátsya*
to come back, to return
Introduced in Chapter 176.

впереди *vperedí*
in front, ahead
Introduced in Chapter 184.

вперёд *vperyód*
forward
Introduced in Chapter 214.

врач *vrach*
a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 32.

вредный *vrédnyy*
harmful
Introduced in Chapter 188.

время *vrémya*
time
Introduced in Chapter 69.

всегда *vsegdá*
always
Introduced in Chapter 74.

вставать *vstavát*
to get up
Introduced in Chapter 132.

встречать *vstrechát*
to meet
Introduced in Chapter 141.

второй третий *vtoróy trétiy*
second and third — where the numbers come back
Introduced in Chapter 26.

вулкан *vulkán*
a volcano
Introduced in Chapter 116.

вверх *vverkh*
up, upwards
Introduced in Chapter 214.

выбирать *vybirát*
to choose
Introduced in Chapter 233.

выигрывать *vyígryvat*
to win
Introduced in Chapter 135.

выход *výkhod*
an exit
Introduced in Chapter 139.

выходной *vykhodnóy*
a day off
Introduced in Chapter 182.

выходные *vykhodnýye*
the weekend
Introduced in Chapter 85.

выключать *vyklyuchát*
to switch off
Introduced in Chapter 175.

высокий *vysókiy*
tall, high
Introduced in Chapter 243.

выставка *výstavka*
an exhibition
Introduced in Chapter 197.

я *ya*
I — one letter, and one of the oldest words in Europe
Introduced in Chapter 2.

яблоко *yábloko*
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 44.

ягода *yágoda*
a berry
Introduced in Chapter 44.

январь *yanvár*
January
Introduced in Chapter 181.

яркий *yárkiy*
bright
Introduced in Chapter 244.

ящик *yáshchik*
a drawer; a crate
Introduced in Chapter 160.

яйцо *yaytsó*
an egg
Introduced in Chapter 43.

язык *yazýk*
the tongue; a language
Introduced in Chapter 31.

еда *yedá*
food
Introduced in Chapter 222.

ель *yel*
a spruce, a fir tree
Introduced in Chapter 224.

ещё *yeshchyó*
still; more
Introduced in Chapter 150.

если *yésli*
if
Introduced in Chapter 154.

ездить *yézdit*
to ride, to go (by transport)
Introduced in Chapter 143.

йогурт *yógurt*
a yoghurt
Introduced in Chapter 106.

ёж *yozh*
a hedgehog
Introduced in Chapter 165.

юбка *yúbka*
a skirt
Introduced in Chapter 102.

юг *yug*
the south
Introduced in Chapter 90.

юрист *yuríst*
a lawyer
Introduced in Chapter 109.

забывать *zabyvát*
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 205.

зачем *zachém*
what for
Introduced in Chapter 136.

задача *zadácha*
a task; a problem (to solve)
Introduced in Chapter 257.

загорать *zagorát*
to sunbathe
Introduced in Chapter 178.

закат *zakát*
sunset
Introduced in Chapter 149.

заказывать *zakázyvat*
to order (food, goods)
Introduced in Chapter 204.

закрытый *zakrýtyy*
closed
Introduced in Chapter 125.

закрывать *zakryvát*
to close
Introduced in Chapter 42.

замечать *zamechát*
to notice
Introduced in Chapter 208.

занавеска *zanavéska*
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 95.

занимать *zanimát*
to borrow; to take up (space)
Introduced in Chapter 232.

занятие *zanyátiye*
a class, a lesson
Introduced in Chapter 231.

занятый *zányatyy*
busy
Introduced in Chapter 124.

запад *západ*
the west
Introduced in Chapter 91.

заполнять *zapolnyát*
to fill in
Introduced in Chapter 236.

заправка *zaprávka*
a petrol station
Introduced in Chapter 167.

запястье *zapyástye*
a wrist
Introduced in Chapter 119.

зарабатывать *zarabátyvat*
to earn
Introduced in Chapter 237.

зарплата *zarpláta*
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 170.

зарядка *zaryádka*
a charger; morning exercises
Introduced in Chapter 191.

завод *zavód*
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 89.

завтрак *závtrak*
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 46.

завтракать *závtrakat*
to have breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 140.

заяц *záyats*
a hare
Introduced in Chapter 62.

зажигать *zazhigát*
to light, to set alight
Introduced in Chapter 175.

здесь *zdes*
here
Introduced in Chapter 72.

здоровый *zdoróvyy*
healthy
Introduced in Chapter 148.

здравствуйте *zdrávstvuyte*
hello (zdrávstvuyte — formal / polite)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

зебра *zébra*
a zebra
Introduced in Chapter 225.

зелёный *zelyónyy*
green
Introduced in Chapter 63.

земля *zemlyá*
the earth; land
Introduced in Chapter 164.

зеркало *zérkalo*
a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 123.

жадный *zhádnyy*
greedy
Introduced in Chapter 186.

жарить *zhárit*
to fry
Introduced in Chapter 173.

жажда *zházhda*
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 33.

ждать *zhdat*
to wait
Introduced in Chapter 41.

желудок *zhelúdok*
a stomach
Introduced in Chapter 121.

жена *zhená*
a wife
Introduced in Chapter 35.

жених *zheníkh*
a bridegroom, a fiancé
Introduced in Chapter 168.

жениться *zhenítsya*
to get married (of a man)
Introduced in Chapter 209.

женщина *zhénshchina*
a woman
Introduced in Chapter 227.

жираф *zhiráf*
a giraffe
Introduced in Chapter 225.

жить *zhit'*
to live — and the English word that used to mean 'alive'
Introduced in Chapter 3.

живот *zhivót*
the belly
Introduced in Chapter 29.

живой *zhivóy*
alive, lively
Introduced in Chapter 158.

жизнь *zhizn*
life
Introduced in Chapter 113.

жук *zhuk*
a beetle
Introduced in Chapter 196.

журнал *zhurnál*
a magazine
Introduced in Chapter 192.

журналист *zhurnalíst*
a journalist
Introduced in Chapter 256.

жёлтый *zhyóltyy*
yellow
Introduced in Chapter 64.

зима *zimá*
winter
Introduced in Chapter 71.

злой *zloy*
angry; wicked
Introduced in Chapter 127.

змея *zmeyá*
a snake
Introduced in Chapter 62.

значение *znachéniye*
a meaning
Introduced in Chapter 228.

значит *znáchit*
that means, so
Introduced in Chapter 185.

знакомиться *znakómitsya*
to get acquainted
Introduced in Chapter 141.

знакомый *znakómyy*
familiar; an acquaintance
Introduced in Chapter 158.

знать *znat'*
to know — the same root as English know, and the sentence you will use most
Introduced in Chapter 3.

зонт *zont*
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 53.

зоопарк *zoopárk*
a zoo
Introduced in Chapter 242.

зуб *zub*
a tooth
Introduced in Chapter 29.

зубная паста *zubnáya pásta*
toothpaste
Introduced in Chapter 219.

зубная щётка *zubnáya shchyótka*
a toothbrush
Introduced in Chapter 96.

звезда *zvezdá*
a star
Introduced in Chapter 58.

звонить *zvonít*
to ring, to phone
Introduced in Chapter 232.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 привет — *watch one word move*
Trace the visible word once, then type the Russian greeting you traced.

1.2 привет — *one supported copy*
Copy the visible Russian word for informal hi once, then type your copy.

1.3 привет — *look, hide, write, compare*
After hiding the model for five seconds, write the Russian word for informal hi and then compare it.

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
From the heard cue privet alone, write the known Russian word for informal hi.

1.5 *Chapter 1 checkpoint — say it, know the letters, write it*
From the heard cue nyet alone, write the Russian word for no.

Chapter 2

2.1 *Why plural* вы *became polite*
Which Russian form is safest with an adult when you are unsure?

2.2 *Why Russian asks* how*, not* what
Which language in this comparison asks what instead of how?

2.3 *Chapter 2 practice — run the exchange*
Turn Kak vas zovút? into the form you use with one friend.

Chapter 15

15.1 а — *a true friend, and the sound Russian keeps landing on*
Is a a true friend, a false friend, or a new shape?

15.2 о — *the letter that is not always itself*
How is the letter o pronounced when it is NOT the stressed vowel of the word?

15.3 г — *a corner, and a hard g*
Is the letter g in Russian ever soft, as in English 'gem'?

15.4 х — *an x that is not an x*
The letter written x in Russian is which of the three kinds — true friend, false friend, or new shape?

15.5 ф — *a circle on a stick*
What does the presence of the letter f usually tell you about a Russian word?

15.6 ц — *one letter for two sounds*
What separates the letter ts from the letter sh on the page?

15.7 й — и *in a hat*
Which letter is underneath the cap, and is the capped letter a vowel or a consonant?

15.8 ю — *a syllable in one letter, again*
Which other letter you have learned writes a whole syllable in one shape, the way yu does?

15.9 *Practice — eight more letters, sorted*
Of this chapter's eight letters, which one is a false friend, and why is that the dangerous kind?

Chapter 23

23.1 два — *two, and the question this book could already ask*
Someone asks skolko. Answer: two.

23.2 три — *three*
Count aloud from one to three in Russian.

23.3 четыре — *four, and one consonant's three fates*
Which language kept the original kw of four whole?

23.4 пять — *five, and a cousin English kept whole*
Count aloud from one to five in Russian.

23.5 *Payoff — one to five, and an answer to* сколько
Count backwards from five to one in Russian.

Chapter 24

24.1 шесть — *six*
Say six in Russian, and its English cousin.

24.2 семь — *seven*
Which sound has Russian sem lost that Latin septem still has?

24.3 восемь — *eight, and the seven inside it*
Where did the -sem of vosem come from, if not from *oktow?*

24.4 девять — *nine*
Latin has novem and Russian has devyat. Which sound changed at the front?

24.5 десять — *ten, and the letter nine borrowed*
Say nine and ten one after the other.

24.6 *Payoff — one to ten*
Count aloud from one to ten in Russian.

Chapter 25

25.1 двадцать — *twenty, and both halves still audible*
What are the two pieces of dvadtsat?

25.2 сто — *a hundred, and the number that named a family*
Russian sto and Latin centum are the same word. Which side of the centum/satem split is Russian on, and why?

25.3 *Payoff — twelve numbers, and what they still cannot do*
Can this book yet say 'two books' in Russian? Say why or why not.

Chapter 26

26.1 первый — *first*
Is pervyy built from odin?

26.2 второй *and* третий — *second, third, and the ending above them*
Build fifth and tenth from pyat and desyat.

26.3 *1-*й — *writing an ordinal as a figure*
Read 1-y aloud as a full Russian word.

26.4 *Payoff — which one, said and written*
Say first, second, third in Russian, then write the first of them as a figure.

26.5 *Close the numeral slice*
Say ten and tenth in Russian.

Chapter 27

27.1 *(reading) — six words off a board*
Which word is cheese?

27.2 *(reading) — three to open, three to rescue*
Which line asks for it slower?

27.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
What is her name?

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 привет — *watch one word move*
Answer: привет

1.2 привет — *one supported copy*
Answer: привет

1.3 привет — *look, hide, write, compare*
Answer: привет

1.4 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
Answer: привет

1.5 *Chapter 1 checkpoint — say it, know the letters, write it*
Answer: нет

Chapter 2

2.1 *Why plural* вы *became polite*
Answer: вы
Also accepted: vy

2.2 *Why Russian asks* how*, not* what
Answer: English

2.3 *Chapter 2 practice — run the exchange*
Answer: Kak tebyá zovút?
Also accepted: Kak tebya zovut?; Kak tebyá zovút; Kak tebya zovut

Chapter 15

15.1 а — *a true friend, and the sound Russian keeps landing on*
Answer: a true friend
Also accepted: true friend; true; a true one

15.2 о — *the letter that is not always itself*
Answer: as a
Also accepted: like a; as an a; it becomes a; a

15.3 г — *a corner, and a hard g*
Answer: no
Also accepted: never; no it is always hard; always hard; no, always hard

15.4 х — *an x that is not an x*
Answer: a false friend
Also accepted: false friend; false; a false one

15.5 ф — *a circle on a stick*
Answer: it is borrowed
Also accepted: it was borrowed; it is a loanword; borrowed from greek or western europe; it came from another language

15.6 ц — *one letter for two sounds*
Answer: the tail below the line
Also accepted: a tail; the descender; the little tail at the foot; two uprights and a tail; it has a tail

15.7 й — и *in a hat*
Answer: i, and it is a consonant
Also accepted: и, a consonant; i - consonant; и and it is a consonant; the letter i, consonant

15.8 ю — *a syllable in one letter, again*
Answer: ya
Also accepted: я; the letter ya

15.9 *Practice — eight more letters, sorted*
Answer: х, because it can be read confidently and wrongly
Also accepted: х; x; kh; the x one; х - it looks like a latin letter but sounds different

Chapter 23

23.1 два — *two, and the question this book could already ask*
Answer: два
Also accepted: dva; два — dva

23.2 три — *three*
Answer: один два три
Also accepted: odin dva tri; один, два, три; odin, dva, tri

23.3 четыре — *four, and one consonant's three fates*
Answer: Latin
Also accepted: Latin, in quattuor; quattuor

23.4 пять — *five, and a cousin English kept whole*
Answer: один два три четыре пять
Also accepted: odin dva tri chetyre pyat; один, два, три, четыре, пять; odin, dva, tri, chetyre, pyat

23.5 *Payoff — one to five, and an answer to* сколько
Answer: пять четыре три два один
Also accepted: pyat chetyre tri dva odin; пять, четыре, три, два, один; pyat, chetyre, tri, dva, odin

Chapter 24

24.1 шесть — *six*
Answer: shest — six
Also accepted: шесть — six; shest, six; шесть six

24.2 семь — *seven*
Answer: the p
Also accepted: p; the p sound

24.3 восемь — *eight, and the seven inside it*
Answer: from sem, seven
Also accepted: from семь; from seven next to it; семь

24.4 девять — *nine*
Answer: n became d
Also accepted: the n became a d; n > d; n to d

24.5 десять — *ten, and the letter nine borrowed*
Answer: девять десять
Also accepted: devyat desyat; девять, десять; devyat, desyat

24.6 *Payoff — one to ten*
Answer: один два три четыре пять шесть семь восемь девять десять
Also accepted: odin dva tri chetyre pyat shest sem vosem devyat desyat; один, два, три, четыре, пять, шесть, семь, восемь, девять, десять

Chapter 25

25.1 двадцать — *twenty, and both halves still audible*
Answer: dva and desyat
Also accepted: два and десять; dva + dtsat; two and ten

25.2 сто — *a hundred, and the number that named a family*
Answer: satem — the k became an s
Also accepted: satem, because the k became s; satem; the satem side

25.3 *Payoff — twelve numbers, and what they still cannot do*
Answer: no — dva changes the form of the noun after it
Also accepted: no, the noun changes form; no — it needs the genitive; no, it governs the noun

Chapter 26

26.1 первый — *first*
Answer: no
Also accepted: no — it means foremost; no, it is a separate root; foremost

26.2 второй *and* третий — *second, third, and the ending above them*
Answer: пятый десятый
Also accepted: pyatyy desyatyy; пятый, десятый; pyatyy, desyatyy

26.3 *1-*й — *writing an ordinal as a figure*
Answer: первый
Also accepted: pervyy; первый — pervyy

26.4 *Payoff — which one, said and written*
Answer: первый второй третий — 1-й
Also accepted: pervyy vtoroy tretiy — 1-y; первый, второй, третий, 1-й; pervyy, vtoroy, tretiy, 1-y

26.5 *Close the numeral slice*
Answer: десять десятый
Also accepted: desyat desyatyy; десять, десятый; desyat, desyatyy

Chapter 27

27.1 *(reading) — six words off a board*
Answer: syr
Also accepted: сыр; cheese

27.2 *(reading) — three to open, three to rescue*
Answer: medlenno
Also accepted: медленно; slowly

27.3 *(reading) — the first passage*
Answer: anna
Also accepted: Анна

A note on sources

Etymologies are traced against standard comparative sources for Slavic and Indo-European, and every English cousin claimed here is one the evidence actually supports. Where a resemblance is only a resemblance, the text says so rather than quietly banking it.

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a joke шутка (shútka)
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a journalist журналист (zhurnalíst)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1609
a journey путешествие (puteshéstviye)
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a judge; a referee судья (sudyá)
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a jumper свитер (svíter)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 673
a kettle чайник (cháynik)
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a key ключ (klyuch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 359
a keyboard клавиатура (klaviatúra)
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a kitchen кухня (kúkhnya)
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a knee колено (koléno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 245
a knife нож (nozh)
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a kopeck копейка (kopéyka)
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a lad, a boyfriend парень (páren)
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a lake озеро (ózero)
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a lamp лампа (lámpa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 49, p. 359
a laptop ноутбук (noutbúk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1219
a lawyer юрист (yuríst)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 723
a leaf; a sheet of paper лист (list)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 397
a lecture лекция (léktsiya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1459
a lecturer, a teacher преподаватель (prepodavátel)
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a leg, a foot нога (nogá)
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a lemon лимон (limón)
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a lesson урок (urók)
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a library библиотека (bibliotéka)
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a lie ложь (lozh)
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a lift лифт (lift)
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a light bulb лампочка (lámpochka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1031
a lion лев (lev)
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a lip губа (gubá)
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a little, few мало (málo)
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a lorry грузовик (gruzovík)
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a lot, many много (mnógo)
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a magazine журнал (zhurnál)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1225
a man мужчина (muzhchína)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1435
a manager менеджер (ménedzher)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1447
a map; a card карта (kárta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 389
a mark, a grade оценка (otsénka)
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a market рынок (rýnok)
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a match матч (match)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1067
a meaning значение (znachéniye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1441
a melon дыня (dýnya)
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a menu меню (menyú)
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a message сообщение (soobshchéniye)
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a microwave микроволновка (mikrovolnóvka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1549
a minute минута (minúta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 481
a mirror зеркало (zérkalo)
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a mistake ошибка (oshíbka)
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a monkey обезьяна (obezyána)
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a month месяц (mésyats)
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a monument памятник (pámyatnik)
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a mosque мечеть (mechét)
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a mosquito комар (komár)
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a motorbike мотоцикл (mototsíkl)
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a mountain гора (gorá)
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a mouse мышь (mysh)
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a mug кружка (krúzhka)
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a muscle мышца (mýshtsa)
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a museum музей (muzéy)
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a mushroom гриб (grib)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 347
a musician музыкант (muzykánt)
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a nail гвоздь (gvozd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 98, p. 655
a nail ноготь (nógot)
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a nanny няня (nyánya)
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a neighbour сосед (soséd)
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a nephew племянник (plemyánnik)
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a newspaper газета (gazéta)
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a notebook тетрадь (tetrád)
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a novel роман (román)
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a number; a hotel room номер (nómer)
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a nurse медсестра (medsestrá)
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a nut орех (orékh)
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a page страница (stranítsa)
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a painting картина (kartína)
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a pancake блин (blin)
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a parcel посылка (posýlka)
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a park парк (park)
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a parrot попугай (popugáy)
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a passenger пассажир (passazhír)
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a passport паспорт (pásport)
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a pavement тротуар (trotuár)
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a peach персик (pérsik)
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a pear груша (grúsha)
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a pen ручка (rúchka)
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a pencil карандаш (karandásh)
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a pension пенсия (pénsiya)
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a pensioner пенсионер (pensionér)
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a person человек (chelovék)
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a petrol station заправка (zaprávka)
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a pharmacy аптека (aptéka)
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a phone телефон (telefón)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 383
a photograph фотография (fotográfiya)
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a piano пианино (pianíno)
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a pie пирог (piróg)
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a pig свинья (svinyá)
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a pigeon голубь (gólub)
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a pill таблетка (tablétka)
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a pillow подушка (podúshka)
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a pilot лётчик (lyótchik)
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a pine сосна (sosná)
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a place; a seat место (mésto)
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a plan план (plan)
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a planet планета (planéta)
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a plate тарелка (tarélka)
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a play, a show спектакль (spektákl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1255
a plum слива (slíva)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1573
a plumber сантехник (santékhnik)
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a pocket карман (karmán)
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a police officer полицейский (politséyskiy)
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a port порт (port)
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a post, a position должность (dólzhnost)
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a post office почта (póchta)
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a postage stamp; a brand марка (márka)
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a postcard открытка (otkrýtka)
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a postman почтальон (pochtalón)
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a prawn креветка (krevétka)
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a prescription; a recipe рецепт (retsépt)
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a price цена (tsená)
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a printer принтер (prínter)
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a problem проблема (probléma)
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a profession профессия (proféssiya)
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a professor профессор (proféssor)
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a programmer программист (programmíst)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1447
a project проект (proyékt)
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a pulse пульс (puls)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1339
a pupil ученик (ucheník)
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a purchase покупка (pokúpka)
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a purse, a wallet кошелёк (koshelyók)
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a quarter четверть (chétvert)
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a question вопрос (voprós)
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a rabbit кролик (królik)
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a radiator; a battery батарея (bataréya)
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a radio радио (rádio)
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a railway station вокзал (vokzál)
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a rainbow радуга (ráduga)
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a raincoat плащ (plashch)
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a rat крыса (krýsa)
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a razor бритва (brítva)
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a reason причина (prichína)
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a receipt чек (chek)
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a relative родственник (ródstvennik)
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a remote control пульт (pult)
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a request просьба (prósba)
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a restaurant ресторан (restorán)
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a result результат (rezultát)
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a ring кольцо (koltsó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 100, p. 667
a river река (reká)
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a road; the way дорога (doróga)
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a rock, a cliff скала (skalá)
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a roof крыша (krýsha)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 365
a room комната (kómnata)
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a root корень (kóren)
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a rope верёвка (veryóvka)
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a rose роза (róza)
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a rouble рубль (rubl)
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a rubber, an eraser ластик (lástik)
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a rucksack рюкзак (ryukzák)
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a rug, a carpet ковёр (kovyór)
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a rule правило (právilo)
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a ruler линейка (linéyka)
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a runny nose насморк (násmork)
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a sailor моряк (moryák)
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a salad салат (salát)
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a salary зарплата (zarpláta)
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a sandwich бутерброд (buterbród)
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a sauce соус (sóus)
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a saucepan кастрюля (kastryúlya)
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a saucer блюдце (blyúdtse)
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a scarf шарф (sharf)
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a school школа (shkóla)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529
a screen экран (ekrán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1393
a seal, a stamp; print печать (pechát)
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a season сезон (sezón)
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a second секунда (sekúnda)
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a secret секрет (sekrét)
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a secretary секретарь (sekretár)
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a security guard охранник (okhránnik)
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a sheep овца (ovtsá)
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a shelf полка (pólka)
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a ship корабль (korábl')
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a shirt рубашка (rubáshka)
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a shop магазин (magazín)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529
a shop assistant продавец (prodavéts)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 717
a shore, a bank берег (béreg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 409
a shoulder плечо (plechó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 245
a shower душ (dush)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 631
a side street переулок (pereúlok)
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a signature подпись (pódpis)
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a singer певец (pevéts)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1097
a sink раковина (rákovina)
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a skirt юбка (yúbka)
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a smile улыбка (ulýbka)
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a snake змея (zmeyá)
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a socket розетка (rozétka)
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a sofa диван (diván)
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a soldier солдат (soldát)
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a son сын (syn)
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a song песня (pésnya)
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a sparrow воробей (vorobéy)
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a spider паук (paúk)
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a spoon ложка (lózhka)
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a spruce, a fir tree ель (yel)
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a square площадь (plóshchad)
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a squirrel белка (bélka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 777
a stadium стадион (stadión)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 595
a star звезда (zvezdá)
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a sticking plaster пластырь (plástyr)
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a stomach желудок (zhelúdok)
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a stone камень (kámen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 409
a stop (bus, tram) остановка (ostanóvka)
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a story; history история (istóriya)
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a street улица (úlitsa)
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a suburban train электричка (elektríchka)
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a suit костюм (kostyúm)
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a suitcase чемодан (chemodán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 619
a supermarket супермаркет (supermárket)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 595
a surname фамилия (famíliya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1603
a sweet конфета (konféta)
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a swimming pool бассейн (basséyn)
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a T-shirt футболка (futbólka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1043
a table стол (stol)
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a tablet (computer) планшет (planshét)
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a tap кран (kran)
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a task; a problem (to solve) задача (zadácha)
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a tax налог (nalóg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1091
a taxi такси (taksí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 547
a teacher учитель (uchítel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 287
a team команда (kománda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1067
a television телевизор (televízor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 94, p. 631
a temperature, a fever температура (temperatúra)
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a temple, a church храм (khram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 989
a text текст (tekst)
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a theatre театр (teátr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 535
a thermometer термометр (termómetr)
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a thing вещь (veshch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1025
a thousand тысяча (týsyacha)
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a throat горло (górlo)
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a thunderstorm гроза (grozá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 759
a ticket билет (bilét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 389
a tie галстук (gálstuk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 673
a tiger тигр (tigr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 771
a till, a checkout касса (kássa)
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a timetable расписание (raspisániye)
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a tomato помидор (pomidór)
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a tooth зуб (zub)
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a toothbrush зубная щётка (zubnáya shchyótka)
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a tortoise, a turtle черепаха (cherepákha)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 771
a tourist турист (turíst)
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a towel полотенце (poloténtse)
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a toy игрушка (igrúshka)
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a traffic jam; a cork пробка (próbka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1261
a train поезд (póyezd)
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a training session тренировка (treniróvka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1067
a tram трамвай (tramváy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613
a transfer, a change (of trains) пересадка (peresádka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1261
a tree дерево (dérevo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 397
a trolleybus троллейбус (trolléybus)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1591
a university университет (universitét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1525
a vacuum cleaner пылесос (pylesós)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1387
a vase ваза (váza)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1399
a vet ветеринар (veterinár)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1097
a village деревня (derévnya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 397
a violin скрипка (skrípka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1429
a visa виза (víza)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1555

a vitamin витамин (vitamín)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1151
a volcano вулкан (vulkán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 765
a waiter официант (ofitsiánt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 723
a wall стена (stená)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 365
a wardrobe, a cupboard шкаф (shkaf)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 649
a washing machine стиральная машина (stirálnaya mashína)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 97, p. 649
a waterfall водопад (vodopád)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 765
a watermelon арбуз (arbúz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1573
a wave волна (volná)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 759
a wedding свадьба (svádba)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1079
a week неделя (nedélya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 475
a whale кит (kit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 777
a wife жена (zhená)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 275
a window окно (oknó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 48, p. 353
a wine glass бокал (bokál)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1031
a wire, a cable провод (próvod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1219
a wolf волк (volk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 433
a woman женщина (zhénshchina)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1435
a word слово (slóvo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 389
a wound рана (rána)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1145
a wrist запястье (zapyástye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 783
a yard, a courtyard двор (dvor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1519

a year год (god)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 475
a yoghurt йогурт (yógurt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 705
a young woman, a girlfriend девушка (dévushka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1597
a zebra зебра (zébra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1423
a zoo зоопарк (zoopárk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1525
air воздух (vózdukh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1055
Alive, Dead, Hungry, Well-fed, Familiar
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1019
alive, lively живой (zhivóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1019
already уже (uzhé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517
Already, Quickly, Eleven, Twelve, Zero
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 517
also, too — two little words fused, and the way to say 'me neither' тоже (tózhe)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 151
although хотя (khotyá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 995
always всегда (vsegdá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 511
Always, Sometimes, Never, Now, Later
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 511
an accident, a crash авария (avária)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1261
an accountant бухгалтер (bukhgálter)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1447
an actor актёр (aktyór)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1609
an address адрес (ádres)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 389
an advert реклама (rekláma)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 905
an aeroplane самолёт (samolyót)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 541
an age возраст (vózrast)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1603

an airport аэропорт (aeropórt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 589
an alarm clock будильник (budílnik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 661
an allergy аллергия (allergíya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1333
an ambulance скорая помощь (skóraya pómoshch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1501
an ankle лодыжка (lodýzhka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 783
an answer ответ (otvét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 317
an ant муравей (muravéy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 789
an apple яблоко (yábloko)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 329
an armchair кресло (kréslo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1025
an artist, a painter художник (khudózhnik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1609
an aunt тётя (tyótya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 281
an avenue проспект (prospékt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 977
an eagle орёл (oryól)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1061
an egg яйцо (yaytsó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 323
an elbow локоть (lókot)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 777
an electrician электрик (elektrík)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1285
an elephant слон (slon)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 789
an engineer инженер (inzhenér)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 723
an entrance вход (vkhod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 905
an envelope конверт (konvért)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1037
an exam экзамен (ekzámen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 735
an example пример (primér)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1441

an exhibition выставка (výstavka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1255
an exit выход (výkhod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 905
an eyebrow бровь (brov)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1507
an eyelash ресница (resnítsa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1507
an hour час (chas)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 481
an idea идея (idéya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 735
an illness болезнь (bolézn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 257
an injection укол (ukól)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1145
an iron утюг (utyúg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1387
an island остров (óstrov)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 409
an oak дуб (dub)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1243
an object; a school subject предмет (predmét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1025
an office офис (ófis)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 601
an ointment мазь (maz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1501
an onion лук (luk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 335
an opinion мнение (mnéniye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1085
an orange апельсин (apelsín)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1411
an oven духовка (dukhóvka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1387
an owl сова (sová)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 777
an umbrella зонт (zont)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 383
ancient древний (drévniy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1537
Ancient, Loud, Bright, Dark, Light
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1537

and-but — the second half of English's but, and the second joining word that is a single letter а (a)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 17, p. 159
and — one letter, one sound, and the commonest word in the language и (i)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 151
And, Or, and Neither
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 151
anger гнев (gnev)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 269
angry; wicked злой (zloy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 831
Ankle, Wrist, Cheek, Lips, Chest
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 783
April апрель (aprél)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1157
around вокруг (vokrúg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 983
at first сначала (snachála)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 971
at last, finally наконец (nakonéts)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 971
at night ночью (nóchyu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 571
at once сразу (srázu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1513
August август (ávgust)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1345
autumn осень (ósen)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 493

B

back, backwards назад (nazád)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1357
Back, Tongue, Lip, Face, Blood
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 251
bad плохой (plokhóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 451
badly плохо (plókho)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 469
Bag, Phone, Umbrella, Money, Gift
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 383

Bank, Station, Museum, Theatre, Restaurant
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 535
Basement, Balcony, Yard, Opposite, Between
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1519
basketball баскетбол (basketból)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1585
Bathtub, Shelf, Curtain, Pillow, Blanket
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 637
beans фасоль (fasól)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1411
Beans, Orange, Lemon, Banana, Grapes
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1411
beautiful красивый (krasívyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 451
because — the question почему answered by turning it round, word for word потому что (patamú shto)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 19, p. 175
beef говядина (govyádina)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 691
Beef, Vegetables, Strawberries, Melon, Garlic
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 691
beer пиво (pívo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1055
Beer, Wine, Climate, Air, Earth
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1055
beetroot свёкла (svyókla)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1237
before, earlier раньше (ránshe)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 893
behind сзади (szádi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 983
below, downstairs внизу (vnizú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 505
Below, Left, Right, A Lot, A Little
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 505
Beside, Around, Inside, Outside, Behind
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 983
beside; roughly (with numbers) около (ókolo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 983
between между (mézhdu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1519
Bicycle, Suitcase, Journey, Holidays, Rug
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 619

big большой (bolshóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 457
Big, Small, Old, Long, Short
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 457
Birch, Spruce, Pine, Bush, Sheep
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1417
Bird, Mouse, Wolf, Bear, Fox
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 433
biscuits печенье (pechénye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 699
bitter горький (górkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 849
Bitter, Salty, Heavy, Thin, Fat
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 849
black чёрный (chyórnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 445
blood кровь (krov)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 251
Blouse, T-shirt, Tights, Trainers, Slippers
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1043
blue (dark blue) синий (síniy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 445
blunt тупой (tupóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1375
Blunt, Smooth, Cool, Fresh, Modern
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1375
Book, Pen, Paper, Notebook, Pencil
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 377
boots сапоги (sapogí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 679
Boots, Skirt, Coat, Shoes, Socks
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 679
Border, Customs, Capital, Flat, Floor
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1351
boring скучный (skúchnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 825
borscht борщ (borshch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1049
brave храбрый (khrábryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1187
bread — masculine, and not a Slavic word at all хлеб (khleb)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 71
breakfast завтрак (závtrak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 341

Breakfast, Lunch, Dinner
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 341
bright яркий (yárkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1537
Brimmed hat, Belt, Pocket, Button, Earrings
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1231
Broom, Washing machine, Sofa, Wardrobe, Saucepan
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 649
brother — masculine, one soft sign away from a verb you already know, and this time it really is your English cousin брат (brat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 79
brown коричневый (koríchnevyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 813
Bull, Cockerel, Goose, Pigeon, Sparrow
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1579
Burn, Allergy, Dentist, Sticking plaster, Bandage
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1333
Bus, Train, Plane, Car, Bridge
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 541
business бизнес (bíznes)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1291
busy занятый (zányatyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 813
but — the flat contradiction, one of two words English hides under a single but но (no)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 159
But, Twice Over
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 159
butter; oil масло (máslo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 323
bye — casual, and much younger than it sounds пока (paká)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97

C

cabbage капуста (kapústa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1237
cabbage soup щи (shchi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1049
calm спокойный (spokóynyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1369
Calm, Nervous, Happy, Sad, Strict
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1369

Car park, Lift, North, South, East
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 607
cash наличные (nalíchnyye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1091
Change, Discount, Purchase, Colleague, Director
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1279
change (money) сдача (sdácha)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1279
cheap дешёвый (deshyóvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 469
cheerful, fun весёлый (vesyólyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 831
Cheerful, Kind, Angry, Serious, Right
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 831
cheese — masculine, and secretly the same word as сырой**, 'raw'** сыр (syr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 115
chess шахматы (shákhmaty)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1591
children дети (déti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 36, p. 281
Children, a Child, Aunt, Grandchildren
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 281
Chin, Rainbow, Lightning, Thunder, Planet
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 801
chocolate шоколад (shokolád)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 699
City, Street, Shop, Market, School
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 529
clean чистый (chístyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1007
clever умный (úmnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1001
closed закрытый (zakrýtyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 819
clothes одежда (odézhda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1561
Clothes, Raincoat, Suit, Jeans, Shorts
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1561
coffee — masculine, the one exception worth meeting on purpose кофе (kófe)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 71
cold холодный (kholódnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 463

comfortable, convenient удобный (udóbnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1013
Company, Firm, Project, Task, Experience
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 1615
complicated сложный (slózhnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1199
cool прохладный (prokhládnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1375
cottage cheese творог (tvoróg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1567
Crocodile, Giraffe, Zebra, Camel, Deer
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1423
Crow, Eagle, Parrot, Hamster, Hedgehog
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1061
Cup, Plate, Spoon, Knife, Fork
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 371
Customer, Till, Boss, Profession, Class
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 729
customs таможня (tamózhnya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1351
CV, Career, Pension, Business trip, Contract
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1103

D

dad — masculine despite the -а ending, the first noun in this book where biology beats the spelling rule папа (pápa)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 12, p. 107
dangerous опасный (opásnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 837
dark тёмный (tyómnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1537
dawn рассвет (rassvét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 965
Day, Week, Month, Year, Evening
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 475
dead мёртвый (myórtvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1019
December декабрь (dekábr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1513
deep глубокий (glubókiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1193
Desert, Volcano, Cave, Waterfall, Donkey
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 765

Dessert, Yoghurt, Ice cream, Sausage, Peach
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 705
Different, Same, Similar, Main, Ordinary
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1381
different, various разный (ráznyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1381
dinner, supper ужин (úzhin)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 341
dirty грязный (gryáznyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1007
Dog, Cat, Horse, Cow, Pig
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 427
down, downwards вниз (vniz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1357
drops (medicine) капли (kápli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1501
dry сухой (sukhóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 837
dumplings пельмени (pelméni)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1237
Dumplings, Salad, Cabbage, Beetroot, Peas
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1237

E

ear — neuter, the first word Russian gives its third gender, and a word-for-word cousin of the English ear ухо (úkho)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 87
early рано (ráno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 565
earrings серьги (sérgi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1231
Easy, Hard, Dear, Cheap, Badly
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 469
eight — and the seven standing inside it восемь (vósem)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 215
elderly пожилой (pozhilóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1531
Electrician, Plumber, Pilot, Sailor, Fisherman
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1285
eleven одиннадцать (odínnadtsat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517
Eleven Letters, Sorted Into Three Kinds
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 121

empty пустой (pustóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1007
even, level ровный (róvnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1193
every, each каждый (kázhdyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 971
everywhere везде (vezdé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1175
Exam, Board, Rubber, Homework, Idea
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 735
excellent отличный (otlíchnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1543
Excuse Me, and Say It Again
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 191
excuse me, sorry — the word this book had no way of saying, and the way every request to a stranger starts извините (izvinítye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 191
expensive; dear дорогой (dorogóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 469
experience; an experiment опыт (ópyt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1615
eye — masculine, and the word that quietly evicted Russian's inherited word for eye глаз (glaz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 87
Eyes, Ears, Mouth, and Nose
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 87

F

Factory, Office, Corner, Crossroads, Traffic lights
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 601
Fairy tale, Story, Chess, Transport, Trolleybus
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1591
familiar; an acquaintance знакомый (znakómyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1019
Family
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 85
family — feminine, and an unexpected cousin of the English word home семья (sem'yá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 8, p. 85
famous известный (izvéstnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 825

far далеко (dalekó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 499
fast быстрый (býstryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 463
fat, thick толстый (tólstyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 849
father — formal register, and an old word that is NOT related to English father at all отец (atéts)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 107
fear страх (strakh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 269
February февраль (fevrál)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1157
Fever, Cough, Rest, Hunger, Thirst
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 263
fifty пятьдесят (pyatdesyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523
Fine, Person, Man, Woman, Boy
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1435
first — which one, not how many, and a word not built from **odin** первый (pérvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 225
fish рыба (rýba)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 323
five — the number inside a word English borrowed whole пять (pyat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 209
flour мука (muká)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 105, p. 699
Flour, Chocolate, Biscuits, Sandwich, Sauce
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 699
flu грипп (gripp)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 953
fog туман (tumán)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 753
food еда (yedá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1405
Food, Dish, Menu, Bun, Kefir
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1405
football футбол (futból)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 753
for example например (naprimér)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1181

foreign иностранный (inostránnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1205
forgive me — the heavier of the two apologies, and the one that asks for something простите (prastítye)
explicit focus: usage and culture; Chapter 21, p. 191
Form, Envelope, Postage stamp, Postcard, Parcel
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1037
fortunately к счастью (k schástyu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1363
forty сорок (sórok)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523
Forty, Fifty, Ninety, a Thousand, a Country
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 523
forward вперёд (vperyód)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1357
Four lines, and the comma you cannot hear
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 260, p. 1627
four — where a kw became a ch, as it did in every Slavic language четыре (chetýre)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 209
Frankfurter, Prawn, Borscht, Cabbage soup, Pancake
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1049
free свободный (svobódnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 819
Free, Open, Closed, Quiet, Noisy
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 819
fresh свежий (svézhiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1375
Friday пятница (pyátnitsa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 487
Friend and Siblings
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 79
friend (female) — feminine, and друг with a prefix and an ending stitched on подруга (podrúga)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 7, p. 79
friend (male, or unspecified) — masculine, and the reason you own ты at all друг (drug)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 79
from here отсюда (otsyúda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1357
From here, Back, Forward, Up, Down
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1357
from there оттуда (ottúda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1175

fruit фрукты (frúkty)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 329
Fruit, Apple, Pear, Cherry, Berry
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 329
Frying pan, Bucket, Rope, Nail, Hammer
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 655
full полный (pólnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1193
Full, Deep, Even, Square, Sharp
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1193
funny смешной (smeshnóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1543
furniture мебель (mébel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1025
Future, in a Week, a Plan, To Plan, To Hope
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 899
future, next будущий (búdushchiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 899

G

Game, Film, Song, Drawing, Life
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 747
Gardener, Cashier, Hairdresser, Security guard, Nanny
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1453
garlic чеснок (chesnók)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 691
generous щедрый (shchédryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1187
Girl, Lad, Young woman, Parents, Nephew
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1597
gloves перчатки (perchátki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 673
glue клей (kley)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 661
Glue, Scissors, Alarm clock, Camera, Purse
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 661
good хороший (khoróshiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 451
good night — literally 'of a calm night,' the last thing you say before sleep спокойной ночи (spakóynay nóchi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97

goodbye (formal / neutral) — literally 'until [our] seeing each other again' до свидания (da svidániya)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97
grapes виноград (vinográd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1411
grass трава (travá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 397
greedy жадный (zhádnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1187
green зелёный (zelyónyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 445
Greetings and courtesy
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
grey серый (séryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 813
Gym, Mosque, Temple, Monument, Fountain
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 989

H

hair волосы (vólosy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 245
Hair, Finger, Neck, Shoulder, Knee
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 245
half an hour полчаса (polchasá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 965
Half an hour, Quarter, Day and a night, Dawn, Sunset
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 965
ham ветчина (vetchiná)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1567
happy счастливый (schastlívyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1369
hard твёрдый (tvyórdyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 843
hard, difficult трудный (trúdnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 469
Hare, Snake, Hen, Duck, Goat
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 439
harmful вредный (vrédnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1199
Hat, Jacket, Shirt, Trousers, Dress
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 685

Head, Hand, Leg, Belly, Tooth
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 239
Headache, Sleep, Diet, Vitamin, Lungs
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1151
headphones наушники (naúshniki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1555
healthy здоровый (zdoróvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 959
Healthy, Weak, Strong, Pale, Tired
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 959
Heart
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 93
heart — neuter, a silent letter, and one of the surest cognates in the entire Indo-European family сердце (sérdtse)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 10, p. 93
heavy тяжёлый (tyazhyólyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 849
Heavy curtain, Sink, Tap, Toilet, Shampoo
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1211
height рост (rost)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1507
hello (zdrávstvuyte — formal / polite) здравствуйте (zdrávstvuyte)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
help помощь (pómoshch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1085
help me — a verb you have owned since the hand chapter, wearing the ending you learned two lessons ago помогите (pamagítye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 191
here здесь (zdes)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 499
Here, There, Far, Near, Up Above
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 499
hi / hello (privét — informal) привет (privét)
explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
Hobby, Exhibition, Play, Guitar, Piano
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1255
hockey хоккей (khokkéy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1585
Hockey, Tennis, Basketball, Running, Swimming
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1585
holidays, leave отпуск (ótpusk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 92, p. 619

homework домашнее задание (domáshneye zadániye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 735
honest честный (chéstnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1187
honey мёд (myod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 347
hot горячий (goryáchiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 463
Hot, Cold, Warm, Fast, Slow
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 463
Hotel, Pharmacy, Church, Park, Taxi
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 547
House, Room, Kitchen, Window, Door
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 353
how many, how much — the question word Russian uses for both, where English needs two сколько (skólka)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 199
hunger голод (gólod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 263
hungry голодный (golódnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1019

I

I — one letter, and one of the oldest words in Europe я (ya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 27
ice лёд (lyod)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 759
ice cream мороженое (morózhenoye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 705
if если (yésli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 995
ill; a patient больной (bolnóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 953
Ill, Cold, Flu, Runny nose, Pill
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 953
important важный (vázhnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 825
in (a week), after через (chérez)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 899
in front, ahead впереди (vperedí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1175

In front, Everywhere, To there, To here, From there
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1175
in the daytime днём (dnyom)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 571
In the daytime, In the evening, At night, Day after tomorrow, Day before yesterday
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 571
in the evening вечером (vécherom)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 571
in the morning утром (útrom)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 565
inside внутри (vnutrí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 983
interesting интересный (interésnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 825
Introducing yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 27
it is necessary — a sentence with a verb, an infinitive, and no subject at all надо (náda)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 183

J

jam варенье (varénye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 711
Jam, Nut, Pepper, Nurse, Cook
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 711
January январь (yanvár)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1157
January, February, March, April, May
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1157
jeans джинсы (dzhínsy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1561
joy радость (rádost)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 269
Joy, Fear, Anger, Sadness, Tiredness
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 269
juice — masculine, an ancient root that never surfaces in English сок (sok)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 115
July июль (iyúl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1345

June июнь (iyún)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1345
June, July, August, September, October
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1345

K

kefir кефир (kefír)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1405
kind добрый (dóbryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 831
Kopeck, Rouble, Lecture, Class, Mark
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1459

L

lamb (meat) баранина (baránina)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1567
last последний (poslédniy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 825
Last, Famous, Important, Interesting, Boring
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 825
last, past прошлый (próshlyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 893
late поздно (pózdno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 565
later, then потом (potóm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 511
laughter смех (smekh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1273
Lawyer, Engineer, Firefighter, Postman, Waiter
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 723
lazy ленивый (lenívyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1001
Lesson, Word, Address, Ticket, Map
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 389
Library, University, Café, Zoo, Circus
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1525
life жизнь (zhizn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 747
light blue голубой (golubóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1013

Light blue, Sweet, Sour, Tasty, Comfortable
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1013
light, bright (of a colour or room) светлый (svétlyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1537
light; easy лёгкий (lyókhkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 67, p. 469
lightning молния (mólniya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 801
Lion, Monkey, Elephant, Bee, Ant
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 789
lips губы (gúby)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 783
Listen, Learn, Answer, Wait, Give
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 311
local местный (méstnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1205
long длинный (dlínnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 457
long ago; for a long time давно (davnó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 893
loud громкий (grómkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1537
low, short низкий (nízkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1531
lunch, the midday meal обед (obéd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 341

M

main главный (glávnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1381
March март (mart)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1157
May май (may)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1157
maybe может быть (mózhet byt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1363
meat мясо (myáso)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 323
Meat, Fish, Egg, Butter, Salt
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 323
medicine лекарство (lekárstvo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 257

Microwave, Kettle, Bowl, Saucer, Mug
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1549
midday полдень (pólden)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 565
Midday, Midnight, Early, Late, In the morning
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 565
midnight полночь (pólnoch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 565
Milk, Cheese, Juice, and Soup
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 115
milk — neuter, and a straight cousin of the English word, hand-motion and all молоко (malakó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 115
Mistake, Rule, Example, Meaning, First name
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1441
modern современный (sovreménnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1375
mom — feminine, and a word that is not really a language-family cousin of anything мама (máma)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 107
Monday понедельник (ponedélnik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 487
Monday to Saturday
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 487
money деньги (déngi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 383
Mother and Father
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 107
mother — formal register, and the real, ancient cousin behind the babble-word мама мать (mat')
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 107
Mountain, Forest, River, Lake, Sea
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 403
mouth — masculine, and this time the resemblance to English is not there to trust рот (rot)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 87
Muscle, Bone, Pulse, Pressure, Strength
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1339
music музыка (múzyka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 741
my name is... — literally 'they call me', with no word for 'my' and no word for 'name' меня зовут… (menyá zovút)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 27

N

narrow узкий (úzkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 843
native; dear родной (rodnóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1205
nature природа (priróda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1243
Nature, Branch, Root, Rose, Oak
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1243
near, close by близко (blízko)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 499
nearby, next to рядом (ryádom)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 589
necessary нужный (núzhnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1199
Neighbour, Guest, Teacher, Pupil, Work
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 287
nervous нервный (nérvnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1369
never никогда (nikogdá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 511
new новый (nóvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 451
Newspaper, Magazine, Dictionary, Ruler, Folder
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1225
Nice, Clever, Silly, Lazy, Polite
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1001
nice, sweet (of a person) милый (mílyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1001
nine — and the ten it is about to rhyme with девять (dévyat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 215
ninety девяносто (devyanósto)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523
no (nyet) нет (nyet)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
nobody никто (niktó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 887
Nobody, Nothing, Nowhere, To Nowhere, What For
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 887
noisy шумный (shúmnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 819

nose — masculine, and the same word as English nose and Latin nasus нос (nos)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 87
nothing ничего (nichevó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 887
November ноябрь (noyábr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1513
November, December, Season, At once, Usually
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1513
now, right now сейчас (seychás)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 511
nowadays, now (after a change) теперь (tepér)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1163
Nowadays, School holidays, Birthday, Day off, On time
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1163
nowhere нигде (nigdé)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 887

O

October октябрь (oktyábr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1345
of course конечно (konéchno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1363
Of course, Probably, Maybe, Unfortunately, Fortunately
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1363
often часто (chásto)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 577
Ointment, Drops, Thermometer, Clinic, Ambulance
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1501
old старый (stáryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 457
on the left слева (sléva)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 505
on the right справа (správa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 73, p. 505
on time вовремя (vóvremya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1163
one — and the English words one, an, a, alone and only are all the same word один (adín)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 17, p. 159
One heard greeting — write what you know
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1

One to Five, and an Answer to Skolko
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 209
One Word, and a Whole Sentence After It
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 167
open открытый (otkrýtyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 819
Open, Close, Drink, Question, Answer
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 317
opposite напротив (naprótiv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1519
or — and it is и with a small question-word stuck on the end или (íli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 16, p. 151
orange (the colour) оранжевый (oránzhevyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 813
ordinary, usual обычный (obýchnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1381
other, another — your word for friend, doing a second job, and half of a joining pattern другой (drugóy)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 17, p. 159
otherwise иначе (ináche)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 995
outside снаружи (snarúzhi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 983

P

pain боль (bol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 32, p. 257
Pain, Illness, Medicine, Doctor
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 257
pale бледный (blédnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 959
paper бумага (bumága)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 377
parents родители (rodíteli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1597
Parting Words
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 97
Passenger, Carriage, Transfer, Traffic jam, Accident
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1261
pasta макароны (makaróny)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1573

peas горох (gorókh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1237
people люди (lyúdi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 101, p. 673
People, Jumper, Tie, Gloves, Scarf
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 673
pepper перец (pérets)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 711
petrol бензин (benzín)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1073
pink розовый (rózovyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 807
Place, Centre, Outskirts, District, Avenue
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 977
please / you're welcome (pozhálusta) пожалуйста (pozhálusta)
explicit focus: script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
pleased to meet you — literally 'very pleasant', and a cousin of English FRIEND очень приятно (óchen priyátno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 27
poems, poetry стихи (stikhí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1429
Police officer, Shop assistant, Farmer, Baker, Driver
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 717
polite вежливый (vézhlivyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1001
poor бедный (bédnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1007
pork свинина (svinína)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1567
porridge каша (kásha)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 46, p. 341
possible возможный (vozmózhnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1199
Post office, Cinema, Supermarket, Swimming pool, Stadium
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 595
Post, Salary, Tax, Bill, Cash
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1091
potatoes картошка (kartóshka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 45, p. 335
Potatoes, Tomato, Onion, Cucumber, Carrot
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 335
Prescription, Injection, Wound, Bruise, Fracture
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1145

pressure; blood pressure давление (davléniye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1339
Price, Football, Concert, Holiday, Fog
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 753
probably наверное (navérnoye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1363
Problem, Sentence, Page, Music, Sport
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 741
Professor, Journalist, Artist, Musician, Actor
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1609
purple фиолетовый (fiolétovyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 813
Purple, Brown, Grey, Orange, Busy
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 813

Q

quickly быстро (býstro)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517
quiet тихий (tíkhiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 819

R

Rabbit, Tiger, Butterfly, Frog, Tortoise
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 771
Radiator, Socket, Wire, Charger, Laptop
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1219
Radio, Headphones, Passport, Visa, Document
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1555
rain дождь (dozhd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 421
Rain, Snow, Wind, Weather, World
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 421
rarely редко (rédko)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 971
Rarely, Every, At first, At last, Still
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 971
Rat, Spider, Mosquito, Fly, Beetle
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1249
Reading — Six Words, Six Lines, and a First Passage
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 231

ready готовый (gotóvyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 837
Reason, Goal, Result, That means, For example
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1181
recently недавно (nedávno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 893
Recently, for a Long Time, Before, Last, To Happen
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 893
red красный (krásnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 445
Request, Help, Opinion, Truth, Lie
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1085
rest отдых (ótdykh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 263
rice рис (ris)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 347
rich богатый (bogátyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1007
Rich, Poor, Clean, Dirty, Empty
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1007
right, correct правильный (právilnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 831
Ring, Photograph, Candle, Calendar, Rucksack
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 667
round круглый (krúglyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 843
rubbish мусор (músor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 643
rude грубый (grúbyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1187
Rude, Honest, Brave, Generous, Greedy
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1187
running бег (beg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1585
Russian русский (rússkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1205

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sad грустный (grústnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1369
sadness грусть (grust)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 269

salt соль (sol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 323
salty солёный (solyónyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 849
sand песок (pesók)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 409
Saturday суббота (subbóta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 487
sausage колбаса (kolbasá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 705
say it again — the first thing you can do about not understanding, and the book's first named imperative повторите (paftarítye)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 21, p. 191
school holidays каникулы (kaníkuly)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1163
scissors ножницы (nózhnitsy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 99, p. 661
second and third — where the numbers come back второй третий (vtoróy trétiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 26, p. 225
Second, Weekend, Date, Century, Often
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 577
Secret, Joke, Laughter, Tears, Smile
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 1273
Secretary, Accountant, Manager, Programmer, Lecturer
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1447
see you later — literally 'until the meeting' до встречи (da fstréchi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97
see you soon — literally 'until the soon [one]' до скорого (da skórava)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97
see you tomorrow — literally 'until [the] morning-after' до завтра (da záftra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 11, p. 97
September сентябрь (sentyábr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1345
serious серьёзный (seryóznyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 831
seven — the s that Persian turned into an h, kept семь (sem)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 215
shampoo шампунь (shampún)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1211

Shark, Nail, Skin, Stomach, Throat
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 795
sharp; spicy острый (óstryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1193
shoes туфли (túfli)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 679
short короткий (korótkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 457
shorts шорты (shórty)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1561
Side street, Pavement, Road, Highway, Port
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1169
Signature, Seal, Business, Cash machine, Coin
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1291
silly, stupid глупый (glúpyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1001
similar, alike похожий (pokhózhiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1381
since, as так как (tak kak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 995
Singer, Vet, Judge, Soldier, Builder
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1097
sister — feminine, brat's other half, and a cognate just as secure сестра (sestrá)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 7, p. 79
six — and the first sign of the split that names half the family шесть (shest)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 215
Six to Ten, and the Pairs That Shaped Each Other
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 215
Six Verbs, and the One You Never Say
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 43
skates коньки (konkí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1067
skin кожа (kózha)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 795
skis лыжи (lýzhi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1067
Skis, Skates, Team, Match, Training session
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1067
Sky, Sun, Moon, Star, Cloud
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 415
sleep; a dream сон (son)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1151

Sleep, Sit, Stand, Run, Play
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 305
slippers тапочки (tápochki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1043
slow медленный (médlennyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 463
slowly — the second half of the repair kit, and the request that actually fixes listening медленно (myédlenna)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 21, p. 191
small маленький (málenkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 457
smooth гладкий (gládkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1375
snow снег (sneg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 421
So, Since, If, Although, Otherwise
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 995
so, therefore поэтому (poétomu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 995
soap мыло (mýlo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 96, p. 643
socks носки (noskí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 102, p. 679
soft мягкий (myákhkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 843
Soft, Hard, Round, Wide, Narrow
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 843
Someone else's, Native, Local, Foreign, Russian
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1205
someone else's; unfamiliar чужой (chuzhóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1205
sometimes иногда (inogdá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 74, p. 511
Son, Daughter, Grandmother, Husband, Wife
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 275
soup — masculine, and an 18th-century French loan, exactly like кофе **before it** суп (sup)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 13, p. 115
sour кислый (kíslyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1013
sour cream сметана (smetána)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1567
Sour cream, Cottage cheese, Pork, Lamb, Ham
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1567

space космос (kósmos)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 807
Space, Bottle, Mirror, Stairs, Pink
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 807
sport спорт (sport)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 741
spring весна (vesná)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 493
square квадратный (kvadrátnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1193
Squirrel, Owl, Whale, Dolphin, Elbow
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 777
stairs лестница (léstnitsa)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 807
still; more ещё (yeshchyó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 971
Stone, Sand, Shore, Island, Field
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 409
straight on прямо (prýamo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 87, p. 589
Straight on, Nearby, Airport, Stop, Square
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 589
strange странный (stránnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1543
Strange, Funny, Wonderful, Terrible, Excellent
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1543
strawberries клубника (klubníka)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 691
strength сила (síla)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1339
strict строгий (strógiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1369
strong сильный (sílnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 959
Suburban train, Motorbike, Lorry, Petrol, Petrol station
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1073
such, like this такой (takóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559
sugar сахар (sákhar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 347
Sugar, Honey, Rice, Mushrooms and a Glass
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 347
summer лето (léto)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 493

Sunday воскресенье (voskresénye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 493
Sunday and the Four Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 493
sunset закат (zakát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 965
Surname, Age, Number, Message, Conversation
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1603
sweet (taste) сладкий (sládkiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1013
swimming плавание (plávaniye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1585

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Table, Chair, Bed, Lamp, Key
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 359
Tablet, Screen, Keyboard, Printer, Remote control
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1393
Taking, Asking, Helping, Loving
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 63
tall, high высокий (vysókiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1531
tasty вкусный (vkúsnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1013
tea — masculine, regular this time, and the overland twin of кофе's sea route чай (chai)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 71
tears слёзы (slyózy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1273
Television, Computer, Fridge, Cooker, Shower
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 631
ten — the word behind decimal, and the one nine copied десять (désyat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 24, p. 215
tennis теннис (ténnis)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1585
terrible ужасный (uzhásnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1543
thank you (spasíbo) спасибо (spasíbo)
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that (feminine) та (ta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559

that (masculine) тот (tot)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559
that means, so значит (znáchit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1181
the back спина (spiná)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 251
the bathroom ванная (vánnaya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 50, p. 365
the belly живот (zhivót)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 239
the centre центр (tsentr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 977
the chest грудь (grud)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 783
, — the comma, and the rule with no exceptions
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar; Chapter 19, p. 175
— the dash that stands where the verb would have been
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar; Chapter 18, p. 167
the day after tomorrow послезавтра (poslezávtra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 571
the day before yesterday позавчера (pozavcherá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 84, p. 571
the earth; land земля (zemlyá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1055
the east восток (vostók)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 607
the evening вечер (vécher)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 68, p. 475
the face лицо (litsó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 251
the head голова (golová)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 29, p. 239
The Letter Yo
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 555
The Letters Shcha and E
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 625
the lungs лёгкие (lyógkiye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1151
the moon луна (luná)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 415
the neck шея (shéya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 30, p. 245
the north север (séver)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 607

the outskirts окраина (okráina)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 977
the same, identical одинаковый (odinákovyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1381
The same writing, with a clock
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 259, p. 1625
the sea море (móre)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 403
the sky небо (nébo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 415
The Small Ya
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 235
the south юг (yug)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 90, p. 607
the sun солнце (sólntse)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 415
. ? ! — the three marks that close a Russian sentence
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar; Chapter 17, p. 159
the tongue; a language язык (yazýk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 31, p. 251
the truth правда (právda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1085
The Two Letters You Already Knew, and Six You Did Not
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 137
the underground метро (metró)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613
The Verb That Takes Another Verb
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 183
the weather погода (pogóda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 421
the weekend выходные (vykhodnýye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 85, p. 577
the west запад (západ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613
the wind ветер (véter)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 421
The Words That Ask, and the Word That Points Back
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 199
the world; peace мир (mir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 59, p. 421
there там (tam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 499
thin худой (khudóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 849

Thing, Object, Furniture, Armchair, Chest of drawers
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1025
thirst жажда (zházhda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 33, p. 263
this (feminine) эта (éta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559
this (masculine) этот (étot)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559
This, This, That, That, Such
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 559
three — three letters, and three of them shared with English три (tri)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 209
thunder гром (grom)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 801
Thunderstorm, Ice, Hill, Rock, Wave
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 759
Thursday четверг (chetvérg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 487
tights колготки (kolgótki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1043
time время (vrémya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 481
tired усталый (ustályy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 959
tiredness усталость (ustálost)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 269
to advise советовать (sovétovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1115
To advise, To describe, To repeat, To translate, To remember
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1115
to answer отвечать (otvechát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 311
to apologise извиняться (izvinyátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 917
to argue спорить (spórit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1133
to ask a question — the verb behind the question you have asked since Chapter 2 спрашивать (spráshivat')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 5, p. 63
to be a student, to study учиться (uchítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1303

to be able, can — the verb the book has been printing inside помогать without ever owning it мочь (moch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 183
to be afraid бояться (boyátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 935
To be afraid, To please, To hate, To praise, To scold
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 935
to be — and the one tense in which Russian refuses to say it быть (byt')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
to be angry сердиться (serdítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1483
to be beaten, to lose (a game) проигрывать (proígryvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 941
to be ill; to ache болеть (bolét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1315
To be ill, To treat, To breathe, To cough, To sneeze
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1315
to be late опаздывать (opázdyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to be silent молчать (molchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1483
to begin начинать (nachinát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 855
To begin, To visit, To put, To believe, To drive
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 855
to believe верить (vérit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 855
to boil, to cook варить (varít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1109
to book, to reserve бронировать (bronírovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 947
To book, To turn, To cross, To stop, To park
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 947
to borrow; to take up (space) занимать (zanimát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1465
to break ломать (lomát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1309
to breathe дышать (dyshát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1315
to bring приносить (prinosít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to build строить (stróit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1309

to buy покупать (pokupát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 299
To carry, To hold, To throw, To catch, To push
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 923
to carry; to wear носить (nosít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 923
to catch ловить (lovít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 923
to change менять (menyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to check проверять (proveryát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1489
to choose выбирать (vybirát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to clean, to peel чистить (chístit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1309
to close закрывать (zakryvát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 317
To come back, To be late, To hurry, To rest, To get tired
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to come back, to return возвращаться (vozvrashchátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to come, to arrive приходить (prikhodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 929
to compare сравнивать (srávnivat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1489
to cook, to prepare готовить (gotóvit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 299
to cost стоить (stóit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1297
to cough кашлять (káshlyat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1315
to count; to consider считать (schitát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1489
To count, To measure, To compare, To check, To fill in
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1489
to cross пересекать (peresekát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 947
to cry плакать (plákat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 293
to cut резать (rézat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1109
to dance танцевать (tantsevát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 293

To decide, To choose, To change, To show, To bring
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to decide; to solve решать (reshát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to describe описывать (opísyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1115
to die умирать (umirát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1495
To die, To knock, To renovate, To move, To earn
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1495
to do the laundry, to wash (clothes) стирать (stirát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 911
to download скачивать (skáchivat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 941
to draw рисовать (risovát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 879
to drink пить (pit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 317
to drive водить (vodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 855
to earn зарабатывать (zarabátyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1495
to fall падать (pádat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 861
to feed кормить (kormít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1477
to feel чувствовать (chúvstvovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1321
To feel, To notice, To hear, To sniff, To touch
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1321
to fill in заполнять (zapolnyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1489
to find находить (nakhodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 873
to fly летать (letát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 929
To fly, To ride, To walk, To come, To leave
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 929
to forget забывать (zabyvát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1303
To forget, To be a student, To study, To teach, To hand in
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1303
to fry жарить (zhárit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1109

to gather, to collect собирать (sobirát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1327
to get acquainted знакомиться (znakómitsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 917
to get dressed одеваться (odevátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 861
To get dressed, To wash, To get up, To sit down, To fall
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 861
to get married (of a man) жениться (zhenítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1327
to get tired уставать (ustavát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to get up вставать (vstavát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 861
to give давать (davát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 311
to go down спускаться (spuskátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 867
to go for a ride, to skate кататься (katátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1139
to go for a walk гулять (gulyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 873
to go — the one-way verb, and a past tense from a different root entirely идти (idtí)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
to go up подниматься (podnimátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 867
To go up, To go down, To stay, To rent, To repair
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 867
to grow расти (rastí)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1477
to hand in; to take (an exam) сдавать (sdavát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1303
to happen случиться (sluchítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 893
to hate ненавидеть (nenavídet)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 935
to have breakfast завтракать (závtrakat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 911
to have dinner ужинать (úzhinat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 911
to have lunch обедать (obédat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 911

To have lunch, To have breakfast, To have dinner, To do the laundry, To iron
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 911
to hear слышать (slýshat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1321
to help — built on can, which is English may and might помогать (pomogát')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to here, this way сюда (syudá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1175
to hold держать (derzhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 923
to hope надеяться (nadéyatsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 899
to hug обнимать (obnimát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1133
To hug, To kiss, To argue, To quarrel, To make up
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1133
to hurry спешить (speshít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to invite приглашать (priglashát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 917
to iron; to stroke гладить (gládit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 911
to joke шутить (shutít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1327
to jump прыгать (prýgat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1139
to keep; to save (a file) сохранять (sokhranyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 941
to kiss целовать (tselovát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1133
to knock стучать (stuchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1495
to know — the same root as English know, and the sentence you will use most знать (znat')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
to laugh смеяться (smeyátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 293
to learn; to teach учить (uchít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 311
to leave, to go away уходить (ukhodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 929

to lift, to raise поднимать (podnimát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1121
to light, to set alight зажигать (zazhigát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1121
to listen слушать (slúshat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 311
to live — and the English word that used to mean 'alive' жить (zhit')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
to look for искать (iskát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 873
to look, to watch смотреть (smotrét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 879
to lose терять (teryát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 879
To lose, To win, To look, To draw, To travel
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 879
to love, and to like — English love itself, with a letter that appears from nowhere любить (lyubít')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to make up (after a quarrel) мириться (mirítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1133
to measure измерять (izmeryát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1489
to meet встречать (vstrechát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 917
To meet, To get acquainted, To invite, To thank, To apologise
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 917
to move (house) переезжать (pereyezzhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1495
to notice замечать (zamechát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1321
(to) nowhere никуда (nikudá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 887
to open открывать (otkryvát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 317
to order (food, goods) заказывать (zakázyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1297
to paint, to dye красить (krásit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1309
to park парковать (parkovát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 947
to pay платить (platít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1297

to photograph фотографировать (fotografírovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1327
To photograph, To gather, To promise, To joke, To get married
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1327
to plan планировать (planírovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 899
to plant сажать (sazhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1477
to play играть (igrát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 305
to please, to be liked нравиться (nrávitsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 935
to pour наливать (nalivát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1109
to praise хвалить (khvalít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 935
to print, to type печатать (pechátat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 941
to promise обещать (obeshchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1327
to pull тянуть (tyanút)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1121
To pull, To lift, To switch on, To switch off, To light
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1121
to push толкать (tolkát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 923
to put (flat) класть (klast)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 855
to put out гасить (gasít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1309
To put out, To build, To break, To paint, To clean
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1309
to quarrel ссориться (ssóritsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1133
to read — and why Russian has no separate way to say I am reading читать (chitát')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 55
to receive, to get получать (poluchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1465
to remember помнить (pómnit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1115
to renovate, to repair ремонтировать (remontírovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1495

to rent; to take off снимать (snimát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 867
to repair чинить (chinít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 867
to repeat повторять (povtoryát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1115
to rest отдыхать (otdykhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1127
to ride, to go (by transport) ездить (yézdit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 929
to ring, to phone звонить (zvonít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1465
to run бежать (bezhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 305
to run about, to jog бегать (bégat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1139
to save up копить (kopít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1465
To save up, To borrow, To ring, To send, To receive
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1465
to scold ругать (rugát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 935
to see — the root behind both vision and wisdom видеть (vídet')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
to sell продавать (prodavát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 299
to send отправлять (otpravlyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1465
to sew шить (shit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1109
To sew, To cut, To boil, To fry, To pour
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1109
to shout кричать (krichát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1483
To shout, To whisper, To be silent, To smile, To be angry
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1483
to show показывать (pokázyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1471
to sign подписывать (podpísyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 941
To sign, To print, To keep, To download, To be beaten
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 941
to sing петь (pet)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 293

to sit сидеть (sidét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 305
to sit down садиться (sadítsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 861
to sleep спать (spat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 305
to smile улыбаться (ulybátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1483
to sneeze чихать (chikhát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1315
to sniff, to smell нюхать (nyúkhat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1321
to speak — one new letter, and a false friend worth killing early говорить (govorít')
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 3, p. 43
to spend (money) тратить (trátit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1297
to stand стоять (stoyát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 305
to stay оставаться (ostavátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 867
to stop останавливаться (ostanávlivatsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 947
to study (a subject) изучать (izuchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1303
to sunbathe загорать (zagorát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1139
to sweep подметать (podmetát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1477
To sweep, To plant, To water, To grow, To feed
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1477
to swim плавать (plávat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 299
to switch off выключать (vyklyuchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1121
to switch on включать (vklyuchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1121
to take — English bear, and a partner from a completely different root брать (brat')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 63
to teach (a subject) преподавать (prepodavát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1303
to tell (a story) рассказывать (rasskázyvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 873

To tell, To go for a walk, To tidy up, To find, To look for
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 873
to thank благодарить (blagodarít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 917
to the left налево (nalévo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 583
to the right направо (napravo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 583
to there, that way туда (tudá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1175
to think — and the fact that shapes every Russian verb you will ever meet думать (dúmat')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 55
to throw бросать (brosát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 923
to tidy up убирать (ubirát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 873
to touch трогать (trógat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1321
to train, to practise тренироваться (trenirovátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1139
To train, To run about, To jump, To go for a ride, To sunbathe
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1139
to translate переводить (perevodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1115
to travel путешествовать (puteshéstvovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 879
to treat (an illness) лечить (lechít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1315
To try, To order, To pay, To cost, To spend
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1297
to try, to taste пробовать (próbovat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1297
to turn поворачивать (povoráchivat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 947
to understand — literally to take hold of, which is what comprehend means too понимать (ponimát')
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 55
to visit посещать (poseshchát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 855
to wait ждать (zhdat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 311
to walk, to go (on foot) ходить (khodít)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 929

to want — the verb this book has been able to describe everything except desire without хотеть (khatét)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 20, p. 183
to wash мыть (myt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 39, p. 299
to wash (oneself) умываться (umyvátsya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 861
to water поливать (polivát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1477
to whisper шептать (sheptát)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1483
to win выигрывать (vyígryvat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 879
to work работать (rabótat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 38, p. 293
to write — one new letter, and the one stress mistake you must not make писать (pisát')
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 55
today сегодня (sevódnya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 481
Today, Yesterday, Hour, Minute, Time
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 481
toothpaste зубная паста (zubnáya pásta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1387
Toothpaste, Razor, Iron, Vacuum cleaner, Oven
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1387
Towel, Soap, Toothbrush, Comb, Rubbish
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 643
Toy, Ball, Doll, Vase, Painting
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1399
traffic lights светофор (svetofór)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 601
trainers кроссовки (krossóvki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1043
transport транспорт (tránsport)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1591
Tree, Flower, Leaf, Grass, Village
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 397
trousers брюки (bryúki)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 103, p. 685
twelve двенадцать (dvenádtsat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517
Twenty, a Hundred, and the Number That Named a Family
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 221

twenty — two tens, with both halves still audible двадцать (dvádtsat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 25, p. 221
two — the second number in the book, twenty-two chapters after the first два (dva)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 23, p. 209

U

ugly некрасивый (nekrasívyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1531
unfortunately к сожалению (k sozhaléniyu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1363
up above, upstairs наверху (naverkhú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 72, p. 499
up, upwards вверх (vverkh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1357
useful полезный (poléznyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1199
Useful, Harmful, Necessary, Possible, Complicated
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1199
usually обычно (obýchno)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1513

V

vegetables овощи (óvoshchi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 104, p. 691
Verbs of the Mind and the Page
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 55
Violin, Drum, Dance, Novel, Poems
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1429

W

Wall, Roof, Garden, Bathroom, Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 365
warm тёплый (tyóplyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 463
Wash, Cook, Buy, Sell, Swim
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 299

Water, Coffee, Tea, and Bread
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 71
water — feminine, and the first noun in this book, so it also teaches how every Russian noun announces itself вода (vodá)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 6, p. 71
Watermelon, Plum, Pasta, Cake, Sweet
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1573
weak слабый (slábyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 959
Wedding, Bridegroom, Bride, Relative, Pensioner
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1079
Wednesday среда (sredá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 70, p. 487
weight вес (ves)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1507
Weight, Height, Eyebrow, Eyelash, Forehead
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1507
well-fed, full up сытый (sýtyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1019
West, Underground, Tram, Ship, Boat
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 613
wet мокрый (mókryy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 837
what for зачем (zachém)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 887
what's your name? — literally 'HOW do they call you?', not 'what' как вас зовут*?* (kak vas zovút)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 27
what — the question word, and the one Russian spells with a ч **and says with a sh** что (shto)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 18, p. 167
when — the fifth of the question family, and the one whose spelling and sound part company again когда (kagdá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 175
where где (gde)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 583
where from откуда (otkúda)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 583
where to куда (kudá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 86, p. 583
Where, Where to, Where from, To the right, To the left
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 583
Which One: the Ordinals, Said and Written
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 225

which, what kind of — the family member the book named two chapters before it taught it какой (kakóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 199
white белый (bélyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 445
White, Black, Red, Blue, Green
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 445
who, which, that — the word that hangs a whole clause onto a noun, and English 'whether' is its cousin который (katóryy)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 199
who — что's twin, and the one Russian says exactly as it is spelled кто (kto)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 199
Why, Because, When
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 175
why — literally 'after what', and the fourth member of the question family почему (pachemú)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 19, p. 175
Why plural вы became polite
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar, usage and culture; Chapter 2, p. 27
Why Russian asks *how*, not *what*
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 27
wide широкий (shirókiy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 843
wine вино (vinó)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1055
Wine glass, Bag, Box, Drawer, Light bulb
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1031
winter зима (zimá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 71, p. 493
wonderful прекрасный (prekrásnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1543
work, a job работа (rabóta)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 37, p. 287
Work, Sing, Dance, Laugh, Cry
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 293
Writing — Four Lines And The Comma You Cannot Hear
chapter topic; Chapter 260, p. 1627
Writing — My Own Line
chapter topic; Chapter 258, p. 1623
Writing — With A Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 259, p. 1625
wrong неправильный (neprávilnyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 128, p. 837

Wrong, Ready, Dangerous, Wet, Dry
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 837

Y

yellow жёлтый (zhyóltyy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 451
Yellow, Beautiful, Good, Bad, New
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 451
yes (da) да (da)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 1, p. 1
yesterday вчера (vcherá)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 69, p. 481
you (informal) and you (formal) — the split English threw away ты, вы (ty, vy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 27
young молодой (molodóy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1531
Young, Elderly, Tall, Low, Ugly
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1531
young people молодёжь (molodyózh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1267
Young people, Citizen, Foreigner, Tourist, Text
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1267
Your own line — the first writing with no model
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 258, p. 1623

Z

zero ноль (nol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517

Other

а — a true friend, and the sound Russian keeps landing on
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
б and д — letters that hide nothing
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1
в and р — writing the two great false friends
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1
г — a corner, and a hard g
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137

(говорить, continued) — The word, taken apart — and a false friend
etymology topic; explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 3, p. 43
е and т — the last two letters of привет
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
ё (yo) — the yo inside ребёнок
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 81, p. 555
ж — the beetle
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
з — a letter shaped like the digit 3
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
и between two sentences — the book's first long sentence
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 16, p. 151
й — и in a hat
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
к — a true friend
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
когда as a hinge — two things happening at once
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 19, p. 175
л — a new shape
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
ли — the small word that has been hiding inside или
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 22, p. 199
м — a true friend, and its capital
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
ни ... ни ... — refusing both halves at once
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 16, p. 151
о — the letter that is not always itself
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, usage and culture; Chapter 15, p. 137
п and и — filling in привет
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 1, p. 1
привет — look, hide, write, compare
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
привет — one supported copy
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
с and н — the last two false friends
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 1, p. 1
у — the letter that looks like Latin y and says 'oo'
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
ф — a circle on a stick
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
х — an x that is not an x
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
ц — one letter for two sounds
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137

ч — one letter for a sound English spells with two
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
что as a hinge — one word carrying a whole sentence
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 167
чтобы — "in order to," which is что wearing a wish
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 183
ш — the comb
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
щ (shcha) — the shch inside площадь
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 93, p. 625
ы — the vowel English has no name for
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
ь — a letter that makes no sound of its own
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
э (e) — the e that opens этот
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 93, p. 625
ю — a syllable in one letter, again
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 15, p. 137
Я — one letter that is a whole syllable
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 14, p. 121
я (ya) — the word for I, written small
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 28, p. 235
я думаю, что ... — saying that an opinion is yours
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 167
я не знаю, что ... — admitting it, in a whole sentence
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 167
я хочу читать — two verbs in a row, and no word between them
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 20, p. 183